

Algebra, Geometry and Number Theory

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Chapter 1

Introduction

The main purposes of these notes is to provide a detailed expositions of Galois Theory, Algebraic Number Theory, Algebraic Varieties over non-algebraically closed fields and Schemes, with particular interest in the Weil Conjectures. As such the section on Algebra, whilst broad, doesn't have huge depth, and often straightforward results are stated without proof. I have also tried to be rather explicit in dependence on earlier results, so much use is made of linked references. The section on Algebra largely follows Lang but with some I hope minor improvements in the exposition (e.g. Separability).

For the section on Algebraic Geometry I've tried to simultaneously develop the somewhat "elementary" approach (e.g. Hartshorne I, Kempf, JMilne) alongside the more technically challenging schemes approach (Stacks, Hartshorne II-III, Liu, EGA I) in order to motivate the constructions. I've also tried to adapt the elementary approach to work over non-algebraically closed fields so that it lends itself to talking about the Weil Conjectures at an early stage.

Finally I've included a very small amount of category theory, as it of course a useful language to talk about "universal properties" and helps frame some of the more technical results around schemes.

Some references I found useful

Set Theory, Lattices

- Naive Set Theory - Halmos [[Hal17](#)]
- Lattice Theory - Birkhoff [[Bir40](#)]

Algebra

- Algebra - Serge Lang [[Lan11](#)]
- Field Theory - Roman [[Rom05](#)]
- Introduction to Commutative Algebra - Atiyah, MacDonald [[AM69](#)]
- Local Rings - Nagata [[Nag75](#)]
- Commutative Algebra II - Zariski-Samuel [[ZS76](#)]

Algebraic Geometry

- Algebraic Geometry - Robin Hartshorne [[Har13](#)]
- Algebraic Geometry - J.S. Milne [[Mil17](#)]
- Basic Algebraic Geometry - Shafarevich [[Sha94](#)]
- Introduction to Algebraic Geometry - Serge Lang [[Lan19](#)]
- Elements of Algebraic Geometry (EGA) - Alexander Grothendieck

Analysis and Geometry

- General Topology - Kelley [[Kel71](#)]
- Foundations of Modern Analysis - Dieudonne [[Die11](#)]
- Real and Functional Analysis - Serge Lang [[Lan12](#)]
- Differential Calculus - Henri Cartan [[Car67](#)]

Chapter 2

Foundations

2.1 Set Theory

2.1.1 Relations

Definition 2.1.1 (Binary Relation)

A **binary relation** (or just **relation**) R on a pair of sets (X, Y) is subset of the cartesian product $X \times Y$.

We write xRy to mean precisely $(x, y) \in R$.

Definition 2.1.2 (Converse Relation)

Let R be a binary relation on (X, Y) then we the converse relation R^T on (Y, X) given by

$$yR^Tx \iff xRy$$

Definition 2.1.3 (Domain and Range)

Let R be a relation on (X, Y) . We define the **domain** of R to be

$$\text{dom}(R) := \{x \in X \mid \exists y \in Y \text{ s.t. } xRy\}$$

and the **range** of R

$$\text{range}(R) := \{y \in Y \mid \exists x \in X \text{ s.t. } xRy\}$$

Definition 2.1.4 (Equivalence Relation)

Let R be a binary relation on (X, X) . It is said to be

- a) **reflexive** if xRx for all $x \in X$
- b) **symmetric** if $xRy \implies yRx$ for all $x, y \in X$
- c) **transitive** if $xRy \wedge yRz \implies xRz$ for all $x, y, z \in X$

A relation which satisfies all these properties is called an **equivalence relation** on X . In this case we would write

$$x \sim y$$

instead of xRy . For an element $x \in X$ denote the **equivalence class** of x by

$$[x]_R = \{y \mid xRy\}$$

Note that $R^T = R$.

Definition 2.1.5 (Partition)

Let X be a set and $\mathcal{F}$ a family of subsets of X . It is said to be a **partition** if

- a) $X = \bigcup_{A \in \mathcal{F}} A$
- b) $A, B \in \mathcal{F} \implies A = B \text{ or } A \cap B = \emptyset$

Proposition 2.1.6 (Equivalence Classes form a Partition)

Let E be an equivalence relation on X . The family

$$\mathcal{F} = \{[x]_E \mid x \in X\}$$

forms a partition of X . Denote by X/E the family of equivalence classes, called the **quotient** of X with respect to E .

Proof. It's clear that

$$X = \bigcup_{A \in \mathcal{F}} A$$

because by reflexive-ness $x \in [x]_E$ for all $x \in X$.

We claim that for any $z \in [x]_E$ we have $[z]_E = [x]_E$. Suppose $y \in [x]_E$ then xRz and xRy . By symmetry and transitivity we then have zRy which implies $y \in [z]_E$. In other words $[x]_E \subseteq [z]_E$. By symmetry of R we have $x \in [z]_E$, so by the same token $[z]_E \subseteq [x]_E$, which shows they are equal.

Therefore it's clear that $[x]_E \cap [y]_E \neq \emptyset \implies [x]_E = [y]_E$ and thus $\mathcal{F}$ forms a partition. $\square$

Definition 2.1.7 (Composition of Relation)

Suppose R is a relation on (X, Y) and S a relation on (Y, Z) . We define the composition $S \circ R$ on (X, Z)

$$S \circ R = \{(x, z) \mid \exists y \in Y \text{ s.t. } xRy \text{ and } yRz\}$$

2.1.2 Functions

Definition 2.1.8 (Function)

A **function** $f : X \rightarrow Y$ consists of a binary relation $\Gamma(f)$ on (X, Y) such that

- $\text{dom}(f) = X$
- $\Gamma(f)$ is **single-valued** that is $x\Gamma(f)y \wedge x\Gamma(f)y' \implies y = y'$

Equivalently for all $x \in X$ there exists precisely one $y \in Y$ such that $x\Gamma(f)y$.

We write $f(x) = y$ for the unique element $y \in Y$ such that $x\Gamma(f)y$.

Proposition 2.1.9 (Equality of Functions)

Two functions $f, g : X \rightarrow Y$ are equal if and only if $f(x) = g(x)$ for all $x \in X$.

Proposition 2.1.10 (Composition of Functions)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $g : Y \rightarrow Z$ be functions then the **composition** $\Gamma(g) \circ \Gamma(f)$ is still a function, which we write $g \circ f$, and

$$(g \circ f)(x) = g(f(x))$$

Furthermore composition is **associative** in the sense that

$$(h \circ g) \circ f = h \circ (g \circ f)$$

Definition 2.1.11 (Injective, Surjective and Bijective)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a function then we say

- f is **injective** if $f(x) = f(x') \implies x = x'$
- f is **surjective** if for all $y \in Y$ there exists x such that $f(x) = y$
- f is **bijective** if it is both injective and surjective

Definition 2.1.12 (Inverse Function)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $g : Y \rightarrow X$ be functions. We say

- g is a **left inverse** for f if $g \circ f = 1_X$
- g is a **right inverse** for f if $f \circ g = 1_Y$
- g is a **two-sided inverse** for f if it is both a left and right inverse

Proposition 2.1.13

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a function then

- f is **injective** if and only if it has a **left inverse**
- f is **surjective** if and only if it has a **right inverse**
- f is **bijective** if and only if it has a **two-sided inverse**

Definition 2.1.14 (Idempotent Function)

A function $p : X \rightarrow X$ is **idempotent** $p \circ p = p$.

Lemma 2.1.15 (Idempotent Criterion)

Let $p : X \rightarrow X$ be a function. Then $\text{Fix}(p) \subseteq \text{Im}(p)$ and these are equal if and only if p is idempotent.

2.1.3 Partial Orders

Definition 2.1.16 (Poset)

A binary relation $\leq$ on (X, X) is a **partial order** if

- **reflexivity** $x \leq x$
- **antisymmetry** $x \leq y$ and $y \leq x \implies y = x$
- **transitivity** $x \leq y$ and $y \leq z \implies x \leq z$

We may refer to $(X, \leq)$ as a **partially ordered set** or **poset**.

Definition 2.1.17 (Dual Poset)

Given a poset $(X, \leq)$ denote the set X with the converse relation by $(X, \leq^d)$. This is the **dual poset** to $(X, \leq)$.

Example 2.1.18

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a family of subsets of a fixed set E . Then $(\mathcal{F}, \subseteq)$ is a poset ordered under inclusion.

Definition 2.1.19 (Top and Bottom)

Let $(X, \leq)$ we say $\top$ (resp. $\perp$) is a **top element** (resp. **bottom element**) if it is greater than (resp. less than) every element of x . In this case it is unique.

Definition 2.1.20 (Monotone/Antitone Function)

Let $(X, \leq)$ and $(Y, \leq)$ be posets. A function $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is

- **monotone / order-preserving** if $x \leq y \implies f(x) \leq f(y)$
- **antitone / order-reversing** if $x \leq y \implies f(y) \leq f(x)$
- a **monotone embedding** if $x \leq y \iff f(x) \leq f(y)$
- an **order isomorphism** if it is bijective and monotone
- a **dual isomorphism** if it is bijective and antitone

Proposition 2.1.21

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a monotone function. Then it is an embedding if and only if it is injective.

In what follows the notion of closure and kernel operator will be important.

Definition 2.1.22 (Closure operator)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a partially ordered set. A function $c : X \rightarrow X$ is a **closure operator** if it is

- a) **extensive** $x \leq c(x)$
- b) **monotone** $x \leq y \implies c(x) \leq c(y)$
- c) **idempotent** $c(c(x)) = c(x)$

Definition 2.1.23 (Kernel operator)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a partially ordered set. A function $\kappa : X \rightarrow X$ is a **kernel operator** if it is

- **co-extensive** $\kappa(x) \leq x$
- **monotone** $x \leq y \implies \kappa(x) \leq \kappa(y)$
- **idempotent** $\kappa(\kappa(x)) = \kappa(x)$

Note these definitions are “dual” with respect to the ordering on X .

2.1.4 Lattices

Certain families of subsets of algebraic structures (e.g. ideals, subgroups, normal subgroups, submodules) form a “sublattice” of the power set. Certain operations on, and results about, these subsets share common features regardless of the type of algebraic structure. Therefore we detail some elements of “Lattice Theory” (see Birkhoff) which may clarify the exposition.

Definition 2.1.24 (Upper and Lower Bounds)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a poset and $S \subseteq X$. Define the set of **upper bounds** for S by

$$S^\uparrow = \{x \in X \mid s \leq x \quad \forall s \in S\}$$

and the set of **lower bounds** for S by

$$S^\downarrow = \{x \in X \mid x \leq s \quad \forall s \in S\}$$

Note by convention $\emptyset^\uparrow = \emptyset^\downarrow = X$. Furthermore

$$X^\uparrow = \begin{cases} \{\top\} & X \text{ has a top element} \\ \emptyset & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

and

$$X^\downarrow = \begin{cases} \{\perp\} & X \text{ has a bottom element} \\ \emptyset & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Lemma 2.1.25 (Upper/Lower bounds are antitone maps)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a poset and S, T subsets of X then

- **antitone** $S \subseteq T \implies T^\uparrow \subseteq S^\uparrow$ and $T^\downarrow \subseteq S^\downarrow$
- **unit-counit relations** $S \subseteq S^{\uparrow\downarrow}$ and $T \subseteq T^{\downarrow\uparrow}$
- **triangular identities** $S^\uparrow = S^{\uparrow\downarrow\uparrow}$ and $T^\downarrow = T^{\downarrow\uparrow\downarrow}$

Proof. We prove only the first triangular identity as the others are straightforward consequences of the definitions. Firstly $S \subseteq S^{\uparrow\downarrow} \implies S^{\uparrow\downarrow\uparrow} \subseteq S^\uparrow$ by the antitone property. Given the relation $T \subseteq T^{\downarrow\uparrow}$ substitute $T = S^\uparrow$ to get the reverse inclusion. $\square$

Lemma 2.1.26

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a poset and S, T subsets of X . Then the intersections $S \cap S^\uparrow$ and $T \cap T^\downarrow$ contain at most one element. **When they exist** write the elements as $\top_S$ and $\perp_T$ respectively, and are referred to as the **maximum** and **minimum** elements respectively.

Proof. Given $x, y \in S \cap S^\uparrow$ then by definition $x \leq y$ and $y \leq x$. By anti-symmetry we have $x = y$ as required. $\square$

Definition 2.1.27 (Supremum and Infimum)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a poset and $S \subseteq X$ a subset. We say a **supremum** of S is the minimal upper bound, i.e. the unique element of

$$S^\uparrow \cap S^{\uparrow\downarrow}$$

when it exists and write this as $\sup S$. Similarly an **infimum** of S is the maximal lower bound, i.e. the unique element of

$$S^\downarrow \cap S^{\downarrow\uparrow}$$

when it exists and write this as $\inf S$.

Lemma 2.1.28 (Maximum = Supremum)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a poset and $S \subseteq X$ a subset. Then $\top_S$ exists if and only if $\sup S$ exists and is a member of S . In this case $\top_S = \sup S$.

Lemma 2.1.29

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a poset. Then $\{\sup S\}^\uparrow = S^\uparrow$ and $\{\inf T\}^\downarrow = T^\downarrow$ when these exist.

Lemma 2.1.30 (Sup is monotone and Inf is antitone)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a poset and S, T subsets of X . Then $S \subseteq T \implies \sup S \leq \sup T$ and $\inf T \leq \inf S$ when these exist.

Proof. Note $S \subseteq T \implies T^\uparrow \subseteq S^\uparrow$ so $\sup T \in S^\uparrow$. By definition $\sup S \in S^{\uparrow\downarrow}$ therefore $\sup S \leq \sup T$.

Similarly $S \subseteq T \implies T^\downarrow \subseteq S^\downarrow$. By definition $\inf T \in T^\downarrow \implies \inf T \in S^\downarrow$. By definition $\inf S \in S^{\downarrow\uparrow}$ therefore $\inf T \leq \inf S$. $\square$

Remark 2.1.31

Note that $\emptyset^\uparrow = X$ and therefore $\sup \emptyset = \perp$ when it exists. Similarly $\inf \emptyset = \top$ when it exists.

When $\top$ exists $\sup X = \top$, otherwise it is not defined. Similarly when $\perp$ exists $\inf X = \perp$, otherwise it is not defined.

Definition 2.1.32 (Lattice)

A poset $(X, \leq)$ is a **lattice** if every pair of elements x, y admits both a supremum and infimum. In this case we write

$$a \vee b := \sup\{a, b\}$$

and

$$a \wedge b := \inf\{a, b\}$$

These are called the **join** and **meet** operations. A subset Y is called a **sub-lattice** if

$$a, b \in Y \implies a \wedge b \in Y \text{ and } a \vee b \in Y.$$

Similarly it is a **complete lattice** if every subset S admits both a supremum and infimum. This is written

$$\bigvee S := \sup S$$

and

$$\bigwedge S := \inf S$$

Note a complete lattice has both a top and a bottom element (by considering $\sup \emptyset$ and $\inf \emptyset$), and a lattice admits **finite** joins and meets.

Trivially

$$\bigwedge \{x\} = \bigvee \{x\} = x$$

Example 2.1.33 (Power Set)

For a fixed set E the collection of subsets $\mathcal{P}(E)$ is a complete lattice under the union and intersection operator **with the convention that empty intersection is the whole set and empty union is the empty set**

In this case $\top = E$ and $\perp = \emptyset$.

Proposition 2.1.34 (Principal down-sets are lattices)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a lattice and $x, y \in X$. Then the subsets $\{x\}^\uparrow$, $\{x\}^\downarrow$ and $\{x\}^\uparrow \cap \{y\}^\downarrow$ are sub-lattices.

Verifying a poset is a lattice is slightly easier than it may first appear.

Lemma 2.1.35 (Supremum is Infimum of upper bounds)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a poset and S a subset of X . Then

$$\sup S = \inf S^\uparrow$$

when either exists. Dually

$$\inf S = \sup S^\downarrow$$

Proof. By definition $\sup S$ is the unique element of $S^\uparrow \cap S^{\uparrow\downarrow}$ and $\inf S^\uparrow$ is the unique element of $S^{\uparrow\downarrow} \cap S^{\uparrow\downarrow\uparrow}$. By (2.1.25) $S^{\uparrow\downarrow\uparrow} = S^\uparrow$ so they are equivalent. $\square$

Proposition 2.1.36 (Criteria to be a Complete Lattice)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a poset. Then the following are equivalent

- a) X is a complete lattice
- b) X admits arbitrary infimums (and in particular has $\top = \inf \emptyset$)
- c) X admits arbitrary supremums (and in particular has $\perp = \sup \emptyset$)

In this case we have the relationships

$$\begin{aligned}\bigvee S &= \bigwedge S^\uparrow \\ \bigwedge S &= \bigvee S^\downarrow\end{aligned}$$

Proof. 1 $\implies$ 2,3 is clear.

2,3 $\implies$ 1 follows from the previous Lemma. $\square$

Lemma 2.1.37

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a poset and $(Y, \leq)$ a sub-poset. Let $S \subseteq Y$ be a subset. Then $\inf_Y S$ exists if and only if $\inf_X S$ exists and belongs to Y . In this case they are equal.

Proof. Note in general that $T^{\downarrow, Y} = T^{\downarrow, X} \cap Y$ and $T^{\uparrow, Y} = T^{\uparrow, X} \cap Y$. Therefore

$$S^{\downarrow, Y} \cap S^{\uparrow, Y} = S^{\downarrow, X} \cap S^{\uparrow, X} \cap Y$$

Recall $\inf S$ is the unique element of $S^\downarrow \cap S^\uparrow$ if it exists. Then the result follows easily. $\square$

Definition 2.1.38 (Moore Family)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a complete lattice. A sub-poset $(Y, \leq)$ is a **Moore family** over X if it satisfies the following property

$$S \subseteq Y \implies \bigwedge_X S \in Y$$

In particular this includes the case $S = \emptyset$ and so $\top \in Y$.

Example 2.1.39 (Moore family of sets)

Given a fixed set E , then $\mathcal{P}(E)$ is a complete lattice ordered under inclusion. Then a family of subsets $\mathcal{F}$ is a Moore family precisely when

- $E \in \mathcal{F}$
- $A_{i \in I} \in \mathcal{F} \implies \bigcap_{i \in I} A_i \in \mathcal{F}$

Proposition 2.1.40 (Equivalent Formulations of Complete Sub-lattice)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a complete lattice and $(Y, \leq)$ a sub-poset. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $(Y, \leq)$ is a Moore family
- b) $(Y, \leq)$ is a complete lattice
- c) Y is the image of some closure operator $c : X \rightarrow X$

In this case the closure operator is given by

$$c(x) = \bigwedge_X \{y \in Y \mid x \leq y\}$$

For $S \subseteq Y$

$$\begin{aligned}\bigwedge_Y S &= \bigwedge_X S \\ \bigvee_Y S &= c\left(\bigvee_X S\right)\end{aligned}$$

and for $S \subseteq X$ we have

$$c\left(\bigvee_X S\right) = \bigwedge_X (S^\uparrow \cap Y)$$

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) By (2.1.37) $S \subseteq Y \implies \bigwedge_Y S = \bigwedge_X S$. By (2.1.36) then Y is a complete lattice.

b) $\implies$ c) Suppose that $(Y, \leq)$ is a complete lattice then define the function $c : X \rightarrow X$ by $c(x) = \bigwedge_X \Gamma_x$ where $\Gamma_x = \{y \in Y \mid x \leq y\}$. We need to show that it is a closure operator. Evidently $x \in \Gamma_x^\perp$ and $c(x) \in \Gamma_x^{\perp\uparrow}$ by definition of infimum. Therefore $x \leq c(x)$ and c is extensive. Note $x \leq y \implies \Gamma_y \subseteq \Gamma_x$. By (2.1.30) we have $\inf \Gamma_x \leq \inf \Gamma_y$, whence $c(x) \leq c(y)$ and c is monotone.

Y is a complete lattice, so by (2.1.37) we have $c(x) \in Y$ so that $\text{Im}(c) \subseteq Y$. We claim that $x \in Y \implies c(x) = x$. In this case $x \in \Gamma_x$ and $c(x) \in \Gamma_x^\perp$ whence $c(x) \leq x$ and therefore $x = c(x)$ as required. Therefore $Y \subseteq \text{Fix}(c) \subseteq \text{Im}(c) \subseteq Y$, whence $Y = \text{Im}(c) = \text{Fix}(c)$ and c is idempotent by (2.1.15). As c is extensive, monotone and idempotent it is by definition a closure operator.

c) $\implies$ a) In order for $Y := \text{Im}(c)$ to be a Moore family, we need to show $S \subseteq Y \implies \bigwedge_X S \in Y$. We claim that by properties of c we have

$$S \subseteq Y \implies c(S^\perp) \subseteq S^\perp$$

$$T \subseteq X \implies c(T^\uparrow) \subseteq T^\uparrow$$

Therefore c maps the singleton set $S^\perp \cap S^{\perp\uparrow} = \{\bigwedge_X S\}$ to itself. In otherwords $\bigwedge_X S \in \text{Fix}(c) = \text{Im}(c) = Y$ as required.

Define $\Gamma_x := \{y \in Y \mid x \leq y\}$. We wish to show that $c(x) = \bigwedge_X \Gamma_x$. As $x \leq c(x)$ we have $c(x) \in \Gamma_x$. Furthermore $y \in \Gamma_x \implies c(x) \leq c(y) = y$. So $c(x) \in \Gamma_x^\perp$. Therefore $c(x) = \perp_{\Gamma_x} = \bigwedge_X \Gamma_x$ as required.

Finally by (2.1.29) $\{\bigvee_X S\}^\uparrow = S^\uparrow$ for any $S \subseteq X$. Therefore, as $c(x) = \bigwedge_X \Gamma_x$ we find

$$c\left(\bigvee_X S\right) = \bigwedge_X \left(\left\{ \bigvee_X S \right\}^\uparrow \cap Y \right) = \bigwedge_X (S^\uparrow \cap Y)$$

as required. In particular when $S \subseteq Y$ we find by (2.1.40)

$$\bigvee_Y S = \bigwedge_Y S^{\uparrow,Y} = \bigwedge_X S^{\uparrow,Y} = \bigwedge_X (S^\uparrow \cap Y) = c\left(\bigvee_X S\right) \quad (2.1)$$

□

Remark 2.1.41

For a given complete lattice $(X, \leq)$ we have established a correspondence between

$$\left\{ \text{closure operators } c : X \rightarrow X \right\} \longleftrightarrow \left\{ \text{complete sub-lattices } (Y, \leq) \right\}$$

Corollary 2.1.42 (Moore family admits a closure operator)

Let E be a fixed set and $\mathcal{F}$ a Moore family over $(\mathcal{P}(E), \subseteq)$. Then there exists a surjective closure operator $c : \mathcal{P}(E) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$ given by

$$c(F) = \bigcap_{F \subseteq E_\alpha \in \mathcal{F}} E_\alpha$$

Any such closure operator $c : \mathcal{P}(E) \rightarrow \mathcal{P}(E)$ gives rise to a Moore family $\mathcal{F} := \text{Im}(c)$.

Proposition 2.1.43 (Alternative expression for join)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a complete lattice and $c : X \rightarrow X$ a closure operator with image Y . Then for any subset $S \subset X$

$$c\left(\bigvee_X S\right) = c\left(\bigvee_X c(S)\right) = \bigvee_Y c(S) = \bigwedge_X (S^\uparrow \cap Y)$$

i.e. it's the smallest "closed" set containing each element of S .

Proof. By (2.1.40) the expression for $c(\bigvee_X S)$ yields

$$c(\bigvee_X c(S)) = \bigwedge_X (c(S)^\uparrow \cap Y) = \bigwedge_X (S^\uparrow \cap Y) = c(\bigvee_X S)$$

where the middle equality follows because if $y \in Y$ then $c(s) \leq y \iff s \leq y$. Furthermore $c(S) \subseteq Y$ so the expression for $\bigvee_Y$ yields

$$c(\bigvee_X c(S)) = \bigvee_Y c(S).$$

as required. □

2.1.5 Distributive Lattice

Proposition 2.1.44

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a *lattice* then the following relations hold

- a) $x \wedge (y \vee z) \geq (x \wedge y) \vee (x \wedge z)$
- b) $x \vee (y \wedge z) \leq (x \vee y) \wedge (x \vee z)$

Proof. a) By definition $x \wedge y \leq x$ and $x \wedge y \leq y \leq y \vee z$. Therefore $x \wedge y \leq x \wedge (y \vee z)$. By symmetry in y and z we have $x \wedge z \leq x \wedge (y \vee z)$. Whence $(x \wedge y) \vee (x \wedge z) \leq x \wedge (y \vee z)$ as required.

b) follows by duality □

Definition 2.1.45 (Distributive Lattice)

We say a *lattice* $(X, \leq)$ is **distributive** if it satisfies the following relations for all $x, y, z \in X$

- $x \wedge (y \vee z) = (x \wedge y) \vee (x \wedge z)$
- $x \vee (y \wedge z) = (x \vee y) \wedge (x \vee z)$

Proposition 2.1.46

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a *lattice* then TFAE

- a) $(X, \leq)$ is a *distributive lattice*
- b) $x \wedge (y \vee z) \leq (x \wedge y) \vee (x \wedge z)$
- c) $x \vee (y \wedge z) \geq (x \vee y) \wedge (x \vee z)$

Example 2.1.47

Any family of subsets closed under finite intersection and union is a distributive lattice.

2.1.6 Galois Connections

Definition 2.1.48 (Galois Connection)

Let $(X, \leq_X)$ and $(Y, \leq_Y)$ be posets. A pair of functions $(f_\star, f^\star)$

$$X \xrightleftharpoons[f_\star]{f^\star} Y$$

is called an **antitone Galois connection** if it satisfies the **adjoint property**

- $x \leq_X f^\star(y) \iff y \leq_Y f_\star(x) \quad \forall x \in X, y \in Y$

We say it is a **monotone Galois connection** if instead

- $x \leq_X f^\star(y) \iff f_\star(x) \leq_Y y \quad \forall x \in X, y \in Y$

We will assume that if not otherwise specified the connection is antitone.

Proposition 2.1.49 (Equivalent Condition for Galois Connection)

Let $(X, \leq_X)$ and $(Y, \leq_Y)$ be posets. Consider a pair of functions

$$X \xrightleftharpoons[f_*]{f^*} Y$$

Then this constitutes an **antitone Galois Connection** if and only if

- f_* and f^* are both antitone
- $x \leq_X f^*(f_*(x))$ and $y \leq_Y f_*(f^*(y))$ for all $x \in X, y \in Y$ (i.e. $f^* \circ f_*$ and $f_* \circ f^*$ are extensive)

Similarly it constitutes a **monotone Galois Connection** if and only if

- f_* and f^* are both monotone
- $x \leq_X f^*(f_*(x))$ and $f_*(f^*(y)) \leq_Y y$ for all $x \in X, y \in Y$

Proof. We consider only the antitone case, as the monotone follows from duality (flip $\leq_Y$).

Suppose that (f_*, f^*) satisfies the adjoint property

$$\begin{aligned} f_*(x) = f_*(x) &\implies f_*(x) \leq_Y f_*(x) \implies x \leq_X f^*(f_*(x)) \\ f^*(y) = f^*(y) &\implies f^*(y) \leq_Y f^*(y) \implies y \leq_Y f_*(f^*(y)) \end{aligned}$$

whence the extensive property follows. Furthermore

$$\begin{aligned} x \leq_X x' &\implies x \leq_X f^*(f_*(x')) \implies f_*(x') \leq_Y f_*(x) \\ y \leq_Y y' &\implies y \leq_Y f_*(f^*(y')) \implies f^*(y) \leq_X f^*(y') \end{aligned}$$

which shows that the functions f_* and f^* are antitone.

Conversely suppose they satisfy the given conditions. Then by the antitone and extensive properties in turn

$$x \leq_X f^*(y) \implies f_*(f^*(y)) \leq_Y f_*(x) \implies y \leq_Y f_*(x)$$

and

$$y \leq_Y f_*(x) \implies f^*(f_*(x)) \leq_X f^*(y) \implies x \leq_X f^*(y).$$

which is the adjoint property as required. □

Definition 2.1.50 (Closed sets)

Let (f_*, f^*) be a Galois connection. Then define the **closed sets** to be

$$\begin{aligned} X^* &:= f^*(Y) \\ Y^* &:= f_*(X) \end{aligned}$$

Proposition 2.1.51 (Isomorphism on closed sets)

Consider an antitone (resp. monotone) Galois connection $X \xrightleftharpoons[f_*]{f^*} Y$. Then it restricts to a **dual isomorphism** (resp. order isomorphism) on **closed sets**

$$X^* \xrightleftharpoons[f_*]{f^*} Y^*$$

Furthermore the following properties hold

- $f_* \circ f^* \circ f_* = f_*$
- $f^* \circ f_* \circ f^* = f^*$
- In the antitone case $f^* \circ f_*$ and $f_* \circ f^*$ are **closure operators**.
- In the monotone case $f^* \circ f_*$ is a closure operator and $f_* \circ f^*$ is a **kernel operator**.

- $X^\star = \text{Fix}(f^\star \circ f_\star) = \text{Im}(f^\star \circ f_\star)$
- $Y^\star = \text{Fix}(f_\star \circ f^\star) = \text{Im}(f_\star \circ f^\star)$

Proof. We detail the antitone case as the monotone case follows by duality. We first prove so-called triangular identities, for by the extensive property (2.1.49)

$$x \leq f^\star(f_\star(x)) \implies f_\star(f^\star(f_\star(x))) \leq f_\star(x)$$

and by the other extensive property

$$f_\star(x) \leq f_\star(f^\star(f_\star(x)))$$

whence they are equal. The other case is similar.

It's immediate that $f^\star \circ f_\star$ and $f_\star \circ f^\star$ are idempotent, and they are extensive by (2.1.49). And the composition of two antitone functions is monotone so $f^\star \circ f_\star$ and $f_\star \circ f^\star$ are closure operators.

Observe

$$\text{Im}(f^\star \circ f_\star) \subseteq \text{Im}(f^\star) \subseteq \text{Fix}(f^\star \circ f_\star)$$

where the first inclusion is trivial and the second inclusion follows from the second triangular identity. However both sides are equal by (2.1.15) and the expression for $X^\star$ follows. The expression for $Y^\star$ follows similarly.

This shows that the maps are mutual inverses as required. $\square$

In certain circumstances we may consider a smaller subset of X , by applying a suitable closure operator which is compatible with the Galois correspondence :

Proposition 2.1.52 (Subordinated Closure Operator)

Let $X \xrightleftharpoons[f_\star]{f^\star} Y$ be a Galois connection and $c : X \rightarrow X$ be a closure operator with image X_c . Then

$$c(x) \leq (f^\star \circ f_\star)(x) \quad \forall x \in X \iff \text{Im}(f^\star) \subseteq \text{Fix}(c) \iff X^\star \subseteq X_c$$

In this case

$$f_\star(c(x)) = f_\star(x)$$

Proof. Suppose $c(x) \leq (f^\star \circ f_\star)(x)$. Substitute $x = f^\star(y)$ then, because c is extensive,

$$f^\star(y) \leq c(f^\star(y)) \leq (f^\star \circ f_\star \circ f^\star)(y) = f^\star(y).$$

Therefore $c(f^\star(y)) = f^\star(y)$ and $\text{Im}(f^\star) \subseteq \text{Fix}(c)$ as required. Conversely suppose this holds, then by the monotone property of c and extensive property of $f^\star \circ f_\star$

$$x \leq (f^\star \circ f_\star)(x) \implies c(x) \leq c((f^\star \circ f_\star)(x)) = (f^\star \circ f_\star)(x).$$

as required. Finally by the extensive property of c

$$x \leq c(x) \leq (f^\star \circ f_\star)(x)$$

and by the antitone/monotone property of $f_\star$ and triangular identity

$$f_\star(x) \leq f_\star(c(x)) \leq f_\star(x)$$

whence $f_\star(c(x)) = f_\star(x)$ as required. $\square$

The meaning of the “adjoint” criterion can be explained by the following rather generic situation

Example 2.1.53 (Canonical example of an antitone Galois connection)

Suppose there is a predicate

$$\psi : X \times Y \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$$

Define a connection

$$\mathcal{P}(X) \xrightleftharpoons[f_*]{f^*} \mathcal{P}(Y)$$

by

$$\begin{aligned} f_*(S) &= \{y \in Y \mid \psi(x, y) = 1 \quad \forall x \in S\} \\ f^*(T) &= \{x \in X \mid \psi(x, y) = 1 \quad \forall y \in T\} \end{aligned}$$

Then

$$S \subseteq f^*(T) \iff \psi(s, t) = 1 \quad \forall s \in S \quad t \in T \iff T \subseteq f_*(S)$$

Proposition 2.1.54 (Joins under Galois Correspondence)

Let $(X, \leq_X)$ and $(Y, \leq_Y)$ be complete lattices with an antitone Galois connection $X \xrightleftharpoons[f_*]{f^*} Y$. Then for $S \subseteq X$

$$f_*(\bigvee S) = \bigwedge f_*(S)$$

Similarly for $T \subseteq Y$ we have

$$f^*(\bigvee T) = \bigwedge f^*(T)$$

Proof. Let $a = \bigvee S$ and $b = \bigwedge f_*(S)$. Then $s \leq a \implies f_*(a) \leq f_*(s)$ for all $s \in S$, which implies $f_*(a) \leq b$. Similarly $b \leq f_*(s) \implies s \leq f^*(b)$ by the adjoint criterion. Therefore $a \leq f^*(b)$ by definition of join, which implies $b \leq f_*(a)$ by the adjoint criterion again. Whence $f_*(a) = b$ as required.

The second statement follows from duality. □

2.1.7 Axiom of Choice

Theorem 2.1.55 (Axiom of choice)

There are a number of essentially equivalent formulations of the axiom of choice

- a) The Cartesian product of a non-empty family of sets is non-empty
- b) For any set X of non-empty sets there exists a function $f : X \rightarrow \bigcup X$ such that $A \in X \implies f(A) \in A$.
- c) **Zorn's Lemma** Suppose a partially ordered set $(X, \leq)$ is such that every *chain* in X has an upper bound in X . Then X contains at least one maximal element.
- d) Every surjective function has a right inverse.

Corollary 2.1.56 (Choose representatives)

Let $\pi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a surjective function and $T \subseteq Y$ a subset. Then there exists a subset $S \subseteq X$ such that $\pi|_S$ is bijective.

When T is finite $\#S = \#T$.

Definition 2.1.57 (Finite Character)

A family of sets $\mathcal{F}$ has **finite character** if it satisfies the following property

$$A \in \mathcal{F} \iff (B \subseteq A \text{ and finite} \implies B \in \mathcal{F})$$

Corollary 2.1.58 (Tukey's Lemma)

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a family of sets of finite character. Then it is chain-complete when ordered by inclusion.

In particular every set is contained in a maximal set.

2.1.8 Chain Conditions

Definition 2.1.59 (Totally ordered / chains)

A poset $(\mathcal{F}, \leq)$ is **totally ordered** if $x \leq y$ or $y \leq x$ for all $x, y \in \mathcal{F}$.

Definition 2.1.60 (Chain)

A non-empty subset C of $\mathcal{F}$ is a **chain** if it is totally ordered under $\leq$.

The length of the chain is simply $\ell(C) := |C| - 1$.

A chain C is

- **saturated** if $x \leq z \leq y$ and $x, y \in C \implies z \in C$.
- **maximal** if it's not contained properly in another chain.

Definition 2.1.61 (Chain-Complete)

A poset $(\mathcal{F}, \leq)$ is **chain complete** if every chain C has a supremum in $\mathcal{F}$. It is **co-chain complete** if every chain C has an infimum in $\mathcal{F}$.

Proposition 2.1.62 (Noetherian / Artinian Poset)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a poset then the following conditions are equivalent

- a) Any ascending chain

$$x_1 \leq x_2 \leq \dots \leq x_n \leq \dots$$

eventually stabilizes

- b) Any non-empty subset $Y \subseteq X$ has a maximal element

Such a poset is called **Noetherian**. If it satisfies the dual condition then it is called **Artinian**.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) If Y has no maximal elements then we may (by axiom of dependent choice) construct a strictly increasing sequence, which by definition does not stabilize.

b) $\implies$ a) Clear. □

2.2 Numbers

Informally we consider the set of integers

$$\mathbb{Z} = \{\dots, -3, -2, -1, 0, 1, 2, 3, \dots\}$$

and the subset of natural numbers

$$\mathbb{N} = \{0, 1, 2, \dots\}$$

Although it's possible to construct the integers painstakingly from a small set of axioms (see ...) we instead for brevity simply state the most commonly used results as axioms.

2.2.1 Integers

We suppose the existence of a set $\mathbb{Z}$ with distinguished elements $0 \neq 1$ together with

- A binary operation

$$+ : \mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$$

and an involution

$$(-) : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$$

satisfying

- $-0 = 0$
- $-(-x) = x$
- $x = -x \iff x = 0$
- $x + 0 = 0 = 0 + x$
- $x + y = y + x$
- $(x + y) + z = x + (y + z)$
- $x + (-x) = 0 = (-x) + x$
- $-(x + y) = (-x) + (-y)$

- A subset $\mathbb{N}$ such that

- $0, 1 \in \mathbb{N}$
- $x, y \in \mathbb{N} \implies x + y \in \mathbb{N}$
- $x \in \mathbb{Z} \implies (x \in \mathbb{N}) \vee (-x \in \mathbb{N})$
- $x \in \mathbb{N} \wedge -x \in \mathbb{N} \implies x = 0$

which also satisfies the principle of induction

- Let $S \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ be a set such that

- $0 \in S$
- $x \in S \implies x + 1 \in S$

then $S = \mathbb{N}$

It's possible to use these to show the existence of multiplication

Proposition 2.2.1 (Multiplication exists)

There exists a binary operation

$$\cdot : \mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$$

such that

- $x \cdot 0 = 0 = 0 \cdot x$
- $x \cdot 1 = x = 1 \cdot x$
- $xy = yx$
- $(xy)z = x(yz)$

- $x(y + z) = xy + xz$
- $(y + z)x = yx + zx$
- $(-x)(y) = -(xy) = x(-y)$

We may also show the existence a partial ordering

Proposition 2.2.2 (Order exists)

There exists a relation $\leq$ on $\mathbb{Z}$ given by

$$x \leq y \iff y - x \in \mathbb{N}$$

which satisfies

$$x \leq y \vee y \leq x$$

$$x \leq y \wedge y \leq x \implies x = y$$

Define $x < y$ in the obvious way then it satisfies the usual trichotomy law, namely precisely one of the following holds

$$x < y, \quad x = y, \quad y < x$$

and further

- $z > 0$ then $x < y \iff xz < yz$
- $z < 0$ then $x < y \iff yz < xz$
- $y > 1$ and $x > 0$ then $x < xy$

Finally we can construct an absolute value function

Proposition 2.2.3

*There exists an **absolute value** function*

$$|\cdot| : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$$

such that

$$|x| = \begin{cases} x & 0 < x \\ 0 & x = 0 \\ -x & x < 0 \end{cases}$$

It satisfies

- $|x| = 0 \iff x = 0$
- $|x| = |y| \iff x = \pm y$
- $|xy| = |x| |y|$
- $|x + y| \leq |x| + |y|$

In many cases it may be more convenient to use the following form of induction

Proposition 2.2.4 (Well-Ordering Principle)

Let $S \subset \mathbb{N}$ be a non-empty subset. Then it contains a minimal element d .

2.2.2 Arithmetic

Proposition 2.2.5 (Division Algorithm)

Let $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ be non-zero integers then there exists q, r such that

$$x = yq + r$$

and

$$0 \leq r < |y|$$

Furthermore (q, r) is the unique such pair.

Proof. Suppose first that $x, y > 0$. Let $S = \{x - yn \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}\} \cap \mathbb{N}$. Then $x \in S$ so it is non-empty. By the Well-Ordering principle it has a minimal element r . By assumption

$$x = yq + r$$

for some $q \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $r \geq 0$. Suppose $r \geq y$, then $0 \leq x - y(q + 1) < r$ contradicting minimality.

The case $x > 0, y < 0$ is then straightforward, as is the case $x < 0$.

For uniqueness suppose $yq' + r' = yq + r$ then $|y||q - q'| = |r' - r| < |y|$ from which it follows $|q - q'| = 0 \implies q = q' \implies r = r'$. $\square$

Corollary 2.2.6 (Ideals are Principal)

Let $S \subseteq \mathbb{Z}$ be a non-empty set such that

$$x, y \in S \implies x \pm y \in S$$

Then $S = d\mathbb{Z}$ for a unique $d \geq 0$.

Proof. First we claim that $0 \in S$. For if $x \in S$ then $0 = x - x \in S$ by assumption. Furthermore $x \in S \implies -x = 0 - x \in S$.

Consider the set $S' = (S \cap \mathbb{N}) \setminus \{0\}$. If it's empty then $S = \{0\}$ (for $x \in S \implies -x \in S$) and $d = 0$.

Otherwise it has a minimal element $d > 0$ by the well-ordering principle. Then by induction $d\mathbb{Z} \subseteq S$. Conversely suppose $y \in S$ then by the division algorithm $y = qd + r$ with $0 \leq r < d$. By assumption $r = y - qd \in S$ and by minimality must be equal to 0. Therefore $y \in d\mathbb{Z}$ and $d\mathbb{Z} = S$ as required. $\square$

Definition 2.2.7 (Divisibility)

Let $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ be two integers. We say that x divides y if there exists a such that $ax = y$. In this case we write

$$x \mid y$$

and

$$\frac{y}{x}$$

for the unique integer a such that $ax = y$.

Lemma 2.2.8

Let $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ be two integers then

$$x \mid y \implies |x| \leq |y|$$

In particular $x \mid y \wedge y \mid x \implies x = \pm y$.

Proposition 2.2.9 (Bezout's Theorem)

Let x, y be non-zero integers. Then there exists a unique positive integer d such that

- d is a common divisor of x, y
- For any other common divisor e we have $e \mid d$.

Further there exists integers a, b such that $ax + by = d$. We write this as (x, y) .

Proof. Let $S = \{ax + by \mid a, b \in \mathbb{Z}\}$. Then by (2.2.6) we have $S = d\mathbb{Z}$ for a unique $d > 0$. As $x, y \in S$ by definition d is a common divisor, and by definition $d = d \cdot 1 = ax + by$ for some integers a, b . Suppose e is a common divisor then $d = ax + by = e(ap + bq)$ and $e \mid d$ as required.

Any two such common divisors have $d = \pm d'$ by the previous Lemma. Since they are positive and non-zero we have $d = d'$. $\square$

Proposition 2.2.10

Let a, x, y be non-zero integers then

$$|a|(x, y) = (ax, ay)$$

In particular

$$\left(\frac{x}{(x, y)}, \frac{y}{(x, y)} \right) = 1$$

Proof. This follows from the characterization of (x, y) as the minimal positive integer in the set $\{mx + ny\}$. $\square$

2.2.3 Prime Factorization**Definition 2.2.11**

Let $x \in \mathbb{Z}$ be a non-zero integer. We say that x

- is a **unit** if it's equal to 1 or -1 .
- is **prime** if it's not a unit and $x \mid p$ implies $x = \pm 1$ or $x = \pm p$
- **composite** otherwise

Lemma 2.2.12

Let p be a positive prime and a a non-zero integer. Then precisely one of the following holds

- $(p, a) = 1$
- $(p, a) = p$ and $p \mid a$

Proof. Note that (p, a) is positive and divides both p and a so the result follows by definition of prime. $\square$

Proposition 2.2.13 (Euclid's Lemma)

Suppose $x \mid ab$ then $\frac{x}{(x, a)} \mid b$.

In particular if p is a prime and $p \mid ab$, then $p \mid a$ or $p \mid b$.

Proof. First suppose that $(x, a) = 1$. Then by assumption $zx = ab$ and by [Bezout's Theorem](#) $mx + na = 1$ for some integers m, n . Multiply by z to find that $abm + na = a(bm + n) = z$. Therefore $a(bm + n)x = ab$ and cancel a to find $x \mid b$ as required.

For the general case define $x' = x/(x, a)$ and $a' = a/(x, a)$. Then by [\(2.2.10\)](#) $(x', a') = 1$. Furthermore it's clear that $x' \mid a'b$ so we have $x' \mid b$ by the special case just proven.

Finally suppose $p \mid ab$. If $(p, a) = 1$ then $p \mid b$ by the first result. By [\(2.2.12\)](#) if this does not hold then $p \mid a$ as required. $\square$

Using these results we may show that there exists a unique factorization into primes, unique up to multiplication by a unit.

2.3 Matroids

The theory of bases of vector spaces (Section 3.4.15) and transcendence bases of field extensions (Section 3.18.17) have some formal similarities, as noted in [vdW91]. Here we use the theory of Matroids to formalise this precisely so that the proofs need not be repeated in each case.

Definition 2.3.1 (Matroid)

Consider a set X together with a **closure operator** $c : \mathcal{P}(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{P}(X)$ (“span” operator) such that $c(\emptyset) = \emptyset$. We say

- $S \subset X$ is **independent** if $x \in S \implies x \notin c(S \setminus \{x\})$
- $\Gamma \subset X$ is **spanning** if $c(\Gamma) = X$.

Note by definition X is spanning and $\emptyset$ is independent. Moreover all singletons $\{x\}$ are independent.

We call the pair (X, c) a **matroid** if it also satisfies the following properties

- **Finitary** $x \in c(\Gamma) \implies x \in c(\Gamma')$ for some finite subset Γ' of Γ .
- **Exchange Property** For all $x, y \in X$ and $Y \subseteq X$ we have

$$x \in c(Y \cup \{y\}) \setminus c(Y) \implies y \in c(Y \cup \{x\})$$

We say (X, c) has **finite rank** if it has a finite spanning set.

Finally we say $\mathcal{B} \subseteq X$ is a **basis** if it is both **spanning** and **independent**.

We begin with some elementary characterizations of independent sets

Lemma 2.3.2

Suppose $S \subset X$ is a subset

- $A \subseteq c(S) \implies c(S \cup A) = c(S)$
- S is independent if and only if no proper subset has the same span.

Proof. We prove each in turn

- By monotonicity

$$c(S) \subseteq c(S \cup A) \subseteq c(c(S) \cup A) = c(c(S)) = c(S)$$

- Suppose S is independent and $S' \subsetneq S$ is a proper subset such that $c(S') = c(S)$. Choose $x \in S \setminus S'$ then by definition $x \in S \implies x \in c(S) = c(S') \subseteq c(S' \cup \{x\})$ contradicting independence.

Conversely suppose for some $x \in S$ we have $x \in c(S \setminus \{x\})$. Define $S' := S \setminus \{x\}$. Then $x \in c(S')$ implies $c(S) = c(S')$ by a). As S' is a proper subset this contradicts the hypothesis.

□

Lemma 2.3.3

Every subset of an independent set is independent. Furthermore the family of independent sets has **finite character**.

Proof. The first statement is straightforward. Suppose S a dependent set such that every finite subset is independent. Then there exists $x \in S$ such that $x \in c(S \setminus \{x\})$. Then by the finitary property there exists a finite subset $S' \subseteq S \setminus \{x\}$ such that $x \in c(S')$. Therefore by definition $S' \cup \{x\}$ is not independent, a contradiction. □

The finitary condition ensures that $\mathcal{E}$ is “inductively ordered”

Corollary 2.3.4

Let $\{S_i\}_{i \in I}$ be a chain of independent subsets. Then $S = \bigcup_{i \in I} S_i$ is also independent.

Lemma 2.3.5 (Extension Property)

Suppose S is an independent set and $x \notin c(S)$, then $S \cup \{x\}$ is independent.

Proof. We require to prove that for all $y \in S$ we have $y \notin c(S \cup \{x\} \setminus \{y\})$. By independence of S we have $y \notin c(S \setminus \{y\})$, so by the Exchange Property $y \in c(S \cup \{x\} \setminus \{y\})$ would imply $x \in c(S)$, contradicting the hypothesis. □

Proposition 2.3.6

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a family of independent sets which satisfies the following properties

- $\emptyset \in \mathcal{F}$

- **extension property** $S \in \mathcal{F}$ and $x \notin c(S) \implies S \cup \{x\} \in \mathcal{F}$
- $\mathcal{F}$ has *finite character*

then $\mathcal{F}$ consists of all independent sets.

Proof. It's enough to show that $\mathcal{F}$ contains all finite independent sets, which follows by induction on $\#S$. For given an independent set S and $x \in S$, then by definition $x \notin c(S \setminus \{x\})$. By the induction hypothesis $S \setminus \{x\} \in \mathcal{F}$ whence by the extension property $S \in \mathcal{F}$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 2.3.7 (Basis exists)

Let (X, c) be a matroid, S independent and Γ a subset such that $S \subseteq \Gamma$. Then there exists an independent set $\mathcal{B}$ such that $S \subseteq \mathcal{B} \subseteq \Gamma$ and $c(\mathcal{B}) = c(\Gamma)$.

In particular if Γ is spanning then $\mathcal{B}$ is a basis.

Proof. Consider the collection

$$\mathcal{I} = \{T \text{ independent} \mid S \subseteq T \subseteq \Gamma\}$$

By (2.3.4) is chain-complete. Therefore it has a maximal element $\mathcal{B}$ by Zorn's Lemma. Suppose $x \in \Gamma \setminus c(\mathcal{B})$ then $\mathcal{B} \cup \{x\}$ is independent by (2.3.5), contradicting maximality. Therefore $\Gamma \subseteq c(\mathcal{B}) \implies c(\Gamma) \subseteq c(\mathcal{B})$. The reverse inequality is clear so that $c(\Gamma) = c(\mathcal{B})$. $\square$

Corollary 2.3.8 (Criteria for bases)

Let (X, c) be a matroid. Then the following are equivalent

- $\mathcal{B}$ is a basis
- $\mathcal{B}$ is a minimal spanning set
- $\mathcal{B}$ is maximally independent (possibly in some spanning set Γ)

Proof. a) $\implies$ b). Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a basis and $\Gamma \subseteq \mathcal{B}$ a spanning set. Then by (2.3.2).b) $\Gamma = \mathcal{B}$.

b) $\implies$ a). Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a minimal spanning set, then by (2.3.7) there exists a subset $\mathcal{B}'$ which is a basis, and in particular spanning. By minimality $\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{B}'$.

c) $\implies$ a). By (2.3.7) there exists a basis $\mathcal{B}'$ containing $\mathcal{B}$. By maximality $\mathcal{B}' = \mathcal{B}$.

a) $\implies$ c). Suppose $\mathcal{B} \subseteq S$ where S is independent. Then S is spanning too, and so by (2.3.2) $\mathcal{B} = S$. $\square$

Lemma 2.3.9 (Mini Exchange Lemma)

Let $S \subseteq \Gamma$ be finite sets and $x \in X \setminus S$ such that

- S is independent
- $x \in c(\Gamma) \setminus c(S)$

Then there exists $y \in \Gamma \setminus S$ such that $c(\Gamma \setminus \{y\} \cup \{x\}) = c(\Gamma)$.

Proof. We may assume without loss of generality that $x \notin \Gamma$.

Consider $\tilde{\Gamma} \subseteq \Gamma$ minimal subject to $S \subseteq \tilde{\Gamma}$ and $x \in c(\tilde{\Gamma})$. If $S = \tilde{\Gamma}$ then $x \in c(S)$ a contradiction. Therefore we may choose $y \in \tilde{\Gamma} \setminus S$. By minimality we have $x \in c(\tilde{\Gamma}) \setminus c(\tilde{\Gamma} \setminus \{y\})$. Therefore by the Exchange Property we have $y \in c(\tilde{\Gamma} \setminus \{y\} \cup \{x\})$. Then by (2.3.2) applied twice

$$c(\Gamma \setminus \{y\} \cup \{x\}) = c(\Gamma \cup \{x\}) = c(\Gamma)$$

as required. $\square$

Proposition 2.3.10 (Exchange Lemma)

Let S be an independent set and Γ be a finite set such that $S \subseteq c(\Gamma)$. Then there exists a subset $T \subseteq \Gamma$ such that

- $\#T = \#S$
- $c(\Gamma \setminus T \cup S) = c(\Gamma)$.

In particular $\#S \leq \#\Gamma$.

Proof. By considering the sub-matroid $(c(\Gamma), c)$ we may assume without loss of generality that $X = c(\Gamma)$.

Let $n = \#\Gamma$ and consider the set of pairs

$$\mathcal{F} := \{(A, B) \mid A \subseteq S, \quad B \subseteq \Gamma, \quad \#A = \#B, \quad c(\Gamma \setminus B \cup A) = X\}$$

Essentially $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of swaps we may perform from S to Γ whilst preserving the span. It is non-empty because $(\emptyset, \emptyset) \in \mathcal{F}$ and we wish to show that $(S, B) \in \mathcal{F}$ for some B .

Observe that for all $(A, B) \in \mathcal{F}$ we have $\#B \leq n$ so choose a pair such that $\#B$ is maximal. We wish to show that in this case $A = S$, so we suppose to the contrary that $A \subsetneq S$.

We claim that $B \subsetneq \Gamma$, for $B = \Gamma$ implies by construction $c(A) = X$ which would imply $c(A) = c(S)$, contradicting the criteria for independence of S given by Lemma (2.3.2).

Define $\Gamma' := \Gamma \setminus B \cup A$. Then by assumption $c(\Gamma') = X$ and $A \subseteq \Gamma'$ is independent. Choose $x \in S \setminus A$ then by definition of independence $x \notin c(A)$. By (2.3.9) there exists $y \in \Gamma' \setminus A$ such that

$$c(\Gamma' \setminus \{y\} \cup \{x\}) = c(\Gamma') = X$$

Note by construction that $y \notin B$, so we see that $(A \cup \{x\}, B \cup \{y\}) \in \mathcal{F}$ has greater length, which contradicts maximality. $\square$

Corollary 2.3.11 (Bases have the same cardinality)

Every base of a finite rank matroid is finite and of the same size. Denote this by $r(X)$.

Proof. There is a finite basis by (2.3.7). Then apply (2.3.10). $\square$

Corollary 2.3.12

Let (X, c) be a finite-rank matroid and $S \subseteq X$ an independent subset, then $\#S \leq r(X)$. Similarly a spanning subset Γ satisfies $\#\Gamma \geq r(X)$.

Proof. Apply (2.3.7) and (2.3.11). $\square$

Corollary 2.3.13 (Basis Criteria)

Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a subset of a finite-rank matroid (X, c) . Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\mathcal{B}$ is a basis
- b) $\mathcal{B}$ is independent and $\#\mathcal{B} \geq r(X)$
- c) $\mathcal{B}$ is spanning and $\#\mathcal{B} \leq r(X)$

Proof. Apply (2.3.7) and (2.3.11). $\square$

Definition 2.3.14 (Submatroid)

*A subset $Y \subseteq X$ is a **sub-matroid** if $c(Y) = Y$. In this case $S \subseteq Y \implies c(S) \subseteq Y$ and so we have an induced matroid structure (Y, c) .*

Proposition 2.3.15

Let $Y \subseteq X$ be a sub-matroid of a finite-rank matroid. Then $Y = X \iff r(Y) = r(X)$.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a basis for Y then $\#\mathcal{B} = r(Y) = r(X)$ and is a-fortiori independent in X . Therefore by (2.3.13) $\mathcal{B}$ is a basis for X and hence $X = c(\mathcal{B}) = Y$. $\square$

2.4 Decomposition in Noetherian and Distributive Lattices

An analogue of irreducible factorization in rings (see Section 3.16) applies to Noetherian Lattices. Furthermore uniqueness holds when the lattice is distributive. For a canonical reference see [Bir40].

Definition 2.4.1 (Meet-Prime and Meet-Irreducible)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a lattice and $x \in X$. Then we say that x is

- **meet-irreducible** if $y \wedge z = x \implies y = x$ or $z = x$
- **meet-prime** if $y \wedge z \leq x \implies y \leq x$ or $z \leq x$
- **join-irreducible** if $y \vee z = x \implies y = x$ or $z = x$
- **join-prime** if $x \leq y \vee z \implies x \leq y$ or $x \leq z$

The following result is proven in [Bir40, Ch. IX Lemma 4.1].

Proposition 2.4.2 (Prime = Irreducible)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a lattice. In general $\text{meet-prime} \implies \text{meet-irreducible}$ and $\text{join-prime} \implies \text{join-irreducible}$. If X is a distributive lattice, then the converse holds.

In the distributive case we denote by $\mathcal{M}(X)$ and $\mathcal{J}(X)$ the sub-poset of meet-prime and join-prime elements respectively.

Proof. The first statement is straightforward. Conversely suppose X is a distributive lattice and x is meet-irreducible. If $y \wedge z \leq x$ then $x = x \vee (y \wedge z) = (y \vee x) \wedge (z \vee x) \implies x = y \vee x$ or $x = z \vee x$, whence the result follows. $\square$

Proposition 2.4.3

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a distributive lattice and Y a sub-lattice, then

$$\mathcal{M}(Y) = \mathcal{M}(X) \cap Y$$

$$\mathcal{J}(Y) = \mathcal{J}(X) \cap Y$$

In particular this holds when $Y = \{x\}^\uparrow, \{y\}^\downarrow, \{x\}^\uparrow \cap \{y\}^\downarrow$.

Proposition 2.4.4

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a distributive lattice. If it is chain-complete (resp. co-chain-complete) then so is $\mathcal{J}(X)$ (resp. $\mathcal{M}(X)$).

Every join-prime element is bounded above by a maximal join-prime element, and every meet-prime element is bounded below by a minimal meet-prime element

Proof. Let C be a chain of join-prime elements and $x := \bigvee C$. Suppose that $y \vee z \geq x$ then $y \vee z \geq w$ for all $w \in C$. Then $y \geq w$ or $z \geq w$ for all $w \in C$. Let $C_1 := \{w \in C \mid y \geq w\}$. If $C_1 = C$ then we are done as $x \leq y$. Otherwise suppose $w_0 \notin C_1$ then by prime-ness $z \geq w_0$. Clearly $w \leq w_0 \implies w \leq z$. Further $w \geq w_0 \implies w \not\leq y$ (as otherwise $w_0 \leq y$) whence $w \leq z$. Therefore $x \leq z$.

The last statement follows from Zorn's Lemma by considering the sub-lattices $\{x\}^\uparrow$ and $\{y\}^\downarrow$ which inherit the chain complete properties. $\square$

Definition 2.4.5

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a lattice and $Y \subseteq X$ a finite subset. Then we say that Y is

- **(meet-)irredundant** if no proper subset has the same meet
- **incomparable** (or an **antichain**) if no two elements are comparable

Lemma 2.4.6 (incomparable $\iff$ irredundant)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a lattice and $Y \subseteq X$ then Y meet-irredundant $\implies Y$ incomparable. Conversely if Y is a finite incomparable subset of meet-prime elements then Y is meet-irredundant.

Proof. The first part is straightforward, for if $y_1 \leq y_2$ are elements of Y then $\bigwedge Y = \bigwedge Y \setminus \{y_2\}$.

Conversely suppose $Y' \subsetneq Y$ is such that $\bigwedge Y' = \bigwedge Y$. Choose $y_2 \in Y \setminus Y'$, then $\bigwedge Y' \leq y_2$, whence by definition of meet-prime (and induction) $y_1 \leq y_2$ for some $y_1 \in Y'$. $\square$

The following is [Bir40, Chapter IX Theorem 9]

Proposition 2.4.7 (Decomposition in Noetherian Lattice)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a *Noetherian distributive lattice*. Then every element $x \in X$ has a unique decomposition

$$x = x_1 \wedge \dots \wedge x_n$$

where x_i are meet-prime and meet-irredundant (equivalently incomparable). These are precisely the meet-primes minimal over x .

Dually, if $(X, \leq)$ is an *Artinian distributive lattice*, then every element $x \in X$ has a unique decomposition

$$x = x_1 \vee \dots \vee x_n$$

where x_i are join-prime and join-irredundant (equivalently incomparable). These are precisely the join-primes maximal below x .

Proof. Let Y be the subset of elements which are not finite meets of meet-prime elements, and suppose it is non-empty. Then by (2.1.62) Y has a maximal element x_0 . It cannot be meet-prime, and therefore not meet-irreducible (2.4.2), so there must exist elements $y_0, z_0 \in X$ such that $x_0 = y_0 \wedge z_0$ but $x_0 \not\leq y_0$ and $x_0 \not\leq z_0$. By maximality y_0, z_0 are finite meets of prime elements, and therefore so is x_0 a contradiction.

Therefore we have a decomposition into distinct primes

$$x = x_1 \wedge \dots \wedge x_n$$

Consider the family of subsets of $\{x_1, \dots, x_n\}$ which have the same meet. Then there exists a minimal subset which by definition is meet-irredundant and by (2.4.6) incomparable. Suppose there is another such decomposition $x = x'_1 \wedge \dots \wedge x'_m$. Then for every $i = 1 \dots n$ we have $x'_{\sigma(i)} \leq x_i$ and for every $j = 1 \dots m$ we have $x_{\tau(j)} \leq x'_j$ whence $x_{\tau(\sigma(i))} \leq x'_{\sigma(i)} \leq x_i$. As the decomposition is incomparable we have $\tau(\sigma(i)) = i$ and $x'_{\sigma(i)} = x_i$. Therefore σ is injective and $n \leq m$. By symmetry $m \leq n$ and σ is a bijection. In otherwords the decomposition is unique.

Note $x \leq z$ and z meet-prime implies $x_j \leq z$ for some j . Therefore if z is a minimal prime then $x_j = z$ and all the meet-primes minimal over x must occur in the decomposition. Similarly if $z \leq x_i$ then by incomparability $x_j = z = x_i$. Therefore each x_i is also minimal. $\square$

2.5 Krull Dimension

The purpose of this section is to abstract the notions of Krull Dimension in commutative ring theory (Section 3.21) and topology (Section 4.1.11). A more standard approach (eg EGA IV) would be to develop the topological notion first, and then link to commutative ring case using the prime spectrum (??). Generally the concept is not well-behaved, so stronger conditions are defined which generally hold in geometric cases. Principle references are (EGA0 IV 14.3, Heinrich).

Definition 2.5.1 (Finite-Dimensional Poset)

Let $(\mathcal{G}, \leq)$ be a poset, we say that it is **finite-dimensional** if

$$\dim(\mathcal{G}) := \sup\{\ell(C) \mid C \subseteq \mathcal{G} \text{ a chain}\} < \infty$$

In this case we define

$$\begin{aligned} \dim(x) &:= \dim(\{x\}^\downarrow) \\ \text{codim}(y) &:= \dim(\{y\}^\uparrow) \\ \text{codim}(y, x) &:= \dim(\{x\}^\downarrow \cap \{y\}^\uparrow) \end{aligned}$$

Note $\mathcal{G}$ is both Noetherian and Artinian, but finite-dimensionality is a stronger condition. Note also that $\{x\}^\downarrow, \{y\}^\uparrow$ and $\{x\}^\downarrow \cap \{y\}^\uparrow$ are finite-dimensional posets

Definition 2.5.2 (Krull Lattice)

Let $(\mathcal{F}, \leq)$ be an **Artinian** distributive lattice. We say it is a **Krull Lattice** if the poset of **join-prime** elements $\mathcal{J}(\mathcal{F})$ is finite-dimensional and define

$$\dim(\mathcal{F}) := \dim(\mathcal{J}(\mathcal{F}))$$

By (2.4.3) we have $\mathcal{H} = \{x\}^\downarrow, \{y\}^\uparrow, \{x\}^\downarrow \cap \{y\}^\uparrow$ are Krull Lattices such that

$$\mathcal{J}(\mathcal{H}) = \mathcal{J}(\mathcal{F}) \cap \mathcal{H}$$

For $x, y \in \mathcal{F}$ we have a unique decomposition into maximal join-prime elements $x_i, y_j \in \mathcal{J}(\mathcal{F})$ (2.4.7)

$$x = x_1 \vee \dots \vee x_n$$

$$y = y_1 \vee \dots \vee y_m$$

Note that $y \leq x \iff$ for all j we have $y_j \leq x_i$ for some i and we may define

$$\dim(x) := \max_i \dim(x_i) = \dim(\{x\}^\downarrow) \quad (2.2)$$

$$\text{codim}(y) := \min_j \text{codim}(y_j) \quad (2.3)$$

$$\text{codim}(y, x) := \min_j \max_i \{\text{codim}(y_j, x_i) \mid y_j \leq x_i\} \quad (2.4)$$

$$= \min_j \text{codim}(y_j, x) \quad (2.5)$$

note it's required to be careful in definition of co-dimension in order to have a sensible co-dimension formula. Note also that

$$\dim(y; \{x\}^\downarrow) = \dim(y) \quad (2.6)$$

Remark 2.5.3

For the topological case, we would define $\mathcal{F}$ to be the closed subsets of X and $\mathcal{J}(\mathcal{F})$ would be the collection of irreducible closed subsets, see (4.1.52).

Proposition 2.5.4 (Extending chains)

Let $(\mathcal{G}, \leq)$ be a finite-dimensional poset

- Every chain is contained in a saturated chain
- Every chain is contained in a maximal chain
- Every maximal chain is of the form

$$x_0 \leq x_1 \leq \dots \leq x_n$$

for x_0 minimal and x_n maximal in $\mathcal{G}$.

Definition 2.5.5 (Properties)

Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a finite-dimensional poset. Then we say it is

- **Irreducible** if it has a top element
- **Equidimensional** if every maximal element has the same dimension
- **Equicodimensional** if every minimal element has the same codimension
- **Biequidimensional** if every maximal chain has the same length
- **Quasi-Biequidimensional** if $\{x\}^\downarrow$ is biequidimensional for all x (equivalently all maximal x)
- **Catenary** if for every pair $y \leq x$, every saturated chain in $[y, x] := \{y\}^\uparrow \cap \{x\}^\downarrow$ has the same length, namely $\text{codim}(y, x)$.

If $\mathcal{F}$ is a Krull Lattice then we say it inherits these properties from $\mathcal{J}(\mathcal{F})$. Note if $\mathcal{F}$ is irreducible then it also has (the same) top element.

Trivially irreducible implies equidimensional. Similarly biequidimensional implies both equidimensional and equicodimensional, but not conversely.

Finally **quasi-biequidimensional + equidimensional $\iff$ biequidimensional**.

Proposition 2.5.6 (Simple Properties)

Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a finite-dimensional poset then

- a) If x is maximal then $\text{codim}(x) = 0$
- b) If x is minimal then $\dim(x) = 0$
- c) $\dim(\mathcal{G}) = \sup\{\dim(x) \mid x \text{ maximal}\} = \sup\{\text{codim}(x) \mid x \text{ minimal}\}$
- d) For all $z \leq y \leq x$ we have $\text{codim}(z, y) + \text{codim}(y, x) \leq \text{codim}(z, x)$

If $\mathcal{F}$ is a Krull Lattice then

- e) For all $y \leq x$ we have $\dim(y) + \text{codim}(y, x) \leq \dim(x)$
- f) For all $y \leq x$ we have $\text{codim}(y, x) = 0 \iff y_j = x_i$ some i, j

Alternatively $\text{codim}(y, x) > 0$ if and only if $(y_j \leq x_i \implies y_j \neq x_i)$.

Proof. e) The case of a finite-dimensional poset is (relatively) clear. In the general case then we have

$$\dim(y_j) + \text{codim}(y, x) \leq \dim(y_j) + \text{codim}(y_j, x) = \max_i (\dim(y_j) + \text{codim}(y_j, x_i)) \leq \max_i \dim(x_i) = \dim(x)$$

and taking max over j yields the result.

f) The case $x, y \in \mathcal{J}(\mathcal{F})$ is clear by (2.5.4). For the general case $\text{codim}(y, x) = 0 \iff \text{codim}(y_j, x) = 0$ for some $j \iff (y_j \leq x_i \implies \text{codim}(y_j, x_i) = 0) \iff y_j = x_i$ for some i, j . $\square$

Corollary 2.5.7 (Codimension 1 formula)

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a Krull Lattice with $y \in \mathcal{F}$, $x \in \mathcal{J}(\mathcal{F})$ and $y \leq x$. Then

$$\dim(y) = \dim(x) - 1 \implies \text{codim}(y, x) = 1$$

Suppose further that $\mathcal{F}$ is irreducible then

$$\dim(y) = \dim(\mathcal{F}) - 1 \implies \text{codim}(y) = 1$$

Proof. By (2.5.6).e) $\text{codim}(y, x) \leq 1$. If $\text{codim}(y, x) = 0$ then by f) we see that $y_j = x$ for some j , whence $y = x$ which contradicts $\dim(y) = \dim(x) - 1$. Therefore $\text{codim}(y, x) = 1$ as required.

If $\mathcal{F}$ is irreducible the result follows with $x = \top$. $\square$

Remark 2.5.8 (Duality)

We note that the concepts of **dimension** (of a poset), **biequidimensional** and **catenary** are self-dual, in the sense that they are preserved when considering the **dual poset** $(\mathcal{G}, \leq^d)$.

Similarly the concepts of **equidimensional** and **equicodimensional** are dual to each other.

Proposition 2.5.9

Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a finite-dimensional poset. Then the following are equivalent

- $\mathcal{G}$ is catenary
- For every triplet $z < y < x$ in $\mathcal{G}$ we have

$$\text{codim}(z, x) = \text{codim}(z, y) + \text{codim}(y, x)$$

When $\mathcal{G}$ is irreducible this is equivalent to

$$\text{codim}(z) = \text{codim}(z, y) + \text{codim}(y)$$

for all $z < y$.

Proof. Suppose $\mathcal{G}$ is catenary. Choose saturated chains C_1 in $[z, y]$ and C_2 in $[y, x]$. One may show that $C_1 \cap C_2 = \{y\}$ and $C_1 \cup C_2$ is a saturated chain in $[x, z]$. The result follows by definition of catenary.

Conversely, consider a saturated chain between x and y of length n

$$x = x_0 \leq x_1 \leq \dots \leq x_n = y$$

Then clearly $\text{codim}(x_i, x_{i+1}) = 1$ for all $i = 0 \dots n - 1$. Therefore by repeatedly applying the relation we may show that

$$\text{codim}(x, y) = n$$

and therefore every saturated chain between x and y has the same length.

When $\mathcal{G}$ is irreducible we may deduce the second formula by setting $x = \top$. Conversely we may see that

$$\text{codim}(z, x) = \text{codim}(z) - \text{codim}(x) = \text{codim}(z) - \text{codim}(y) + \text{codim}(y) - \text{codim}(x) = \text{codim}(z, y) + \text{codim}(y, x)$$

□

Lemma 2.5.10

Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a biequidimensional finite-dimensional poset. Then for $x \in \mathcal{G}$ we have

- a) $\{x\}^\downarrow$ and $\{x\}^\uparrow$ are biequidimensional
- b) $\dim(\mathcal{G}) = \dim(x) + \text{codim}(x)$
- c) If x is maximal then $\dim(x) = \dim(\mathcal{G})$ and in particular $\mathcal{G}$ is equidimensional
- d) If x is minimal then $\text{codim}(x) = \dim(\mathcal{G})$ and in particular $\mathcal{G}$ is equicodimensional

In particular $\mathcal{G}$ is quasi-biequidimensional.

Proof. Consider a fixed maximal chain C of $\{x\}^\uparrow$, necessarily containing x . Any maximal chain C' of $\{x\}^\downarrow$ also contains x and combines with C to yield a maximal chain of $\mathcal{F}$. Whence $\ell(C') + \ell(C) = \dim(\mathcal{F})$ and $\{x\}^\downarrow$ is biequidimensional. By duality $\{x\}^\uparrow$ is biequidimensional and $\ell(C) = \text{codim}(x)$ from which the formula follows.

If x is maximal then clearly $\text{codim}(x) = 0$, and similarly if x is minimal then $\dim(x) = 0$, so the last two statements follow immediately.

□

Proposition 2.5.11 (Equivalent Characterizations of Biequidimensionality)

Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a finite-dimensional poset. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\mathcal{G}$ is quasi-biequidimensional
- b) $\mathcal{G}$ is catenary and for every maximal x we have $\{x\}^\downarrow$ is equicodimensional
- c) $\mathcal{G}$ satisfies $\dim(x) = \dim(y) + \text{codim}(y, x)$ for $y \leq x$
- d) $\mathcal{G}$ satisfies c) whenever $\text{codim}(y, x) = 1$

Furthermore the following relationship holds

$$\text{codim}(y) = \text{codim}(y, x) + \text{codim}(x) \quad y \leq x$$

Proof. **a)** $\implies$ **c)**. By assumption $\{x\}^\downarrow$ is biequidimensional. Then

$$\dim(x) = \dim(\{x\}^\downarrow) \stackrel{(2.5.10)}{=} \dim(y; \{x\}^\downarrow) + \text{codim}(y; \{x\}^\downarrow) = \dim(y) + \text{codim}(y, x)$$

For **c)** $\implies$ **b)**. Suppose $z < y < x$ in $\mathcal{G}$ then by the codimension formula applied twice

$$\text{codim}(z, x) = \dim(x) - \dim(z) = \dim(x) - \dim(y) + \dim(y) - \dim(z) = \text{codim}(y, x) + \text{codim}(z, y)$$

so by (2.5.9) $\mathcal{G}$ is catenary. Let x be a maximal element and z a minimal element of $\{x\}^\downarrow$, then by the codimension formula

$$\text{codim}(z, x) = \dim(x) - \dim(z) = \dim(x)$$

whence $\{x\}^\downarrow$ is equicodimensional.

b) $\implies$ **a)**. Let x be a maximal element and C a maximal chain in $\{x\}^\downarrow$ with minimum element y then, as $\mathcal{G}$ is catenary, we have $\ell(C) = \text{codim}(y, x)$. As $\{x\}^\downarrow$ is equicodimensional we have $\text{codim}(y, x) = \dim(x)$ which shows that $\{x\}^\downarrow$ is biequidimensional.

Clearly **c)** $\implies$ **d)**. Conversely for **d)** $\implies$ **a)** consider a maximal chain in $\{x\}^\downarrow$

$$x_0 \leq \dots \leq x_n = x$$

Then clearly $\text{codim}(x_i, x_{i+1}) = 1$ whence by induction $\ell(C) = \dim(x)$.

The final statement follows from (2.5.9) because $\{x\}^\downarrow$ is irreducible and catenary. $\square$

Remark 2.5.12

This is a corrected version of EGA IV 14.3.3, as noted by Heinrich.

Corollary 2.5.13

When $\mathcal{F}$ is a quasi-biequidimensional Krull Lattice then we have the following codimension formulas for all $x \in \mathcal{J}(\mathcal{F})$ and $y \in \mathcal{F}$ such that $y \leq x$

$$\dim(x) = \dim(y) + \text{codim}(y, x) \tag{2.7}$$

$$\text{codim}(y) = \text{codim}(y, x) + \text{codim}(x) \tag{2.8}$$

Furthermore if $\mathcal{F}$ is biequidimensional then for all $y \in \mathcal{F}$

$$\dim(\mathcal{F}) = \dim(y) + \text{codim}(y)$$

Proof. The first two relations hold when $x, y \in \mathcal{J}(\mathcal{F})$ by (2.5.11). We may generalise this as follows.

For the first relation and fixed $x \in \mathcal{J}(\mathcal{F})$ we see $\dim(y_j)$ is maximal precisely when $\text{codim}(y_j, x)$ is minimal. Therefore it holds for all $y \in \mathcal{F}$.

Similarly for the second relation we see that $\text{codim}(y_j, x)$ is minimal precisely when $\text{codim}(y_j)$ is minimal.

The final statement follows from the first relation by taking the supremum over all maximal elements x . $\square$

Corollary 2.5.14

Let $\mathcal{G}$ be an irreducible finite-dimensional poset. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\mathcal{G}$ is biequidimensional
- b) $\mathcal{G}$ is quasi-biequidimensional
- c) $\mathcal{G}$ is catenary and equicodimensional
- d) $\dim(x) = \dim(y) + \text{codim}(y, x) \quad \forall y \leq x$
- e) $\mathcal{G}$ satisfies d) when $\text{codim}(y, x) = 1$

Proof. The equivalence follows from (2.5.11) by noting that an irreducible poset has only one maximal element and is in particular equidimensional. $\square$

Proposition 2.5.15

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a quasi-biequidimensional Krull Lattice. Then for all $x \in \mathcal{F}$ we have $\{x\}^\downarrow$ is a quasi-biequidimensional Krull Lattice.

Proof. Consider $y \in \mathcal{J}(\{x\}^\downarrow) \stackrel{(2.4.3)}{=} J(\mathcal{F}) \cap \{x\}^\downarrow$. Then by definition $\{y\}^\downarrow$ is biequidimensional, and so $\{x\}^\downarrow$ is quasi-biequidimensional. $\square$

2.6 Category Theory

2.6.1 Categories

Definition 2.6.1 (Category)

A (locally small) **category** $\mathcal{C}$ consists of

- a class $\text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$ of objects
- for every pair of objects $a, b \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$ a set of **morphisms** $\text{Mor}(a, b)$
- for every three objects a, b, c a **law of composition**

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}(a, b) \times \text{Mor}(b, c) &\rightarrow \text{Mor}(a, c) \\ (g, f) &\rightarrow g \circ f \end{aligned}$$

such that the following conditions hold

- $h \circ (g \circ f) = (h \circ g) \circ f$ **associativity**
- There exists $1_a \in \text{Mor}(a, a)$ such that $1_a \circ f = f$ and $g \circ 1_a = g$.

Example 2.6.2

The category of sets is **Set** with maps in the usual way. Note associativity is automatically satisfied.

Example 2.6.3 (n -pointed category)

Given a category $\mathcal{C}$ where objects are sets, we may consider the pointed category $(\mathcal{C}, \star^n)$ consisting of pairs (A, a) where $A \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$ and $a \in A^n$. We consider only morphisms $f : A \rightarrow B$ such that $f(a_i) = b_i$.

Definition 2.6.4 (Opposite Category)

Given a category $\mathcal{C}$ the **opposite category** is denoted $\mathcal{C}^{op}$ and given by

- The same class of objects $\text{ob } \mathcal{C}^{op} = \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$
- For every pair of objects $a, b \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}$ the morphisms are reversed

$$\text{Mor}^{op}(a, b) := \text{Mor}(b, a)$$

- The law of composition is reversed

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}^{op}(a, b) \times \text{Mor}^{op}(b, c) &\rightarrow \text{Mor}^{op}(a, c) \\ (g, f) &\rightarrow f \circ g \end{aligned}$$

Definition 2.6.5 (Initial object)

An **initial object** of a category $\mathcal{C}$ is an object a such that for all objects b

$$\text{Mor}(a, b) = \{\eta_b^a\}$$

consists of a single element. Clearly in this case we have

$$f \circ \eta_b^a = \eta_c^a$$

for all $f : b \rightarrow c$ and $\eta_a^a = 1_a$.

Example 2.6.6

The polynomial ring $A[X]$ is an initial object in the category of pointed A -algebras.

Definition 2.6.7 (Isomorphism)

A morphism $f : a \rightarrow b$ is an **isomorphism** if there exists $g : b \rightarrow a$ such that

$$g \circ f = 1_a$$

and

$$f \circ g = 1_b$$

Proposition 2.6.8 (Initial objects are unique)

An initial object is unique up to isomorphism

Proof. First observe by uniqueness $\eta_a^a = 1_a$. Let a, a' be two initial objects with morphisms η_a^a and $\eta_{a'}^{a'}$ respectively. Then by definition

$$\eta_a^{a'} \circ \eta_{a'}^a = \eta_a^a = 1_a$$

and vice-versa. □

Definition 2.6.9 (Functor)

A **covariant functor** $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ consists of a mapping of objects

$$F : \text{ob}(\mathcal{C}) \rightarrow \text{ob}(\mathcal{D})$$

together with a mapping of morphisms

$$F(-) : \text{Mor}(a, b) \rightarrow \text{Mor}(F(a), F(b))$$

which satisfies

- $F(1_a) = 1_{F(a)}$
- $F(f \circ g) = F(f) \circ F(g)$

A **contravariant functor** $\mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ is equivalent to a covariant functor on the opposite category $\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$, namely where arrows are reversed.

Definition 2.6.10 (Full and faithful)

A functor F is said to be

- **Faithful** if $F(-)$ is injective.
- **Full** if $F(-)$ is surjective.

Definition 2.6.11 (Concrete Category)

A **concrete category** is a pair $(\mathcal{C}, U)$ where $\mathcal{C}$ and a “**forgetful functor**” $U : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ which is faithful

Example 2.6.12 (Forgetful Functor)

The category of groups (resp. rings, modules, ...) is a concrete category in the obvious way.

Definition 2.6.13 (Mor functor)

For any objects $a, b, c \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$, there is a canonical covariant functor

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}(a, -) : \mathcal{C} &\longrightarrow \mathbf{Set} \\ b &\longrightarrow \text{Mor}(a, b) \end{aligned}$$

which acts on a morphism $f : b \rightarrow c$ by

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}(a, f) : \text{Mor}(a, b) &\rightarrow \text{Mor}(a, c) \\ g &\rightarrow f \circ g \end{aligned}$$

It's a functor precisely because composition of functions is associative. Similarly there's a canonical contravariant functor $\text{Mor}(-, b)$.

Definition 2.6.14 (Natural Transformation)

Let $F, G : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be covariant functors. A **natural transformation** $\eta : F \Rightarrow G$ consists of a family of morphisms

$$\eta_c : F(c) \rightarrow G(c) \quad c \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$$

such that the following diagram commutes holds for all $f : c \rightarrow c'$

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
F(c) & \xrightarrow{\eta_c} & G(c) \\
\downarrow F(f) & & \downarrow G(f) \\
F(c') & \xrightarrow{\eta_{c'}} & G(c')
\end{array}$$

for all $f : c \rightarrow c'$.

Definition 2.6.15 (Natural isomorphism)

A natural transformation $\eta : F \Rightarrow G$ is a natural isomorphism if η_c is an isomorphism for all $c \in \mathcal{C}$.

Definition 2.6.16

We say $\mathcal{C}' \subset \mathcal{C}$ is a **subcategory** if

- $\text{ob}(\mathcal{C}') \subseteq \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$
- $\text{Mor}_{\mathcal{C}'}(c, d) \subseteq \text{Mor}_{\mathcal{C}}(c, d)$
- Composition agrees when it is well-defined

We say $\mathcal{C}'$ is a **full subcategory** if additionally $\text{Mor}_{\mathcal{C}'}(c, d) = \text{Mor}_{\mathcal{C}}(c, d)$.

2.6.2 Product Categories and Bifunctors

Definition 2.6.17 (Product Category)

Given two categories $\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{D}$ we may construct the product category $\mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{D}$ as follows

- The objects are given by pairs

$$\text{ob}(\mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{D}) := \text{ob}(\mathcal{C}) \times \text{ob}(\mathcal{D})$$

- The morphisms are given by pairs

$$\text{Mor}((c, c'), (d, d')) := \text{Mor}(c, c') \times \text{Mor}(d, d')$$

Concretely given $f : c \rightarrow c'$ and $g : d \rightarrow d'$ write $f \times g : (c, d) \rightarrow (c', d')$

- The law of composition is determined by

$$(f \times g) \circ (h \times k) := (f \circ h) \times (g \circ k)$$

It's clear that the law of composition is associative and the identity morphism for (c, d) is $(1_c, 1_d)$. Furthermore we observe the following property

$$(f \times 1_d) \circ (1_c \times g) = (f \times g) = (1_c \times g) \circ (f \times 1_d) \quad (2.9)$$

Definition 2.6.18 (Bifunctor)

A functor on a product category, $F : \mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ is termed a **bifunctor**. F induces a family of functors

- $F(c, -) : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ given by

$$F(c, g) := F(1_c \times g)$$

- $F(-, d) : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ given by

$$F(f, d) := F(f \times 1_d)$$

which satisfy the compatibility conditions

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
F(c, d) & \xrightarrow{F(f, d)} & F(c', d) \\
F(c, g) \downarrow & \searrow F(f, g) & \downarrow F(c', g) \\
F(c, d') & \xrightarrow{F(f, d')} & F(c', d')
\end{array}$$

by applying F to Eq. (2.9).

Proposition 2.6.19 (Reconstruct Bifunctor)

Consider a family of functors $\{F_L(c) : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}\}_{c \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})}$ and $\{F_R(d) : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}\}_{d \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{D})}$. Suppose the following conditions hold

- $F_L(c)(d) = F_R(d)(c)$
- $F_L(c')(g) \circ F_R(d)(f) = F_R(d')(f) \circ F_L(c)(g)$

then these determine a well-defined bifunctor given by

$$F(f \times g) := F_L(c')(g) \circ F_R(d)(f)$$

Proposition 2.6.20

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ be a bifunctor. For $f : c \rightarrow c'$ then there is a natural transformation

$$F(f, -) : F(c, -) \Rightarrow F(c', -)$$

given by $F(f, -)_d := F(f, 1_d)$. Similarly for $g : d \rightarrow d'$ then there is a natural transformation

$$F(-, g) : F(-, d) \Rightarrow F(-, d')$$

Proof. The naturality condition is immediate from Equation (2.9) and the commutative diagram in (2.6.18). □

Proposition 2.6.21 (Criteria for Natural Transformation)

Let $F, G : \mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ be two bifunctors and suppose we have a family of natural transformations

$$\eta_c : F(c, -) \Rightarrow G(c, -)$$

for all $c \in \mathcal{C}$. Then the following are equivalent

- $\eta : F(-, -) \Rightarrow G(-, -)$ is a natural transformation
- The following diagram commutes for all $d \in \mathcal{D}$ and $f : c \rightarrow c'$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} F(c, d) & \xrightarrow{\eta_{c,d}} & G(c, d) \\ F(f \times 1_d) \downarrow & & \downarrow G(f \times 1_d) \\ F(c', d) & \xrightarrow{\eta_{c',d}} & G(c', d) \end{array}$$

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) This diagram is a special case of the naturality condition.

b) $\implies$ a) Suppose $f : c \rightarrow c'$ and $g : d \rightarrow d'$ then we require to show that

$$G(f \times g)(\eta_{c,d}(\phi)) = \eta_{c',d'}(F(f \times g)(\phi))$$

However

$$\begin{aligned} G(f \times g)(\eta_{c,d}(\phi)) &= G(f \times 1_{d'})(G(1_c \times g)(\eta_{c,d}(\phi))) \\ &= G(f \times 1_{d'})\eta_{c,d'}(F(1_c \times g)(\phi)) \\ &= \eta_{c',d'}(F(f \times 1_{d'})(F(1_c \times g)(\phi))) \\ &= \eta_{c',d'}(F(f \times g)(\phi)) \end{aligned}$$

where we have used that $\eta_{c,d}$ is natural in d and c individually. □

Example 2.6.22 (Mor is a bifunctor)

The canonical example is the following, given any locally small category $\mathcal{C}$, we have a bifunctor

$$\text{Mor} : \mathcal{C}^{op} \times \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$$

given by the set of morphisms. The action on morphisms is given by

$$\text{Mor}(f \times g)(\phi) = g \circ \phi \circ f$$

and we verify by associativity of $\mathcal{C}$ that

$$\text{Mor}((f \times g) \circ (h \times k)) = \text{Mor}(f \times g) \circ \text{Mor}(h \times k)$$

and it's clear that the commutativity condition in Eq. (2.9) is satisfied.

Example 2.6.23 (Concrete bifunctors)

Let $\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{D}$ be concrete categories and consider the following bifunctor

$$\begin{aligned} F &: \mathcal{D}^{op} \times \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set} \\ F(d, c) &:= \{\phi : d \rightarrow c \mid P(\phi)\} \end{aligned}$$

where $P(-)$ is some predicate such that $P(\phi) \implies P(g \circ \phi \circ f)$.

2.6.3 Equivalence of categories

Definition 2.6.24 (Equivalence of categories)

Let $\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{D}$ be categories. An **equivalence of categories** consists of a pair of functors (either both covariant or both contravariant)

$$\mathcal{C} \xrightleftharpoons[F]{G} \mathcal{D}$$

together with natural isomorphisms

$$\begin{aligned} \eta : \mathbf{1} &\Rightarrow GF \\ \epsilon : FG &\Rightarrow \mathbf{1} \end{aligned}$$

We say F is an equivalence of categories if there exists some G satisfying these conditions.

Definition 2.6.25

We say a functor $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ is **essentially surjective** if for all $d \in \mathcal{D}$ there exists $c \in \mathcal{C}$ such that $F(c)$ is isomorphic to d .

Lemma 2.6.26

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}, G : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ be functors.

If there exists a natural isomorphism $\eta : \mathbf{1} \Rightarrow GF$ then F is faithful. Explicitly $F(-)$ has a left-inverse given by

$$g \rightarrow \eta_{c'}^{-1} \circ G(g) \circ \eta_c$$

Furthermore $GF(\eta_c) = \eta_{GF(c)}$.

Proof. Consider the sequence of maps

$$\text{Mor}(c, c') \xrightarrow{F(-)} \text{Mor}(F(c), F(c')) \xrightarrow{G(-)} \text{Mor}(GF(c), GF(c')) \xrightarrow{\text{Mor}(\eta_c, \eta_{c'}^{-1})} \text{Mor}(c, c')$$

Note that the composite of this map is given by

$$f \rightarrow \eta_{c'}^{-1} \circ GF(f) \circ \eta_c = \eta_{c'}^{-1} \circ \eta_{c'} \circ f = f$$

in other words $F(-)$ has a left inverse and therefore F is faithful.

Note by naturality we have $GF(\eta_c) \circ \eta_c = \eta_{GF(c)} \circ \eta_c$. Since η_c is an isomorphism we may cancel to find $GF(\eta_c) = \eta_{GF(c)}$. $\square$

Proposition 2.6.27 (Equivalence is full and faithful)

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be a functor then the following are equivalent

- F is full, faithful and *essentially surjective*
- F is an *equivalence of categories*

In other words $F(-)$ is bijective and hence has a two-sided inverse. Explicitly it is given by

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Mor}(c, c') & \longleftrightarrow & \text{Mor}(F(c), F(c')) \\ f & \rightarrow & F(f) \\ \eta_{c'}^{-1} \circ G(g) \circ \eta_c & \leftarrow & g \end{array}$$

Proof. We prove only the second implies the first. By assumption there is an equivalence with G and by the previous Lemma both F and G are faithful by considering η and ϵ^{-1} in turn. Further the given map is already shown to be a left inverse. We claim it's also a right inverse, for consider

$$g' := F(\eta_{c'}^{-1}) \circ FG(g) \circ F(\eta_c).$$

We claim that $G(g') = G(g)$. As G is faithful this would imply $g' = g$ and the given map is a right inverse as required. Observe

$$G(g') = GF(\eta_{c'}^{-1}) \circ GFG(g) \circ GF(\eta_c) = \eta_{GF(c')}^{-1} \circ GFG(g) \circ \eta_{GF(c)} = \eta_{GF(c')}^{-1} \circ \eta_{GF(c')} \circ G(g) = G(g)$$

where we have used the result that $GF(\eta_c) = \eta_{GF(c)}$. Since the maps are mutual inverses we see that F is full and faithful as required.

Given $d \in \mathcal{D}$ then $F(G(d))$ is isomorphic to d via ϵ so F is essentially surjective. $\square$

Proposition 2.6.28 (Duality)

Let $(-)^* : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ be a contravariant functor such that there is a natural isomorphism

$$\eta : 1_{\mathcal{C}} \Rightarrow (-)^{**}$$

then $(-)^*$ is an equivalence of categories and in particular full and faithful.

Proof. Define $\epsilon = \eta^{-1}$ to determine the equivalence of categories. By the previous result then $(-)^*$ is full and faithful. $\square$

2.6.4 Properties of Morphisms

Definition 2.6.29 (Injective, Surjective and Bijective)

Let $(\mathcal{C}, U)$ be a *concrete category* and $f : a \rightarrow c$ a morphism. Then we say

- f is **injective** if $U(f)$ is injective
- f is **surjective** if $U(f)$ is surjective

Remark 2.6.30

Note if f is both surjective and injective it need not be an isomorphism.

The concepts of monic/split-monic, epic/split-epic, iso generalize the notion of injective, surjective and bijective to general categories as we shall see.

Definition 2.6.31 (Monomorphism)

A morphism $f : a \rightarrow b$ is said to be a **monomorphism** (or **monic**) if

$$f \circ g_1 = f \circ g_2 \implies g_1 = g_2$$

for all $g_1, g_2 : c \rightarrow a$.

Definition 2.6.32 (Epimorphism)

A morphism $f : a \rightarrow b$ is said to be an **epimorphism** (or **epic**) if

$$g_1 \circ f = g_2 \circ f \implies g_1 = g_2$$

for all $g_1, g_2 : b \rightarrow c$.

Definition 2.6.33 (Split-monic / Section)

A morphism $f : a \rightarrow b$ is **split-monic** if it has a left inverse, $g : b \rightarrow a$

$$g \circ f = 1_a$$

We say g is a **section** of f .

Definition 2.6.34 (Split-epic / Retraction)

A morphism $f : a \rightarrow b$ is **split-epic** if it has a right inverse, $g : b \rightarrow a$

$$f \circ g = 1_b$$

We say g is a **retraction** of f .

Proposition 2.6.35 (Split Monic $\implies$ Monic)

For a general category $\mathcal{C}$ we have

- $\text{split-monic} \implies \text{monic}$
- $\text{split-epic} \implies \text{epic}$

We say an **isomorphism** is a morphism with a two-sided inverse. We can refine the criteria for f to be an isomorphism using the notions just defined

Proposition 2.6.36 (Isomorphism Criteria)

Let $f : a \rightarrow b$ be a morphism. Then the following are equivalent

- a) f is an **isomorphism**
- b) f is both **split-epic** and **split-monic**
- c) f is **split-epic** and **monic**
- d) f is **split-monic** and **epic**

In this case a morphism g is a retraction if and only if it is a section. And such a g is unique, so we denote it by f^{-1}

Proof. This is mostly formal

1 $\implies$ 2) Clear.

2 $\implies$ 3, 4) This follows from (2.6.35).

3 $\implies$ 2) Suppose g is a retraction of f , that is $fg = 1_b$. Then $f(gf) = (fg)f = 1_b \circ f = f = f \circ 1_a$. As f is monic we conclude that $gf = 1_a$ and g is a section of f .

4 $\implies$ 2) Analogous

2 $\implies$ 1) We've shown that any retraction is a section and vice-versa. Furthermore by monic/epic-ness a retraction or section is unique. $\square$

Proposition 2.6.37

For the category **Set** we have

- $\text{split-monic} \iff \text{monic} \iff \text{injective}$
- $\text{split-epic} \iff \text{epic} \iff \text{surjective}$
- $\text{isomorphism} \iff \text{bijective}$

Definition 2.6.38 (Preserves/Reflects)

Let $\mathcal{P}$ be a property of morphisms and $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be a functor then we say

- F **preserves** $\mathcal{P}$ if $(f \text{ satisfies } \mathcal{P} \implies F(f) \text{ satisfies } \mathcal{P})$
- F **reflects** $\mathcal{P}$ if $(F(f) \text{ satisfies } \mathcal{P} \implies f \text{ satisfies } \mathcal{P})$

Proposition 2.6.39

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be a covariant functor then

- F preserves split-monic, split-epic and iso morphisms.

If in addition F is faithful then

- F reflects monic and epic morphisms.

and if F is full and faithful then

- F reflects split-epic, split-monic and isomorphisms.

Similar statements apply when F is contravariant.

Proof. The first statement is easy, for example if $gf = 1_a$ then $F(g) \circ F(f) = 1_{F(a)}$.

Suppose F is faithful, $F(f)$ is monic and $fg_1 = fg_2$. Then $F(f)F(g_1) = F(f)F(g_2) \implies F(g_1) = F(g_2)$ by assumption. As F is faithful $g_1 = g_2$ as required. The other statement is similar.

Suppose F is full and faithful and $F(f)$ is split-monic. Then $hF(f) = 1_{F(a)}$. As F is full $h = F(g)$ and $1_{F(a)} = F(gf)$. As F is faithful then $gf = 1_a$. the other statements are similar. $\square$

Proposition 2.6.40

Let $(\mathcal{C}, U)$ be a *concrete category* then

- f split-monic $\implies f$ injective $\implies f$ monic
- f split-epic $\implies f$ surjective $\implies f$ epic
- f isomorphism $\implies f$ bijective

Proof. Suppose f is split-monic, then $U(f)$ is split-monic by (2.6.39) and so by (2.6.37) $U(f)$ is injective.

Suppose $U(f)$ injective, then by (2.6.37) $U(f)$ is monic. By (2.6.39) U reflects monics and so f is monic.

The other statements are similar. $\square$

We can restate the criteria for split-epic/split-monic

Proposition 2.6.41

Let $f : a \rightarrow b$ be a morphism then

- f is split-monic if and only if $\text{Mor}(f, c)$ is surjective for all $c \in \mathcal{C}$
- f is epic if and only if $\text{Mor}(f, c)$ is injective for all $c \in \mathcal{C}$

dually

- f is split-epic if and only if $\text{Mor}(c, f)$ is surjective for all $c \in \mathcal{C}$
- f is monic if and only if $\text{Mor}(c, f)$ is injective for all $c \in \mathcal{C}$

Proof. f is epic (resp. monic) iff $\text{Mor}(f, c)$ (resp. $\text{Mor}(c, f)$) is injective precisely by the definitions.

Suppose f is split-monic, then $gf = 1_a \implies (hg)f = h$ for any h . That is $\text{Mor}(f, c)$ is surjective. Conversely if it's surjective then let $c = b$ and choose g such that $gf = \text{Mor}(f, b)(g) = 1_a$.

A similar statement follows dually for f split-epic, and f monic. $\square$

Corollary 2.6.42 (Isomorphism Criteria)

Let $f : a \rightarrow b$ be a morphism then TFAE

- f is an isomorphism
- $\text{Mor}(f, c)$ is bijective for all $c \in \mathcal{C}$
- $\text{Mor}(c, f)$ is bijective for all $c \in \mathcal{C}$

Proof. This follows from combining (2.6.41) with (2.6.36). $\square$

Definition 2.6.43 (Algebraic Category)

We say a concrete category $(\mathcal{C}, U)$ is an algebraic category if

- U reflects (and preserves) isomorphisms
- $\mathcal{C}$ has directed limits and U commutes with them

2.6.5 Directed Limits

Definition 2.6.44 (Directed Category)

We say a category I is **directed** if

- It is small
- For any $i, j \in \text{ob}(I)$ we have at most one morphism $i \rightarrow j$ (NB bit non-standard)
- For any $i, j \in \text{ob}(I)$ there is a k and morphisms $i \rightarrow k$ and $j \rightarrow k$

If there is a morphism $i \rightarrow j$ then we write $i \prec j$.

Definition 2.6.45 (Direct limit)

Let I be a directed category and $F : I \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ a functor (“diagram”). We write $A_i := F(i)$ and $\rho_{ij} : A_i \rightarrow A_j$ when $i \prec j$. Observe that

$$\rho_{jk} \circ \rho_{ij} = \rho_{ik} \quad \forall i, j, k \text{ s.t. } i \prec j, j \prec k.$$

A **cone** over F is a pair $(A, \{\phi_i^A : A_i \rightarrow A\}_{i \in I})$ for $A \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$ which satisfies

$$\phi_j^A \circ \rho_{ij} = \phi_i^A \quad \forall i, j \text{ s.t. } i \prec j.$$

The cones form a category where morphisms consist of morphisms $\psi : A \rightarrow B$ such that

$$\psi \circ \phi_i^A = \phi_i^B$$

A **directed limit** is a cone $(\varinjlim_i A_i, \{\phi_i : A_i \rightarrow \varinjlim_i A\})$ for which given any other cone (A, ϕ_i^A) there exists a unique morphism of cones

$$(\varinjlim_i A_i, \phi_i) \rightarrow (A, \phi_i^A).$$

In other words it is an initial object in the category of cones over F .

Proposition 2.6.46 (Direct limit of sets)

Let I be a directed category and $F : I \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ be a diagram of sets. Write $A_i = F(i)$ and $\rho_{ij} : A_i \rightarrow A_j$ for the unique morphism whenever $i \prec j$. We may construct a direct limit as follows

$$\varinjlim_i A_i := \{(i, x) \mid i \in I, x \in A_i\} / \sim$$

where we consider the equivalence relation

$$(i, x) \sim (j, y)$$

if for some $k \in I$ we have $i \prec k, j \prec k$ and $\rho_{ik}(x) = \rho_{jk}(y)$.

Proposition 2.6.47 (Restricted Direct Limit)

Let I be a directed category and I' a full subcategory which is also directed. Suppose the limits

$$A := \varinjlim_{i \in I} A_i$$

$$A' := \varinjlim_{i \in I'} A_i$$

exist. Then there is a unique morphism

$$\Phi : A' \rightarrow A$$

such that

$$\Phi \circ \phi'_{i'} = \phi_{i'} \quad \forall i' \in I'$$

Suppose in addition that there exists $\pi : \text{ob}(I) \rightarrow \text{ob}(I')$ such that $\pi(i) \prec i$. Then this morphism is an isomorphism with two-sided inverse $\Psi : A \rightarrow A'$ such that $\Psi \circ \phi_{i'} = \phi'_{i'}$ for all $i' \in I'$.

Proof. Given the property we may define a morphism $\Psi : A \rightarrow A'$ such that $\Psi \circ \phi_i = \phi'_{\pi(i)} \circ \rho_{i\pi(i)}$. Then considering the morphism $\Phi \circ \Psi : A \rightarrow A$ we see

$$\Phi \circ \Psi \circ \phi_i = \Phi \circ \phi'_{\pi(i)} \circ \rho_{i\pi(i)} = \phi_{\pi(i)} \circ \rho_{i\pi(i)} = \phi_i \quad \forall i \in I$$

By uniqueness $\Phi \circ \Psi = 1_A$. Similarly

$$\Psi \circ \Phi \circ \phi'_{i'} = \Psi \circ \phi_{i'} = \phi'_{\pi(i')} \circ \rho_{i'\pi(i')} = \phi'_{i'}$$

whence $\Psi \circ \Phi = 1_{A'}$ as required. $\square$

2.6.6 Adjoint Functors

Some universal constructions may be expressed as an adjoint pair of functors. Using this concept we can simplify the verification of universal properties by appealing to general criteria for adjoint functors as below.

Definition 2.6.48 (Adjoint Pair)

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ and $G : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ be functors. We say that F is **left adjoint** to G if there is a bijection

$$\psi_{c,d} : \text{Mor}(F(c), d) \longrightarrow \text{Mor}(c, G(d))$$

which is natural in c and d in the following sense. Let $\alpha : c' \rightarrow c$, $\beta : d \rightarrow d'$, then for all $f : F(c) \rightarrow d$ we have

$$\psi_{c',d'}(\beta \circ f \circ F(\alpha)) = G(\beta) \circ \psi_{c,d}(f) \circ \alpha \quad (2.10)$$

or equivalently for all $g : c \rightarrow G(d)$

$$\beta \circ \psi_{c,d}^{-1}(g) \circ F(\alpha) = \psi_{c',d'}^{-1}(G(\beta) \circ g \circ \alpha) \quad (2.11)$$

Proposition 2.6.49 (Adjoint $\implies$ unit, counit)

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ and $G : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ be adjoint functors with relationship

$$\psi_{c,d} : \text{Mor}(F(c), d) \longrightarrow \text{Mor}(c, G(d))$$

Then we have two natural transformations (**unit** and **counit** respectively)

$$\begin{aligned} \eta : \mathbf{1} &\Rightarrow G \circ F \\ \epsilon : F \circ G &\Rightarrow \mathbf{1} \end{aligned}$$

defined by

$$\begin{aligned} \eta_c &= \psi_{c,F(c)}(1_{F(c)}) \\ \epsilon_d &= \psi_{G(d),d}^{-1}(1_{G(d)}) \end{aligned}$$

Furthermore we may recover the adjoint relationship via

$$\begin{aligned} \psi_{c,d}(f) &= G(f) \circ \eta_c \\ \psi_{c,d}^{-1}(g) &= \epsilon_d \circ F(g) \end{aligned}$$

Proof. We show that the transformations given are natural. Suppose $\alpha : c \rightarrow c'$ then

$$\begin{aligned} G(F(\alpha)) \circ \eta_c &= G(F(\alpha)) \circ \psi_{c,F(c)}(1_{F(c)}) \\ &= \psi_{c,F(c')} (F(\alpha) \circ 1_{F(c)}) \quad (2.10) \\ &= \psi_{c,F(c')} (1_{F(c')} \circ F(\alpha)) \\ &= \psi_{c',F(c')} (1_{F(c')} \circ \alpha) \quad (2.10) \\ &= \eta_{c'} \circ \alpha \end{aligned}$$

so η is a natural transformation. Furthermore

$$\psi_{c,d}(f) = \psi_{c,d}(f \circ 1_{F(c)}) = G(f) \circ \psi_{c,F(c)}(1) = G(f) \circ \eta_c$$

as required. Similarly for $\beta : d \rightarrow d'$

$$\begin{aligned}
 \beta \circ \epsilon_d &= \beta \circ \psi_{G(d),d}^{-1}(1_{G(d)}) \\
 &= \psi_{G(d),d'}^{-1}(G(\beta) \circ 1_{G(d)}) \quad (2.11) \\
 &= \psi_{G(d),d'}^{-1}(1_{G(d')} \circ G(\beta)) \\
 &= \psi_{G(d'),d'}^{-1}(1_{G(d')} \circ F(G(\beta))) \quad (2.11) \\
 &= \epsilon_{d'} \circ F(G(\beta))
 \end{aligned}$$

□

Given two natural transformations we may recover a corresponding adjoint

Proposition 2.6.50 (Adjoint from unit and counit)

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ and $G : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ be functors with two natural transformations

$$\begin{aligned}
 \eta : \mathbf{1} &\Rightarrow G \circ F \\
 \epsilon : F \circ G &\Rightarrow \mathbf{1}
 \end{aligned}$$

Then the following are equivalent

- a) F is left adjoint to G with unit and counit η, ϵ , and
- b) the so-called **triangular identities** are satisfied

$$1_{G(d)} : G(d) \xrightarrow{\eta_{G(d)}} GFG(d) \xrightarrow{G(\epsilon_d)} G(d) \quad (2.12)$$

$$1_{F(c)} : F(c) \xrightarrow{F(\eta_c)} FGF(c) \xrightarrow{\epsilon_{F(c)}} F(c) \quad (2.13)$$

More precisely the adjunction is given by

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \text{Mor}(F(c), d) & \xleftrightarrow[\psi]{\phi} & \text{Mor}(c, G(d)) \\
 f & \longrightarrow & G(f) \circ \eta_c \\
 \epsilon_d \circ F(g) & \longleftarrow & g
 \end{array}$$

Proof. Let ψ, ϕ denote the proposed adjunction maps. We will use the triangular identities to show that these are mutually inverse. First observe by naturality of η and ϵ that

$$\psi\phi(g) = G(\epsilon_d \circ F(g)) \circ \eta_c = G(\epsilon_d) \circ \eta_{G(d)} \circ g \quad (2.14)$$

$$\phi\psi(f) = \epsilon_d \circ F(G(f) \circ \eta_c) = f \circ \epsilon_{F(c)} \circ F(\eta_c) \quad (2.15)$$

It's then immediate that these are mutually inverse maps if and only if the triangular identities are satisfied (one way is obvious, the other way consider $f = 1_{F(c)}$ and $g = 1_{G(d)}$).

Further one may easily verify that ψ, ϕ so-defined are natural in c and d

$$\begin{aligned}
 \psi(\beta \circ f \circ F(\alpha)) &= G(\beta) \circ G(f) \circ GF(\alpha) \circ \eta_c \\
 &= G(\beta) \circ G(f) \circ \eta_{c'} \circ \alpha \\
 &= G(\beta) \circ \psi(f) \circ \alpha
 \end{aligned}$$

□

Proposition 2.6.51 (Criteria for right adjoint to be full and faithful)

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ and $G : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ be adjoint functors with η, ϵ unit and counit transformations. Then

- G is faithful if and only if ϵ is pointwise epic
- G is full if and only if ϵ is pointwise split-monic
- G is full and faithful if and only if ϵ is a pointwise isomorphism

Proof. Consider the composite map

$$\text{Mor}(d', d) \xrightarrow{\text{Mor}(\epsilon_{d'}, d)} \text{Mor}(F(G(d')), d) \xrightarrow{\psi_{G(d'), d}} \text{Mor}(G(d'), G(d))$$

which is natural in d and d' . Note that image of $\alpha \in \text{Mor}(d', d)$ is

$$\psi_{G(d'), d}(\alpha \circ \epsilon_{d'}) = G(\alpha) \circ \psi_{G(d'), d'}(\epsilon_{d'}) = G(\alpha)$$

so the composite is just $G(-)$. The second map is bijective by the adjoint assumption. Therefore the first map is injective (resp. surjective) if and only if G is faithful (resp. full).

By (2.6.41) $\text{Mor}(\epsilon_{d'}, d)$ is injective (resp. surjective) for all d, d' if and only if $\epsilon_{d'}$ is epic (resp. split-monic) for all d' .

Then the first two statements follow easily. The last statement follows from the previous two, combined with (2.6.36). $\square$

The following criteria will be useful

Proposition 2.6.52 (Alternative Characterization)

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ and $G : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ be functors. Suppose that we have natural transformations

$$\epsilon : F \circ G \Rightarrow \mathbf{1}$$

$$\eta : \mathbf{1} \Rightarrow G \circ F$$

such that the first **triangular identity** is true

$$G(\epsilon_d) \circ \eta_{G(d)} = 1_{G(d)}$$

and one of the following holds

- The map $\psi : \text{Mor}(F(c), d) \xrightarrow{G(-) \circ \eta_c} \text{Mor}(c, G(d))$ is injective
- The map $\phi : \text{Mor}(c, G(d)) \xrightarrow{\epsilon_d \circ F(-)} \text{Mor}(F(c), d)$ is surjective

Then η, ϵ induce an adjoint relationship between F and G as in (2.6.50).

Proof. Recall the proposed adjoint maps from (2.6.50), ψ and ϕ , where we also demonstrated that

$$\psi(\phi(f)) = G(\epsilon_d) \circ \eta_{G(d)} \circ f$$

Then the first hypothesis clearly implies $\psi\phi = 1$, i.e. ϕ has a left-inverse and ψ has a right inverse.

Suppose that the given map ψ is injective, then by (2.6.37) ψ has a left-inverse too. By (2.6.36) ψ is an isomorphism with inverse $\psi^{-1} = \phi$.

The case that ϕ is surjective is similar. $\square$

2.6.7 Yoneda Lemma

The motivation for the following result becomes more clear in the next section. Roughly speaking properties of an object, c , are encoded in the functor $\text{Mor}(c, -)$.

Proposition 2.6.53 (Yoneda Lemma)

Suppose $c, c' \in \mathcal{C}$ then there is a bijection between morphisms and natural transformation of functors

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Mor}(c', c) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{Nat}(\text{Mor}(c, -), \text{Mor}(c', -)) \\ f & \longrightarrow & \text{Mor}(f, -) : (\phi \rightarrow \phi \circ f) \\ \alpha_c(1_c) & \longleftarrow & \alpha \end{array}$$

Observe that under this correspondence

- $f = \text{Mor}(f, c)(1_c)$
- $\text{Mor}(f \circ g, -) = \text{Mor}(g, -) \circ \text{Mor}(f, -)$
- f is an isomorphism $\iff \text{Mor}(f, -)$ is a natural isomorphism.

In the latter case $\text{Mor}(f, -)^{-1} = \text{Mor}(f^{-1}, -)$

In many cases the set of morphisms $\text{Mor}(c, c')$ has an additional structure (typically an abelian group or module). We encode this with the following definition

Definition 2.6.54 (Enriched Hom Functor)

Let $(\mathcal{S}, U)$ be a *concrete category* for which U reflects isomorphisms. We say a bifunctor

$$\text{Hom} : \mathcal{C}^{op} \times \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{S}$$

is an **enriched hom functor** if we have

- $U(\text{Hom}(c, d)) = \text{Mor}(c, d)$
- $U(\text{Hom}(f, d)) = \text{Mor}(f, d)$
- $U(\text{Hom}(c, g)) = \text{Mor}(c, g)$

and bijections

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & \text{Mor}(c', c) & \\ \text{Hom}(f, -) \swarrow & & \searrow \text{Mor}(f, -) \\ \text{Nat}(\text{Hom}(c, -), \text{Hom}(c', -)) & \xrightarrow[\sim]{U} & \text{Nat}(\text{Mor}(c, -), \text{Mor}(c', -)) \end{array}$$

Write the inverse of $f \rightarrow \text{Hom}(f, -)$ as $\mathcal{Y}$. Then for $\alpha \in \text{Nat}(\text{Hom}(c, -), \text{Hom}(c', -))$

- a) α is a natural isomorphism $\iff U\alpha$ is a natural isomorphism $\iff \mathcal{Y}(\alpha)$ is an isomorphism.
- b) $\mathcal{Y}(\alpha) = U(\alpha_c)(1_c)$

Note the right hand arrow is always a bijection by Yoneda's Lemma (2.6.53) and the diagram always commutes by assumption.

Proof. Suppose α is a natural isomorphism then $U\alpha^{-1} \circ U\alpha = U(1_{\text{Hom}(c, -)}) = 1_{\text{Mor}(c, -)}$ and similarly $U\alpha \circ U\alpha^{-1} = 1_{\text{Mor}(c', -)}$, so $U\alpha$ is a natural isomorphism. □

Note this trivially includes the usual case $\mathcal{S} = \mathbf{Set}$.

2.6.8 Representable Functors

Many algebraic constructions (e.g. tensor product) may be formalised in terms of “representable” functors (2.6.55). The usual definition involves the set-valued functor $\text{Mor}(c, -)$ as defined in (2.6.13).

As a generalisation follows we consider an *enriched hom functor* $\text{Hom}(-, -)$ taking values in the concrete category $(\mathcal{S}, U)$ where U reflects isomorphisms. This clearly generalises the usual case.

Definition 2.6.55 (Representable Functor)

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{S}$ a covariant functor. We say F is **representable** if there is a pair (x, Φ) where $x \in \mathcal{C}$ and Φ is a natural isomorphism

$$\text{Hom}(x, -) \xrightarrow[\sim]{\Phi} F(-)$$

We say F is **represented** by the pair (x, Φ) . Note this implies $U \circ F$ is represented by $U\Phi$.

It is often useful to have another conception of representable functor in terms of universal properties as this is more intuitive for applications.

Definition 2.6.56 (Universal Element)

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{S}$ be a covariant functor, then we say that a pair (x, i) , where $x \in \mathcal{C}, i \in (U \circ F)(x)$, is a **universal element** for F if for all $c \in \mathcal{C}$ there are bijections

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Mor}(x, c) & \longrightarrow & (U \circ F)(c) \\ f & \longrightarrow & (U \circ F)(f)(i) \end{array} \quad (2.16)$$

In this case we may also say F is **represented** by the universal element (x, i) .

We show the equivalence of the two notions by some abstract nonsense

Proposition 2.6.57 (Representable Set-Valued Functor = Universal Element)

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ be a covariant functor then there is a natural correspondence between representations and universal elements

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{representations of } F \end{array} \right\} & \longleftrightarrow & \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{universal elements of } F \end{array} \right\} \\
(x, \Phi) & \longrightarrow & (x, \Phi(1_x)) \\
(x, f \rightarrow F(f)(i)) & \longleftarrow & (x, i)
\end{array}$$

The following may in particular be used to show that representations are unique up to isomorphism.

Proposition 2.6.58 (Morphisms Between Representations)

Suppose (x, Φ) and (x', Φ') represent the covariant functors $F, F' : \mathcal{C}^{op} \rightarrow \mathcal{S}$ respectively. Then there are bijections

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
\text{Mor}(x, x') & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{Nat}(\text{Hom}(x', -), \text{Hom}(x, -)) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{Nat}(F'(-), F(-)) \\
f & \rightarrow & \text{Hom}(f, -) & \rightarrow & \widehat{f} \\
U(\eta_{x'})(1_{x'}) & \leftarrow & \eta & \leftarrow & \alpha
\end{array}$$

where we define the mutual inverses

$$\begin{aligned}
\widehat{f} &= \Phi \circ \text{Hom}(f, -) \circ (\Phi')^{-1} \\
\alpha^* &= U(\Phi_{x'}^{-1} \circ \alpha_{x'} \circ \Phi'_{x'})(1_{x'})
\end{aligned}$$

Note this has the following properties

- $\widehat{1_x} = \text{id}_F$
- $\widehat{g \circ f} = \widehat{f} \circ \widehat{g}$ where $g : x' \rightarrow x''$ is morphism and (x'', Φ'') represents F''
- f is an isomorphism $\iff \widehat{f}$ is a natural isomorphism and in this case $\widehat{f^{-1}} = \widehat{f}^{-1}$.

Further $\alpha^* \in \text{Mor}(x, x')$ is the unique morphism such that the following diagram of natural transformations commutes

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\text{Hom}(x', -) & \xrightarrow{\Phi'} & F'(-) \\
\text{Hom}(\alpha^*, -) \downarrow \text{=} \downarrow & & \downarrow \alpha \\
\text{Hom}(x, -) & \xrightarrow{\Phi} & F(-)
\end{array}$$

and satisfies

- $\text{id}_F^* = 1_x$
- $(\beta \circ \alpha)^* = \alpha^* \circ \beta^*$
- α^* is an isomorphism $\iff \alpha$ is a natural isomorphism

Proof. The first bijection is simply the Yoneda Lemma and the second bijection is obvious. □

Corollary 2.6.59 (Representation is Unique)

Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{S}$ be a covariant functor which is represented by pairs (x, Φ) and (x', Φ') . Then they are isomorphic with two-sided inverses

$$x \xrightleftharpoons[U(\Phi'^{-1})(i)]{U(\Phi^{-1})(i')} x'$$

where $i := (U\Phi)(1_x)$ and $i' := (U\Phi')(1_{x'})$.

Proof. We may apply the previous result with $F = F'$ and the identity natural transformation id_F . □

In practice we typically have a family of representations, and we want to show the construction is functorial

Definition 2.6.60 (Representable Bifunctor)

Let $F : \mathcal{D}^{op} \times \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{S}$ be a bifunctor. We say that it is **representable** by (G, Φ) where $G : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ is a functor, if Φ is a natural isomorphism of bifunctors

$$\Phi : \text{Hom}(G(-), -) \xrightarrow{\sim} F(-, -)$$

The following shows we only need to construct the representation pointwise.

Proposition 2.6.61

Let $F : \mathcal{D}^{op} \times \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{S}$ be a bifunctor such that $F(d, -)$ is representable for all $d \in \mathcal{D}$, by $(G(d), \Phi_d)$. Then G can be made into a covariant functor uniquely such that Φ constitutes a natural isomorphism of bifunctors

$$\Phi : \text{Hom}(G(-), -) \xrightarrow{\sim} F(-, -)$$

Denote by $i_d := (U\Phi)_{d, G(d)}(1_{G(d)}) \in (U \circ F)(d, G(d))$ the universal element corresponding to d . Then we have

$$(U \circ F)(1_d \times G(h))(i_d) = (U\Phi)_{d, G(d)}(G(h)) = (U \circ F)(h \times 1_{G(d')})(i_{d'})$$

Proof. It is straightforward to verify that for any covariant functor G , the mapping $\text{Mor}(G(-), -)$ is a bifunctor (contravariant in the first “slot”).

By (2.6.20) $F(h, -) : F(d', -) \rightarrow F(d, -)$ is a natural transformation. Therefore we may define

$$G(h) := F(h, -)^*$$

in the notation of (2.6.58). Explicitly we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Hom}(G(d'), -) & \xrightarrow{\Phi_{d'}} & F(d', -) \\ \text{Hom}(G(h), -) \downarrow \text{Hom} & & \downarrow F(h, -) \\ \text{Hom}(G(d), -) & \xrightarrow{\Phi_d} & F(d, -) \end{array}$$

Furthermore $G(h \circ k) = F(h \circ k, -)^* = (F(k, -) \circ F(h, -))^* = F(h, -)^* \circ F(k, -)^* = G(h) \circ G(k)$. We conclude by (2.6.21) that Φ is a natural transformation of bifunctors.

The last statement follows by chasing $1_{G(d')}$ round the commutative diagram and using Equation (2.16). $\square$

Example 2.6.62 (Concrete Interpretation)

Let $\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{D}$ be concrete categories and consider the following bifunctor

$$\begin{aligned} F & : \mathcal{D}^{op} \times \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set} \\ F(d, c) & := \{\phi : d \rightarrow c \mid P(\phi)\} \end{aligned}$$

where $P(-)$ is some predicate such that $P(\phi) \implies P(g \circ \phi \circ f)$. Then the universal element is simply an object $G(d) \in \mathcal{C}$ together with a mapping

$$i_d : d \rightarrow G(d)$$

satisfying P such that there is a bijection

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}(G(d), c) & \xrightarrow{\sim} F(d, c) := \{f : d \rightarrow c \mid P(f)\} \\ \phi & \longmapsto \phi \circ i_d \end{aligned}$$

The functoriality of G corresponds to a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} d & \xrightarrow{f} & d' \\ \downarrow i_d & & \downarrow i_{d'} \\ G(d) & \xrightarrow{G(f)} & G(d') \end{array}$$

where $G(f)$ is the unique morphism making the diagram commute.

Proposition 2.6.63 (Functorial Yoneda Lemma)

Let $G, G' : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ be functors. Then there is a bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Nat}(G(-), G'(-)) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{Nat}(\text{Hom}(G'(-), -) \text{Hom}(G(-), -)) \\ f_d & \rightarrow & \text{Hom}(f_d, 1_c) \\ U(\eta_{d, G'(d)})(1_{G'(d)}) & \leftarrow & \eta_{d, c} \end{array}$$

We have the following properties

- $\widehat{\text{id}_G} = \text{id}$
- $\widehat{g \circ f} = \widehat{f} \circ \widehat{g}$
- f is a natural isomorphism iff $\text{Hom}(f, -)$ is a natural isomorphism

Proof. In order to demonstrate that $\text{Hom}(f_d, 1_c)$ is a natural transformation of bifunctors it's enough by (2.6.20) to show the following diagram commutes for $h : d' \rightarrow d$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Hom}(G'(d), c) & \xrightarrow{\circ f_d} & \text{Hom}(G(d), c) \\ \downarrow \circ G'(h) & & \downarrow \circ G(h) \\ \text{Hom}(G'(d'), c) & \xrightarrow{\circ f_{d'}} & \text{Hom}(G(d'), c) \end{array}$$

However $f_d \circ G(h) = G'(h) \circ f_{d'}$ by definition of natural transformation, from which it follows immediately. The map is a pointwise bijection (for every $d \in D$) with the inverse given by the usual Yoneda Lemma.

The first two properties are straightforward. From these it follows that if f is a natural isomorphism then so is $\text{Hom}(f, -)$. Conversely if $\text{Hom}(f, -)$ is a natural isomorphism then it has a two-sided inverse which is of the form $\text{Hom}(g, -)$. It's then straightforward to argue that g is a two-sided inverse of f . □

2.6.9 Product and Coproduct

Proposition 2.6.64 (Categorical Product)

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category, $\{c_i\}_{i \in J}$ a family of objects and $c' \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) There exists “projection” maps $\pi_i : c' \rightarrow c_i$ such that

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}(c, c') &\longrightarrow \prod_{j \in J} \text{Mor}(c, c_j) \\ f &\longrightarrow (\pi_i \circ f)_{i \in J} \end{aligned}$$

is a bijection for all $c \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$, i.e. $(c', (\pi_j)_{j \in J})$ is a universal element for the contravariant functor $\prod_{j \in J} \text{Mor}(-, c_j)$

- b) There is a natural isomorphism

$$\Phi : \text{Mor}(-, c') \xrightarrow{\sim} \prod_{j \in J} \text{Mor}(-, c_j)$$

i.e. (c', Φ) represents the contravariant functor $\prod_{j \in J} \text{Mor}(-, c_j)$

More precisely $(\pi_j)_{j \in J} = \Phi(1_{c'})$ and $\Phi(f) = (\pi_j \circ f)_{j \in J}$.

We denote such an object by $\prod_{j \in J} c_j$ together with a family of projection maps $\pi_j : \prod_{j \in J} c_j \rightarrow c_j$.

Proposition 2.6.65 (Categorical Coproduct)

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category, $\{c_j\}_{j \in J}$ a family of objects and $c' \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) There exists “injection” maps $i_j : c_j \rightarrow c'$ such that

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}(c', c) &\longrightarrow \prod_{j \in J} \text{Mor}(c_j, c) \\ f &\longrightarrow (f \circ i_j)_{j \in J} \end{aligned}$$

is a bijection for all $c \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$, i.e. $(c', i_{j \in J})$ is a universal element for the contravariant functor $\prod_{j \in J} \text{Mor}(c_j, -)$

- b) There is a natural isomorphism

$$\Phi : \text{Mor}(c', -) \xrightarrow{\sim} \prod_{j \in J} \text{Mor}(c_j, -)$$

i.e. (c', Φ) represents the covariant functor $\prod_{j \in J} \text{Mor}(c_j, -)$

More precisely $(i_j)_{j \in J} = \Phi(1_{c'})$ and $\Phi(f) = (f \circ i_j)_{j \in J}$.

We denote such an object by $\coprod_{j \in J} c_j$ together with a family of injection maps $i_j : c_j \rightarrow \coprod_{j \in J} c_j$.

Proposition 2.6.66 (Functoriality of Product)

Let $c, c', d, d' \in \mathcal{C}$ be such that $c \times d$ and $c' \times d'$ exists. For $f : c \rightarrow c'$ and $g : d \rightarrow d'$ there exists a unique morphism

$$f \times g : c \times d \rightarrow c' \times d'$$

such that

$$\pi_{c'} \circ (f \times g) = f \circ \pi_c$$

and

$$\pi_{d'} \circ (f \times g) = g \circ \pi_d$$

If $\mathcal{C}$ has all binary products then this determines a bifunctor

$$\times : \mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$$

Proof. We have

$$(f \circ \pi_c, g \circ \pi_d) \in \text{Mor}(c \times d, c') \times \text{Mor}(c \times d, d')$$

By the universal property of $c' \times d'$ we have a morphism

$$(f \times g) \in \text{Mor}(c \times d, c' \times d')$$

satisfying the required properties.

The uniqueness shows that we have functoriality, namely

$$(h \times k) \circ (f \times g) = (h \circ f) \times (k \circ g)$$

□

Chapter 3

Algebra

3.1 Introduction

Follows largely Lang with some Bourbaki.

3.2 Magmas and Monoids

Definition 3.2.1 (Magma)

Let X be a set. A **law of composition** on $X \times X$ is a function

$$\cdot : X \times X \rightarrow X$$

and we typically write the composition of $x, y \in X$ as either

$$x \cdot y$$

or xy , or $x + y$ in the commutative case.

A pair $(X, \cdot)$ consisting of a set X and law of composition on X is called a **magma**.

Definition 3.2.2 (Magma/Monoid)

A **magma** $(X, \cdot)$ is said to be

- **associative** if $(x \cdot y) \cdot z = x \cdot (y \cdot z)$
- **commutative** if $x \cdot y = y \cdot x$ for all $x, y \in X$
- **unital** if there exists $e \in X$ such that $e \cdot x = x \cdot e = x$ for all $x \in X$. Such an e is called an **identity**.
- a **monoid** if it is both **associative** and **unital**

Proposition 3.2.3 (Identity is Unique)

A magma $(X, \cdot)$ has at most one element e such that

$$x \cdot e = e \cdot x = x$$

for all $x \in X$.

Definition 3.2.4 (Invertible / Monoid)

Let $(X, \cdot)$ be a unital magma. An element $x \in X$ is **invertible** if there exists $y \in X$ such that

$$x \cdot y = y \cdot x = e$$

Proposition 3.2.5 (Inverses are unique)

Let $(X, \cdot)$ be a monoid. If $x \in X$ is invertible then its inverse is unique and denoted x^{-1} .

Proof. Suppose that $xy = xy' = e = yx = y'x$. Then

$$xy = e \implies y'(xy) = y'e = y' \implies (y'x)y = y' \implies y = y'$$

□

Definition 3.2.6 (Homomorphism)

Let $(X, \cdot), (Y, \cdot)$ be magmas. Then a function $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ is said to be a **magma homomorphism** if it satisfies

$$\phi(x_1 \cdot x_2) = \phi(x_1) \cdot \phi(x_2) \quad \forall x_1, x_2 \in X$$

If $(X, \cdot)$ and $(Y, \cdot)$ are unital then ϕ is **unital** if

$$\phi(e_X) = e_Y$$

If $(X, \cdot)$ and $(Y, \cdot)$ are monoids then ϕ is a **monoid morphism** if it satisfies both these conditions.

Proposition 3.2.7 ($\mathbb{N}$ is an initial object)

Let $(X, \cdot)$ be a monoid and $x \in X$. Then there is a unique monoid morphism

$$x^{(-)} : (\mathbb{N}, +) \rightarrow (X, \cdot)$$

such that

$$x^1 = x$$

Furthermore if $\phi : (X, \cdot) \rightarrow (Y, \cdot)$ is a monoid morphism then

$$\phi(x^n) = \phi(x)^n$$

for all $x \in X$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Proposition 3.2.8 ($\mathbb{Z}$ is an initial object)

Let $(X, \cdot)$ be a monoid and $x \in X$ be an invertible element. Then there is a unique monoid morphism

$$x^{(-)} : (\mathbb{Z}, +) \rightarrow (X, \cdot)$$

such that

$$x^1 = x$$

and

$$x^{-n} \text{ is the inverse of } x^n$$

Furthermore if $\phi : (X, \cdot) \rightarrow (Y, \cdot)$ is monoid morphism then

$$\phi(x^n) = \phi(x)^n$$

for all $x \in X$ invertible and $n \in \mathbb{Z}$.

3.3 Groups

Definition 3.3.1 (Group)

A **group** is a **monoid** $(G, \cdot)$ in which every element is invertible.

A group G is said to be **abelian** if the binary operation is **commutative**. In this case we typically write the group operation additively

$$g + h$$

Definition 3.3.2 (Subgroup, Normal Subgroup)

A **subgroup** $H \leq G$ is a subset with the following properties

- $e_G \in H$
- $x, y \in H \implies xy \in H$
- $x \in H \implies x^{-1} \in H$

A subgroup H is said to be **normal** in G if in addition it satisfies

$$gHg^{-1} := \{ghg^{-1} \mid g \in G\} = H$$

for all $g \in G$. NB it is easily verified that in an abelian group every subgroup is normal.

Proposition 3.3.3 (Subgroup is a group)

Let H be a subgroup of $(G, \cdot)$ then $(H, \cdot|_{H \times H})$ is a group.

Example 3.3.4

$\mathbb{Z}$ is an abelian group under addition. The subgroups are of the form $n\mathbb{Z}$.

Definition 3.3.5

Let $(G, \cdot)$ and $(H, \cdot)$ be groups. A function $\phi : G \rightarrow H$ is a **group homomorphism** if

- $\phi(e_G) = e_H$
- $\phi(x \cdot y) = \phi(x) \cdot \phi(y)$

Define the **image** of ϕ to be

$$\text{Im}(\phi) = \{\phi(g) \mid g \in G\}$$

and the **kernel** to be

$$\ker(\phi) := \{g \in G \mid \phi(g) = e_H\}$$

It may be verified that $\text{Im}(\phi)$ is a subgroup of H and $\ker(\phi)$ is a normal subgroup of G .

Proposition 3.3.6 (Raise to the n -th power)

Let $g \in G$ be a group element. Then there exist a unique group homomorphism

$$g^{(-)} : (\mathbb{Z}, +) \rightarrow (G, \cdot)$$

satisfying

$$g^1 = g$$

In other words such that

$$g^0 = e_G$$

$$g^{n+m} = g^n \cdot g^m \quad \forall n, m \in \mathbb{Z}$$

Proposition 3.3.7

Let $g \in G$ be a group element. Then

$$(g^n)^m = g^{nm}$$

for all integers $n, m \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Definition 3.3.8 (Order of an element)

For $g \in G$ define the **order** of g to be $o(g) := \inf\{n \geq 0 \mid g^n = e\}$ where $\inf \emptyset = \infty$.

We say g has **finite order** if $o(g) \neq \infty$.

Definition 3.3.9 (Subgroup generated by an element)

The **subgroup generated** by an element $g \in G$ is defined to be $\langle g \rangle = \{g^n \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$

It may be shown that when g has finite order n we have

$$\langle g \rangle = \{e, g, \dots, g^{n-1}\}$$

and in particular $\#\langle g \rangle = o(g)$.

Proposition 3.3.10 (Cosets)

Let H be a subgroup of G . The following is an equivalence relation on G

$$g_1 \sim_H g_2 \iff g_1 g_2^{-1} \in H$$

and the equivalence classes are precisely the sets of the form

$$gH = \{gh \mid h \in H\} = [g]_{\sim_H}$$

for some $g \in G$. Such an equivalence class is called a **right coset** and we denote the set of right cosets by

$$G/H$$

Define the **index** of H in G by $[G : H] := \#G/H$. When H is finite each equivalence class has order $\#H$.

We say $\{g_i \in G\}_{i \in I}$ is a set of **coset representatives** for H if the corresponding equivalence classes $\{[g_i]\}_{i \in I}$ are pairwise disjoint and cover G .

Proof. It's trivial to show that $\sim_H$ is an equivalence relation (precisely because H is a subgroup). Therefore by (2.1.6) the equivalence classes form a partition which we denote G/H .

We claim that $[g_1] = g_1 H$. Then $g_2 \in [g_1] \iff g_1 \sim_H g_2 \iff g_2 \sim_H g_1 \iff g_2 g_1^{-1} \in H \iff g_2 \in g_1 H$, which shows that the sets are equal.

The translation map $\psi_g : G \rightarrow G$ given by $g' \rightarrow gg'$ is bijective (for it has a two-sided inverse equal to $\psi_{g^{-1}}$). So in particular restricts to a bijective map $H \rightarrow gH$. This shows that all the cosets have the same order. $\square$

Example 3.3.11

$d\mathbb{Z}$ is a subgroup of $\mathbb{Z}$ of index d . A set of coset representatives are $\{0, 1, \dots, d-1\}$.

Corollary 3.3.12 (Lagrange's Theorem)

Let $H \leq G$ be a subgroup then

$$\#G = [G : H] \times \#H$$

More generally if $K \leq H$ then

$$[G : K] = [G : H][H : K]$$

Example 3.3.13

$d\mathbb{Z} \subseteq e\mathbb{Z} \iff d \mid e$ and $[e\mathbb{Z} : d\mathbb{Z}] = e/d$.

Proposition 3.3.14

Let $g \in G$ be an element of finite order. Then

$$o(g) \mid \#G$$

Furthermore

$$g^n = e \iff o(g) \mid n$$

Proof. The first statement follows because the order $o(g)$ equals the order of the subgroup $\langle g \rangle$ generated by g .

Let $m = o(g)$ then by the division algorithm $n = qm + r$ for some $r < m$. Then $e = g^n = g^{qm+r} = (g^m)^q g^r = e^q g^r = g^r$. By minimality we have $r = 0$ and $m \mid n$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.3.15 (Quotient Group)

Let N be a normal subgroup G . Then the set of cosets

$$G/N$$

forms a group under the binary operation

$$g_1N \cdot g_2N \rightarrow (g_1g_2)N$$

with identity eN .

a) There is a canonical surjective group homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \pi : G &\longrightarrow G/N \\ g &\rightarrow gN \end{aligned}$$

with kernel N .

b) Let $N \subseteq H$ be a subgroup then define the corresponding subgroup of G/N

$$H/N := \pi(H) = \{hN \mid h \in H\}.$$

c) Let $\phi : G \rightarrow G'$ be a homomorphism with $N \subseteq \ker(\phi)$, then there exists a unique homomorphism $\tilde{\phi}$ making the diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} G & \xrightarrow{\phi} & G' \\ \downarrow \pi & \nearrow \tilde{\phi} & \\ G/N & & \end{array}$$

such that

- i) $\text{Im}(\phi) = \text{Im}(\tilde{\phi})$
- ii) $\ker(\tilde{\phi}) = \ker(\phi)/N$

Corollary 3.3.16 (Isomorphism Theorem)

Let $\phi : G \rightarrow H$ be a group homomorphism, then there is a canonical isomorphism

$$G/\ker(\phi) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Im}(\phi)$$

Proposition 3.3.17 (Correspondence Theorem)

Let $\pi : G \rightarrow G'$ be a surjective homomorphism with $\ker(\pi) = N$ then there is a bijective correspondence of subgroups

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \{H \leq G \mid N \subseteq H\} & \longleftrightarrow & \{H' \leq G'\} \\ H & \longrightarrow & \pi(H) \\ \pi^{-1}(H') & \longleftarrow & H' \end{array}$$

which preserves index, that is

$$[G' : H'] = [G : H]$$

Furthermore $\#H' = [H : N]$.

Proposition 3.3.18

Suppose $N \subset G$ and $K \subset N$ are normal subgroups. Then $K \subset G$ is normal and there is a canonical isomorphism

$$(G/N)/(K/N) \xrightarrow{\sim} G/K$$

given by

$$\overline{g + N} \rightarrow g + K$$

3.3.1 Cyclic Groups

Definition 3.3.19

A group G is said to be **cyclic** if there is a surjective group homomorphism

$$(\mathbb{Z}, +) \longrightarrow (G, \cdot)$$

equivalently if there is $g \in G$ such that $\langle g \rangle = G$. Such a g is called a **generator** for G .

Proposition 3.3.20

Consider the additive group $(\mathbb{Z}, +)$. Then

- a) Every subgroup is of the form $d\mathbb{Z}$ for $d \geq 0$ and is itself cyclic
- b) When $d > 0$, then $\mathbb{Z}/d\mathbb{Z}$ has a complete set of coset representatives

$$S := \{0, 1, \dots, d-1\}$$

- c) In particular $[\mathbb{Z} : d\mathbb{Z}] = d$ when $d > 0$
- d) $d\mathbb{Z} \subseteq e\mathbb{Z} \iff e \mid d$ and in this case $[e\mathbb{Z} : d\mathbb{Z}] = \frac{d}{e}$

Proof. We prove each in turn

- a) By (2.2.6) every subgroup is of the form $d\mathbb{Z}$. Multiplication map $[d] : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow d\mathbb{Z}$ shows it is itself cyclic.
- b) By the division algorithm (2.2.5) S is a complete set. Given $i, j \in S$ we note that $|i - j| < d$. And $i \sim_d j \implies d \mid |i - j| \implies |i - j| = 0 \implies i = j$. Therefore the set S consists of distinct coset representatives.
- c) This is clear from the previous step
- d) The first equivalence is clear. By (3.3.12)

$$[\mathbb{Z} : d\mathbb{Z}] = [\mathbb{Z} : e\mathbb{Z}][e\mathbb{Z} : d\mathbb{Z}]$$

and the result follows. □

Proposition 3.3.21

Let G be a cyclic group. Then

- If G is infinite it is isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}$
- If G is finite it is isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ for some $n > 0$

Proof. By the previous Proposition the kernel of the homomorphism $\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow G$ is of the form $n\mathbb{Z}$ for $n \geq 0$. By (...) G is isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$. When $n = 0$ this is canonically isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}$.

By the previous Proposition $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ is finite for $n > 0$ and therefore if G is not finite we must have $n = 0$. Similarly If G is finite then we must have $n > 0$. □

We analyse the structure of finite cyclic groups in more detail. First recall the definition of **Euler's Totient Function**

Definition 3.3.22 (Euler Totient Function)

Define the function

$$\phi(n) = \#\{0 < d \leq n \mid (d, n) = 1\}$$

Proposition 3.3.23 (Finite Cyclic Groups)

Consider a finite cyclic group G of order n . Then

- a) The order of g^r is $\frac{n}{(n,r)}$ where $0 < r \leq n$.
- b) There are $\phi(n)$ generators
- c) For every $d \mid n$ there is a unique subgroup of order n/d given by $\langle g^d \rangle$, which is cyclic.
- d) For $d \mid n$ there are precisely $\phi(d)$ elements of order d
- e) There are precisely d elements of order dividing d

Proof. We prove each in turn

- a) $(g^r)^s = e_G \iff g^{rs} = e_G \xLeftrightarrow{(3.3.14)} n \mid rs \xLeftrightarrow{(2.2.13)} \frac{n}{(n,r)} \mid s$. Therefore g^r has order $\frac{n}{(n,r)}$ as required.
- b) Note h is a generator iff $o(h) = n$. So g^r is a generator iff $(n, r) = 1$ by the previous step. As $G = \{g, g^2, \dots, g^n\}$ the result follows by definition of the totient function.
- c) Recall there is a canonical surjective morphism $\pi : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow G$ with kernel $n\mathbb{Z}$ and $\pi(1) = g$. By (3.3.17) the subgroups H of G correspond bijectively to subgroups H' of $\mathbb{Z}$ containing $n\mathbb{Z}$, preserving the index. By (3.3.20) these are of the form $H' = d\mathbb{Z}$ for $d \mid n$, which correspond under π to subgroups $H = \langle g^d \rangle$. Further $[G : \langle g^d \rangle] = [\mathbb{Z} : d\mathbb{Z}] = d$ whence $\#\langle g^d \rangle = \frac{n}{d}$. By definition $\langle g^d \rangle$ is cyclic.
- d) Let $G[d]$ be the unique (cyclic) subgroup of order d . If h has order d then $\langle h \rangle$ has order d , and therefore by uniqueness is equal to $G[d]$. In particular $h \in G[d]$. Therefore by the previous part there are $\phi(d)$ elements of order d
- e) Suppose h has order $e \mid d$. Both G and $G[d]$ contain a unique subgroup of order e and therefore by uniqueness this is simply $G[e] \subseteq G[d]$. Similarly by uniqueness $G[e] = \langle h \rangle$. Therefore $h \in G[d]$. Conversely suppose $h \in G[d]$ then $o(h) \mid d$ by (3.3.14). Therefore $G[d]$ consists of all the elements of order dividing d .

□

Corollary 3.3.24

Let n be a positive integer then

$$n = \sum_{d \mid n} \phi(d)$$

Proof. Consider a cyclic group G of order n . Every element has order dividing n so the result follows from the previous Proposition by partitioning the group G into subsets consisting of elements of equal order. □

For an abelian group G define the following subgroup

$$G[d] := \{g \in G \mid g^d = e\}.$$

We have shown for a cyclic group that $\#G[d] = d$ whenever $d \mid n$ and it is empty otherwise. We claim that this can be used to characterize cyclic groups. NB the following is adapted from [this stackexchange answer](#)

Proposition 3.3.25 (Characterization of cyclic group)

Let G be a finite abelian group such that $\#G[d] \leq d$ for all $d \mid n$. Then G is cyclic.

Proof. Let $n = \#G$ and G_d be the subset of elements of order exactly d . Then we wish to show that G_n is non-empty as any element of this set will be a generator. We actually show that $\#G_d = \phi(d) > 0$ whenever $d \mid n$.

Note that $G_d \subseteq G[d]$. If it's non-empty then for any $y \in G_d$, we have $\langle y \rangle$ is a subgroup of $G[d]$ of order d . As $\#G[d] \leq d$ we have $G[d] = \langle y \rangle$ is cyclic of order d . In other words G_d is equal to the set of generators for $G[d]$. By the

previous Proposition $G[d]$ has $\phi(d)$ generators. We conclude that for all $d \mid n$ we have G_d is either empty or of order $\phi(d)$.

Therefore

$$n = \sum_{d \mid n} \#G_d \leq \sum_{d \mid n} \phi(d) = n$$

Therefore we must have equality everywhere and $\#G_d = \phi(d)$ as required. $\square$

Example 3.3.26

Let $G = \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$ of order p^2 . Then $G[p] = G$ so $\#G[p] = p^2 > p$.

3.3.2 Group Actions

Definition 3.3.27 (Group Action)

Let G be a group and S a set. A group action of G on S is a map

$$\begin{aligned} G \times S &\longrightarrow S \\ (g, s) &\longrightarrow g \cdot s \end{aligned}$$

such that

- $es = s$
- $g(hs) = (gh)s$

Definition 3.3.28 (Faithful group action)

A group action G on S is faithful if

$$gs = s \quad \forall s \in S \implies g = e$$

Definition 3.3.29 (Free group action)

A group action G on S is free if

$$g \neq e \implies gs \neq s \quad \forall s$$

Definition 3.3.30 (Orbit/Stabilizer)

Let G be a group with an action on S and $s \in S$. Define the stabilizer subgroup

$$G_s := \{g \in G \mid gs = s\}$$

and the orbit

$$Gs := \{gs \mid g \in G\}$$

Proposition 3.3.31 (S is disjoint union of orbits)

Let G be a group with an action on S . Then the following is an equivalence relation

$$s \sim t \iff gs = t \text{ some } g \in G$$

and the equivalence classes are precisely the orbits of elements of S under G . Further S is the disjoint union of orbits.

Remark 3.3.32

An action is free if and only if $G_s = \{e\}$ for all $s \in S$.

Proposition 3.3.33 (Orbit-Stabilizer Theorem)

Let G be a group with an action on S . Given an element $s \in S$ there is a natural bijection

$$G/G_s \longrightarrow Gs$$

between the cosets of G_s and the orbit Gs . In particular when G is finite

$$\#G = \#Gs \times \#G_s$$

and when the action is *free*

$$\#G = \#Gs$$

3.3.3 Symmetric Group

Definition 3.3.34 (Symmetric Group)

Let S_n denote the set of permutations (bijections) of $\{1, \dots, n\}$.

Permutations $\sigma, \tau \in S_n$ are called **disjoint** if the supports are disjoint. Note disjoint permutations commute.

Definition 3.3.35 (Cycle)

Let $i_1, \dots, i_r \in J_n$ be an ordered r -tuple, the permutation which maps

$$i_k \rightarrow \begin{cases} i_{k+1} & k < r \\ i_1 & k = r \end{cases}$$

is denoted by $(i_1 i_2 \dots i_r)$ and called a **cycle**.

A cycle with two elements $(i j)$ is called a **transposition**. Finally an **adjacent transposition** is one of the form $(i i + 1)$.

Proposition 3.3.36

Let $\sigma \in S_n$. Then σ may be represented by

- a) a product of disjoint cycles, which is unique up to permutation of cycles.
- b) a product of transpositions, the number of which is unique modulo 2
- c) There is a well-defined group homomorphism

$$\epsilon : S_n \rightarrow \{-1, 1\}$$

such that

$$\epsilon((i j)) = -1$$

and $\epsilon(1) = 1$.

- d) A cycle σ of length r satisfies $\epsilon(\sigma) = (-1)^{r+1}$

3.3.4 Shuffle Permutations

Definition 3.3.37

Let $p + q = n$ be positive integers. We define the subgroup of **shuffle permutations**

$$\text{Sh}(p, q) := \{\sigma \in S_n \mid \sigma(1) < \dots < \sigma(p) \text{ and } \sigma(p+1) < \dots < \sigma(p+q)\}$$

Similarly if $p + q + r = n$ are positive integers define the subgroup

$$\text{Sh}(p, q, r) := \{\sigma \in S_n \mid \sigma(1) < \dots < \sigma(p) \text{ and } \sigma(p+1) < \dots < \sigma(p+q) \text{ and } \sigma(p+q+1) < \dots < \sigma(p+q+r)\}$$

Let $u : [1, p] \rightarrow [1, n]$ and $v : [1, q] \rightarrow [1, n]$ be injective maps such that $u([1, p]) \cap v([1, q]) = \emptyset$. Define $u \star v \in S_n$ by

$$(u \star v)(i) := \begin{cases} u(i) & 1 \leq i \leq p \\ v(i - p) & p < i \leq p + q \end{cases}$$

If u, v are order preserving then $u \star v \in \text{Sh}(p, q)$. Every shuffle permutation is of this form.

Lemma 3.3.38

Let $X, Y \subset \mathbb{N}$ be a finite sets of order n . There exists a unique order isomorphism

$$u : X \rightarrow Y$$

Proposition 3.3.39

Let $p + q = n$ be positive integers. There is a bijection

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Sh}(p, q) &\rightarrow \{u : [1, p] \rightarrow [1, n] \text{ order preserving} \} \\ \sigma &\rightarrow \sigma|_{[1, p]} \end{aligned}$$

Proof. We provide an explicit inverse. For given u the set $Y := [1, n] \setminus u([1, p])$. As u is order preserving it is injective, whence $\#Y = n - \#u([1, p]) = n - p = q$. Therefore there is an order isomorphism $v : [1, q] \rightarrow Y$ and we may define the shuffle permutation $\sigma := u \star v$. $\square$

Proposition 3.3.40

Let $p + q = n$ be positive integers. There is an injective group homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} S_p \times S_q &\rightarrow S_n \\ (\sigma_1, \sigma_2) &\rightarrow \sigma_1 \star (\sigma_2 + p) \end{aligned}$$

The image is the set $\sigma \in S_n$ for which $\sigma([1, p]) = [1, p]$ (equivalently $\sigma([p + 1, q]) = \sigma([p + 1, n])$).

Proposition 3.3.41

Let $p + q = n$ be positive integers. There is a bijection

$$\text{Sh}(p, q) \rightarrow S_n / (S_p \times S_q)$$

Furthermore $\# \text{Sh}(p, q) = \frac{(p+q)!}{p!q!}$. By a similar argument $\# \text{Sh}(p, q, r) = \frac{(p+q+r)!}{p!q!r!}$.

Proof. Let $\sigma \in S_n$. Then there exists an order isomorphism $u : [1, p] \rightarrow \sigma([1, p])$ and $v : [1, q] \rightarrow \sigma([p + 1, p + q])$. Define $\sigma_1(i) := u^{-1}(\sigma(i))$ and $\sigma_2(j) := v^{-1}(\sigma(j + p))$. Then we may verify that $\sigma_1 \in S_p$, $\sigma_2 \in S_q$ and

$$(u \star v) \circ (\sigma_1 \star (\sigma_2 + p)) = \sigma$$

so the map is surjective.

Suppose $\sigma, \sigma' \in \text{Sh}(p, q)$ are such that

$$\sigma = \sigma' \circ (\sigma_1 \star (\sigma_2 + p))$$

for $\sigma_1 \in S_p$ and $\sigma_2 \in S_q$. If $\sigma_1 \neq e$ then there exists $1 \leq i < j \leq p$ such that $\sigma_1(j) < \sigma_1(i)$. Then by monotonicity of σ' we have $\sigma(j) = \sigma'(\sigma_1(j)) < \sigma'(\sigma_1(i)) = \sigma(i)$, which contradicts monotonicity of σ . So we conclude $\sigma_1 = e$ and similarly $\sigma_2 = e$. Therefore $\sigma = \sigma'$, and the map is injective. By the Orbit-Stabilizer theorem we have

$$\# \text{Sh}(p, q) = \# S_n / \# (S_p \times S_q)$$

from which the result follows. $\square$

Definition 3.3.42 (Circulant Permutation)

Let n be an integer, and write $\rho_n \in S_n$ for the permutation

$$\{1, \dots, n\} \rightarrow \{2, 3, \dots, n, n + 1\}$$

Note that $\epsilon(\rho_n) = (-1)^{n+1}$.

Proposition 3.3.43 (Symmetry of Shuffling)

Let $p + q = n$ be positive integers. Then there is a bijection

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Sh}(p, q) &\rightarrow \text{Sh}(q, p) \\ \sigma &\rightarrow \sigma \circ \rho_{p+q}^p \end{aligned}$$

Note that $\epsilon(\rho_{p+q}^p) = (-1)^{pq}$ by (3.3.42).

Proposition 3.3.44 (Associativity of Shuffling)

The following map is a bijection

$$\begin{aligned} \pi : \text{Sh}(p + q, r) \times \text{Sh}(p, q) &\rightarrow \text{Sh}(p, q, r) \\ (\sigma_1, \sigma_2) &\rightarrow \sigma_1 \circ (\sigma_2 \star (1_r + p + q)) \end{aligned}$$

Similarly so is

$$\begin{aligned} \pi' : \text{Sh}(p, q + r) \times \text{Sh}(q, r) &\rightarrow \text{Sh}(p, q, r) \\ (\sigma_1, \sigma_2) &\rightarrow \sigma_1 \circ (1_p \star (\sigma_2 + p)) \end{aligned}$$

Proof. It is straightforward to verify that $\pi(\sigma_1, \sigma_2)$ is injective and satisfies the ordering properties. Therefore π is well-defined and we claim it is surjective.

Given $\sigma \in \text{Sh}(p, q, r)$ let $u : [1, p+q] \rightarrow \sigma([1, p+q])$, $v : [1, r] \rightarrow \sigma([p+q+1, p+q+r])$ be the unique order isomorphisms. Define $\sigma_1 = u \star v$ and $\sigma_2 := u^{-1} \circ \sigma|_{[1, p+q]}$. We may verify that $\sigma_1 \in \text{Sh}(p+q, r)$ and $\sigma_2 \in \text{Sh}(p, q)$, and furthermore that $\pi(\sigma_1, \sigma_2) = \sigma$. By counting π is injective.

For the second case let $u : [1, p] \rightarrow \sigma([1, p])$, $v : [1, q+r] \rightarrow \sigma([p+1, p+q+r])$ be the unique order isomorphisms. Define $\sigma_1 = u \star v$ and $\sigma_2(j) := v^{-1}(\sigma(j+p))$. The verification follows as before. $\square$

3.3.5 Totally Ordered Abelian Group

Definition 3.3.45 (Ordered Abelian Group)

An *abelian group* $(G, +)$ together with a *total order* $\leq$ is an **ordered abelian group** if it satisfies

$$x \leq y \implies x + z \leq y + z \quad \forall x, y, z \in G$$

Define $G^+ := \{g \in G \mid (0 \leq g) \wedge (g \neq 0)\}$ and $G^- := \{g \in G \mid (g \leq 0) \wedge (g \neq 0)\}$.

3.4 Rings and Modules

3.4.1 Commutative Rings

Definition 3.4.1 (Ring)

A ring consists of a triple $(A, +, \cdot)$ where A is a set and $+$ and $\cdot$ are laws of composition (“additive” and “multiplicative” respectively) such that the following holds

- $(A, +)$ is an **abelian group**, whose identity element we refer to as 0_A .
- $(A, \cdot)$ is a **monoid**, whose identity element we refer to as 1_A
- $+$ and $\cdot$ satisfy the **distributive property**, that is for all $x, y, z \in A$

$$x \cdot (y + z) = x \cdot y + x \cdot z$$

$$(x + y) \cdot z = x \cdot z + y \cdot z$$

For $x \in A$ we write the additive inverse as $-x$, and abbreviate multiplication $x \cdot y =: xy$.

We say that A is a **zero-ring** (or trivial) if $0_A = 1_A \iff A = \{0\}$.

A is **commutative** if in addition $xy = yx$ i.e. $(A, \cdot)$ is abelian.

Example 3.4.2

The set of integers (Section 2.2.1) $\mathbb{Z}$ is the canonical example of a ring with operations of addition and multiplication.

Definition 3.4.3 (Subring)

A **subring** of a ring A is a subset B such that

- $0_A, 1_A \in B$
- $x \in B \implies -x \in B$
- $x, y \in B \implies x + y \in B$
- $x, y \in B \implies x \cdot y \in B$

Then $(B, +|_{B \times B}, \cdot|_{B \times B})$ is a ring.

Definition 3.4.4 (Multiplicative set)

A subset $S \subset A$ is said to be **multiplicative** if

- $1 \in S$
- $x, y \in S \implies xy \in S$

Further it is said to be **saturated** if in addition

$$x, y \in S \iff xy \in S$$

Definition 3.4.5 (Integral Domain)

A commutative ring A is said to be an **integral domain** if it is not a zero-ring and it is cancellative, that is

$$ab = ac, a \neq 0 \implies b = c.$$

Definition 3.4.6 (Reduced)

A commutative ring A is said to be **reduced** if for all $a \in A$

$$a^n = 0 \implies a = 0$$

Definition 3.4.7 (Unit / Group of Units)

An element $0 \neq a$ of a ring A is called a **unit** if it has a two-sided multiplicative inverse.

For A not a zero-ring, the set of units A^* forms a group under multiplication, called the **group of units**.

Definition 3.4.8 (Field)

A **field** K is a commutative non-zero ring such that every non-zero element is a unit, so that K^* is a group under multiplication and $K^* = K \setminus \{0\}$.

Proposition 3.4.9

Every subring of a field K is an integral domain.

Proof. Suppose $A \subset K$ is a subring. Suppose that $a, b \in A$ such that $ab = 0$. Suppose $a \neq 0$ then $a^{-1}ab = 0 \implies b = 0$. $\square$

Note we have the implications

Corollary 3.4.10

Let A be a ring then we have the following implications

$$\text{field} \implies \text{integral domain} \implies \text{reduced}$$

Definition 3.4.11 (Ring homomorphism)

A **ring homomorphism** $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ is a mapping which is both a multiplicative (monoid) and additive (group) homomorphism

- $\phi(0_A) = 0_B$
- $\phi(1_A) = 1_B$
- $\phi(x + y) = \phi(x) + \phi(y)$
- $\phi(xy) = \phi(x)\phi(y)$

The **kernel** of ϕ is defined to be

$$\ker(\phi) = \{a \mid \phi(a) = 0_B\}$$

Definition 3.4.12 (Ideal)

A (two-sided) **ideal** $\mathfrak{a}$ of a ring A is a subset of A which is an additive subgroup and closed under multiplication by A :

- $0_A \in \mathfrak{a}$
- $x, y \in \mathfrak{a} \implies x + y \in \mathfrak{a}$
- $x \in \mathfrak{a} \implies -x \in \mathfrak{a}$
- $x \in \mathfrak{a}, a \in A \implies ax, xa \in \mathfrak{a}$

$\mathfrak{a}$ is said to be **proper** if $\mathfrak{a} \neq A$.

Lemma 3.4.13 (Proper ideal)

An ideal $\mathfrak{a}$ is proper if and only if $1 \notin \mathfrak{a}$ if and only if $\mathfrak{a} \cap A^* = \emptyset$.

Alternatively $\mathfrak{a} = A$ if and only if $1 \in \mathfrak{a}$ if and only if $\mathfrak{a} \cap A^* \neq \emptyset$.

Proposition 3.4.14

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring homomorphism, then

- a) The kernel $\ker(\phi)$ is a two-sided ideal of A
- b) The image $\phi(A)$ is a subring of B
- c) ϕ is injective if and only if $\ker(\phi) = \{0\}$

Proposition 3.4.15 (Krull's Theorem)

Let A be a ring and $\mathfrak{a}$ a proper ideal. Then it is contained in a proper maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$.

In particular any non-unit $a \notin A^*$ is contained in a maximal ideal.

Proposition 3.4.16 (Criteria to be a Field)

Let A be a ring. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is a field
- b) A is not the zero-ring and the only proper ideal is $\{0\}$.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b). By definition A is not the zero-ring. Let $\mathfrak{a}$ be a proper ideal. By (3.4.13) $\mathfrak{a} \cap A^* = \emptyset \implies \mathfrak{a} = \{0\}$ as required.

b) $\implies$ a). Suppose $0 \neq a \in A$ then the ideal $Aa = (a)$ is either $\{0\}$ or A . However $a = 1 \cdot a \in (a)$ which implies $(a) \neq \{0\}$ and therefore $(a) = A$. In particular there exists $a^{-1} \in A$ such that $a^{-1}a = 1_A$ and a is invertible. $\square$

3.4.2 Modules I

Definition 3.4.17 (Module)

Let A be a ring. A **left A -module** $(M, +, \cdot)$ is an abelian group $(M, +)$ together with a “multiplication” operation

$$\cdot : A \times M \rightarrow M$$

which satisfies the following properties

- $(a \times_A a') \cdot x = a \cdot (a' \cdot x)$
- $(a +_A a') \cdot x = a \cdot x + a' \cdot x$
- $a \cdot (x + y) = a \cdot x + a \cdot y$

Similarly a **right A -module** $(M, +, \cdot)$ is an abelian group $(M, +)$ together with a multiplication operation

$$\cdot : M \times A \rightarrow M$$

- $(a \times_A a') \cdot x = (x \cdot a') \times_A a$
- $(a +_A a') \cdot x = a \cdot x + a' \cdot x$
- $a \cdot (x + y) = a \cdot x + a \cdot y$

Considering the first property M is a left A -module iff it is a right A^{op} module in the obvious way. Therefore in the usual case that A is commutative the concepts coincide and we may speak simply of an **A -module**, though we almost always write the action on the left.

Similarly almost all results for left A -modules carry over unchanged for right A -modules. In this case we may simply by refer to A -modules rather than state the result for both cases separately.

Definition 3.4.18 (Submodule)

Let $(M, +, \cdot)$ be a left A -module. Then a subset $N \subset M$ is called an **A -submodule** if

- N is a **subgroup** of $(M, +)$
- $m \in N, a \in A \implies am \in N$

Then $(N, +|_{N \times N}, \cdot|_{A \times N})$ is a left A -module. Similar definition applies for a right A -module.

Definition 3.4.19 (Module homomorphism)

Let $(M, +, \cdot), (N, +, \cdot)$ be left A -modules. A function $f : M \rightarrow N$ is an **A -module homomorphism** if

- It is an (additive) group homomorphism $(M, +) \rightarrow (N, +)$.
- It is A -linear; $\forall a \in A, m \in M \quad f(a \cdot m) = a \cdot f(m)$

It may be verified that f is bijective if and only if it's an isomorphism. In this way we have the following categories

- **$A\text{-Mod}$** the category of modules over a commutative ring A
- **${}_A\text{Mod}$** the category of left A -modules
- **Mod_A** the category of right A -modules

Definition 3.4.20 (Kernel and Image)

The **kernel** of a module homomorphism f is given by

$$\ker(f) := \{m \in M \mid f(m) = 0\}$$

and the **image** is given by

$$\text{Im}(f) = f(M)$$

Example 3.4.21 (Trivial Examples)

A ring A is a left A -module over itself, denoted A_s .

Definition 3.4.22 (Restriction of Scalars)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ a ring homomorphism and M a B -module. Then we may consider M as an A -module in the obvious way. Denote this by $[M]_\phi$.

Proposition 3.4.23 (Submodules constitute a lattice)

Let M be an A -module then the collection $\text{SubMod}(M)$ of A -submodules form a *complete sub-lattice* of $\mathcal{P}(M)$ with meet and join given by

$$\bigwedge_{i \in I} N_i = \bigcap_{i \in I} N_i$$

and (the *internal sum*)

$$\bigvee_{i \in I} N_i = \bigcap_{N_i \subseteq N \subseteq M} N =: \sum_{i \in I} N_i = \left\{ \sum_{j \in J} n_j \mid n_j \in N_j \quad \#J < \infty \right\}$$

Moreover it is the image of the *closure operator* $\langle - \rangle : \mathcal{P}(M) \rightarrow \mathcal{P}(M)$ given by

$$\langle X \rangle = \bigcap_{X \subseteq N} N = \left\{ \sum_j a_j x_j \mid x_j \in X \right\}$$

Proof. The A -submodules of M naturally form a *Moore family* of subsets of M . By (2.1.40) they form a complete sub-lattice with the given form of meet and join. Furthermore it is the image of the given closure operator. The only non-trivial statement is the explicit form of $\sum_{i \in I} N_i$ TODO. $\square$

Lemma 3.4.24

Let M be a module. Then

- a) $\langle \bigcup_{i \in I} X_i \rangle = \sum_{i \in I} \langle X_i \rangle$
- b) $\langle \bigcup_{i \in I} N_i \rangle = \sum_{i \in I} N_i$
- c) $N_1 \subseteq N_2 \implies N_1 + N_2 = N_2$

Proof. a) This follows from (2.1.43) applied to the closure operator $\langle - \rangle$

b) This follows from a) because $N_i = \langle N_i \rangle$

c) This follows from b) because $N_1 \cup N_2 = N_2$

$\square$

Definition 3.4.25 (Hom Sets)

A **module homomorphism** $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ is an additive group homomorphism which commutes with the A action

$$\phi(am) = a\phi(m) \quad \forall a \in A, m \in M$$

Denote the abelian group of A -module homomorphisms

$$\text{Hom}_A(M, N)$$

and the endomorphism ring

$$\text{End}_A(M) := \text{Hom}_A(M, M)$$

When A is commutative then these have natural A -module and A -algebra structures respectively.

3.4.3 Operations on Ideals

For this section we assume A is a commutative ring.

Definition 3.4.26 (Product of ideal and module)

Let M be an A -module and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ an ideal. Define

$$\mathfrak{a}M = \langle \mathfrak{a} \cdot M \rangle = \left\{ \sum_{i=1}^n a_i m_i \mid a_i \in \mathfrak{a} \quad m_i \in M \right\}$$

Proposition 3.4.27 (Lattice of Ideals)

Let A be a ring and $\mathcal{I}(A)$ the set of ideals. Then $\mathcal{I}(A)$ forms a *complete lattice* ordered by inclusion with join and meets given by

$$\bigwedge_{i \in I} \mathfrak{a}_i = \bigcap_{i \in I} \mathfrak{a}_i$$

and

$$\bigvee_{i \in I} \mathfrak{a}_i = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{a}_i \subseteq \mathfrak{a}} \mathfrak{a} =: \sum_i \mathfrak{a}_i := \left\{ \sum_i a_i \mid a_i \in \mathfrak{a}_i \right\}$$

This induces a corresponding *closure operator*

$$\langle - \rangle : \mathcal{P}(A) \rightarrow \mathcal{I}(A)$$

given by

$$\langle X \rangle := \bigcap_{X \subseteq \mathfrak{a}} \mathfrak{a} = \left\{ \sum_j a_j x_j \mid a_j \in A \quad x_j \in X \right\}$$

Proposition 3.4.28

Let A be a ring and $\mathfrak{a}_i$ a family of ideals. Then

$$\langle \bigcup_{i \in I} \mathfrak{a}_i \rangle = \sum_{i \in I} \mathfrak{a}_i$$

Definition 3.4.29 (Product of ideals)

The product of two ideals $\mathfrak{a}\mathfrak{b}$ is

$$\mathfrak{a}\mathfrak{b} = \left\{ \sum_{i=1}^n a_i b_i \mid a_i \in \mathfrak{a} \quad b_i \in \mathfrak{b} \right\}$$

and is itself an ideal.

Definition 3.4.30 (Coprime)

We say two elements x, y of a commutative ring A are *co-prime* if $(x, y) = (1) \iff ax + by = 1$ for some $a, b \in A$

We say a family of ideals $\{\mathfrak{a}_i\}_{i \in I}$ are co-prime if $\sum_{i \in I} \mathfrak{a}_i = A$.

Definition 3.4.31 (Principal Ideal)

A *principal ideal* is an ideal generated by a single element

$$(a) := \langle \{a\} \rangle = Aa$$

Lemma 3.4.32

A principal ideal (a) is proper if and only if $a \notin A^\star$

Definition 3.4.33 (Maximal Ideal)

An ideal $\mathfrak{m} \triangleleft A$ is *maximal* if it is both *proper* and not contained in another proper ideal.

Definition 3.4.34 (Prime Ideal)

An ideal $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A$ is **prime** if it is both *proper* and satisfies the following property

$$xy \in \mathfrak{p} \implies x \in \mathfrak{p} \vee y \in \mathfrak{p}$$

Definition 3.4.35 (Radical Ideal)

An ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ is **radical** if it satisfies the following property

$$x^n \in \mathfrak{a} \implies x \in \mathfrak{a}$$

Proposition 3.4.36 (Maximal ideals exist)

Let A be a ring and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ a proper ideal. Then it is contained in some maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$.

In particular there always exists a maximal ideal by considering $\mathfrak{a} = (0)$.

Proof. Simple application of Zorn's Lemma. □

Proposition 3.4.37 (Properties of prime ideals)

Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be a prime ideal and $\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}$ be ideals then the following are equivalent

- a) $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ or $\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$
- b) $\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$
- c) $\mathfrak{a}\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) Follows because $\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$

b) $\implies$ c) Follows because $\mathfrak{a}\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}$

c) $\implies$ a) If $\mathfrak{a} \not\subseteq \mathfrak{p}$, then choose $a \in \mathfrak{a} \setminus \mathfrak{p}$. By hypothesis $\mathfrak{a}\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ and since $\mathfrak{p}$ is prime $\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$. □

Corollary 3.4.38 (Ideal version of primality)

Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be a proper ideal. Then $\mathfrak{p}$ is prime if and only if the following condition holds for all ideals $\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}$

$$\mathfrak{a}\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \implies \mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \text{ or } \mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$$

In particular for all $k > 0$ we have

$$\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \iff \mathfrak{a}^k \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$$

Proof. One direction has been shown in (3.4.37). Conversely suppose $fg \in \mathfrak{p}$ then apply the condition to the ideals (f) and (g) we find $f \in \mathfrak{p}$ or $g \in \mathfrak{p}$. □

Lemma 3.4.39 (Prime ideals are meet-prime)

Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be a prime ideal. Then

$$\bigcap_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \implies \mathfrak{a}_i \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \text{ some } i = 1 \dots n$$

in other words $\mathfrak{p}$ is *meet-prime* in the lattice of ideals.

Proof. Suppose $\mathfrak{a}_i \not\subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ for all i then there exists $x_i \in \mathfrak{a}_i \setminus \mathfrak{p}$. Then $x_1 \dots x_n \in \bigcap_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ by hypothesis, so by primality $x_i \in \mathfrak{p}$ for some i , a contradiction. □

Lemma 3.4.40 (Generate prime ideals)

Let A be a ring, S a *multiplicative* set and $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft A$ such that $\mathfrak{b} \cap S = \emptyset$ then

$$\mathcal{I} = \{\mathfrak{a} \mid \mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{a} \text{ } \mathfrak{a} \cap S = \emptyset\}$$

has a maximal element, which is *prime*.

Proof. Since $\mathfrak{b} \in \mathcal{I}$ it is non-empty. By Zorn's Lemma it has a maximal element, $\mathfrak{p}$. We claim it is prime, for suppose $xy \in \mathfrak{p}$ and $x, y \notin \mathfrak{p}$. Then by maximality $\mathfrak{p} + (x)$ and $\mathfrak{p} + (y)$ intersect S . Therefore S intersects $(\mathfrak{p} + (x))(\mathfrak{p} + (y)) \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$, a contradiction. $\square$

Definition 3.4.41 (Minimal prime)

Let A be a ring and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ a proper ideal. A prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ is a **minimal prime over $\mathfrak{a}$** if it contains $\mathfrak{a}$, and every other such prime ideal contains $\mathfrak{p}$.

We say it is simply a **minimal prime** if it is minimal over (0) .

Proposition 3.4.42 (Prime ideals are chain complete)

Let $\{\mathfrak{p}_i\}_{i \in I}$ be a **chain** of prime ideals, then $\bigcap_i \mathfrak{p}_i$ and $\bigcup_i \mathfrak{p}_i$ are prime ideals.

Proof. By (3.4.36) $\bigcup_i \mathfrak{p}_i$ is an ideal, and it's easily verified to be prime. Clearly $\bigcap_i \mathfrak{p}_i$ is an ideal. Suppose $a, b \notin \bigcap_i \mathfrak{p}_i$ then $a \notin \mathfrak{p}_j$ and $b \notin \mathfrak{p}_k$ with $j \leq k$. Then $b \notin \mathfrak{p}_j$, and $ab \notin \mathfrak{p}_j$ by primality, whence $ab \notin \bigcap_i \mathfrak{p}_i$. $\square$

Corollary 3.4.43 (Minimal primes exist)

Let A be a ring and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ be a proper ideal contained in a prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$. Then there exists a minimal prime over $\mathfrak{a}$ contained in $\mathfrak{p}$.

In particular there always exists a minimal prime over $\mathfrak{a}$ and every prime ideal contains a minimal prime ideal.

Proof. We may use (3.4.42) together with Zorn's Lemma. $\square$

Proposition 3.4.44 (Minimal Primes consist of Zero Divisors)

Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be a proper prime ideal minimal over $\mathfrak{a}$. Then for every $x \in \mathfrak{p}$ there exists $a \in A \setminus \mathfrak{a}$ such that $xa \in \mathfrak{a}$.

In particular a minimal prime ideal consists of zero-divisors.

Proof. Observe that $\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{a}$ is a proper minimal prime ideal of $A/\mathfrak{a}$ by (3.4.56). Then the first statement is equivalent to showing every $x \in \mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{a}$ is a zero divisor and we may reduce to the case $\mathfrak{a} = (0)$.

Consider the ring $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$, it has a unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ which is also minimal by (3.7.35). Every other prime ideal is contained in $\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ by (3.4.36), and therefore equal by minimality. Therefore $\sqrt{(0)A_{\mathfrak{p}}} = \mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ by (3.4.46). Suppose $x \in \mathfrak{p}$ then $x^n/1 = 0$ and $tx^n \in \mathfrak{a}$ for $t \notin \mathfrak{p}$. Choose n minimal subject to this condition. Then $n \geq 1$ because $t \notin \mathfrak{a}$, and so $a = tx^{n-1}$ has the required properties. $\square$

Proposition 3.4.45

Let A be a ring. Then the set $\text{Rad}(A)$ of radical ideals forms a complete sub-lattice of the lattice of ideals $\mathcal{I}(A)$. This induces a **closure operator**

$$\sqrt{} : \mathcal{I}(A) \rightarrow \text{Rad}(A)$$

given by

$$\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} := \bigcap_{\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{r}} \mathfrak{r} = \{x \mid x^n \in \mathfrak{a} \quad n > 0\}$$

The “join” is given by

$$\bigvee_{i \in I} \mathfrak{a}_i = \sqrt{\sum_i \mathfrak{a}_i}$$

In particular

- a) $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$
- b) $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{b} \implies \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \subseteq \sqrt{\mathfrak{b}}$
- c) $\sqrt{\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}} = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$

Proof. The set of radical ideals is closed under arbitrary intersections (which are meets in the lattice $\mathcal{I}(A)$). Therefore by (2.1.40) it forms a complete sub-lattice with meet given by intersection of ideals.

It also shows that $\sqrt{}$ as defined is a closure operator with image $\text{Rad}(A)$, which demonstrates the required properties.

Finally we just need to show that $I' := \{x \mid x^n \in \mathfrak{a} \quad n > 0\}$ is equal to $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$. Firstly it's an ideal for if $x, y \in I'$ then $x^n \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $y^m \in \mathfrak{a}$, so we may show that $(x + y)^{n+m} \in \mathfrak{a}$ whence $x + y \in I'$. Similarly $a \in A$ and $x \in I'$ implies

$(ax)^n = a^n x^n \in I'$. It's radical for suppose $x^m \in I'$ then $x^{mn} = (x^m)^n \in \mathfrak{a}$ by definition whence $x \in I'$. As it contains $\mathfrak{a}$ we find that $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \subseteq I'$. Let $\mathfrak{r}$ be another radical ideal containing $\mathfrak{a}$ then $x \in I' \implies x^n \in \mathfrak{a} \implies x^n \in \mathfrak{r} \implies x \in \mathfrak{r}$. Therefore the reverse inclusion follows. $\square$

Proposition 3.4.46 (Prime Nullstellensatz)

The radical of an ideal satisfies

$$\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}: \mathfrak{p} \text{ prime}} \mathfrak{p}$$

Further the intersection may be taken over all minimal primes over $\mathfrak{a}$.

Proof. Suppose $x \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$ and $\mathfrak{p} \supseteq \mathfrak{a}$. Then $x^n \in \mathfrak{p} \implies x \in \mathfrak{p}$. Therefore $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \subseteq \bigcap_{\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}} \mathfrak{p}$. Conversely suppose $x \notin \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$ then $S := \{1, x, x^2, \dots\}$ is a proper multiplicative set such that $S \cap \mathfrak{a} = \emptyset$. By (3.4.40) there is a prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ containing $\mathfrak{a}$ which does not intersect S . Therefore $x \notin RHS$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.4.47 (Properties of Radical Ideals)

Let $\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}$ be ideals then

- a) $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}^k} = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$ for $k > 0$
- b) $\sqrt{\sum_i \mathfrak{a}_i} = \sqrt{\sum_i \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}_i}}$
- c) $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} = A \iff \mathfrak{a} = A$
- d) $\sum_i \mathfrak{a}_i = A \iff \sum_i \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}_i} = A$
- e) $\sum_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i^{k_i} = A \iff \sum_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i = A \quad k_i > 0$.

Proof. a) This may be shown by direct calculation or combining (3.4.46) and (3.4.37).

b) This follows by applying (2.1.43) to the closure operator $\sqrt{}$.

c) $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} = A \iff 1 \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \iff 1 \in \mathfrak{a} \iff \mathfrak{a} = A$

d) This follows from combining c) and b)

e) This follows from d), b) and a)

$\square$

Lemma 3.4.48 (Ideal Finitely Generated by Nilpotents is Nilpotent)

Let A be a ring with ideals $\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}$ such that $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \subseteq \mathfrak{b}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ finitely generated. Then there exists an integer $n > 0$ such that $\mathfrak{b}^n \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$.

Definition 3.4.49 (Extended and contracted ideals)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a homomorphism and $\mathfrak{a}$ (resp. $\mathfrak{b}$) be an ideal of A (resp. B). Define the **contraction** (resp. **extension**) ideals as follows

$$\begin{aligned} \mathfrak{b}^c &:= \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{b}) \\ \mathfrak{a}^e &:= \phi(\mathfrak{a})B := \langle \phi(\mathfrak{a}) \rangle = \left\{ \sum_i b_i \phi(a_i) \mid a_i \in \mathfrak{a} \right\} \end{aligned}$$

An ideal is said to be **contracted** (resp. **extended**) if it is of the form $\mathfrak{b}^c$ (resp. $\mathfrak{a}^e$)

Proposition 3.4.50 (Operations on ideals)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ a ring homomorphism and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A, \mathfrak{b} \triangleleft B$ ideals then

- a) $\mathfrak{b}^c \triangleleft A$ and $\mathfrak{a}^e \triangleleft B$
- b) $\mathfrak{b}^c$ proper if and only if $\mathfrak{b}$ is proper
- c) $\mathfrak{b}^{ce} \subseteq \mathfrak{b}$ and $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{a}^{ec}$
- d) $\mathfrak{a}^{ece} = \mathfrak{a}^e$ and $\mathfrak{b}^{cec} = \mathfrak{b}^c$
- e) $\mathfrak{b}^{ce} = \mathfrak{b} \iff \mathfrak{b} \text{ is an extended ideal} \iff \mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{b}^{ce}$

$$\text{f) } \mathfrak{a}^{ec} = \mathfrak{a} \iff \mathfrak{a} \text{ is a contracted ideal} \iff \mathfrak{a}^{ec} \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$$

$$\text{g) } \sqrt{\mathfrak{b}^c} = \left(\sqrt{\mathfrak{b}} \right)^c$$

$$\text{h) } (\sqrt{\mathfrak{b}^c})^e \subseteq \sqrt{\mathfrak{b}} \text{ with equality when } \phi \text{ is surjective}$$

When ϕ is surjective every ideal $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft B$ is extended, and the contracted ideals are precisely the ideals containing $\ker(\phi)$.

Proof. We prove each in turn

a-c) Straightforward

d) By the previous step $\mathfrak{b}^{ce} \subseteq \mathfrak{b} \implies (\mathfrak{b}^{ce})^c \subseteq \mathfrak{b}^c$, similarly $\mathfrak{b}^c \subseteq (\mathfrak{b}^c)^{ec}$. The other relation is similar.

e-f) These follow from c) and d)

$$\text{g) } x \in \left(\sqrt{\mathfrak{b}} \right)^c \iff \phi(x) \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{b}} \iff \phi(x)^n \in \mathfrak{b} \iff \phi(x^n) \in \mathfrak{b} \iff x^n \in \mathfrak{b}^c \iff x \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{b}^c}$$

h) By c) and g) we find $(\sqrt{\mathfrak{b}^c})^e = \left(\sqrt{\mathfrak{b}} \right)^{ce} \subseteq \sqrt{\mathfrak{b}}$. We will show that when ϕ is surjective every ideal is extended, in which case the equality follows from e).

Suppose that ϕ is surjective. Then by e) we only need to show that $\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{b}^{ce}$ for every ideal $\mathfrak{b}$. Let $y \in \mathfrak{b}$ then $y = \phi(x)$, whence $x \in \mathfrak{b}^c$ and $y \in \mathfrak{b}^{ce}$. $\square$

Proposition 3.4.51

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring homomorphism and $\mathfrak{a}_1, \dots, \mathfrak{a}_n$ ideals of A . Then

$$\left(\sum_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i \right)^e = \sum_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i^e$$

Similarly

$$\left(\prod_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i \right)^e = \prod_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i^e$$

Proof. Evidently $\phi(\mathfrak{a}_i) \subseteq \phi(\sum_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i) \subseteq (\sum_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i)^e$ and therefore $\mathfrak{a}_i^e \subseteq (\sum_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i)^e \implies \sum_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i^e \subseteq (\sum_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i)^e$.

Similarly $\phi(\sum_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i) \subseteq \sum_{i=1}^n \phi(\mathfrak{a}_i) \subseteq \sum_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i^e$ whence the reverse inclusion follows.

The second statement follows similarly. $\square$

Corollary 3.4.52

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring homomorphism then extension and contraction constitute a *monotone Galois connection*

$$\{\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A\} \longleftrightarrow \{\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft B\}$$

and therefore is order-preserving and satisfies the adjoint property

$$\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{b}^c \iff \mathfrak{a}^e \subseteq \mathfrak{b}$$

is satisfied.

Proof. Extension and contraction satisfy conditions of (2.1.49) by (3.4.50).c) and d) $\square$

Corollary 3.4.53

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring homomorphism then there is a order-preserving bijection between “contracted” and “extended ideals”

$$\{\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A \mid \mathfrak{a} \text{ contracted}\} \longleftrightarrow \{\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft B \mid \mathfrak{b} \text{ extended}\}$$

which restricts to proper ideals.

Proof. We’ve shown that $\mathfrak{a}$ (resp. $\mathfrak{b}$) is contracted (resp. extended) if and only if the given maps are mutually inverse. Note that $\mathfrak{b}$ is proper implies $\mathfrak{b}^c$ is proper. Furthermore $\mathfrak{b}^c$ proper implies $\mathfrak{b}^{ce} \subseteq \mathfrak{b}$ is proper. Therefore it restricts to proper ideals. $\square$

Proposition 3.4.54 (Inverse image of maximal / prime ideals)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a morphism then

- $\mathfrak{q} \triangleleft B$ prime $\implies \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{q})$ prime
- $\mathfrak{n} \triangleleft B$ maximal and ϕ surjective $\implies \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{n})$ is maximal

Proposition 3.4.55

Consider maps $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ and $\psi : B \rightarrow C$ and an ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$. Then extension of ideals is transitive, that is

$$\psi(\phi(\mathfrak{a})B)C = (\psi \circ \phi)(\mathfrak{a})C$$

3.4.4 Quotient Rings

Proposition 3.4.56 (Quotient Ring)

Let $(A, +, \cdot)$ be a ring and $\mathfrak{a}$ an ideal. As $\mathfrak{a}$ is an additive subgroup we may consider the quotient group $(A/\mathfrak{a}, +)$. For an element $a \in A$ write $a + \mathfrak{a}$ for the coset $[a]_{\mathfrak{a}} \in A/\mathfrak{a}$. There is a well-defined multiplicative law of composition

$$\begin{aligned} \cdot : A/\mathfrak{a} \times A/\mathfrak{a} &\rightarrow A/\mathfrak{a} \\ (a + \mathfrak{a}) \cdot (b + \mathfrak{a}) &\rightarrow (a \cdot b + \mathfrak{a}) \end{aligned}$$

which makes $(A/\mathfrak{a}, +, \cdot)$ into a ring. Further there is a canonical surjective ring homomorphism

$$\pi : A \rightarrow A/\mathfrak{a}$$

with the following properties

- $\ker(\pi) = \mathfrak{a}$
- Every morphism $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ such that $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \ker(\phi)$, factors uniquely through π .

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\phi} & B \\ \downarrow \pi & \nearrow \tilde{\phi} & \\ A/\mathfrak{a} & & \end{array}$$

- $\ker(\tilde{\phi}) = \ker(\phi)/\mathfrak{a}$
- $\tilde{\phi}$ is injective if and only if $\ker(\phi) = \mathfrak{a}$
- $\tilde{\phi}$ is surjective if and only if ϕ is surjective

For an ideal $\mathfrak{b} \supseteq \mathfrak{a}$ define the corresponding quotient ideal

$$\mathfrak{b}/\mathfrak{a} := \{b + \mathfrak{a} \mid b \in \mathfrak{b}\} = \pi(\mathfrak{b})$$

This induces a bijective, order-preserving correspondence of ideals

$$\{\mathfrak{b}' \triangleleft A/\mathfrak{a}\} \xleftrightarrow[\pi^{-1}(-)]{\pi(-)} \{\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft A \mid \mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{b}\}$$

under which maximal (resp. prime, radical) ideals of A containing $\mathfrak{a}$ correspond to maximal (resp. prime, radical) ideals of $A/\mathfrak{a}$.

Corollary 3.4.57 (Isomorphism Theorem)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring homomorphism. Then this induces a canonical isomorphism

$$A/\ker(\phi) \cong \phi(A) \subset B$$

Corollary 3.4.58 (Second Isomorphism Theorem)

Let $\mathfrak{b}, \mathfrak{a}$ be ideals then there is a unique morphism making the diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\pi} & A/\mathfrak{a} \\ \downarrow \pi & \nearrow \tilde{\pi} & \downarrow \pi \\ A/(\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b}) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & (A/\mathfrak{a})/((\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b})/\mathfrak{a}) \end{array}$$

which is in fact an isomorphism. If $\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{c}$ this restricts to an isomorphism of $A/\mathfrak{b}$ -modules

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathfrak{c} & \xrightarrow{\pi} & \mathfrak{c}/\mathfrak{a} \\ \downarrow \pi & & \downarrow \pi \\ \mathfrak{c}/(\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b}) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & (\mathfrak{c}/\mathfrak{a})/((\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b})/\mathfrak{a}) \end{array}$$

Proposition 3.4.59 (Criteria for Maximal, Prime and Reduced)

Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ then $\mathfrak{a}$ is

- **maximal** if and only if $A/\mathfrak{a}$ is a *field*
- **prime** if and only if $A/\mathfrak{a}$ is an *integral domain*
- **radical** if and only if $A/\mathfrak{a}$ is *reduced*

Proof. Suppose $\mathfrak{a}$ is maximal then it is by definition proper so $A/\mathfrak{a}$ is not the zero-ring. By (3.4.56) then $A/\mathfrak{a}$ has no proper non-zero ideals and so by (3.4.16) is a field.

Conversely if $A/\mathfrak{a}$ is a field it is by definition not the zero ring, and so by (3.4.56) $\mathfrak{a}$ is proper. Furthermore by the same result $\mathfrak{a}$ is maximal.

Suppose $\mathfrak{a}$ is prime and $\overline{x} \cdot \overline{y} = 0$. Then by definition $\overline{x} \cdot \overline{y} = 0 \implies x \cdot y \in \mathfrak{a} \implies x \in \mathfrak{a}$ or $y \in \mathfrak{a} \implies \overline{x} = 0$ or $\overline{y} = 0$. This shows that $A/\mathfrak{a}$ is an integral domain. The converse is similar. $\square$

Corollary 3.4.60

Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ be a proper ideal, then the following implications hold

$$\text{maximal} \implies \text{prime} \implies \text{radical}$$

Proof. This follows by combining (3.4.10) and (3.4.59). $\square$

Corollary 3.4.61 (Field Morphisms are injective)

Let $\phi : k \rightarrow B$ be a homomorphism from a field to a non-zero ring. Then ϕ is injective.

Proof. $\ker(\phi)$ is an ideal. As $\phi(1_k) = 1_B$ and $0_B \neq 1_B$ then $\ker(\phi) \neq k$. Since the only ideals are (0) and k we see $\ker(\phi) = \{0\}$ and ϕ is injective. $\square$

3.4.5 Chinese Remainder Theorem

Proposition 3.4.62 (Chinese Remainder Theorem)

Let A be a commutative ring with ideals $\mathfrak{a}_1, \dots, \mathfrak{a}_n$ which are pairwise coprime (i.e. $\mathfrak{a}_i + \mathfrak{a}_j = A$ for all $1 \leq i < j \leq n$). Then there is a canonical isomorphism

$$A / \bigcap_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i \longrightarrow A/\mathfrak{a}_1 \times \dots \times A/\mathfrak{a}_n$$

Further we have the following identity

$$\bigcap_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i = \prod_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i$$

Proof. Consider the canonical ring homomorphism

$$\phi : A \longrightarrow A/\mathfrak{a}_1 \times \dots \times A/\mathfrak{a}_n.$$

Trivially it has kernel $\bigcap_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i$. Therefore by (3.4.56) it is sufficient to show it is surjective. First we show that $e_1 := (1, 0, \dots, 0)$ is in the image of ϕ . For we have $x_i + y_i = 1$ for $x_i \in \mathfrak{a}_1$, $y_i \in \mathfrak{a}_i$ and $1 < i \leq n$. Take $f_1 = y_2 \dots y_n \in \bigcap_{i=2}^n \mathfrak{a}_i$. Then $x = \prod_{i=2}^n (1 - x_i) \in 1 + \mathfrak{a}_1$ and $\phi(f_1) = e_1$ as required.

Similarly there exists f_i such that $\phi(f_i) = (0, \dots, 1, \dots, 0) =: e_i$. Finally for $\overline{x_1} \in A/\mathfrak{a}_1, \dots, \overline{x_n} \in A/\mathfrak{a}_n$ then

$$\phi(f_1 x_1 + \dots + f_n x_n) = (\overline{x_1}, \dots, \overline{x_n})$$

For the final statement we may assume by induction that

$$\bigcap_{i=1}^{n-1} \mathfrak{a}_i = \prod_{i=1}^{n-1} \mathfrak{a}_i$$

We have equations

$$x_i + y_i = 1 \quad x_i \in \mathfrak{a}_i, y_i \in \mathfrak{a}_n$$

Then

$$x_1 \dots x_{n-1} = \prod_{i=1}^{n-1} (1 - y_i) \in 1 + \mathfrak{a}_n$$

so we may conclude

$$\bigcap_{i=1}^{n-1} \mathfrak{a}_i + \mathfrak{a}_n = A.$$

This then reduces to the case $n = 2$. Suppose $x \in \mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}$, by assumption $1 = y + z$ for $y \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $z \in \mathfrak{b}$. Then $x = x(y + z) \in \mathfrak{a}\mathfrak{b}$, so $\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b} \subset \mathfrak{a}\mathfrak{b}$. The reverse inclusion is obvious. $\square$

Proposition 3.4.63 (Chinese Remainder Theorem II)

Let A be a commutative ring with $\mathfrak{a}_1, \dots, \mathfrak{a}_n$ co-prime ideals. For any positive integers $k_1, \dots, k_n$ there is a canonical isomorphism

$$A / \bigcap_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i^{k_i} \longrightarrow A / \mathfrak{a}_1^{k_1} \times \dots \times A / \mathfrak{a}_n^{k_n}$$

and

$$\bigcap_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i^{k_i} = \prod_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{a}_i^{k_i}$$

Proof. By (3.4.47) the ideals $\mathfrak{a}_1^{k_1}, \dots, \mathfrak{a}_n^{k_n}$ are pairwise co-prime. Therefore we may apply (3.4.62). $\square$

3.4.6 Irreducible and Reduced rings

We say an element x is nilpotent if $x^n = 0$. By (3.4.45) these form an ideal.

Definition 3.4.64 (Nilradical)

Define the **nilradical** to be the set (ideal) of nilpotents

$$N(A) := \sqrt{(0)} \stackrel{(3.4.46)}{=} \bigcap_{\mathfrak{p}} \mathfrak{p}$$

Clearly A is **reduced** if and only if $N(A) = \{0\}$.

We also make the following definition

Definition 3.4.65 (Irreducible)

Let A be a ring. We say A is **irreducible** if $N(A)$ is prime.

The notion of irreducible ring is related to the notion of minimal primes

Proposition 3.4.66

A ring A is irreducible if and only if it has a unique minimal prime ideal. In this case it is equal to $N(A)$.

Proof. First we note that every prime ideal contains $N(A)$. If A is irreducible then by definition $N(A)$ is prime and it is therefore the unique minimal prime ideal.

Conversely if $\mathfrak{p}_0$ is the unique minimal prime ideal then by (3.4.43) it is contained in every prime ideal. Therefore (3.4.64) $N(A) = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{p}} \mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{p}_0$ is prime and A is irreducible. $\square$

Proposition 3.4.67 (Integral Domain $\iff$ Reduced and Irreducible)

Let A be a ring. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is an integral domain
- b) A is reduced and has a unique minimal prime
- c) (0) is prime
- d) A is reduced and irreducible.

The following may be useful

Proposition 3.4.68

Let A be a ring then the sum of an invertible and nilpotent element is again invertible

$$A^\star + N(A) \subseteq A^\star$$

Proof. For if

$$a = u + n = u(1 - (u^{-1})(-n))$$

with $n \in N(A)$ and $u \in A^\star$. Then way may reduce to the case $1 - n$ and observe that

$$(1 - n)^{-1} = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} n^i$$

which by assumption is a finite sum. □

3.4.7 Algebra over a Commutative Ring

For what follows let A be a commutative ring.

Definition 3.4.69 (Algebra (over a commutative ring))

An algebra over A (or an A -algebra) is a pair (i_B, B) where B is a (not necessarily commutative) ring and $i_B : A \rightarrow B$ is a ring homomorphism.

We call i_B the structural morphism and write $a \cdot b := i_B(a)b$

Morphisms of A -algebras are the ring homomorphisms $\phi : B \rightarrow C$ such that $\phi \circ i_B = i_C$. This then constitutes a category $\mathbf{Alg}_A$.

If k is a field an algebra over k is referred to as a k -algebra.

Definition 3.4.70 (Sub-algebra)

Let (i_B, B) be an A -algebra. A sub-algebra C is a subring C of B for which

$$a \in A \quad c \in C \implies i_B(a)c \in C$$

Example 3.4.71 (Algebra over commutative sub-ring)

If $A \subset B$ is a commutative sub-ring, then B is naturally a A -algebra.

The polynomial ring $A[X]$ is naturally an A -algebra

Definition 3.4.72 (Algebra generated by a set)

Let B be an A -algebra. The collection of A -subalgebras forms a *Moore family*. Therefore by (2.1.40) there is a canonical closure operator

$$A[-] : \mathcal{P}(B) \rightarrow \mathbf{SubAlg}_A(B)$$

which we denote by $A[S]$ for $S \subset B$. A more explicit characterization when S is finite is given in Section 3.11. More generally we have

$$A[S] = \bigcup_{S' \subset S \mid S' \text{ finite}} A[S']$$

Proposition 3.4.73

Let $B = A[S]$ be an A -algebra and $\mathfrak{a}$ a sub- A -module of B . Then $\mathfrak{a}$ is an ideal if and only if

$$s \in S \implies s\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$$

Proof. One direction is obvious. Suppose the condition given holds, and define

$$B' := \{b \in B \mid b\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{a}\}$$

Then clearly $S \subseteq B'$. It's easy to show that B' is a sub- A -algebra of B , so $B' = B$ and $\mathfrak{a}$ is an ideal. □

3.4.8 Finite-type Algebras

Definition 3.4.74 (Finite algebra)

An A -algebra B is finite if it is finite as an A -module.

Definition 3.4.75 (Finitely generated algebra)

An A -algebra B is finitely generated (or of finite type) if there exists an integer $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and a surjection of A -algebras

$$A[X_1, \dots, X_n] \rightarrow B$$

the images of X_i are the generators.

Proposition 3.4.76

Let C be a finitely-generated B algebra and B a finitely-generated A -algebra. Then C is finitely-generated as an A -algebra.

Proof. Suppose $C = B[c_1, \dots, c_n]$. Then by definition $c_i = F_i(b_1, \dots, b_m)$ for some $F_i \in A[X_1, \dots, X_m]$. Then we may take as a generating set

$$b_1^{\lambda_1} \dots b_m^{\lambda_m}$$

where $\lambda \in \mathbb{N}^m$ runs through all the exponents of non-zero coefficients of the F_i . □

3.4.9 Bimodules

For applications it is often useful to have multiple rings acting on a single module (“bimodule”). For example an A -algebra B naturally has an action from both A and B . It may also allow us to generalise results which would otherwise only hold in the commutative case.

Definition 3.4.77 (Bimodule)

Let A, B be rings. We say an abelian group M is a (A, B) -**bimodule** if it is both a left A -module and a right B -module for which the two actions commute

$$a \cdot (m \cdot b) = (a \cdot m) \cdot b \quad \forall a \in A, b \in B, m \in M$$

We may denote this by ${}_A M_B$ in order to emphasise the actions. If homomorphisms are defined in the obvious way then these constitute a category ${}_A \mathbf{Mod}_B$. Recall that every abelian group is automatically both a left and right $\mathbb{Z}$ -module with the following action for $N \in \mathbb{Z}$

$$N \cdot m = m \cdot N := \begin{cases} \underbrace{m + \dots + m}_{N \text{ times}} & N \geq 0 \\ -(m \cdot (-N)) & N < 0 \end{cases}$$

Therefore we have the following generalisations

- A right B -module is precisely a $(\mathbb{Z}, B)$ -bimodule
- A left A -module is precisely a $(A, \mathbb{Z})$ -bimodule
- When A is commutative an A -module has a well-defined (A, A) -bimodule structure by defining

$$a \cdot m \cdot a' := a' a \cdot m = aa' \cdot m$$

in other words $A\text{-Mod}$ is (equivalent to) a full subcategory of ${}_A \mathbf{Mod}_A$.

- A ring A has an obvious (A, A) -bimodule structure by associativity of the multiplication operation

We will understand by the notation N_B that N is a $(\mathbb{Z}, B)$ -bimodule and by ${}_A M$ that M is a $(A, \mathbb{Z})$ -bimodule.

We generalize slightly the consideration of the third bullet point

Proposition 3.4.78 ((A, A) -Bimodule $\equiv$ A -module)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a homomorphism of commutative rings and Z a B -module. Then Z is naturally a (B, A) -module with the following action

$$b \cdot m \cdot a := \phi(a)b \cdot m \quad \forall a \in A, b \in B, m \in Z \quad (\star)$$

Suppose M is another (B, A) -bimodule satisfying $\star$ then we may identify the (B, A) -bimodule homomorphisms and the left B -module homomorphisms.

$$\mathrm{Hom}(M, {}_B Z_A) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{Hom}({}_B M, {}_B Z)$$

In particular when $\phi = 1_A$ and $B = A$ we may identify (A, A) -bimodules and A -modules, as well as the corresponding homomorphisms. Explicitly for M, Z A -modules these have well-defined (A, A) -bimodule structures and there is a bijection

$$\text{Hom}({}_A M_A, {}_A Z_A) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}(M, Z)$$

Proof. We may show that the right A -module structure on Z is well-defined because B is commutative and using the associativity of the B -module action. Similarly the associativity of the B -module action ensures that the actions commute and so form a (B, A) -bimodule structure.

Suppose $\theta : M \rightarrow Z$ is a (left) B -module homomorphism. Then

$$\theta(m \cdot a) = \theta(\phi(a) \cdot m) = \phi(a)\theta(m) = \theta(m) \cdot a$$

so it is (B, A) -bilinear as required. The converse is clear, so we see that the sets are equal as subsets of the set of abelian group homomorphisms.

The case $\phi = 1_A$ is immediate. □

We generalize the notion of “Hom-Set”

Definition 3.4.79 (Hom Functors)

Let A, B, C be arbitrary rings. Then we have an *enriched hom functor* for ${}_A \mathbf{Mod}_B$

$$\text{Hom} : {}_A \mathbf{Mod}_B^{op} \times {}_A \mathbf{Mod}_B \rightarrow \mathbf{AbGrp}$$

In order to generalise the Tensor-Hom adjunction we consider the following functors (“right-linear” and “left-linear” respectively)

$$\begin{aligned} \text{RHom} : {}_B \mathbf{Mod}_A^{op} \times {}_C \mathbf{Mod}_A &\rightarrow {}_C \mathbf{Mod}_B \\ \text{LHom} : {}_A \mathbf{Mod}_B^{op} \times {}_A \mathbf{Mod}_C &\rightarrow {}_B \mathbf{Mod}_C \end{aligned}$$

For example if $\psi \in \text{RHom}({}_B M_C, {}_A N_C)$ then the (A, B) -bimodule action is defined to be

$$(a\psi b)(m) := a\psi(bm)$$

and similarly if $\phi \in \text{LHom}({}_A M_B, {}_A N_C)$ then

$$(b\phi c)(m) := \phi(mb)c$$

which we may verify satisfies the axioms of a bimodule. In order to standardize notation we may write Hom_A in place of RHom and LHom .

If $B = C = \mathbb{Z}$ then we recover the simple case (3.4.25).

If A is a commutative ring then we’ve observed that $A\text{-Mod}$ is a full subcategory of ${}_A \mathbf{Mod}_A$ and the functors RHom , LHom become equal to the simple case (3.4.25) when restricted to this subcategory.

3.4.10 Module Direct Product and Sum

Definition 3.4.80 (External Direct Product / Sum)

Let A be a ring and $\{M_i\}_{i \in I}$ a family of A -modules. Define the **external direct product** as the set of ordered tuples indexed over I

$$\prod_{i \in I} M_i := \{(m_i)_{i \in I} \mid m_i \in M_i\}$$

with the obvious module operations. The **external direct sum** is the subset of tuples for which all but finitely many elements are zero. We denote this as follows

$$\bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i$$

Clearly when I is finite then these are equal.

Proposition 3.4.81 (Categorical Product)

Let $\{M_i\}_{i \in I}$ be a family of left A -modules and consider the family of projections

$$\pi_i : \prod_{i \in I} M_i \rightarrow M_i$$

For Z an (A, C) -bimodule there is a natural isomorphism of left C -modules

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}_A(Z, \prod_{i \in I} M_i) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \prod_{i \in I} \text{Hom}_A(Z, M_i) \\ \theta &\rightarrow (\pi_i \circ \theta)_{i \in I} \end{aligned}$$

This in particular includes the case $A = C$ is commutative.

Proposition 3.4.82 (Categorical Coproduct)

Let $\{M_i\}_{i \in I}$ be a family of left A -modules and consider the family of inclusions

$$u_i : M_i \rightarrow \bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i$$

For Z a (A, C) -bimodule there is a natural isomorphism of right C -modules

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}_A(\bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i, Z) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \prod_{i \in I} \text{Hom}_A(M_i, Z) \\ \theta &\rightarrow (\theta \circ u_i)_{i \in I} \end{aligned}$$

This in particular includes the case $A = C$ is commutative.

Corollary 3.4.83

Let $(M_i)_{i \in I}$ and $(N_j)_{j \in J}$ be families of left A -modules. Then there is an isomorphism of abelian groups

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}_A\left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i, \prod_{j \in J} N_j\right) &\cong \prod_{(i,j) \in I \times J} \text{Hom}_A(M_i, N_j) \\ \psi &\rightarrow (\pi_j \circ \psi \circ u_i)_{(i,j)} \end{aligned}$$

where $\pi_j : \prod_{j \in J} N_j \rightarrow N_j$ and $u_i : M_i \rightarrow \bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i$ are the canonical projections and injections respectively.

These maps are A -linear if A is commutative.

Definition 3.4.84 (Free Module)

An A -module M is

- **free** if it is isomorphic to

$$\bigoplus_{i \in A} A =: A^{(I)}$$

for some indexing set I

- **finite free** if it is free with respect to a finite indexing set I

Under the isomorphism $M \rightarrow \bigoplus_{i \in I} A$ the set of elements $\{m_i\}_{i \in I}$ corresponding to the standard basis vectors e_i is called a **basis** for M .

We say that M has **rank** n if there exists a basis of order n . NB rank is not necessarily unique.

Proposition 3.4.85

Let M be an (A, C) -bimodule then there is a canonical isomorphism of right C -modules

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}_A(A, M) &\cong M \\ \theta &\rightarrow \theta(1_A) \end{aligned}$$

This in particular includes the case $A = C$ is commutative.

Proposition 3.4.86

Let M be a free left A -module with basis $(m_i)_{i \in I}$ and N an (A, C) -bimodule then there is an isomorphism of right C -modules

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}_A(M, N) &\cong \prod_{i \in I} N \\ \theta &\rightarrow (\theta(m_i))_{i \in I} \end{aligned}$$

This in particular includes the case $A = C$ is commutative.

3.4.11 Free Modules

Definition 3.4.87 (Faithful Module)

We say an A -module M is **faithful** if

$$am = 0 \quad \forall m \in M \implies a = 0$$

Definition 3.4.88 (Linearly Independent, Spanning and Basis)

Let M be an A -module and $S \subset M$ a set. We say S is

- **spanning** if $\langle S \rangle = M$
- **linearly independent** if for every finite subset $\{s_1, \dots, s_n\} \subseteq S$ with s_i distinct we have

$$\sum_{i=1}^n a_i s_i = 0 \implies a_i = 0 \quad 1 \leq i \leq n$$

- a **basis** if it is both spanning and linearly independent

Definition 3.4.89 (Finite Module)

An A -module M is **finite** if there exists a finite spanning set.

Definition 3.4.90 (Minimal spanning set)

Let M be an A -module. Then $S \subset M$ is a **minimal spanning set** if it generates M and no proper subset does so.

Definition 3.4.91 (Free Module)

Let M be an A -module. We say that M is a **free module** over A if it has a basis.

Proposition 3.4.92 (Free A -module is an external sum of A)

An A -module M is free if and only if it is isomorphic to $\bigoplus_{i \in I} A$ for some I . The isomorphism is given by

$$\sum_{i \in I} a_i m_i \rightarrow (a_i)_{i \in I}$$

Definition 3.4.93 (Internal Direct Sum Module)

An A -module M is an **internal direct sum** of submodules $\{M_i\}_{i \in I}$ the canonical mapping of the external direct sum

$$\bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i \rightarrow M$$

is an isomorphism.

Proposition 3.4.94

Let M be an A -module and $\{M_i\}_{i \in I}$ a family of submodules. Then the following are equivalent

- $\sum_{i \in I} M_i$ is the internal direct sum of the family $\{M_i\}_{i \in I}$
- The relation $\sum_{i \in I} m_i = 0$ implies $m_i = 0$ for all $i \in I$
- For any $i \in I$ we have $M_i \cap \left(\sum_{k \neq i} M_k\right) = \{0\}$

Proposition 3.4.95

We say that M_1, M_2 are **supplementary** submodules of M if M is the internal direct sum of M_1 and M_2 .

We say that M_1 is a **direct factor** of M if it is supplementary to another submodule.

3.4.12 Exact Sequences

Definition 3.4.96 (Vector space)

If k is a field and V a k -module, then we say V is a **vector space** over k .

Remark 3.4.97

We will see that every vector space is free and every k -submodule is a direct factor.

Proposition 3.4.98 (Kernel)

Let $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ be an A -module homomorphism, then the **kernel** of ϕ

$$\ker(\phi) := \{m \in M \mid \phi(m) = 0\}$$

is an A -submodule of M . Observe ϕ is injective iff $\ker(\phi) = 0$.

Proposition 3.4.99 (Image)

Let $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ be an A -module homomorphism then the image

$$\text{Im}(\phi) = \{\phi(m) \mid m \in M\}$$

is an A -submodule of N .

Definition 3.4.100 (Quotient Module)

Let $N \subseteq M$ be an A -submodule then define the **quotient module** M/N to be the quotient group with an action of A given by

$$a(m + N) = (am + N)$$

When $N \subseteq P \subseteq M$ is a sequence of submodules then define the A -submodule P/N of M/N by

$$P/N := \{p + N \mid p \in P\}$$

Proposition 3.4.101 (Quotient Module Properties)

Let $N \subseteq M$ be an A -submodule then there is a canonical surjective morphism

$$\pi : M \rightarrow M/N$$

with the following properties

- a) $\pi(m) = m + N$
- b) $\ker(\pi) = N$
- c) Every homomorphism $\psi : M \rightarrow P$ such that $N \subseteq \ker(\psi)$, factors uniquely through π

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M & \xrightarrow{\psi} & P \\ \downarrow \pi & \nearrow \tilde{\psi} & \\ M/N & & \end{array}$$

Furthermore there is a bijection of A -submodules

$$\{P' \subseteq M/N\} \longleftrightarrow \{P \mid N \subseteq P \subseteq M\}$$

given by $P' = P/N$. In the situation above $\ker(\tilde{\psi}) = \ker(\psi)/N$. In particular if $\ker(\psi) = N$ then $\tilde{\psi}$ is injective.

Corollary 3.4.102

Let $\psi : M \rightarrow N$ be an A -module homomorphism, then this induces an isomorphism

$$M/\ker(\psi) \cong \text{Im}(\psi)$$

Definition 3.4.103 (Exact Sequence)

Let $N \xrightarrow{\phi} M \xrightarrow{\psi} P$ be a sequence of A -module homomorphisms. We say it is **exact** if

$$\text{Im}(\phi) = \ker(\psi)$$

It is equivalent to the following two conditions

- a) $\psi \circ \phi = 0$

b) $\psi(m) = 0 \implies m = \phi(n)$ for some $n \in N$.

An exact sequence of the form

$$0 \rightarrow N \rightarrow M \rightarrow P \rightarrow 0$$

is said to be **short-exact**.

Remark 3.4.104

There are a few trivial observations

- $0 \rightarrow M \rightarrow N$ is exact if and only if the map $M \rightarrow N$ is injective
- $M \rightarrow N \rightarrow 0$ is exact if and only if the map $M \rightarrow N$ is surjective.

Proposition 3.4.105 (Isomorphism induced by short-exact sequence)

Let $N \subseteq M$ be a A -submodule then there is a canonical short-exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow N \rightarrow M \rightarrow M/N \rightarrow 0$$

Conversely suppose we have a short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow N \xrightarrow{i} M \xrightarrow{\pi} P \rightarrow 0$$

then this induces an isomorphism

$$M/i(N) \cong P$$

If N is a submodule of M then we would simply write $M/N \cong P$.

Proposition 3.4.106 (Third Isomorphism Theorem)

Let $N \subseteq N' \subseteq M$ be a chain of modules then there is a short-exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow N'/N \rightarrow M/N \rightarrow M/N' \rightarrow 0$$

which then induces an isomorphism

$$(M/N)/(N'/N) \cong M/N'$$

Proposition 3.4.107 (Product of ideal and quotient module)

Let N be a submodule of M and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ an ideal. Then

$$\mathfrak{a}(M/N) = (N + \mathfrak{a}M)/N$$

Proposition 3.4.108 (Induced module)

Let M be an A -module and $\mathfrak{a}$ an ideal such that $\mathfrak{a}M = 0$, then M is naturally an $A/\mathfrak{a}$ -module with action given by

$$\bar{a} \cdot m := a \cdot m$$

3.4.13 Dual Module

Proposition 3.4.109 (Dual Module)

Let M be a left (resp. right) A -module. Then the set

$$M^\vee := \text{Hom}_A(M, A)$$

is canonically a right (resp. left) A -module.

If M is a finite free left (resp. right) A -module with basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ then $M^\vee$ is a finite free right (resp. left) A -module with basis $\{v_1^\vee, \dots, v_n^\vee\}$ where these are the unique homomorphisms satisfying

$$v_i^\vee(v_j) = \delta_{ij}$$

Moreover every basis of $M^\vee$ is of this form.

Proposition 3.4.110 (Hom-Set is free)

Let M be a finite free left A -module with basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ and N a (A, B) -bimodule. Then there is an isomorphism of right B -modules

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}_A(M, N) &\cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^n N \\ \theta &\rightarrow (\theta(v_i))_{i \in I} \end{aligned}$$

If A is commutative and N is a finite-free A -module with basis $\{w_1, \dots, w_m\}$ then there is further an isomorphism of A -modules

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}_A(M, N) &\cong \bigoplus_{i,j=1}^{n,m} A \\ \theta &\rightarrow (w_j^\vee(\theta(v_i)))_{i,j} \end{aligned}$$

where $w_1^\vee, \dots, w_m^\vee$ is the dual basis for $N^\vee$. In particular $\text{Hom}_A(M, N)$ is a finite-free A -module with basis

$$\{w_j v_i^\vee\}_{i,j}$$

Definition 3.4.111 (Dual Functor)

Let A be a commutative ring and $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ an A -module homomorphism. Define the dual homomorphism $\phi^\vee : N^\vee \rightarrow M^\vee$ by

$$\phi^\vee(\psi) := \psi \circ \phi$$

This determines a contravariant functor

$$(-)^\vee : A\text{-Mod} \rightarrow A\text{-Mod}$$

Corollary 3.4.112 (Double Dual Natural Isomorphism)

Let A be a commutative ring and M a finite free A -module then the canonical A -module homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \eta : M &\longrightarrow M^{\vee\vee} \\ x &\rightarrow (\phi \rightarrow \phi(x)) \end{aligned}$$

is an isomorphism, which is natural in M .

Corollary 3.4.113

The contravariant functor $(-)^\vee : \mathbf{FiniteFreeMod}_A \rightarrow \mathbf{FiniteFreeMod}_A$ is an equivalence of categories and therefore full and faithful.

Proof. Use the dual isomorphism η together with (2.6.28) and (2.6.27). □

3.4.14 Matrices

For this section we assume that A is a commutative ring. In this context $A^n := A \times \dots \times A$ is a [finite free module](#) with basis $e_1, \dots, e_n$. Matrices are concrete realisations of linear maps of finite free modules.

Proposition 3.4.114

Let M, N be finite free A -modules with ordered bases $\mathcal{B} := \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$, $\mathcal{B}' := \{w_1, \dots, w_m\}$ respectively. Let $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ be an A -linear map and define $[\phi]$ to be the unique $m \times n$ matrix satisfying the following condition

$$\phi(v_i) = \sum_{j=1}^m [\phi]_{ji} w_j \quad \forall i = 1 \dots n$$

(notice sum over the first index). Then it is also the unique matrix ensuring that the following diagram commutes

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M & \xrightarrow{\phi} & N \\ \sim \uparrow & & \sim \uparrow \\ A^n & \xrightarrow{x \rightarrow [\phi]x} & A^m \end{array}$$

where the bottom arrow is given by usual multiplication of a matrix by a column vector

Proposition 3.4.115 (Matrices as linear maps)

Let M, N be free A -modules with ordered bases $\mathcal{B} := \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$, $\mathcal{B}' := \{w_1, \dots, w_m\}$ respectively. Then there are mutually inverse isomorphisms of A -modules

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Mat}_{m \times n}(A) & \longleftrightarrow & \text{Hom}_A(M, N) \\ E & \longrightarrow & \widehat{E} \\ [\phi]_{\mathcal{B}'}^{\mathcal{B}} & \longleftarrow & \phi \end{array}$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \widehat{E} \left(\sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i v_i \right) &:= \sum_{j=1}^m \left(\sum_{i=1}^n E_{ji} \lambda_i \right) w_j \\ \phi(v_i) &= \sum_{j=1}^m [\phi]_{ji} w_j \end{aligned}$$

If we further consider a free A -module P with ordered bases $\mathcal{B}'' = \{u_1, \dots, u_p\}$ then

$$\begin{aligned} \widehat{E} \circ \widehat{F} &= \widehat{EF} \\ [\psi \circ \phi]_{\mathcal{B}''}^{\mathcal{B}'} &= [\psi]_{\mathcal{B}''}^{\mathcal{B}'} [\phi]_{\mathcal{B}'}^{\mathcal{B}} \end{aligned}$$

Observe that

$$[1_M]_{\mathcal{B}}^{\mathcal{B}} = I_n$$

Furthermore there is an isomorphism of A -algebras

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{End}_A(M) & \longleftrightarrow & \text{Mat}_{n,n}(A) \\ \phi & \longrightarrow & (v_i^\vee(\phi(v_j)))_{ij} \\ \sum_{ij} E_{ij} v_i v_j^\vee & \longleftarrow & E \end{array}$$

Corollary 3.4.116

Matrix multiplication is associative. In particular

$$(EF)v = E(Fv)$$

Proof. We may consider the free A -modules A^n , A^m and A^p with canonical bases. The result follows because function composition is associative and $\widehat{\cdot}$ is injective. $\square$

Corollary 3.4.117

There is an isomorphism of A -modules

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Mat}_{m \times n}(A) & \longleftrightarrow & \text{Hom}_A(A^n, A^m) \\ E & \rightarrow & (v \rightarrow Ev) \end{array}$$

and further an isomorphism of A -algebras

$$\text{Mat}_{n,n}(A) \longleftrightarrow \text{End}_A(A^n)$$

Corollary 3.4.118

Let M be a finite free A -module with bases $\mathcal{B}, \mathcal{B}'$ and $\phi \in \text{End}_A(M)$. Then ϕ is an isomorphism if and only if $[\phi]_{\mathcal{B}'}^{\mathcal{B}} \in \text{Mat}_{n \times n}(A)$ is invertible.

Corollary 3.4.119 (Change of basis)

Let M be a finite free A -module and $\mathcal{B}, \mathcal{B}'$ bases then

$$[1_M]_{\mathcal{B}'}^{\mathcal{B}} = ([1_M]_{\mathcal{B}}^{\mathcal{B}'})^{-1}$$

and

$$[\phi]_{\mathcal{B}'}^{\mathcal{B}'} = P[\phi]_{\mathcal{B}}^{\mathcal{B}} P^{-1}$$

where

$$P := [1_M]_{\mathcal{B}'}^{\mathcal{B}}$$

is invertible.

Definition 3.4.120 (Transpose)

Let E be an $m \times n$ matrix in A , then define the **transpose** of E to be the $n \times m$ matrix E^t where

$$(E^t)_{ij} := E_{ji}$$

Proposition 3.4.121

Let M, N be finite-free A -modules with bases $\mathcal{B} = \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ and $\mathcal{B}' = \{w_1, \dots, w_m\}$. Let $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ be an A -module homomorphism and $\phi^\vee : N^\vee \rightarrow M^\vee$ the dual homomorphism then

$$[\phi^\vee]_{\mathcal{B}^\vee}^{\mathcal{B}'^\vee} = ([\phi]_{\mathcal{B}'}^{\mathcal{B}})^t$$

Similarly if E is an $m \times n$ matrix over A then

$$\widehat{E}^\vee = \widehat{E}^t$$

where the right hand side is understood to be with respect to the dual bases.

Corollary 3.4.122

Let E, F be matrices then

$$(EF)^t = (FE)^t$$

3.4.15 Vector Spaces**Definition 3.4.123** (Vector Space)

A **vector space** V over k is simply a k -module.

A k -submodule is referred to as a **subspace**

A k -module homomorphism is referred to as a **linear map**

A vector space is finite-dimensional if it is finite as a k -module.

The main result on vector spaces is that **bases** exist and all have the same cardinality. Recall that $\langle \cdot \rangle$ is a **closure operator**. We show that $(V, \langle \cdot \rangle)$ determines a **matroid** so that we may appeal to results in Section 2.3. First we need to show that the notions of independence coincide

Proposition 3.4.124 (Equivalent definitions of linear independence)

Let V be a vector space and $S \subset V$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) S is **linearly independent**
- b) No proper subset $S' \subset S$ satisfies $\langle S' \rangle = \langle S \rangle$
- c) **Matroid Independence** $x \in S \implies x \notin \langle S \setminus \{x\} \rangle$

Further S is independent if and only if every finite subset of S is.

Proof. $b \iff c$) This is (2.3.2).

$a \implies c$). If $x \in \langle S \setminus \{x\} \rangle$ then it's clear that S is not linearly independent.

$c \implies a$). Suppose we have a linear relationship

$$0 = \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i v_i \quad v_i \in S$$

By renumbering assume that $\lambda_1 \neq 0$, then rearrange to show $v_1 \in \langle S \setminus \{v_1\} \rangle$, contradicting the hypothesis. $\square$

We show that $(V, \langle \cdot \rangle)$ satisfies the **Exchange Property** and therefore constitutes a matroid.

Proposition 3.4.125 (Exchange Property)

Let V be a vector space and $S \subset V$. Then

$$y \in \langle S \cup \{x\} \rangle \setminus \langle S \rangle \implies x \in \langle S \cup \{y\} \rangle$$

Proof. Suppose y is as given, then

$$y = \lambda x + \sum_i \lambda_i s_i \quad s_i \in S$$

The case $\lambda = 0$ is obvious. Otherwise we may rearrange to find

$$x = \lambda^{-1}y - \sum_i \lambda^{-1}\lambda_i s_i$$

whence $x \in \langle S \cup \{y\} \rangle$. □

Therefore we have the following

Proposition 3.4.126 (Vector Spaces are Free)

Every vector space has a basis, and in the finite-dimensional case every basis is finite of the same size. We denote this by $\dim_k V$.

More generally every linearly independent set is contained in a basis (so has order at most $\dim_k V$) and every spanning set contains a basis (so has order at least $\dim_k V$)

Proof. Follows from (2.3.7) and (2.3.11). The final statement follows from (2.3.12). □

Proposition 3.4.127 (Basis Criteria)

Let V be a vector space with $n = \dim_k V$ and $\mathcal{B} \subseteq V$. Then TFAE

- a) $\mathcal{B}$ is a basis
- b) $\mathcal{B}$ is linearly independent and $\#\mathcal{B} \geq \dim_k V$
- c) $\mathcal{B}$ is spanning and $\#\mathcal{B} \leq \dim_k V$

Proof. The equivalence of a), b) and c) follows from (2.3.13). □

Proposition 3.4.128

A vector space $V = \{0\}$ if and only if $\dim_k V = 0$

Proposition 3.4.129 (Image of a basis)

Let $\phi: V \rightarrow W$ be a linear map

- a) *If S is linearly-independent and ϕ is injective, then $\phi(S)$ is linearly-independent*
- b) *If Γ is spanning then (ϕ is surjective $\iff \phi(\Gamma)$ is spanning)*
- c) *If $\mathcal{B}$ is a basis then (ϕ is an isomorphism $\iff \phi(\mathcal{B})$ is a basis and ϕ injective on $\mathcal{B}$)*

Proof. a) Suppose $\sum_i \lambda_i \phi(s_i) = 0 \implies \phi(\sum_i \lambda_i s_i) = 0$. As ϕ is injective this implies $\sum_i \lambda_i s_i = 0 \implies \lambda_i = 0$.

b) If ϕ is surjective then for $w \in W$ we have $\phi(v) = w$ for some $v \in V$. By hypothesis $v = \sum_i \lambda_i \gamma_i$ and $w = \sum_i \phi(\lambda_i \gamma_i)$. Conversely given $w \in W$ by hypothesis $w = \sum_i \lambda_i \phi(\gamma_i) = \phi(\sum_i \lambda_i \gamma_i)$ and ϕ is surjective as required.

c) Suppose ϕ is isomorphism, then it's surely injective on $\mathcal{B}$ and by a), b) $\phi(\mathcal{B})$ is a basis. Conversely if $\phi(\mathcal{B}) =: \mathcal{B}'$ is a basis then by b) ϕ is surjective. Suppose $\phi(v) = 0$. Then by hypothesis $v = \sum_i \lambda_i v_i$ for $v_i \in \mathcal{B}$ and $0 = \phi(v) = \sum_i \lambda_i \phi(v_i)$. By hypothesis $\phi(v_i)$ are distinct elements of the basis $\mathcal{B}'$ and therefore $\lambda_i = 0$ and $v = 0$. Therefore ϕ is injective and hence bijective. □

Corollary 3.4.130 (Dimension is an invariant)

Dimension is preserved under isomorphism. More generally for $\phi: V \rightarrow W$ we have

$$\phi \text{ injective} \implies \dim_k V \leq \dim_k W$$

$$\phi \text{ surjective} \implies \dim_k V \geq \dim_k W$$

Proposition 3.4.131

Let $W \subseteq V$ be finite-dimensional vector spaces then the dimension of the quotient module satisfies

$$\dim_k V/W = \dim_k V - \dim_k W$$

Proof. Let $\{v_1, \dots, v_m\}$ be a basis of W , then there exists a basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_m, v_{m+1}, \dots, v_n\}$ of V containing the first by (3.4.126). We claim that

$$\{[v_{m+1}], \dots, [v_n]\}$$

is a basis for V/W , and the result follows. For given $[v] \in V/W$ then

$$v = \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i v_i$$

since the basis is spanning. We have

$$v - \sum_{i=m+1}^n \lambda_i v_i \in W$$

therefore

$$[v] = [\sum_{i=m+1}^n \lambda_i v_i] = \sum_{i=m+1}^n \lambda_i [v_i]$$

and the given set is spanning. Similarly suppose

$$\sum_{i=m+1}^n \lambda_i [v_i] = 0$$

then by definition $\sum_{i=m+1}^n \lambda_i v_i \in W$. Therefore

$$\sum_{i=m+1}^n \lambda_i v_i = \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i v_i$$

and since v_i are linearly independent we must have $\lambda_i = 0$. □

Proposition 3.4.132 (Injective Criteria)

Let $\phi : V \rightarrow W$ be a linear map then

$$\phi \text{ injective} \iff \ker(\phi) = \{0\} \iff \dim_k \ker(\phi) = 0$$

Proof. Note for any linear map ϕ we have $\phi(0) = 0$. Therefore ϕ injective clearly shows $\ker(\phi) = \{0\}$. Conversely suppose $\ker(\phi) = 0$ and $\phi(v) = \phi(w)$. Then $\phi(v - w) = 0 \implies v - w = 0 \implies v = w$ as required. □

Definition 3.4.133 (Rank)

Let $\phi : V \rightarrow W$ be a linear map then define

$$\text{rank}_k(\phi) := \dim_k(\text{Im}(\phi))$$

Proposition 3.4.134 (Surjective Criteria)

Let $\phi : V \rightarrow W$ be a linear map with W finite-dimensional then

$$\phi \text{ surjective} \iff \text{rank}_k(\phi) = \dim_k W$$

Proof. This follows directly from (2.3.15). □

Proposition 3.4.135 (Isomorphism Theorem / Rank-Nullity)

Let $\phi : V \rightarrow W$ be a linear map then this induces an isomorphism

$$V/\ker(\phi) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{im}(\phi)$$

in particular when V is finite-dimensional

$$\dim_k V = \dim_k \ker(\phi) + \text{rank}_k(\phi)$$

Corollary 3.4.136 (Isomorphism Criteria)

Let V, W vector spaces with W finite-dimensional. A linear map $\phi : V \rightarrow W$ is an isomorphism if and only if any two of the following are satisfied

- a) $\dim_k \ker(\phi) = 0 \iff \phi$ injective
- b) $\dim_k V = \dim_k W$
- c) $\text{rank}_k(\phi) = \dim_k W \iff \phi$ surjective

Proof. The rank-nullity equation ensures that if any two hold the third is automatically satisfied. In this case ϕ is isomorphism as required. $\square$

Corollary 3.4.137 (Endomorphism Isomorphism Criteria)

Let V be a finite-dimensional vector space and $\phi : V \rightarrow V$ then TFAE

- a) ϕ is injective
- b) ϕ is surjective
- c) ϕ is an isomorphism

Proof. For the equivalence of a), b) and c) we may use the previous result with $W = V$ and note $\dim_k W = \dim_k V$ is automatically satisfied. $\square$

Proposition 3.4.138 (Internal Direct Sum)

Let U_1, U_2 be two subspaces of V then TFAE

- a) $U_1 \cap U_2 = \{0\}$ and $V = U_1 + U_2$
- b) Every $v \in V$ may be written uniquely as $u_1 + u_2$ for $u_i \in U_i$.

and we say $V = U_1 \oplus U_2$ is an **internal direct sum** and U_2 is a **supplementary subspace** for U_1 .

Proposition 3.4.139 (Subspaces are direct factors)

Every subspace U has a supplementary subspace U' such that

$$V = U \oplus U'$$

Proof. Let $\mathcal{B}_1$ be a basis for U and extend to a basis $\mathcal{B}$ and define $\mathcal{B}_2 := \mathcal{B} \setminus \mathcal{B}_1$. Then it's easy to show that $U' = \langle \mathcal{B}_2 \rangle$ is a supplementary subspace. $\square$

Proposition 3.4.140 (Dimension formula for direct sums)

Suppose $V = U_1 \oplus U_2$, $\mathcal{B}_1$ is a basis for U_1 and $\mathcal{B}_2$ is a basis for U_2 . Then $\mathcal{B}_1 \cap \mathcal{B}_2 = \emptyset$ and $\mathcal{B}_1 \cup \mathcal{B}_2$ is a basis for V . In particular

$$\dim_k V = \dim_k U_1 + \dim_k U_2$$

3.4.15.1 Dual Space**Definition 3.4.141** (Dual Space)

Let V be a k -vector space and define the **dual space** to be

$$V^\vee := \text{Hom}_k(V, k)$$

This is an abelian group and even a k -vector space under the obvious operations. The construction $V \rightarrow V^\vee$ determines a contravariant functor

$$(-)^\vee : \mathbf{Vect}_k \rightarrow \mathbf{Vect}_k$$

Definition 3.4.142 (Annihilator)

Let V be a vector space and $U \subseteq V$ a subspace. Define the **annihilator** of U by

$$U^\circ = \{\theta \in V^\vee \mid \theta(u) = 0 \quad \forall u \in U\}$$

This is a linear subspace of $V^\vee$.

Proposition 3.4.143 (Dimension formula for annihilators)

There is a canonical isomorphism by restriction

$$V^\vee / U^\circ \longrightarrow U^\vee$$

In particular when V is a finite-dimensional vector space then

$$\dim_k V = \dim_k U + \dim_k U^\circ$$

Proof. Let W be a supplementary subspace and consider the morphism $V = U \oplus W \xrightarrow{\pi_U} U$. Then $(\theta \circ \pi_U)|_U = \theta$ so the restriction map is surjective. Clearly the kernel is U° . The dimension formula follows from (3.4.135) and (3.4.109). $\square$

Corollary 3.4.144 (Dual rank = rank)

Let $\phi : V \rightarrow W$ be a linear map and $\phi^\vee : W^\vee \rightarrow V^\vee$ then

$$\begin{aligned} \ker(\phi^\vee) &= \operatorname{im}(\phi)^\circ \\ \operatorname{im}(\phi^\vee) &\subseteq \ker(\phi)^\circ \end{aligned}$$

In the finite-dimensional case $\operatorname{im}(\phi^\vee) = \ker(\phi)^\circ$ and

$$\begin{aligned} \dim_k \ker(\phi^\vee) &= \dim_k W - \operatorname{rank}_k(\phi) \\ \operatorname{rank}_k(\phi^\vee) &= \operatorname{rank}_k(\phi) \end{aligned}$$

Proof. Note $\ker(\phi^\vee) = \operatorname{im}(\phi)^\circ$ and $\operatorname{im}(\phi^\vee) \subseteq \ker(\phi)^\circ$ by the definitions.

Consider the finite-dimensional case. By (3.4.143)

$$\dim_k \ker(\phi^\vee) = \dim_k \operatorname{im}(\phi)^\circ = \dim_k W - \operatorname{rank}_k(\phi)$$

By rank-nullity applied to $\phi^\vee$ and $\dim_k W = \dim_k W^\vee$ we deduce

$$\operatorname{rank}_k(\phi^\vee) = \operatorname{rank}_k(\phi).$$

By (3.4.143) and rank-nullity applied to ϕ

$$\dim_k \ker(\phi)^\circ = \dim_k V - \dim_k \ker(\phi) = \operatorname{rank}_k(\phi).$$

Finally by (2.3.15) $\operatorname{im}(\phi^\vee) = \ker(\phi)^\circ$.

$\square$

From this it follows that taking duals reflects and preserve isomorphisms

Corollary 3.4.145 $(-)^{\vee}$ reflects isomorphisms

Let $\phi : V \rightarrow W$ be a linear map of finite-dimensional spaces then

- a) ϕ is injective if and only if $\phi^\vee$ is surjective
- b) ϕ is surjective if and only if $\phi^\vee$ is injective
- c) ϕ is iso if and only if $\phi^\vee$ is iso

Proof. Note by (3.4.144) we have $\operatorname{rank}_k(\phi) = \operatorname{rank}_k(\phi^\vee)$ and by (3.4.109) $\dim_k V^\vee = \dim_k V$.

ϕ is surjective $\iff \operatorname{rank}_k(\phi) = \dim_k W = \operatorname{rank}_k(\phi^\vee) \xLeftrightarrow{(3.4.135)} \dim_k \ker(\phi^\vee) = 0 \iff \ker(\phi^\vee) = \{0\}$

ϕ is injective $\iff \dim_k \ker(\phi) = 0 \xLeftrightarrow{(3.4.135)} \operatorname{rank}_k(\phi) = \dim_k V \iff \dim_k V^\vee = \operatorname{rank}_k(\phi^\vee) \iff \phi^\vee$ is surjective.

The last point may be deduced from the first two, or the fact that $(-)^{\vee}$ is full and faithful (3.4.113) and category-theoretic result (2.6.39). $\square$

3.4.15.2 Bilinear Pairings

Definition 3.4.146 (Bilinear maps)

Let V, W be vector spaces a bilinear map ψ is a map

$$\psi : V \times W \rightarrow k$$

which is k -linear in each variable. We denote the set of bilinear maps as

$$\text{Bilin}_k(V, W)$$

Proposition 3.4.147 (Matrix Representation)

Let V, W be finite-dimensional vector spaces with bases $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ and $\{w_1, \dots, w_m\}$ then there is a canonical isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Bilin}_k(V, W) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Mat}_{n,m}(k) \\ \psi &\longrightarrow (\psi(v_i, w_j))_{ij} \end{aligned}$$

In particular a bilinear map ψ is determined uniquely by the values $\psi(v_i, w_j)$.

Proposition 3.4.148 (Dual maps)

Let V and W be vector spaces, then there is a natural bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \text{Mor}_k(V, W^\vee) & \longleftrightarrow & \text{Bilin}_k(V, W) & \longleftrightarrow & \text{Mor}_k(W, V^\vee) \\ \psi_L \longleftarrow & & \psi & & \\ & & \psi & \longrightarrow & \psi_R \end{array}$$

where

$$\psi_L(v)(w) = \psi(v, w) = \psi_R(w)(v)$$

When V, W are finite-dimensional then ψ_L is an isomorphism if and only if ψ_R is an isomorphism. In this case we say ψ is a perfect pairing. More generally

$$\text{rank}_k(\psi_L) = \text{rank}_k(\psi_R)$$

Proof. The bijections stated are obvious. One may show that $\psi_L = \psi_R^\vee \circ \eta_V$ where $\eta_V : V \rightarrow V^{\vee\vee}$ is the dual isomorphism. Therefore ψ_L is an isomorphism if and only if $\psi_R^\vee$ is an isomorphism, and by (3.4.145) if and only if ψ_R is an isomorphism. Since η_V is surjective we have $\text{rank}_k(\psi_L) = \text{rank}_k(\psi_R^\vee) = \text{rank}_k(\psi_R)$, by (3.4.144). $\square$

Proposition 3.4.149

Let $\psi : V \times V \rightarrow k$ be a bilinear map. Then the following are equivalent

- a) ψ is a perfect pairing
- b) ψ_L is an isomorphism
- c) ψ_R is an isomorphism
- d) ψ_L is injective
- e) ψ_R is injective
- f) ψ_L is surjective
- g) ψ_R is surjective.

Proof. We may use the fact $\dim_k V = \dim_k V^\vee$ and (3.4.136) to show b) $\iff$ d) $\iff$ f) and c) $\iff$ e) $\iff$ g). We've already shown that a) $\iff$ b) $\iff$ c). $\square$

Definition 3.4.150 (Orthogonal Complement)

Let $\psi : V \times W \rightarrow k$ be a perfect pairing of finite-dimensional vector spaces. Suppose $U \subset V$ is a subspace then define the **orthogonal complement**

$$U^\perp := \{w \in W \mid \psi(v, w) = 0 \quad \forall v \in U\}$$

Proposition 3.4.151

Let $\psi : V \times W \rightarrow k$ be a perfect pairing of finite-dimensional vector spaces and $U \subset V$ a subspace. Then

$$\dim_k U + \dim_k U^\perp = \dim_k V$$

Indeed ψ_R induces an isomorphism $U^\perp \rightarrow U^\circ$.

Proof. We claim that $\psi_R(U^\perp) = U^\circ$. For if $w \in U^\perp$ then $\psi_R(w)(v) = \psi(w, v) = 0$ for all $v \in U$, and so $\psi_R(w) \in U^\circ$. Conversely given $\theta \in U^\circ$, as ψ_R is surjective, there is $w \in W$ such that $\psi_R(w) = \theta$. By definition $w \in U^\perp$ as required.

As ψ_R is injective then $\dim_k U^\perp \stackrel{(3.4.130)}{=} \dim_k U^\circ \stackrel{(3.4.143)}{=} \dim_k V/U = \dim_k V - \dim_k U$. $\square$

Remark 3.4.152

In the case $V = W$, then it's not necessarily true that $U \cap U^\perp = \{0\}$, and so $U^\perp$ is not necessarily a complementary subspace.

The classic example is the perfect pairing on $\mathbb{R}^n$ induced by vDv^T for a real diagonal matrix D . Then it's true in general if and only if D is positive-definite.

Proposition 3.4.153 (Quotients are dual to subspaces)

Let $\psi : V \times W \rightarrow k$ be a perfect pairing of finite-dimensional vector spaces. Suppose $U \subset V$ is a subspace, then there is a canonical perfect pairing

$$\psi' : V/U \times U^\perp \rightarrow k$$

given by

$$\psi'(v + U, w) = \psi(v, w)$$

Proof. The given map is well defined, for suppose $v_1 + U = v_2 + U$ then $v_1 - v_2 \in U \implies \psi(v_1 - v_2, w) = 0 \quad \forall w \in U^\perp \implies \psi(v_1, w) = \psi(v_2, w)$ as required. It's clearly k -bilinear.

It's clear that ψ'_R is injective, because $\psi'_R(w) = 0_{V/U} \implies \psi_R(w) = 0_V \implies w = 0$.

By the previous Proposition $\dim_k U^\perp = \dim_k V/U$. Therefore by (3.4.136) ψ'_R is an isomorphism and ψ' is perfect. $\square$

3.5 Tensor Products

3.5.1 Commutative Tensor Product

We consider the “Tensor Product” of modules over a single commutative ring as an important special case, and as a guide to the general bimodule case.

In order to streamline the (typically tedious) verification of standard properties we make heavy use of the notion of **representable bifunctor** (2.6.60) however all the results may be proved in an essentially identical “low-tech” way.

First we define the so-called “Internal Hom Functor”

Definition 3.5.1 (Internal Hom)

Let A be a commutative ring and M, N be A -modules. The set of A -linear homomorphisms $M \rightarrow N$ is itself an A -module. Therefore we have an *enriched hom functor*

$$\mathrm{Hom} : A\text{-}\mathbf{Mod}^{op} \times A\text{-}\mathbf{Mod} \rightarrow A\text{-}\mathbf{Mod}$$

where

$$(a \cdot \psi)(m) := a \cdot \psi(m) = \psi(a \cdot m)$$

and in particular we have a bijection

$$\mathrm{Mor}(M, N) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{Nat}(\mathrm{Hom}(N, -), \mathrm{Hom}(M, -))$$

Definition 3.5.2 (Bilinear Map)

Let M, N, Z be A -modules. Then a map

$$\psi : M \times N \rightarrow Z$$

is **bilinear** if it satisfies

- **additive** $\psi(m + m', n) = \psi(m, n) + \psi(m', n)$ and $\psi(m, n + n') = \psi(m, n) + \psi(m, n')$
- **A -linear** $\psi(am, n) = \psi(m, an) = a\psi(m, n)$ for all $a \in A$

This yields a bifunctor which we denote by

$$\mathrm{Bilin}(-, -; -) : (A\text{-}\mathbf{Mod} \times A\text{-}\mathbf{Mod})^{op} \times A\text{-}\mathbf{Mod} \rightarrow A\text{-}\mathbf{Mod}$$

Remark 3.5.3 (A -linearity)

The A -module structure on the image of Hom and Bilin is only well-defined because A is commutative. For given $\psi : M \rightarrow N$ an A -linear map then for $(a \cdot \psi)$ to be A -linear we may verify this requires

$$a' a \psi(m) = (a \psi)(a' m) = a a' \psi(m)$$

which in general does not hold unless A is commutative.

Proposition 3.5.4 (Existence of Tensor Product)

The bifunctor $\mathrm{Bilin}(-, -; -)$ is *representable* by a functor

$$\otimes_A : A\text{-}\mathbf{Mod} \times A\text{-}\mathbf{Mod} \rightarrow A\text{-}\mathbf{Mod}$$

for which there exists an isomorphism natural in M, N, Z

$$\Phi : \mathrm{Hom}(M \otimes N, Z) \cong \mathrm{Bilin}(M, N; Z)$$

For every pair M, N there is a distinguished bilinear map

$$i : M \times N \rightarrow M \otimes N$$

through which every bilinear map $M \times N \rightarrow Z$ factors uniquely. We denote the **elementary tensor** by

$$m \otimes n := i(m, n)$$

Further for morphisms $f : M \rightarrow M'$ and $g : N \rightarrow N'$ there is a unique morphism

$$(f \otimes g) : M \otimes N \rightarrow M' \otimes N'$$

such that

$$(f \otimes g)(m \otimes n) = f(m) \otimes g(n)$$

Proof. In light of (2.6.61) it is sufficient to show that $\text{Bilin}(M, N; -)$ is representable for fixed M, N and the rest of the properties follow, observing that $i = \Phi(1_{M \otimes N})$.

For let F be the free abelian group on $M \times N$ and let $S \subset F$ be the subgroup generated by elements of the form

- $(m + m', n) - (m, n) - (m', n)$
- $(m, n' + n) - (m, n') - (m, n)$
- $(am, n) - a(m, n)$
- $(m, n) - (m, an)$

Observe there is a canonical map $M \times N \rightarrow F$. Suppose that Z is an abelian group and $\psi : M \times N \rightarrow Z$ is a bilinear map. Then we may extend by linearity to a group homomorphism $\psi : F \rightarrow Z$. By construction $S \subseteq \ker(\psi)$ whence there is a unique group homomorphism $\hat{\psi} : F/S \rightarrow Z$ such that $\hat{\psi} \circ i = \psi$ where $i : M \times N \rightarrow F/S$ is the canonical inclusion. This shows that $(F/S, i)$ is a universal element for $\text{Bilin}(-, -; -)$ as we required and we denote this by $M \otimes N$. The representation exists as a functor of sets by (2.6.57), and Φ is clearly an isomorphism of A -modules because

$$\Phi(f + g) = (f + g) \circ i = f \circ i + g \circ i = \Phi(f) + \Phi(g)$$

and

$$\Phi(\lambda f) = (\lambda f) \circ i = \lambda(f \circ i) = \lambda\Phi(f)$$

□

Lemma 3.5.5 (Currying Lemma)

Let M, N, Z be A -modules then there are natural isomorphisms

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \text{Bilin}(M, N, Z) & \cong & \text{Hom}(M, \text{Hom}(N, Z)) & \cong & \text{Hom}(N, \text{Hom}(M, Z)) & \cong & \text{Bilin}(N, M, Z) \\ \psi & & m \rightarrow (n \rightarrow \psi(m, n)) & & n \rightarrow (m \rightarrow \psi(m, n)) & & (n, m) \rightarrow \psi(m, n) \end{array}$$

This gives the following important result (which may be seen as an adjoint relationship)

Proposition 3.5.6 (Tensor-Hom Adjunction)

Let M, N, Z be A -modules then we have the following natural isomorphism of functors

$$\text{Hom}(M \otimes N, Z) \cong \text{Hom}(M, \text{Hom}(N, Z)) \tag{3.1}$$

$$\theta \rightarrow (m \rightarrow (n \rightarrow \theta(m \otimes n))) \tag{3.2}$$

We may also use the Currying Lemma (3.5.5) to demonstrate symmetry of the tensor product

Proposition 3.5.7 (Symmetry of Tensor Product)

There is a natural isomorphism

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M \otimes N & \cong & N \otimes M \\ m \otimes n & \rightarrow & n \otimes m \end{array}$$

Proof. We observe that there is a natural isomorphism of functors which the tensor products represent

$$\text{Bilin}(M, N; Z) \cong \text{Bilin}(N, M; Z)$$

so the result follows from (2.6.63). □

Proposition 3.5.8 (Associativity of Tensor Product)

There is a natural isomorphism of A -modules

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (M \otimes N) \otimes P & \cong & M \otimes (N \otimes P) \\ (m \otimes n) \otimes p & \rightarrow & m \otimes (n \otimes p) \end{array}$$

Proof. We may make repeated use of the Tensor-Hom adjunction to exhibit natural isomorphisms

$$\begin{aligned} \operatorname{Hom}((M \otimes N) \otimes P, Z) &\cong \operatorname{Hom}(M \otimes N, \operatorname{Hom}(P, Z)) \\ &\cong \operatorname{Hom}(M, \operatorname{Hom}(N, \operatorname{Hom}(P, Z))) \\ &\cong \operatorname{Hom}(M, \operatorname{Hom}(N \otimes P, Z)) \\ &\cong \operatorname{Hom}(M \otimes (N \otimes P), Z) \end{aligned}$$

The required isomorphism is then a consequence of (2.6.63). For explicit form set $Z = M \otimes (N \otimes P)$ and consider the identity map 1_Z . We see tracing back under these natural isomorphisms this corresponds to the given map. $\square$

3.5.2 Bimodule Tensor Product

To develop the tensor product in general it is convenient to work with bimodules. We make heavy use of the notion of bimodule hom-sets (3.4.79).

Definition 3.5.9 (Bilinear maps)

Consider the bimodules ${}_A M_B, {}_B N_C$. We say that a map

$$\psi : {}_A M_B \times {}_B N_C \rightarrow {}_A Z_C$$

is (A, C) -**bilinear** if it satisfies all of the following conditions

- **additive** $\psi(m + m', n + n') = \psi(m, n) + \psi(m', n) + \psi(m, n') + \psi(n, n')$
- **balanced** $\psi(mb, n) = \psi(m, bn)$
- **A-linear** $\psi(am, n) = a\psi(m, n)$
- **C-linear** $\psi(m, nc) = \psi(m, n)c$

Extending the notation from earlier we denote the set of additive, balanced and (A, C) -bilinear maps by $\operatorname{Bilin}(M, N; Z)$. This determines a functor

$$\operatorname{Bilin} : ({}_A \mathbf{Mod}_B \times {}_B \mathbf{Mod}_C)^{op} \times {}_A \mathbf{Mod}_C \rightarrow \mathbf{AbGrp}$$

where addition is defined pointwise. We may also consider the functor of only additive and balanced maps

$$\operatorname{Balan} : (\mathbf{Mod}_B \times {}_B \mathbf{Mod})^{op} \times \mathbf{AbGrp} \rightarrow \mathbf{AbGrp}$$

and the functor

$$\operatorname{RBilin} : ({}_B \mathbf{Mod}_C \times {}_C \mathbf{Mod}_D)^{op} \times {}_A \mathbf{Mod}_D \rightarrow {}_A \mathbf{Mod}_B$$

where we drop the B -linear requirement but also introduce an extra (A, B) -module structure on the maps, as follows

$$(a\psi b)(m, n) := a\psi(bm, n)$$

Proposition 3.5.10 (Existence of Bimodule Tensor Product)

Let A, B, C be arbitrary rings

- The bifunctor $\operatorname{Balan}(M, N; -)$ is represented by the **balanced tensor product**

$$\otimes_B : \mathbf{Mod}_B \times {}_B \mathbf{Mod} \rightarrow \mathbf{AbGrp}$$

with natural isomorphism for Z an Abelian group

$$\begin{aligned} \Phi : \operatorname{Hom}(M_B \otimes_B {}_B N, Z) &\cong \operatorname{Balan}(M_B, {}_B N; Z) \\ \theta &\rightarrow \theta \circ i \end{aligned}$$

where i is a universal balanced map

$$i : M \times N \rightarrow M_B \otimes_B {}_B N$$

The tensor product is generated by **elementary tensors** of the form $m \otimes n := i(m, n)$.

- The bifunctor $\text{Bilin}(M, N; -)$ is represented by the balanced tensor product $M \otimes_B N$ with an additional (A, C) -bimodule structure given by

$$a \cdot (m \otimes n) \cdot c := (a \cdot m) \otimes (n \cdot c)$$

This determines a bifunctor

$$\otimes_B : {}_A\mathbf{Mod}_B \times {}_B\mathbf{Mod}_C \rightarrow {}_A\mathbf{Mod}_C$$

and a natural isomorphism of Abelian groups

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}({}_A M_B \otimes_B {}_B N_C, Z) &\cong \text{Bilin}({}_A M_B, {}_B N_C; {}_A Z_C) \\ \theta &\rightarrow \theta \circ i \end{aligned}$$

In either case, if $f : M \rightarrow M'$ and $g : N \rightarrow N'$ are morphisms then there is a unique morphism

$$(f \otimes g) : (M \otimes N) \rightarrow (M' \otimes N')$$

such that

$$(f \otimes g)(m \otimes n) = f(m) \otimes g(n)$$

Furthermore for maps $f' : M' \rightarrow M''$ and $g' : N' \rightarrow N''$ the following property is satisfied

$$(f' \otimes g') \circ (f \otimes g) = (f' \circ f) \otimes (g' \circ g)$$

Proof. In light of (2.6.61) we only need to show that the functors are representable for fixed M, N , as the functoriality will follow immediately by abstract nonsense.

We first show that $\text{Balan}(-, -; -)$ is representable. For let F be the free abelian group on $M \times N$ and let $S \subset F$ be the subgroup generated by elements of the form

- $(m + m', n) - (m, n) - (m', n)$
- $(m, n' + n) - (m, n') - (m, n)$
- $(mb, n) - (m, bn)$

Observe there is a canonical map $M \times N \rightarrow F$. Suppose that Z is an abelian group and $\psi : M \times N \rightarrow Z$ is a balanced additive map. Then we may extend by linearity to a group homomorphism $\psi : F \rightarrow Z$. By construction $S \subseteq \ker(\psi)$ whence there is a unique group homomorphism $\hat{\psi} : F/S \rightarrow Z$ such that $\hat{\psi} \circ i = \psi$ where $i : M \times N \rightarrow F/S$ is the canonical inclusion. This shows that $(F/S, i)$ is a universal element for $\text{Balan}(-, -; -)$ and we denote this by $M_B \otimes_B N$. Then (2.6.57) exhibits Φ as a natural isomorphism of sets, which may readily be observed to be additive.

In order to define the (A, C) -bimodule structure in the second case let $\psi_a : M \rightarrow M$ denote multiplication by a and $\psi_c : N \rightarrow N$ multiplication by c . We note these are both B -module homomorphisms by definition so we may define the action by functoriality of the balanced tensor product case

$$\begin{aligned} a \cdot v &:= (\psi_a \otimes 1_N)(v) \quad \forall v \in M \otimes N \\ v \cdot c &:= (1_M \otimes \psi_c)(v) \quad \forall v \in M \otimes N \end{aligned}$$

These are B -linear by construction and we may demonstrate (A, C) -bimodule actions are associative and commute by using the functoriality of the tensor product

$$\begin{aligned} (\psi_{a'} \otimes 1_N) \circ (\psi_a \otimes 1_N) &= (\psi_{a'} \circ \psi_a) \otimes 1_N = (\psi_{a'a}) \otimes 1_N \\ (1_M \otimes \psi_c) \circ (1_M \otimes \psi_{c'}) &= 1_M \otimes (\psi_c \circ \psi_{c'}) = 1_M \otimes \psi_{cc'} \\ (\psi_a \otimes 1_N) \circ (1_M \otimes \psi_c) &= \psi_a \otimes \psi_c = (1_M \otimes \psi_c) \circ (\psi_a \otimes 1_N) \end{aligned}$$

Further by construction the canonical map i is (A, C) -bilinear. Consider any (A, C) -bilinear map $\psi : M \times N \rightarrow Z$ then by the previous part there is a unique group homomorphism $\hat{\psi} : M \otimes_B N \rightarrow Z$ such that

$$\hat{\psi}(m \otimes n) := \psi(m, n)$$

which we see by construction (and linearity) is (A, C) -bilinear. It is clearly the unique such map so that we may conclude $\text{Bilin}(-, -; -)$ has universal element $({}_A M_B \otimes_B {}_B N_C, i)$. The (2.6.57) exhibits Φ as a natural isomorphism of sets which may be readily exhibited to be additive. $\square$

Lemma 3.5.11 (Currying Lemma)

Let M, N, P, Y, Z be bimodules. Then there is an isomorphism of abelian groups and (A, B) -bimodules respectively

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Bilin}({}_A M_B, {}_B N_C; {}_A Y_C) &\cong \text{Hom}({}_A M_B, \text{RHom}({}_B N_C, {}_A Y_C)) \\ &\cong \text{Hom}({}_B N_C, \text{LHom}({}_A M_B, {}_A Y_C)) \\ \text{RBilin}({}_B N_C, {}_C P_D; {}_A Z_D) &\cong \text{RHom}({}_B N_C, \text{RHom}({}_C P_D, {}_A Z_D)) \end{aligned}$$

contravariant in M, N, P and covariant in Y and Z .

Proof. The maps on abelian groups are clear, namely given a bi-additive map ψ we have a well-defined homomorphism of abelian groups

$$m \rightarrow (n \rightarrow \psi(m, n))$$

The verification that the maps are well-defined and bijective is tedious but mechanical. $\square$

Proposition 3.5.12 (Tensor-Hom Adjunction)

Let M, N, P, Y, Z be bimodules then

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}({}_A M_B \otimes {}_B N_C, {}_A Y_C) &\cong \text{Hom}({}_A M_B, \text{RHom}({}_B N_C, {}_A Y_C)) \\ &\cong \text{Hom}({}_B N_C, \text{LHom}({}_A M_B, {}_A Y_C)) \\ \text{RHom}({}_B N_C \otimes {}_C P_D, {}_A Z_D) &\cong \text{RHom}({}_B N_C, \text{RHom}({}_C P_D, {}_A Z_D)) \end{aligned}$$

where the first is an isomorphism of Abelian Groups and the second of (A, B) -bimodules. Further the isomorphisms are contravariant in M, N, P and covariant in Y and Z .

Proof. This first two isomorphism follow directly from the Currying Lemma and universal property for bimodule tensor product.

The final isomorphism follows from the Currying Lemma if we show that there is an isomorphism

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{RHom}({}_B N_C \otimes {}_C P_D, {}_A Z_D) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{RBilin}({}_B N_C, {}_C P_D; {}_A Z_D) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \text{Hom}({}_B N_C \otimes {}_C P, {}_A Z) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{Bilin}({}_B N_C, {}_C P; {}_A Z) \end{array}$$

where the bottom is simply the universal property of the balanced tensor product and the top we require to also be (A, B) -bilinear. Recall the underlying sets are the same and the horizontal maps are given by $\theta \rightarrow \theta \circ i$ in both cases. It's clear that the map is well-defined and injective. Further it's surjective because if θ is (B, D) -bilinear on elementary tensors it is (B, D) -bilinear everywhere. Finally we need to show that the isomorphism is (A, B) -bilinear as follows

$$(a(\theta \circ i)b)(n, p) = a(\theta \circ i)(bn, p) = a\theta((bn) \otimes p) = a\theta(b(n \otimes p)) = (a\theta b)(n \otimes p)$$

$\square$

Proposition 3.5.13 (Associativity of Tensor Product)

Let ${}_A M_B, {}_B N_C, {}_C P_D$ be bimodules then there is a natural isomorphism of (A, D) -bimodules

$$\begin{aligned} (M \otimes_B N) \otimes_C P &\cong M \otimes_B (N \otimes_C P) \\ (m \otimes n) \otimes p &\rightarrow m \otimes (n \otimes p) \end{aligned}$$

Proof. This follows much as in the commutative case. Let Z be an (A, D) -bimodule. Then by the Tensor-Hom adjunction there are natural isomorphisms of Abelian groups

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}(({}_A M_B \otimes {}_B N_C) \otimes {}_C P_D, {}_A Z_D) &\cong \text{Hom}({}_A M_B \otimes {}_B N_C, \text{RHom}({}_C P_D, {}_A Z_D)) \\ &\cong \text{Hom}({}_A M_B, \text{RHom}({}_B N_C, \text{RHom}({}_C P_D, {}_A Z_D))) \\ &\cong \text{Hom}({}_A M_B, \text{RHom}({}_B N_C \otimes {}_C P_D, {}_A Z_D)) \\ &\cong \text{Hom}({}_A M_B \otimes_B ({}_B N_C \otimes_C {}_C P_D), {}_A Z_D) \end{aligned}$$

The required isomorphism is then a consequence of (2.6.63). For explicit form set $Z = M \otimes (N \otimes P)$ and consider the identity map 1_Z . We see tracing back under these natural isomorphisms this corresponds to the given map. $\square$

3.5.3 Extensions of Scalars

We observe that for a ring homomorphism $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ we have on B a natural (A, B) -bimodule and (B, A) -bimodule structure. Using the tensor product then we may use this to extend the coefficients from A to B . We first prove some elementary lemmas

Lemma 3.5.14 (Unit Hom)

Let $\phi : B \rightarrow C$ be a ring homomorphism and Z a (A, C) -bimodule. Then there is a natural isomorphism of (A, B) -bimodules

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{RHom}({}_B C_C, {}_A Z_C) &\cong {}_A Z_B \\ \theta &\rightarrow \theta(1) \\ z(-) &\leftarrow z \end{aligned}$$

and similarly let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring homomorphism and Y a (B, C) -bimodule then there is a natural isomorphism of (A, C) -bimodules

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{LHom}({}_B B_A, {}_B Y_C) &\cong {}_A Y_C \\ \theta &\rightarrow \theta(1) \end{aligned}$$

Proof. Observe

$$(a\theta b)(1) = a\theta(\phi(b)) = a\theta(1)\phi(b)$$

so the left to right map is an (A, B) -bimodule homomorphism. Further $\theta(c) = \theta(1)c$ so the maps are mutual inverses. $\square$

Lemma 3.5.15 (Unit Hom (Commutative Ring Case))

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a homomorphism of commutative rings and Z a B -module. Then there is a natural isomorphism of B -modules

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{Hom}(B, Z) &\cong Z \\ \theta &\rightarrow \theta(1) \end{aligned}$$

Proposition 3.5.16 (Extension of Scalars)

Let M be an (A, C) -bimodule and $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ a ring homomorphism. We may define a (B, C) -module

$$M_{(B)} := {}_B B_A \otimes_A M$$

For Z a (B, C) -bimodule there is a natural isomorphism of abelian groups

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{Hom}(M_{(B)}, Z) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{Hom}(M, {}_A Z_C) \\ \psi &\rightarrow m \rightarrow \psi(1 \otimes m) \\ b \otimes m \rightarrow b \cdot \phi(m) &\leftarrow \phi \end{aligned}$$

In otherwords we have an adjunction (2.6.48)

$${}_A \mathbf{Mod}_C \rightleftarrows {}_B \mathbf{Mod}_C$$

Setting $C = \mathbb{Z}$ yields an adjunction for left modules

$${}_A \mathbf{Mod} \rightleftarrows {}_B \mathbf{Mod}$$

In particular for M a left A -module we have an isomorphism of abelian groups

$$\mathrm{Hom}(M_{(B)}, B) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{Hom}_A(M, B)$$

which is B -linear when B is commutative.

Proof. By the tensor-hom adjunction (3.5.12) and (3.5.14) there is a natural isomorphism

$$\mathrm{Hom}(B \otimes_A M, Z) \cong \mathrm{Hom}(M, \mathrm{LHom}({}_B B_A, {}_B Z_C)) \cong \mathrm{Hom}(M, {}_A Z_C)$$

$\square$

Proposition 3.5.17

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a homomorphism of commutative rings and $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ a homomorphism of A -modules. Then there is a unique B -module homomorphism $\phi_{(B)} : M_{(B)} \rightarrow N_{(B)}$ such that

$$\phi_{(B)}(1 \otimes m) = 1 \otimes \phi(m)$$

Proof. The homomorphism $\phi_{(B)} = 1_B \otimes \psi$ exists by functoriality of the tensor product (3.5.4). It clearly satisfies the given property, and as the tensor product is generated by elementary tensors it is evidently unique. $\square$

Proposition 3.5.18 (Tensor Unit)

Let M be an (A, C) -bimodule then there is a natural isomorphism of (A, C) -bimodules

$$\begin{aligned} A \otimes_A M &\cong M \\ a \otimes m &\rightarrow a \cdot m \\ 1 \otimes m &\leftarrow m \end{aligned}$$

Similarly there is a natural isomorphism of (A, C) -bimodules

$$M \otimes_C C \cong M$$

Proof. By (3.5.16) with $\phi = 1_A$ there is a natural isomorphism

$$\text{Hom}(A \otimes_A M, -) \cong \text{Hom}(M, -)$$

and so natural isomorphism follows from (2.6.63).

We may deduce that there is a natural isomorphism of (C^{op}, A^{op}) -bimodules

$$C^{op} \otimes_{C^{op}} M^{op} \cong M^{op}$$

which amounts to a natural isomorphism of (A, C) -bimodules

$$M \otimes_C C \cong M$$

$\square$

Proposition 3.5.19 (Transitivity of Extension of Scalars)

Let M be a (A, D) -bimodule and $\phi : A \rightarrow B$, $\psi : B \rightarrow C$ homomorphisms of commutative rings. Then there is an isomorphism of (C, D) -bimodules

$$\begin{aligned} C \otimes_B (B \otimes_A M) &\xrightarrow{\sim} {}_C C_A \otimes_A M \\ c \otimes (b \otimes m) &\rightarrow (c\psi(b)) \otimes m \end{aligned}$$

Proof. By associativity (3.5.13) and (3.5.18) there is a natural isomorphism

$$C \otimes_B (B \otimes_A M) \cong (C \otimes_B B) \otimes_A M \cong C \otimes_A M$$

$\square$

Proposition 3.5.20 (Transitivity of Extension of Scalars (Commutative Case))

Let M be an A -module and $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ and $\psi : B \rightarrow C$ homomorphisms of commutative rings. Then there is an isomorphism of C -modules

$$C \otimes_B (B \otimes_A M) \cong {}_C C_A \otimes_A M$$

Proof. Regarding M as an (A, A) -bimodule we have an isomorphism of (C, A) -bimodules by (3.5.19) which is a-fortiori a C -module isomorphism. $\square$

3.5.4 Tensor Product Commutes with Direct Sum

Proposition 3.5.21 (Tensor Product Commutes with Sum)

Let $(M_i)_{i \in I}$ be a family of (A, B) -bimodules and $(N_j)_{j \in J}$ a family of (B, C) -bimodules. Then there is an isomorphism of (A, C) -bimodules

$$\left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i \right) \otimes_B \left(\bigoplus_{j \in J} N_j \right) \cong \bigoplus_{(i,j) \in I \times J} (M_i \otimes_B N_j)$$

Corollary 3.5.22

Suppose M is an (A, B) -bimodule and N is a (B, C) -bimodule and $M' \subseteq M$ and $N' \subseteq N$ are direct factors. Then the canonical map is injective

$$M' \otimes_B N' \hookrightarrow M \otimes_B N$$

Corollary 3.5.23

Let N be **free** left A -module with basis $(n_i)_{i \in I}$ and M a (B, A) -bimodule. Then there is an isomorphism of left B -modules

$$\begin{aligned} M \otimes_A N &\cong \bigoplus_{i \in I} M \\ m \otimes \sum_i a_i n_i &\longrightarrow (m \cdot a_i)_{i \in I} \\ \sum_i (m_i \otimes n_i) &\longleftarrow (m_i)_{i \in I} \end{aligned}$$

When A is commutative then this is a (B, A) -bimodule isomorphism. Further when M is an A -module then this is an isomorphism of A -modules.

Proof. By (3.5.21) and (3.5.18)

$$\begin{aligned} M \otimes_A N &\cong M \otimes_A \left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} A \right) \cong \bigoplus_{i \in I} (M \otimes_A A) \cong \bigoplus_{i \in I} M \\ m \otimes \sum_i a_i n_i &\rightarrow m \otimes (a_i)_{i \in I} \rightarrow (m \otimes a_i)_{i \in I} \rightarrow (m \cdot a_i)_{i \in I} \end{aligned}$$

□

Corollary 3.5.24

If M, N are free A -modules with bases $\{m_i\}_{i \in I}$ and $\{n_j\}_{j \in J}$ then $M \otimes_A N$ is a free A -module with basis $\{m_i \otimes n_j\}_{(i,j) \in I \times J}$.

Corollary 3.5.25 (Free modules are flat)

Let N be a free left A -module and $i : M' \rightarrow M$ an injective map of (B, A) -bimodules. Then the corresponding map

$$i \otimes 1_N : M' \otimes_A N \rightarrow M \otimes_A N$$

is injective.

Corollary 3.5.26 (Extension of Scalars (Free Module))

Let M be **free** left A -module with basis $\{m_i\}_{i \in I}$ and $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ a ring homomorphism. Then there is a canonical isomorphism of left B -modules

$$\begin{aligned} M_{(B)} &\cong \bigoplus_{i \in I} B \\ b \otimes \sum_i a_i m_i &\rightarrow (b\phi(a_i))_{i \in I} \end{aligned}$$

In particular $\{1 \otimes m_i\}_{i \in I}$ is a basis for $M_{(B)}$. Further when Z is a left B -module then there is an isomorphism of abelian groups

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}_A(M, Z) &\cong \text{Hom}_B(M_{(B)}, Z) \cong \prod_{i \in I} Z \\ \theta &\rightarrow (\theta(m_i))_{i \in I} \end{aligned}$$

which is B -linear when B is commutative.

When M is a finite free A -module of rank n (with basis $\{v_i\}$) then $M_{(B)}$ is a finite free B -module of rank n (with basis $\{1 \otimes v_i\}$). When B is commutative, $M_{(B)}^\vee$ is also a finite free B -module of rank n .

Proof. The first isomorphism follows directly from (3.5.23). Then by (3.4.83) there is an isomorphism

$$\text{Hom}(M_{(B)}, Z) \cong \text{Hom}\left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} B, Z\right) \cong \prod_{i \in I} \text{Hom}(B, Z) \cong \prod_{i \in I} Z$$

□

We may generalize (3.4.110)

Proposition 3.5.27 (Extension of Scalars (Hom-Set))

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a homomorphism of commutative rings, M a finite-free A -module and N a finite-free B -module. Then

$$\text{Hom}_A(M, N) \cong \text{Hom}_B(M_{(B)}, N)$$

is a finite-free B -module. More precisely suppose M has basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ and N has basis $\{w_1, \dots, w_m\}$ then $\text{Hom}_A(M, N)$ has basis

$$\{w_j v_i^\vee\}_{i,j}$$

Proof. By (3.5.26) there are isomorphisms of B -modules

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}_A(M, N) &\cong \text{Hom}_B(M_{(B)}, N) \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^n N \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \bigoplus_{j=1}^m B \\ \theta &\mapsto 1 \otimes \theta \mapsto (\theta(v_i))_i \mapsto (w_j^\vee(\theta(v_i)))_{i,j} \end{aligned}$$

Under this isomorphism the standard basis of the right hand side corresponds to the set $\{w_j v_i^\vee\}_{i,j}$ whence these constitute a basis. $\square$

3.5.5 Tensor Product Exact Sequences

Proposition 3.5.28 (Tensor Product is Right Exact)

Consider an exact sequence of A -modules (i.e. such that β is surjective and $\ker(\beta) = \text{im}(\alpha)$)

$$M \xrightarrow{\alpha} N \xrightarrow{\beta} P \rightarrow 0$$

Then the corresponding sequence of A -modules

$$M \otimes_A Z \xrightarrow{\alpha \otimes 1_Z} N \otimes_A Z \xrightarrow{\beta \otimes 1_Z} P \otimes_A Z \rightarrow 0$$

is exact. Similarly the sequence

$$Z \otimes_A M \xrightarrow{1_Z \otimes \alpha} Z \otimes_A N \xrightarrow{1_Z \otimes \beta} Z \otimes_A P \rightarrow 0$$

is exact.

Proof. Trivially the submodule $\text{im}(\beta \otimes 1_Z)$ contains elementary tensors and therefore equals $P \otimes_A Z$. In otherwords $\beta \otimes 1_Z$ is surjective. Furthermore by functoriality $(\beta \otimes 1_Z) \circ (\alpha \otimes 1_Z) = (\beta \circ \alpha) \otimes 1_Z$ which is zero on elementary tensors and therefore zero everywhere. In particular $\text{im}(\alpha \otimes 1_Z) \subseteq \ker(\beta \otimes 1_Z)$. Consider a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} P \times Z & \xrightarrow{\psi} & (N \otimes_A Z) / \text{im}(\alpha \otimes 1_Z) \\ & \searrow & \downarrow \overline{\beta \otimes 1_Z} \\ & & P \otimes_A Z \end{array}$$

where ψ is yet to be defined. For a given $p \in P$ and $z \in Z$ consider the subset

$$\mathcal{I}_{p,z} := \{n \otimes z \mid n \in N, \beta(n) = p\} \subset N \otimes_A Z$$

Observe that any ψ making the diagram commute satisfies $\psi(p, z) \in \overline{\mathcal{I}_{p,z}}$, and we aim to show this set is a singleton.

As β is surjective $\mathcal{I}_{p,z}$ is non-empty. First we show that $x, y \in \mathcal{I}_{p,z} \implies x - y \in \text{im}(\alpha \otimes 1_Z)$. For if $\beta(n) = \beta(n')$ then $\beta(n - n') = 0$ by definition $n - n' = \alpha(m)$ for some $m \in M$. It follows that $n \otimes z - n' \otimes z = \alpha(m) \otimes z = (\alpha \otimes 1_Z)(m \otimes z)$. This shows that $\overline{\mathcal{I}_{p,z}}$ is a singleton, whose element we define to be $\psi(p, z)$. Then ψ is the unique map such that

$$\psi(\beta(n), z) = \overline{n \otimes z}$$

for all $n \in N$ and $z \in Z$. Clearly ψ is A -bilinear and therefore there is a map $\sigma : P \otimes_A Z \rightarrow (N \otimes_A Z) / \text{im}(\alpha \otimes 1_Z)$ such that $\sigma(\beta(n) \otimes z) = \overline{n \otimes z}$. By linearity $\sigma \circ \overline{\beta \otimes 1_Z}$ is the identity which shows $\overline{\beta \otimes 1_Z}$ is injective. Therefore $\ker(\beta \otimes 1_Z) = \text{im}(\alpha \otimes 1_Z)$ as required (for $x \in \ker(\beta \otimes 1_Z) \implies (\beta \otimes 1_Z)(x) = 0 \implies (\overline{\beta \otimes 1_Z})(\bar{x}) = 0 \implies \bar{x} = 0 \implies x \in \text{im}(\alpha \otimes 1_Z)$). $\square$

Proposition 3.5.29 (Quotient of a Tensor Product)

Consider exact sequences

$$\begin{aligned} 0 \rightarrow M' &\xrightarrow{i} M \xrightarrow{\pi_1} M/M' \rightarrow 0 \\ 0 \rightarrow N' &\xrightarrow{j} N \xrightarrow{\pi_2} N/N' \rightarrow 0 \end{aligned}$$

Then there is an exact sequence

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (M' \otimes N) \oplus (M \otimes N') & \xrightarrow{\alpha} & M \otimes N \\ (m' \otimes n, m \otimes n') & \longrightarrow & i(m') \otimes n + m \otimes j(n') \end{array} \xrightarrow{\pi_1 \otimes \pi_2} M/M' \otimes N/N' \rightarrow 0$$

$$\overline{m} \otimes \overline{n} \rightarrow 0$$

In particular there is a canonical isomorphism

$$(M \otimes N)/(M' \otimes N + M \otimes N') \cong M/M' \otimes N/N'$$

Proof. Observe $\pi_1 \otimes \pi_2 = (\pi_1 \otimes 1_{N/N'}) \circ (1_M \otimes \pi_2)$ by comparison on elementary tensors. By (3.5.28) each of these maps is surjective, and so the composite is surjective. Evidently $(\pi_1 \otimes \pi_2) \circ (i \otimes 1_N) = 0$ and $(\pi_1 \otimes \pi_2) \circ (1_M \otimes j) = 0$ by checking elementary tensors. This in particular means that $(\pi_1 \otimes \pi_2) \circ \alpha = 0$ where α is the first map. Therefore $\text{im}(\alpha) \subseteq \ker(\pi_1 \otimes \pi_2)$ and it suffices to demonstrate the reverse inclusion. Suppose $z \in \ker(\pi_1 \otimes \pi_2)$. This means precisely that $(1_M \otimes \pi_2)(z) \in \ker(\pi_1 \otimes 1_{N/N'}) = \text{im}(i \otimes 1_{N/N'})$ by (3.5.28). Therefore $(1_M \otimes \pi_2)(z) = (i \otimes 1_{N/N'})(y)$ for $y \in M' \otimes N/N'$. By (3.5.28) again $y = (1_{M'} \otimes \pi_2)(x)$ for $x \in M' \otimes N$ and $(1_M \otimes \pi_2)(z) = (i \otimes \pi_2)(x)$. Therefore $(1_M \otimes \pi_2)(z - (i \otimes 1_N)(x)) = 0$ and $z - (i \otimes 1_N)(x) = (1_M \otimes j)(w)$ for some $w \in M \otimes N'$. Therefore we conclude $z \in \text{im}(\alpha)$ as required. $\square$

3.5.6 Vector Space Tensor Product

Recall that vector spaces are free, every linearly independent set may be extended to a basis and every subspace is a direct factor. This simplifies the structure of tensor product.

Proposition 3.5.30

Let V, W be k -vector spaces with subspaces V' and W' . Then the canonical k -module homomorphism

$$V' \otimes_k W' \rightarrow V \otimes_k W$$

is injective.

Proof. The homomorphism exists by (3.5.36). By (3.4.139) both V' and W' are direct factors. Therefore the map is injective by (3.5.22). $\square$

Proposition 3.5.31

Let V, W be k -modules. Suppose $\{v_i\}_{i \in I}$ and $\{w_j\}_{j \in J}$ are linearly independent (resp. bases) then $\{v_i \otimes w_j\}_{(i,j) \in I \times J}$ is a k -linearly independent subset (resp. a k -basis) of $V \otimes_k W$.

Proof. The case that they are bases is simply (3.5.24). For the general case we may use (3.4.126) to extend to bases, then a-fortiori the given set, being a subset of a basis, is linearly independent. $\square$

3.5.7 Algebra Tensor Product

Let A be a commutative ring and revert to the case of commutative tensor product described in Section 3.5.1. We show that given two A -algebras B, C the tensor product naturally forms an algebra. We first prove some preliminary results.

Lemma 3.5.32

Let B be a commutative A -algebra. Then there exists a unique homomorphism of A -modules

$$B \otimes_A B \rightarrow B$$

such that

$$b \otimes b' \rightarrow bb'$$

Proof. Multiplication is bilinear so the map exists by universal property. $\square$

Lemma 3.5.33

Let B, C be commutative A -algebras and define the A -module $X := B \otimes_A C$. Then there is a unique homomorphism of A -modules

$$m : X \otimes_A X \rightarrow X$$

such that

$$(b \otimes c) \otimes (b' \otimes c') \rightarrow (bb') \otimes (cc')$$

Define $1_X := (1 \otimes 1)$ then it satisfies

$$\text{a) } m(1_X \otimes x) = m(x \otimes 1_X) = x$$

- b) $m(x \otimes y) = m(y \otimes x)$
- c) $m(x \otimes m(y \otimes z)) = m(m(x \otimes y) \otimes z)$
- d) $m((x + y) \otimes z) = m(x \otimes z) + m(y \otimes z)$
- e) $m(x \otimes (y + z)) = m(x \otimes y) + m(x \otimes z)$

for $x, y, z \in X$.

Proof. By associativity and commutativity of the tensor product there is an A -module isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} X \otimes_A X &\cong (B \otimes_A B) \otimes_A (C \otimes_A C) \\ (b \otimes c) \otimes (b' \otimes c') &\rightarrow (b \otimes b') \otimes (c \otimes c') \end{aligned}$$

composing with $m_B \otimes m_C$ where $m_B : (B \otimes_A B) \rightarrow B$ and $m_C : (C \otimes_A C) \rightarrow C$ are the maps given in (3.5.32), yields the required map m .

The properties may be verified on tensors of the form $x_i = (b_i \otimes c_i)$ and $y_j = (b'_j \otimes c'_j)$. The results follow from linearity, since $(\sum_i x_i) \otimes (\sum_j y_j) = \sum_{i,j} (x_i \otimes y_j)$. $\square$

Proposition 3.5.34 (Algebra Tensor Product)

Let B, C be commutative A -algebras. Then the A -module $B \otimes_A C$ has a unique commutative ring structure with unit $1 \otimes 1$ and multiplication which satisfies

$$\begin{aligned} \cdot : (B \otimes_A C) \times (B \otimes_A C) &\rightarrow B \otimes_A C \\ (b \otimes c) \cdot (b' \otimes c') &:= (bb') \otimes (cc') \end{aligned}$$

and may be extended by linearity. Further there is an ring homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} i_A : A &\rightarrow B \otimes_A C \\ a &\rightarrow (a \otimes 1) = (1 \otimes a) \end{aligned}$$

making $B \otimes_A C$ into an A -algebra.

Proof. Let $X := B \otimes_A C$ and consider the map $m : X \otimes_A X \rightarrow X$ defined in (3.5.33). Define $x \cdot y := m(x \otimes y)$ then the properties of m ensure that this satisfies the properties of a ring. $\square$

Proposition 3.5.35 (Criteria to be an algebra homomorphism)

Let B, C, Z be commutative A -algebras and let $\phi : B \otimes_A C \rightarrow Z$ be an A -module homomorphism. Then the following are equivalent

- a) ϕ is an A -algebra homomorphism
- b) $\phi((b \otimes c) \cdot (b' \otimes c')) = \phi(b \otimes c) \cdot \phi(b' \otimes c')$

Similarly suppose $\psi : Z \rightarrow B \otimes_A C$ is an A -module homomorphism and Z is generated as an A -module by $S \subset Z$. Then the following equivalent

- a) ψ is an A -algebra homomorphism
- b) $\psi(ss') = \psi(s)\psi(s')$

Proof. In each case a) $\implies$ b) is obvious. For the converse we simply need to show that ϕ and ψ are in general multiplicative. This follows by linearity and because every element of the tensor product is a linear combination of elementary tensors. $\square$

Proposition 3.5.36 (Functoriality)

Let $\phi : B \rightarrow B'$ and $\psi : C \rightarrow C'$ be A -algebra homomorphisms. The A -module homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \phi \otimes \psi : B \otimes_A C &\rightarrow B' \otimes_A C' \\ b \otimes c &\rightarrow \phi(b) \otimes \psi(c) \end{aligned}$$

is an A -algebra homomorphism.

Proof. The A -module homomorphism exists by (3.5.4). It is in A -algebra homomorphism by (3.5.35). $\square$

Proposition 3.5.37 (Tensor Product is Coproduct)

Let B, C be commutative A -algebras then there are A -algebra homomorphisms

$$\begin{aligned} i_B : B &\rightarrow B \otimes_A C \\ b &\rightarrow b \otimes 1 \\ i_C : C &\rightarrow B \otimes_A C \\ c &\rightarrow 1 \otimes c \end{aligned}$$

which are natural in B and C respectively. In particular $B \otimes_A C$ is both a C -algebra and a B -algebra.

Furthermore for Z an A -algebra there is a bijection

$$\begin{aligned} \text{AlgHom}_A(B \otimes_A C, Z) &\cong \text{AlgHom}_A(B, Z) \times \text{AlgHom}_A(C, Z) \\ \psi &\rightarrow (\psi \circ i_B, \psi \circ i_C) \end{aligned}$$

which is natural in Z .

Proof. The existence of i_B and i_C is easily demonstrated using universal property of tensor product. Observe that in general

$$\begin{aligned} (\psi \circ i_B)(b) &= \psi(b \otimes 1_C) \\ (\psi \circ i_C)(c) &= \psi(1_B \otimes c) \end{aligned}$$

Furthermore the map is clearly well-defined. It's injective because if ψ and ψ' have the same image then $\psi(b \otimes 1) = \psi'(b \otimes 1)$ and $\psi(1 \otimes c) = \psi'(1 \otimes c)$ whence $\psi(b \otimes c) = \psi'(b \otimes c)$. By linearity they are everywhere equal.

To show that the map is a bijection we construct a two-sided inverse. For given A -algebra homomorphisms $f : B \rightarrow Z$ and $g : C \rightarrow Z$ then $(b, c) \rightarrow (f(b)g(c))$ is A -bilinear and so corresponds to an A -module homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \psi_{f,g} : B \otimes_A C &\rightarrow Z \\ b \otimes c &\rightarrow f(b)g(c) \end{aligned}$$

and by (3.5.35) this is an algebra homomorphism. Clearly $\psi \circ i_B = f$ and $\psi \circ i_C = g$. Conversely let $\psi : B \otimes_A C \rightarrow Z$ be an algebra homomorphism and we define $f(b) := \psi(b \otimes 1_C)$ and $g(c) := \psi(1_B \otimes c)$. Then $f(b)g(c) = \psi(b \otimes c)$ which shows that $\psi_{f,g}$ agrees with ψ on elementary tensors, and therefore is identically equal. This completes the demonstration that $\psi_{f,g}$ is a two-sided inverse to the given map.

Naturality in Z is straightforward. □

Proposition 3.5.38 (Extension of Scalars)

Let B, C be commutative A -algebras. Then define the C -algebra

$$B_{(C)} := C \otimes_A B$$

There is a natural isomorphism for any C -algebra Z

$$\begin{aligned} \text{AlgHom}_C(B_{(C)}, Z) &\cong \text{AlgHom}_A(B, Z) \\ \psi &\rightarrow \psi \circ i_B \end{aligned}$$

Proof. We consider the commutative diagram obtained from (3.5.37)

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{AlgHom}_A(B_{(C)}, Z) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{AlgHom}_A(B, Z) \times \text{AlgHom}_A(C, Z) \\ \cup & & \cup \\ \text{AlgHom}_C(B_{(C)}, Z) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{AlgHom}_A(B, Z) \times \{i_{CZ}\} \end{array}$$

An A -algebra homomorphism $\phi : B_{(C)} \rightarrow Z$ is a C -algebra homomorphism precisely when $\phi \circ i_C = i_{CZ}$ so that the bottom arrow is well-defined and bijective as required. □

Proposition 3.5.39 (Transitivity of Extension of Scalars)

Let B, C be commutative A -algebras and D a commutative C -algebra. Then there is an isomorphism of D -algebras

$$\begin{aligned} D \otimes_C (C \otimes_A B) &\cong D \otimes_A B \\ d \otimes (c \otimes b) &\rightarrow (dc) \otimes b \end{aligned}$$

Proof. Let Z be a D -algebra then there is a natural isomorphism of functors

$$\begin{aligned} \text{AlgHom}_D(D \otimes_C (C \otimes_A B), Z) &\cong \text{AlgHom}_C(C \otimes_A B, Z) \\ &\cong \text{AlgHom}_A(B, Z) \\ &\cong \text{AlgHom}_D(D \otimes_A B, Z) \end{aligned}$$

Consider the case $Z = D \otimes_A B$ and the identity map yields the required isomorphism (by the Yoneda Lemma). $\square$

Proposition 3.5.40

Let B be a commutative A -algebra then there is a natural isomorphism of A -algebras

$$\begin{aligned} u_B : B &\xrightarrow{\sim} B_{(A)} \\ b &\rightarrow 1 \otimes b \\ ab &\leftarrow a \otimes b \end{aligned}$$

Furthermore for C a commutative A -algebra there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} B & \xrightarrow{u_B} & A \otimes_A B \\ & \searrow u_B & \downarrow i_A \otimes 1_B \\ & & C \otimes_A B \end{array}$$

Proof. By (3.5.38) there is an bijection natural in Z

$$\begin{aligned} \text{AlgHom}_A(B_{(A)}, Z) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \text{AlgHom}_A(B, Z) \\ \psi &\rightarrow \psi(1 \otimes -) \end{aligned}$$

which by the Yoneda Lemma (2.6.53) yields the required isomorphism (given by the image of $1_{B_{(A)}}$). $\square$

Proposition 3.5.41 (Structural Morphisms are Injective)

Let B, C be commutative A -algebras such that the structural morphisms are injective and A is a direct factor of B and C (e.g. if $A = k$ is a field). Then the canonical maps (3.5.37)

$$\begin{aligned} B &\rightarrow B \otimes_A C \\ C &\rightarrow B \otimes_A C \end{aligned}$$

are injective.

Proof. By (3.5.22) the canonical map

$$B \otimes_A A \rightarrow B \otimes_A C$$

is injective. By (3.5.40) we have a canonical isomorphism $B \cong B \otimes_A A$ and the composite is simply the canonical map $B \rightarrow B \otimes_A C$. $\square$

Proposition 3.5.42 (Extension of Ideals under Tensor Product)

Let B, C be commutative A -algebras and $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft B$ and $\mathfrak{c} \triangleleft C$ ideals. Then $\mathfrak{b}^e$ (resp. $\mathfrak{c}^e$) is the image of the A -module $\mathfrak{b} \otimes_A C$ (resp. $B \otimes_A \mathfrak{c}$) in $B \otimes_A C$. Furthermore there is a canonical A -algebra isomorphism

$$(B \otimes_A C)/(\mathfrak{b}^e + \mathfrak{c}^e) \cong B/\mathfrak{b} \otimes_A C/\mathfrak{c}$$

Proof. Let $\phi : B \rightarrow B \otimes_A C$ be the structural morphism then for $b \in \mathfrak{b}$ we have $b \otimes c = (c \otimes 1)(b \otimes 1) = (1 \otimes c)\phi(b)$ whence $\phi(\mathfrak{b}) \subseteq \mathfrak{b} \otimes_A C \subseteq \mathfrak{b}^e$. Evidently $\mathfrak{b} \otimes_A C$ is an ideal and therefore we see $\mathfrak{b} \otimes_A C = \mathfrak{b}^e$ as required. The isomorphism follows from (3.5.29). $\square$

3.6 Multilinear Algebra

3.6.1 Multilinear Maps and Determinants

Remark 3.6.1

The purpose of this section is to define the determinant, rather than develop any further theory. The approach is a little non-standard as we take an abstract module-theoretic approach as in [Bou98b], but avoid use of the tensor algebra. The connection is there are natural isomorphisms (i.e. the tensor algebra represents the functor $L_a^n(M; -)$)

$$L_a^n(M; N) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}(\Lambda^n(M), N)$$

and

$$\Lambda^n(M)^\vee \xrightarrow{\sim} \Lambda^n(M^\vee)$$

when M is finite free. Therefore the exterior product we define really corresponds to the exterior product on (the tensor algebra of) $M^\vee$.

Definition 3.6.2 (Multilinear Map)

Let $M_1, \dots, M_n, N$ be A -modules then a map

$$\psi : M_1 \times \dots \times M_n \longrightarrow N$$

is **A -multilinear** if it is A -linear in each variable, whilst fixing the other variables at any value.

Definition 3.6.3 (Bilinear form)

Let M, N be A -modules then $\psi : M \times N \rightarrow A$ is a **bilinear form** if it is A -multilinear.

Denote the set of such bilinear pairings by $\text{Bilin}_A(M, N)$. It is naturally an A -module.

Proposition 3.6.4

Let M, N be A -modules then there is a natural bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \text{Hom}_A(M, \text{Hom}_A(N, A)) & \longleftrightarrow & \text{Bilin}_A(M, N) & \longleftrightarrow & \text{Hom}_A(N, \text{Hom}_A(M, A)) \\ \psi_L \longleftarrow & & \psi & & \longrightarrow \psi_R \\ & & \psi & & \end{array}$$

where

$$\psi_L(m)(n) = \psi(m, n) = \psi_R(n)(m)$$

Definition 3.6.5 (Alternating map)

An A -multilinear map $f : M^n \rightarrow N$ is **alternating** if

$$f(x_1, \dots, x_n) = 0$$

whenever $x_i = x_{i+1}$ for some $i = 1 \dots, n-1$.

Denote by $L_a^n(M, N)$ the set of such alternating maps, and $L_a^n(M) := L_a^n(M, A)$ the set of **alternating forms**. These are clearly A -modules.

Proposition 3.6.6 (Functorial Properties)

Let M be an A -module and $L_a^k(M)$ the set of k -alternating forms. Then it is a contravariant functor in M , that is if $g : M \rightarrow N$ then there is a well-defined map

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L_a^k(g) : L_a^k(N) & \rightarrow & L_a^k(M) \\ \psi & \rightarrow & \psi \circ g^{(k)} \end{array}$$

such that $L_a^k(g \circ h) = L_a^k(h) \circ L_a^k(g)$

Lemma 3.6.7

Let M be an A -module and $\psi \in L_a^{p-1}(M; A)$. Then

$$\psi'(x_1, \dots, x_p) := \sum_{j=1}^p (-1)^{j+1} \psi(x_1, \dots, \widehat{x_j}, \dots, x_p) x_j$$

is an element of $L^p(M; M)$.

Proof. It is clear that ψ' is multilinear, so we only need to show it is alternating. Suppose that $x_i = x_{i+1}$. then the only non-zero terms are where one of x_i and x_{i+1} are omitted, hence

$$\psi'(x_1, \dots, x_p) = (-1)^i \psi(x_1, \dots, \widehat{x_i}, \dots, x_p) x_i + (-1)^{i+1} \psi(x_1, \dots, \widehat{x_{i+1}}, \dots, x_p) x_{i+1} = 0$$

as required. □

Corollary 3.6.8 (Exterior Product of Alternating Forms)

Let M be an A -module, $\theta \in L_a^1(M)$, $\psi \in L_a^{n-1}(M)$ then the function

$$\begin{aligned} \theta \wedge \psi : M^p &\longrightarrow A \\ (x_1, \dots, x_n) &\longrightarrow \sum_{j=1}^n (-1)^{j+1} \psi(x_1, \dots, \widehat{x_j}, \dots, x_p) \theta(x_j) \end{aligned}$$

is an alternating form. We denote this by $\theta \wedge \psi$ and refer to it as either the **wedge product** or **exterior product**, and determines a bilinear map

$$\wedge : L_a^1(M) \times L_a^{n-1}(M) \rightarrow L_a^n(M)$$

Lemma 3.6.9

Let $f : M^n \rightarrow N$ be an alternating map then

$$f(x_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(n)}) = \epsilon(\sigma) f(x_1, \dots, x_n)$$

for any permutation $\sigma \in S_n$.

Furthermore if any of the x_i are equal then $f(x_1, \dots, x_n) = 0$

Proof. A permutation σ may be represented as a product of adjacent transpositions (...) therefore it's enough to demonstrate the case $\sigma = (i \ i+1)$. This follows directly from the definition because

$$0 = f(x+y, x+y) = f(x, x) + f(y, x) + f(x, y) + f(y, y) = f(x, y) + f(y, x)$$

Suppose $x_i = x_j$, then we may apply the first result to the transposition $\sigma = (i \ j)$ to see that $f(x_1, \dots, x_n) = 0$. $\square$

Lemma 3.6.10

Let $\psi : M^p \rightarrow N$ be a multilinear map. Suppose $v_1, \dots, v_n \in M$ and $w_1, \dots, w_p \in M$ such that

$$w_i = \sum_{j=1}^n a_{ij} v_j \quad \forall i = 1 \dots p \text{ and some } a_{ij} \in A$$

Then

$$\psi(w_1, \dots, w_p) = \sum_{\sigma} a_{1\sigma(1)} \dots a_{p\sigma(p)} \psi(v_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, v_{\sigma(p)})$$

where σ runs over all functions $[1, p] \rightarrow [1, n]$.

Lemma 3.6.11

Let $\psi : M^n \rightarrow N$ be an alternating map. Suppose $v_1, \dots, v_n \in M$ and $w_1, \dots, w_n \in M$ such that

$$w_i = \sum_{j=1}^n a_{ij} v_j \quad \forall i = 1 \dots n \text{ and some } a_{ij} \in A$$

then

$$\psi(w_1, \dots, w_n) = \sum_{\sigma \in S_n} \epsilon(\sigma) a_{1\sigma(1)} \dots a_{n\sigma(n)} \psi(v_1, \dots, v_n)$$

Proof. By (3.6.10)

$$\psi(w_1, \dots, w_n) = \sum_{\sigma} a_{1\sigma(1)} \dots a_{n\sigma(n)} \psi(v_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, v_{\sigma(n)})$$

where σ ranges over all maps from $\{1, \dots, n\}$ to itself. If σ is not a permutation, then it must not be injective and by (3.6.9) the corresponding term is zero. Therefore we may restrict to the case $\sigma \in S_n$. By the first part of (3.6.9) the result follows. $\square$

Proposition 3.6.12

Let M be a finite free A -module of rank n . Then the space of alternating forms $L_a^p(M; N) = 0$ for any integer $p > n$.

Proof. We may use (3.6.10) and observe that at least one basis element must occur at least twice in the expansion, and so is zero by (3.6.9). $\square$

Proposition 3.6.13 (Existence and Uniqueness of Determinant Corresponding to a Basis)

Let M be a finite free A -module with basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$. Then there is a unique alternating form $\Delta_v \in L_a^n(M)$ such that $\Delta_v(v_1, \dots, v_n) = 1$.

Furthermore $L_a^n(M)$ is a free module of rank 1 with basis Δ_v .

More precisely every $\Delta \in L_a^n(M)$ satisfies $\Delta = \Delta(v_1, \dots, v_n)\Delta_v$. Further every Δ also satisfies **Leibniz' formula**

$$\Delta(x_1, \dots, x_n) = \sum_{\sigma \in S_n} \epsilon(\sigma) v_{\sigma(1)}^\vee(x_1) \dots v_{\sigma(n)}^\vee(x_n) \Delta(v_1, \dots, v_n)$$

Proof. Let $\{v_1^\vee, \dots, v_n^\vee\}$ be the canonical dual basis of $M^\vee$. Then we may use the wedge product (3.6.8) to construct Δ_v inductively

$$\Delta_v := v_1^\vee \wedge \dots \wedge v_n^\vee$$

(using “right associativity” to ensure this expression is meaningful as the left operand must always be a linear functional). It is then clear that $\Delta_v(v_1, \dots, v_n) = 1$. We may apply (3.6.11) to obtain Leibniz' formula for both Δ_v and Δ , which shows that $\Delta = \Delta(v_1, \dots, v_n)\Delta_v$. $\square$

Corollary 3.6.14 (Existence and Uniqueness of Determinant)

For every $n \geq 1$ there is a unique $D_n \in L_a^n(A^n)$ such that $D_n(e_1, \dots, e_n) = 1$, given by the **Leibniz Formula**

$$D_n(v_1, \dots, v_n) = \sum_{\sigma \in S_n} \epsilon(\sigma) v_{1\sigma(1)} \dots v_{n\sigma(n)}.$$

Further $L_a^n(A^n)$ is a free A -module of rank 1 generated by D_n . Explicitly every $\Delta \in L_a^n(A^n)$ satisfies

$$\Delta = \Delta(e_1, \dots, e_n)D_n$$

Further D_n satisfies the **Laplace Expansion Formula** that is for all $i, j = 1 \dots n$ we have the relationship

$$D_n(v_1, \dots, v_n) = \sum_{j=1}^n (-1)^{i+j} v_{ji} D_{n-1}(\pi_i(v_1), \dots, \widehat{\pi_i(v_j)}, \dots, \pi_i(v_n))$$

where $\pi_i : A^n \rightarrow A^{n-1}$ drops the i -th element.

Proof. The first two statements follow from (3.6.13) in the case $M = A^n$.

The function $(-1)^{i+1} D_{n-1}(\pi_i(v_1), \dots, \pi_i(v_{n-1}))$ is evidently multilinear and alternating, that is an element of $L^{n-1}(A^n)$. Forming the wedge product with $e_i^\vee$ we obtain an element Δ of $L^n(A^n)$, which has the form given by the Laplace Expansion. Furthermore

$$\Delta(e_1, \dots, e_n) = (-1)^{i+1} e_i^\vee(e_i) (-1)^{i+1} D_{n-1}(\pi_i(e_n), \dots, \widehat{\pi_i(e_i)}, \dots, \pi_i(e_n)) = 1,$$

whence by (3.6.13) $\Delta = D_n$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.6.15 (Rank is Unique)

Let M be a finite free A -module. Then the rank is unique.

Proof. This follows from (3.6.12) and (3.6.13). Explicitly if M has bases of order p and q with $p < q$, then we deduce $L_a^q(M)$ is both zero and non-zero a contradiction. $\square$

Definition 3.6.16 (Determinant of a Module)

Let M be a finite free A -module of rank n , then we say a generator for $L_a^n(M)$ is a **determinant** and Δ_v is the **determinant** corresponding to the basis $v_1, \dots, v_n$.

The determinant for A^n corresponding to the standard basis $e_1, \dots, e_n$ is called the **standard determinant** for A^n , and denoted by D_n .

Corollary 3.6.17 (Determinant of an endomorphism)

Let M be a finite free A -module of rank n and $f \in \text{End}_A(M)$ an endomorphism. Then the corresponding linear map

$$L_a^n(f) : L_a^n(M) \rightarrow L_a^n(M)$$

satisfies

$$L_a^n(f)(\psi) = \det(f)\psi$$

for a unique $\det(f) \in A$, which we call the **determinant** of f . We have the following properties

$$\begin{aligned}\det(f \circ g) &= \det(f) \det(g) \\ \det(1_M) &= 1_A \\ \det(f) &= \Delta_v(f(v_1), \dots, f(v_n))\end{aligned}$$

for Δ_v any generator for $L_a^n(M)$ corresponding to a basis $v_1, \dots, v_n$.

Proof. Let Δ be a generator then $L_a^n(f)(\Delta) = \Delta_v(f(v_1), \dots, f(v_n))\Delta$ by (3.6.13). Clearly $\det(f) := \Delta_v(f(v_1), \dots, f(v_n))$ then satisfies the equation for all such $\psi = a\Delta$. It's unique because $L_a^n(M)$ is a free module, and the properties follow from uniqueness. $\square$

We may use this to define the determinant of a matrix

Definition 3.6.18 (Determinant of a Matrix)

Let $E \in \text{Mat}_{n \times n}(A)$ then we define the **determinant** of E to be simply $\det(\widehat{E})$.

Proposition 3.6.19 (Expressions for Matrix Determinant)

Let $E \in \text{Mat}_{n \times n}(A)$ and denote by $v_1, \dots, v_n$ the column vectors of E . Then

$$\det(E) = D_n(v_1, \dots, v_n)$$

where D_n is the standard determinant. Further there is the Leibniz Formula

$$\det(E) = \sum_{\sigma \in S_n} \epsilon(\sigma) \prod_{i=1}^n E_{i\sigma(i)}$$

and Laplace Expansion Formula

$$\det(E) = \sum_{j=1}^n (-1)^{i+j} E_{ij} \det(E_{(ij)})$$

where $E_{(ij)}$ is the $(n-1) \times (n-1)$ matrix with the i -th row and j -th column dropped.

Proof. Let $e_1, \dots, e_n$ be the standard basis of A^n then by definition we have $\widehat{E}(e_i) = v_i$. Recall by (3.6.14) that D_n is a generator of $L_a^n(M)$ and so by (3.6.17) we have $\det(\widehat{E}) = D_n(v_1, \dots, v_n)$.

The Leibniz Formula and Laplace Expansion Formula also follows directly from (3.6.14). $\square$

Corollary 3.6.20 (Properties of Matrix Determinant)

The determinant satisfies a number of properties

- a) $\det(EF) = \det(E) \det(F) = \det(F) \det(E)$
- b) $\det(I_n) = 1$
- c) $\det(PEP^{-1}) = \det(E)$
- d) $\det(E^t) = \det(E)$

Proof. a) – c) follow from (3.4.115) and (3.6.17). Explicitly

$$\det(EF) = D(\widehat{EF}) = D(\widehat{E} \circ \widehat{F}) = D(\widehat{E})D(\widehat{F}) = \det(E) \det(F)$$

and

$$\det(I_n) = D(\widehat{I_n}) = D(\mathbf{1}_{A^n}) = 1_A$$

d) can be shown by using Leibniz formula and observing that $\sigma \rightarrow \sigma^{-1}$ simply permutes the elements of S_n . $\square$

Proposition 3.6.21

Let M be a finite free A -module and $f \in \text{End}_A(M)$. Let $(e_1, \dots, e_n)$ be a basis and Δ_e the corresponding determinant. Define

$$f^{\text{ad}}(x) := \sum_{j=1}^n \Delta_e(f(e_1), \dots, f(e_{j-1}), x, f(e_{j+1}), \dots, f(e_n)) e_j.$$

Then

$$f \circ f^{\text{ad}} = f^{\text{ad}} \circ f = \det(f) \mathbf{1}_M$$

Furthermore the matrix of f^{ad} with respect to the given basis satisfies

$$[f^{\text{ad}}]_{ij} = (-1)^{i+j} \det([f]_{(ji)})$$

where $M_{(ji)}$ denotes the matrix M with the j -th row and i -th column removed.

Proof. We may consider by (3.6.7) the alternating map $\psi \in L_a^{n+1}(M; M)$ given by

$$\psi(x_1, \dots, x_{n+1}) := \sum_{j=1}^{n+1} (-1)^{j+1} \Delta_e(x_1, \dots, \widehat{x_j}, \dots, x_{n+1}) x_j$$

By (3.6.12) necessarily ψ is identically zero. Evaluating at $(x, f(e_1), \dots, f(e_n))$ we find that

$$0 = \det(f)x + \sum_{j=1}^n (-1)^j \Delta_e(x, f(e_1), \dots, \widehat{f(e_j)}, \dots, f(e_n)) f(e_j)$$

whence

$$\begin{aligned} \det(f)x &= \sum_{j=1}^n (-1)^{j+1} \Delta_e(x, f(e_1), \dots, \widehat{f(e_j)}, \dots, f(e_n)) f(e_j) \\ &= \sum_{j=1}^n \Delta_e(f(e_1), \dots, x, \dots, f(e_n)) f(e_j) \end{aligned}$$

where we have used (3.6.9).

Therefore using the definition of $f^{\text{ad}}(x)$ we find that $f(f^{\text{ad}}(x)) = \det(f)x$ as required. For the second relation, first observe that (3.4.109)

$$x = \sum_{k=1}^n e_k^\vee(x) e_k$$

and so applying $f(-)$

$$f(x) = \sum_{k=1}^n e_k^\vee(x) f(e_k)$$

Therefore we may calculate directly

$$\begin{aligned} f^{\text{ad}}(f(x)) &= \sum_{j=1}^n \Delta_e(f(e_1), \dots, f(e_{j-1}), f(x), f(e_{j+1}), \dots, f(e_n)) e_j \\ &= \sum_{j=1}^n \Delta_e(f(e_1), \dots, f(e_n)) e_j^\vee(x) e_j \\ &= \det(f) \sum_{j=1}^n e_j^\vee(x) e_j \\ &= \det(f)x \end{aligned}$$

as required.

For the final statement we may assume that $M = A^n$ with $(e_1, \dots, e_n)$ the standard basis and $D_n = \Delta_e$. Then by (...), (3.6.14), (3.6.18) we have

$$\begin{aligned} [f^{\text{ad}}]_{ij} &= D_n(f(e_1), \dots, f(e_{i-1}), e_j, f(e_{i+1}), \dots, f(e_n)) \\ &= (-1)^{i+j} D_{n-1}(\pi_j(f(e_1)), \dots, \widehat{\pi_j(f(e_i))}, \dots, \pi_j(f(e_n))) \\ &= (-1)^{i+j} \det([f]_{(ji)}) \end{aligned}$$

□

Corollary 3.6.22

Let M be a finite free A -module. Then $f \in \text{End}_A(M)$ is an isomorphism if and only if $D(f) \in A^\star$.

Corollary 3.6.23

Let $E \in \text{Mat}_{n \times n}(A)$ and define the adjugate matrix

$$E_{ij}^{\text{ad}} := (-1)^{i+j} \det(E_{(ji)})$$

Then

$$E^{\text{ad}} E = E E^{\text{ad}} = \det(E) I_n$$

Proof. By definition and (3.6.21) we have that $\widehat{E^{\text{ad}}} = \widehat{E}^{\text{ad}}$. The identities of endomorphisms are proven in (3.6.21), and we deduce the corresponding identities of matrices by (3.4.117). □

3.6.2 Trace Map

Proposition 3.6.24 (Existence and Uniqueness of the Trace Map)

Let M be an A -module, then there exists a well-defined A -bilinear map

$$\begin{aligned} M \otimes_A M^\vee &\longrightarrow \text{End}_A(M) \\ m \otimes \theta &\longrightarrow \theta(-) \cdot m. \end{aligned}$$

When M is a finite free A -module this is bijective, and there exists a unique A -linear map $\text{Tr} : \text{End}_A(M) \rightarrow A$ making the following diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M \otimes_A M^\vee & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{End}_A(M) \\ & \searrow & \downarrow \text{Tr} \\ & & A \end{array}$$

where the diagonal map is simply evaluation

$$m \otimes \theta \rightarrow \theta(m)$$

Equivalently it is the unique A -linear map satisfying

$$\text{Tr}(\theta(-) \cdot m) = \theta(m)$$

for all $m \in M$ and $\theta \in M^\vee$.

Finally we have the identity

$$\text{Tr}(\phi) = \text{Tr}([\phi]) = \sum_{i=1}^n [\phi]_{ii}$$

for all bases $\mathcal{B}$ of M .

Proof. There exists an obvious A -bilinear map $M \times M^\vee \rightarrow \text{End}_A(M)$ so the map exists by the universal property. If M is finite free then it has a basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$. By (3.4.109) $M^\vee$ has basis $\{v_1^\vee, \dots, v_n^\vee\}$ and by (...) $M \otimes_A M^\vee$ has basis $\{v_i \otimes v_j^\vee\}$. By (3.4.110) this maps to a basis of $\text{End}_A(M)$ and so it is an isomorphism.

Similarly the map $M \times M^\vee \rightarrow A$ is A -bilinear, and so the evaluation map $M \otimes_A M^\vee \rightarrow A$ exists. In light of the isomorphism then Tr exists and satisfies the required uniqueness property. $\square$

Proposition 3.6.25 (Trace is Symmetric)

Let $\phi, \psi : M \rightarrow M$ be endomorphisms of a finite free A -module. Then

$$\text{Tr}(\phi \circ \psi) = \text{Tr}(\psi \circ \phi)$$

Proof. We may verify that the mapping

$$\begin{aligned} \text{End}_A(M) \times \text{End}_A(M) &\rightarrow A \\ (\phi, \psi) &\rightarrow \text{Tr}(\phi \circ \psi) \end{aligned}$$

is A -bilinear. Therefore it is sufficient to show the relationship holds for rank-one endomorphisms $\phi = \theta(-) \cdot m$ and $\psi = \iota(-) \cdot n$, as these generate $\text{End}_A(M)$. Then we have

$$\text{Tr}(\phi \circ \psi) = \text{Tr}(\theta(\iota(-) \cdot n) \cdot m) = \text{Tr}((\iota(-)\theta(n)) \cdot m) = \iota(m)\theta(n)$$

and by symmetry the result follows. $\square$

Recall from (...) that every endomorphism $\phi : M \rightarrow M$ determines a family of endomorphisms $L_a^r(\phi) : L_a^r(M) \rightarrow L_a^r(M)$ for all integers $1 \leq r \leq n$, where n is the rank of M .

Proposition 3.6.26 (Determinant as a Trace)

Let M be a finite-free A module of rank n and $\phi : M \rightarrow M$ an endomorphism. Then

$$\det(\phi) = \text{Tr}(L_a^n(\phi))$$

and

$$\text{Tr}(\phi) = \text{Tr}(L_a^1(\phi))$$

Definition 3.6.27

Let K be a subset of $[1, n]$ of order k . Then we denote by $\sigma_K : [1, k] \rightarrow K$ the unique order preserving bijection.

Denote by $\mathfrak{F}_k(n)$ the family of subsets of $[1, n]$ of order k .

If X is an $m \times n$ matrix and $K \subset [1, m]$, $H \subset [1, n]$, then we denote by $X_{H,K}$ the $\#K \times \#H$ matrix given by

$$(X_{H,K})_{ij} = X_{\sigma_K(i), \sigma_H(j)}$$

Lemma 3.6.28

Let M be an A -module with subset $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ and $\psi : M^k \rightarrow N$ be an alternating map. Suppose that $x_1, \dots, x_k$ satisfy

$$x_i = \sum_{j=1}^n A_{ji} v_j.$$

for some $n \times k$ matrix A . Then

$$\psi(x_1, \dots, x_k) = \sum_{K \subset \mathfrak{F}_k(n)} \det(A_{K, [1, k]}) \psi(v_K)$$

where $v_K := (v_{\sigma_K(1)}, \dots, v_{\sigma_K(k)})$.

Proof.

$$\begin{aligned} \psi(x_1, \dots, x_k) &= \sum_{i_1, \dots, i_k} a_{i_1 1} \dots a_{i_k k} \psi(v_{i_1}, \dots, v_{i_k}) \\ &= \sum_{K \subset \mathfrak{F}_k(n)} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} a_{\sigma_K(\sigma(1))1} \dots a_{\sigma_K(\sigma(k))k} \psi(v_{\sigma_K(\sigma(1))}, \dots, v_{\sigma_K(\sigma(k))}) \\ &= \sum_{K \subset \mathfrak{F}_k(n)} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} \epsilon(\sigma) a_{\sigma_K(\sigma(1))1} \dots a_{\sigma_K(\sigma(k))k} \psi(v_{\sigma_K(1)}, \dots, v_{\sigma_K(k)}) \\ &= \sum_{K \subset \mathfrak{F}_k(n)} \det(A_{K, [1, k]}) \psi(v_K) \end{aligned}$$

□

Proposition 3.6.29

Let M be a finite free A -module with $v_1, \dots, v_n$ a basis. For every subset $K \subset [1, n]$ of order k denote

$$v_K^\vee := v_{\sigma_K(1)} \wedge \dots \wedge v_{\sigma_K(k)}.$$

Then $L_a^k(M)$ has basis $\{v_K^\vee\}_{K \in \mathfrak{F}_k(n)}$. Furthermore we have the identity

$$v_K^\vee(v_{K'}) = \delta_{KK'}$$

and each basis element is uniquely determined by this relationship.

Proposition 3.6.30

Let M be a finite free A -module with basis $\mathcal{B} = \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$. Let $\phi : M \rightarrow M$ be an A -module endomorphism. Then for all $K \in \mathfrak{F}_k(n)$

$$L_a^k(\phi)(v_K^\vee) = \sum_{H \in \mathfrak{F}_k(n)} \det(X_{K,H}) v_H^\vee$$

where $X = [\phi]_{\mathcal{B}}$.

In particular we see that

$$\text{Tr}(L_a^k(\phi)) = \sum_{K \in \mathfrak{F}_k(n)} \det(X_{K,K})$$

Proof. We have for $H \in \mathfrak{F}_k(n)$

$$\begin{aligned} L_a^k(\phi)(v_K^\vee)(v_H) &= v_K^\vee(\phi(v_{\sigma_H(1)}), \dots, \phi(v_{\sigma_H(k)})) \\ &= \sum_{L \subset \mathfrak{F}_k(n)} \det(X_{L,H}) v_K^\vee(v_L) \\ &= \det(X_{K,H}) \end{aligned}$$

By (3.6.29) then both sides agree on v_H for all $H \in \mathfrak{F}_k(n)$, which shows they are equal by (3.6.28). □

Proposition 3.6.31

Let M be a finite-free A module of rank n and $\phi : M \rightarrow M$ an endomorphism. For $a, b \in A$ we have

$$\det(a1_M + b\phi) = \sum_{k=0}^n \operatorname{Tr}(L_a^k(\phi)) a^{n-k} b^k$$

Proof. To calculate the left hand side consider a basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ for M and the corresponding determinant Δ_v . Then

$$\det(a1_M + b\phi) = \Delta_v(av_1 + b\phi(v_1), \dots, av_n + b\phi(v_n))$$

Expand to find that this equals

$$\sum_{k=0}^n a^{n-k} b^k \sum_{K \in \mathfrak{F}_k(n)} \Delta_v(x_{1K}, \dots, x_{nK})$$

where $x_{iK} = \phi(v_i)$ if $i \in K$ and v_i otherwise.

Define τ_K to be the unique shuffle permutation of type $(k, n-k)$ (3.3.37) such that $\tau_K|_{[1,k]} = \sigma_K$. Denote the inner term of the sum by z_K . Then we have by (3.6.9)

$$z_K = \epsilon(\tau_K) \Delta_v(\phi(v_{\sigma_K(1)}), \dots, \phi(v_{\sigma_K(k)}), v_{\sigma_H(1)}, \dots, v_{\sigma_H(n-k)})$$

where H is the complement of K in $[1, n]$. Then by considering Δ_v to be an alternating form in the first k arguments, we may apply (3.6.28) to find

$$z_K = \epsilon(\tau_K) \sum_{L \subset \mathfrak{F}_k(n)} \det(X_{L,K}) \Delta_v(v_{\sigma_L(1)}, \dots, v_{\sigma_L(k)}, v_{\sigma_H(1)}, \dots, v_{\sigma_H(n-k)})$$

The summand is non-zero if and only if $L \cap H = \emptyset$, which occurs if and only if $L = K$. Therefore we conclude that

$$\begin{aligned} z_K &= \epsilon(\tau_K) \det(X_{K,K}) \Delta_v(v_{\tau_K(1)}, \dots, v_{\tau_K(n)}) \\ &= \det(X_{K,K}) \Delta_v(v_1, \dots, v_n) \\ &= \det(X_{K,K}) \end{aligned}$$

The result then follows easily from (3.6.30). □

3.6.3 Block Matrices

Proposition 3.6.32

Let $A = \mathbb{Z}[X_{11}, \dots, X_{nn}]$ be a polynomial ring in n^2 indeterminates. Consider the matrix $(X_{ij}) \in \operatorname{Mat}_{n \times n}(A)$ and let D_n denote the determinant of this matrix.

Then for any commutative ring B and matrix $M \in \operatorname{Mat}_{n \times n}(B)$ we have

$$\det(B) = D_n(B_{11}, \dots, B_{1n}, B_{21}, \dots, B_{nn})$$

where the right hand side corresponds the obvious evaluation homomorphism $A \rightarrow B$.

Proposition 3.6.33 (Block Matrix Determinant)

Suppose M_{ij} ($1 \leq i \leq n, 1 \leq j \leq n$) are $m \times m$ matrices with coefficients in a ring A and which commute pairwise. Form the matrix M with coefficients in A as follows

$$M = \begin{pmatrix} M_{11} & \cdots & M_{1n} \\ \vdots & & \vdots \\ M_{n1} & \cdots & M_{nn} \end{pmatrix}$$

Then

$$\det(M) = \det(D_n(M_{11}, \dots, M_{1n}, M_{21}, \dots, M_{nn}))$$

Proof. We observe without proof that there is a “block” correspondence

$$\operatorname{Mat}_{n \times n}(\operatorname{Mat}_{m \times m}(A)) \longleftrightarrow \operatorname{Mat}_{(nm) \times (nm)}(A)$$

which commutes with matrix multiplication.

Let B denote the commutative subring of $\text{Mat}_{m \times m}(A)$ generated by the matrices M_{ij} . Then we may regard M as an element of $\text{Mat}_{n \times n}(B)$, and denote this by $\widetilde{M}$ to disambiguate. As B is commutative we may consider the adjugate matrix $\widetilde{M}^{\text{ad}}$. Further consider the matrix M' given in block form by

$$M' = \begin{pmatrix} (\widetilde{M}^{\text{ad}})_{11} & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ (\widetilde{M}^{\text{ad}})_{21} & I_m & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ (\widetilde{M}^{\text{ad}})_{n1} & 0 & \cdots & I_m \end{pmatrix}$$

Recall by (3.6.23) and (3.6.32) that

$$\widetilde{M}_{11}^{\text{ad}} = D_{n-1}(M_{22}, \dots, M_{2n}, M_{31}, \dots, M_{nn})$$

and

$$\widetilde{M}\widetilde{M}^{\text{ad}} = \begin{pmatrix} \det(\widetilde{M}) & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & \cdots & \det(\widetilde{M}) \end{pmatrix}$$

as elements of $\text{Mat}_{n \times n}(B)$. Therefore computing the matrix product block-wise we find

$$MM' = \begin{pmatrix} \det(\widetilde{M}) & M_{12} & \cdots & M_{1n} \\ 0 & M_{22} & \cdots & M_{2n} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & M_{n2} & \cdots & M_{nn} \end{pmatrix}$$

Then we may show using the Leibniz Expansion that

$$\det(M) \cdot \det(M') = \det(MM') = \det(\det(\widetilde{M})) \cdot \det(M_{[n+1, mn, n+1, mn]})$$

By induction on n we may then assume $\det(M_{[n+1, mn, n+1, mn]}) = \det(D_{n-1}(M_{22}, \dots, M_{2n}, \dots, M_{nn})) = \det((\widetilde{M}^{\text{ad}})_{11})$. Similarly we may argue by the Leibniz expansion that $\det(M') = \det((\widetilde{M}^{\text{ad}})_{11})$. When this is not a zero-divisor in A then we conclude that

$$\det(M) = \det(\det(\widetilde{M})) = \det(D_n(M_{11}, \dots, M_{1n}, \dots, M_{nn}))$$

as required.

In order to handle the case where $\det((\widetilde{M}^{\text{ad}})_{11})$ is a zero divisor we may replace the ring A with the polynomial ring $A[Z]$ and consider the matrix N for which

$$\widetilde{N} = \widetilde{M} + (Z \cdot I_m) \cdot I_n.$$

Then the submatrices of N still commute pairwise. Further $\det((\widetilde{N}^{\text{ad}})_{11})$ is a polynomial of non-zero degree in Z whose leading coefficient is 1, and therefore is not a zero-divisor. We conclude from the previous case that

$$\det(N) = \det(D_n(N_{11}, \dots, N_{1n}, \dots, N_{nn}))$$

Finally we may apply the ring homomorphism $A[Z] \rightarrow A$ (evaluation at 0) to deduce the general case. $\square$

3.6.4 Exterior Product

Proposition 3.6.34

Let M be an A -module. There is a bilinear map

$$\wedge : L_a^p(M) \times L_a^q(M) \rightarrow L_a^{p+q}(M)$$

given by

$$(f \wedge g)(x_1, \dots, x_{p+q}) := \sum_{\sigma \in \text{Sh}(p, q)} \epsilon(\sigma) f(x_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p)}) g(x_{\sigma(p+1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p+q)})$$

where the sum is taken over shuffle permutations (3.3.37).

Proof. Suppose that $x_i = x_j$ then we require to prove that $(f \wedge g)(x_1, \dots, x_{p+q}) = 0$ in order to demonstrate that it is alternating. If $1 \leq i, j \leq p$ then this follows from (3.6.9). Similarly if $p < i, j \leq p+q$. So we may consider the case $i \leq p < j$. Consider the family of right cosets $\text{Sh}(p, q)/\{e, (i, j)\}$, and let Σ be some coset representatives. Then by (3.3.10)

$$\text{Sh}(p, q) = \bigsqcup_{\sigma \in \Sigma} \{\sigma, (i, j)\sigma\}$$

Therefore the sum is equal to

$$\sum_{\sigma \in \Sigma} \epsilon(\sigma) [f(x_\sigma)g(x_\sigma) - f(x_{(i, j)\sigma})g(x_{((i, j)\sigma)})]$$

so when $x_i = x_j$ this sum is zero. $\square$

Proposition 3.6.35 (Basic Properties of Exterior Product)

Let M be an A -module. Suppose $f \in L_a^p(M)$, $g \in L_a^q(M)$ and $h \in L_a^r(M)$. Then the following properties hold

- a) $f \wedge g = (-1)^{pq}g \wedge f$
- b) $(f \wedge g) \wedge h = f \wedge (g \wedge h)$

Proof. a) By definition and (3.3.43)

$$\begin{aligned} (f \wedge g)(x) &= \sum_{\sigma \in \text{Sh}(p, q)} \epsilon(\sigma) f(x_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p)}) g(x_{\sigma(p+1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p+q)}) \\ &= \sum_{\sigma \in \text{Sh}(q, p)} (-1)^{pq} \epsilon(\sigma) f(x_{\sigma(p+1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p+q)}) g(x_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p)}) \\ &= (-1)^{pq} (g \wedge f) \end{aligned}$$

b) Similarly by definition

$$\begin{aligned} ((f \wedge g) \wedge h)(x_1, \dots, x_{p+q+r}) &= \sum_{\sigma \in \text{Sh}(p+q, r)} \epsilon(\sigma) (f \wedge g)(x_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p+q)}) h(x_{\sigma(p+q+1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p+q+r)}) \\ &= \sum_{\sigma \in \text{Sh}(p+q, r)} \sum_{\tau \in \text{Sh}(p, q)} \epsilon(\sigma) \epsilon(\tau) f(x_{\sigma(\tau(1))}, \dots, x_{\sigma(\tau(p))}) g(x_{\sigma(\tau(p+1))}, \dots, x_{\sigma(\tau(p+q))}) \\ &\quad h(x_{\sigma(p+q+1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p+q+r)}) \\ &\stackrel{(3.3.44)}{=} \sum_{\sigma \in \text{Sh}(p, q, r)} \epsilon(\sigma) f(x_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p)}) g(x_{\sigma(p+1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p+q)}) h(x_{\sigma(p+q+1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p+q+r)}) \end{aligned}$$

and symmetrically

$$\begin{aligned} (f \wedge (g \wedge h))(x_1, \dots, x_{p+q+r}) &= \sum_{\sigma \in \text{Sh}(p, q+r)} \epsilon(\sigma) f(x_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p)}) (g \wedge h)(x_{\sigma(p+1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p+q+r)}) \\ &= \sum_{\sigma \in \text{Sh}(p, q+r)} \sum_{\tau \in \text{Sh}(q, r)} \epsilon(\sigma) \epsilon(\tau) f(x_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p)}) g(x_{\sigma(\tau(p+1))}, \dots, x_{\sigma(\tau(p+q))}) \\ &\quad h(x_{\sigma(\tau(p+q+1))}, \dots, x_{\sigma(\tau(p+q+r))}) \\ &\stackrel{(3.3.44)}{=} \sum_{\sigma \in \text{Sh}(p, q, r)} \epsilon(\sigma) f(x_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p)}) g(x_{\sigma(p+1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p+q)}) h(x_{\sigma(p+q+1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(p+q+r)}) \end{aligned}$$

therefore we conclude that the expressions are equal. $\square$

3.6.5 Matrix Rank

Definition 3.6.36 (Column and Row Rank)

Let k be a field and E an $m \times n$ matrix over k . Consider the canonical vector spaces k^n and k^m . Then define the **column rank** of E to be

$$\text{rank}_k(\widehat{E})$$

and the **row rank** of E to be

$$\text{rank}_k(\widehat{E}^t)$$

Proposition 3.6.37 (Row Rank = Column Rank)

Let E be a matrix over k , then row rank and column rank are equal, and denote this by $\text{rk}(E)$.

It is also the maximal number of linearly independent rows, or columns, and furthermore $\text{rk}(E) \leq \min(m, n)$.

We say E is **full rank** if $\text{rk}(E) = \min(m, n)$.

Proof. By (3.4.144) $\text{rank}_k(\widehat{E}) = \text{rank}_k(\widehat{E}^\vee)$ and by (3.4.121) this equals $\text{rank}_k(\widehat{E}^t)$ as required.

The columns (resp. rows) clearly span $\text{im}(\widehat{E})$ (resp. $\text{im}(\widehat{E}^t)$). By (3.4.126) there are $r := \text{rk}(E)$ columns (resp. rows) constituting a basis, and therefore linearly independent. For any other subset of linearly independent columns (resp. rows) we must have the order is less than r by (3.4.126). Therefore $\text{rk}(E)$ is the maximal number of linearly independent rows or columns. $\square$

Proposition 3.6.38 (Criteria for Full Rank Square Matrix)

Let E be an $n \times n$ matrix over a field k . Then the following are equivalent

- a) E is invertible
- b) $\text{rk}(E) = n$ (i.e. $\widehat{E}$ is surjective or E is full-rank)
- c) $Ev = 0 \implies v = 0$ for all column vectors v (i.e. $\widehat{E}$ is injective).
- d) The columns of E are linearly independent
- e) $\det(E) \neq 0$

Finally E is full rank if and only if E^t is full rank.

Proof. Consider k^n with canonical basis, then by (3.4.115) E is invertible if and only if $\widehat{E}$ is an isomorphism. By definition $\text{rk}(E) = \text{rank}_k(\widehat{E})$. Furthermore c) is equivalent to $\widehat{E}$ being injective, and is also equivalent to d). Therefore the equivalence follows from (3.4.137).

Finally it's clear from either a), b) or e) that this property is self-dual. $\square$

Definition 3.6.39 (Minor of a matrix)

Let E be an $m \times n$ matrix, we say a k -**minor** (for $k \leq \min(m, n)$) is the determinant of a $k \times k$ submatrix obtained by deleting $m - k$ rows and $n - k$ columns.

Proposition 3.6.40 (Criteria for rank)

Let E be an $m \times n$ matrix over k . Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\text{rk}(E) \geq r$
- b) There exists an $r \times r$ sub-matrix with full rank
- c) There exists a non-zero r -minor

Proof. We see b) $\iff$ c) by (3.6.38).e)

Suppose b) holds, then a-fortiori E has r linearly independent columns. Therefore by (3.6.37) $\text{rk}(E) \geq r$ and a) holds.

Conversely suppose $\text{rk}(E) \geq r$ then by (3.6.37) there are certainly r linearly independent columns. We consider the $m \times r$ sub-matrix E' consisting of these columns. By (3.6.37) $\text{rk}(E') = r$ and there are r linearly independent rows. Choosing these rows yields an $r \times r$ submatrix E'' which has r linearly independent rows, and so by (3.6.38) is full rank as required. $\square$

Corollary 3.6.41

Let E be an $m \times n$ matrix over k and r an integer. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\text{rk}(E) = r$
- b) r is the maximal dimension of a full-rank square sub-matrix
- c) r is the maximal dimension of a non-zero minor

3.7 Localization

Algebraically, localization can be seen as enlargening a ring to include inverses. In terms of the ideal structure this means removing (proper) ideals which contain the newly inverted elements. Geometrically ideals correspond to points/subsets, so localization may be viewed as reducing the set of interest.

Recall the definition of [multiplicative set](#). Some rather canonical examples are as follows

Example 3.7.1

The set $S_f = \{1, f, f^2, \dots\}$ is m.c. but not necessarily saturated. As an example consider $A = \mathbb{Z}$ and $S_n = \{1, n, n^2, \dots\}$ for n composite. Then $pq \in S_n$ but $p \notin S_n$.

We denote the localization of A at S_f by A_f (or alternatively $A[1/f]$).

Example 3.7.2

If $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A$ is a prime ideal, then $A \setminus \mathfrak{p}$ is a [saturated multiplicative set](#). More generally, we show later that S is a saturated multiplicative set if and only if it's of the form

$$A \setminus \bigcup_i \mathfrak{p}_i$$

for some family of prime ideals. We denote the localization of A at $\mathfrak{p}$ by $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$.

3.7.1 Rings

Definition 3.7.3 (Localization of a ring)

Let A be a ring and S a multiplicative set. Define the set

$$S^{-1}A = \left\{ \frac{a}{s} \mid a \in A, s \in S \right\}$$

under the equivalence relation

$$\frac{a}{s} = \frac{b}{t} \iff u(at - bs) = 0 \quad \text{some } u \in S.$$

then this is a ring in the obvious way

Proposition 3.7.4

The set $S^{-1}A$ is a ring under the obvious ring operations. It is non-zero precisely when S is proper. There is a canonical homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} i_S : A &\rightarrow S^{-1}A \\ a &\rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} a \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

- a) $\ker(i_S) = \text{Ann}(S)$
- b) $S^{-1}A$ is the zero-ring if and only if $0 \in S$ if and only if there exists $s, t \in S$ such that $st = 0$.
- c) $i_S(s)$ is invertible for all $s \in S$
- d) i_S is injective if and only if S has no zero-divisors
- e) This is an isomorphism if and only if $S \subseteq A^*$ already consists only of invertible elements (e.g. $S = \{1\}$).

Proof. a) This follows by the definitions

- b) $1/1 = 0/0 \iff s = 0$ for some $s \in S$ by the definitions
- c) $\frac{s}{1} \frac{1}{s} = \frac{s}{s} = \frac{1}{1}$
- d) This follows from the first part.

- e) If $S \subseteq A^*$ then it contains no zero-divisors and i_S is injective. Further it's clear that $\frac{a}{s} = \frac{as^{-1}}{1}$ so that the map is surjective. Similarly if the map is bijective S does not contain zero-divisors and $\frac{1}{s}$ is in the image. Therefore there is a such that $tas = 1$ for some t , which implies s is invertible.

□

Note when A is an integral domain and S is proper then the equivalence relation may be weakened to $at - bs = 0$.

Proposition 3.7.5 (Universal Property)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring homomorphism and S a multiplicative set. Then

- a) There is a unique morphism $\tilde{\phi}$ making the diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\phi} & B \\ \downarrow i_S & \nearrow \tilde{\phi} & \\ S^{-1}A & & \end{array}$$

if and only if $\phi(S) \subseteq B^*$. In this case it's given by

$$\tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{a}{s}\right) = \phi(a)\phi(s)^{-1}$$

- b) $\ker(\tilde{\phi}) = S^{-1}\ker(\phi)$

Proof. a) If $\tilde{\phi}$ exists then $1 = \tilde{\phi}(1) = \tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{s}{1}\right) = \tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{s}{1}\right)\tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{1}{s}\right) = \phi(s)\tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{1}{s}\right)$. Which shows that $\phi(S) \subseteq B^*$ and $\phi(s)^{-1} = \tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{1}{s}\right)$.

Conversely suppose $\phi(S) \subseteq B^*$ then we claim that the given mapping is well-defined. For

$$\frac{a}{s} = \frac{a'}{s'} \implies s''(s'a - sa') = 0 \implies \phi(s'')\phi(s')\phi(a) = \phi(s'')\phi(s)\phi(a')$$

Multiply by the appropriate inverses to find

$$\phi(a)\phi(s)^{-1} = \phi(a')\phi(s')^{-1}$$

It's clearly a multiplicative homomorphism. Further it's additive because

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{a}{s} + \frac{b}{t}\right) &= \tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{at + bs}{st}\right) \\ &= \phi(at + bs)\phi(st)^{-1} \\ &= \phi(a)\phi(t)\phi(s)^{-1}\phi(t)^{-1} + \phi(b)\phi(s)\phi(s)^{-1}\phi(t)^{-1} \\ &= \phi(a)\phi(s)^{-1} + \phi(b)\phi(t)^{-1} \\ &= \tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{a}{s}\right) + \tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{b}{t}\right) \end{aligned}$$

- b) Suppose $\tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{a}{s}\right) = 0$ then clearly $a \in \ker(\phi) \implies \frac{a}{s} \in S^{-1}\ker(\phi)$. The converse is clear.

□

In the case that A is an integral domain then generally everything becomes a lot simpler.

Example 3.7.6 (Quotient Field)

Let A be an integral domain then $A \setminus 0 = A^*$ and we define the **quotient field**

$$\text{Frac}(A) := (A \setminus 0)^{-1}A$$

Proposition 3.7.7 (Quotient Field contains all localization)

Let A be an integral domain, and $\text{Frac}(A)$ the quotient field. Define another model for $S^{-1}A$ as follows

$$S^{-1}A := \left\{ \frac{a}{s} \in \text{Frac}(A) \mid a \in A, s \in S \right\}$$

The canonical map $A \rightarrow S^{-1}A \subset \text{Frac}(A)$ is injective, and satisfies the universal property for localization.

Proof. It's injective because A has no zero-divisors. That it satisfies the universal property is very similar as before. $\square$

Proposition 3.7.8 (Directed Limit)

Let S_i be a family of multiplicatively closed sets *directed* by inclusion, such that $S = \bigcup_i S_i$ is multiplicatively closed. Then there is a canonical isomorphism

$$\varinjlim S_i^{-1}A \rightarrow S^{-1}A$$

induced by the canonical maps

$$S_i^{-1}A \rightarrow S^{-1}A$$

Proof. The canonical maps $i_{S_i S}$ induce a unique morphism

$$\begin{aligned} \varinjlim S_i^{-1}A &\longrightarrow S^{-1}A \\ [a_i/s_i] &\longrightarrow a_i/s_i \end{aligned}$$

by the universal property. An element on the right hand side is written a/s for some $s \in S$. By hypothesis $s \in S_i$ for some i , therefore it is surjective. Suppose we have two elements $[a_i/s_i]$ and $[a_j/s_j]$ on the left hand side which become equal in $S^{-1}A$. Then by definition $s_k(s_j a_i - a_j s_i) = 0$ for some $s_k \in S_k$. Since it's a directed system we can find S_l containing S_i, S_j, S_k . Then by definition $a_i/s_i = a_j/s_j$ in $S_l^{-1}A$ and we see that $[a_i/s_i] = [a_j/s_j]$. Therefore the given morphism is also injective as required. $\square$

3.7.2 Modules

Definition 3.7.9 (Localization of a module)

Let A be a ring with S multiplicative set and M an A -module. Then we define

$$S^{-1}M = \left\{ \frac{m}{s} \mid m \in M \right\}$$

under the obvious equivalence relation. This is then an $S^{-1}A$ -module in the obvious way.

Definition 3.7.10 (Localization of a sub-module)

Let M be an A -module and $N \subseteq M$ a sub- A -module then define

$$S^{-1}N = \left\{ \frac{n}{s} \mid n \in N, s \in S \right\} \subseteq S^{-1}M$$

Proposition 3.7.11

$S^{-1}(-)$ constitutes a functor $A\text{-Mod} \rightarrow S^{-1}A\text{-Mod}$. More precisely there is a unique morphism ψ making the following diagram commute as A -module morphisms

$$\begin{array}{ccc} N & \xrightarrow{\psi} & M \\ \downarrow i_S & & \downarrow i_S \\ S^{-1}N & \xrightarrow{S^{-1}(\psi)} & S^{-1}M \end{array}$$

where $S^{-1}(\psi)$ is in fact an $S^{-1}A$ -module morphism.

It is an exact functor; for an exact sequence

$$N \rightarrow M \rightarrow P$$

the corresponding sequence of $S^{-1}A$ -module morphisms

$$S^{-1}N \rightarrow S^{-1}M \rightarrow S^{-1}P$$

is exact. If N is a submodule of M then we may regard $S^{-1}N$ as a submodule of $S^{-1}M$.

Proposition 3.7.12 (Localization commutes with quotients)

There is a commutative diagram of A -module morphisms

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
0 & \longrightarrow & N & \xrightarrow{i} & M & \xrightarrow{\pi} & M/N \longrightarrow 0 \\
& & \downarrow i_S & & \downarrow i_S & & \downarrow \\
0 & \longrightarrow & S^{-1}N & \longrightarrow & S^{-1}M & \xrightarrow{S^{-1}(\pi)} & S^{-1}(M/N) \longrightarrow 0
\end{array}$$

with exact rows and the bottom row consists of $S^{-1}A$ -module morphisms. This induces an isomorphism of $S^{-1}A$ -modules.

$$S^{-1}M/S^{-1}N \cong S^{-1}(M/N)$$

Proposition 3.7.13

Suppose $N \subseteq N' \subseteq M$ then there is a canonical short-exact sequence of $S^{-1}A$ -modules

$$0 \rightarrow S^{-1}(N'/N) \rightarrow S^{-1}(M/N) \rightarrow S^{-1}(M/N') \rightarrow 0$$

which induces an isomorphism

$$S^{-1}(M/N)/S^{-1}(N'/N) \cong S^{-1}(M/N')$$

Proposition 3.7.14

Let M be a finitely-generated A -module. Then

$$S^{-1}M = 0 \iff sM = 0 \text{ some } s \in S$$

3.7.3 Ideals

Recall the notion of extended and contracted ideals in Definition (3.4.49).

Definition 3.7.15 (Localization of an ideal)

Let A be a ring and S a multiplicative set and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ define

$$S^{-1}\mathfrak{a} := \left\{ \frac{a}{s} \mid a \in \mathfrak{a}, s \in S \right\}$$

then this is an ideal of $S^{-1}A$.

Proposition 3.7.16 (Extension and Contraction)

Let A be a ring with multiplicative set S and canonical morphism $i_S : A \rightarrow S^{-1}A$.

- a) $\mathfrak{a}^e = i_S(\mathfrak{a})S^{-1}A = \left\{ \frac{a}{s} \mid a \in \mathfrak{a}, s \in S \right\} = S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$
- b) $\mathfrak{b}^c = \left\{ a \mid \frac{a}{1} \in \mathfrak{b} \right\}$
- c) An ideal $\mathfrak{a}$ in A satisfies

$$\mathfrak{a}^{ec} = \bigcup_{s \in S} (\mathfrak{a} : s) = \{a \in A \mid as \in \mathfrak{a} \text{ some } s \in S\}$$

In particular $\mathfrak{a}$ is *contracted* if and only if

$$as \in \mathfrak{a} \wedge s \in S \implies a \in \mathfrak{a}$$

- d) $\mathfrak{b}$ proper $\iff \mathfrak{b}^c$ proper $\iff \mathfrak{b}^c \cap S = \emptyset$
- e) $\mathfrak{a}^e$ proper $\iff \mathfrak{a} \cap S = \emptyset$
- f) Every ideal $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft S^{-1}A$ is *extended* (equiv. $\mathfrak{b} = \mathfrak{b}^{ce} = S^{-1}\mathfrak{b}^c$).
- g) A prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ is contracted if and only if $\mathfrak{p} \cap S = \emptyset$. In this case $\mathfrak{p}^e$ is prime.
- h) $\mathfrak{q}$ prime $\implies \mathfrak{q}^c$ is prime and satisfies $\mathfrak{q}^c \cap S = \emptyset$.

Proof. .

- a) $S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$ is an additive subgroup because $\frac{a_1}{s_1} + \frac{a_2}{s_2} = \frac{a_1 s_2 + a_2 s_1}{s_1 s_2}$. It contains $i_S(\mathfrak{a})$ and is closed under multiplication by A , therefore $\mathfrak{a}^e \subseteq S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$. Similarly as $\mathfrak{a}^e$ is an ideal containing $i_S(\mathfrak{a})$, we have $\frac{a}{s} = \frac{1}{s} \frac{a}{1} \in \mathfrak{a}^e$, i.e. $S^{-1}\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{a}^e$ as required.
- b) This is clear
- c) Observe that

$$\begin{aligned} \mathfrak{a}^{ec} &= \left\{ a \in A \mid \frac{a}{1} \in \mathfrak{a}^e \right\} \\ &= \left\{ a \in A \mid \frac{a}{1} = \frac{a'}{s} \quad a' \in \mathfrak{a} \ s \in S \right\} \\ &= \{ a \in A \mid sa \in \mathfrak{a} \text{ some } s \in S \} \end{aligned}$$

By (3.4.50) an ideal $\mathfrak{a}$ is contracted if and only if $\mathfrak{a} = \mathfrak{a}^{ec}$. Furthermore it always satisfies $\mathfrak{a}^{ec} \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$. The reverse inclusion is precisely the condition given.

- d) This first equivalence is true in general, see (3.4.50). Clearly $\mathfrak{b}^c = A \implies \mathfrak{b}^c \cap S \neq \emptyset$. Similarly if $S \cap \mathfrak{b}^c \neq \emptyset$ then $s \in \mathfrak{b}^c \implies \frac{s}{1} \in \mathfrak{b} \implies 1 \in \mathfrak{b} \implies 1 \in \mathfrak{b}^c$.
- e) By d) $\mathfrak{a}^e$ is proper if and only if $\mathfrak{a}^{ec}$ is proper. By c) we see $1 \in \mathfrak{a}^{ec}$ if and only if $S \cap \mathfrak{a} \neq \emptyset$ and the result follows.
- f) By (3.4.50) we need only show $\mathfrak{b}^{ce} \subseteq \mathfrak{b}$. Note $\frac{a}{s} \in \mathfrak{b}^{ce} \implies \frac{a}{s} = \frac{a'}{s'}$ with $a' \in \mathfrak{b}^c$. By 2. $\frac{a'}{1} \in \mathfrak{b}$ and therefore so is $\frac{a}{s} = \frac{a'}{s'} = \frac{a'}{1} \frac{1}{s'} \in \mathfrak{b}$ as required.
- g) If $\mathfrak{p} \cap S = \emptyset$ then by primality it automatically satisfies the conditions in c) and is therefore contracted. Conversely if a prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ is contracted then $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{q}^c$. It is by definition proper so by d) it satisfies $\mathfrak{p} \cap S = \emptyset$ as required. Suppose $\mathfrak{p}$ is prime and $\frac{a}{s} \frac{b}{t} \in \mathfrak{p}^e$ then $\frac{ab}{st} = \frac{x}{u}$ for $x \in \mathfrak{p} \implies v(abu - xst) = 0 \implies uvab \in \mathfrak{p} \implies a \in \mathfrak{p}$ or $b \in \mathfrak{p}$. Therefore $\frac{a}{s} \in \mathfrak{p}^e$ or $\frac{b}{t} \in \mathfrak{p}^e$ as required.
- h) Generically $\mathfrak{q}^c$ is a contracted prime ideal and we've already shown in d) that $\mathfrak{q}^c \cap S = \emptyset$.

□

Corollary 3.7.17 (Ideal Structure Localization)

Let A be a ring and S a multiplicative set then there is an order-preserving bijection of proper ideals

$$\{ \mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A \mid \mathfrak{a} \text{ contracted} \} \longleftrightarrow \{ \mathfrak{b} \triangleleft S^{-1}A \}$$

which restricts to a bijection of prime ideals

$$\{ \mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A \mid \mathfrak{p} \cap S = \emptyset \} \longleftrightarrow \{ \mathfrak{q} \triangleleft S^{-1}A \}$$

Proof. From (3.7.16) every ideal of $S^{-1}A$ is extended. Therefore the bijection of proper ideals follows from (3.4.53). For prime ideals each direction is well-defined by (3.7.16).g). □

3.7.4 Change of Rings

For what follows it is useful to have the concept of saturation of a multiplicatively closed set. Essentially taking the saturation $\bar{S}$ of S doesn't change the ring $S^{-1}A$.

Proposition 3.7.18 (Saturation)

Let A be a ring and S a multiplicatively closed set. Then the following sets are equal

- a) $(i_S)^{-1}((S^{-1}A)^*)$
- b) $\{ x \in A \mid ax \in S \text{ for some } a \in A \}$
- c) $\bigcap_{T \supseteq S: T \text{ saturated}} T$

which we denote by $\bar{S}$. We have the following properties

- $\bar{S}$ is saturated.

- S is saturated if and only if $S = \bar{S}$
- $\bar{\bar{S}} = \bar{S}$.

Proof. Note $x \in (i_S)^{-1}((S^{-1}A)^*) \implies \frac{x}{1} \frac{b}{t} = 1 \implies s(xb - t) = 0 \implies (sb)x \in S$. Similarly if $ax \in S$ then $\frac{x}{1} \frac{a}{ax} = 1$.

It's clear from b) that the set thus defined is saturated and multiplicatively closed. Let T be another saturated multiplicatively closed set containing S and suppose $ax \in S \implies ax \in T \implies x \in T$, so we find that the sets are equal.

We've proved that $\bar{S}$ is saturated. Clearly $S = \bar{S}$ implies S is saturated. Conversely if S is saturated then by c) we have $\bar{S} \subseteq S$, and clearly $S \subseteq \bar{S}$. The final part follows easily. $\square$

We also give another characterization of saturated multiplicatively closed subsets

Proposition 3.7.19

Let A be a ring and S a multiplicatively closed subset. Then

$$\bar{S} = A \setminus \bigcup_{\mathfrak{p} \cap S = \emptyset} \mathfrak{p}$$

Proof. Denote the right hand side by T . Then clearly $S \subseteq T$ and as noted before in (3.7.2) T is saturated. Therefore $\bar{S} \subseteq T$ by (3.7.18).c).

Conversely suppose $a \notin \bar{S}$. Consider the principal ideal (a) then $(a) \cap S = \emptyset$ (because $ab \in S \implies a \in \bar{S}$ by (3.7.18).b)). Therefore by (3.4.40) there is a prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ containing a which does not intersect S . Therefore $a \notin T$. Contrapositively $T \subseteq \bar{S}$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.7.20 (Change of Rings)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring homomorphism, S, T corresponding multiplicative subsets. Then

- There exists a morphism $\tilde{\phi}$ making the diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\phi} & B \\ \downarrow i_S & & \downarrow i_T \\ S^{-1}A & \xrightarrow{\tilde{\phi}} & T^{-1}B \end{array}$$

if and only if $\phi(S) \subseteq \bar{T}$. In this case it is unique and given by

$$\tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{a}{s}\right) = \frac{\phi(a)b'}{\phi(s)b'}$$

where $b' \in B$ is any b' such that $\phi(s)b' \in T$.

- If in addition $T \subseteq \phi(\bar{S})$ then ϕ injective (resp. surjective, bijective) implies $\tilde{\phi}$ is injective (resp. surjective, bijective)
- Further ϕ surjective $\implies \ker(\tilde{\phi}) = S^{-1}\ker(\phi)$.

Proof. • If $\tilde{\phi}$ is well-defined, then $i_T(\phi(S)) = \tilde{\phi}(i_S(S)) \subseteq \tilde{\phi}((S^{-1}A)^*) \subseteq (T^{-1}B)^*$, which implies $\phi(S) \subseteq i_T^{-1}((T^{-1}B)^*) = \bar{T}$.

Conversely if $\phi(S) \subseteq \bar{T}$ then $(i_T \circ \phi)(S) \subseteq (T^{-1}B)^*$ therefore by (3.7.5) the morphism exists making the diagram commute.

Note that

$$\tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{a}{s}\right) = \tilde{\phi}(i_S(a)i_S(s)^{-1}) = \tilde{\phi}(i_S(a))\tilde{\phi}(i_S(s))^{-1}$$

so it is uniquely defined by the commutativity condition. Note that given $s \in S$ by ((3.7.18)) there exists $b' \in B$ such that $\phi(s)b' \in T$. In this case it's clear that $i_T(\phi(s))^{-1} = \frac{b'}{\phi(s)b'}$ from which the explicit form results.

- Suppose $T \subseteq \phi(\bar{S})$ and ϕ is injective. Then $\tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{a}{s}\right) = 0 \implies t\phi(a) = 0$ for $t \in T$. Then there exists $s' \in \bar{S}$ and $x \in A$ such that $xs' \in S$ and $\phi(s') = t$. Therefore $\phi(as') = 0 \implies as' = 0 \implies a(xs') = 0 \implies \frac{a}{s} = 0$ as required.

Similarly if ϕ is surjective and given $\frac{b}{t} \in T^{-1}B$ there exists $a \in A$ such that $\phi(a) = b$ and $s \in \bar{S}$ such that $\phi(s) = t$. Then $xs \in S$, $\phi(xs) \in \bar{T}$ and $\phi(yxs) \in T$ for some $x, y \in A$. Finally

$$\tilde{\phi}\left(\frac{axy}{sxy}\right) = \frac{\phi(axy)}{\phi(sxy)} = \frac{b}{t}$$

as required.

- TODO

□

Corollary 3.7.21

Let $A \xrightarrow{\phi} B \xrightarrow{\psi} C$ be a sequence of homomorphisms and S, T, U be multiplicative sets such that $\phi(S) \subseteq \overline{T}$ and $\psi(T) \subseteq \overline{U}$, then in the notation of the previous Proposition

$$\tilde{\psi} \circ \tilde{\phi} = \widetilde{\psi \circ \phi}$$

Proof. This follows from the uniqueness condition in Proposition 3.7.20. □

Corollary 3.7.22 (Localization Maps)

Let A be a ring and S, T two multiplicative sets. Then TFAE

- There exists $i_{ST} : S^{-1}A \rightarrow T^{-1}A$ such that $i_{ST} \circ i_S = i_T$
- $S \subseteq \overline{T}$

In this case i_{ST} is the unique such map. We have the transitivity relationships

$$i_{TU} \circ i_{ST} = i_{SU}$$

$$i_{SS} = \mathbf{1}_{S^{-1}A}$$

and furthermore i_{ST} is an isomorphism if and only if $\overline{S} = \overline{T}$. In particular $i_{S\overline{S}}$ is an isomorphism.

Finally $\ker(i_{ST}) = S^{-1} \ker(i_T)$.

Proof. This existence of i_{ST} follows from (3.7.20) when considering the map $\phi = 1_A$. The transitivity and reflexive relationships follow from (3.7.21). □

Corollary 3.7.23 (Localization commutes with quotient)

Let A be a ring, $\mathfrak{a}$ an ideal and S a multiplicative set. Then there exists a unique morphism making the diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\pi} & A/\mathfrak{a} \\ \downarrow i_S & & \downarrow i_{\pi(S)} \\ S^{-1}A & & \pi(S)^{-1}(A/\mathfrak{a}) \\ \downarrow \pi & \dashrightarrow & \\ S^{-1}A/S^{-1}\mathfrak{a} & \dashrightarrow & \pi(S)^{-1}(A/\mathfrak{a}) \end{array}$$

which is an isomorphism, and determined by

$$\frac{a}{s} + S^{-1}\mathfrak{a} \longrightarrow \frac{a + \mathfrak{a}}{s + \mathfrak{a}}$$

Note that $S \cap \mathfrak{a} \neq \emptyset \iff S^{-1}A/S^{-1}\mathfrak{a} = 0 \iff \pi(S)^{-1}(A/\mathfrak{a}) = 0$.

When $\mathfrak{b} \supseteq \mathfrak{a}$ this restricts to a commutative diagram of A -modules

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathfrak{b} & \xrightarrow{\pi} & \mathfrak{b}/\mathfrak{a} \\ \downarrow i_S & & \downarrow i_{\pi(S)} \\ S^{-1}\mathfrak{b} & & \pi(S)^{-1}(\mathfrak{b}/\mathfrak{a}) \\ \downarrow \pi & \dashrightarrow & \\ S^{-1}\mathfrak{b}/S^{-1}\mathfrak{a} & \dashrightarrow & \pi(S)^{-1}(\mathfrak{b}/\mathfrak{a}) \end{array}$$

and the bottom arrow is still an isomorphism of $S^{-1}A/S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$ -modules.

Corollary 3.7.24 (Localization commutes with quotient II)

Let A be a ring, $\mathfrak{a}$ an ideal and S a multiplicative set. Then there exists a unique morphism making the diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\pi} & A/\mathfrak{a} \\ \downarrow i_S & & \downarrow \\ S^{-1}A & \xrightarrow{\pi} & S^{-1}A/S^{-1}\mathfrak{a} \end{array}$$

given by

$$a + \mathfrak{a} \mapsto \frac{a}{1} + S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$$

and it is an isomorphism precisely when every $s \in S$ is co-prime to $\mathfrak{a}$, i.e.

$$(s) + \mathfrak{a} = A \quad \forall s \in S.$$

When $\mathfrak{b} \supseteq \mathfrak{a}$ this restricts to a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathfrak{b} & \xrightarrow{\pi} & \mathfrak{b}/\mathfrak{a} \\ \downarrow i_S & & \downarrow \\ S^{-1}\mathfrak{b} & \xrightarrow{\pi} & S^{-1}\mathfrak{b}/S^{-1}\mathfrak{a} \end{array}$$

which is an $A/\mathfrak{a}$ -module morphism, and is an isomorphism when the condition (...) holds.

Proof. The condition given for being an isomorphism is equivalent to $\pi(S) \subset (A/\mathfrak{a})^*$, which is equivalent to $i_{\pi(S)}$ being an isomorphism. Therefore we may apply (3.7.23). $\square$

Corollary 3.7.25

Let A be a ring, $\mathfrak{m}$ a maximal ideal and S a multiplicative set such that $S \cap \mathfrak{m} = \emptyset$. Then there is an isomorphism

$$A/\mathfrak{m} \longrightarrow S^{-1}A/S^{-1}\mathfrak{m}$$

In particular $S^{-1}\mathfrak{m}$ is a maximal ideal of $S^{-1}A$.

Proposition 3.7.26 (Transitivity)

Let $S \subset T$ be multiplicative subsets of A and let

$$i_S : A \rightarrow S^{-1}A$$

be the localization at S . Define $T_S := i_S(T)$. Then T_S is multiplicative and there is a canonical isomorphism

$$T^{-1}A \longrightarrow (T_S)^{-1}(S^{-1}A) \longrightarrow (\overline{T_S})^{-1}(S^{-1}A)$$

Furthermore if $T \subseteq U$ then $T_S \subseteq U_S$ there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & S^{-1}A & & \\ & \swarrow i_{ST} & \downarrow i_{TS} & \searrow i_{\overline{T_S}} & \\ T^{-1}A & \xrightarrow{\sim} & (T_S)^{-1}(S^{-1}A) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & (\overline{T_S})^{-1}(S^{-1}A) \\ \downarrow i_{TU} & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ U^{-1}A & \xrightarrow{\sim} & (U_S)^{-1}(S^{-1}A) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & (\overline{U_S})^{-1}(S^{-1}A) \end{array}$$

3.7.5 Localization at an element**Definition 3.7.27** (Localization at an element)

Let A be a ring and $f \in A$. Then define

$$S_f = \{1, f, \dots, f^n, \dots\}$$

and

$$A_f := (S_f)^{-1}A$$

We have canonical maps

$$i_f : A \rightarrow A_f$$

given by $i_f := i_{S_f}$.

Note that A_f is a zero ring iff f is nilpotent.

Proposition 3.7.28 (Transition maps for localization at an element)

Let A be a ring and $f, g \in A$ then

$$S_f \subseteq \overline{S_g} \iff f \mid g^N \text{ some } N > 0$$

in this case define $i_{fg} = i_{S_f S_g}$ to be the unique morphism such that $i_{fg} \circ i_f = i_g$ (3.7.22). In addition if $h \in A$ and $S_g \subseteq \overline{S_h}$ we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & A & & \\ & i_f \swarrow & \downarrow i_g & \searrow i_h & \\ A_f & \xrightarrow{\quad} & A_g & \xrightarrow{\quad} & A_h \\ & i_{fg} \searrow & \downarrow i_{gh} & \swarrow i_{fh} & \end{array}$$

Furthermore $\overline{S_1} = A^\star$ and i_1 is an isomorphism.

Proposition 3.7.29 (Transitivity of localizing at elements)

Let A be a ring and $f, g \in A$ such that $S_f \subseteq \overline{S_g}$. There is a canonical isomorphism

$$A_g \xrightarrow{\sim} (A_f)_{g/1}$$

Furthermore $S_g \subseteq \overline{S_h} \implies S_{g/1} \subseteq \overline{S_{h/1}}$ and there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (A_f)_1 & \xrightarrow{\sim} & A_f \\ i_{1(g/1)} \downarrow & & \downarrow i_{g/1} \\ (A_f)_{g/1} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & A_g \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow i_{gh} \\ (A_f)_{h/1} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & A_h \end{array}$$

with the horizontal arrows isomorphisms and the vertical arrows are well-defined.

Proof. The existence of the isomorphism is from (3.7.26) as $i_f(S_g) = S_{g/1}$. The second statement follows because $g \mid h^N \implies g/1 \mid h^N/1$ trivially. $\square$

Proposition 3.7.30

Let A be a ring and $f \in A$. Then localisation map $A \rightarrow A_f$ induces an order-preserving correspondence of prime ideals

$$\{\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A \mid f \notin \mathfrak{p}\} \longleftrightarrow \{\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A_f\}$$

Proof. The correspondence of prime ideals follows from (3.7.17) once we observe that $S_f \cap \mathfrak{p} = \emptyset \iff f \notin \mathfrak{p}$. $\square$

Proposition 3.7.31

Let A be a ring, S a multiplicatively closed subset and $g \in S$. Then the canonical map $A_g \rightarrow S^{-1}A$ has kernel $\ker(i_S)_g$. In particular when $\ker(i_S)$ is finitely generated it is injective iff $g^r \ker(i_S) = 0$ for some $r > 0$.

When A is Noetherian then there always exists g such $A_g \rightarrow S^{-1}A$ is injective, and any multiple of g also satisfies this property.

Proof. The first statement follows from (3.7.4).

When A is Noetherian then $\ker(i_S) = (a_1, \dots, a_n)$ for some $a_i \in A$. By definition there exists some s_i such that $s_i a_i = 0$, whence we may take $g = s_1 \cdots s_n$. $\square$

Proposition 3.7.32

Let A be a ring, S a multiplicatively closed subset and $M_1, \dots, M_n$ a family of A -modules. Then there is an isomorphism

$$S^{-1} \left(\bigoplus_{i=1}^n M_i \right) \xrightarrow{\sim} \bigoplus_{i=1}^n S^{-1} M_i$$

3.7.6 Localization at a prime ideal

Definition 3.7.33 (Localization at a prime ideal)

Let A be a ring and $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A$ a prime ideal. Then $S := A \setminus \mathfrak{p}$ is a saturated multiplicatively closed subset, and we define

$$A_{\mathfrak{p}} := (A \setminus \mathfrak{p})^{-1} A$$

For an ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ write the extended ideal

$$\mathfrak{a}A_{\mathfrak{p}} := S^{-1}\mathfrak{a} = \mathfrak{a}^e.$$

Definition 3.7.34 (Relative localization at a prime ideal)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring homomorphism and $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A$ a prime ideal. Define

$$B_{\mathfrak{p}} := \phi(A \setminus \mathfrak{p})^{-1} B$$

For an ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ write

$$\mathfrak{a}B_{\mathfrak{p}} := (\phi(\mathfrak{a})B)B_{\mathfrak{p}}$$

Observe $B_{\mathfrak{p}} = 0 \iff \mathfrak{p} \not\subseteq \ker(\phi)$, so we would typically assume $\ker(\phi) \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$.

Proposition 3.7.35

Let A be a ring and $\mathfrak{p}$ a prime ideal. Consider the localization $A \rightarrow A_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Then there is an order-preserving bijection between (prime) ideals contained in $\mathfrak{p}$ and (prime) ideals of $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$

$$\begin{aligned} \{\mathfrak{q} \triangleleft A \mid \mathfrak{q} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}\} &\longleftrightarrow \{\mathfrak{q} \triangleleft A_{\mathfrak{p}}\} \\ \mathfrak{q} &\longrightarrow \mathfrak{q}A_{\mathfrak{p}} \end{aligned}$$

In particular $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a *local ring* with unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$.

Proof. Clearly $\mathfrak{q} \cap (A \setminus \mathfrak{p}) = \emptyset \iff \mathfrak{q} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$, so the result follows from (3.7.17). $\square$

Proposition 3.7.36

Let A be a ring and $\mathfrak{p}$ a prime ideal. Then the map

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Frac}(A/\mathfrak{p}) &\xrightarrow{\sim} A_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}} \\ \frac{\bar{a}}{\bar{b}} &\rightarrow \frac{\overline{a/1}}{\overline{b/1}} = \overline{\left(\frac{a}{b}\right)} \end{aligned}$$

is a ring isomorphism

Proof. Consider the ring map $A \rightarrow A_{\mathfrak{p}} \rightarrow A_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Then this has kernel $\mathfrak{p}^{ec} = \mathfrak{p}$ (3.7.16), so may be factored as an injective map $A/\mathfrak{p} \hookrightarrow A_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$. By (3.7.35) $A_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a field so by universal property of localisation (3.7.5) this extends to an injective map $\text{Frac}(A/\mathfrak{p}) \hookrightarrow A_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ of the given form. We may verify directly that it is surjective. $\square$

Proposition 3.7.37 (Localization at prime is direct limit of localization at an element)

Let A be a ring and $\mathfrak{p}$ a prime ideal then

$$S_{\mathfrak{p}} := A \setminus \mathfrak{p} = \bigcup_{f \in A \setminus \mathfrak{p}} \overline{S_f}$$

Therefore there are canonical morphisms (for $f \notin \mathfrak{p}$)

$$i_{S_f S_{\mathfrak{p}}} : A_f \longrightarrow A_{\mathfrak{p}}$$

Furthermore the family of multiplicatively closed sets $\{S_f\}_{f \notin \mathfrak{p}}$ (resp. rings $\{A_f\}_{f \notin \mathfrak{p}}$) form a *directed system* under the relation $S \prec T \iff S \subseteq \overline{T}$. Therefore we have a canonical ring homomorphism

$$\varinjlim_{f \notin \mathfrak{p}} A_f \longrightarrow A_{\mathfrak{p}}$$

which is an isomorphism.

Proof. As $A \setminus \mathfrak{p}$ is a saturated multiplicatively closed set we have $f \in A \setminus \mathfrak{p} \iff S_f \subseteq A \setminus \mathfrak{p} \iff \overline{S_f} \subseteq A \setminus \mathfrak{p}$. Therefore the expression for $S_{\mathfrak{p}}$ follows.

The family of multiplicatively closed subsets is a directed system because $S_f \subseteq \overline{S_{fg}}$. To see this note $fg \in \overline{S_{fg}} \implies f \in \overline{S_{fg}} \implies S_f \subseteq \overline{S_{fg}}$.

The final isomorphism follows because we can decompose it into two maps

$$\varinjlim_{f \notin \mathfrak{p}} A_f \xrightarrow{\sim} \varinjlim_{f \notin \mathfrak{p}} \overline{S_f}^{-1} A \xrightarrow{\sim} A_{\mathfrak{p}}$$

The first is an isomorphism by (3.7.22) and the second by (3.7.8), in light of the first statement. $\square$

Proposition 3.7.38 (Quotient commutes with Localization at Prime ideal)

Let A be a ring, $\mathfrak{a}$ an ideal and $\mathfrak{p} \supset \mathfrak{a}$ a prime ideal. Then there is an isomorphism of non-zero rings

$$\begin{aligned} A_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{a}_{\mathfrak{p}} &\cong (A/\mathfrak{a})_{\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{a}} \\ \frac{a}{s} + \mathfrak{a}_{\mathfrak{p}} &\rightarrow \frac{a + \mathfrak{a}}{s + \mathfrak{a}} \end{aligned}$$

Proof. Let $\pi : A \rightarrow A/\mathfrak{a}$ be the quotient map then we claim $\pi(A \setminus \mathfrak{p}) = \pi(A) \setminus \pi(\mathfrak{p})$. As π is surjective we only need to show that $\pi^{-1}(\pi(\mathfrak{p})) = \mathfrak{p}$. That is if $\pi(a) = \pi(b)$ and $b \in \mathfrak{p}$ then $a \in \mathfrak{p}$. However this follows by assumption because $\mathfrak{a} \subset \mathfrak{p}$. Therefore we may apply (3.7.23). $\square$

3.7.7 Finiteness Results

Lemma 3.7.39

Let M be an A -module, N a submodule and $f_1, \dots, f_r \in A$ such that

- a) $N_{f_i} \rightarrow M_{f_i}$ is surjective for all $i = 1 \dots r$
- b) $A = (f_1, \dots, f_r)$ as an ideal

then $M = N$.

Proof. Consider the A -module $P := M/N$. Suppose $P \neq 0$, then $0 \neq p \in P$ and $\text{Ann}(p)$ is a proper ideal of A . In particular $f_i \notin \text{Ann}(p)$ for some i . This shows $P_{f_i} \neq 0$. From (3.7.12) we have $P_{f_i} \xrightarrow{\sim} M_{f_i}/N_{f_i}$ and so $N_{f_i} \neq M_{f_i}$ a contradiction. $\square$

Proposition 3.7.40

Let M be an A -module. Then

- a) M finitely-generated $\implies M_f$ is a finitely generated A_f -module for all $f \in A$
- b) $(f_1, \dots, f_r) = A$ and M_{f_i} a finitely generated A_{f_i} -module for all $i = 1 \dots r \implies M$ is a finitely-generated A -module

Proof. a) Let $m_1, \dots, m_n \in M$ be a generating set. Then it is easy to verify that $m_1/1, \dots, m_n/1$ is a generating set for M_f .

- b) For each $i = 1 \dots r$, let m_{ij} be such that $m_{ij}/1$ generates M_{f_i} as an A_{f_i} -module. Let N be the A -submodule of M generated by the m_{ij} . Then $N_{f_i} = M_{f_i}$. We conclude by (3.7.39) that $N = M$ is finitely generated as an A -module. $\square$

3.8 Monoid Ring

Definition 3.8.1 (Monoid Ring)

Let A be a commutative ring and G be a commutative monoid. We define the **monoid ring** to be the free abelian group

$$A[G] := \bigoplus_{g \in G} A$$

We may write a general element as a formal sum

$$\sum_{g \in G} a_g g$$

where all but finitely many a_g are zero. Multiplication is defined extending the group operation. More precisely

$$\left(\sum_{g \in G} a_g g \right) \cdot \left(\sum_{g \in G} b_g g \right) = \sum_{g \in G} \left(\sum_{(h,k) | h+k=g} a_h b_k \right) g$$

We may verify that the identity is simply e and the multiplication is both associative and distributive.

When G is an abelian group we say that $A[G]$ is the **group ring**. There is a canonical map $A \rightarrow A[G]$ making $A[G]$ into an A -algebra.

Proposition 3.8.2

Let A, B be commutative rings and G a commutative monoid. Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring homomorphism and $\alpha : G \rightarrow (B, \times)$ a monoid homomorphism. Then there is a unique homomorphism

$$\phi \ltimes \alpha : A[G] \rightarrow B$$

such that $(\phi \ltimes \alpha)(ae) = \phi(a)$ and $(\phi \ltimes \alpha)(1_A g) = \alpha(g)$.

Proof. Define

$$(\phi \ltimes \alpha) \left(\sum_{g \in G} a_g g \right) = \sum_{\substack{g \in G \\ a_g \neq 0}} \phi(a_g) \alpha(g)$$

□

3.9 Polynomial Rings in One Variable

Definition 3.9.1 (Polynomial Ring)

Let A be a commutative ring. Define the polynomial ring $A[X]$ to be the monoid ring $A[\mathbb{N}]$ consisting of formal

$$f(X) = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} a_i X^i$$

such that only finitely many a_i are non-zero. Define degree in the obvious way

$$\deg(f) = \inf\{n \mid m > n \implies a_m = 0\} < \infty$$

and the leading coefficient to be $\ell(f) := a_{\deg(f)}$. By convention $\deg(0) = -\infty$.

Definition 3.9.2 (Monic polynomial)

Let $f \in A[X]$. We say f is **monic** if the leading coefficient, $\ell(f)$, is 1.

Lemma 3.9.3

If A is an integral domain then for elements $f, g \in A[X]$

$$\deg(fg) = \deg(f) + \deg(g)$$

$$\ell(fg) = \ell(f)\ell(g)$$

Further $A[X]$ is an integral domain.

Proposition 3.9.4 (Nilpotent and Invertible Polynomials)

Let A be a ring then

$$\text{a) } N(A[X]) = N(A)[X] \subset A[X]$$

$$\text{b) } A[X]^* = A^* + XN(A)[X]$$

Proof. Suppose $a \in N(A)$ then clearly aX^i is nilpotent. Therefore $N(A)[X] \subseteq N(A[X])$ since the nilradical is an ideal. Conversely suppose $f \in A[X]$ is nilpotent, i.e. $f^n = 0$. For any prime ideal $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A$ we find that $\bar{f}^n = 0$ as an element of $(A/\mathfrak{p})[X]$. As $A/\mathfrak{p}$ is an integral domain we have by the previous Lemma $\bar{f} = 0$. As $\mathfrak{p}$ was arbitrary and $N(A) = \bigcap \mathfrak{p}$ we see that $f \in N(A)[X]$ as required.

Suppose $f \in A[X]^*$ and $fg = 1$, then clearly the constant term of f must be invertible. Reduce modulo $\mathfrak{p}$ to find $\deg(\bar{f}) + \deg(\bar{g}) = 0 \implies \deg(\bar{f}) = \deg(\bar{g}) = 0$, which means $\bar{f}$ is a constant polynomial. As $\mathfrak{p}$ was arbitrary we see again that the other coefficients of f must be nilpotent as required. Therefore $A[X]^* \subseteq A^* + XN(A)[X]$. Conversely by (3.4.68) and a) we have $A^* + XN(A)[X] \subseteq A[X]^* + N(A[X]) \subseteq A[X]^*$ so the result follows. $\square$

It satisfies the following universal property

Proposition 3.9.5 (Evaluation at a point)

Consider an A -algebra B and $b \in B$. Then there exists a unique A -algebra homomorphism

$$\text{ev}_b : A[X] \rightarrow B$$

such that $\text{ev}_b(X) = b$. We write $p(b) = \text{ev}_b(p)$. It is given by

$$p(b) = \sum_{k=0}^{\deg(p)} i_B(a_k) b^k$$

The image of ev_p is equal to $A[b]$ the smallest sub- A -algebra **generated by** b . For any morphism $\phi : B \rightarrow C$ such that $\phi(b) = c$ we have

$$\phi \circ \text{ev}_b = \text{ev}_c$$

Remark 3.9.6

In categorical jargon $A[X]$ is an **initial object** in the category of pointed A -algebras.

Proposition 3.9.7 (Evaluation commutes with algebra homomorphism)

Let $\phi : B \rightarrow C$ be a homomorphism of A -algebras and $p \in A[X]$ then

$$\phi(p(b)) = p(\phi(b))$$

Definition 3.9.8 (Conjugate polynomial)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a homomorphism and $f \in A[X]$, then define

$$f^\phi(X) := \sum_{i=0}^n \phi(a_i) X^i$$

It induces a ring homomorphism

$$A[X] \rightarrow B[X]$$

and has the property that

$$f^\phi(\phi(a)) = \phi(f(a))$$

Proposition 3.9.9 (Division Algorithm I)

Let A be an integral domain and $f(X) \in A[X]$ a polynomial and $g(X) \in A[X]$ a non-zero *monic* polynomial. Then there exists unique polynomials $q(X)$ and $r(X)$ such that

- $f(X) = q(X)g(X) + r(X)$
- $\deg(r) < \deg(g)$

In particular when $\deg(g) = 1$ then $r \in A$.

Proof. If $\deg(f) < \deg(g)$ then $q = 0$ and $r = f$. Otherwise assume $n = \deg(f) \geq \deg(g) = m$ and proceed by induction on n . Note that since g is monic then we have $f - \ell(f)gX^{n-m}$ has degree $n - 1$, so by induction

$$f - \ell(f)gX^{n-m} = q'g + r$$

with $\deg(r) < \deg(g)$. Therefore

$$f = (q' + \ell(f)X^{n-m})g + r$$

as required.

Suppose $qg + r = q'g + r'$ then $(q - q')g = (r' - r)$. This implies that $\deg((q - q')g) < \deg(g)$ which implies $(q - q')g = 0 \implies q = q'$ and $r = r'$. This demonstrates uniqueness. $\square$

Proposition 3.9.10

Let B be an A -algebra and $f \in B$ not nilpotent. Then there is a canonical isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} B[X]/(1 - Xf) &\rightarrow B_f \\ \overline{P(X)} &\rightarrow P(1/f) \end{aligned}$$

In particular if B is a finitely-generated A -algebra, then so is B_f .

Proof. By (3.9.5) there is a A -algebra homomorphism $\phi : B[X] \rightarrow B_f$ such that $\phi(X) = \frac{1}{f}$. Evidently $(1 - Xf) \subset \ker(\phi)$ so by (...) this induces an A -algebra homomorphism $B'_f := B[X]/(1 - Xf) \rightarrow B_f$. Evidently $\overline{X} = \overline{f}^{-1}$ in B'_f , so by (3.7.5) there is a map $\psi : B_f \rightarrow B[X]/(1 - Xf)$ given by $\frac{b}{f^r} \rightarrow \overline{bX^r}$. One may verify that ψ is a two-sided inverse for ϕ , and so is an isomorphism.

The final statement follows from (3.4.76). $\square$

3.10 Laurent Polynomials

Definition 3.10.1 (Laurent polynomial ring)

Let A be a commutative ring. Define the **laurent polynomial ring** $A[X, X^{-1}]$ to be the group ring $A[\mathbb{Z}]$. Denote an element as a formal sum

$$f(X) := \sum_{i=-\infty}^{\infty} a_i X^i$$

Proposition 3.10.2

Let B be an A -algebra and $b \in B^\star$ a unit. Then there is a unique A -algebra homomorphism $\text{ev}_b : A[X, X^{-1}] \rightarrow B$ such that

$$\text{ev}_b(X) = b$$

If the structural morphism $A \rightarrow B$ is injective, so is ev_b .

Proposition 3.10.3

Let A be a commutative ring. Then there is an isomorphism of rings

$$\begin{aligned} A[X, X^{-1}] &\rightarrow A[X]_X \\ \sum_{i=-r}^{\infty} a_i X^i &\rightarrow \frac{\sum_{i=0}^{\infty} a_{i-r} X^i}{X^r} \quad r = \min\{k \mid a_k \neq 0\} \vee 0 \\ \sum_{i=-r}^{\infty} a_{i+r} X^i &\leftarrow \frac{\sum_{i=0}^{\infty} a_i X^i}{X^r} \end{aligned}$$

Proof. Denote the maps by ψ and ϕ . Then ψ exists by (3.10.2) and ϕ exists by the universal property of localisation. $\square$

3.11 Polynomial Rings in Many Variables

Definition 3.11.1

Let A be a ring then the polynomial ring $A[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ is the monoid ring $A[\mathbb{N}^n]$ consisting of formal sums of monomials

$$f(X_1, \dots, X_n) = \sum_{v \in \mathbb{N}^n} f_v X_1^{v_1} \dots X_n^{v_n}$$

where $f_v \in A$ and only finitely many coefficients are non-zero. Addition is defined in the obvious way.

We may canonically regard A , $A[X_i]$ and $A[X_1, \dots, X_i]$ as subrings in the obvious way.

Define $\deg(f, i)$ to be the maximal power of X_i with a non-zero coefficient.

Remark 3.11.2

It may be useful for certain induction arguments to write

$$A[X_1, \dots, X_n] = A$$

when $n = 0$.

Proposition 3.11.3 (Evaluation Homomorphism)

$A[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ satisfies the following universal property. Given any A -algebra B and points $(b_1, \dots, b_n)$ there exists a ring homomorphism

$$\phi_b : A[X_1, \dots, X_n] \rightarrow B$$

such that

$$\phi_b(X_i) = \phi(b_i)$$

given by

$$\phi_b\left(\sum_v a_v X_1^{v_1} \dots X_n^{v_n}\right) = \sum_v i_B(a_v) \phi(b_1)^{v_1} \dots \phi(b_n)^{v_n}$$

In other words it is an *initial* object in the category of n -pointed A -algebras. Furthermore

$$\text{Im}(\phi_b) = A[b_1, \dots, b_n]$$

Lemma 3.11.4 (Iterated polynomial ring)

Given $f \in A[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ and let $N = \deg(f, n)$ then there exist unique polynomials $g_i \in A[X_1, \dots, X_{n-1}]$ such that

$$f = \sum_{i=0}^N g_i X_n^i$$

in other words there is a canonical isomorphism

$$\psi : A[X_1, \dots, X_{n-1}][X_n] \rightarrow A[X_1, \dots, X_n]$$

under which $\deg(f) = \deg(\psi(f); n)$.

Proposition 3.11.5 (Homogenous grading)

Consider $R = k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ and $x \in k^n$. Then there is a direct sum of k -submodules

$$R = \bigoplus_{n \geq 0} R^{n,x}$$

where

$$R^{n,x} = \left\{ \sum_{|\alpha|_1 = n} \lambda_\alpha (X_1 - x_1)^{\alpha_1} \dots (X_n - x_n)^{\alpha_n} \mid \lambda_\alpha \in k \quad \alpha \in \mathbb{N}^n \right\}$$

and every $F \in R$ may be written uniquely as

$$F(X) = F(x) + F^{(1,x)}(X) + \dots + F^{(n,x)}(X) + \dots$$

with $F^{(n,x)} \in R^{n,x}$. Note that

$$\ker(\text{ev}_x) =: M_x = \bigoplus_{n \geq 1} R^{n,x} = (X_1 - x_1, \dots, X_n - x_n)$$

and

$$M_x^k = \bigoplus_{n \geq k} R^{n,x}$$

Finally there is a canonical isomorphism

$$k[X_1, \dots, X_n]^{(1,x)} \cong M_x / M_x^2$$

Proof. By Proposition (...) there is k -algebra homomorphism $\rho_x : R \rightarrow R$ given by $X_i \rightarrow X_i + x_i$. It is an isomorphism with two-sided inverse ρ_{-x} . Let $F \in R$ then

$$\rho_x(F) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(\sum_{|\alpha|_1=n} \lambda_{\alpha} X_1^{\alpha_1} \dots X_n^{\alpha_n} \right)$$

whence applying ρ_{-x}

$$\begin{aligned} F(X) &= \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} F^{(n)}(X) \\ F^{(n)}(X) &= \sum_{|\alpha|_1=n} \lambda_{\alpha} (X_1 - x_1)^{\alpha_1} \dots (X_n - x_n)^{\alpha_n} \end{aligned}$$

as required. The coefficients λ_{α} are seen to be uniquely determined by applying ρ_x . Therefore the internal sum is direct. Finally evaluate at x to find $F^{(0)} = F(x)$. The statement regarding M_x is straightforward. And because $R^{n,x} \cdot R^{m,x} \subseteq R^{n+m,x}$ the statement regarding M_x^k follows by induction. $\square$

Definition 3.11.6 (Projection to linear terms)

Given $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ and $x \in k^n$ define

$$\mathfrak{a}^{(i,x)} = \{F^{(i,x)} \mid F \in \mathfrak{a}\}$$

The following is useful

Lemma 3.11.7

Let A be a k -algebra and $F \in k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ and $G_1, \dots, G_n \in k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m]$ polynomials. For $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_m \in A$ we have

$$F(G_1, \dots, G_n)(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_m) = F(G_1(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_m), \dots, G_n(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_m))$$

3.12 Δ -Graded Rings

References :

- [Bou98b, Chap. II §11]

Let Δ be a commutative monoid. By convention we write the monoid operation additively and 0 for the identity. Further we assume it is **cancellable**: $\lambda + \mu = \lambda + \mu' \implies \mu = \mu'$. Typically $\Delta = \mathbb{Z}$, but for example we may also consider $\mathbb{N}^k$ for some positive integer k .

Definition 3.12.1 (Graded Abelian Groups)

Let Δ be a cancellable commutative monoid. An abelian group G is **Δ -graded** if it may be written as internal direct sum (3.4.93) of $\mathbb{Z}$ -modules

$$G = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \Delta} G_\lambda$$

for subgroups $G_\lambda \leq G$. In particular the subgroups G_λ are disjoint. This means for every $g \in G$ there is a unique decomposition into a finite sum

$$g = \sum_{\lambda \in \Delta} g_\lambda$$

If $g \in G_\lambda$ then we say g is **homogenous**. In this case we write $\delta(g) := \lambda$ for the **degree** of g .

We may write $\pi_\lambda : G \rightarrow G_\lambda$ and $i_\lambda : G_\lambda \rightarrow G$ for projection and inclusion respectively. For $g \in G$ we may abbreviate $\pi_\lambda(g)$ by g_λ .

Definition 3.12.2 (Graded Ring)

Let Δ be a cancellable commutative monoid. A commutative ring A is **graded** of type Δ if the additive group $(A, +)$ is Δ -graded, and the multiplication is compatible in the sense that

$$a \in A_\lambda, b \in A_\mu \implies a \cdot b \in A_{\lambda+\mu}$$

Lemma 3.12.3

Let A be a Δ -ring. Then A_0 is a subring.

In the case $\Delta = \mathbb{N}$ the additive subgroups

$$A_{\geq k} := \sum_{l \geq k} A_l$$

are homogenous ideals. We write $A_+ := A_{\geq 1}$ which we call the **irrelevant ideal**.

Proof. We need only show $1 \in A_0$. By hypothesis there is a unique decomposition

$$1 = \sum_{\lambda \in \Delta} e_\lambda \quad e_\lambda \in A_\lambda$$

For every $x \in A_\mu$ we have

$$x = x \cdot 1 = \sum_{\lambda \in \Delta} x \cdot e_\lambda$$

By the cancellable assumption we have $\lambda \neq 0 \implies \lambda + \mu \neq \mu$. Therefore $x \cdot e_0 = x$. By distributivity this then holds for all $x \in A$ and in particular $1 = 1 \cdot e_0 = e_0$ $\square$

Definition 3.12.4 (Graded Module)

Let A be a Δ -graded ring and M a left (resp. right) A -module which is a Δ -graded as an abelian group. Then M is a **graded module** if the A -module structure is compatible with the grading, namely

$$a \in A_\lambda, m \in M_\mu \implies a \cdot m \in M_{\lambda+\mu}$$

Elements of M_λ are known as homogenous.

Definition 3.12.5 (Graded Homomorphisms)

Let A, B be Δ -graded rings and $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ a ring homomorphism. It is a **graded ring homomorphism** if

$$\phi(A_\lambda) \subseteq B_\lambda \quad \forall \lambda \in \Delta$$

Let M, M' be graded A -modules and $\phi : M \rightarrow M'$ an A -module homomorphisms. Then ϕ is a **graded module homomorphism** if

$$\phi(M_\lambda) \subseteq M'_\lambda \quad \forall \lambda \in \Delta$$

Definition 3.12.6 (Graded Submodules)

Let M be a graded A -module, and $N \leq M$ an A -submodule. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $n \in N, \lambda \in \Delta \implies \pi_\lambda(n) \in N$
- b) N is generated by homogenous elements
- c) N is equal to the internal direct sum

$$\bigoplus_{\lambda \in \Delta} N \cap M_\lambda$$

We say such a submodule is **graded** or **homogenous** and we write $N_\lambda := N \cap M_\lambda$.

Proposition 3.12.7

Let M be a graded A -module and $\{N_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in I}$ be a family of submodules. Then both

$$\sum_{\alpha \in I} N_\alpha$$

and

$$\bigcap_{\alpha \in I} N_\alpha$$

are graded submodules.

Proposition 3.12.8

Let M be a finitely-generated graded A -module. Then M has a finite generating set of homogenous elements.

Definition 3.12.9 (Homogenous Ideal)

Let A be a commutative graded ring. An ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ which is homogenous as an A -submodule of A is a **homogenous ideal**. We write $\mathfrak{a}_\lambda := \mathfrak{a} \cap A_\lambda$, then by definition

$$\mathfrak{a} = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \Delta} \mathfrak{a}_\lambda$$

Note if A is Noetherian then every homogenous ideal has a finite generating set of homogenous elements.

Lemma 3.12.10

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a graded ring and $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft B$ a homogenous ideal. Then $\phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{b})$ is homogenous.

Example 3.12.11 (Polynomial Ring)

The polynomial ring $k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ is a graded ring over $\mathbb{N}$ with

$$k[X_0, \dots, X_n]_d = k\langle \{X_1^{\alpha_1} \cdots X_n^{\alpha_n} \mid \alpha_1 + \dots + \alpha_n = d\} \rangle$$

Furthermore

$$\bigoplus_{i \geq d} k[X_0, \dots, X_n]_i = (X_0, \dots, X_n)^d$$

Proposition 3.12.12 (Quotient by a Homogenous Ideal)

Suppose Δ is a commutative cancellable monoid. Let A be a Δ -graded ring and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ a homogenous ideal. Then $A/\mathfrak{a}$ is a Δ -graded ring by considering the internal direct sum of abelian groups

$$\begin{aligned} A/\mathfrak{a} &= \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \Delta} (A/\mathfrak{a})_\lambda \\ (A/\mathfrak{a})_\lambda &:= \{\bar{a} \mid a \in A_\lambda\} \end{aligned}$$

Furthermore there is an isomorphism of A -modules

$$(A/\mathfrak{a})_\lambda \xrightarrow{\sim} A_\lambda / (\mathfrak{a} \cap A_\lambda)$$

For every homogenous ideal $\mathfrak{b} \supset \mathfrak{a}$ the quotient ideal $\mathfrak{b}/\mathfrak{a}$ is homogenous with

$$\mathfrak{b}/\mathfrak{a} = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \Delta} (\mathfrak{b}/\mathfrak{a})_\lambda$$

Proof. Evidently the $(A/\mathfrak{a})_\lambda$ are abelian subgroups and span $A/\mathfrak{a}$. Observe that

$$0 = \sum_{\lambda \in \Delta} \overline{a_\lambda} \implies \sum_{\lambda \in \Delta} a_\lambda \in \mathfrak{a}$$

Then as $\mathfrak{a}$ is homogenous we conclude $a_\lambda \in \mathfrak{a}$ and therefore $\overline{a_\lambda} = 0$. Therefore the family $(A/\mathfrak{a})_\lambda$ satisfy the criteria of (3.4.94) and the direct sum is well-defined. Evidently the ring multiplication on $A/\mathfrak{a}$ is compatible with the given Δ -grading.

The isomorphism is induced by π_λ .

Suppose that $\bar{b} \in \mathfrak{b}/\mathfrak{a}$ then we require to prove that $(\bar{b})_\lambda \in (\mathfrak{b}/\mathfrak{a})$. By assumption $b_\lambda \in \mathfrak{b}$ so $\overline{b_\lambda} \in \mathfrak{b}/\mathfrak{a}$. However by the first part $\overline{b_\lambda} = (\bar{b})_\lambda$. $\square$

Proposition 3.12.13 (Localization at Homogenous Elements)

Let Δ be an abelian group, A a Δ -graded ring and $S \subset A$ a multiplicative set of **homogenous** elements. Then we may define a Δ -gradation on $S^{-1}A$ by

$$(S^{-1}A)_\lambda := \left\{ \frac{a}{s} \mid \delta(a) - \delta(s) = \lambda \right\}$$

For a homogenous ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ then the ideal $S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$ is homogenous.

Proof. We first show that $(S^{-1}A)_\lambda$ is an additive subgroup, for given homogenous $a, a' \in A$ and $s, s' \in S$ by definition

$$\frac{a}{s} + \frac{a'}{s'} = \frac{as' + a's}{ss'}$$

Suppose $\delta(a) - \delta(s) = \lambda = \delta(a') - \delta(s')$ then $\delta(as') = \delta(a's)$. Therefore $as' + a's$ is homogenous and $\delta(as' + a's) = \delta(as') = \lambda + \delta(s) + \delta(s') = \lambda + \delta(ss')$ whence $(S^{-1}A)_\lambda$ is an additive subgroup. Similarly for the multiplicative structure suppose $\delta(a) = \delta(s) + \lambda$ and $\delta(a') = \delta(s') + \lambda'$ then

$$\delta(aa') = \delta(a) + \delta(a') = \delta(\lambda) + \delta(\lambda') + (\lambda + \lambda') = \delta(\lambda\lambda') + (\lambda + \lambda')$$

so that $\frac{a}{s} \cdot \frac{a'}{s'} \in (S^{-1}A)_{\lambda+\lambda'}$ as required. Evidently $S^{-1}A$ is the internal sum of $(S^{-1}A)_\lambda$. To show it is direct suppose that

$$0 = \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{a_i}{s_i} \quad \delta(a_i) = \delta(s_i) + \lambda_i$$

for distinct $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n$. Then

$$0 = \sum_{i=1}^n a_i t \prod_{j \neq i} s_j$$

for some $t \in S$. Furthermore

$$\delta \left(a_i t \prod_{j \neq i} s_j \right) = \delta(a_i) + \sum_{j \neq i} \delta(s_j) + \delta(t) = \lambda_i + \sum_{j=1}^n \delta(s_j) + \delta(t)$$

As Δ is cancellable the elements $\widehat{\lambda}_i := \lambda_i + \sum_{j=1}^n \delta(s_j) + \delta(t)$ are distinct. By assumption we conclude that $a_i t \prod_{j \neq i} s_j = 0$ and so $\frac{a_i}{s_i} = 0$. Therefore $S^{-1}A$ is the direct sum of $(S^{-1}A)_\lambda$ by (3.4.94).

For $\frac{a}{s} \in S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$ we wish to show that $(\frac{a}{s})_\lambda \in S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$ for all $\lambda \in \Delta$. Here $a \in \mathfrak{a}$ so by assumption $a_\lambda \in \mathfrak{a}$ for all $\lambda \in \Delta$ and $a = \sum_{\lambda \in \Delta} a_\lambda$ so

$$\frac{a}{s} = \sum_{\lambda \in \Delta} \frac{a_\lambda}{s} = \sum_{\lambda \in \Delta} \frac{a_{\lambda+\delta(s)}}{s}$$

and so $(\frac{a}{s})_\lambda = \frac{a_{\lambda+\delta(s)}}{s} \in S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$ as required. $\square$

Recall for any Δ -graded ring A the additive subgroup A_0 is also a subring.

Definition 3.12.14

Let Δ be a commutative abelian group, A a Δ -graded ring and S be a multiplicative subset of homogenous elements. Define the subring of $S^{-1}A$

$$A_{(S)} := (S^{-1}A)_0 = \left\{ \frac{a}{s} \mid \delta(s) = \delta(a) \right\}$$

Similarly for $\mathfrak{a}$ a homogenous ideal define the homogenous ideal of $S^{-1}A$

$$\mathfrak{a}_{(S)} := \left\{ \frac{a}{s} \mid a \in \mathfrak{a}, s \in S, \delta(s) = \delta(a) \right\}$$

In the case $\mathfrak{p}$ is a homogenous prime ideal define the local ring

$$A_{(\mathfrak{p})} := A_{(\{x \notin \mathfrak{p}\})}$$

and for $f \in A$ homogenous define

$$A_{(f)} := A_{(\{1, f, f^2, \dots\})}$$

Lemma 3.12.15

Let Δ be an abelian group, A a Δ -graded ring and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ a homogenous ideal. Then

$$\mathfrak{a}_{(S)} = A_{(S)} \cap S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$$

as subsets of $S^{-1}A$.

Lemma 3.12.16

Let Δ be an abelian group, A a Δ -graded ring, $a \in A_\mu$ homogenous and $x \in A$. Then

$$(ax)_\lambda = a \cdot x_{\lambda-\mu}$$

In particular ax is homogenous iff x is homogenous.

Proposition 3.12.17 (Homogenous localisation comutes with quotients)

Let Δ be an abelian group, A a Δ -graded ring, $\mathfrak{a}$ a homogenous ideal and $S \subset A$ a multiplicatively closed set of homogenous elements such that $S \cap \mathfrak{a} = \emptyset$. Then there is a canonical isomorphism of Δ -graded rings

$$\begin{aligned} (S^{-1}A)/(S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \pi(S)^{-1}(A/\mathfrak{a}) \\ \frac{a}{s} + S^{-1}A &\rightarrow \frac{a + \mathfrak{a}}{s + \mathfrak{a}} \end{aligned}$$

where $\pi : A \rightarrow A/\mathfrak{a}$ is the canonical surjection. In particular there is an isomorphism of rings

$$A_{(S)}/\mathfrak{a}_{(S)} \xrightarrow{\sim} (S^{-1}A/S^{-1}\mathfrak{a})_0 \xrightarrow{\sim} (A/\mathfrak{a})_{(\pi(S))}$$

Proof. The first isomorphism of rings is from (3.7.23), and it is obviously compatible with the Δ -grading. For suppose $x \in (S^{-1}A)/(S^{-1}\mathfrak{a})$ with $\delta(x) = \lambda$. Then $x = \frac{a}{s}$ with $\delta(a) - \delta(s) = \lambda$. By definition $\delta(a + \mathfrak{a}) - \delta(s + \mathfrak{a}) = \lambda$ as required.

The third isomorphism follows immediately. For the second consider the ring homomorphism

$$\phi : A_{(S)} \hookrightarrow S^{-1}A \rightarrow S^{-1}A/S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$$

Then evidently the image is $(S^{-1}A/S^{-1}\mathfrak{a})_0$ as the quotient map is graded. The kernel is $A_{(S)} \cap S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$ which equals $\mathfrak{a}_{(S)}$ by (3.12.15). $\square$

Proposition 3.12.18

Let Δ be an abelian group, A a Δ -graded ring, $\mathfrak{a}$ a homogenous ideal and $\mathfrak{p} \supset \mathfrak{a}$ a homogenous prime ideal. Then there is a canonical isomorphism of Δ -graded rings

$$\begin{aligned} A_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{a}_{\mathfrak{p}} &\xrightarrow{\sim} (A/\mathfrak{a})_{\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{a}} \\ \frac{a}{s} + \mathfrak{a}_{\mathfrak{p}} &\rightarrow \frac{a + \mathfrak{a}}{s + \mathfrak{a}} \end{aligned}$$

In particular there is an isomorphism of rings

$$\begin{aligned} A_{(\mathfrak{p})}/\mathfrak{a}_{(\mathfrak{p})} &\xrightarrow{\sim} (A_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{a}_{\mathfrak{p}})_0 \xrightarrow{\sim} (A/\mathfrak{a})_{(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{a})} \\ \frac{a}{s} + \mathfrak{a}_{(\mathfrak{p})} &\rightarrow \frac{a + \mathfrak{a}}{s + \mathfrak{a}} \end{aligned}$$

Proof. Follows from (3.12.17) and the observation that $A/\mathfrak{a} \setminus \mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{a} = \pi(A \setminus \mathfrak{p})$. $\square$

3.13 Graded Rings

Definition 3.13.1 (Graded Ring over $\mathbb{Z}$)

A ring A (resp. A -module M) is said to be $\mathbb{Z}$ -**graded** (or simply **graded**) if it is graded in the sense of Definition (3.12.2) with gradation group $\Delta = \mathbb{Z}$.

If $i < 0 \implies A_i = 0$ (resp. $M_i = 0$) then we say A (resp. M) is **positively graded**.

Note in this case that we have the multiplication formula

$$(a \cdot b)_i = \sum_{j+k=i} a_j \cdot b_k$$

Definition 3.13.2

For an element $a \in A$ we define the **degree** to be

$$\deg(a) := \max\{i \mid a_i \neq 0\}$$

Definition 3.13.3 (Essential and Irrelevant Ideals)

Let A be a positively graded ring. Then we say a homogenous ideal $\mathfrak{a}$ is **irrelevant** if the following condition holds

$$\exists n_0 \text{ s.t. } n \geq n_0 \implies \mathfrak{a}_n = A_n$$

In particular A_+ is irrelevant. Otherwise we say that it is **essential**.

Proposition 3.13.4 (Radical of Homogenous Ideal is Homogenous)

Let A be a graded ring and $\mathfrak{a}$ a homogenous ideal. Then $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$ is also a homogenous ideal.

Proof. Define $\mathfrak{r} := \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$ and fix $x \in \mathfrak{r}$. Suppose

$$x = \sum_{i=-\infty}^{\infty} x_i$$

where $\delta(x_i) = i$ and $x^k \in \mathfrak{r}$. Then

$$x^k = \sum_{i=-\infty}^{\infty} x_i^k$$

where $\delta(x_i^k) = ki$. Without loss of generality we may assume $k > 0$ so by assumption $x_i^k \in \mathfrak{r}$ for all i and therefore $x_i \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{r}}$. $\square$

Proposition 3.13.5

Let A be a graded ring and $\mathfrak{p}$ a homogenous ideal satisfying the following property

$$a \in A_n, b \in A_m, ab \in \mathfrak{p} \implies a \in \mathfrak{p} \text{ or } b \in \mathfrak{p}$$

Then $\mathfrak{p}$ is a prime ideal.

Proof. Suppose $\mathfrak{p}$ is not prime. Then there exists $a, b \in A$ such that $ab \in \mathfrak{p}$ and $a, b \notin \mathfrak{p}$. Write $a = \sum_j a_j$ and $b = \sum_k b_k$. Then

$$ab = \sum_{i=-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\sum_{(j,k)|j+k=i} a_j b_k \right)$$

As $\mathfrak{p}$ is assumed homogenous then for each i we have

$$(ab)_i := \sum_{(j,k)|j+k=i} a_j b_k \in \mathfrak{p}_i$$

Let j' (resp. k') be the largest integer such that $a_{j'} \notin \mathfrak{p}$ (resp. $a_{k'} \notin \mathfrak{p}$). For all other pairs j'', k'' such that $j' + k' = j'' + k''$ we have by maximality $a_{j''} b_{k''} \in \mathfrak{p}_i$. Therefore we conclude $a_{j'} b_{k'} \in \mathfrak{p}$, which contradicts the original assumption. $\square$

Proposition 3.13.6

Let A be a positively graded ring. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A_+ is a finitely-generated A -module
- b) A is a finitely-generated A_0 -algebra

More precisely for homogenous elements $x_0, \dots, x_n \in A_+$ we have

$$A_+ = \sum_{i=0}^n Ax_i \iff A = A_0[x_0, \dots, x_n]$$

In this case we say that A is **finitely generated**. Further

$$A_+^m = (x_0, \dots, x_n)^m$$

for all integers $m > 0$.

Proposition 3.13.7 (Criteria for Irrelevant ideals)

Let A be a positively graded ring which is finitely generated and $\mathfrak{a}$ a homogenous ideal. Then the following are equivalent

a) $\mathfrak{a}$ is irrelevant (i.e. $n \geq n_0 \implies \mathfrak{a}_n = A_n$)

b) $A_+ \subset \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) It is sufficient to show that $i > 0 \implies A_i \subset \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$. Given $x \in A_i$ then by the Archimedean property there exists $k > 0$ such that $ik > n_0$. Therefore by assumption $x^k \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $x \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$.

b) $\implies$ a) TODO. □

Proposition 3.13.8

Let A be a graded ring and $f \in A_1$. Then there is an isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} A_{(f)}[X, X^{-1}] &\xrightarrow{\sim} A_f \\ \sum_{i \in \mathbb{Z}} \frac{a_{n_i}}{f^{n_i}} X^i &\longrightarrow \sum_{i \in \mathbb{Z}} \frac{a_{n_i}}{f^{n_i-i}} \quad a_{n_i} \in A \text{ homogenous of degree } n_i \\ \sum_{i \in \mathbb{Z}} \frac{a_i}{f^i} X^{i-r} &\longleftarrow \frac{\sum_{i \in \mathbb{Z}} a_i}{f^r} \end{aligned}$$

Proof. Denote the maps by ψ, ϕ , then ψ exists and is a ring homomorphism by (3.10.2) satisfying $\psi(X) = f$ and whence $\psi(X^i) = f^i$. To show ψ is well-defined first consider the map

$$\begin{aligned} \psi' : A &\rightarrow A_{(f)}[X, X^{-1}] \\ \sum_{i \in \mathbb{Z}} a_i &\rightarrow \sum_{i \in \mathbb{Z}} \frac{a_i}{f^i} X^i \end{aligned}$$

which is evidently a well-defined homomorphism of abelian groups. Furthermore

$$\left(\sum_{i \in \mathbb{Z}} \frac{a_i}{f^i} X^i \right) \left(\sum_{i \in \mathbb{Z}} \frac{b_i}{f^i} X^i \right) = \sum_{i \in \mathbb{Z}} \left(\sum_{j+k=i} \frac{a_j b_k}{f^{j+k}} \right) X^i = \sum_{i \in \mathbb{Z}} \left(\frac{1}{f^i} \sum_{j+k=i} a_j b_k \right) X^i$$

and so the map is a ring-homomorphism by the multiplication formula in A . By the universal property of localisation the ring homomorphism ϕ exists with $\phi(f) = X$ and hence $\phi(f^i) = X^i$. We have

$$\phi(\psi(X)) = \phi(f) = X$$

$$\phi \left(\psi \left(\frac{a_j}{f^j} \right) \right) = \phi \left(\frac{a_j}{f^j} \right) = \frac{a_j}{f^j}$$

so by linearity $\phi \circ \psi = \mathbf{1}$. Similarly

$$\psi \left(\phi \left(\frac{a_i}{f^i} \right) \right) = \psi \left(\frac{a_i}{f^i} X^{i-r} \right) = \frac{a_i}{f^i} f^{i-r} = \frac{a_i}{f^r}$$

so by linearity $\psi \circ \phi = \mathbf{1}$. □

3.14 Chain Conditions

Definition 3.14.1 (Noetherian / Artinian / Finite Modules)

We say an A -module M is **Noetherian** if it satisfies the **ascending chain condition**, namely any ascending chain of submodules

$$M_0 \subseteq M_1 \subseteq \dots \subseteq M$$

eventually stabilizes, i.e. $M_n = M_{n+1} \quad \forall n \geq N$.

Similarly we say an A -module M is **Artinian** if it satisfies the **descending chain condition**, namely any descending chain of submodules

$$M \supseteq M_0 \supseteq M_1 \supseteq \dots$$

eventually stabilizes.

Definition 3.14.2 (Noetherian / Artinian Ring)

We say a ring A is **Noetherian** (resp. **Artinian**) if it is Noetherian (resp. Artinian) as an A -module.

The following is useful

Proposition 3.14.3 (Noetherian criterion)

Let M be an A -module. The following are equivalent

- a) M is Noetherian
- b) Every submodule $N \subseteq M$ is finitely-generated
- c) Every set of submodules has a maximal element

Proposition 3.14.4

Let M be an A -module and A a Noetherian ring. Then M is Noetherian if and only if it is finitely generated as an A -module.

Proposition 3.14.5 (Restriction of Scalars preserves finiteness)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a finite A -algebra and M a **finite** B -module. Then $[M]_\phi$ is a **finite** A -module.

Proof. We suppose that M is generated by $m_1, \dots, m_n$, and B is generated by $b_1, \dots, b_m$. Then we claim that the elements $b_i m_j$ generate $[M]_\phi$. □

Proposition 3.14.6

Let A be a Noetherian ring and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ an ideal. Then $A/\mathfrak{a}$ is Noetherian.

Proof. Consider an increasing sequence of ideals $\mathfrak{a}_i \triangleleft A/\mathfrak{a}$. Then by (3.4.56) this corresponds to an increasing sequence of ideals $\mathfrak{a}'_i \triangleleft A$ containing $\mathfrak{a}$. As A is Noetherian, this sequence eventually stabilizes. Again by (3.4.56) the original sequence stabilizes. □

Proposition 3.14.7

Let A be a Noetherian ring then every finitely-generated A -algebra is Noetherian.

In particular $A[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ is Noetherian.

Proof. By (3.14.6) it's enough to show that $A[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ is Noetherian. By induction and (3.11.4) it's enough to consider the case $n = 1$. Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A[X]$ then by (3.14.3) it's enough to show that $\mathfrak{a}$ is finitely-generated.

Define

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{a}}_i := \{\ell(f) \mid f \in \mathfrak{a} \text{ s.t. } \deg(f) = i\}$$

Then clearly $\tilde{\mathfrak{a}}_i \triangleleft A$ is an ideal. This is an increasing sequence of ideals, and so it stabilizes for $i \geq d$ for some $d > 0$. Furthermore each ideal is finitely generated

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{a}}_i := (c_{i1}, \dots, c_{i n(i)})$$

where $c_{ij} = c(f_{ij})$ for polynomials $f_{ij} \in \mathfrak{a}$ of degree i . We claim that

$$\mathfrak{a} = (f_{ij})_{i \leq d, j \leq n(i)}$$

Denote the right hand side by $\mathfrak{b}$, then clearly $\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$. We show by induction on $m = \deg(f)$ that $f \in \mathfrak{a} \implies f \in \mathfrak{b}$. Let $m' := \min(m, d)$. Then by assumption $\ell(f) \in \tilde{\mathfrak{a}}_{m'} = \tilde{\mathfrak{a}}_{m'}$ so there exists $\lambda_j \in A$ such that

$$\ell(f) = \sum_{j=1}^{n(m')} c_{m'j} \lambda_j$$

Consider the decomposition

$$f = (f - \sum_{j=1}^{n(m')} \lambda_j f_{m'j} X^{m-m'}) + \sum_{j=1}^{n(m')} \lambda_j f_{m'j} X^{m-m'}$$

The first term has strictly smaller degree than f , so by the inductive hypothesis lies in $\mathfrak{b}$. Therefore $f \in \mathfrak{b}$ as required. $\square$

3.15 Principal Ideal Domains

Definition 3.15.1 (Principal Ideal Domain)

An *integral domain* A is a **principal ideal domain** (or **PID**) if every ideal $\mathfrak{a}$ is principal.

Proposition 3.15.2

A PID is *Noetherian*.

Proof. Suppose we have an ascending chain of ideals

$$\mathfrak{a}_1 \subset \mathfrak{a}_2 \subset \dots \subset \mathfrak{a}_n \dots$$

Clearly the union is again an ideal, which is also principal of the form (a) . We must have $a \in \mathfrak{a}_n$ for some n , whence it terminates after n . $\square$

Proposition 3.15.3 (Integers form a PID)

$\mathbb{Z}$ is a PID.

Proof. This follows from the well-ordering principle. Let $\mathfrak{a}$ be an ideal with minimal positive element d . We claim $\mathfrak{a} = (d)$. By the division algorithm (or apply well-ordering principle to the coset $x + (d)$), for every $x \in \mathfrak{a}$ there is $0 \leq r < d$ and $q \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$x = qd + r.$$

Clearly $r \in \mathfrak{a}$, whence by minimality $r = 0$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.15.4

Let k be a field then the polynomial ring $k[X]$ is a PID

Proof. Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X]$ be an ideal. Choose $f \in \mathfrak{a}$ to have minimal degree, then we claim $\mathfrak{a} = (f)$. For $g \in \mathfrak{a}$ we have by (3.9.9) $g = qf + r$ for $\deg(r) < \deg(f)$. Clearly $r \in \mathfrak{a}$, so by minimality $r = 0$ and the result follows. $\square$

Lemma 3.15.5 (Co-prime elements in a PID)

Let A be a PID, then x, y are *coprime* if and only if they have no non-invertible common divisors.

Proof. First suppose $(x, y) = A$, then $ax + by = 1$ and any common divisor d must divide 1 and therefore be invertible.

Conversely suppose $(x, y) \neq (1)$, since A is a PID it must equal (d) for some non-invertible d which is then a common divisor. $\square$

Proposition 3.15.6

Let A be a principal ideal domain, M a free A -module with rank m and $N \subset M$ an A -submodule. Then N is free with rank $n \leq m$.

Proof. Recall (...) that the rank of a finite free A -module is well-defined.

We proceed by induction on m . Suppose that $m = 1$ then there is an isomorphism of A -modules $A \xrightarrow{\sim} M$. Therefore under this isomorphism N corresponds to an ideal, say (a) . If $a = 0$ then $N = 0$ is by definition free of rank 0. If $a \neq 0$ then we may consider the map of A -modules

$$\begin{aligned} A &\rightarrow (a) \\ x &\rightarrow ax \end{aligned}$$

it is by definition surjective, and injective by cancellation and so an isomorphism. This shows that N is free of rank 1.

Suppose then $x_1, \dots, x_m$ is a basis for M , and let M' be the free submodule generated by $x_1, \dots, x_{m-1}$, and M'' the rank-1 free module generated by x_m . Then

$$M := M' \oplus M''$$

and we may show that N is the internal direct sum

$$N = (N \cap M') \oplus (N \cap M'').$$

Then by the induction hypothesis we find N is free of rank at most $m - 1 + 1 = m$. $\square$

Proposition 3.15.7

Let A be a principal ideal domain and M a finitely generated, torsion-free A -module. Then M is a finite free A -module.

Proof. Let $\{m_1, \dots, m_n\}$ be a generating set for M , and $\{v_1, \dots, v_r\}$ an arbitrary linearly independent subset of M . Then by definition we have

$$v_i = \sum_{j=1}^n a_{ij} m_j \quad a_{ij} \in A$$

Consider the elements of A^n given by

$$w_i := (a_{i1}, \dots, a_{in})$$

Then we can see that $\{w_1, \dots, w_r\}$ is an A -linearly independent subset of A^n , and therefore a K -linearly independent subset of K^n for $K = \text{Frac}(A)$. By (...) we see that $r \leq n$.

Therefore we may choose $\{v_1, \dots, v_r\}$ to be a maximal linearly independent subset. For each $m_i \in M$, by maximality of the subset there must exist an $0 \neq a_i$ such that

$$a_i m_i \in M'$$

Define $a := a_1 \dots a_n$ then this satisfies $aM \subset M'$, since the m_i generate M . As A is an integral domain we have a series of injections

$$M \hookrightarrow aM \subset M' \xrightarrow{\sim} A^r$$

Therefore we are done by (3.15.6). □

3.16 Factorisation

For this section we assume A is a commutative [integral domain](#).

Definition 3.16.1 (Associates)

We say two non-zero elements x and y are **associates** if $x = uy$ for some $u \in A^\star$. We write $x \sim y$.

Note this is an equivalence relation on $A \setminus \{0\}$.

Lemma 3.16.2

Let A be a ring and $x, y \in A$ non-zero elements then the following are equivalent

- $x \mid y$
- $(y) \subseteq (x)$
- $y \in (x)$

Lemma 3.16.3

Let A be a ring and $x, y \in A$ non-zero elements then the following are equivalent

- $x \mid y$ and $y \mid x$
- $(x) = (y)$

If A is an integral domain this is equivalent to $x \sim y$.

Definition 3.16.4 (Irreducible element)

We say $0 \neq x$ is **irreducible** if it is not invertible and $x = ab \implies a$ a unit or b a unit.

Equivalently if $y \mid x$ implies either y is a unit or $y \sim x$.

Definition 3.16.5 (Prime element)

We say $0 \neq p$ is **prime** if $p \mid ab \implies p \mid a$ or $p \mid b$.

Example 3.16.6

The units of $\mathbb{Z}$ are $\{-1, 1\}$ so each equivalence class is of the form $\{n, -n\}$.

Example 3.16.7

A number $p \in \mathbb{Z}$ is prime in the traditional sense exactly when it is irreducible. It is of course also prime in the ring-theoretic sense but this requires proof (see (2.2.13)).

The concept of associates is important to unique factorization, because we may only hope to have unique factorization upto multiplication by a unit.

Lemma 3.16.8

If $x \sim y$ are [associates](#) then x is [irreducible](#) iff y is

Proof. Suppose $x \sim y$ and x irreducible. If $y = ab$ then $x = abu \implies a$ a unit or bu a unit $\implies b$ a unit. Therefore y is irreducible as required. $\square$

Lemma 3.16.9 (Criterion for primality)

Suppose $0 \neq p \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then p is prime if and only if (p) is a prime ideal

Proof. Note $x \mid y \iff y \in (x)$. So in particular if p is prime then $xy \in (p) \implies p \mid xy \implies p \mid x$ or $p \mid y \implies x \in (p)$ or $y \in (p)$, whence (p) is prime.

Conversely if (p) is prime, then $p \mid xy \implies xy \in (p) \implies x \in (p)$ or $y \in (p) \implies p \mid x$ or $p \mid y$, so that p is prime. $\square$

Lemma 3.16.10 (Criterion for irreducibility)

Let A be an [integral domain](#). Then f is irreducible if and only if (f) is maximal amongst proper [principal](#) ideals.

Proof. Suppose f is irreducible and $(f) \subseteq (g)$. Then $f = ag$ with either a a unit or g a unit. If a is a unit then $(f) = (g)$, and if g is a unit $(g) = A$. So the result follows.

Conversely suppose $f = ab$, then $f \in (a) \implies (f) \subseteq (a)$. Then by hypothesis either $(a) = (f)$ or $(a) = A$. In the second case a is a unit. In the first case then $f \mid a \implies bf \mid f \implies b \mid 1$ whence b is a unit. $\square$

Proposition 3.16.11 (Primes are Irreducible)

Let A be an integral domain then p prime $\implies p$ irreducible

Proof. Suppose $b \mid p$ then $p = ab$ and $a \mid p$. By hypothesis $p \mid a$ or $p \mid b$. If $p \mid a$ (resp. b) then by (3.16.3) $p \sim a$ (resp. b) as required. $\square$

Definition 3.16.12 (Unique Factorisation Domain (UFD) or Factorial Ring)

We say an integral domain A is factorial (or a UFD) if every element $0 \neq a$ may be represented as

$$a = u \prod_{i=1}^n p_i$$

for u a unit and p_i *irreducible*, and moreover this is unique in the sense that given another factorization

$$a = u' \prod_{i=1}^m p'_i$$

we have $n = m$ and $p_i \sim p'_{\psi(i)}$, for ψ a permutation on $\{1, \dots, n\}$.

Furthermore it may be convenient in applications to count the multiplicities

Proposition 3.16.13 (Factorisation with multiplicities)

Let A be a UFD, then for every element $0 \neq a \in A$ there is a factorization of the form

$$a = u \prod_{i=1}^n p_i^{r_i}$$

where $r_i > 0$ and none of the p_i are associate to each other. Furthermore this is essentially unique in the sense that given another such factorization we have $n = n'$, $r_i = r'_{\sigma(i)}$ and $p_i \sim p'_{\sigma(i)}$ for some permutation $\sigma \in S_n$.

Proof. Given a factorization into irreducible elements

$$a = u \prod_{i=1}^n p_i$$

Consider a representative set of irreducibles $q_1, \dots, q_m$ (under the equivalence relation $x \sim y$). Then we have $p_i = q_{\pi(i)} u_i$ for some units u_i and mapping $\pi : \{1, \dots, n\} \rightarrow \{1, \dots, m\}$. Let $r_j = \#\pi^{-1}(j)$. Then we have that the set of irreducibles $\{p_1, \dots, p_n\}$ is the *disjoint* union of the set of equivalence classes with representatives q_j . Therefore

$$a = u \prod_{j=1}^m \prod_{p \sim q_j} p = u \prod_{j=1}^m \prod_{i: \pi(i)=j} p_i = \left(u \prod_{j=1}^m \prod_{i: \pi(i)=j} u_i \right) \prod_{j=1}^m q_j^{r_j}$$

as required. Suppose we have two factorizations

$$u \prod_{i=1}^n p_i^{r_i} = u' \prod_{i=1}^m (p'_i)^{r'_i}$$

Let I be the indexing set of p_i and J the set of p'_j . By unique factorization there must be mappings $\sigma : I \rightarrow J$ such that $p_i \sim p'_{\sigma(i)}$, and $\tau : J \rightarrow I$ such that $p'_j \sim p_{\tau(j)}$. Which means that $p_i \sim p_{\tau(\sigma(i))}$ and $p'_j \sim p_{\sigma(\tau(j))}$. Since none are associate to each other we see that τ and σ are mutual inverses, whence $m = n$ and we may regard $\sigma \in S_n$. In the unique factorization p_i appears r_i times and $p'_{\sigma(i)}$ appears $r'_{\sigma(i)}$ times. Since p_i is associate to $p'_{\sigma(i)}$ it is not associate to any p'_j for $j \neq \sigma(i)$. Unique factorization shows that $r_i = r'_{\sigma(i)}$. $\square$

Definition 3.16.14

Let A be a UFD and $x \in A$ a non-zero, non-unit such that

$$x \sim \prod_{i=1}^n p_i^{r_i}$$

is an (almost) unique factorization into irreducibles. Then for $p \in A$ an irreducible define

$$v_p(x) := \begin{cases} r_i & p \sim p_i \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

If $x \in A$ is a unit then simply define $v_p(x) = 0$ for all p .

Lemma 3.16.15

Let A be a UFD then the following are equivalent

- a) $x \mid y$
- b) $(y) \subseteq (x)$
- c) $v_p(x) \leq v_p(y)$ for all p irreducible

In particular $x \sim y \iff (x) = (y) \iff v_p(x) = v_p(y)$ for all p irreducible.

Definition 3.16.16 (Atomic Ring)

We say that A is **atomic** if every element has a (not necessarily unique) decomposition into irreducible elements.

Definition 3.16.17 (Ascending Chain Condition for Principal Ideals (ACCP))

We say a ring A satisfies **ACCP** if every ascending chain of principal ideals eventually stabilizes.

Note every Noetherian ring satisfies this condition.

Proposition 3.16.18

An integral domain A satisfying **ACCP** is **atomic**.

In particular a Noetherian ring is atomic. .

Proof. Suppose a ring A is not atomic, then choose any non-unit $x_1 \in A$. By repeated application (3.16.10) it's possible to construct a strictly ascending sequence of proper principal ideals

$$(x_1) \subsetneq (x_2) \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq (x_n) \subsetneq \dots$$

therefore A does not satisfy ACCP. □

Remark 3.16.19

The converse is not in general true (...) but see (3.16.21) for a partial converse.

We show a simple criterion for a ring to be a UFD.

Definition 3.16.20

We say an integral domain A is **AP** if p irreducible $\implies p$ prime.

Roughly speaking, “atomic” ensures the existence of factorization and “AP” ensures the uniqueness.

Proposition 3.16.21 (Atomic + AP $\iff$ UFD)

Let A be an integral domain. The following are equivalent

- a) A is a UFD
- b) A is **atomic** and **AP**
- c) A satisfies **ACCP** and is **AP**

Proof. $a \implies c$). Suppose A is a UFD. If p is an irreducible element and $p \mid ab$, then by uniqueness it must appear in the irreducible factorization of either a or b . Therefore p is prime. If we have an ascending chain of principal ideals $(x_1) \subseteq (x_2) \dots$ then by (3.16.15) we have $v_p(x_i)$ is a decreasing sequence for all irreducible p occurring in the factorization of x_1 . Furthermore $\max_p v_p(x_i)$ is a finite decreasing sequence. Choose $i = N$ such that $\max_p v_p(x_i)$ is minimal, then all these sequences must stabilise for $i \geq N$ and therefore by (3.16.15) the chain of principal ideals also stabilises.

$c \implies b$). This is (3.16.18).

$b \implies a$). We require to show that factorization into irreducibles is unique up to associates. Suppose

$$\prod_{i=1}^n p_i \sim \prod_{j=1}^m p'_j$$

By convention an empty product is 1 and by hypothesis all the elements are in fact prime. If $n = 0$, then since p'_j is irreducible, it is not a unit and hence $m = 0$. Otherwise consider p_1 , then $p_1 \mid \text{RHS}$, so by definition of prime we must have $p_1 \mid p'_j$ for some j . Since p'_j is irreducible and p_1 is not a unit, we have $p_1 \sim p'_j$. Since A is integral we may cancel these two to obtain an equivalence of smaller degree and we may proceed by induction. □

Lemma 3.16.22 (PID is an AP-domain)

Let A be a PID and $a \in A$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) a is prime
- b) a is irreducible
- c) (a) is maximal

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) This holds for an arbitrary integral domain (3.16.11).

b) $\iff$ c) as all ideals are principal this follows from (3.16.10)

c) $\implies$ a) By (3.4.60) (a) is prime, whence a is prime by (3.16.9) □

Proposition 3.16.23

A PID is Noetherian UFD.

Furthermore (f is irreducible $\iff f$ is prime), and every prime ideal is maximal.

Proof. A is Noetherian by (3.15.2) and atomic by (3.16.18). And by (3.16.22) an irreducible element is prime. Therefore we are done by (3.16.21). □

If we take a suitable fixed set of irreducible elements we can obtain completely unique factorization

Definition 3.16.24

Let A be a ring we say $\mathcal{P}$ is a **representative set of irreducible elements** if

- No two elements $p, q \in \mathcal{P}$ are associate
- Every irreducible element $p \in A$ is associate to (precisely) one in $\mathcal{P}$

Example 3.16.25

For $\mathbb{Z}$ the positive primes are a canonical set of irreducible elements.

Proposition 3.16.26

Let A be a UFD and $K = \text{Frac}(A)$ then for every irreducible $p \in A$ there is a unique map

$$v_p : K^\star \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$$

such that

- $u \in A^\star \implies v_p(u) = 0$
- $v_p(xy) = v_p(x) + v_p(y)$
- $v_p(p) = 1$

Furthermore let $\mathcal{P}$ be a set of irreducible representatives then we have a group isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} K^\star / A^\star &\xrightarrow{\sim} \bigoplus_{p \in \mathcal{P}} \mathbb{Z} \\ x &\longrightarrow (v_p(x))_{p \in \mathcal{P}} \\ \prod_{p \in \mathcal{P}} p^{n_p} &\longleftarrow (n_p)_{p \in \mathcal{P}} \end{aligned}$$

Finally $x \in A \iff v_p(x) \geq 0$ for all $p \in \mathcal{P}$.

Proof. By (3.16.13) there is a well-defined map $v_p : A \setminus \{0\} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ satisfying the given properties. We claim that

$$\begin{aligned} v_p : K^\star &\rightarrow \mathbb{Z} \\ xy^{-1} &\rightarrow v_p(x) - v_p(y) \end{aligned}$$

is well-defined. For suppose $xy^{-1} = wz^{-1}$ then $zx = wy$ whence $v_p(z) + v_p(x) = v_p(w) + v_p(y)$ and therefore $v_p(xy^{-1}) = v_p(wz^{-1})$.

It's clear the multiplicative property also holds and so ϕ is well-defined (since by definition $A^\star$ is in the kernel of v_p). Denote by ϕ, ψ the proposed maps. By definition of unique factorization ϕ and ψ are mutual inverses when restricted as follows

$$(A \setminus \{0\})/A^* \longleftrightarrow \bigoplus_{p \in \mathcal{P}} \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$$

We also observe that $\phi(x^{-1}) = -\phi(x)$ and $\psi(-n) = \psi(n)^{-1}$, so then it's easy to demonstrate they are mutually inverse over the whole domain.

Suppose $v_p(xy^{-1}) \geq 0$ then $v_p(x) \geq v_p(y)$. If this holds for all $p \in \mathcal{P}$, then by (3.16.15) $y \mid x$ as elements of A whence by definition $xy^{-1} \in A$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.16.27

Suppose A is an integral domain satisfying ACCP then so is $A[X]$.

Proof. Suppose we have an ascending chain of principal ideals

$$(f_1) \subseteq (f_2) \subseteq \dots (f_n) \dots$$

Without loss of generality the f_i are non-zero. Then $f_{i+1} \mid f_i$ and by (...) $\deg(f_{i+1}) \leq \deg(f_i)$. Choose N such that $\deg(f_i)$ is minimal, and define $a_i := \ell(f_i) \in A$. Then by (3.9.3) $a_{i+1} \mid a_i$ for $i \geq N$ as elements of A . Therefore we have an increasing sequence of principal ideals

$$(a_N) \subseteq (a_{N+1}) \subseteq \dots$$

which by hypothesis stabilizes, that is $a_i \sim a_j$ for all $i, j \geq M$ for some $M \geq N$. For $i \geq M$ we have $ua_i = a_{i+1}$, consider $uf_i - f_{i+1} \in (f_i)$. This has degree strictly smaller than N , and therefore by minimality must be 0. In particular $f_i \sim f_{i+1}$ and $(f_i) = (f_{i+1})$. $\square$

Lemma 3.16.28

Suppose $p \in A$ is prime, then it is prime as an element of $A[X]$.

Lemma 3.16.29 (Nagata's Criterion)

Let A be a ring and S a multiplicative subset generated by prime elements and units. Let $f \in A$ be irreducible or a unit, then

- a) $\frac{f}{1}$ is irreducible or a unit in $S^{-1}A$
- b) $\frac{f}{1}$ prime or a unit in $S^{-1}A \implies f$ is a prime or a unit in A .

Furthermore if $S^{-1}A$ is AP then so is A .

Proof. Note the condition on S means every $a \in S$ satisfies $a \sim p_1 \dots p_r$ for primes $p_i \in A$.

- a) Suppose $\frac{f}{1} = \frac{g}{a} \frac{h}{b}$ for $f, g, h \in A$ and $a, b \in S$, then $abf = gh$. Further $ab \sim p_1 \dots p_r$. Then $p_i \mid a$ or $p_i \mid b$, whence we can find $f \sim g'h'$ where $g = cg'$, $h = dh'$ and $c, d \in S$. As f is irreducible (or a unit), then for example g' is invertible, in which case $\frac{g}{a} = \frac{cg'}{a}$ is invertible. Therefore $\frac{f}{1}$ is either irreducible or a unit.
- b) The case f a unit is clear, so assume that f is irreducible. Suppose $\frac{f}{1}$ is prime or a unit and $f \mid gh$. Then $\frac{f}{1} \mid \frac{g}{1} \frac{h}{1}$ and for example $\frac{f}{1} \mid \frac{g}{1}$. Therefore $ff' = gp_1 \dots p_r$ for some $f' \in A$ and $p_1, \dots, p_r \in A$ prime. If $p_i \mid f$ for some i then by irreducibility we have $p_i \sim f$, and we see that f is prime. Otherwise $p_i \mid f'$ for all i and we find $f \mid g$. Therefore f is prime as required.

The last statement follows immediately from the previous two results. $\square$

3.16.1 Polynomial Ring is a UFD

We prove the following result, first by Nagata's Criterion and again by Gauss' Lemma.

Proposition 3.16.30

Suppose A is a UFD, then so is $A[X]$.

Proof. By (3.16.21) we need to show that $A[X]$ satisfies ACCP and is AP. The first follows from (3.16.27).

Let $S = A \setminus \{0\}$ the set of non-zero elements. Let $K = \text{Frac}(A)$. If we regard $A[X]$ as a subring of $K[X]$ then we claim $S^{-1}(A[X]) = K[X]$; this follows by multiplying an element of $K[X]$ by the product of denominators of all the coefficients. Furthermore as A is a UFD (and by (3.16.21)) S is generated by prime elements and units. By (3.16.23) $K[X]$ is a UFD, and so in particular is AP. Therefore by (3.16.29) $A[X]$ is AP as required. $\square$

For Gauss' Lemma we require to introduce some notation first.

Definition 3.16.31 (Primitive polynomials)

Let A be a UFD, $K := \text{Frac}(A)$ and $f \in K[X]$ a polynomial given by

$$f(X) = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i X^i$$

Define the **content** of f by

$$c(f) = \prod_{p \in \mathcal{P}} p^{\min_i v_p(a_i)} \in K^\star$$

where the product is taken over a representative set of primes for A . Changing the set of representatives only changes the value of $c(f)$ by multiplication of a unit.

We say that f is **primitive** precisely when $c(f) = 1$

Lemma 3.16.32 (Gauss' Lemma I)

Let A be a UFD and $f \in K[X]$ where $K = \text{Frac}(A)$. Then the content $c(f)$ satisfies the following properties

- a) $f \in A[X] \iff c(f) \in A$
- b) f is primitive $\iff \min_i v_p(a_i) = 0 \quad \forall p$ prime and in this case $f \in A[X]$
- c) $c(\lambda f) = \lambda c(f)$ for $\lambda \in K^\star$ up to multiplication by a unit in A
- d) $f/c(f) \in A[X]$ is primitive
- e) f, g primitive $\implies fg$ primitive
- f) $c(fg) = c(f)c(g)$ for all $f, g \in K[X]$

Proof. We prove each in turn

- a) $f \in A[X] \iff a_i \in A \quad \forall i \stackrel{(3.16.26)}{\iff} v_p(a_i) \geq 0 \quad \forall i \quad \forall p \in \mathcal{P} \iff \min_i v_p(a_i) \geq 0 \quad \forall p \in \mathcal{P} \stackrel{(3.16.26)}{\iff} c(f) \in A$
- b) $c(f) = 1 \iff v_p(c(f)) = 0 \quad \forall p \iff \min_i v_p(a_i) = 0 \quad \forall p$. Further $v_p(a_i) \geq 0$ whence $f \in A[X]$ by (3.16.26).
- c) Note $v_p(\lambda a_i) = v_p(\lambda) + v_p(a_i) \implies v_p(c(\lambda f)) = \min_i v_p(\lambda a_i) = v_p(\lambda) + \min_i v_p(a_i) = v_p(\lambda) + v_p(c(f))$. Whence by (3.16.26) we see $c(\lambda f)$ and $\lambda c(f)$ are equal up to multiplication by a unit in A .
- d) Clear by b).
- e) Consider p prime and the reduction $\bar{\cdot} : A[X] \rightarrow (A/(p))[X]$. Then by assumption $\bar{f}$ and $\bar{g}$ are non-zero. Furthermore $(A/(p))[X]$ is an integral domain so that $\bar{f} \cdot \bar{g} = \overline{f \cdot g} \neq 0$. Therefore p does not divide all the coefficients of $f \cdot g$. As p was arbitrary this shows that $f \cdot g$ is primitive.
- f) We may reduce to e) by dividing by the content.

□

Lemma 3.16.33 (Gauss' Lemma II)

Let A be a UFD and $f \in A[X]$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) f is irreducible in $A[X]$
- b) f is an irreducible element of A or (f is primitive and irreducible in $K[X]$)

where $K = \text{Frac}(A)$.

In particular if $f \in K[X]$ is irreducible then $f/c(f)$ is irreducible in $A[X]$.

Proof. b) $\implies$ a). It's clear that an irreducible element of A remains irreducible in $A[X]$. Suppose $0 \neq f \in A[X]$ is primitive and irreducible in $K[X]$. Then as $f \notin K[X]^\star$ we have $\deg(f) > 0$. Suppose $f = gh$ in $A[X]$ then by irreducibility $\deg(g) = 0$ or $\deg(h) = 0$. Further $1 = c(f) = c(g)c(h)$ by Gauss' Lemma, so one of h and g must lie in $A^\star = A[X]^\star$. Therefore f is irreducible in $A[X]$ as required.

a) $\implies$ b). If $\deg(f) = 0$ then clearly f is an irreducible element of A . So assume $\deg(f) > 0$. Observe $f = c(f) \cdot (f/c(f))$ so by irreducibility we require $c(f) = 1$ and therefore f is primitive. Suppose $f = gh$ in $K[X]$ then $1 = c(g)c(h)$ and therefore

$$f = \frac{g}{c(g)} \frac{h}{c(h)}$$

is a decomposition in $A[X]$ which shows one of g, h has degree 0. Therefore f is irreducible in $K[X]$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.16.34

Let A be a UFD. Then so is $A[X]$.

Proof. For $0 \neq f \in A[X]$ we may use irreducible factorisation in $K[X]$ to find

$$f = \lambda \pi_1 \dots \pi_n$$

where $\lambda \in K$ and $\pi_i \in K[X]$ are irreducible. Replace $\pi_i \rightarrow \pi_i/c(\pi_i)$ then may assume that π_i are irreducible in $A[X]$ by (3.16.33). Furthermore

$$c(f) = \lambda c(\pi_1) \dots c(\pi_n) = \lambda$$

which shows $\lambda \in A$. As A is a UFD then λ may be decomposed into irreducibles of A , which by (3.16.33) are irreducible in $A[X]$. Therefore $A[X]$ is atomic.

Suppose that $f \in A[X]$ is irreducible we require to show it is prime. The case $\deg(f) = 0$ follows from the AP property of A , so assume $\deg(f) > 0$. Suppose $f \mid gh$ then as $K[X]$ is a UFD we see that, without loss of generality, $qf = g$ for $q \in K[X]$. Then $c(qf) = c(q)c(f) = c(q) = c(g) \in A$, so $q \in A[X]$ by (3.16.32) and we see $f \mid g$ in $A[X]$. This shows that $A[X]$ is AP and therefore a UFD by (3.16.21). $\square$

Corollary 3.16.35

Suppose A is a UFD. Then $A[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ is a UFD.

3.17 Cayley-Hamilton Theorem

Definition 3.17.1 (Characteristic Polynomial of a Matrix)

For a matrix $E \in \text{Mat}_n(A)$ define the characteristic polynomial by

$$P_E(X) := \det(X \cdot I_n - E)$$

working in $\text{Mat}_n(A[X])$. This is a monic polynomial in $A[X]$ and satisfies $P_E(X) = P_{E^t}(X)$ (3.6.20).

Definition 3.17.2 (Characteristic Polynomial of an endomorphism of a free module)

Let M be a finite free A -module. Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a basis for M , $\phi : M \rightarrow M$ an A -module endomorphism and $[\phi]$ the matrix representation of ϕ with respect to $\mathcal{B}$. Define the characteristic polynomial of ϕ by

$$P_\phi(X) := P_{[\phi]}(X)$$

This is independent of the basis $\mathcal{B}$ by (3.6.20).

Lemma 3.17.3

Suppose $M = \langle m_1, \dots, m_n \rangle$ is a finitely generated A -module and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ an ideal, then

$$\mathfrak{a}M = \mathfrak{a}m_1 + \dots + \mathfrak{a}m_n$$

That is every $m \in \mathfrak{a}M$ may be written as

$$m = \sum_{i=1}^n a_i m_i \quad \text{for some } a_i \in \mathfrak{a}$$

Proof. By hypothesis

$$m = \sum_{j=1}^n b_j m'_j \quad \text{for some } m'_j \in M, b_j \in \mathfrak{a}$$

Furthermore by the finite-generation hypothesis for $j = 1 \dots n$

$$m'_j = \sum_{i=1}^n c_{ji} m_i \quad \text{for some } c_{ji} \in A.$$

Therefore

$$m = \sum_{i=1}^n \left(\sum_{j=1}^n b_j c_{ji} \right) m_i$$

whence $a_i := \sum_{j=1}^n b_j c_{ji}$ lie in $\mathfrak{a}$ and give the required coefficients. □

Theorem 3.17.4 (Cayley-Hamilton)

Let M be a finitely generated A -module and $\phi \in \text{End}_A(M)$. Then there exists a monic polynomial $P(X) \in A[X]$ such that $P(\phi) = 0$.

This may be strengthened in the following ways

- a) If M is a finite free A -module then P may be taken to be the characteristic polynomial $P_\phi(X)$.
- b) If $\phi(M) \subseteq \mathfrak{a}M$ for some ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$, then the non-leading coefficients of $P(X)$ may be chosen to be in $\mathfrak{a}$.

Proof. First since $\text{End}_A(M)$ is an A -algebra there is a canonical evaluation morphism

$$\text{ev}_\phi : A[X] \rightarrow \text{End}_A(M)$$

and the meaning of $P(\phi)$ is simply $\text{ev}_\phi(P)$.

Let $\{m_1, \dots, m_n\}$ be a generating set, then by definition

$$\phi(m_i) = \sum_{j=1}^n E_{ij} m_j \quad i = 1 \dots n$$

for some $E \in \text{Mat}_n(A)$. Consider the matrix

$$B(X) = XI_n - E \in \text{Mat}_n(A[X])$$

Then we may define $B(\phi) := B(X)^{\text{ev } \phi} \in \text{Mat}_n(\text{End}_A(M))$ pointwise, so given by

$$B(\phi)_{ij} = \delta_{ij}\phi - E_{ij}1_M \quad i, j = 1 \dots n$$

By definition

$$\sum_j B(\phi)_{ij}m_j = \phi(m_i) - \sum_{ij} E_{ij}m_j = 0$$

Formally we have a group action

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mat}_n(\text{End}_A(M)) \times M^n &\rightarrow M^n \\ F \cdot \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ \vdots \\ x_n \end{pmatrix} &\rightarrow \begin{pmatrix} \sum_{j=1}^n F_{1j}(x_j) \\ \vdots \\ \sum_{j=1}^n F_{nj}(x_j) \end{pmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

such that $(EF)v = E(Fv)$ (check). And we have shown that

$$B(\phi) \begin{pmatrix} m_1 \\ \vdots \\ m_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

Using (3.6.21), premultiply by the adjugate matrix to show that

$$\det(B(\phi))I_n \begin{pmatrix} m_1 \\ \vdots \\ m_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

and $\det(B(\phi)) \in \text{End}_A(M)$ annihilates $m_1, \dots, m_n$ and therefore M .

Finally we claim that $P(X) := \det(B(X)) \in A[X]$ is a suitable monic polynomial. We see that

$$P(\phi) := \text{ev}_\phi(\det(B(X))) = \det(B(X)^{\text{ev } \phi}) = \det(B(\phi)) = 0$$

When M is a finite free A -module then we may choose $\{m_1, \dots, m_n\}$ to be a basis, and then the matrix E equals $[\phi]^T$ as required.

Finally when $\phi(M) \subseteq \mathfrak{a}M$ then (3.17.3) shows we may choose the coefficients E_{ij} to be in $\mathfrak{a}$. It's clear that $P(X)$ then has non-leading coefficients in $\mathfrak{a}$. $\square$

3.17.1 The $A[X]$ -module associated to an endomorphism

Proposition 3.17.5

Let $\phi : M \rightarrow M$ be an A -module endomorphism. Then there is a well-defined $A[X]$ -module structure defined by

$$\begin{aligned} A[X] \times M &\rightarrow M \\ (P, m) &\rightarrow P(\phi)(m) \end{aligned}$$

where $P = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i X^i$. We denote this by M_ϕ .

With this notation then ϕ is itself an $A[X]$ -module endomorphism of M_ϕ .

Proof. Let $P, Q \in A[X]$ be two polynomials. Then we need to show that

$$(PQ)(\phi) = P(\phi) \circ Q(\phi)$$

which amounts to saying that $A[X] \rightarrow \text{End}_A(M)$ is an A -algebra homomorphism.

The final statement follows because X commutes with any polynomial in $A[X]$. More explicitly

$$\phi(P \cdot m) = \phi(P(\phi)(m)) = (XP)(\phi)(m) = (PX)(\phi)(m) = P(\phi)(\phi(m)) = P \cdot (\phi(m))$$

$\square$

Proposition 3.17.6

Let M be an A -module and $\phi \in \text{End}_A(M)$. Then is an $A[X]$ -linear map

$$\begin{aligned}\tilde{\phi} : A[X] \otimes_A M &\rightarrow M_\phi \\ P \otimes m &\rightarrow P(\phi)(m)\end{aligned}$$

and similarly

$$\begin{aligned}1 \otimes \phi : A[X] \otimes_A M &\rightarrow A[X] \otimes_A M \\ P \otimes m &\rightarrow P \otimes (\phi(m))\end{aligned}$$

Proof. By the universal property $\tilde{\phi}$ exists and is A -linear. To show it is $A[X]$ -linear observe that

$$\tilde{\phi}(Q(P \otimes m)) = \tilde{\phi}((QP) \otimes m) = (QP)(\phi)(m) = Q(\phi)(P(\phi)(m)) = Q \cdot P(\phi)(m) = Q \cdot \tilde{\phi}(P \otimes m)$$

and so the result follows by linearity.

The second exists by (3.5.17). □

Proposition 3.17.7

Let M be a finite free A -module and $\phi \in \text{End}_A(M)$. Then the characteristic polynomial $P_\phi(X)$ equals the determinant of the $A[X]$ -linear map

$$(X - 1 \otimes \phi) : A[X] \otimes_A M \rightarrow A[X] \otimes_A M$$

Furthermore

$$P_\phi(X) = X^n + \sum_{j=1}^n (-1)^j \text{Tr}(L_a^j(\phi)) X^{n-j}$$

and in particular

$$P_\phi(X) = X^n - \text{Tr}(\phi)X^{n-1} + \dots + (-1)^n \det(\phi)$$

Proof. Let $\mathcal{B} := \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ be a basis for M , then by (3.5.24) $\{1 \otimes v_1, \dots, 1 \otimes v_n\}$ is an $A[X]$ -basis for $A[X] \otimes_A M$. Let $E = [\phi]$ be the matrix associated to the basis $\mathcal{B}$ then by definition

$$\phi(v_i) = \sum_{j=1}^n E_{ji} v_j$$

and

$$(X - 1 \otimes \phi)(1 \otimes v_i) = X \otimes v_i - 1 \otimes \phi(v_i) = X(1 \otimes v_i) - \sum_{j=1}^n E_{ji}(1 \otimes v_j)$$

This shows that

$$[X - 1 \otimes \phi]_{ij} = X\delta_{ij} - E_{ij}$$

and so $P_\phi(X) = \det(XI_n - E) = \det(X - 1 \otimes \phi)$ as required.

Then by (3.6.31) we have

$$P_\phi(X) = X^n + \sum_{j=1}^n (-1)^j \text{Tr} L_a^j(1 \otimes \phi) X^{n-j}$$

The matrix of $1 \otimes \phi$ coincides with that of ϕ and so we deduce the second relationship. The final statement follows from (...). □

3.18 Fields and Galois Theory

3.18.1 Prime Fields

Recall that for p prime the quotient ring $\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$ is a field (3.15.3), (3.16.22), (3.4.59).

Definition 3.18.1 (Finite field of order p)

Denote by $\mathbb{F}_p$ the field $\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$ of order p .

Definition 3.18.2 (Rational Integers)

We denote by $\mathbb{Q}$ the field of **rational numbers** defined to be the quotient field of the integers, $\text{Frac}(\mathbb{Z})$ (see (3.7.6)).

Definition 3.18.3 (Prime Field)

We say that a field k is a **prime field** if it is isomorphic to one of $\mathbb{F}_p$ or $\mathbb{Q}$.

Note none of these fields are mutually isomorphic by considering cardinalities.

Proposition 3.18.4 (Prime Subfield Exists)

Let k be a field. Then k contains a **prime subfield**. It is the smallest subfield contained in k .

Proof. By (...) there is a unique ring homomorphism

$$\phi : \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow k$$

As k is not the zero-ring then $\phi(1) = 1 \neq 0$ and $\ker(\phi)$ is a proper ideal. Then $\text{Im}(\phi)$ is an integral domain by (3.4.9). By (3.4.57) $\mathbb{Z}/\ker(\phi) \cong \text{Im}(\phi)$ and therefore by (3.4.59) $\ker(\phi) =: \mathfrak{p}$ is a prime ideal.

By (3.15.3) the ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ is principal. Suppose $\mathfrak{p} = (0)$. By (3.7.5) ϕ extends to a homomorphism $\phi' : \mathbb{Q} \rightarrow k$ whose kernel is zero and therefore injective (...). In particular $\text{Im}(\phi')$ is a prime subfield being isomorphic to $\mathbb{Q}$.

Otherwise by (3.16.9) $\mathfrak{p} = (p)$ for p a prime number and we have already observed that $\mathbb{F}_p = \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z} \cong \text{Im}(\phi)$ is a prime subfield.

Let k' be any subfield of k , then by induction we may show that $\text{Im}(\phi) \subset k'$. In the case $\ker(\phi) = \{0\}$ then we may also show $\text{Im}(\phi') \subset k'$. Therefore k' contains the prime subfield, whence it is the smallest subfield. $\square$

Definition 3.18.5 (Characteristic)

Let k be a field. Then we define the **characteristic** of k to be p if the prime subfield is isomorphic to $\mathbb{F}_p$ or 0 if the prime subfield is isomorphic to $\mathbb{Q}$. This is denoted $\text{char}(k)$.

If A is a k -algebra then we define the characteristic of A to be that of k . We also define the **characteristic exponent** of A to be

$$\begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } \text{char}(A) = 0 \\ p & \text{if } \text{char}(A) = p \end{cases}$$

Proposition 3.18.6 (Frobenius Homomorphism)

Let A be a k -algebra and suppose $\text{char}(A) = p$. Then the mapping

$$a \rightarrow a^p$$

is a ring homomorphism which we call the **Frobenius map**. In particular

$$(a + b)^p = a^p + b^p \quad \forall a, b \in A$$

Definition 3.18.7

Let A be a k -algebra with characteristic exponent p . We say that A is **perfect** if A is reduced and $A^p = A$. When $p > 1$ this is equivalent to the Frobenius homomorphism being an isomorphism.

3.18.2 Field Extensions

Definition 3.18.8 (Field Extension)

Let k be a field. A field extension K/k is a k -algebra K which is also a field. Every field K is an extension over its prime subfield (or, over $\mathbb{Q}$ or $\mathbb{F}_p$).

We typically denote the structural morphism by $i_{kK} : k \rightarrow K$, and it is automatically injective (3.4.61). We may write $(K/k, i_{kK})$ if we need to stress the relevance of the structural morphism to the argument.

These objects form a category $\mathbf{Field}_k$ in the obvious way. The morphisms may be called k -embeddings and we denote them by

$$\text{Mor}_k(K, L) := \{\psi : K \rightarrow L \mid \psi \circ i_{kK} = i_{kL}\}$$

and the set of automorphisms by

$$\text{Aut}(K/k).$$

Observe every extension K/k may be viewed as a k -vector space so we define the degree of an extension field to be the vector space dimension

$$[K : k] := \dim_k K$$

Definition 3.18.9 (Finite field extension)

A field extension K/k is finite if $[K : k] < \infty$

Definition 3.18.10 (Tower of Field Extensions)

We may also consider a “tower” of extensions

$$K_n / \dots / K_0 = k$$

with embeddings $i_{K_i K_{i+1}} : K_i \rightarrow K_{i+1}$, with the picture that these usually correspond to inclusions. We may consider an extension K_i/K_j for $j < i$. Typically if we have a family of morphisms

$$\sigma_i : K_i \rightarrow M$$

they would commute with these embeddings. In particular we may abuse notation by defining $\sigma_i|_{K_j} = \sigma_i \circ i_{K_{i-1} K_i} \circ \dots \circ i_{K_j K_{j+1}}$.

Proposition 3.18.11

Let K/k be a finite field extension and V a finite-dimensional vector space over K . Then V is naturally a finite-dimensional k -vector space with

$$\dim_k V = [K : k] \dim_K V$$

More precisely if K/k has basis $\{\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_r\}$ and V has K -basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$, then the following is a k -basis for V

$$\{\lambda_i v_j\}_{i,j}.$$

Proposition 3.18.12

Let L/K and K/k be two finite extensions with basis $\{l_1, \dots, l_n\}$ and $\{k_1, \dots, k_m\}$. Then L/k has basis $\{l_i k_j\}_{i,j}$. In particular

$$[L : k] = [L : K][K : k]$$

Corollary 3.18.13

Let $K = K_n / \dots / K_0 = k$ be a tower of finite extensions then

$$[K : k] = \prod_{i=1}^n [K_i : K_{i-1}]$$

Lemma 3.18.14

Let K/k be a field extension and $f, g \in k[X]$. Then $g \mid f$ in $k[X]$ if and only if $i_{kK}(g) \mid i_{kK}(f)$.

Proof. One implication is obvious. For the converse we assume wlog that $k \subset K$ and suppose $f = gh$ for $h \in K[X]$. We may apply the division algorithm (3.18.36) in $k[X]$ to find $f = gq + r$ for $q, r \in k[X]$ and $\deg(r) < \deg(g)$. Then $r = g(h - q)$ and comparing degrees we conclude that $h = q$ and $r = 0$. This shows $f = gq$ and $g \mid f$ as elements of $k[X]$. $\square$

Definition 3.18.15 (Evaluation homomorphism)

Let K/k be a field extension and $\alpha \in K$. There is a canonical homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \text{ev}_\alpha : k[X] &\rightarrow K \\ \sum_{i=0}^n a_i X^i &\rightarrow \sum_{i=0}^n i_{kK}(a_i) \alpha^i \end{aligned}$$

which we write as $f(\alpha)$. We say $\alpha \in K$ is a root of $f(X)$ if $f(\alpha) = 0$.

Proposition 3.18.16 (Morphisms commute with evaluation)

Let $\sigma : K/k \rightarrow L/k$ be a morphism of field extensions then

$$\sigma(p(\alpha)) = p(\sigma(\alpha))$$

for all $p \in k[X]$. In particular α is a root of $p \iff \sigma(\alpha)$ is a root of p .

Proof. This is just a specific case of (3.9.7), The last statement is obvious, because σ is injective (3.4.61). $\square$

Definition 3.18.17 (Subalgebra generated by a set)

Let K/k be a field extension and $S \subset K$. Define

$$k[S] := \bigcap_{\substack{A \subset K/k \\ S \subset A}} A$$

where the intersection is taken over all k -subalgebras. It is the smallest k -subalgebra of K/k .

Proposition 3.18.18 (Subalgebra generated by directed family)

Let K/k be a field extension and $\{S_i\}_{i \in I}$ a family of directed subsets of K . Then

$$k\left[\bigcup_{i \in I} S_i\right] = \bigcup_{i \in I} k[S_i]$$

In particular for any set S we have

$$k[S] = \bigcup_{\substack{S' \subset S \\ S' \text{ finite}}} k[S']$$

Proposition 3.18.19 (Subalgebra generated by a set)

Let K/k be a field extension and $S \subset K$ a finite subset. Write $S = \{\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n\}$ then

$$k[S] = \{p(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n) \mid p \in k[X_1, \dots, X_n]\} = \text{Im}(\text{ev}_\alpha)$$

Lemma 3.18.20 (Trivial result)

For $S, T \subset K/k$ finite

- $S \subset T \implies k[S] \subseteq k[T]$
- $k[S][T] = k[S \cup T]$

Definition 3.18.21

Let K/k be a field extension and $S \subset K$. Define

$$k(S) := \bigcap_{\substack{K' \subset K/k \\ S \subset K'}} K'$$

It is the smallest subfield of K/k containing S .

Proposition 3.18.22

Let K/k be a field extension and $\{S_i\}_{i \in I}$ be a family of directed subsets of K . Then

$$k\left(\bigcup_{i \in I} S_i\right) = \bigcup_{i \in I} k(S_i)$$

In particular for any set S we have

$$k(S) = \bigcup_{\substack{S' \subset S \\ S' \text{ finite}}} k(S')$$

Proposition 3.18.23

Let K/k be a field extension and $S \subset K$ be a finite subset. Write $S = \{\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n\}$ then

$$k(S) := \left\{ \frac{p(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n)}{q(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n)} \mid p, q \in k[X_1, \dots, X_n], q(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n) \neq 0 \right\}$$

Lemma 3.18.24 (Trivial result)

For $S, T \subset K/k$

- $S \subset T \implies k(S) \subseteq k(T)$
- $k(S)(T) = k(S \cup T)$

Lemma 3.18.25

If $S \subset K$ and $k[S]$ is a field then $k[S] = k(S)$

Proof. Generically $k[S] \subset k(S)$ from the definition. As $k[S]$ is a field then $k(S) \subset k[S]$. □

Lemma 3.18.26 (Image of f.g. field extension)

Let K/k be a field extension and $S \subset K$ a subset. If $\sigma : K/k \rightarrow L/k$ is a morphism then

$$\sigma(k(S)) = k(\sigma(S))$$

Proposition 3.18.27 (Uniqueness of morphisms on a generating set)

Let K/k be a field extension and $S \subset K$. If $\sigma, \sigma' : k(S)/k \rightarrow L/k$ are morphisms of field extensions such that $\sigma|_S = \sigma'|_S$. Then $\sigma = \sigma'$.

Definition 3.18.28 (Simple (Algebraic) Extension)

A field extension K/k is **simple** if $K = k(\{\alpha\}) =: k(\alpha)$ for some $\alpha \in K$. It is a **simple algebraic** extension if α is also algebraic over k .

Definition 3.18.29 (Algebraic Element)

We say an element $\alpha \in K/k$ is **algebraic** if it is a root of a polynomial $f \in k[X]$ (i.e. α is **integral**, since we can always ensure f is monic). Otherwise we say that $x \in K$ is **transcendental**.

We say K/k is an **algebraic extension** if every element $\alpha \in K$ is algebraic over k .

Proposition 3.18.30 (Finite $\implies$ algebraic)

A finite extension K/k is algebraic.

Proof. Suppose $n = \dim_k K$. The set $\{1, \alpha, \alpha^2, \dots, \alpha^n\}$ is linearly dependent by (2.3.12). Therefore there is a non-zero polynomial with α as a root. □

Proposition 3.18.31 (Endomorphisms are automorphisms)

Let $\sigma \in \text{Mor}_k(K, K)$ be an endomorphism of an algebraic extension. Then it is an isomorphism. In other words

$$\text{Mor}_k(K, K) = \text{Aut}(K/k)$$

Proof. As field morphisms are injective (3.4.61) we only need to show that σ is surjective. Given $\alpha \in K$ let T denote the set of roots of $m_\alpha \in k[X]$ in K . Note by (3.18.41) T is finite. Further by (3.18.16) σ maps T to itself. Since σ is injective it is also surjective on T . In particular α is in the image of σ as required. □

3.18.3 Polynomials

In this section we consider the polynomial ring with coefficients in a field, $k[X]$.

Proposition 3.18.32

Degree is multiplicative in the sense $0 \neq f, g$ we have

$$\deg(fg) = \deg(f) + \deg(g)$$

In particular $f \mid g \implies \deg(f) \leq \deg(g)$.

Proposition 3.18.33

The units of $k[X]$ are precisely the non-zero polynomials of degree 0.

Proposition 3.18.34 (Associate polynomials)

The following are equivalent for $0 \neq f, g$

- $f \sim g$
- $f = \lambda g$ for $\lambda \neq 0$
- $f \mid g$ and $g \mid f$

Proposition 3.18.35

A polynomial $f \in k[X]$ is *associate* to precisely one monic polynomial g . If f is *irreducible* so is g .

Proof. **TODO** □

Proposition 3.18.36 (Division Algorithm over a field)

For k a field consider the polynomial ring $k[X]$. For every pair of polynomials $f(X)$, $g(X)$ there exists unique polynomials $q(X)$ and $r(X)$ such that

$$f(X) = q(X)g(X) + r(X)$$

and $\deg(r) < \deg(g)$.

Proof. Apply (3.9.9) to $g/\ell(g)$, and multiply by $\ell(g)$ again. □

Proposition 3.18.37 (Polynomial ring is a PID)

Let k be a field, then $k[X]$ is a *PID*, and therefore a *Noetherian UFD*.

Proof. Let $(0) \neq \mathfrak{a}$ be an ideal and let $f \in \mathfrak{a}$ be a polynomial of minimal degree. We may assume it is monic. Any $g \in \mathfrak{a}$ may be represented as $f = qg + r$ by the division algorithm. Clearly $r \in \mathfrak{a}$, therefore by minimality $r = 0$, whence $g \in (f)$. □

Proposition 3.18.38 (Unique Factorisation of Polynomials)

For the ring $k[X]$ the set of irreducible monic polynomials constitutes a representative set (Definition (3.16.24)). Therefore we have a unique factorization

$$f = \ell(f) \prod_{p \text{ irreducible monic}} p^{v_p(f)}$$

such that

$$v_p(fg) = v_p(f) + v_p(g)$$

Proof. (3.18.35) shows that the irreducible monic polynomials constitute a representative set. Therefore the result follows from (3.16.26). Let u be the unit appearing in the factorization, it must be an element of k . Compare leading coefficients to see that $u = \ell(f)$. □

Lemma 3.18.39 (Roots and Multiplicity)

For $f \in k[X]$ a non-constant polynomial and $\alpha \in k$ we have

$$f(\alpha) = 0 \iff (X - \alpha) \mid f \iff v_{(X-\alpha)}(f) > 0$$

In this case $r := v_{(X-\alpha)}(f)$ is the multiplicity of the root α , and observe

$$f(X) = \ell(f)(X - \alpha)^r g(X)$$

with $g(\alpha) \neq 0$ (equivalently $v_{(X-\alpha)}(g) = 0$).

Proof. The right to left implication is obvious. Conversely by the division algorithm we may write

$$f(X) = f(\alpha) + (X - \alpha)Q(X)$$

Then if $f(\alpha) = 0$ we clearly have $v_{(X-\alpha)}(f) > 0$. Finally we may construct

$$g(X) = \prod_{p \neq (X-\alpha)} p^{v_p(f)}$$

It's clear that for every p appearing in the product $p(\alpha) \neq 0$ because otherwise we would have $(X - \alpha) \mid p$ and by irreducibility $(X - \alpha) = p$. Therefore $g(\alpha) \neq 0$ as required. □

Definition 3.18.40 (Splitting Polynomial)

Let K/k be a field extension and $f \in k[X]$. By abuse of notation we may also identify f with its image in $K[X]$. We say a polynomial f **splits completely** in K if the irreducible factorization of f in $K[X]$ is

$$f = \ell(f) \prod_{i=1}^n (X - \alpha_i)^{r_i}$$

where α_i are the distinct roots of f in K and $r_i := v_{(X-\alpha_i)}(f^i)$ are the multiplicities. Equivalently f splits in K if

$$p \in K[X] \text{ irreducible} \wedge \deg(p) > 1 \implies v_p(f) = 0 \quad (3.3)$$

Observe that the number of roots counting multiplicities is $\deg(f)$

$$\deg(f) = \sum_{i=1}^n v_{(X-\alpha_i)}(f)$$

Corollary 3.18.41

A polynomial f has at most $\deg(f)$ roots

Corollary 3.18.42

Let K/k be a field extension and $f \in k[X]$. Suppose $g \mid f$ and f splits completely in K . Then so does g .

Proof. By assumption the irreducible factorization of f consists of polynomials of degree 1. Consider the irreducible factorization of $g = \prod_{i=1}^n g_i$, then by unique factorization (3.18.38) each g_i must appear in the factorization of f , that is to say g splits completely. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.43 (Formal derivative)

Let k be a field. Then there exists a unique k -vector space homomorphism

$$(-)' : k[X] \rightarrow k[X]$$

such that

$$(X^r)' = \begin{cases} 0 & r = 0 \\ rX^{r-1} & r > 0 \end{cases}$$

It satisfies the product rule

$$(fg)' = f'g + fg'$$

for all $f, g \in k[X]$. Define recursively $f^{(0)} = f$ and $f^{(n)} := f^{(n-1)'}.$

Proof. The monomials $\{1, X, X^2, \dots\}$ form a k -basis of $k[X]$, so $(-)'$ exists and is unique.

Suppose $f(X) = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i X^i$ and $g(X) = \sum_{i=0}^m b_i X^i$. Then

$$(fg)(X) = \sum_{i=0}^{n+m} \left(\sum_{k+l=i} a_k b_l \right) X^i$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} f'(X) &= \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} (i+1)a_{i+1}X^i \\ g'(X) &= \sum_{i=0}^{m-1} (i+1)b_{i+1}X^i \\ (fg)'(X) &= \sum_{i=0}^{n+m-1} (i+1) \left(\sum_{k+l=i+1} a_k b_l \right) X^i \\ &= \sum_{i=0}^{n+m-1} \left(\sum_{k+l=i+1} (k+l)a_k b_l \right) X^i \\ &+ \sum_{i=0}^{n+m-1} \left(\sum_{k+l=i} (k+1)a_{k+1} b_l \right) X^i + \sum_{i=0}^{n+m-1} \left(\sum_{k+l=i} (l+1)a_k b_{l+1} \right) X^i \\ &= f'(X)g(X) + f(X)g'(X) \end{aligned}$$

$\square$

Proposition 3.18.44 (Criteria for Multiple Roots)

Let $f(X) \in k[X]$ be a polynomial, r a positive integer and suppose that either $\text{char}(k) = 0$ or $r < \text{char}(k)$. Then $\alpha \in k$ is a root of f with *multiplicity* r precisely when

$$f(\alpha) = f^{(1)}(\alpha) = \dots = f^{(r-1)}(\alpha) = 0$$

and $f^{(r)}(\alpha) \neq 0$.

Therefore the multiple roots are precisely the common roots of $f(X)$ and $f'(X)$ (irrespective of the characteristic).

Proof. Note that by (3.18.39) and (3.18.43)

$$f^{(1)}(X) = (X - \alpha)^{r-1}[rg(X) + (X - \alpha)g'(X)]$$

with $g(\alpha) \neq 0$ and r the multiplicity of the root. If $r = 1$, then $f^{(1)}(\alpha) = g(\alpha) \neq 0$ as required. If $r > 1$, then $f^{(1)}(X)$ has α as a root of multiplicity $r - 1$, so it follows by induction.

The second statement is simply the case $r = 1$. □

Definition 3.18.45 (Separable Polynomial)

A polynomial $f \in k[X]$ is **separable** if f and f' are *co-maximal*, that is $(f, f') = (1)$. Otherwise it is **inseparable**.

Proposition 3.18.46

A *separable* polynomial $f \in k[X]$ has no multiple roots (and f and f' have no common roots) in any extension field K/k .

Proof. Since $(f, f') = (1)$ we have $af + bf' = 1$ for some $a, b \in k[X]$. Clearly f and f' can have no common roots, and therefore f has no multiple roots by (3.18.44). □

Proposition 3.18.47

Suppose $f, g \in k[X]$, g is separable and $f \mid g$, then f is separable.

Proof. Suppose f is not separable then by (3.15.5) f and f' have a common divisor d such that $\deg(d) > 0$. Since $g = fh$, so $g' = f'h + fh'$. Therefore d is also a non-trivial common divisor of g and g' contradicting (3.15.5). □

We can provide a partial converse to (3.18.46) by working in a large enough extension field

Proposition 3.18.48 (Separability)

Let K/k be a field extension and $f \in k[X]$ a polynomial which splits completely in K . Then TFAE

- a) f is separable
- b) f has no multiple roots in K
- c) f and f' have no common roots in K
- d) f has $\deg(f)$ distinct roots in K

Proof. Using the formula

$$\deg(f) = \sum_{i=1}^n v_{(X-\alpha_i)}(f)$$

we see easily that $d) \iff b)$. By (3.18.44) $b) \iff c)$

Proposition (3.18.46) shows that $a) \implies b)$. Conversely suppose f is not separable, then by (3.15.5) f and f' must have a non-trivial common divisor h . By (3.18.42) we see that h splits in K . Any root of h is a common root of f and f' in K , which by (3.18.44) is a multiple root of f in K . □

3.18.4 Algebraic Extensions**Proposition 3.18.49** (Minimal Polynomial)

If $\alpha \in K/k$ is algebraic then there is a unique *monic, irreducible* polynomial $m_{\alpha,k}(X) \in k[X]$ such that $m_{\alpha,k}(\alpha) = 0$. This is called the *minimal polynomial* of α over k and $(m_{\alpha,k}) = \ker(\text{ev}_\alpha)$.

In particular any polynomial $f(X) \in k[X]$ which has α as a root, satisfies $m_{\alpha,k}(X) \mid f(X)$.

Proof. Let $\mathfrak{a} = \ker(\text{ev}_\alpha)$. Since $k[X]$ is a PID it is of the form $(m_{\alpha,k})$. As α is algebraic it is non-zero. $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ cannot be a constant, and therefore is not a unit.

We claim $m_{\alpha,k}$ is irreducible. If $m_{\alpha,k}(X) = p(X)q(X)$ then p, q are non-zero and either $p(\alpha) = 0$ or $q(\alpha) = 0$. If $p(\alpha) = 0$ then $m_{\alpha,k} \mid p$. As $p \mid m_{\alpha,k}$ by (3.18.34) $m_{\alpha,k} = \lambda p$. In particular $\deg(m_{\alpha,k}(X)) = \deg(p(X))$ so $\deg(q(X)) = 0$ and $q(X)$ is a unit (3.18.33). Therefore by definition $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ is irreducible.

Dividing by the leading coefficient we may assume that this polynomial is monic. Suppose $m'(X)$ is another such irreducible monic polynomial. Then $m_\alpha \mid m'$. Since m_α is not a unit, by definition of irreducible $m' \sim m_\alpha$ whence $m' = \lambda m_\alpha$. Compare leading coefficients to find $\lambda = 1$ and $m' = m_\alpha$. $\square$

Lemma 3.18.50

Let $K/E/k$ be extensions and $\alpha \in K$ algebraic over k . Then α is algebraic over E .

Definition 3.18.51 (Conjugate elements)

Two elements $\alpha, \beta \in K$ are said to be **conjugate elements** if they have the same minimal polynomial.

NB it's necessary and sufficient that $m_{\alpha,k}(\beta) = 0$.

Proposition 3.18.52

Let $\sigma : K/k \rightarrow L/k$ be a field morphism and $\alpha \in K$. Then $m_{\alpha,k}(X) = m_{\sigma(\alpha),k}(X)$.

Proof. This follows from (3.18.16). $\square$

Given an irreducible polynomial $f \in k[X]$ it's possible to construct an extension field K/k which has at least one root, as follows.

Proposition 3.18.53 (Construct simple extension)

Let $f \in k[X]$ be an irreducible polynomial. Then (f) is maximal and $K := k[X]/(f)$ is a field extension with canonical structural morphism. Define $\alpha := X + (f)$

- $f(\alpha) = 0$
- $K = k(\alpha)$ is a simple field extension and $k(\alpha) = k[\alpha]$
- $m_\alpha = f/\ell(f)$ and $\deg(m_\alpha) = \deg(f) =: n$
- K is a finite-dimensional k -vector space with basis $\{1, \alpha, \dots, \alpha^{n-1}\}$.

Example 3.18.54

Take $k = \mathbb{R}$, $f(X) = X^2 + 1$, then $\mathbb{C}/\mathbb{R} = \mathbb{R}[i] = \mathbb{R}[X]/(X^2 + 1)$.

Proof. Consider the structural morphism $i : k \rightarrow k[X]$ and canonical surjective homomorphism

$$\pi : k[X] \rightarrow k[X]/(f)$$

and $\alpha = X + (f) = \pi(X)$. As $k[X]$ is a PID, f irreducible implies (f) maximal by (3.16.22) so K is a field by (3.4.59). The composition $\pi \circ i$ makes K into a k -algebra and hence a field extension. Furthermore π is then by definition a k -algebra homomorphism.

Since π is surjective every $\beta \in K$ is represented as $\pi(p(X)) \stackrel{(3.18.16)}{=} p(\pi(X)) = p(\alpha)$. By (3.18.19) we see $K = k[\alpha]$. Since K is a field then $K = k[\alpha] = k(\alpha)$ is simple by (3.18.25).

Similarly $f(\alpha) = f(\pi(X)) \stackrel{(3.18.16)}{=} \pi(f(X)) = 0$, so α is a root of f . By (3.18.34) $f/\ell(f)$ is irreducible and by uniqueness in (3.18.49) we have $m_\alpha = f/\ell(f)$.

Given $\beta = p(\alpha)$, the division algorithm (...) yields

$$p(X) = q(X)f(X) + r(X)$$

with $\deg(r) < \deg(f) = n$. Therefore $\beta = r(\alpha)$ and the given set is spanning. A non-trivial linear dependence yields a non-zero polynomial $g(X)$ such that $g(\alpha) = 0$ and $\deg(g) < \deg(f)$. But by definition of the minimal polynomial $m_\alpha \mid g$, which is a contradiction by comparing degrees. Therefore the given set is linearly independent and hence a basis. $\square$

Conversely any simple algebraic extension is obtained in this way, as follows

Proposition 3.18.55 (Simple extension)

Let $k(\alpha)/k$ be a simple extension. Then there is a canonical isomorphism of k -algebras

$$k[X]/(m_\alpha) \longrightarrow k(\alpha)$$

under which $X + (m_\alpha) \rightarrow \alpha$. Further $k(\alpha)$ is a finite-dimensional vector space with basis

$$\{1, \alpha, \dots, \alpha^{n-1}\}$$

where $n = \deg(m_\alpha) = [k(\alpha) : k]$ and $k(\alpha) = k[\alpha]$.

Proof. By (3.18.49), Definition (3.18.19) and (3.4.57) there is a canonical isomorphism $k[X]/(m_\alpha) \rightarrow k[\alpha]$ of k -algebras induced by the evaluation homomorphism $\text{ev}_\alpha : k[X] \rightarrow K$. (3.18.53) shows that the image of this isomorphism, $k[\alpha]$, is a field, whence $k[\alpha] = k(\alpha)$ by (3.18.25). Since a k -algebra isomorphism is a fortiori a k -vector space isomorphism it maps a basis to a basis. The result follows from (3.18.53) as the basis thus defined is the image of the basis in the proposition under the specified isomorphism. $\square$

Definition 3.18.56 (Degree of an algebraic element)

Let K/k be an algebraic extension and $\alpha \in K$. Then define

$$\deg_k(\alpha) := \deg m_{\alpha,k} = [k(\alpha) : k]$$

We may show the following

Proposition 3.18.57 (Finitely generated by algebraic $\implies$ finite and algebraic)

Let $K = k(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n)/k$ be a field extension such that α_i is algebraic. Then K/k is a finite algebraic extension. Furthermore

$$k[\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n] = k(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n)$$

In particular a finitely-generated algebraic extension is finite.

Proof. We write $K_i = k(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_i)$. Then we have a tower

$$K = K_n / \dots / K_0 = k$$

such that $K_i = K_{i-1}(\alpha_i)$ is a simple algebraic extension. By (3.18.55) K_i/K_{i-1} is finite. Therefore by (3.18.13) K/k is finite. By (3.18.30) it's also algebraic. For the second statement we may proceed inductively. Note we have

$$k[\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_{i+1}] \stackrel{(3.18.20)}{=} k[\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_i][\alpha_{i+1}] = k(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_i)[\alpha_{i+1}] \stackrel{(3.18.55)}{=} k(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_i)(\alpha_{i+1}) \stackrel{(3.18.24)}{=} k(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_{i+1})$$

The second equality is simply the inductive hypothesis. $\square$

Corollary 3.18.58

Let K/k be a field extension then the algebraic elements form a subfield.

Proof. For any two algebraic elements $\alpha, \beta \in K$ we have $k(\alpha, \beta)$ is an algebraic extension. $\square$

The following is useful for reducing to cases of finite extensions where counting arguments work.

Lemma 3.18.59 (Reduce to finite extensions)

Let $K/E/k$ be a tower with E algebraic over k . For every $\alpha \in K$ algebraic over E , there is some subfield $E_0 \subset E$ such that

- E_0/k is finite
- α is algebraic over E_0
- $m_{\alpha,E} = m_{\alpha,E_0}$

Therefore α is algebraic over k iff it is algebraic over E and $m_{\alpha,E_0} \mid m_{\alpha,k}^{i_{k,E}}$.

Proof. Suppose

$$m_{\alpha,E}(X) = a_0 + a_1X + \dots + a_nX^n$$

Then define $E_0 = i_{k,E}(k)(a_0, \dots, a_n)$. By (3.18.57) E_0/k is finite. Clearly α is algebraic over E_0 as it is a root of $m_{\alpha,E}$. By (3.18.49) $m_{\alpha,E_0} \mid m_{\alpha,E}$ as elements of $E_0[X]$ and $m_{\alpha,E} \mid m_{\alpha,E_0}$. Therefore $m_{\alpha,E_0} = m_{\alpha,E}$.

By (3.18.55) $E_0(\alpha)/E$ is finite, therefore $E_0(\alpha)/k$ is finite. By (3.18.30) $E_0(\alpha)/k$ is algebraic, whence α is algebraic over k . The last statement follows from (3.18.49) again. $\square$

Corollary 3.18.60

K/E and E/k are both algebraic if and only if K/k is.

Proof. One direction is (3.18.50). The converse follows from the previous result. $\square$

We may prove the first lifting theorem

Proposition 3.18.61 (Lifting to simple extensions)

Let $k(\alpha)/k$ be a simple algebraic extension and L/k a field extension such that $m_{\alpha,k}$ has a root in L . Then there exists a morphism $\sigma : k(\alpha)/k \rightarrow L/k$.

More precisely there is a bijective mapping

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}_k(k(\alpha), L) &\longrightarrow \{\beta \in L \mid m_{\alpha,k}(\beta) = 0\} \\ \sigma &\longrightarrow \sigma(\alpha) \end{aligned}$$

and $\sigma(k(\alpha)) = k(\sigma(\alpha))$. In particular if $m_{\alpha,k}$ is *separable* and *splits completely* in L then there are precisely $\deg(m_{\alpha,k}) \stackrel{(3.18.55)}{=} [k(\alpha) : k]$ such extensions.

Proof. Observe $m_{\alpha,k}(\sigma(\alpha)) \stackrel{(3.18.16)}{=} \sigma(m_{\alpha,k}(\alpha)) = 0$. Therefore the mapping is well-defined. By (3.18.27) it is injective. We claim it is also surjective. By (3.18.55) there is a k -algebra isomorphism

$$k[X]/(m_{\alpha,k}) \longrightarrow k(\alpha)$$

Similarly for $\beta \in T$ there is a k -algebra isomorphism

$$k[X]/(m_{\beta,k}) \longrightarrow k(\beta)$$

We are done if $m_{\alpha,k} = m_{\beta,k}$. But $m_{\alpha,k}$ is monic, irreducible and has β as a root. So this follows from uniqueness of the minimal polynomial in (3.18.49). The final statement follows from (3.18.48) $\square$

We may use this to generalize to arbitrary extensions, but we require that the minimal polynomials split completely in order for the inductive step to work.

Proposition 3.18.62 (Generic Lifting Theorem)

Let K/k be an algebraic field extension such that $K = k(\{\alpha_i\}_{i \in I})$ and L/k a field extension such that $m_{\alpha_i,k}(X)$ splits completely in L for all $i \in I$.

Then there exists a morphism $\sigma : K/k \rightarrow L/k$.

Furthermore given $\alpha \in K$ and $\beta \in L$ any root of $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ we may choose σ such that $\sigma(\alpha) = \beta$.

Proof. If K/k is finite then we may proceed by induction on $[K : k]$, using (3.18.61) and applying a similar argument to below.

For the general case we may consider the poset of morphisms $\sigma : K'/k \rightarrow L/k$ for subfields $K'/k \subset K/k$ ordered by consistency. It is non-empty by considering $K' = i_{kK}(k)$. By Zorn's Lemma it has a maximal element, (K', σ') . It's enough to show that $K' = K$.

If $\alpha_i \in K'$ for all $i \in I$ then $K' = K$ and we are done. Otherwise choose $\alpha = \alpha_i \notin K'$. By (...) $m_{\alpha,K'}(X) \mid m_{\alpha,k}(X)$. By (3.18.42) $m_{\alpha,K'}(X)$ splits in L (because $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ does). Therefore by (3.18.61) there is a morphism $\sigma : K'(\alpha)/K' \rightarrow (L/K', \sigma')$. Note that by definition $\sigma|_{K'} = \sigma'$ and $K' \subsetneq K'(\alpha)$, contradicting maximality.

For the final part we may consider the poset consisting only of morphisms such that $\sigma(\alpha) = \beta$. By (3.18.61) the poset is non-empty, and the same argument works. $\square$

3.18.5 Galois Theory Summary**Definition 3.18.63** (Separable, Normal and Galois)

Let K/k be an algebraic extension. We say that K/k is

- **Normal** if every minimal polynomial $m_{\alpha,k} \in k[X]$ *splits completely* in K (iff every irreducible polynomial $f \in k[X]$ with at least one root in K splits completely in K)
- **Separable** if every minimal polynomial $m_{\alpha,k} \in k[X]$ is *separable*.
- **Galois** if it is both normal and separable (iff $m_{\alpha,k}$ has $\deg(m_{\alpha,k})$ distinct roots in K , see (3.18.48)).

In the case of a Galois extension we denote the group of automorphisms by $\text{Gal}(K/k)$.

To summarize the main results

- a) The group of automorphism of a normal extension K/k acts transitively on the roots of a given irreducible polynomial.
- b) For K/k finite we have $\# \text{Aut}(K/k) \leq [K : k]$ with equality if and only if K/k is Galois.
- c) An algebraic extension K/k is automatically separable whenever either $\text{char}(k) = 0$ or k is finite.
- d) When K/k is finite and Galois then we have an order-reversing bijection between subfields and subgroups

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \{H \leq \text{Gal}(K/k)\} & \longleftrightarrow & \{F \subseteq K\} \\ H & \longrightarrow & K^H := \{x \in K \mid h(x) = x \quad \forall h \in H\} \\ \text{Gal}(K/F) & \longleftarrow & F \end{array}$$

3.18.6 Splitting Fields and Algebraic Closure

In this section we discuss splitting fields, which are the “smallest” extensions in which a given set of polynomials split completely. The fundamental result is that splitting fields are precisely the Normal extensions. Further we discuss the algebraic closure, in which every polynomial splits and in which every algebraic extension (normal or otherwise) may be embedded.

Definition 3.18.64 (Splitting field)

Let $S \subset k[X]$ a family of polynomials. We say that K/k is a **splitting field** for S if

- Every polynomial $f \in S$ *splits completely* in K
- K is generated by the roots of all the polynomials in S

Note that by (3.18.57) K/k is necessarily algebraic, and if S is finite then so is K/k .

Definition 3.18.65 (Set of roots)

Let K/k be a field extension and $f \in k[X]$. Then define

$$T_{f,K} := \{\beta \in K \mid f(\beta) = 0\}$$

Proposition 3.18.66 (Splitting field is minimal)

Let $S \subset k[X]$ be a family of polynomials which split completely in K/k . Then the following are equivalent

- K is generated by the roots of every polynomial $f \in S$, that is

$$K = k \left(\bigcup_{f \in S} T_{f,K} \right)$$

- Any subfield $K' \subset K$ in which S splits completely is equal to K

Proof. For all $f \in S$ there is a factorisation

$$f = \prod_{\alpha \in T_{f,K}} (X - \alpha)$$

Suppose $K = k(\bigcup_{f \in S} T_{f,K})$ and let K' be a subfield in which all $f \in S$ split completely. Then by unique factorization in $K[X]$ we have $T_{f,K} \subset K'$ for all $f \in S$ and therefore $K' = K$.

Conversely it's clear that S splits completely in $k(\bigcup_{f \in S} T_{f,K})$, therefore by hypothesis this equals K . □

Lemma 3.18.67

Let $\sigma : K/k \rightarrow L/k$ be a morphism and $f(X) \in k[X]$ a polynomial. Then

- σ induces an injective map on the roots $T_{f,K} \rightarrow T_{f,L}$
- f splits completely in $K \iff f$ splits completely in $\sigma(K)$. In this case the above map is a bijection

Proposition 3.18.68 (Image of a splitting field is fixed)

Let K/k be a splitting field for S and $\sigma : K/k \rightarrow L/k$ a morphism. Then S splits completely in L . Any such σ satisfies

$$\sigma(K) = k \left(\bigcup_{f \in S} T_{f,L} \right)$$

Proof. Clearly by (3.18.67) S splits completely in L .

By the same result σ induces a bijection $T_{f,K} \longleftrightarrow T_{f,L}$. Therefore $\sigma(K) = \sigma(k(\bigcup_{f \in S} T_{f,K})) = k(\sigma(\bigcup_{f \in S} T_{f,K})) = k(\bigcup_{f \in S} T_{f,L})$ by (3.18.26). $\square$

Proposition 3.18.69 (Uniqueness of Splitting Fields)

Let $S \subset k[X]$ be a family of polynomials. Let K/k be a splitting field for S and L/k an extension in which S splits completely.

Then there exists a morphism $\sigma : K/k \rightarrow L/k$. Let $\alpha \in K$ and $\beta \in L$ be conjugate elements, then we may choose σ such that $\sigma(\alpha) = \beta$.

Furthermore any two splitting fields are isomorphic.

Proof. By assumption K is generated by the roots α_{ij} of $f_i \in S$. For each α_{ij} we therefore have $m_{\alpha_{ij},k}(X) \mid f_i(X)$ and $m_{\alpha_{ij},k}(X)$ splits completely in L by (3.18.42). Therefore the morphism $\sigma : K/k \rightarrow L/k$ exists by (3.18.62).

Note by (3.18.68) S splits in $\sigma(K) = k(\bigcup_{f \in S} T_{f,L})$. If L is also a splitting field for S then $L = \sigma(K)$ by (3.18.66) and therefore σ is an isomorphism as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.70 (Algebraically Closed)

A field M is algebraically closed if one of the following equivalent conditions holds

- Every algebraic extension M'/M is trivial
- Every non-constant polynomial in $M[X]$ has a root in M
- Every non-constant polynomial in $M[X]$ splits in M

NB in this case M is also *normal*.

Definition 3.18.71 (Algebraic Closure)

An **algebraic closure** $\bar{k}$ of k is a field extension $\bar{k}/k$ which is algebraic and for which $\bar{k}$ is algebraically closed.

Proposition 3.18.72 (Existence of Algebraic Closure)

Given a field k there exists an algebraic closure $\bar{k}/k$

Proposition 3.18.73 (Algebraic extensions embed into Algebraic Closure)

Let K/k be an algebraic extension and M/k be field such that every polynomial $f \in k[X]$ splits completely then there exists a morphism $\sigma : K/k \rightarrow M/k$.

In particular this holds when M is algebraically closed.

Proof. A straightforward application of (3.18.62) since every $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ splits in M . $\square$

Corollary 3.18.74 (Uniqueness of algebraic closure)

An algebraic closure $\bar{k}$ of k is unique up to (non-unique) isomorphism.

More generally we may show the existence of smaller splitting fields

Proposition 3.18.75 (Existence of Splitting Field)

Given a field k and family of polynomials $S \subset k[X]$ then there exists a splitting field K .

When $S = \{f\}$ then this can be chosen such that $[K : k] \leq n!$ where $n = \deg(f)$.

Proof. We may take the subfield of $\bar{k}$ generated by the roots of polynomials in S .

In the case S is finite it is possible to avoid the use of $\bar{k}$. First reduce to the case of a single polynomial $S = \{f\}$ and proceed by induction on $\deg(f)$. The inductive step may be demonstrated using (3.18.53). $\square$

Remark 3.18.76

Note if K/k is an algebraic extension then (3.18.73) shows that we may construct an embedding $K \rightarrow \bar{k}$ commuting with $k \rightarrow \bar{k}$.

In general given a tower of algebraic extensions

$$K = k_n / \dots / k_0 = k$$

we will assume the existence of compatible embeddings $i_{k_i} : k_i \rightarrow \bar{k}$ such that $i_{k_{i+1}} \circ i_{k_i, k_{i+1}} = i_{k_i}$.

3.18.7 Normal Extensions

Recall that an algebraic extension K/k is normal if all minimal polynomials split completely. They are in some sense “closed”. Furthermore $\bar{k}/k$ is clearly normal and results about $\bar{k}$ can often be generalized to normal fields L/k . We also show that an extension is normal iff it is a splitting field.

Lemma 3.18.77

Let $L/K/k$ be a tower of algebraic extensions and $\alpha \in L$. If $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ splits completely in L so does $m_{\alpha,K}(X)$. In particular

$$L/k \text{ normal} \implies L/K \text{ normal}$$

Proof. Note $m_{\alpha,K}(X) \mid m_{\alpha,k}^{i_{kK}}(X)$ as elements of $K[X]$ by (3.18.49). Apply i_{KL} and then we may use (3.18.42). $\square$

Proposition 3.18.78 (Conjugate elements in Normal Extensions)

Let L/k be a normal extension (e.g. $L = \bar{k}$) and $\alpha, \beta \in L$ elements with the same minimal polynomial $m_\alpha(X) = m_\beta(X)$. Then there exists $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(L/k)$ such that

$$\sigma(\alpha) = \beta$$

Proof. Apply (3.18.62) with $K = L$. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.79 (Normal Criteria)

Let $L/K/k$ be a tower of extensions such that L/k is normal (e.g. $L = \bar{k}$). Then the following are equivalent

NOR1 For any $\sigma \in \text{Mor}_k(K, L)$ we have $\sigma(K) = i_{KL}(K)$.

NOR2 K/k is the splitting field of some family of polynomials $f_i \in k[X]$.

NOR3 K/k is *normal*

Proof. Clearly $3 \implies 2$, for K is the splitting field of all the minimal polynomials of elements in K .

$2 \implies 1$. This is (3.18.68).

$1 \implies 3$. Consider any $\alpha \in K$ with minimal polynomial $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$. By definition $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ splits completely in L because it has a root $\alpha_1 = i_{KL}(\alpha)$. Denote the roots by $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_r$. By (3.18.78) there is $\sigma_j \in \text{Aut}(L/k)$ such that $\sigma_j(\alpha_1) = \alpha_j$. By hypothesis we have $\alpha_j \in (\sigma_j \circ i_{KL})(K) = i_{KL}(K)$ whence there exists $\alpha'_j \in K$ such that $i_{KL}(\alpha'_j) = \alpha_j$. By (3.18.67) $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ splits completely in K . Therefore K/k is normal as required. $\square$

Corollary 3.18.80 (Splitting fields are normal)

An algebraic extension K/k is normal if and only if it is a splitting field.

Proof. We may apply the previous Proposition with $L = \bar{k}$.

We may prove a splitting field is normal more directly (without recourse to $\bar{k}$ or Zorn’s Lemma in the finite case). Suppose K/k is a splitting field for $S \subset k[X]$. Consider $\alpha \in K$ with minimal polynomial $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$. Let $(L/K, i_{KL})$ be a splitting field for $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ (as a polynomial in $K[X]$, NB may not be irreducible).

Let $\beta \in L$ be another root of $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$. Observe that S splits in L , so by (3.18.69) there is a morphism $\sigma : K/k \rightarrow L/k$ with $\sigma(\alpha) = \beta$. By (3.18.68) we have $i_{KL}(K) = \sigma(K)$ whence $\beta \in i_{KL}(K)$. As β was an arbitrary root of $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ we see it splits completely in $i_{KL}(K)$. Finally by (3.18.67) $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ splits completely in K . As α was arbitrary then K/k is normal. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.81 (Extension to normal overfield)

Let $L/K/k$ be a tower of algebraic field extensions with L/k normal (e.g. $L = \bar{k}$) then there is a canonical surjection

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}_k(i_{KL}, L) : \text{Aut}(L/k) &\rightarrow \text{Mor}_k(K, L) \\ \sigma &\rightarrow \sigma \circ i_{KL} \end{aligned}$$

When i_{KL} is inclusion then this is simply the restriction to K . The kernel is precisely $\text{Aut}(L/K)$.

Proof. Given $\tilde{\sigma} \in \text{Mor}_k(K, L)$, apply (3.18.62) to construct a morphism $\sigma : (L/K, i_{KL}) \rightarrow (L/K, \tilde{\sigma})$. The hypotheses apply because the minimal polynomial $m_{\alpha,K}(X)$ with respect to either extension divides the minimal polynomial $m_{\alpha,k}^{i_{kK}}(X)$ which by assumption splits completely in L . By (3.18.31) it is an automorphism. Furthermore

$$\sigma \circ i_{KL} = \sigma \circ i_{KL} \circ i_{kK} = \tilde{\sigma} \circ i_{kK} = i_{kL}$$

whence $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(L/k)$ as required. $\square$

Corollary 3.18.82 (Lifting inside normal overfield)

Let $L/K/F/k$ be a tower of field extensions with L/k normal, then there is a surjection

$$\text{Mor}_k(i_{FK}, L) : \text{Mor}_k(K, L) \rightarrow \text{Mor}_k(F, L)$$

Proof. Note that $\text{Mor}_k(i_{FK}, L) \circ \text{Mor}_k(i_{KL}, L) = \text{Mor}_k(i_{FL}, L)$. By (3.18.81) this composition is surjective, whence the result follows. $\square$

Corollary 3.18.83 (Quotient of automorphism group)

Let $L/K/k$ be a tower of extensions such that L/k and K/k are normal. Then L/K is normal and there is an isomorphism of groups.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Aut}(L/k)/\text{Aut}(L/K) &\longrightarrow \text{Aut}(K/k) \\ \sigma &\longmapsto i_{KL}^{-1} \circ \sigma \circ i_{KL} \end{aligned}$$

Proof. The given map is well-defined by (3.18.79) since $(\sigma \circ i_{KL})(K) = i_{KL}(K)$, and σ fixes K precisely when $\sigma \circ i_{KL} = i_{KL}$, that is $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(L/K)$. Given $\tau \in \text{Aut}(K/k)$, by (3.18.81) there exists $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(L/k)$ such that $\sigma \circ i_{KL} = i_{KL} \circ \tau$. This shows the given map is surjective. The result follows from the group isomorphism theorem. $\square$

Definition 3.18.84 (Normal Closure)

Let K/k be an algebraic extension. Then an algebraic extension L/K is a **normal closure** for K/k if

- L/k is normal
- No proper subfield $i_{KL}(K) \subseteq L' \subsetneq L$ is normal over k

Proposition 3.18.85 (Existence and Uniqueness of Normal Closure)

Let K/k be an algebraic extension. Then a normal closure L/K exists and is unique up to isomorphism. Indeed it is the splitting field for all the minimal polynomials $\{m_{\alpha,k}(X) \mid \alpha \in K\}$ over k .

Furthermore if K/k is finite then so is L/k

Proof. Suppose $K = k(\{\alpha_i\}_{i \in I})$. Let L/k be the splitting field for $S = \{m_{\alpha_i,k}(X)\}_{i \in I}$. By (3.18.80) L/k is normal and by (3.18.62) there is a morphism $\sigma : K/k \rightarrow L/k$, so we may consider it as an extension $(L/K, \sigma)$. Suppose $i_{KL}(K) \subset L' \subset L$ is normal. As $i_{KL}(\alpha_i) \in L'$, by definition S splits in L' and therefore $L' = L$ by (3.18.66). Therefore L/K is a normal closure as required.

If K/k is finite then we may choose I to be finite, and therefore L/k is finite.

Let L/K be an arbitrary normal closure, then we claim L/k is a splitting field for $S' := \{m_{\alpha,k}(X) \mid \alpha \in K\}$. Clearly S' splits in L/k , because each has a root in L . Let L'/k be the subfield generated by roots of S' . Then it is a splitting field and therefore normal by (3.18.80). By assumption $L' = L$ and therefore L/k is the splitting field for S' . Uniqueness follows from the uniqueness of splitting fields (3.18.69). $\square$

3.18.8 Separability (Algebraic Case)

We follow Lang and not only characterize separability but define a “separability degree” which equals the extension degree if and only if it’s separable. The proofs are somewhat technical, especially in light of the fact most base fields will be perfect.

Definition 3.18.86 (Separable element)

We say $\alpha \in K/k$ is **separable** over k if it is algebraic and $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ is a **separable polynomial**.

We say K/k is **separable algebraic** (or just **separable** if K/k is assumed to be algebraic) if every $\alpha \in K$ is **separable**.

Lemma 3.18.87

$\alpha \in K/k$ is separable if and only if it is a root of a **separable polynomial** in $k[X]$.

In particular α separable over k implies it is separable over any subfield $i_{kK}(k) \subset E \subset K$.

Proof. One direction is obvious. Conversely suppose $f(\alpha) = 0$ with f separable. Then $m_{\alpha,k} \mid f$ so the result follows from (3.18.47). $\square$

Proposition 3.18.88 (Separability Degree)

Let K/k be an algebraic extension and L/K an extension such that L/k is normal (e.g. $L = \bar{k}$ or L is a normal closure). Then define the **separability degree**

$$[K : k]_s := \# \text{Mor}_k(K, L)$$

This is independent of the choice of L/K .

Proof. Given such an L , let L'/K be the intersection of all subfields of L/K normal over k . This is a normal closure of K/k . Let $\sigma \in \text{Mor}_k(K, L)$ and $\alpha \in K$. Then $\sigma(\alpha)$ is a root of $m_{\alpha, k}(X)$ along with $i_{KL}(\alpha) \in L'$. As L' is normal we have $\sigma(\alpha) \in L'$. Therefore without loss of generality we may replace L with L' . As the normal closure is unique up to isomorphism the degree is well-defined. $\square$

First we prove a key lemma regarding simple extension

Lemma 3.18.89 (Separability degree of simple extension)

If $k(\alpha)/k$ is a simple extension and L/k normal overfield then

$$[k(\alpha) : k]_s = \#\{\text{roots of } m_\alpha \text{ in } L\} \leq \deg(m_\alpha) = [k(\alpha) : k]$$

Furthermore equality holds iff α is separable over k .

Proof. The first equality follows from (3.18.61), the final equality from (3.18.55). The inequality follows from (3.18.41). The final statement follows from (3.18.48). $\square$

The main results of this section are the following

Proposition 3.18.90 (Separability Degree)

Let $L/K/F/k$ be a tower of finite extensions with L/k normal. Then the restriction map

$$\text{Mor}_k(i_{FK}, L) : \text{Mor}_k(K, L) \rightarrow \text{Mor}_k(F, L)$$

is surjective with finite fibers of order $[K : F]_s$. In particular we have

$$[K : k]_s = [K : F]_s [F : k]_s$$

Further $[K : k]_s \leq [K : k]$ with equality if and only if K/k is separable

Proof. For a tower $L/K/F/k$ with L/k normal, consider the restriction map

$$\psi := \text{Mor}_k(i_{FK}, L) : \text{Mor}_k(K, L) \rightarrow \text{Mor}_k(F, L)$$

It is surjective by (3.18.82). Consider $\sigma \in \text{Mor}_k(F, L)$ and the fibre $\psi^{-1}(\sigma) = \text{Mor}_F(K, (L/F, \sigma))$. This has order equal to $\#\psi^{-1}(\sigma) = [K : F]_s$ for all σ , because by (3.18.88) this does not depend on the embedding i_{FL} . As $\text{Mor}_k(K, L)$ is equal to the disjoint union of all the fibres, then the multiplicativity result follows.

It is possible to decompose K/k as a tower of simple extensions

$$K = K_n / \dots / K_0 = k$$

with $K_i = K_{i-1}(\alpha_i)$. By (3.18.89) we have

$$[K_i : K_{i-1}]_s \leq [K_i : K_{i-1}]$$

with equality iff α_i separable over K_{i-1} . By multiplicativity the inequality follows.

If K/k is separable then by (3.18.87) α_i is separable over K_{i-1} and we have $[K_i : K_{i-1}]_s = [K_i : K_{i-1}]$ and $[K : k]_s = [K : k]$ by multiplicativity. Conversely if $[K : k]_s = [K : k]$ then $[K_i : K_{i-1}]_s = [K_i : K_{i-1}]$ and α_i is separable over K_{i-1} . Since the choice of α_1 was arbitrary we see that K/k is separable. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.91 (Towers of separable extensions)

Consider a tower of algebraic extensions $K/E/k$. Then K/E and E/k is separable iff K/k is.

Proof. K/k separable $\implies K/E$ and E/k separable follows from (3.18.87).

Conversely the finite case follows from (3.18.90) by multiplicativity. For the general case, consider $\alpha \in K$. Then (3.18.59) shows the existence of a finite subextension E_0/k of E such that $m_{\alpha,E} = m_{\alpha,E_0}$. Therefore α is separable over E_0 . By (3.18.89) we see that $[E_0(\alpha) : E_0]_s = [E_0(\alpha) : E_0]$. As E/k is separable a-fortiori E_0/k is separable so by (3.18.90) $[E_0 : k]_s = [E_0 : k]$. By multiplicativity $[E_0(\alpha) : k]_s = [E_0(\alpha) : k]$ and the same result again shows that $E_0(\alpha)/k$ is separable. In particular α is separable over k as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.92

An algebraic extension $K = k(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n)/k$ is separable iff α_i are.

Proof. Let $K = k(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n)$. Then we may construct a tower of finite (simple) extensions

$$K = K_n / \dots / K_0 = k$$

with $K_i = k(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_i)$ and $K_i = K_{i-1}(\alpha_i)$. By (3.18.87) α_i is separable over K_{i-1} . Therefore $[K_i : K_{i-1}]_s = [K_i : K_{i-1}]$ by (3.18.89) and $[K : k]_s = [K : k]$ by multiplicativity. (3.18.90) shows that K/k is separable. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.93

Let K/k be a splitting field for finitely many separable polynomials f_i . Then K/k is finite and Galois.

Proof. By definition K is generated by the (finitely) many roots α_{ij} and so is finite by (3.18.57) and normal by (3.18.80). By (3.18.87) each α_{ij} is separable and so by (3.18.92) K/k is separable. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.94

Let K/k be a finite separable extension and L/k a normal closure. Then L/k is separable.

Proof. By (3.18.85) L/k is the splitting field of finitely many minimal polynomials $m_{\alpha_i,k}(X)$ for $\alpha_i \in K$. By (3.18.92) the α_i are separable and therefore so are $m_{\alpha_i,k}(X)$. By (3.18.93) we see that L/k is separable. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.95 (Equivalent definition of separability)

Let K/k be an algebraic extension. TFAE

- a) K/k is separable
- b) E/k is separable for every finite subextension
- c) $[E : k]_s = [E : k]$ for every finite subextension

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) is trivial and b) $\iff$ c) follows from (3.18.90). We need only show b) $\implies$ a).

Consider $\alpha \in K$. Then by (3.18.59) there exists a finite subextension E/k such that α is algebraic over E . Therefore $E(\alpha)/k$ is finite, and by assumption $E(\alpha)/k$ separable as required. $\square$

trio

3.18.9 Purely Inseparable Extensions and Separable Closure

In what follows we let p be the characteristic exponent of k . In other words when $\text{char}(k) = 0$ then $p = 1$ and the statements are trivial.

Definition 3.18.96

An element $x \in K/k$ is **purely inseparable** (or p -radical) if there exists an integer $n \geq 0$ such that $x^{p^n} \in k$. The **height** of x is the least such integer.

We say an extension K/k is **purely inseparable** if every $x \in K/k$ is purely inseparable.

Further K/k is **purely inseparable of height** $\leq n$ if additionally every $x \in K$ has height at most n .

Lemma 3.18.97

Let $a \in k$. For every integer $e \geq 0$ the polynomial $f(X) := X^{p^e} - a$ has at most one root in any extension field K/k .

Proof. Suppose that b is a root, then by (3.18.6) we have $f(X) = (X - b)^{p^e}$. Then evidently b is the unique root. $\square$

Lemma 3.18.98

Let $a \in k \setminus k^p$. Then for every integer $e \geq 0$ the polynomial $X^{p^e} - a$ is irreducible in $k[X]$.

Proof. Let K/k be a splitting field for $f(X) = X^{p^e} - a$, $b \in K$ a root and $g(X)$ be the minimal polynomial of b . By (3.18.6) $f(X) = (X - b)^{p^e}$ in $K[X]$. Suppose π is a monic irreducible factor of f in $k[X]$ then by unique factorisation in $K[X]$ we have $\pi(X) = (X - b)^r$ for some r . In particular π has b as a root and therefore is divisible by g . By irreducibility we conclude every irreducible factor is equal to g and the irreducible factorization of f is g^s . Furthermore $p^e = rs$. Consequently both r and s are p th powers, and we have

$$\begin{aligned}\pi &= (X - b)^{p^d} \\ f &= \pi^{p^{e-d}}\end{aligned}$$

for some $0 \leq d \leq e$. In particular $b^{p^d} \in k$ and $a = b^{p^{e-d}}$. By assumption a is not a p -th power and so we must have $d = e$, and $f = \pi$ is irreducible. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.99

Let $x \in K/k$ be purely inseparable of height e . Then the minimal polynomial of x is $X^{p^e} - x^{p^e}$. Furthermore

$$\begin{aligned}[k(x) : k] &= p^e \\ [k(x) : k]_s &= 1\end{aligned}$$

More precisely for every field L/k there is at most one morphism $k(x)/k \rightarrow L/k$.

Proof. By definition $x^{p^e} \in k$ is not a p -th power. Therefore the given polynomial is irreducible by (3.18.98) and therefore is the minimal polynomial by uniqueness. The first relation follows from (3.18.55) and the second from (3.18.89). $\square$

Corollary 3.18.100

Let $x \in K/k$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) x is purely inseparable
- b) $m_x(X) = (X - x)^r$ for some r

In this case we must have $r = p^n$ where n is the height of x .

Corollary 3.18.101

Suppose $x \in K/k$ is both separable and purely inseparable. Then $x \in k$.

Proof. The minimal polynomial is $X^{p^e} - x^{p^e} = (X - x)^{p^e}$. Therefore by (3.18.48) $e = 0$ which means precisely $x \in k$. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.102 (Relative Separable Closure)

Let K/k be a field extension. The subextension $K_s/k \subset K/k$ of separable elements form a separable algebraic subfield. Furthermore if K/k is algebraic then K/K_s is purely inseparable and the restriction map

$$\text{Mor}_k(K, L) \rightarrow \text{Mor}_k(K_s, L)$$

is bijective for every normal extension L/K . In particular when K_s/k is finite then we have the relation

$$[K_s : k] = [K_s : k]_s = [K : k]_s$$

Proof. Suppose $\alpha, \beta \in K$ are separable algebraic then the field $k(\alpha, \beta)$ is separable algebraic by (3.18.92). As this contains $\alpha \pm \beta$ and $\alpha\beta$ then K_s is a subfield which is by definition separable. Then by (3.18.90) we have $[K_s : k] = [K_s : k]_s$ when this is finite.

For $x \in K$ let $f(X)$ be the minimal polynomial over k . There exists some integer $m \geq 0$ such that $f(X) \in k[X^{p^m}]$ but not in $k[X^{p^{m+1}}]$. In other words $f(X) = g(X^{p^m})$ and $g(X) \notin k[X^p]$. As f is irreducible so is g , and is therefore the minimal polynomial of x^{p^m} . By (3.18.104) g is separable and therefore $x^{p^m} \in K_s$. This shows that K/K_s is purely inseparable.

Let $L/K/k$ be tower such that L/k is normal. Consider the mapping

$$\text{Mor}_k(K, L) \rightarrow \text{Mor}_k(K_s, L)$$

obtained by restriction. By (3.18.82) it is surjective. Consider $\psi : K_s \rightarrow L$ and $\hat{\psi} : K \rightarrow L$ an extension. For every $x \in K$ we have $\hat{\psi}|_{K_s(x)} = i_{K_s(x)L}$ by (3.18.99). This shows that $\hat{\psi}$ is unique and the mapping is bijective. $\square$

This relied on the following results

Lemma 3.18.103 (Inseparable polynomials)

Let $f \in k[X]$ be a non-constant polynomial and p the characteristic exponent of k . Then $f' = 0 \iff p > 1$ and $f \in k[X^p]$.

Proposition 3.18.104 (Separable Irreducible Polynomials)

Let $f \in k[X]$ be an irreducible polynomial and p the characteristic exponent of k . Then the following are equivalent

- a) f is separable (i.e. f and f' are co-maximal)
- b) $f' \neq 0$
- c) $p = 1$ or $f \notin k[X^p]$

Proof. Note by assumption f is not a unit and therefore not constant.

a) $\implies$ b) Suppose $f' = 0$ then $(f, f') = (f) \neq k[X]$ and therefore f is not separable.

b) $\implies$ a) Suppose f is not separable. By (...) (f) is maximal and so we must have $f' \in (f)$. As $\deg(f') < \deg(f)$ this implies $f' = 0$.

b) $\iff$ c) This is just the contrapositive of (3.18.103) □

Definition 3.18.105 (Degree of Inseparability)

Let K/k be a finite extension. Then in light of (3.18.102) we may define the **degree of inseparability** to be the integer

$$[K : k]_i := \frac{[K : k]}{[K : k]_s}$$

By (3.18.12) and (3.18.90) it is multiplicative in the sense that for a tower of finite extensions

$$[L : k]_i = [L : K]_i [K : k]_i$$

Further by (3.18.90) K/k is separable if and only if $[K : k]_i = 1$.

We may refine this further by showing that $[K : k]_i$ is always a power of the characteristic exponent.

Proposition 3.18.106

Let $k(\alpha)/k$ be a simple algebraic extension with characteristic exponent p . There exists a unique integer $r \geq 0$ such that every root of $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ has multiplicity p^r (in any splitting field).

Further

$$[k(\alpha) : k]_i = p^r$$

and $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ has $[k(\alpha) : k]_s$ distinct roots.

Proof. Let $L/k(\alpha)/k$ be a normal overfield, and let $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_s$ be the distinct roots of $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ with $\alpha_1 = \alpha$. Then we have a factorisation in $L[X]$ given by

$$m_{\alpha,k}(X) = \prod_{i=1}^s (X - \alpha_i)^{m_i}$$

for some integers $m_i > 0$.

For every $1 \leq i \leq s$ there exists an automorphism $\sigma_i \in \text{Aut}(L/k)$ such that $\sigma_i(\alpha) = \alpha_i$ (3.18.62). By definition σ_i fixes $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ so by unique factorisation we deduce that $m_i = m_1$, so all the roots have the same multiplicity m .

If $m = 1$ then by (3.18.46) $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ is separable. Otherwise by (3.18.104) there is a polynomial $g(X)$ such that $f(X) = g(X^p)$ which has α^p as a root. We may continue inductively to find an integer $r \geq 0$ such that $f(X) = g(X^{p^r})$ and $g(X)$ is separable. Then α^{p^r} is separable. By definition α is purely inseparable over $k(\alpha^{p^r})$ so by (3.18.99)

$$[k(\alpha) : k(\alpha^{p^r})]_i = p^r$$

By (3.18.90) we have

$$[k(\alpha^{p^r}) : k]_i = 1$$

and by multiplicativity $[k(\alpha) : k]_i = p^r$. By (3.18.89) the number of distinct roots of $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$ is $[k(\alpha) : k]_s$. Comparing degrees we have $\deg(m_{\alpha,k}(X)) = [k(\alpha) : k] = [k(\alpha) : k]_s m$ whence $m = [k(\alpha) : k]_i = p^r$ as required. □

Proposition 3.18.107

Let K/k be a finite field extension with characteristic exponent p . Then $[K : k]_i = p^r$ for some integer $r \geq 0$.

K/k is separable if and only if $p = 1$ or $r = 0$.

Proof. We may decompose K/k into a tower of simple extensions, and the result follows from multiplicativity and (3.18.106). $\square$

3.18.10 Separable closure

Proposition 3.18.108 (Relatively Separably Closed)

Let K/k be an extension. The following are equivalent

- a) Every separable $x \in K/k$ lies in k
- b) Every separable algebraic subextension is trivial
- c) K_s/k is trivial

In this case we say K/k is **relatively separably closed**.

If K/k is algebraic then this is equivalent to being purely inseparable.

Proof. The final statement follows from (3.18.102). $\square$

Definition 3.18.109

We say a field k is **separably closed** if every separable algebraic extension is trivial.

We say an extension k^{sep}/k is a **separable closure** if it is separable algebraic and separably closed.

Proposition 3.18.110

Let $\bar{k}/k$ be an algebraic closure, then the subextension $\bar{k}_s/k$ is a separable closure for k .

Furthermore every separable closure is isomorphic to $\bar{k}_s/k$ and $\bar{k}/\bar{k}_s$ is purely inseparable.

Proof. By (3.18.102) $\bar{k}_s/k$ is separable and algebraic. Suppose $K/\bar{k}_s$ is separable and algebraic then by (...) there exists an embedding $i : K/\bar{k}_s \rightarrow \bar{k}/\bar{k}_s$. As $\bar{k}_s$ is relatively separably closed in $\bar{k}$ we see that $i(K) = \bar{k}_s$ and therefore $K = \bar{k}_s$.

Let k^{sep}/k be a separable closure, then by (3.18.73) there is an embedding $\phi : k^{sep}/k \rightarrow \bar{k}/k$. Then by definition $\phi(k^{sep}) \subset \bar{k}_s$, so this defines an extension $\bar{k}_s/k^{sep}$ which is by definition separable. By assumption it is trivial which means precisely $\phi(k^{sep}) = \bar{k}_s$.

It follows from (3.18.102) that $\bar{k}/\bar{k}_s$ is purely inseparable. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.111

Let k^{sep}/k be a separable closure and k'/k a separable algebraic extension. Then there exists a morphism

$$k'/k \rightarrow k^{sep}/k$$

Proof. By (3.18.110) we may identify k^{sep}/k with $\bar{k}_s/k$. By (3.18.73) there exists a morphism $k'/k \rightarrow \bar{k}/k$ which by definition has image in $\bar{k}_s/k$. $\square$

3.18.11 Perfect Fields

Proposition 3.18.112 (Perfect Closure)

Let k be a field with characteristic exponent p contained in an algebraically closed field Ω (e.g. $\bar{k}$). Define

$$k^{p^{-n}} := \{x \in \Omega \mid x^{p^n} \in k\}$$

Then $k^{p^{-n}}$ is a subfield of Ω/k , which is purely inseparable of height $\leq n$. Furthermore it is a splitting field for the family of polynomials $\{X^{p^r} - a \mid a \in k, r \leq n\}$ which characterizes it up to isomorphism. Furthermore

$$k^{p^{-\infty}} := \{x \in \Omega \mid x^{p^n} \in k \text{ some } n \geq 1\} = \bigcup_{n \geq 1} k^{p^{-n}}$$

is the smallest perfect subfield of Ω containing k and is also a splitting field for the family of polynomials $\{X^{p^n} - a \mid a \in k, n \in \mathbb{N}\}$.

Proof. Suppose $\alpha, \beta \in k^{p^{-n}}$ then applying the Frobenius homomorphism (...) we see $(\alpha + \beta)^{p^n} = \alpha^{p^n} + \beta^{p^n}$ and so $k^{p^{-n}}$ is an additive subgroup. Furthermore $(\alpha\beta)^{p^n} = \alpha^{p^n}\beta^{p^n}$ whence it is a multiplicative subgroup as this demonstrates $(\alpha^{-1})^{p^n} = (\alpha^{p^n})^{-1} \in k$. Therefore it is a subfield which is by definition purely inseparable of height $\leq n$.

By definition $k^{p^{-n}}$ is precisely the set of roots of the given polynomials and it is therefore the corresponding splitting field by (...). This also shows that $n \leq m \implies k^{p^{-n}} \subseteq k^{p^{-m}}$ which shows that the union $k^{p^{-\infty}}$ is a subfield of Ω .

To demonstrate it's perfect we need to show every element $x \in k^{p^{-n}}$ has a p -th root. By definition $x^{p^n} \in k$ and there exists a root α to the polynomial $X^{p^{n+1}} - x^{p^n}$ in $k^{p^{-(n+1)}}$. Therefore $(\alpha^p - x)^{p^n} = 0$ whence $\alpha^p = x$ as required.

Let k' be another perfect subfield containing k . We claim by induction that $k^{p^{-n}} \subseteq k'$. For given $\alpha \in k^{p^{-(n+1)}}$ by definition $\alpha^p \in k^{p^{-n}}$ whence $\alpha^p \in k'$ by the inductive hypothesis, and by assumption $\alpha \in k'$. Therefore $k^{p^{-\infty}}$ is the smallest perfect subfield. Furthermore by definition it is the set of roots of the given family of polynomials and therefore the corresponding splitting field. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.113

Let k'/k be a purely inseparable extension of height $\leq n$, then there exists an embedding

$$k'/k \rightarrow k^{p^{-n}}/k$$

If k'/k is purely inseparable and K/k is perfect then there also exists an embedding

$$k'/k \rightarrow K/k$$

Proof. For the first part let $\alpha \in k'$ then by (3.18.99) the minimal polynomial of α is $g(X) = X^{p^e} - \alpha^{p^e}$ for $e \leq n$ which splits completely in $k^{p^{-n}}$ by (3.18.112). Then the embedding exists by (3.18.62).

Suppose K/k is perfect then we claim that $X^{p^n} - a$ splits completely for every $a \in K$. By induction there is $b \in K$ such that $b^{p^n} = a$. Then $X^{p^n} - a = (X - b)^{p^n}$ splits completely. In particular for every $\alpha \in k'$ the minimal polynomial splits completely in K/k and the embedding follows from (3.18.62). $\square$

Recall a perfect field k satisfies $k^p = k$ where p is the characteristic exponent. We show that in this case there are no inseparable algebraic extensions. First we show that all finite fields are perfect.

Proposition 3.18.114 (Finite fields are perfect)

Any finite field is perfect.

Proof. The Frobenius homomorphism is injective and therefore surjective by counting. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.115 (Perfect field criteria)

Let k be a field with characteristic exponent p . Then the following are equivalent

- a) Every irreducible polynomial in $k[X]$ is separable
- b) Every algebraic extension K/k is separable
- c) $\bar{k}/k$ is separable
- d) $k^p = k$

In particular every field of characteristic zero is perfect, and an algebraic extension of a perfect field is separable.

Proof. We prove each in turn

a) $\implies$ b) Minimal polynomials are irreducible by (3.18.49) and therefore are separable by hypothesis.

b) $\iff$ c) One direction is automatic as $\bar{k}$ is algebraic. On the other hand every algebraic extension is isomorphic to a subfield of $\bar{k}$, so the implication follows from (3.18.91).

b) $\implies$ d) We need only show $k^p = k$ in the case $p > 1$. If there exists $a \in k \setminus k^p$ then by (3.18.98) the polynomial $f(X) := X^p - a$ is irreducible. Then it's clear that the field extension $K := k[X]/(X^p - a)$ is not separable. For the minimal polynomial of $\bar{X}$ is f which by (3.18.104) is not separable. This contradicts the assumption that K/k is separable.

d) $\implies$ a) Suppose that f is irreducible but not separable. Then by (3.18.104) $\text{char}(k) = p > 1$ and $f \in k[X^p]$. By assumption all the coefficients are p -th powers and therefore $f = h^p$ by (3.18.6) for some $h \in k[X]$. This contradicts irreducibility of f , and so f must be separable. $\square$

3.18.12 Applications of Separability

Definition 3.18.116 (Bounds on $\text{Aut}(K/k)$)

Let K/k be an algebraic extension and L/K an extension such that L/k is normal. Then there is a natural injection

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}_k(K, i_{KL}) : \text{Aut}(K/k) &\rightarrow \text{Mor}_k(K, L) \\ \sigma &\rightarrow i_{KL} \circ \sigma \end{aligned}$$

In particular in the case $[K : k] < \infty$

$$\# \text{Aut}(K/k) \leq [K : k]_s \leq [K : k] < \infty$$

If i_{KL} is inclusion, then we may regard $\text{Aut}(K/k)$ as a subset of $\text{Mor}_k(K, L)$

As an application of the concept of separability degree we prove

Proposition 3.18.117 (Primitive Element Theorem)

Let K/k be a finite separable extension of k then $K = k(\alpha)$ is simple.

Proof. We only prove the case k is infinite. The finite case can be proven separately by showing that the K^* is cyclic.

Consider the set $\text{Mor}_k(K, \bar{k}) = \{\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_n\}$ which by (3.18.95) has order $n = [K : k]$. By induction we can assume that $K = k(\alpha, \beta)$. We claim that there exists $0 \neq c \in k$ such that $\sigma_i(\alpha + c\beta)$ are all distinct. In this case we clearly have $\# \text{Mor}_k(k(\alpha + c\beta), \bar{k}) \geq n$ so by the same result $[k(\alpha + c\beta) : k] \geq [k(\alpha + c\beta) : k]_s \geq n$ whence $k(\alpha + c\beta) = K$ (by (2.3.15)).

We have $\sigma_i(\alpha + c\beta) = \sigma_j(\alpha + c\beta) \iff c(\sigma_i(\beta) - \sigma_j(\beta)) = (\sigma_i(\alpha) - \sigma_j(\alpha))$. Therefore consider the polynomial

$$f(X) = \prod_{i \neq j} (X(\sigma_i(\beta) - \sigma_j(\beta)) - (\sigma_i(\alpha) - \sigma_j(\alpha)))$$

Then the embeddings are distinct precisely when $f(c) \neq 0$. Since $f(X)$ has at most finitely many roots and k is infinite, there must exist such a c . $\square$

3.18.13 Normal Extensions II

We provide some more straightforward criteria based on $[K : k]_s$

Proposition 3.18.118 (Normal Criteria II)

Let $L/K/k$ be a tower of algebraic extensions such that L/k is normal (e.g. $L = \bar{k}$). Then K/k is normal if and only if the embedding

$$\text{Mor}_k(K, i_{KL}) : \text{Aut}(K/k) \rightarrow \text{Mor}_k(K, L)$$

is a bijection. In particular if K/k is finite, then it is normal if and only if

$$\# \text{Aut}(K/k) = [K : k]_s$$

Proof. Suppose K/k is normal and consider $\sigma \in \text{Mor}_k(K, L)$. Then by NOR1 $\sigma(K) = i_{KL}(K)$ and we may define $\tau := i_{KL}^{-1} \circ \sigma$ with $\tau \in \text{Aut}(K/k)$. The converse is similar.

For the final part we've already observed (3.18.116) that in the finite case $\# \text{Aut}(K/k) \leq [K : k]_s = \# \text{Mor}_k(K, L) \leq [K : k] < \infty$. Therefore the embedding $\text{Mor}_k(K, i_{KL})$ is a bijection precisely when the orders are the same. $\square$

Corollary 3.18.119 (Galois Criteria)

Let K/k be a finite extension. Then

$$\# \text{Aut}(K/k) \leq [K : k]_s \leq [K : k]$$

with equalities if and only if K/k is *Galois*.

Proof. We've seen the inequalities (3.18.116)

$$\# \text{Aut}(K/k) \leq [K : k]_s \leq [K : k] < \infty$$

with equality if and only if K/k is both normal (3.18.118) and separable (3.18.90) $\square$

3.18.14 Finite Fields

A finite field K necessarily has positive characteristic p , and therefore the prime subfield is isomorphic to the field $\mathbb{F}_p := \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$. We list some necessary properties of a finite field

Proposition 3.18.120 (Properties of finite fields)

Every finite field K is a finite-dimensional vector space over its prime subfield $\mathbb{F}_p$. Define $n = [K : \mathbb{F}_p]$.

- $\#K = p^n$
- K is a splitting field for $X^{p^n} - X \in \mathbb{F}_p[X]$, and indeed is equal to the set of roots
- The multiplicative group of units $K^\star$ is cyclic.
- $K/\mathbb{F}_p$ is simple

Proof. Since $K/\mathbb{F}_p$ is a finite-dimensional vector space it must have order p^n .

The group of units has order $p^n - 1$, so by Lagrange's theorem every non-zero element satisfies $X^{p^n-1} - 1 = 0$, so therefore every element satisfies $X^{p^n} - X = 0$. Since this polynomial can have at most p^n roots (3.18.41) the roots are exactly all the elements of K .

We note again that $X^d - 1$ has at most d roots by (3.18.41). Therefore the fact $K^\star$ is cyclic follows from (3.3.25). $\square$

Proposition 3.18.121 (Frobenius morphism)

Given any field $K/\mathbb{F}_p$ the Frobenius map

$$\phi : x \rightarrow x^p$$

is an injective field homomorphism. In particular when K is finite (or even algebraic) it is an automorphism over $\mathbb{F}_p$.

Proof. The only non-trivial step is showing

$$(x + y)^p = x^p + y^p$$

which follows from elementary calculations on binomial coefficients.

For the final statement use (3.18.31). $\square$

Further we can show existence and uniqueness of finite fields.

Proposition 3.18.122 (Existence and uniqueness of finite fields)

Consider the algebraic closure $\overline{\mathbb{F}_p}$ and let $\mathbb{F}_{p^n}$ denote the splitting field of $f(X) = X^{p^n} - X$ in $\overline{\mathbb{F}_p}$. Then

- $\mathbb{F}_{p^n}$ is equal to the set of roots of $X^{p^n} - X$
- It is the unique subfield of order p^n and every finite field of order p^n is isomorphic to this.
- $\mathbb{F}_{p^m} \subset \mathbb{F}_{p^n} \iff m \mid n$

Proof. By (3.18.121) the set of roots of $f(X)$ forms a subfield of $\overline{\mathbb{F}_p}$.

Furthermore $f'(X) = -1$ so $f(X)$ is separable because clearly $(f, f') = 1$. Therefore by (3.18.48) $f(X)$ has p^n distinct roots and the splitting field of $f(X)$ is exactly the set of roots.

Furthermore every subfield of order p^n must satisfy this polynomial by Lagrange's Theorem (3.3.12), so it is the unique such subfield.

Since every algebraic extension of $\mathbb{F}_p$ is isomorphic to a subfield of $\overline{\mathbb{F}_p}$ it's also the unique algebraic extension of order p^n up to isomorphism.

Clearly if $\mathbb{F}_{p^m} \subset \mathbb{F}_{p^n}$ then $[\mathbb{F}_{p^n} : \mathbb{F}_p] = [\mathbb{F}_{p^n} : \mathbb{F}_{p^m}][\mathbb{F}_{p^m} : \mathbb{F}_p]$, so we must have $m \mid n$. Conversely if $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_{p^m}$ then $\alpha^{p^m} = \alpha \implies \alpha^{p^{rm}} = \alpha$ for all $r > 0$, so $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_{p^n}$. $\square$

It is usually most convenient to work in $\overline{\mathbb{F}_p}$ and consider the subfields of order p^n . We've seen in (3.18.114) that every finite field $\mathbb{F}_q := \mathbb{F}_{p^n}$ is perfect and therefore every algebraic extension is separable (3.18.115). In fact we may show that every finite extension is Galois.

Proposition 3.18.123

The field extension $\mathbb{F}_{p^n}/\mathbb{F}_p$ is Galois with

$$\text{Gal}(\mathbb{F}_{p^n}/\mathbb{F}_p) = \langle \phi \rangle$$

cyclic of order n generated by the Frobenius automorphism.

Proof. Let $G = \text{Aut}(\mathbb{F}_{p^n}/\mathbb{F}_p)$. We've observed that $\phi \in G$. Let $d = o(\phi)$, then we wish to prove that $n = d$. Certainly Lagrange's Theorem applied to the multiplicative group $\mathbb{F}_{p^n}^*$ implies $\phi^n = 1$. Therefore $d \mid n$ by (3.3.12) applied to G . By definition $\phi^d = e$, so every $\alpha \in \mathbb{F}_{p^n}$ satisfies the polynomial $X^{p^d} - X = 0$. This polynomial has at most p^d roots (3.18.41) so we must have $d \geq n$, and therefore $d = n$. Clearly ϕ generates a cyclic subgroup of order n . However by (3.18.119) G has at most order n , whence $G = \langle \phi \rangle$ as required. Furthermore by the same result $\mathbb{F}_{p^n}/\mathbb{F}_p$ is Galois. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.124 (Subfields of $\mathbb{F}_{p^n}$)

Consider the field extension $\mathbb{F}_{p^n}/\mathbb{F}_p$. Then it has a unique subfield of order p^m if $m \mid n$ (and no such subfield otherwise). In this case $\mathbb{F}_{p^n}/\mathbb{F}_{p^m}$ is Galois and

$$\text{Gal}(\mathbb{F}_{p^n}/\mathbb{F}_{p^m}) = \langle \phi^m \rangle$$

and in particular has order n/m .

Proof. We've already shown that $\mathbb{F}_{p^n}$ has a unique subfield of order p^m , by assuming an embedding in $\overline{\mathbb{F}_p}$. Let $H = \text{Aut}(\mathbb{F}_{p^n}/\mathbb{F}_{p^m})$. Note ϕ^m has order n/m . Furthermore from (3.18.122) every element of $\mathbb{F}_{p^m}$ satisfies $X^{p^m} - X$. In other words ϕ^m fixes $\mathbb{F}_{p^m}$ and $\phi^m \in H$. Therefore $\langle \phi^m \rangle \leq H$ and $\#H \geq n/m$. By (3.18.119) $\#H \leq [\mathbb{F}_{p^n} : \mathbb{F}_{p^m}] = n/m$, whence we have equality and so the extension is Galois by (3.18.119) and $H = \langle \phi^m \rangle$. $\square$

Lemma 3.18.125

Let $x \in \mathbb{F}_{p^n}$. Then $\deg(x) = n \iff \text{Fix}(x) = \{1\} \subset \text{Gal}(\mathbb{F}_{p^n}/\mathbb{F}_p)$.

In other words $\text{Gal}(\mathbb{F}_{p^n}/\mathbb{F}_p)$ acts freely on the elements of degree n .

Proof. Observe that $\deg(x) = n \iff [\mathbb{F}_p(x) : \mathbb{F}_p] = n \iff \mathbb{F}_p(x) = \mathbb{F}_{p^n} \xLeftrightarrow{(3.18.127)} \text{Gal}(\mathbb{F}_{p^n}/\mathbb{F}_p(x)) = \{1\}$ which is equivalent to the statement given. $\square$

3.18.15 Galois Theory

We've seen that for K/k a finite extension

$$\# \text{Aut}(K/k) \leq [K : k]_s \leq [K : k]$$

with equality if and only if K/k is Galois, by (3.18.119).

Remark 3.18.126

If k is perfect then $\bar{k}/k$ is Galois.

The main result of Galois Theory is

Proposition 3.18.127

Let K/k be a finite Galois extension then there is an order-reversing bijection between subgroups and subfields

$$\begin{aligned} \{H \leq \text{Gal}(K/k)\} &\longleftrightarrow \{F/k \subseteq K/k\} \\ H &\longrightarrow K^H := \{x \in K \mid h(x) = x \quad \forall h \in H\} \\ \text{Gal}(K/F) &\longleftarrow F \end{aligned}$$

Proof. This is proved in a series of Propositions in the rest of this section. Firstly we show it is well-defined in (3.18.128). The maps are mutual inverses by (3.18.129) and (3.18.130). $\square$

Such an order reversing map is usually called an (antitone) Galois connection, as the first such type arose from Galois Theory. Note it is well-defined because of the following proposition.

Proposition 3.18.128

If K/k is Galois and $F \subset K/k$ then K/F is Galois.

Proof. This follows from (3.18.77) and (3.18.91). $\square$

Proposition 3.18.129 (Fixed field of Galois group)

If K/k is Galois and $F \subset K/k$ a subfield then

$$K^{\text{Gal}(K/F)} = F$$

Proof. Clearly $F \subseteq K^{\text{Gal}(K/F)}$. Conversely given $\alpha \in K \setminus F$, then $\deg m_{\alpha,F} > 1$. Since α is separable it must have another root $\beta \in K$. By (3.18.78) there is an element $\sigma \in \text{Gal}(K/F)$ such that $\sigma(\alpha) = \beta$. In other words $\alpha \notin K^{\text{Gal}(K/F)}$, which shows the reverse inclusion. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.130

Let K/k be a field extension and $H \subseteq \text{Aut}(K/k)$ a finite subgroup then K/K^H is a finite Galois extension with

$$\text{Gal}(K/K^H) = H$$

and order equal to $[K : K^H]$. When K/k is finite then H is automatically finite.

Proof. Firstly observe that trivially $H \subseteq \text{Aut}(K/K^H)$. If we know that $[K : K^H] < \infty$, then by (3.18.119) we have

$$\#H \leq \# \text{Aut}(K/K^H) \leq [K : K^H]_s \leq [K : K^H]$$

We can prove equality everywhere if we show that $[K : K^H] \leq \#H$, which is shown either by (3.18.131) or (3.18.132). Note equality also shows that K/K^H is finite Galois by the same result.

Finally when K/k is finite, then $\# \text{Aut}(K/k) < \infty$. So in this case H is always finite. $\square$

We present two approaches to showing the inequality $[K : K^H] \leq \#H$. The first uses independence of characters style argument, and the second which is more straightforward uses the action of H to show that every element has degree at most $\#H$ (Artin).

Lemma 3.18.131 (Bound degree of fixed field I)

Let K/k be a field extension and $H \subset \text{Aut}(K/k)$ a finite subgroup. Then $[K : K^H] \leq \#H$

Proof. Let $H = \{\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_n\}$ with $\sigma_1 = \text{id}$ and $\{\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_m\}$ a K^H -linearly independent subset of K .

Consider the vector space K^n and the elements $\hat{\alpha}_j = (\sigma_1(\alpha_j), \dots, \sigma_n(\alpha_j))$ for $j = 1 \dots m$. It's enough to show that these are linearly independent over K , as that implies $m \leq n$ by (3.4.126). Therefore K/K^H is finite dimensional with dimension at most $n = \#H$.

Let $S(K) := \{v \in K^m \mid \sum_{j=1}^m v_j \hat{\alpha}_j = 0\}$, we aim to show that $S(K) = \{0\}$. If we also consider $S(K^H)$, any non-zero elements will be a K^H linear-dependence for $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_m$ by considering the first component ($\sigma_1 = \text{id}$). Therefore by linear independence of α_i we see $S(K^H) = \{0\}$. So it's enough to show that $S(K) \neq \{0\} \implies S(K^H) \neq \{0\}$, to prove $S(K) = \{0\}$ by contradiction.

First observe that $K^\star$ and H both act on $S(K)$ component-wise. The first by multiplication and the second by application. This is well-defined because $v \in S(K)$ if and only if

$$\sum_j v_j \sigma(\alpha_j) = 0 \quad \forall \sigma \in H.$$

Apply τ to obtain

$$\sum_j \tau(v_j) (\tau \circ \sigma)(\alpha_j) = 0 \quad \forall \sigma \in H$$

and since multiplication by τ permutes H we see $\tau(v) \in S(K)$ as required.

If there exists $0 \neq v \in S(K)$, consider v with a minimal number of non-zero components. By scaling we can assume λv has at least one component in K^H . The vector $\tau(\lambda v) - \lambda v$ then has at least one fewer non-zero components, so by minimality must be zero. Since τ was arbitrary we see $0 \neq \lambda v \in S(K^H)$ as required. $\square$

Lemma 3.18.132 (Bound degree of fixed field II)

Let K/k be a field extension and H a finite subgroup of $\text{Aut}(K/k)$. Then K/K^H is finite separable, and simple, with $[K : K^H] \leq \#H$

Proof. We show that K/K^H is separable and every element has degree at most $\#H$. For any $\alpha \in K$, consider the orbit $\alpha^H = \{\sigma(\alpha) \mid \sigma \in H\}$, which is of order at most $\#H$. Then the polynomial

$$f(X) = \prod_{\beta \in \alpha^H} (X - \beta)$$

has α as a root and is separable by (3.18.48). Furthermore $f^\tau = f$ because τ permutes α^H (it's injective and hence bijective). Therefore $f \in K^H[X]$ and $m_{\alpha, K^H} \mid f$. We see that α has degree at most $\#H$ and is separable by (3.18.47).

If K/k is finite, then a-fortiori K/K^H is finite, so we may apply the Primitive Element Theorem (3.18.117) directly to show the result.

More generally let $K^H(\alpha)$ be a simple subfield of K of maximal degree. This exists because the degree of α is bounded above by $\#H$. We claim $K^H(\alpha) = K$, for if not then $K^H \subseteq K^H(\alpha) \subsetneq K^H(\alpha, \beta)$ is a finite separable extension of

K^H , whence it must be simple by the Primitive Element Theorem (3.18.117), contradicting maximality. Finally the degree of $[K : K^H]$ is the degree of α , which we've seen is bounded above by $\#H$. $\square$

Now we may demonstrate straightforward criteria for subfield to be normal

Proposition 3.18.133

Let K/k be a finite Galois extension and $k \subset F \subset K$ a subfield.

Then F/k is Galois if and only if $\text{Gal}(K/F) \triangleleft \text{Gal}(K/k)$ is normal. In this case we have a canonical isomorphism

$$\text{Gal}(K/k)/\text{Gal}(K/F) \rightarrow \text{Gal}(F/k)$$

Proof. Recall from (3.18.79) we have F/k is normal iff $\sigma(F) = F$ for all $\sigma \in \text{Gal}(K/k)$. Recall K/F is normal for all subfields F . Furthermore, we observe that

$$\text{Gal}(K/\sigma(F)) = \sigma \text{Gal}(K/F) \sigma^{-1}$$

By the correspondence (3.18.127) $\text{Gal}(K/F) = \text{Gal}(K/F') \iff F = F'$. Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} F/k \text{ normal} &\iff \sigma(F) = F \quad \forall \sigma \in \text{Gal}(K/k) \\ &\iff \text{Gal}(K/\sigma(F)) = \text{Gal}(K/F) \quad \forall \sigma \in \text{Gal}(K/k) \\ &\iff \sigma \text{Gal}(K/F) \sigma^{-1} = \text{Gal}(K/F) \quad \forall \sigma \in \text{Gal}(K/k) \\ &\iff \text{Gal}(K/F) \triangleleft \text{Gal}(K/k) \end{aligned}$$

The result then follows from (3.18.83). $\square$

3.18.16 Norm and Trace

In what follows we assume that K is a commutative ring and A is a K -algebra which is finite free as a K -module (free is automatic when K is a field).

Definition 3.18.134 (Norm, Trace and Characteristic Polynomial)

For $\alpha \in A$ consider the K -linear multiplication map

$$\text{mult}_{\alpha, K} : A \rightarrow A$$

and define

- a) $\text{Tr}_{A/K}(\alpha) := \text{Tr}(\text{mult}_{\alpha}) \in K$
- b) $\text{Norm}_{A/K}(\alpha) := \det(\text{mult}_{\alpha}) \in K$
- c) $\text{Pc}_{A/K}(\alpha; X) := \chi_{\text{mult}_{\alpha}} = \det(\text{mult}_{X - \alpha, K[X]}) = \det(X \cdot I_n - [\text{mult}_{\alpha}]) \in K[X]$ the characteristic polynomial.

Proposition 3.18.135

With the notation as in (3.18.134) we have the following properties

- a) $\text{Tr}(\alpha + \beta) = \text{Tr}(\alpha) + \text{Tr}(\beta)$
- b) $\text{Tr}(\alpha\beta) = \text{Tr}(\beta\alpha)$
- c) $\text{Norm}(\alpha\beta) = \text{Norm}(\alpha) \text{Norm}(\beta)$

and further that

$$\text{Pc}(\alpha; X) = X^n - \text{Tr}(\alpha)X^{n-1} + \dots + (-1)^n \text{Norm}(\alpha)$$

Finally for $\lambda \in K$ we have

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Tr}(\lambda) &= \dim_k A \cdot \lambda \\ \text{Norm}(\lambda) &= \lambda^{\dim_k A} \end{aligned}$$

Proof. We prove each in turn

- a) We have $\text{mult}_{\alpha+\beta} = \text{mult}_{\alpha} + \text{mult}_{\beta}$ and ordinary trace is additive (3.6.24).
- b) When A is commutative this is obvious, however even in general we have $\text{mult}_{\alpha\beta} = \text{mult}_{\alpha} \circ \text{mult}_{\beta}$ and so the result follows from symmetry of the ordinary trace (3.6.25)

c) This follows similarly because the determinant is multiplicative (3.6.17).

The identity for the characteristic polynomial follows directly from (3.17.7). Finally the matrix representation of mult_λ is simply $\lambda \cdot I_n$ with respect to any basis. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.136 (Characteristic Polynomial is a Norm)

For $\alpha \in A$ we have the relationship

$$\text{Pc}_{A/K}(\alpha; X) = \text{Norm}_{A[X]/K[X]}(X - \alpha)$$

Proof. This follows from the definitions and (3.17.7). $\square$

Proposition 3.18.137

Let M be a finite free A -module. Then M is a finite free K -module. Explicitly given a basis (m_j) of M over A and (a_i) of A over K , then $(a_i \cdot m_j)$ is a basis for M over K .

If $u : M \rightarrow M$ is an endomorphism then we denote by u_K the endomorphism of M regarded as a (finite free) K -module.

Proposition 3.18.138 (Transitivity of Trace)

Suppose A is commutative, M is a finite free A -module and $u : M \rightarrow M$ an endomorphism. Then

$$\text{Tr}(u_K) = \text{Tr}_{A/K}(\text{Tr}(u))$$

and

$$\det(u_K) = \text{Norm}_{A/K}(\det(u))$$

Proof. Let $(e_1, \dots, e_m)$ be an A -basis for M and $(a_1, \dots, a_n)$ be a K -basis for A . Then by (3.18.137) $(a_i \cdot e_j)$ is a K -basis for M . For $\alpha \in A$ let $M(\alpha) \in \text{Mat}_n(K)$ denote the matrix corresponding mult_α and let $(c_{lj}) \in \text{Mat}_m(A)$ be the matrix of u with respect to (e_j) . By definition this means

$$u(e_j) = \sum_{l=1}^m c_{lj} \cdot e_l$$

and

$$a_i \alpha = \alpha a_i = \sum_{k=1}^n M(\alpha)_{ki} a_k.$$

Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} u_K(a_i e_j) &= a_i u(e_j) \\ &= a_i \cdot \left(\sum_{l=1}^m c_{lj} \cdot e_l \right) \\ &= \sum_{l=1}^m (a_i c_{lj}) \cdot e_l \\ &= \sum_{l=1}^m \left(\sum_{k=1}^n M(c_{lj})_{ki} a_k \right) \cdot e_l \\ &= \sum_{l=1}^m \sum_{k=1}^n M(c_{lj})_{ki} \cdot (a_k \cdot e_l) \end{aligned}$$

Consequently the matrix for u_K with respect to the basis $(a_i \cdot e_j)$ is given in block form by

$$\begin{pmatrix} M(c_{11}) & \cdots & M(c_{1m}) \\ \vdots & & \vdots \\ M(c_{m1}) & \cdots & M(c_{mm}) \end{pmatrix}$$

Therefore we see that

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Tr}(u_K) &= \sum_{j=1}^m \text{Tr}(M(c_{jj})) \\
 &= \sum_{j=1}^m \text{Tr}_{A/K}(c_{jj}) \\
 &= \text{Tr}_{A/K} \left(\sum_{j=1}^m c_{jj} \right) \\
 &= \text{Tr}_{A/K}(\text{Tr}(u))
 \end{aligned}$$

as required. Similarly by (3.6.33)

$$\det(u_K) = \det(D_m(M(c_{11}), \dots, M(c_{mm})))$$

and by the Laplace Expansion

$$\begin{aligned}
 D_m(M(c_{11}), \dots, M(c_{mm})) &= \sum_{\sigma \in S_m} \epsilon(\sigma) \prod_{i=1}^m M(c_{i\sigma(i)}) \\
 &= \sum_{\sigma \in S_m} \epsilon(\sigma) M \left(\prod_{i=1}^m c_{i\sigma(i)} \right) \\
 &= M \left(\sum_{\sigma \in S_m} \epsilon(\sigma) \prod_{i=1}^m c_{i\sigma(i)} \right) \\
 &= M(\det(u))
 \end{aligned}$$

where we implicitly use that $\alpha \rightarrow \text{mult}_\alpha \rightarrow M(\alpha)$ is a ring homomorphism. Therefore by definition

$$\det(u_K) = \det(M(\det(u))) = \text{Tr}_{A/K}(\det(u))$$

□

Corollary 3.18.139 (Transitivity)

Suppose B is a commutative A -algebra which is finite free as an A -module. Then

$$\text{Tr}_{B/K}(b) = \text{Tr}_{A/K}(\text{Tr}_{B/A}(b))$$

and

$$\text{Norm}_{B/K}(b) = \text{Norm}_{A/K}(\text{Norm}_{B/A}(b))$$

for all $b \in B$. Furthermore

$$\text{Pc}_{B/K}(b; X) = \text{Norm}_{A[X]/K[X]}(\text{Pc}_{B/A}(b; X))$$

Proposition 3.18.140

Let K/k be a finite field extension and $\alpha \in L$. Then

$$\text{Pc}_{K/k}(\alpha; X) = m_{\alpha,k}(X)^{[K:k(\alpha)]}$$

Proof. Consider first the case $K = k(\alpha)$. Then by (3.17.4) we have $\text{Pc}_{K/k}(\alpha; X)(\text{mult}_\alpha) = 0$ and in particular $\text{Pc}_{K/k}(\alpha; X)(\alpha) = 0$ (since $\alpha^n = \alpha^n \cdot 1$). By (...) $m_{\alpha,k} \mid \text{Pc}_{K/k}(\alpha; X)$. Further by (...) $\deg(m_{\alpha,k}) = [k(\alpha) : k] = [K : k] = \deg(\text{Pc}_{K/k}(\alpha; X))$. Since they are both monic then we find they are equal.

For the general case we may write the matrix for mult_α in block form by considering the tower basis for $K/k(\alpha)/k$ (see (3.18.137)). This is block diagonal, so we may use the Liebniz formula to compute this directly as product of determinants of the blocks. □

We may pull together these results to give a more classical expression for norm and trace.

Proposition 3.18.141

Let $L/K/k$ be a tower of extensions such that L/k is normal (e.g. $L = \bar{k}$). Then for any $\alpha \in K$ we have the identities

$$i_{kL}(\text{Norm}_{K/k}(\alpha)) = \left(\prod_{\sigma \in \text{Mor}_k(K, L)} \sigma(\alpha) \right)^{[K:k]_i}$$

and

$$i_{kL}(\text{Tr}_{K/k}(\alpha)) = [K:k]_i \sum_{\sigma \in \text{Mor}_k(K,L)} \sigma(\alpha)$$

Proof. Recall from (3.18.90) that the restriction map

$$\text{Mor}_k(K, L) \rightarrow \text{Mor}_k(k(\alpha), L)$$

is surjective with finite fibers of order $[K:k(\alpha)]_s$. Therefore we may write the right hand side as

$$\begin{aligned} \left(\prod_{\sigma \in \text{Mor}_k(K,L)} \sigma(\alpha) \right)^{[K:k]_i} &= \left(\prod_{\sigma \in \text{Mor}_k(k(\alpha), L)} \sigma(\alpha) \right)^{[K:k(\alpha)]_s [K:k]_i} \\ &= \left(\prod_{\sigma \in \text{Mor}_k(k(\alpha), L)} \sigma(\alpha) \right)^{[K:k(\alpha)][k(\alpha):k]_i} \end{aligned}$$

Similarly by (3.18.139) and (3.18.135) the left hand side may be written as

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Norm}_{K/k}(\alpha) &= \text{Norm}_{k(\alpha)/k}(\text{Norm}_{K/k(\alpha)}(\alpha)) \\ &= \text{Norm}_{k(\alpha)/k}(\alpha^{[K:k(\alpha)]}) \\ &= \text{Norm}_{k(\alpha)/k}(\alpha)^{[K:k(\alpha)]} \end{aligned}$$

Comparing these expressions shows we may reduce to the case $K = k(\alpha)$.

From (3.18.61) and (3.18.106) the right hand side is the product of all the roots of $m_{\alpha,k}$ including multiplicity, which is $(-1)^{[K:k]} i_{kL}(c_0)$ where c_0 is the constant term of $m_{\alpha,k}(X)$. Then using (3.18.140) and (3.18.135) we see that this also equals $i_{kL}(\text{Norm}_{k(\alpha)/k}(\alpha))$ as required.

The case of trace is similar. □

Lemma 3.18.142 (Dedekind's Lemma)

Let K/k be a field extension and A a k -algebra. The set of k -algebra homomorphisms

$$\text{AlgHom}_k(A, K)$$

is K -linearly independent as a subset of $\text{Hom}_k(A, K)$.

Proof. Suppose that the k -algebra homomorphisms are not linearly independent. Then choose a minimal subset of distinct k -algebra homomorphisms $\phi_1, \dots, \phi_n$ with a non-trivial relationship over K

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i \phi_i = 0 \quad \lambda_i \in K^*$$

If $n = 1$ then $\phi_1 = 0$ which is a contradiction. Suppose without loss of generality that $n > 1$. For a given $x \in K$ we may define

$$\widehat{\phi}_i := (\phi_i(x) - \phi_n(x)) \phi_i \quad i = 1 \dots n-1$$

We may choose x such that at least one is non-zero. Then for all $y \in A$ we have

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n-1} \lambda_i \widehat{\phi}_i(y) = \sum_{i=1}^{n-1} \lambda_i (\phi_i(x) - \phi_n(x)) \phi_i(y) = \sum_{i=1}^{n-1} \lambda_i \phi_i(xy) - \phi_n(x) \sum_{i=1}^{n-1} \lambda_i \phi_i(y) = 0$$

This contradicts minimality of the subset. □

Proposition 3.18.143

Let K/k be a finite extension. Then the following are equivalent

- a) K/k is separable
- b) $\text{Tr}_{K/k}$ is not identically zero
- c) The bilinear form

$$(x, y) \rightarrow \text{Tr}_{K/k}(xy)$$

is a perfect pairing (see (3.4.148)).

Proof. $c) \implies b)$ By (3.4.148) for all $0 \neq x \in K$ we have $y \rightarrow \text{Tr}_{K/k}(xy)$ is non-zero, so there exists y such that $\text{Tr}_{K/k}(xy) \neq 0$ as required.

$b) \implies c)$ By (3.4.149) it's enough to show that for all $0 \neq x \in K$ the map $y \rightarrow \text{Tr}_{K/k}(xy)$ is non-zero. By assumption there exists some z such that $\text{Tr}_{K/k}(z) \neq 0$ then we may consider $y = z/x$.

$a) \implies b)$ By (3.18.105) $[K : k]_i = 1$, and so from (3.18.141) the trace equals $\sum_{\sigma} \sigma$, which is non-zero by (3.18.142).

$b) \implies a)$ Suppose K/k is not separable then $[K : k]_i$ is a power of p (3.18.107), and so the trace is zero by (3.18.141). $\square$

3.18.17 Transcendental Field Extensions

Definition 3.18.144 (Algebraic Independence)

Let K/k be a field extension and $S \subset K$. We say S is **algebraically independent** over k if for every finite subset of distinct elements $x_1, \dots, x_n \in S$ we have

$$f(x_1, \dots, x_n) = 0 \implies f = 0$$

for all $f \in k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$.

For a subset $S \subset K$ define the **closure operator**

$$c(S) := \overline{k(S)} \cap K := \{x \in K \mid x \text{ algebraic over } k(S)\}$$

We say Γ is **algebraically spanning** if $c(\Gamma) = K$, equivalently if $K/k(\Gamma)$ is algebraic.

We say that $\mathcal{B}$ is a **transcendence base** if it is both algebraically independent and spanning (i.e. $K/k(\mathcal{B})$ is algebraic).

Essentially we show that (K, c) satisfies the properties of a **matroid**, in analogy with vector spaces, so that we can use the results of Section 2.3 to show that that transcendence bases exist and they satisfy certain properties.

Proposition 3.18.145

Let K/k be a field extension and S, T subsets of K . Then the following are equivalent

- a) $S \cup T$ is algebraically independent and $S \cap T = \emptyset$
- b) S is algebraically independent over k and T is algebraically independent over $k(S)$
- c) T is algebraically independent over k and S is algebraically independent over $k(T)$

Proof. By symmetry it's enough to show that $a) \iff b)$.

Suppose $a)$ holds, then a-fortiori S is algebraically independent over k . Suppose T is algebraically dependent over $k(S)$, then there exists $t_1, \dots, t_n \in T$ such that $F(x_1, \dots, x_n) = 0$ for some $0 \neq F \in k(S)[X_1, \dots, X_n]$. By clearing denominators we may assume that $F \in k[S][X_1, \dots, X_n]$. As there are only finitely many coefficients we may also take $S = \{s_1, \dots, s_m\}$ to be finite. Explicitly

$$F(X_1, \dots, X_n) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}^n} \lambda_{\alpha} X_1^{\alpha_1} \dots X_n^{\alpha_n}$$

and

$$\lambda_{\alpha} = G_{\alpha}(s_1, \dots, s_m)$$

for some $G_{\alpha} \in k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m]$. We may then define $\widehat{F} \in k[X_1, \dots, X_n, Y_1, \dots, Y_m]$ by

$$\widehat{F}(X_1, \dots, X_n, Y_1, \dots, Y_m) := \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{N}^n} G_{\alpha}(Y_1, \dots, Y_m) X_1^{\alpha_1} \dots X_n^{\alpha_n}$$

Then $\widehat{F}(t_1, \dots, t_n, s_1, \dots, s_m) = 0$, and by assumption this is an algebraic dependence (as $S \cap T = \emptyset$). Therefore by assumption $\widehat{F} = 0$ and in particular $G_{\alpha}(s_1, \dots, s_m) = 0$ for all α . This implies $F = 0$, a contradiction.

$b) \implies a)$ Evidently $S \cap T = \emptyset$ otherwise there is a trivial algebraic dependence of T on $k(S)$. Suppose there is an algebraic dependence of $S \cup T$ on k . We may assume wlog that $S = \{s_1, \dots, s_m\}$ and $T = \{t_1, \dots, t_n\}$ are finite. Then the evaluation homomorphism

$$k[X_1, \dots, X_n, Y_1, \dots, Y_m] \rightarrow K$$

may be written as a composite

$$k[X_1, \dots, X_n, Y_1, \dots, Y_m] \rightarrow k(S)[X_1, \dots, X_n] \rightarrow K$$

which are both injective by hypothesis. $\square$

Corollary 3.18.146 (Exchange Property)

Let K/k be a field extension, $\Gamma \subseteq K$. Suppose x is algebraic over $k(\Gamma \cup \{y\})$ and transcendental over $k(\Gamma)$, then y is algebraic over $k(\Gamma \cup \{x\})$.

Proof. By considering the extension $K/k(\Gamma)$ we may reduce to the case $\Gamma = \emptyset$.

It's enough to show that x transcendental over k and y transcendental over $k(x)$ implies x transcendental over $k(y)$. This follows directly from (3.18.145) by considering $S = \{x\}$ and $T = \{y\}$. $\square$

Corollary 3.18.147 (Extension Property)

Let K/k be a field extension, $S \subseteq K$ algebraically independent and $x \in K$ transcendental over $k(S)$. Then $S \cup \{x\}$ is algebraically independent.

Proof. Follows immediately from (3.18.145). $\square$

Corollary 3.18.148 (Equivalent form of independence)

Let K/k be a field extension and $S \subset K$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) S is algebraically independent
- b) x is transcendental over $k(S \setminus \{x\})$ for all $x \in S$

In other words the algebraically independent subsets are precisely the matroid independent subsets.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) Follows from (3.18.145).

b) $\implies$ a) Let $\mathcal{F}$ be the family of algebraically independent subsets. We've shown that all such sets are also matroid independent, and by definition the family is of finite character. Furthermore by (3.18.147) it satisfies the extension property. Therefore by (2.3.6) it is precisely the family of matroid independent sets. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.149 (Transcendence Base Exists)

Let K/k be a field extension. Suppose S is an algebraic independent subset of K and $\Gamma \supset S$ is such that $K/k(\Gamma)$ is algebraic. Then there exists a transcendence base $\mathcal{B}$ such that $S \subseteq \mathcal{B} \subseteq \Gamma$.

Proof. This is (2.3.7). $\square$

Proposition 3.18.150 (Transcendence Base)

Let K/k be a field extension and $S \subset K$ a subset. Then the following are equivalent

- a) S is a **transcendence base**
- b) S is a maximal algebraically independent set
- c) S is minimal under the condition $K/k(S)$ is algebraic

When K/k admits a finite algebraic spanning set then all bases are finite of the same size (**transcendence degree**). Write this as $\text{trdeg}(K/k)$ or $\text{trdeg}_k(K)$.

Proof. Follows from (2.3.8) and (2.3.11). $\square$

Proposition 3.18.151

Let K/k be a field extension of finite transcendence degree and $S \subset K$ a subset. Then

- S algebraically independent $\implies |S| \leq \text{trdeg}(K/k)$
- $K/k(S)$ is algebraic $\implies |S| \geq \text{trdeg}(K/k)$

Proof. Follows directly from (2.3.12). $\square$

Proposition 3.18.152

Let K/k be a field extension of finite transcendence degree and $S \subset K$ a subset. Then the following are equivalent

- S is a transcendence base
- S is algebraically independent and $|S| \geq \text{trdeg}(K/k)$
- $K/k(S)$ is algebraic and $|S| \leq \text{trdeg}(K/k)$

In this case $|S| = \text{trdeg}(K/k)$.

Proof. Follows directly from (2.3.13). $\square$

In case K/k is finitely generated then we guarantee that $K/k(S)$ is finite.

Proposition 3.18.153

Let K/k be a finitely generated field extension. Then

- $\text{trdeg}(K/k) < \infty$
- Suppose $K/k(\Gamma)$ is algebraic then it is in fact finite.

Proof. a) If K/k is finitely generated then the set of generators is algebraically spanning and so $\text{trdeg}(K/k) < \infty$ by (3.18.150)

b) A-fortiori $K/k(\Gamma)$ is finitely generated and by assumption algebraic so by (...) it is finite □

3.18.18 Separating Transcendence Base

In applications the existence of a separating transcendence base is important, and is guaranteed when k is perfect, or a weaker condition.

Definition 3.18.154 (Separating Transcendence Base)

A field extension K/k is **separably generated** if there exists a transcendence base S such that $K/k(S)$ is separable (and algebraic). We call such an S a **separating transcendence base**.

Note when $\text{char}(k) = 0$ then every transcendence base is separating.

Definition 3.18.155 (MacLane's Criterion)

We say that an algebra A/k of characteristic exponent p satisfies **MacLane's Criterion** if it is reduced and for all $a_1, \dots, a_n \in K$ the following property holds

$$\{a_1, \dots, a_n\} \text{ } k\text{-linearly independent} \implies \{a_1^p, \dots, a_n^p\} \text{ } k\text{-linearly independent}$$

When $p = 1$ this is trivially always satisfied and when $p > 1$ such an algebra is automatically reduced by the following result

Lemma 3.18.156

Let A be a k -algebra and $m > 1$ an integer. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is reduced
- b) $x^m = 0 \implies x = 0$

In particular if A has characteristic exponent $p > 1$ then it is reduced iff the Frobenius homomorphism is injective.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) is trivial. Conversely suppose $x^n = 0$. Then there exists $a > 0$ such that $n \leq am$. In particular $x^{am} = 0$ and therefore by induction $x = 0$ as required. □

This is a generalization of the case of a perfect base field by the following result.

Proposition 3.18.157 (Perfect $\implies$ MacLane)

Let A/k be a reduced algebra with k **perfect**. Then it satisfies MacLane's Criterion.

In particular this holds for every field extension K/k of a perfect base field.

Proof. By assumption A is reduced so we may consider only the case $p > 1$.

Suppose $0 = \sum_i \lambda_i a_i^p$ then by hypothesis $\lambda_i = \mu_i^p$. By (3.18.6) $0 = (\sum_i \mu_i a_i)^p$. As A is reduced we find $0 = \sum_i \mu_i a_i$ as required. □

Lemma 3.18.158

Let $n \geq 0$ an integer and $K = k(x_1, \dots, x_{n+1})$ an extension of k such that

- $\text{char}(k) \neq 0$
- $\{x_1, \dots, x_n\}$ is a transcendence base
- K/k satisfies MacLane's Criterion

Then for some x_i the set $\{x_1, \dots, \widehat{x_i}, \dots, x_{n+1}\}$ is a **separating transcendence base** for K/k .

Note when $n = 0$ this means precisely that a simple algebraic extension satisfying MacLane's Criterion is separable.

Proof. By assumption x_{n+1} is algebraic over $k(x_1, \dots, x_n)$, and therefore there exists a non-zero $F \in k[X_1, \dots, X_{n+1}]$ such that $F(x_1, \dots, x_{n+1}) = 0$. Let F be such a polynomial of minimal total degree (total degree = the maximum degree of a monomial with non-zero coefficient appearing in F). We claim it is irreducible. For suppose not, then one of the irreducible factors must vanish at $(x_1, \dots, x_{n+1})$, and this factor would have smaller total degree.

We wish to show that not all powers of X_i appearing in F are multiples of p . Suppose this were the case then the monomials

$$\{x_1^{\alpha_1} \dots x_{n+1}^{\alpha_{n+1}} \mid \lambda_\alpha \neq 0\}$$

are k -linearly dependent where λ_α are the coefficients of F and $\alpha \in \mathbb{N}^{n+1}$. Then by MacLane's Criterion the set

$$\{x_1^{\alpha_1/p} \dots x_{n+1}^{\alpha_{n+1}/p} \mid \lambda_\alpha \neq 0\}$$

is linearly dependent. This contradicts the minimality of F .

Choose X_i for which a non p -th power appears in F and define

$$F_i(T) := F(x_1, \dots, x_{i-1}, T, x_i, \dots, x_{n+1}) \in k[S_i][T]$$

where $S_i := \{x_1, \dots, \widehat{x_i}, \dots, x_{n+1}\}$. By assumption $F_i(T)$ is non-zero and clearly $F_i(x_i) = 0$ so that x_i , and therefore by (3.18.57) K is algebraic over $k(S_i)$. By (3.18.152) S_i is a transcendence base for K and in particular algebraically independent. Therefore $k[S_i][T]$ may be identified with $k[X_1, \dots, X_{n+1}]$ and we may conclude that $F_i(T)$ is irreducible. Further $k[S_i]$ is a UFD so by (3.16.33) $F_i(T)$ is irreducible as a polynomial in $k(S_i)[T]$. By construction $F_i(T) \notin k(S_i)[T^p]$ so by (3.18.104) F_i is separable. Therefore x_i is separable over $k(S_i)$, and $K/k(S_i)$ is separable by (3.18.92) as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.18.159

Let K/k be a finitely-generated field extension which satisfies MacLane's Criterion (e.g. k is perfect). Then K/k is separably generated.

More precisely every generating set contains a separating transcendence base.

Proof. When $\text{char}(k) = 0$ the generating set contains a transcendence base by (3.18.150). Every subfield of K also has characteristic 0, so then we are done by (3.18.115). So we may only consider the positive characteristic case, $p > 1$.

Suppose $K = k(x_1, \dots, x_n)$. By (3.18.149) there is a (possibly empty) subset which is a transcendence base, say $\{x_1, \dots, x_d\}$ after renumbering. By (3.18.57) $[K : K'] < \infty$ where $K' = k(x_1, \dots, x_d)$, and we may choose K' such that the degree of inseparability $[K : K']_i$ is minimal. If K/K' is separable then we are done. Otherwise we may assume by renumbering that $K'(x_{d+1})/K$ is not separable (3.18.92) and therefore $[K'(x_{d+1}) : K']_i > 1$. Then by (3.18.158) $[K'(x_{d+1}) : K'']_i = 1$ where $K'' := k(x_1, \dots, \widehat{x_j}, \dots, x_{d+1})$. By multiplicativity

$$[K : K']_i = [K : K'(x_{d+1})]_i [K'(x_{d+1}) : K']_i > [K : K'(x_{d+1})]_i [K'(x_{d+1}) : K'']_i = [K : K'']_i$$

which contradicts minimality. $\square$

3.19 Local Rings

Local rings arise quite naturally when localizing at a prime ideal (see (3.7.35) and (3.19.4)) so we recall some basic properties here.

Definition 3.19.1 (Local Ring)

A ring A is a **local ring** if it has a unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$. The field $A/\mathfrak{m}$ is called the **residue field** of A and sometimes denoted $\kappa(\mathfrak{m})$.

When A is a k -algebra we may denote the residue field by $k(\mathfrak{m})$.

Definition 3.19.2 (Local Homomorphism)

Let $(A, \mathfrak{m}_A)$ and $(B, \mathfrak{m}_B)$ be local rings. A ring homomorphism $\phi: A \rightarrow B$ is said to be a local homomorphism if

$$\phi(\mathfrak{m}_A) \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_B$$

Recall that the group of units $A^\star$ of a ring is a saturated multiplicative set, that is

$$xy \in A^\star \iff x \in A^\star \wedge y \in A^\star$$

Proposition 3.19.3 (Criteria for Local Rings)

Let A be a ring. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is a local ring
- b) $A \setminus A^\star$ is an additive subgroup of A

In this case $\mathfrak{m} = A \setminus A^\star$ is the unique maximal ideal of A .

Proof. 1 $\implies$ 2) Let $\mathfrak{m}$ be the unique maximal ideal then, because it's proper, $\mathfrak{m} \cap A^\star = \emptyset \implies \mathfrak{m} \subseteq A \setminus A^\star$ by (3.4.13). Conversely given $x \in A \setminus A^\star$ then (x) is a proper ideal by (3.4.32), and therefore contained in a maximal ideal (3.4.15) which by uniqueness means $x \in \mathfrak{m}$.

2 $\implies$ 1) Define $\mathfrak{m} = A \setminus A^\star$ it's a (prime) ideal because it is an additive subgroup and $A^\star$ is a saturated multiplicative set. Let $\mathfrak{a}$ be a proper ideal then $\mathfrak{a} \cap A^\star = \emptyset \implies \mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}$. Therefore $\mathfrak{m}$ is the unique maximal ideal. $\square$

Example 3.19.4

Let A be a ring and $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A$ a prime ideal. Then $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a local ring with unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$.

When $A \subset K$ is a subring of a field then $A \subset A_{\mathfrak{p}} \subset K$ in a natural way.

We may use this to provide another criteria

Lemma 3.19.5 (Criteria for Local Domain)

Let $A \subset K$ be a subring of a field with a prime ideal $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A$. Then $A \subset A_{\mathfrak{p}}$.

A is a local ring with unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ if and only if $A = A_{\mathfrak{p}}$,

Proof. We've observed that $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a local ring with unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$.

If $A = A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ then it is a local ring and $\mathfrak{p} \subset \mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$. For $y \notin \mathfrak{p}$, then $\frac{1}{y} \in A_{\mathfrak{p}} \implies \frac{1}{y} \in A$. So we see that $x \in \mathfrak{p}, y \notin \mathfrak{p}$ we have $\frac{x}{y} \in \mathfrak{p}$ and $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$.

Conversely suppose A is a local ring with unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{p}$. Then $y \notin \mathfrak{p} \implies y \in A^\star$ and $A_{\mathfrak{p}} = A$ as required. $\square$

3.20 Modules over Local Rings (Nakayama's Lemma)

The main result of this section (3.20.7) is that every finitely-generated module over a local ring has a [minimal spanning set](#). Recall in the vector space case a minimal spanning set is precisely a basis (2.3.8). Analogously we may also show that (in the local case) every minimal spanning set has the same order. The crucial result is Nakayama's Lemma, which we develop here.

Definition 3.20.1 (Jacobson Radical)

Let A be a commutative ring. Define the **Jacobson Radical** to be the intersection of all maximal ideals

$$\sqrt{0}^J := \bigcap_{\mathfrak{m} \triangleleft A} \mathfrak{m}$$

Proposition 3.20.2

The Jacobson Radical $\sqrt{0}^J$ is a proper ideal

Example 3.20.3

When $(A, \mathfrak{m}_A)$ is a local ring then $\sqrt{0}^J = \mathfrak{m}_A$.

Lemma 3.20.4 (Characterization of Jacobson Radical)

For an ideal $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{m}$ a maximal ideal

- a) $\mathfrak{a} \not\subseteq \mathfrak{m} \iff \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{m} = A \iff (1 + \mathfrak{a}) \cap \mathfrak{m} \neq \emptyset$
- b) $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \sqrt{0}^J \iff 1 + \mathfrak{a} \subseteq A^\star$
- c) $x \in \sqrt{0}^J \iff 1 + (x) \subseteq A^\star$

Proof. We prove each in turn.

- a) Clearly $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{m} \implies \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{m} = \mathfrak{m}$. Conversely $\mathfrak{a} \not\subseteq \mathfrak{m} \implies \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{m} = A$ by maximality. Suppose $\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{m} = A$ then $1 = a + m$ whence $(1 - a) \in \mathfrak{m}$. The converse is similar.
- b) By a) $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \sqrt{0}^J \implies (1 + \mathfrak{a}) \cap \mathfrak{m} = \emptyset$ for all maximal ideals $\mathfrak{m}$. By (3.4.15) this implies $(1 + \mathfrak{a}) \subseteq A^\star$.
Conversely if $(1 + \mathfrak{a}) \subseteq A^\star$ then $(1 + \mathfrak{a}) \cap \mathfrak{m} = \emptyset$ for any maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$ by (3.4.13). Again by a) $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}$ as required.
- c) This follows from b) and noting $x \in \sqrt{0}^J \iff (x) \subseteq \sqrt{0}^J$.

□

Proposition 3.20.5 (Nakayama's Lemma)

Let M be a finitely generated A -module and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ an ideal. Then the following holds

- a) If $M = \mathfrak{a}M$ then there exists $a \in \mathfrak{a}$ such that $m = am$ for all $m \in M$

Suppose in addition that $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \sqrt{0}^J$ (e.g. if A is [local](#) and $\mathfrak{a}$ is proper) then

- b) $M = \mathfrak{a}M \implies M = 0$
- c) $N \leq M$ and $M = N + \mathfrak{a}M \implies M = N$.

Proof. We prove each in turn

- a) Apply (3.17.4) with $\phi := \mathbf{1}_M$ to find a monic polynomial $P(X) \in A[X]$ with non-leading coefficients in $\mathfrak{a}$ such that $P(\phi)(m) = 0$ for all $m \in M$. Then we see that $(1 + a_{n-1} + \dots + a_0)m = 0$ for all $m \in M$ whence $a := -(a_{n-1} + \dots + a_0)$ is the required element.

More directly, suppose $m_1, \dots, m_n$ is a generating set for M . By Lemma 3.17.3 (and $M = \mathfrak{a}M$) there is a matrix E with coefficients in $\mathfrak{a}$ such that

$$(I_n - E)\mathbf{m} = 0$$

where $\mathbf{m}$ is the column vector consisting of $m_1, \dots, m_n$. By Proposition ?? we see $\det(I_n - E)m_i = 0$ for all $i = 1 \dots n$. It's enough to show $a := \det(I_n - E) \in 1 + \mathfrak{a}$. Observe

$$\det(I_n - E) = \prod_i (1 - E_{ii}) + \sum_{\sigma \neq id} \epsilon(\sigma) \prod_j E_{j\sigma(j)}$$

The second term lies in $\mathfrak{a}$ and

$$\prod_i (1 - E_{ii}) = 1 - \sum_{i=1}^n E_{ii} \prod_{j>i} (1 - E_{jj}) \in 1 + \mathfrak{a}$$

- b) Consider any $m \in M$. By [a](#)) we have $(1 - a)m = 0$ for some $a \in \mathfrak{a}$, and by [\(3.20.4\)](#) $(1 - a)$ is invertible, whence $m = 0$ as required.
- c) Observe $\mathfrak{a}(M/N) \stackrel{(3.4.107)}{=} (N + \mathfrak{a}M)/N = M/N$ whence $M/N = 0$ by [b](#)). Therefore $N = M$ as required.

We may show [b](#)) more directly. Suppose $M \neq 0$, and let $\{m_1, \dots, m_n\}$ be a non-zero generating set for M of minimal size. Then by [Lemma 3.17.3](#)

$$m_1 = \sum_j a_j m_j \quad a_j \in \mathfrak{a}$$

whence

$$(1 - a_1)m_1 = \sum_{j \geq 2} a_j m_j$$

As $a_1 \in \sqrt{0}^J$ we have $1 - a_1 \in A^*$ by [\(3.20.4\)](#). Then $\{m_2, \dots, m_n\}$ is a smaller generating set, a contradiction. Therefore $M = 0$.

[a](#)) may be deduced from [b](#)) as follows. Observe $S := 1 + \mathfrak{a}$ is a multiplicatively closed subset, so we may consider $S^{-1}M$ as an $S^{-1}A$ -module. It's easy to verify that $1 + S^{-1}\mathfrak{a} \subseteq (S^{-1}A)^*$ so by [Lemma 3.20.4](#) $S^{-1}\mathfrak{a} \subseteq J(S^{-1}A)$. Clearly $\mathfrak{a}M = M \implies (S^{-1}\mathfrak{a})S^{-1}M = S^{-1}M$ so by the weaker form $S^{-1}M = 0$. By [\(3.7.14\)](#) there exists $s \in S$ such that $sM = 0$, which is the required result as $s = 1 + a$ for some $a \in \mathfrak{a}$. $\square$

Recall [\(3.4.108\)](#) in the case of a local ring $(A, \mathfrak{m})$ that $\widetilde{M} := M/\mathfrak{m}M$ is a vector space over $k := A/\mathfrak{m}$. We may use Nakayama's Lemma to exhibit a correspondence between minimal spanning sets of M and bases of $M/\mathfrak{m}M$ as a k -vector space. First we prove a simpler form

Lemma 3.20.6

Let $(A, \mathfrak{m})$ be a local ring with residue field $k = A/\mathfrak{m}$, M a finite A -module and $S \subset M$ a subset. Then

$$S \text{ spans } M \iff \widetilde{S} \text{ spans } \widetilde{M}$$

where $\widetilde{\cdot}$ denotes reduction modulo $\mathfrak{m}M$.

Proof. One direction is obvious. Conversely suppose $\widetilde{S}$ spans $\widetilde{M}$. Define $N := \langle S \rangle$, then this means precisely that $N + \mathfrak{m}M = M$, so $N = M$ by [\(3.20.5\).c](#)) as required. $\square$

Recall from [\(2.1.56\)](#) that every subset of T of $M/\mathfrak{m}M$ may be written in the form $\widetilde{S}$ for $S \subset M$ and $\widetilde{\cdot}$ injective on S .

Proposition 3.20.7 (Structure theorem for modules over a local ring)

Let $(A, \mathfrak{m})$ be a local ring with residue field $k = A/\mathfrak{m}$, M a finite A -module. Then

- $\widetilde{M} := M/\mathfrak{m}M$ is a finite-dimensional k -module (of dimension n say)
- If $\widetilde{S}$ is a k -basis for $\widetilde{M}$ and $\widetilde{\cdot}|_S$ is injective, then S is a minimal spanning set for M and $\#S = \#\widetilde{S} = n$
- If S is a minimal spanning set then $\widetilde{S}$ is a basis for $\widetilde{M}$ (and $\widetilde{\cdot}|_S$ is injective so $\#S = \#\widetilde{S} = n$).

Proof. a) By [\(3.4.108\)](#) $\widetilde{M}$ is a k -module, and it's clearly finite.

- By the [\(3.20.6\)](#) S spans M . Suppose $S' \subset S$ spans M , then by the same result $\widetilde{S'}$ spans $\widetilde{M}$. Recall [\(2.3.8\)](#) that a vector space basis is precisely a minimal spanning set, so $\widetilde{S'} = \widetilde{S}$. As $\widetilde{\cdot}$ is injective this means $S' = S$. Therefore S is a minimal spanning set.

- c) Let S be a minimal spanning set. Then by (3.20.6) $\widetilde{S}$ spans $\widetilde{M}$. Suppose $\widetilde{T} \subset \widetilde{S}$ also spans $\widetilde{M}$. By (3.20.6) T spans $\widetilde{M}$, and by hypothesis $T = S$. Therefore $\widetilde{T} = \widetilde{S}$. As $\widetilde{T}$ was arbitrary we see that $\widetilde{S}$ is a minimal spanning set for $\widetilde{M}$, which by (2.3.8) is a basis.

Finally suppose $\widetilde{\cdot}$ is not injective on S , that is $\widetilde{s}_1 = \widetilde{s}_2$. Then $S' := S \setminus \{s_1\}$ satisfies $\widetilde{S}' = \widetilde{S}$. Therefore by the Lemma S' spans M , contradicting minimality.

□

3.21 Krull Dimension

Definition 3.21.1 (Krull Dimension)

Let A be a commutative ring. We say that a chain of distinct prime ideals

$$\mathfrak{p}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_1 \subsetneq \cdots \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_n$$

has **length** n .

- a) The **Krull dimension** $\dim A$ of S is the maximum length of all chains of prime ideals.
- b) The **height** of a prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$, denoted $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p})$, is the maximum length of chains of prime ideals contained in $\mathfrak{p}$. More generally define $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) = \inf\{\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) \mid \mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}\}$. By (3.4.43) we may take the infimum over only minimal prime ideals.
- c) The **dimension** of an ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$, denoted $\dim \mathfrak{a}$, is the maximum length of chains of prime ideals containing $\mathfrak{a}$.

We say A is **finite-dimensional** if $\dim A < \infty$. Observe that $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \iff \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ for any prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ so

$$\begin{aligned} \dim \mathfrak{a} &= \dim \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \\ \text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) &= \text{ht}(\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}) \end{aligned}$$

and we may, without loss of generality, consider only radical ideals.

Definition 3.21.2

Let A be a commutative ring. We say a chain of prime ideals is

- **maximal** if it's not properly contained in any chain
- **saturated** if $\mathfrak{p}_i \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}_{i+1} \implies \mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{p}_i$ or $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{p}_{i+1}$.

We say that A is **biequidimensional** if every maximal chain has the same length (equal to $\dim A$).

We say A is **quasi-biequidimensional** if $A/\mathfrak{p}$ is **biequidimensional** for every minimal prime $\mathfrak{p}$. Note that **equidimensional** + **quasi-biequidimensional** $\iff$ **biequidimensional**.

We say that A is **catenary** if the length of a saturated chain

$$\mathfrak{p}_0 \subsetneq \cdots \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_n$$

depends only on $\mathfrak{p}_0$ and $\mathfrak{p}_n$ and is equal to $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}_n/\mathfrak{p}_0)$

We say that A is **equidimensional** if every minimal prime ideal has the same dimension (equal to $\dim A$). Note an **irreducible** ring has only one minimal prime ideal so is trivially equidimensional.

We say that A is **equicodimensional** if every maximal ideal has the same height (equal to $\dim A$).

In order to connect this to the lattice-theoretic notion of Krull Dimension in Section 2.5 we prove the following result (provided we consider the lattice of radical ideals ordered by *reverse* inclusion).

Proposition 3.21.3

Let A be a ring then the **lattice of radical ideals** $\text{Rad}(A)$ is **distributive**, that is we have equality

$$\mathfrak{r}_1 \cap \sqrt{\mathfrak{r}_2 + \mathfrak{r}_3} = \sqrt{\mathfrak{r}_1 \cap \mathfrak{r}_2 + \mathfrak{r}_1 \cap \mathfrak{r}_3}$$

Furthermore the **meet-prime** radical ideals are precisely the prime ideals. Therefore the lattice of radical ideals of a finite-dimensional Noetherian ring, ordered by **reverse inclusion**, is a **Krull Lattice**.

Proof. Clearly it's enough to show that $\text{LHS} \subseteq \text{RHS}$. Suppose $x \in \text{LHS}$ then $x \in \mathfrak{r}_1$ and $x^n = a + b$ where $a \in \mathfrak{r}_2$ and $b \in \mathfrak{r}_3$. Then $x^{n+1} = ax + bx \in \mathfrak{r}_1 \cap \mathfrak{r}_2 + \mathfrak{r}_1 \cap \mathfrak{r}_3$ whence $x \in \text{RHS}$.

We've shown that prime ideals are meet-prime (3.4.39). Suppose $\mathfrak{r}$ is a meet-prime radical ideal, and $fg \in \mathfrak{r}$. Then we claim that

$$\sqrt{\mathfrak{r} + (f)} \cap \sqrt{\mathfrak{r} + (g)} \subseteq \mathfrak{r}$$

For $x \in \text{LHS} \implies x^n \in \mathfrak{r} + (f)$ and $x^m \in \mathfrak{r} + (g) \implies x^{n+m} \in \mathfrak{r} \implies x \in \mathfrak{r}$. As $\mathfrak{r}$ is meet-prime then for example $\sqrt{\mathfrak{r} + (f)} \subseteq \mathfrak{r}$ and in particular $f \in \mathfrak{r}$. Therefore $\mathfrak{r}$ is also prime. $\square$

Remark 3.21.4

This is easier to see in light of the dual isomorphism in ??, because the closed sets of a topological space trivially form a distributive lattice, and the irreducible closed subsets of a topological space are precisely the join-prime elements of this lattice.

Proposition 3.21.5 (Simple properties)

The following properties of Krull dimension hold

- a) $\dim A = \dim A/N(A)$
- b) $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = \dim A_{\mathfrak{p}}$
- c) $\dim \mathfrak{a} = \dim A/\mathfrak{a}$
- d) $\dim \mathfrak{a} = \dim \mathfrak{a}/\mathfrak{b}$ for any ideal $\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$
- e) $\dim A = \sup_{\mathfrak{p}} \dim A_{\mathfrak{p}}$
- f) **codimension inequality** $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) \geq \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{q}) + \text{ht}(\mathfrak{q})$
- g) $\dim k = 0$ for any field k
- h) A principal ideal domain A which is not a field has dimension 1

Proof. a) By (3.4.56) there is an order-isomorphism between prime ideals of A containing $N(A)$ and prime ideals of $A/N(A)$. However by (3.4.46) all prime ideals of A contain $N(A)$, so there is a bijection between chains of A and chains of $A/N(A)$, and the result follows.

- b) This follows similarly from (3.7.35).
- c) This follows similarly from (3.4.56).
- d) $\dim \mathfrak{a} = \dim A/\mathfrak{a} = \dim(A/\mathfrak{a})/(\mathfrak{a}/\mathfrak{b}) = \dim \mathfrak{a}/\mathfrak{b}$
- e) This follows from (2.5.6)
- f) This follows from (2.5.6)
- g) The only (prime) ideal is (0)
- h) By (...) every prime ideal (besides (0)) is maximal so every chain has length at most 1.

□

Lemma 3.21.6

Let A be a UFD and $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A$ a non-zero prime ideal. Then it contains a non-zero principal prime ideal (p) .

In particular $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = 1$ if and only if it is principal.

Proof. Choose $0 \neq f \in \mathfrak{p}$. Then by definition it has a factorization into primes, and at least one must be in $\mathfrak{p}$, say p . Then (p) is prime by (3.16.9). Therefore if $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = 1$ then it is equal to (p) .

Conversely if $\mathfrak{q} \subseteq (p)$ then $(q) \subseteq \mathfrak{q} \subseteq (p)$ for q prime, which implies $p \mid q$. As q is irreducible (...) then $(p) = (q) = \mathfrak{q}$. Therefore $\text{ht}((p)) = 1$. □

Proposition 3.21.7

Let A be a Noetherian ring and $\mathfrak{a}$ a proper ideal. Then there are only finitely many minimal primes containing $\mathfrak{a}$, say $\mathfrak{p}_1, \dots, \mathfrak{p}_n$. Further we have a decomposition

$$\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} = \bigcap_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{p}_i$$

which is irredundant (and the only such decomposition). Furthermore

$$\begin{aligned} \text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) &= \min_i \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}_i) \\ \dim(\mathfrak{a}) &= \max_i \dim(\mathfrak{p}_i) \end{aligned}$$

Proof. This follows from (2.4.7) and (3.21.3) applied to the radical ideal $\sqrt{a}$. $\square$

Remark 3.21.8

This is essentially the proof of [Kap74, Theorem 87, 88].

We've noted in general (3.21.5) that the so-called codimension formula does not hold. However it holds in the following case, for essentially trivial reasons.

Proposition 3.21.9 (Codimension 1 formula)

Let A be an irreducible Noetherian ring of finite Krull Dimension, and $\mathfrak{a}$ such that $\dim(\mathfrak{a}) = \dim(A) - 1$ then $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) = 1$.

Proof. Apply (2.5.7). $\square$

In practice most rings of geometric interest are catenary or quasi-biequidimensional. We recall some properties and equivalent criteria for these cases.

Proposition 3.21.10 (Catenary Criteria)

Let A be a ring. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is catenary
- b) For all prime ideals $\mathfrak{r} \subseteq \mathfrak{q} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ the following holds

$$\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{r}) = \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{q}) + \text{ht}(\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{r})$$

When A is irreducible this is equivalent to the following condition

$$\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = \text{ht}(\mathfrak{q}) + \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{q})$$

Proof. This is restatement of (2.5.9). $\square$

Proposition 3.21.11 (Biequidimensional Criteria)

Let A be a ring. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is quasi-biequidimensional
- b) A is catenary and $A/\mathfrak{p}$ is equicodimensional for every minimal prime $\mathfrak{p}$
- c) A satisfies the formula

$$\dim \mathfrak{q} = \dim \mathfrak{p} + \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{q}) \quad \forall \mathfrak{q} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$$

- d) A satisfies c) whenever $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{q}) = 1$ (i.e. $\mathfrak{q} \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}$ is saturated)

Furthermore

$$\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{q}) + \text{ht}(\mathfrak{q})$$

Proof. This is a restatement of (2.5.11). $\square$

Proposition 3.21.12 (Irreducible Biequidimensional Criteria)

When A is irreducible the following are equivalent

- a) A is biequidimensional
- b) A is quasi-biequidimensional
- c) A is catenary and equicodimensional
- d) A satisfies the formula

$$\dim \mathfrak{q} = \dim \mathfrak{p} + \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{q}) \quad \forall \mathfrak{q} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$$

- e) A satisfies d) whenever $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{q}) = 1$ (i.e. $\mathfrak{q} \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}$ is saturated)

Proof. This is a restatement of (2.5.14). $\square$

Proposition 3.21.13 (Codimension Formula)

Let A be a quasi-biequidimensional ring, $\mathfrak{a}$ an ideal and $\mathfrak{p} \subset \mathfrak{a}$ a prime ideal. Then the following properties hold

$$\begin{aligned}\mathrm{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) &= \mathrm{ht}(\mathfrak{a}/\mathfrak{p}) + \mathrm{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) \\ \dim \mathfrak{p} &= \dim \mathfrak{a} + \mathrm{ht}(\mathfrak{a}/\mathfrak{p})\end{aligned}$$

When A is biequidimensional (e.g. quasi-biequidimensional and integral), then for all ideals $\mathfrak{a}$ we have the relation

$$\dim A = \dim \mathfrak{a} + \mathrm{ht}(\mathfrak{a})$$

Proof. This is a restatement of (2.5.13). □

3.22 Lying over, Incomparability, Going Up and Going Down

Definition 3.22.1 (Lying over / Going up)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring map and $\mathfrak{p}$ and $\mathfrak{q}$ primes of A and B respectively

- a) $\mathfrak{q}$ **lies over** $\mathfrak{p}$, or $\mathfrak{p}$ **lies under** $\mathfrak{q}$ if $\mathfrak{p} = \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{q}) = \mathfrak{q}^c$. When $A \subseteq B$ and ϕ is the identity then this is equivalent to saying $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{q} \cap A$.

Definition 3.22.2 (Lying Over / Going Up / Incomparability)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring map. We say that it has the

- a) **lying over property** if every prime ideal $\mathfrak{p} \supseteq \ker(\phi)$ has a prime $\mathfrak{q}$ lying over it. NB $\ker(\phi) \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ is a necessary condition for $\mathfrak{p}$ to be a contraction and is equivalent to $B_{\mathfrak{p}} \neq 0$.
- b) **going up property** if for every pair of prime ideals $\mathfrak{p} \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}'$ in A and $\mathfrak{q} \triangleleft B$ lying over $\mathfrak{p}$, there exists a prime ideal $\mathfrak{q}'$ such that $\mathfrak{q} \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}'$ and $\mathfrak{q}'$ lies over $\mathfrak{p}'$.
- c) **incomparability property** if for every pair of prime ideals $\mathfrak{q}, \mathfrak{q}' \triangleleft B$ then $\mathfrak{q} \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}' \implies \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{q}) \subsetneq \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{q}')$
- d) **going down property** if for every pair of prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}' \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}$ in A and $\mathfrak{q} \triangleleft B$ lying over $\mathfrak{p}$, there exists a prime ideal $\mathfrak{q}'$ such that $\mathfrak{q}' \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}$ and $\mathfrak{q}'$ lies over $\mathfrak{p}'$.

Remark 3.22.3

It's possible to interpret these geometrically in terms of the map $\phi_{\star} : \text{Spec}(B) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(A)$.

- Lying over - $\phi_{\star}$ is surjective onto $V(\ker(\phi))$
- Going up - $\phi_{\star}$ is closed
- Incomparability - fibres have dimension 0
- Going down (and finite presentation) - $\phi_{\star}$ is open

The main result of this section is the correspondence between primes lying over $\mathfrak{p}$ and primes of the ring $B_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{p}}$ Proposition 3.22.5. As a preliminary result we consider conditions under which we can strengthen $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq \mathfrak{q}^c$ to $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{q}^c$, as the former condition is somewhat easier to satisfy.

Lemma 3.22.4 (Lying over criteria)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring map, $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A$ prime such that $\ker(\phi) \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ and $\mathfrak{q} \triangleleft B$. Then

$$\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{q}^c \iff \mathfrak{p}^e \subseteq \mathfrak{q} \text{ and } \mathfrak{q} \cap \phi(A \setminus \mathfrak{p}) = \emptyset$$

In particular

$$\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{p}^{ec} \text{ is contracted} \iff \mathfrak{p}^e \cap \phi(A \setminus \mathfrak{p}) = \emptyset$$

Proof. Recall (3.4.52) that in general $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq \mathfrak{q}^c \iff \mathfrak{p}^e \subseteq \mathfrak{q}$. The first equivalence is then clear because $x \in \mathfrak{q}^c \setminus \mathfrak{p} \iff \phi(x) \in \mathfrak{q} \cap \phi(A \setminus \mathfrak{p})$. For $\phi(x) \in \mathfrak{q} \cap \phi(A \setminus \mathfrak{p}) \implies \phi(x) = \phi(y)$ for $y \notin \mathfrak{p}$ and $x \in \mathfrak{q}^c$. This implies $x - y \in \ker(\phi) \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ whence $x \notin \mathfrak{p}$ as required.

The final statement follows by considering $\mathfrak{q} = \mathfrak{p}^e$. □

Proposition 3.22.5 (Lying over correspondence)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring map and $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A$ a prime ideal s.t. $\ker(\phi) \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$. Then there is a order-preserving correspondence of prime ideals

$$\begin{aligned} \{\mathfrak{q} \mid \mathfrak{q} \text{ lies above } \mathfrak{p}\} &\longleftrightarrow \{\mathfrak{q}' \triangleleft B_{\mathfrak{p}} \mid \mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{p}} \subseteq \mathfrak{q}'\} \longleftrightarrow \{\mathfrak{q}'' \triangleleft B_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{p}}\} \\ \mathfrak{q} &\longrightarrow \mathfrak{q}B_{\mathfrak{p}} && \longrightarrow \mathfrak{q}B_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{p}} \end{aligned}$$

In particular TFAE

- $\mathfrak{p}$ lies under a prime $\mathfrak{q}$
- $B_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{p}} \neq 0$
- $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{p}^{ec}$ is contracted

NB c) is *a-priori* weaker than a).

Proof. Recall $B_{\mathfrak{p}} := S^{-1}B$ and $\mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{p}} := \mathfrak{p}^e B_{\mathfrak{p}} = S^{-1}\mathfrak{p}^e$ where $S := \phi(A \setminus \mathfrak{p})$.

By Lemma 3.22.4 $\mathfrak{q}$ lies above $\mathfrak{p}$ if and only if $\mathfrak{p}^e \subseteq \mathfrak{q}$ and $\mathfrak{q} \cap S = \emptyset$. The first correspondence then follows from (3.7.17) and the second from (3.4.56).

$a) \iff b)$ This follows from the correspondence, since a ring without any non-zero prime ideals is simply the zero-ring.

$b) \iff c)$ Follows by noting $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{p}^{ec} \xleftrightarrow{3.22.4} \mathfrak{p}^e \cap S = \emptyset \xleftrightarrow{3.7.16.e)} \mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{p}} \neq B_{\mathfrak{p}}$ $\square$

Remark 3.22.6

Geometrically this is an explicit representation of the fiber as a prime spectrum

$$\mathrm{Spec}(\phi)^{-1}(\mathfrak{p}) \longleftrightarrow \mathrm{Spec}(B_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{p}})$$

Proposition 3.22.7 (Injective Ring Maps are Dense)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring map and $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A$ a minimal prime over $\ker(\phi)$. Then there exists a prime ideal $\mathfrak{q} \triangleleft B$ such that $\mathfrak{q}^c = \mathfrak{p}$. Furthermore $\mathfrak{q}$ may be taken to be minimal.

Proof. We may reduce to the case ϕ is injective by replacing A with $A/\ker(\phi)$. We have the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\phi} & B \\ \downarrow i_S & & \downarrow i_T \\ A_{\mathfrak{p}} & \xrightarrow{\tilde{\phi}} & T^{-1}B \end{array}$$

where $S := A \setminus \mathfrak{p}$ and $T := \phi(S)$. By (3.7.5) there exists a homomorphism $\tilde{\phi}$. Define $\mathfrak{m} := \mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ to be the unique maximal ideal of $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$. By (3.7.16) it is a minimal prime ideal and therefore the unique prime ideal. By assumption $0 \notin T$ and so $T^{-1}B \neq 0$. $T^{-1}B$ has a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{n}$ by (3.4.36). By uniqueness we find $\tilde{\phi}^{-1}(\mathfrak{n}) = \mathfrak{m}$. Therefore $\mathfrak{q} := i_T^{-1}(\mathfrak{n})$ is a prime ideal such that $\mathfrak{q}^c = \mathfrak{p}$.

By (3.4.43) there is a minimal prime $\mathfrak{r} \subset \mathfrak{q}$ which by minimality also satisfies $\mathfrak{r}^c = \mathfrak{p}$. $\square$

3.23 Integral Ring Extensions

Definition 3.23.1 (Integral Element)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring map and $\alpha \in B$. Then we say α is **algebraic** over A if $m(\alpha) = 0$ for some polynomial $m(X) \in A[X]$.

Furthermore we say that α is **integral** over A if $m(X)$ may be chosen to be monic.

Note often we assume $A \subseteq B$ and ϕ is the identity.

Definition 3.23.2 (Ring Extensions)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring map (so that B is an A -algebra). Then we say ϕ is

- **finite** if B is **finite** as an A -module
- **finite-type** if B is **finitely generated** as an A -algebra
- **integral** if every element of B is **integral** over A

When $A \subseteq B$ and ϕ is the identity then we say that B is respectively finite over A , finite-type over A or integral over A .

We note the trivial implication

$$\text{finite} \implies \text{finite type}$$

For example $k[X]$ is a ring of finite type over k , but certainly not finite. The follow criterion for integrality is fundamental.

Proposition 3.23.3

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring map and $b \in b$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) b is integral over A
- b) $\phi(A)[b]$ is a finite A -module
- c) $\phi(A)[b]$ is contained in a subring C of B which is a finite A -module
- d) There exists a $\phi(A)[b]$ -module M which is faithful and finite as an A -module

Proof. Note that the subring C in c) is a faithful A -module, so the only non-trivial step is $d \implies a$. This is the usual “determinant trick”. We apply (3.17.4) by considering $\psi_b \in \text{End}_A(M)$ to be multiplication by b . Then we have some monic polynomial $P(X) \in A[X]$ such that $P(\psi_b) = 0$, whence $P^\phi(b)m = 0$ for all $m \in M$. Since M is faithful, then we have $P(b) = 0$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.23.4 (Finite $\iff$ finite-type and integral)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring map and $b_1, \dots, b_n \in B$ integral over A . Then the ring homomorphism $\phi : A \rightarrow \phi(A)[b_1, \dots, b_n]$ is finite and integral.

In particular if ϕ is integral and of finite type if and only if it is finite.

Proof. We assume without loss of generality that $A \subseteq B$ and ϕ is the identity map. Consider a tower

$$A \subset A[b_1] \subset \dots \subset A[b_1, \dots, b_n] = B$$

We proceed inductively on n . Namely we assume that $A[b_1, \dots, b_i]$ is a finite A -module. Then a-fortiori $A[b_1, \dots, b_{i+1}]$ is integral over $A[b_1, \dots, b_i]$. Therefore by the previous Proposition it is a finite $A[b_1, \dots, b_i]$ -module and therefore a finite A -module (by (3.14.5)).

For any $b \in A[b_1, \dots, b_n]$ we have $A[b] \subset A[b_1, \dots, b_n]$ so by (3.23.3) we have b is integral over A .

It then follows that B integral and finite type $\implies B$ is finite (as an A -module). Conversely if B is finite then it is clearly finitely-generated. Further for any $b \in B$ then $A[b]$ is contained in the ring B which is finite as an A -module, and therefore b is integral by (3.23.3). $\square$

Proposition 3.23.5 (Transitivity property)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ and $\psi : B \rightarrow C$ be ring maps.

If $c \in C$ is integral over B , then it is integral over A (with respect to the ring map $\psi \circ \phi : A \rightarrow C$)

In particular if ϕ integral and ψ integral (e.g. surjective) $\implies \psi \circ \phi$ integral.

Proof. Suppose $c \in C$ is integral over B . Let $b_0, \dots, b_{n-1}$ be the coefficients of the integral relation then clearly c is integral over $B' := A[b_0, \dots, b_{n-1}]$. By (3.23.3) B' is a finite A -module and $B'[c]$ is a finite B' -module. Therefore $B'[c]$ is a finite A -module and by (3.23.3) we have c is integral over A . $\square$

Definition 3.23.6 (Integrally Closed)

Let $A \subset B$ be a subring, then we say that A is **integrally closed** in B if

$$b \in B \text{ integral over } A \implies b \in A.$$

We say that an integral domain A is **integrally closed** if it is integrally closed in its quotient field.

Proposition 3.23.7 (Integral Closure)

Let A be a subring of a ring B . Then the set of elements of B integral over A (the **integral closure**) is a subring of B . Denote this by $\overline{A}^B$ or just $\overline{A}$ when the overring B is unambiguous.

Further $\overline{A}^B$ is **integrally closed** in B .

Proof. Let $\alpha, \beta \in B$ be integral over A . Then by (3.23.4) the subring $A[\alpha, \beta]$ is a finite A -module containing $\alpha \pm \beta$ and $\alpha\beta$. Therefore by (3.23.3) they are also integral over A .

Clearly $\overline{A}$ is integral over A so by (3.23.5) it is integrally closed. $\square$

Lemma 3.23.8

Let A be a subring of a field K and $S \subset A$ a multiplicatively closed subset. If $x \in K$ is integral over $S^{-1}A$ then sx is integral over A for some $s \in S$.

Conversely if $y \in K$ is integral over A then $\frac{y}{s}$ is integral over $S^{-1}A$ for every $s \in S$.

Proof. Suppose $x \in K$ is integral over $S^{-1}A$ then we have by definition

$$x^n + \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \frac{a_j}{s_j} x^j = 0$$

for $a_j \in A$ and $s_j \in S$. Let $s := s_0 \dots s_{n-1}$ and multiply by s^n to find

$$y^n + \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} s^{n-j-1} \frac{s}{s_j} a_j y^j = 0$$

where $y = sx$. This shows that sx is integral over A

Similarly if $y \in K$ is integral over A then

$$y^n + \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} a_j y^j = 0$$

for some $a_j \in A$. Then let $x = \frac{y}{s}$ we have

$$x^n + \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \frac{a_j}{s^{n-j}} x^j = 0$$

whence x is integral over $S^{-1}A$. $\square$

Lemma 3.23.9

Let $A \subset K$ be a subring of a field. Then $\overline{S^{-1}A}^K = S^{-1}\overline{A}^K$.

In particular if A is integrally closed in K then so is $S^{-1}A$.

Proof. This follows directly from (3.23.8). $\square$

Proposition 3.23.10 (Normality is Local)

Let A be an integral domain. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is integrally closed
- b) $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is integrally closed for every prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$
- c) $A_{\mathfrak{m}}$ is integrally closed for every maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) This is simply (3.23.9).

b) $\implies$ c) is immediate.

c) $\implies$ a) Suppose that $x \in K$ is integral over A and consider the ideal $\mathfrak{a} := \{a \in A \mid ax \in A\}$. Then by definition it is a non-zero ideal, and we wish to show that $\mathfrak{a} = A$. Suppose not, then by (...) it is contained in some maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$. A-fortiori x is integral over $A_{\mathfrak{m}}$ whence by assumption $x \in A_{\mathfrak{m}}$. This means there is some $s \notin \mathfrak{m}$ such that $sx \in A$, that is $s \in \mathfrak{a}$ a contradiction. $\square$

Proposition 3.23.11 (Integral closure of an ideal)

Let $A \subset B$ be a subring and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ an ideal. Then for $b \in B$ TFAE

- a) b integral over $\mathfrak{a}$
- b) b^n integral over $\mathfrak{a}$ for some $n \geq 1$
- c) $b \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}\bar{A}}$

In particular $\bar{\mathfrak{a}}$ is an ideal of $\bar{A}$.

Furthermore if A is integrally closed in B then $\bar{\mathfrak{a}} = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$.

Proof. It's clear that a) $\iff$ b). For a) $\implies$ c) consider the integral relation

$$b^n + a_{n-1}b^{n-1} + \dots + a_0 = 0 \quad a_i \in \mathfrak{a}$$

By (3.23.7) $\bar{A}$ is a subring, and by assumption $b \in \bar{A}$. Therefore $b^k \in \bar{A}$, and the integral relation shows that $b^n \in \mathfrak{a}\bar{A}$ as required.

For c) $\implies$ b) suppose $b \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}\bar{A}}$ then $b^n = \sum_{i=1}^n a_i x_i$ for $a_i \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $x_i \in \bar{A}$. Let $B' := B[x_1, \dots, x_n]$, which is a finite A -submodule by (3.23.4). Let $\phi \in \text{End}_A(M)$ denote multiplication by b^n then $\phi(M) \subseteq \mathfrak{a}M$ so by (3.17.4) ϕ satisfies a monic polynomial with coefficients in $\mathfrak{a}$. In particular b^n is integral over $\mathfrak{a}$. $\square$

Proposition 3.23.12

A UFD is integrally closed.

In particular polynomial ring over a UFD is integrally closed.

Proof. $\square$

The following criterion is also useful :

Lemma 3.23.13 (Integral Criterion II)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring map. Suppose $x \in B$ is invertible, then x is integral over A if and only if $x \in \phi(A)[x^{-1}]$

Proof. Suppose $x \in \phi(A)[x^{-1}]$ then

$$x = \phi(a_0) + \phi(a_1)x^{-1} + \dots + \phi(a_n)x^{-n}$$

Multiply by x^n to deduce an integral equation. Conversely suppose $x \in B$ is integral over A then by definition

$$x^n + \phi(a_{n-1})x^{n-1} + \dots + \phi(a_0) = 0$$

Multiply by $x^{-(n-1)}$ to deduce $x \in \phi(A)[x^{-1}]$ $\square$

Proposition 3.23.14 (Integral extension preserves field property)

Let $\phi : A \hookrightarrow B$ be an injective, integral ring map. Then B is a field if and only if A is a field.

Proof. As ϕ is injective, it induces an isomorphism between A and $\phi(A)$. So we may assume without loss of generality that $A \subseteq B$ and ϕ is the identity.

Suppose B is a field and $x \in A$. Then $x^{-1} \in B$ is integral over A by hypothesis, so by the previous Lemma $x^{-1} \in A[x] \subseteq A$. Therefore A is a field.

Conversely suppose A is a field and $0 \neq x \in B$. Then by hypothesis x is integral over A , that is

$$x^n + a_{n-1}x^{n-1} + \dots + a_1x + a_0 = 0$$

Choose the degree n to be minimal. We claim $a_0 \neq 0$, for if $a_0 = 0$ we may cancel x to obtain an integral relation of smaller degree. Therefore

$$-x(x^{n-1} + a_{n-1}x^{n-2} + \dots + a_1)a_0^{-1} = 1$$

and in particular x is invertible. □

Proposition 3.23.15

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be an integral ring map. Then

- a) If $\phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{b}) \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$ then the induced ring map $A/\mathfrak{a} \rightarrow B/\mathfrak{b}$ (see (3.4.56)) is integral.
- b) If S is a multiplicatively closed subset of A and $T := \phi(S)$, then the induced ring map $S^{-1}A \rightarrow T^{-1}B$ is also integral.

Proposition 3.23.16 (Maximal ideals under integral extension)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be an integral ring map. Suppose $\mathfrak{q}$ lies above $\mathfrak{p}$. Then

$$\mathfrak{p} \text{ is maximal} \iff \mathfrak{q} \text{ is maximal}$$

Proof. The map $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ induces an injective map $A/\mathfrak{p} \hookrightarrow B/\mathfrak{q}$ of integral domains by (3.4.56). By (3.23.15) this map is also integral. Note $A/\mathfrak{p}$ (resp. $B/\mathfrak{q}$) is a field if and only if $\mathfrak{p}$ (resp. $\mathfrak{q}$) is a maximal ideal by (3.4.59). Then we may apply (3.23.14) to show the equivalence. □

Proposition 3.23.17 (Properties of integral extensions)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be an integral ring map then it has

- a) the **Lying Over** property
- b) the **Incomparability** property
- c) the **Going Up** property

Proof. For any prime ideal $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A$ we have the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\phi} & B \\ \downarrow i_S & & \downarrow i_T \\ A_{\mathfrak{p}} & \xrightarrow{\tilde{\phi}} & B_{\mathfrak{p}} \end{array}$$

where $S := A \setminus \mathfrak{p}$ and $T := \phi(S)$. By (3.7.5) there exists a morphism $\tilde{\phi}$, and by (3.23.15) it is integral. Define $\mathfrak{m} := \mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ to be the unique maximal ideal of $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$.

- a) As we assume $\ker(\phi) \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ we know $B_{\mathfrak{p}} \neq 0$ (3.7.34). Let $\mathfrak{n}$ be a maximal (and hence prime) ideal of $B_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Then $\mathfrak{q} := i_T^{-1}(\mathfrak{n})$ is a prime ideal of B such that $\mathfrak{q} \cap T = \emptyset$. In addition by (3.23.16) $\tilde{\phi}^{-1}(\mathfrak{n})$ is a maximal ideal, and therefore by uniqueness $\mathfrak{m} = \tilde{\phi}^{-1}(\mathfrak{n})$. By commutativity of the diagram we then have $\phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{q}) = \mathfrak{p}$ as required.

(Stacks) As an alternative argument to show existence of $\mathfrak{q}$ by (3.22.5) it's enough to show that $\mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is proper (by assumption $\ker(\phi) \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ so $B_{\mathfrak{p}} \neq 0$). By the diagram above $\mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{p}} = \tilde{\phi}(\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}})B_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Therefore it's enough to consider the case $(A, \mathfrak{m})$ local and to show $\phi(\mathfrak{m})B$ is proper. Suppose $1 \in \phi(\mathfrak{m})B$ then

$$1 = \sum_{i=1}^n \phi(a_i)b_i \quad a_i \in \mathfrak{m}_A \quad b_i \in B.$$

By (3.23.4) the subring $B' := \phi(A)[b_1, \dots, b_n] \subseteq B$ is a finite A -module. Furthermore $1 \in \mathfrak{m}B'$ whence $\mathfrak{m}B' = B'$ and by Nakayama's Lemma (3.20.5) $B' = 0$, a contradiction.

- b) Suppose $\mathfrak{p} = \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{q}) = \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{q}')$ and $\mathfrak{q} \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}'$. Let $\mathfrak{n} = \mathfrak{q}B_{\mathfrak{p}}$ and $\mathfrak{n}' = \mathfrak{q}'B_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Clearly $\mathfrak{n} \subsetneq \mathfrak{n}'$. By commutativity of the diagram $i_S^{-1}(\tilde{\phi}^{-1}(\mathfrak{n})) = \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{q}) = \mathfrak{p}$. By (3.7.16) extending the ideals to $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ shows $\tilde{\phi}^{-1}(\mathfrak{n}) = \mathfrak{m}$, and similarly for $\mathfrak{n}'$. By (3.23.16) both $\mathfrak{n}, \mathfrak{n}'$ are maximal so $\mathfrak{n} = \mathfrak{n}'$. By (3.7.17) $\mathfrak{q} = \mathfrak{q}'$.
- c) Suppose we have prime ideals $\mathfrak{p} \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}'$ and $\mathfrak{q}$ is a prime ideal lying above $\mathfrak{p}$. Consider the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\phi} & B \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ A/\mathfrak{p} & \xrightarrow{\tilde{\phi}} & B/\mathfrak{q} \end{array}$$

The induced map $\tilde{\phi}$ is integral (3.23.16). By a) there is a prime ideal of $B/\mathfrak{q}$ lying above $\mathfrak{p}'/\mathfrak{p}$, which is of the form $\mathfrak{q}'/\mathfrak{q}$ for $\mathfrak{q} \subseteq \mathfrak{q}'$ prime (3.4.56). Then from the diagram we see $\phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{q}') = \mathfrak{p}'$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.23.18 (Coefficients of minimal polynomial)

Let $A \subseteq B$ be integral domains, A is integrally closed, and define $K = \text{Frac}(A)$ and $L = \text{Frac}(B)$. For $b \in B$ integral over $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ we have the non-leading coefficients of $m_b(X)$ are integral over $\mathfrak{a}$ and therefore lie in $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$.

Note if b is only assumed to be integral over A then the coefficients of $m_b(X)$ lie in A .

Both $\text{Norm}_{L/K}(b)$ and $\text{Tr}_{L/K}(b)$ lie in A .

Proof. Let M/K be a normal closure for L/K (...). By (3.23.11) the integral closure of $\mathfrak{a}$ in M is simply $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$. Then the minimal polynomial $m_b(X)$ splits completely in M and by (3.18.78) all the roots b_i are conjugate by $\text{Aut}(M/K)$. In particular it's clear that b_i are integral over $\mathfrak{a}$, and so lie in $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$. The coefficients of $m_b(X)$ are polynomials in the b_i , and so by the observation above are also lie in $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$ (and are integral over $\mathfrak{a}$).

We may consider the case $\mathfrak{a} = A$ to deduce that $m_b(X)$ is a monic polynomial with coefficients in A . By (3.18.140) then the coefficients of $\text{Pc}_{L/K}(b; X)$ lie in A , and so by (3.18.135) so do the norm and trace. $\square$

Proposition 3.23.19 (Going Down)

Let $A \subseteq B$ be integral ring extension such that A is an integrally closed domain and B is an integral domain. Then it has the *Going Down* property.

Proof. Let $\mathfrak{p} \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}'$ be prime ideals of A and $\mathfrak{q}'$ a prime ideal lying over $\mathfrak{p}'$. We wish to find a prime ideal $\mathfrak{q} \subseteq \mathfrak{q}'$ lying over $\mathfrak{p}$ (clearly inclusion must be strict).

Consider the inclusion of rings $A \subseteq B_{\mathfrak{q}'}$. Then by (3.22.5) $\mathfrak{p}$ lies under a prime of $B_{\mathfrak{q}'}$ if and only if $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{p}^{ec} = \mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{q}'} \cap A$. If this is the case then it is of the form $\mathfrak{q}B_{\mathfrak{q}'}$ for some prime ideal $\mathfrak{q} \subseteq \mathfrak{q}'$ (3.7.35) of B . It's clear that $\mathfrak{q}$ lies over $\mathfrak{p}$.

Note in general that $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}^{ec}$, so we only need to demonstrate the reverse inclusion. Choose $x \in \mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{q}'} \cap A$. By (3.7.16) $\mathfrak{p}B_{\mathfrak{q}'} = S^{-1}(\mathfrak{p}B)$ where $S = B \setminus \mathfrak{q}'$.

Then $x = \frac{y}{s}$ for $y \in \mathfrak{p}B$ and $s \in B \setminus \mathfrak{q}'$. By (3.23.11) we have y is integral over $\mathfrak{p}$ whence by (3.23.18) the minimal polynomial $m_{y,K}(X)$ is equal to

$$X^r + u_1X^{r-1} + \dots + u_r \quad u_i \in \mathfrak{p}$$

However $s = yx^{-1}$ and $x \in A \implies x^{-1} \in K$. So we can derive the minimal polynomial $m_{s,K}(X)$

$$X^r + v_1X^{r-1} + \dots + v_r \quad v_i := \frac{u_i}{x^i}$$

As s is assumed to be integral over A the coefficients must all lie in A , by (...). Consequently $v_i \in A$ and $v_ix^i \in \mathfrak{p}$ for all i . If $x \notin \mathfrak{p}$ then we have $v_i \in \mathfrak{p}$ for all i , and s is integral over $\mathfrak{p}$. By the minimal polynomial we see that $s \in B\mathfrak{p} \subseteq B\mathfrak{p}' \subseteq \mathfrak{q}'$, which contradicts the choice of s . Therefore $x \in \mathfrak{p}$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.23.20

Let B, C be commutative A -algebras such that B is integral over A . Then $C \otimes_A B$ is integral over C .

Proof. Let $\overline{C}$ be the subring of $C \otimes_A B$ of elements which are integral over C (3.23.7). Consider an elementary tensor $c \otimes b$ then by definition there is $P \in A[X]$ such that $P(b) = 0$. Then

$$P(c \otimes b) = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i(c \otimes b)^i = \sum_{i=0}^n c^i \otimes a_ib^i = c^i \otimes \sum_i a_ib^i = c^i \otimes P(b) = 0$$

This shows that $\overline{C}$ contains the elementary tensors and therefore is equal to $C \otimes_A B$. $\square$

Lemma 3.23.21

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a finite ring homomorphism. Suppose $B = (f_1, \dots, f_n)$ and the composite map $\phi_i : A \rightarrow B_{f_i}$ is finite for all $i = 1 \dots n$, then so is ϕ .

Proof. There are finitely many elements $\{b_{ij}/f_i^{n_{ij}}\}_j$ which generate B_{f_i} as an A -module. Let B' be the A -submodule of B generated by all the b_{ij} . Then $B'_{f_i} = B_{f_i}$ as B -modules. By (3.7.39) we have $B' = B$ and therefore B is finitely generated as an A -module. $\square$

Proposition 3.23.22 (Krull Dimension is preserved under integral maps)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a ring map.

- a) *Going Up* $\implies \dim B \geq \dim(A/\ker(\phi))$
- b) *Incomparability* $\implies \dim B \leq \dim(A/\ker(\phi))$

In particular ϕ integral and injective implies $\dim A = \dim B$.

Proof. Without loss of generality we can assume that ϕ is injective. The two cases follow by lifting chains of prime ideals from A (resp. B) to B (resp. A), and checking that distinct is maintained.

The final statement follows from (3.23.17). $\square$

Corollary 3.23.23

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be integral and $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft B$, then $\dim \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{b}) = \dim(\mathfrak{b})$.

3.23.1 Integral Closure in Finite Extensions

Proposition 3.23.24

Let L/K be an algebraic field extension and A a subring with quotient field K . Then the integral closure $B := \overline{A}^L$

- a) has quotient field L ,
- b) spans L as a K -vector space and
- c) is integrally closed.

Furthermore $\dim B = \dim A$.

Proof. We may show a), b) if we prove $L = (A^*)^{-1}B$. Consider $x \in L$, then by definition it is integral over $K = (A^*)^{-1}A$ so by (3.23.8) $ax \in B$, and therefore $x \in (A^*)^{-1}B$ as required.

It is integrally closed by (3.23.7) and $\dim B = \dim A$ from (3.23.22). $\square$

Proposition 3.23.25

Let L/K be a finite field extension, A a subring with quotient field K and B a subring with quotient field L . Suppose that A is a principal ideal domain and B is a finite A -module. Then B is a finite free A -module of rank $[L : K]$.

Proof. By (3.15.7) B is a finite free A -module. Let $b_1, \dots, b_r$ be an A -basis, then by (3.23.24) this spans L as a K -vector space. Similarly by clearing denominators it is linearly independent, therefore by (...) $r = [L : K]$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.23.26 (Finite Separable Extension of Normal Domain)

Let L/K be a finite separable extension, with A an integrally closed Noetherian subring with quotient field K . Then the integral closure $\overline{A}^L$ is a finite A -module.

In particular $\overline{A}^L$ is Noetherian and $\dim A = \dim \overline{A}^L$.

If in addition A is a principal ideal domain, then $\overline{A}^L$ is a free A -module of rank $[L : K]$.

Proof. By (3.18.143) the trace map $L \times L \rightarrow K$ is a perfect pairing. By (3.23.24) we may choose $x_1, \dots, x_n \in B$ a K -basis for L where $n = [L : K]$. Denote $x_1^*, \dots, x_n^* \in L$ by the (unique) basis dual under this pairing satisfying

$$\mathrm{Tr}_{L/K}(x_i x_j^*) = \delta_{ij}$$

We claim that $B := \overline{A}^L$ satisfies

$$B \subset Ax_1^* + \dots + Ax_n^*.$$

For every $b \in B$ we have $b = \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i x_i^*$ and some $\lambda_i \in K$. Then by linearity $\mathrm{Tr}_{L/K}(bx_i) = \lambda_i$. By (3.23.18) we have $\lambda_i \in A$. The right hand side is a finitely generated A -module, which is therefore Noetherian (3.14.4). B is a submodule and therefore also finitely generated as an A -module (3.14.3).

Then by (3.14.4) B is Noetherian as an A -module, therefore a-fortiori Noetherian as a B -module (or equivalently as a ring).

If A is a principal ideal domain then $\overline{A}^L$ is a finite free A -module of rank $[L : K]$ by (3.23.25). □

Lemma 3.23.27

Let $A \subset B \subset C$ be subrings. Then $\overline{A}^C \cap B = \overline{A}^B$.

Lemma 3.23.28

Let $A \subset B \subset C$ be rings such that B is integral over A . Then $\overline{A}^C = \overline{B}^C$.

Lemma 3.23.29

Let A be a Noetherian integral domain with quotient field K and L/K be a finite extension.

Suppose that L'/L is a finite extension such that $\overline{A}^{L'}$ is a finite A -module, then so is $\overline{A}^L$.

Proof. By (3.14.4) $\overline{A}^{L'}$ is Noetherian as an A -module, whence by (3.23.27) $\overline{A}^L \subset \overline{A}^{L'}$ is a finitely-generated A -module. □

3.24 Valuation Rings and Places

Definition 3.24.1 (Valuation Ring)

A subring $A \subset K$ of a field K is a **valuation ring for K** if for every $0 \neq x \in K$ either $x \in A$ or $x^{-1} \in A$ (or both). Such a ring is an integral domain and K is necessarily a quotient field for A .

An integral domain A is a **valuation ring** if it is a valuation ring for its quotient field.

Proposition 3.24.2 (Properties of valuation rings)

Let A be a valuation ring and K its quotient field then the following properties hold

- a) A is local ring
- b) $x \in A \setminus A^\star \iff x \in \mathfrak{m} \iff x^{-1} \notin A$
- c) A is *integrally closed* in K

Proof. We prove each in turn

- a) By (3.19.3) we need to show that $\mathfrak{m} := A \setminus A^\star$ is an additive subgroup of A . Given $x, y \in \mathfrak{m}$, without loss of generality we may assume that x, y are non-zero, and $x/y \in A$. Then $x + y = y(1 + x/y)$. If $(x + y) \in A^\star$ then $y \in A^\star$ a contradiction. Therefore $(x + y) \in \mathfrak{m}$ as required.
- b) Note $x^{-1} \notin A \iff x \in A \setminus A^\star \iff x \in \mathfrak{m}$.
- c) Suppose $0 \neq x \in K$ is integral over A . If $x \in A$ we are done. If $x^{-1} \in A$ then by (3.23.13) $x \in A[x^{-1}] \subseteq A$ as required.

□

Proposition 3.24.3 (Local Homomorphism)

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a homomorphism of local rings. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\phi(\mathfrak{m}_A) \subset \mathfrak{m}_B$
- b) $\mathfrak{m}_A = \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{m}_B)$
- c) $\phi(\mathfrak{m}_A)B \subsetneq B$

We say that in this case ϕ is a **local homomorphism**. When ϕ is simply inclusion then we say B **dominates** A .

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) $\phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{m}_B)$ is a proper ideal containing $\mathfrak{m}_A$ and therefore equal by maximality

b) $\implies$ a) This is obvious

a) $\implies$ c) $\phi(\mathfrak{m}_A)B \subset \mathfrak{m}_B B = \mathfrak{m}_B \subsetneq B$

c) $\implies$ a) By (3.4.15) $\phi(\mathfrak{m}_A)B \subset \mathfrak{m}_B$ and trivially $\phi(\mathfrak{m}_A) \subset \phi(\mathfrak{m}_A)B$.

□

Corollary 3.24.4

Let $(A, \mathfrak{m})$ be a local ring, K a field and $\phi : A \rightarrow K$ a homomorphism. Then the following are equivalent

- a) ϕ is a local ring homomorphism (i.e. $\mathfrak{m} \subset \ker(\phi)$)
- b) $\ker(\phi) = \mathfrak{m}$
- c) ϕ factors through $\kappa(\mathfrak{m})$.

Definition 3.24.5 (Place (Zariski-Samuel 1960 / Lang 1972))

Let K be a field. A **place** of K consists of a valuation ring $(A, \mathfrak{m}_A)$ for K and a local homomorphism to a field F

$$\phi : A \rightarrow F$$

(such that $\ker(\phi) = \mathfrak{m}_A$)

Furthermore if $x \in K \setminus A$ then we may write $\phi(x) = \infty$. Note that the second part of the previous Proposition then may be reinterpreted as saying

$$\phi(x) = \infty \iff \phi(x^{-1}) = 0 \quad \forall x \in K$$

which motivates the alternative definition below.

We say it is a **semi-place** of K if $(A, \mathfrak{m}_A)$ is simply a local ring.

Lemma 3.24.6

Let $A \subset K$ be a subring of a field and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ a proper ideal. Then at least one of $\mathfrak{a}A[x]$ or $\mathfrak{a}A[x^{-1}]$ is a proper ideal.

Proof. Suppose neither are proper then we can write

$$1 = \sum_{j=0}^n a_j x^j$$

$$1 = \sum_{j=0}^m b_j x^{-j}$$

for $a_j, b_j \in \mathfrak{a}$. Choose n, m to be minimal and assume wlog that $m \leq n$. Observe that $a_0 \neq 1 \implies m > 0$. Multiply the second equation by $x^n a_n$ to find

$$x^n a_n (1 - b_0) = a_n b_1 x^{n-1} + \dots + a_n b_m x^{n-m}$$

and multiply the first by $(1 - b_0)$ to find

$$(1 - b_0) = a_0(1 - b_0) + \dots + a_n(1 - b_0)x^n$$

consequently cancelling the x^n term and we obtain a relation of smaller degree a contradiction. $\square$

We prove the first extension theorem

Proposition 3.24.7 (Extension to localization)

Let A be a ring and $\phi : A \rightarrow \Omega$ a homomorphism into a field. Let $\mathfrak{p} := \ker(\phi)$. Then

- $\mathfrak{p}$ is prime
- There is a unique extension $\tilde{\phi}$ making the diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\phi} & \Omega \\ \downarrow & \nearrow \tilde{\phi} & \\ A_{\mathfrak{p}} & & \end{array}$$

Furthermore $\ker(\tilde{\phi}) = \mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ i.e. $\tilde{\phi}$ is local.

Proof. Clearly $\mathfrak{p}$ is prime because $\phi(A)$ is an integral domain. We may extend ϕ to the ring $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ in the obvious way. The extension has kernel $\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$, the unique maximal ideal of $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$. $\square$

Proposition 3.24.8 (Places as maximal extensions)

Let A be a subring of a field K and $\phi : A \rightarrow \Omega$ a homomorphism into an algebraically closed field. Then

- For all $x \in K$, ϕ may be extended to at least one of $A[x]$ and $A[x^{-1}]$.
- There exists a maximal extension $\tilde{\phi} : B \rightarrow \Omega$. For any such maximal extension B is a valuation ring and $\tilde{\phi}$ is local (i.e. $\ker(\tilde{\phi}) = \mathfrak{m}_B$). Furthermore $\mathfrak{m}_B \cap A = \ker(\phi)$.

Proof. We prove each in turn.

- By (3.24.7) we may assume without loss of generality that A is a local ring with unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m} = \ker(\phi)$. By (3.24.6) we may also suppose that $\mathfrak{m}A[x]$ is proper. Then it's contained in a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{B} \triangleleft A[x]$. Furthermore $\mathfrak{m} = \mathfrak{B} \cap A$ by maximality of $\mathfrak{m}$. Let $k = A/\mathfrak{m}$ and $K = A[x]/\mathfrak{B}$, then there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & \phi & & \\ & \searrow & & \searrow & \\ A & \xrightarrow{\quad} & k & \xrightarrow{\quad} & \Omega \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow & \nearrow & \\ A[x] & \xrightarrow{\quad} & K & & \end{array}$$

Then $K = k[\bar{x}]$ is a field and by (...) $\bar{x}$ is algebraic over k . Therefore K/k is algebraic and, because Ω is algebraically closed, by (3.18.73) there is an extension to K , which gives the required extension to $A[x]$.

- It's easy to show that the poset of extensions to subrings of K ordered by consistency is chain complete. Therefore by Zorn's Lemma there is a maximal extension $\tilde{\phi} : B \rightarrow \Omega$. By the previous part for any $x \in K$ any such maximal element B must satisfy either $B[x] = B$ or $B[x^{-1}] = B$, i.e. B is a valuation ring for K . Consider $\mathfrak{B} := \ker(\tilde{\phi})$ a prime ideal contained in $\mathfrak{m}_B$. Then by (3.24.7) may extend $\tilde{\phi}$ to $B/\mathfrak{B}$ and so by maximality $B = B/\mathfrak{B}$. Finally (3.19.5) shows that B is a local ring with maximal ideal $\mathfrak{B} = \mathfrak{m}_B$. Clearly $\ker(\tilde{\phi}) \cap A = \ker(\phi)$, so the final statement follows easily. $\square$

Corollary 3.24.9

Let $A \subset K$ be a subring of a field and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ a proper ideal. Then there exists a valuation ring $(B, \mathfrak{m}_B)$ such that $A \subset B$ and $\mathfrak{a} \subset \mathfrak{m}_B \cap A$. In particular if $\mathfrak{a} = \mathfrak{m}_A$ is maximal then $\mathfrak{m}_A = \mathfrak{m}_B \cap A$.

Proof. By (3.4.36) there is a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}_A \triangleleft A$ containing $\mathfrak{a}$. Let $k = A/\mathfrak{m}_A$ and $\Omega = \bar{k}$. Then the canonical homomorphism $\phi : A \rightarrow \Omega$ has kernel $\mathfrak{m}_A$. It has an extension to a valuation ring $(B, \mathfrak{m}_B)$ by (3.24.8), such that $\mathfrak{m}_B \cap A = \ker(\phi) = \mathfrak{m}_A$. $\square$

Proposition 3.24.10 (Alternative Characterisation of Valuation Rings)

Let K be a field and $A \subset K$ a subring. Then the following are equivalent

- A is a valuation ring for K
- A is a local ring maximal under the relation “ B dominates A ”
- $K = \text{Frac}(A)$ and the principal ideals of A are totally ordered
- $K = \text{Frac}(A)$ and the ideals of A are totally ordered

Proof. Let $(A, \mathfrak{m}_A) \preceq (B, \mathfrak{m}_B)$ denote the relation B dominates A .

$a) \implies b)$ Suppose that $(A, \mathfrak{m}_A) \preceq (B, \mathfrak{m}_B)$ with B local and A a valuation ring. We claim that $A = B$; suppose for a contradiction that $x \in B \setminus A$. Then $x^{-1} \in A \implies x^{-1} \in B \implies x \in B^*$. Therefore $A \subset B \setminus B^* = \mathfrak{m}_B$. In particular $1 \in \mathfrak{m}_B$ which is a contradiction as $\mathfrak{m}_B$ is proper.

$b) \implies a)$ Let $(A, \mathfrak{m}_A)$ be a maximal local ring. By (3.24.9) there exists a valuation ring $(B, \mathfrak{m}_B)$ such that $(A, \mathfrak{m}_A) \preceq (B, \mathfrak{m}_B)$. By maximality $A = B$ and A is a valuation ring.

$a) \implies c)$ Evidently $K = \text{Frac}(A)$. Suppose $(a) \not\subset (b)$, then $a \notin (b) \implies b^{-1}a \notin A \implies a^{-1}b \in A \implies b \in (a) \implies (b) \subset (a)$.

$c) \implies d)$ Suppose $\mathfrak{a} \not\subset \mathfrak{b}$ then there exists $a \in \mathfrak{a} \setminus \mathfrak{b}$. In particular for all $b \in \mathfrak{b}$ we have $a \notin (b)$, whence by assumption $b \in (a)$. Therefore we conclude $\mathfrak{b} \subset (a) \subset \mathfrak{a}$.

$d) \implies b)$ As A is a non-zero ring it has a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}_A$, which by assumption must be the unique maximal ideal. So $(A, \mathfrak{m}_A)$ is a local ring. Suppose that $(A, \mathfrak{m}_A) \preceq (B, \mathfrak{m}_B)$ and given $x \in B$ we have by assumption $x = a_1 a_2^{-1}$ for some $a_1, a_2 \in A$. If $a_1 \in (a_2)$ then $x \in A$. Otherwise $a_2 \in (a_1)$ whence $x^{-1} \in A \implies x^{-1} \in B^* \xrightarrow{(3.24.2)} x^{-1} \notin \mathfrak{m}_B \xrightarrow{(3.24.3)} x^{-1} \notin \mathfrak{m}_A \implies x^{-1} \in A^* \implies x \in A$. Consequently $A = B$ and $b)$ holds. $\square$

Corollary 3.24.11

Let $A \subset K$ be a subring of a field then the integral closure of A in K (denoted $\bar{A}$) satisfies

$$\bar{A} = \bigcap_{A \subset V} V$$

where the intersection is taken over all valuation rings V of K containing A .

Alternatively the integral elements over A are precisely the elements which are finite at all places of K , which are finite over A .

Proof. First if $x \in \bar{A}$ then by (3.23.13) we have $x \in A[x^{-1}] \subseteq V[x^{-1}]$. If $x \notin V$ then by hypothesis $x^{-1} \in V$, whence $x \in V$ a contradiction. Therefore $x \in V$ as required.

Conversely suppose $x \notin \bar{A}$, then $x \notin A[x^{-1}]$. That is to say (x^{-1}) is a proper ideal in $A[x^{-1}]$. Therefore by (3.24.9) there is a valuation ring $(V, \mathfrak{m}_V)$ such that $x^{-1} \in \mathfrak{m}_V$ which implies $x \notin V$ by (3.24.2). $\square$

Definition 3.24.12 (Valuation)

Let K be a field and Γ an abelian ordered group. A function $v : K^* \rightarrow \Gamma$ is said to be a **valuation** if it satisfies the following properties

- a) $v(ab) = v(a) + v(b)$ for all $a, b \in K^\star$
- b) $v(a + b) \geq \min(v(a), v(b))$ with the convention that $v(0) = \infty$

Note $v(1) = 0$. We say that two valuations v, v' are equivalent if there is an order-preserving isomorphism $\phi : v(K^\star) \rightarrow v'(K^\star)$ such that $\phi \circ v = v'$. Clearly this is an equivalence relation.

If $k \subset K$ and $v(k) = 0$ then we say v is a valuation for K/k .

Proposition 3.24.13 (Correspondence between Valuations Rings and Valuations)

Let K be a field with $k \subset K$. Then there is a bijection

$$\begin{aligned} \{k \subset A \subset K \mid A \text{ is a valuation ring}\} &\longleftrightarrow \{v : K^\star \rightarrow \Gamma \mid v \text{ is a valuation over } k\} / \sim \\ A &\rightarrow v_A : K^\star \rightarrow K^\star / A^\star \\ v^{-1}(\Gamma_{\geq 0}) &\leftarrow v : K^\star \rightarrow \Gamma \end{aligned}$$

Under this map v_A is just the quotient map and $\bar{x} \leq \bar{y} \iff xy^{-1} \in A^\star$. Furthermore

- a) $v_A(\bar{x}) \geq 0 \iff x \in A$.
- b) $v_A(\bar{x}) = 0 \iff x \in A^\star$
- c) $v_A(\bar{x}) > 0 \iff x \in \mathfrak{m}_A$

Proof. Given a valuation ring we may define the abelian group $\Gamma := K^\star / A^\star$ under multiplication with $\bar{x} \leq \bar{y} \iff xy^{-1} \in A$. This is easily verified to be a total ordering. Then $v_A : K^\star \rightarrow K^\star / A^\star$ is simply the quotient map and we clearly $v_A(\bar{x}) \geq 0 \iff x \in A^\star$. To demonstrate the additive condition we may consider the case $x, y \neq 0$ and suppose wlog that $xy^{-1} \in A$

$$v(x + y) = v((xy^{-1} + 1)y) = v(xy^{-1} + 1) + v(y) \geq v(y) \geq \min(v(x), v(y))$$

The case that one of $x, y = 0$ is trivial. Observe $A = v_A^{-1}(\Gamma_{\geq 0}) \cup \{0\}$. We may therefore construct a one-sided inverse; given a valuation $v : K' \rightarrow \Gamma$ we may define $A_v := v^{-1}(\Gamma_{\geq 0}) \cup \{0\}$. It's evident from the two properties of v that A is an additive and multiplicative subgroup. Further by total ordering we see that A is a valuation ring. We only need to demonstrate that the given constructions are mutually inverse, namely $v \sim v_{A_v}$. However this is immediate because the composite $v(K^\star) \rightarrow K^\star / A_v^\star \rightarrow v_{A_v}(K^\star)$ is an abelian group isomorphism, which preserves the positive segments, and therefore is an order isomorphism. $\square$

Proposition 3.24.14 (Bezout Domain)

Let A be an integral domain. Then the following are equivalent

- a) Every finitely generated ideal is principal
- b) Every ideal generated by two elements is principal

In this case we say A is a **Bezout Domain**. Further in this case every pair of elements has a greatest common divisor d which satisfies $d = ax + by$ for some $x, y \in A$.

Proof. By assumption $(a, b) = (d)$. Immediately we have $d \mid a$ and $d \mid b$. Similarly $d = \lambda a + \mu b$. Suppose $a = xe$ and $b = ye$ then $d = (\lambda x + \mu y)e$ whence $e \mid d$. $\square$

Lemma 3.24.15 (Valuation Ring = Local Bezout Domain)

Let A be an integral domain. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is a valuation ring
- b) A is a local Bezout domain.

In particular A is a Noetherian valuation ring iff it is a local principal ideal domain.

Proof. Suppose A is a valuation ring and $\mathfrak{a} = (x, y)$. Without loss of generality $xy^{-1} \in A$ whence $x \in (y)$ so $\mathfrak{a} = (y)$ as required.

Conversely suppose A is a local Bezout domain and let $x = \frac{y}{z} \in K$. We may divide by the greatest common divisor so that $\lambda y + \mu z = 1$. We claim one of λy and μz is a unit, for suppose not then by (3.19.3) we have $\lambda y, \mu z \in \mathfrak{m} \implies 1 \in \mathfrak{m}$ a contradiction. Therefore one of y, z is a unit which implies $x \in A$ or $x^{-1} \in A$, and A is a valuation ring. $\square$

3.25 Derivations

Definition 3.25.1 (Module of Derivations)

Let A be a commutative ring and M an (A, B) -bimodule, then we say a derivation is a map $D : A \rightarrow M$ satisfying the following properties

- $D(x + y) = D(x) + D(y)$ **linearity**
- $D(xy) = xD(y) + yD(x)$ **product rule**

We denote the family of such derivations by $\text{Der}(A, M)$, and it is an (A, B) -bimodule.

We may consider case $M = B$ and $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ a ring homomorphism and in this case the product rule becomes

$$D(xy) = \phi(x)D(y) + D(x)\phi(y)$$

We observe that by induction we have $D(n \cdot 1_A) = 0$ for all $n \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Suppose that A is a k -algebra then we claim the following are equivalent

- $D(\lambda) = 0 \quad \forall \lambda \in k$
- $D(\lambda x) = \lambda D(x) \quad \forall \lambda \in k$

In this case we denote the set of k -linear derivations by

$$\text{Der}_k(A, B)$$

Note every derivation is $\mathbb{Z}$ -linear so we may work with $k = \mathbb{Z}$ in these cases. Finally we write

$$\text{Der}_k(A) := \text{Der}_k(A, A)$$

For our purposes the following will be the key example

Example 3.25.2 (Evaluation at a zero)

Consider the case $A = k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}$ a f.g. k -algebra, L/k a field extension and $(x) \in L^n$ a zero of $\mathfrak{a}$. Then we may define the A -module structure on L by

$$f \cdot \lambda := f(x)\lambda$$

In this case we have the more explicit form

$$\text{Der}_k(A, L; x) = \{D \in \text{Hom}_k(A, L) \mid D(fg) = f(x)D(g) + g(x)D(f)\}$$

which is an (A, L) -bimodule.

Lemma 3.25.3 (Rigidity of Derivations)

Suppose $D, D' \in \text{Der}_k(A, M)$ agree on a set of generators for A , then they are identically equal. For example in the previous example when $D(\overline{X}_i) = D'(\overline{X}_i)$.

The following is a useful technical tool to identify derivations as algebra homomorphisms

Definition 3.25.4 (Dual Ring)

Let M be an A -module. Define the **dual ring** as follows

$$A[M] := A \times M$$

$$(a, m) \times (a', m') = (aa', am' + a'm)$$

with addition defined in the obvious way and multiplicative unit is $(1_A, 0_M)$. Observe that it has an ideal $N := 0 \times M$ such that $N^2 = 0$ and canonically $A[M]/N \cong A$.

Proposition 3.25.5

Let M be an A -module where A is a k -algebra then there is a bijection

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Der}_k(A, M) &\rightarrow \text{AlgHom}_k(A, A[M]) \\ D &\rightarrow \phi_D(a) = (a, D(a)) \end{aligned}$$

Definition 3.25.6 (Partial Derivative)

Suppose $F \in A[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ given by

$$F(X_1, \dots, X_n) = \sum_{i \in \mathbb{N}^n} a_i X_1^{i_1} \dots X_n^{i_n} \quad a_i \in A$$

Define the partial derivative as follows

$$\frac{\partial F}{\partial X_k} := \sum_{\substack{i \in \mathbb{N}^n \\ i_k \neq 0}} a_i i_k X_1^{i_1} \dots X_k^{i_k-1} \dots X_n^{i_n} \quad (3.4)$$

We observe that

$$\frac{\partial X_l}{\partial X_k} = \delta_{lk}$$

Note this condition uniquely determines Equation (3.4), see (3.25.8).

We show that these form a basis for $\text{Der}_k(A)$.

Lemma 3.25.7 (Product Rule)

For $F, G \in A[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ we have the **product rule**

$$\frac{\partial FG}{\partial X_k} = F \frac{\partial G}{\partial X_k} + G \frac{\partial F}{\partial X_k}$$

Proof. First we demonstrate the result in the univariate case $n = 1$. For monomials this is straightforward :

$$\frac{\partial X^r X^s}{\partial X} = (r+s)X^{r+s-1} = X^s \frac{\partial X^r}{\partial X} + X^r \frac{\partial X^s}{\partial X}$$

For general univariate polynomials the product rule follows from the linearity of $\frac{\partial}{\partial X}$. The multivariate case then follows from considering the isomorphism $A[X_1, \dots, X_n] \cong A[X_1, \dots, \widehat{X_k}, \dots, X_n][X_k]$ under which $\frac{\partial}{\partial X_k}$ corresponds to $\frac{\partial}{\partial X}$. $\square$

Lemma 3.25.8 (Multivariate Chain Rule)

Let $D \in \text{Der}_k(A, M)$ be a derivation, $x_1, \dots, x_n \in A$ and $F \in A[X_1, \dots, X_n]$. Then

$$D(F(x_1, \dots, x_n)) = \sum_{k=1}^n \frac{\partial F}{\partial X_k}(x_1, \dots, x_n) D(x_k)$$

As a special case we find

$$\begin{aligned} D(F(x)) &= F'(x)D(x) \\ D(x^n) &= nx^{n-1}D(x) \end{aligned}$$

Proof. First we observe that by induction on n

$$D(x_1 \dots x_n) = \sum_{k=1}^n x_1 \dots \widehat{x_k} \dots x_n D(x_k)$$

and in particular

$$D(x^n) = \begin{cases} nx^{n-1}D(x) & n > 0 \\ 0 & n = 0 \end{cases}$$

Then for $F \in k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ we have

$$\begin{aligned}
 D(F(x_1, \dots, x_n)) &= \sum_{i \in \mathbb{N}^n} a_i D(x_1^{i_1} \dots x_n^{i_n}) \\
 &= \sum_{i \in \mathbb{N}^n} a_i \sum_{k=1}^n x_1^{i_1} \dots \widehat{x_k^{i_k}} \dots x_n^{i_n} D(x_k^{i_k}) \\
 &= \sum_{k=1}^n \sum_{i \in \mathbb{N}^n} a_i x_1^{i_1} \dots \widehat{x_k^{i_k}} \dots x_n^{i_n} D(x_k^{i_k}) \\
 &= \sum_{k=1}^n \sum_{\substack{i \in \mathbb{N}^n \\ i_k \neq 0}} i_k a_i x_1^{i_1} \dots x_k^{i_k-1} \dots x_n^{i_n} D(x_k^{i_k})
 \end{aligned}$$

which gives the required result. □

Proposition 3.25.9 (Extensions to Quotient Field)

Let A be a k -algebra and M an A -module. Then we have the following isomorphisms

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Der}_k(A, M) &\cong \text{Der}(S^{-1}A, S^{-1}M) \\
 D &\rightarrow \frac{a}{s} \rightarrow \frac{aD(s) - sD(a)}{s^2}
 \end{aligned}$$

In particular if $M = \Omega$ is a field containing A then we have an isomorphism

$$\text{Der}_k(A, \Omega) \cong \text{Der}_k(K, \Omega)$$

where $K := \text{Frac}(A)$.

In light of (3.25.5) the following definition is clearly related to the existence of derivations.

Definition 3.25.10 (Formally Smooth)

Let A be a k -algebra. We say it is **formally smooth** if for any k -algebra C with $N \triangleleft C$ such that $N^2 = 0$ and any homomorphism $v : A \rightarrow C/N$ there exists a lifting $\bar{v} : A \rightarrow C$.

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 k & \longrightarrow & C \\
 \downarrow & \nearrow & \downarrow \pi \\
 A & \xrightarrow{v} & C/N
 \end{array}$$

We say that A is **formally unramified** if in addition the lifting is always unique.

Lemma 3.25.11

Let C be a ring and $N \subseteq \sqrt{(0)}$ an ideal. Then $x \in C$ is invertible if and only if $\bar{x} \in C/N$ is invertible.

Proof. One direction is obvious. Conversely if $\bar{x}$ is invertible then $x \in C^* + N \subseteq C^* + \sqrt{(0)} \subseteq C^*$ by (3.4.68) as required. □

Lemma 3.25.12

If a ring A is formally smooth (resp. unramified) then so is $S^{-1}A$.

Proof. It's enough to show that for $s \in S$ we have $\bar{v}(s)$ is invertible, which follows from (3.25.11). □

Lemma 3.25.13

The polynomial ring $k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ and function field $k(X_1, \dots, X_n)$ is formally smooth.

Proof. The first follows by definition and the second by (3.25.12). □

Lemma 3.25.14

Let A be a formally smooth (resp. formally unramified) k -algebra and B is a formally smooth (resp. formally unramified) A -algebra. Then B is a formally smooth (resp. formally unramified) k -algebra.

Lemma 3.25.15 (Separable algebraic extensions are “formally unramified”)

A separable algebraic extension K/k is formally unramified.

Proof. Consider the following commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k & \longrightarrow & C \\ \downarrow & \nearrow & \downarrow \pi \\ K & \xrightarrow{v} & C/N \end{array}$$

We suppose first that K is a finite extension. By (3.18.117) it is simple, namely $K = k(\alpha) = k[\alpha]$. Let $m(X)$ be the minimal polynomial over k and choose $x \in C$ such that $\pi(x) = v(\alpha)$. Note that $\bar{v}(\alpha) = x$ need not be well-defined because in general $m(x) \neq 0$. We show however there is an $n \in N$ such that $m(x + n) = 0$. For consider any $n \in N$ and $f(X) \in k[X]$.

$$\begin{aligned} f(x + n) &= f(x) + \sum_{i=0}^N \lambda_i [(x + n)^i - x^i] \\ &= f(x) + f'(x)n \end{aligned}$$

as $n^2 = 0$. Therefore we propose $n = -m(x)/m'(x)$; to show this is well-defined, consider firstly $\pi(m(x)) = m(v(\alpha)) = v(m(\alpha)) = 0$ whence $m(x) \in N$. To show that $m'(x)$ is a unit we argue as follows. As α is separable, $m'(\alpha) \neq 0$, hence is a unit in K . As v is injective $v(m'(\alpha)) = m'(v(\alpha)) = m'(\pi(x)) = \pi(m'(x))$ is a unit in C/N . By (3.25.11) $m'(x) \in C^*$. Therefore $n \in N$ is well-defined and $m(a + n) = 0$ by construction. Therefore the map $\bar{v} : k[\alpha] \rightarrow A$ such that $\bar{v}(\alpha) = a + n$ is well-defined, and the diagram commutes because $\pi(a + n) = \pi(a) + \pi(n) = v(\alpha)$.

Suppose we had another $\bar{v}'$, then $a' := \bar{v}'(\alpha)$ again satisfies $m(a') = 0$ and $\pi(a') = v(\alpha)$ whence $a' - a \in N$. By the same argument as before

$$m(a') = m(a + (a' - a)) = m(a) + m'(a)(a' - a)$$

As $m'(a) \neq 0$ and $m(a') = m(a) = 0$ we see $a' = a$ which demonstrates uniqueness.

Suppose that K/k is algebraic than for every $\alpha \in K$ we have liftings $v_\alpha : k(\alpha) \rightarrow k$. We claim that $v_\alpha|_{k(\alpha) \cap k(\beta)} = v_\beta|_{k(\alpha) \cap k(\beta)}$. However $k(\alpha) \cap k(\beta)$ is also finite and so we are done by uniqueness. $\square$

Proposition 3.25.16

A separably generated extension K/k is formally smooth.

Proof. This follows from (3.25.13), (3.25.15) and (3.25.14). $\square$

3.26 Hauptidealsatz

The main result of this section is the following result due to Krull

Proposition 3.26.1 (Generalized Hauptidealsatz for Noetherian Rings)

Suppose A is a Noetherian ring then the following properties hold

- a) *Every prime ideal of height n is minimal over some ideal $\mathfrak{a} := (x_1, \dots, x_n)$. Furthermore $\mathfrak{a}$ may be chosen such that $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) = n$ and every minimal prime of $\mathfrak{a}$ is of height n*
- b) *We have the following characterization of height*

$$\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = \min\{n \mid \mathfrak{p} \text{ minimal over } (x_1, \dots, x_n)\}$$

In particular if $\mathfrak{p}$ is minimal over $(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ then $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) \leq n$.

In full generality the proof is quite subtle and in most cases of interest a simpler proof is possible. Therefore we introduce the following notions.

Definition 3.26.2 (Hauptidealsatz Ring)

*We say a ring A is a **generalized hauptidealsatz** ring if for all $x_1, \dots, x_n \in A$ and $\mathfrak{p}$ prime ideals minimal over $(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ we have $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) \leq n$*

*We say a ring A is simply a **hauptidealsatz** ring if this holds for $n = 1$.*

Lemma 3.26.3

Let A be a hauptidealsatz ring and $\mathfrak{p}$ a prime ideal. Then $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is hauptidealsatz.

Proof. Any prime ideal of $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ has the form $\mathfrak{q}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ by the correspondence of ideals under localization (3.7.17). If $\mathfrak{q}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is minimal over $(f/s) = (f/1)$, then clearly $(f) \subseteq \mathfrak{q}$. Furthermore $(f) \subseteq \mathfrak{q}' \implies (f/1) \subseteq \mathfrak{q}'A_{\mathfrak{p}}$. So $\mathfrak{q}$ is also minimal over (f) and therefore has height at most 1 by assumption. By the same result $\mathfrak{q}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ has height at most 1. $\square$

Proposition 3.26.4 (Hauptidealsatz $\implies$ Generalized Hauptidealsatz (Geometric))

Suppose that A is catenary, and hauptidealsatz for every quotient by a prime ideal. Then A is generalized hauptidealsatz, and so is every localization at a prime ideal.

Proof. We consider the case first that A is integral (which means it is hauptidealsatz by assumption because (0) is prime) and assume wlog that $n > 1$. Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be a minimal prime of $(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ and $\mathfrak{q}$ a minimal prime of $(x_1, \dots, x_{n-1})$. By considering the localization $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ we may choose $\mathfrak{q} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$. By induction $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{q}) \leq n - 1$. Then $\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{q}$ is a minimal prime over $(x_n + \mathfrak{q})$ and therefore by assumption has height at most 1. By the codimension formula (3.21.10) we see $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) \leq n$ as required.

For the general case, suppose $\mathfrak{p}$ is minimal over $(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ and let $\mathfrak{r} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ be a minimal prime. Then the ring $A/\mathfrak{r}$ is integral and we see that $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{r}) \leq n$ by the first part. Taking the supremum over all minimal primes $\mathfrak{r}$ shows that $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) \leq n$.

For the last statement we need only show that every localization at a prime ideal satisfies the hypotheses of the theorem. By correspondence of ideals under localisation (3.7.17) we see that every such ring is catenary. By (3.7.23) $A_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{q}A_{\mathfrak{p}} \cong (A/\mathfrak{q})_{\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{q}}$ for any prime ideal $\mathfrak{q} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ so every quotient by a prime ideal is hauptidealsatz by the previous Lemma. $\square$

The catenary assumption may be relaxed by making a more complicated argument.

Proposition 3.26.5 (Hauptidealsatz $\implies$ Generalized Hauptidealsatz (Algebraic))

Suppose A is a ring such that every quotient by a prime ideal satisfies the hauptidealsatz. Then A is generalized hauptidealsatz and so is every localization at a prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$.

Proof. We prove this by induction on n for a fixed ring A . Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be a minimal prime over $(x_1, \dots, x_n)$. Suppose $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) > n$ then we may choose a saturated chain $\mathfrak{q} \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}$ such that $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{q}) \geq n$. By minimality of $\mathfrak{p}$ we have $\mathfrak{q} \cap \{x_1, \dots, x_n\} = \{x_1, \dots, x_r\}$ with $r < n$ after a suitable reordering (possibly with $r = 0$). Furthermore we may choose $\mathfrak{q}$ such that r is maximal. Then by the induction hypothesis $\mathfrak{q}$ is not minimal over $(x_1, \dots, x_r)$ and there is a chain

$$(x_1, \dots, x_r) \subseteq \mathfrak{r} \subsetneq \mathfrak{q} \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}$$

We claim that $\mathfrak{p}$ is minimal over $(\mathfrak{r}, x_{r+1})$ for suppose

$$(\mathfrak{r}, x_{r+1}) \subseteq \mathfrak{p}' \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}$$

then by construction of $\mathfrak{q}$ (r was maximal) we see that $\mathfrak{p}' = \mathfrak{p}$. Taking quotients by $\mathfrak{r}$ the hauptidealsatz property shows that $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{r}) \leq 1$. On the other hand we have a chain

$$(0) \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{r} \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{r}$$

which is a contradiction.

The final statement follows a similar argument as before. $\square$

Remark 3.26.6

This argument is from [Kap74, Sec. 3.2 Ex. 6]

Before proceeding to the main result we need a some technical results related to height of ideals.

Lemma 3.26.7

Let $\mathfrak{q} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ be prime ideals then

$$\text{ht}(\mathfrak{q}) \leq \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p})$$

with equality iff $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{q}$.

Proof. The inequality is clear since any maximal chain below $\mathfrak{q}$ may be extended to a maximal chain below $\mathfrak{p}$. Similarly $\mathfrak{q} \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}$ implies that the inequality is strict. $\square$

Lemma 3.26.8

Suppose $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{b}$. Then

$$\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) \leq \text{ht}(\mathfrak{b})$$

If these are equal and $\mathfrak{b}$ is prime, then it must be a minimal prime of $\mathfrak{a}$.

Proof. We consider first the case $\mathfrak{b} = \mathfrak{p}$ is prime. By (3.4.43) there is a minimal prime $\mathfrak{p}'$ such that $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}' \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$. By definition $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) \leq \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}')$. Furthermore by the previous Lemma $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}') \leq \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p})$, which yields the required result.

Suppose $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = \text{ht}(\mathfrak{a})$ then by definition $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) \leq \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}') \leq \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p})$ and therefore we conclude $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}')$. By the previous lemma we conclude that $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{p}'$ is a minimal prime.

For the general case every minimal prime of $\mathfrak{b}$ also contains $\mathfrak{a}$ so the inequality follows by taking the minimum over all minimal primes. $\square$

Lemma 3.26.9

Let $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{b}$ be ideals such that there exists $x \in \mathfrak{b}$ not contained in any minimal prime of $\mathfrak{a}$. Then

$$\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) < \text{ht}(\mathfrak{b})$$

Proof. By the previous Lemma we have $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) \leq \text{ht}(\mathfrak{b})$. Suppose they are equal then there is a minimal prime $\mathfrak{p}$ of $\mathfrak{b}$ of the same height, which by (3.26.8) is a minimal prime of $\mathfrak{a}$. This must contain x which then contradicts the assumption. $\square$

Proposition 3.26.10 (Prime Avoidance Theorem)

Let $\mathfrak{p}_1, \dots, \mathfrak{p}_n$ be ideals and $\mathfrak{a}$ an ideal such that $\mathfrak{a} \not\subseteq \mathfrak{p}_i$ for all $i = 1 \dots n$. Then there exists $x \in \mathfrak{a} \setminus (\mathfrak{p}_1 \cup \dots \cup \mathfrak{p}_n)$.

Proof. We proceed by induction on the number of prime ideals n , the case $n = 1$ being trivial. Consider then the case of $n + 1$ prime ideals and suppose on the contrary that $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}_1 \cup \dots \cup \mathfrak{p}_{n+1}$. By the induction hypothesis there exists $x_i \in \mathfrak{a} \setminus \bigcup_{j \neq i} \mathfrak{p}_j$, and therefore by our assumption $x_i \in (\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{p}_i) \setminus \bigcup_{j \neq i} \mathfrak{p}_j$. Define

$$y := x_1 \dots x_n$$

Then $y \notin \mathfrak{p}_{n+1}$ by primality and clearly $y \in \mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{p}_1 \cap \dots \cap \mathfrak{p}_n$. Define $z := y + x_{n+1}$ then we see

- a) $z \in \mathfrak{a}$
- b) $z \notin \mathfrak{p}_{n+1}$
- c) $z \notin \mathfrak{p}_i$ for $i = 1 \dots n$

which contradicts our original assumption. $\square$

Lemma 3.26.11

*Let A be a **generalized hauptidealsatz** ring and $\mathfrak{a} = (x_1, \dots, x_n)$. Then the following are equivalent*

- a) $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) = n$

b) every minimal prime of $\mathfrak{a}$ has height n

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) By definition this means every minimal prime has height at least n , and the reverse inequality follows from generalized hauptidealsatz assumption.

b) $\implies$ a) Recall from (3.21.1) we may take the infimum over only minimal prime ideals. $\square$

Proposition 3.26.12 (Alternative characterization of height)

Suppose A is a Noetherian ring satisfying **generalized hauptidealsatz**, then the following properties hold

- a) Every prime ideal of height n is minimal over some ideal $\mathfrak{a} := (x_1, \dots, x_n)$. Furthermore $\mathfrak{a}$ may be chosen such that $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) = n$ and every minimal prime is of height n
- b) We have the following characterization of height

$$\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = \min\{n \mid \mathfrak{p} \text{ minimal over } (x_1, \dots, x_n)\}$$

In particular every prime ideal has finite height.

Proof. We first demonstrate a). Suppose $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = n$ then there is a saturated chain of prime ideals

$$\mathfrak{p}_0 \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_n = \mathfrak{p}$$

It's clear from the above chain that $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}_i) \geq i$. Furthermore by (3.26.7) $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}_i) < \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}_{i+1})$ whence we see $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}_i) = i$.

We show by induction that there are elements $x_1, \dots, x_n \in A$ for which $\mathfrak{p}_i$ is a minimal prime over $\mathfrak{a}_i := (x_1, \dots, x_i)$ for all $i = 0 \dots n$ and $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}_i) = i$.

The case $i = 0$ is clear, so suppose $i > 0$. In general by (3.21.7) there are finitely many minimal primes over $\mathfrak{a}_{i-1}$ say $\mathfrak{q}_1, \dots, \mathfrak{q}_r$ which all have height $i - 1$ by (3.26.11). In particular $\mathfrak{p}_i \not\subseteq \mathfrak{q}_k$.

By prime avoidance (3.26.10) we may choose $x_i \in \mathfrak{p}_i \setminus (\mathfrak{q}_1 \cup \dots \cup \mathfrak{q}_r)$. Clearly

$$\mathfrak{a}_{i-1} \subseteq \mathfrak{a}_i \subseteq \mathfrak{p}_i$$

Then by (3.26.8) and (3.26.9) we have $i - 1 = \text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}_{i-1}) < \text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}_i) \leq i$ whence $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}_i) = i$. By (3.26.8) again we see $\mathfrak{p}_i$ is a minimal prime of $\mathfrak{a}_i$. This completes the inductive step.

To show b) let m denote the right hand side. Then by the generalized hauptidealsatz hypothesis $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) \leq m$. On the other hand by part a) we have $m \leq \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p})$ whence they are equal.

Finally by the Noetherian hypothesis $\mathfrak{p}$ is finitely generated and clearly minimal over itself. $\square$

3.27 Regular Local Rings

The results of the previous section allow a more direct characterization of the dimension of a Noetherian local ring, which naturally leads to the notion of regular local ring.

Lemma 3.27.1 ($\mathfrak{m}$ -primary)

Let $(A, \mathfrak{m})$ be a local ring and $\mathfrak{a}$ a proper ideal. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} = \mathfrak{m}$
- b) $\mathfrak{m}$ is a minimal prime of $\mathfrak{a}$

Furthermore $\mathfrak{a}$ is primary. In this case we say $\mathfrak{a}$ is $\mathfrak{m}$ -primary. A sufficient condition is that for some n

$$\mathfrak{m}^n \subset \mathfrak{a} \subset \mathfrak{m}$$

and this is necessary when $\mathfrak{m}$ is finitely generated.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) Suppose $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ then $\mathfrak{m} = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ by (3.4.46). In particular $\mathfrak{m}$ is a minimal prime.

b) $\implies$ a) Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be a prime ideal containing $\mathfrak{a}$. By (3.4.36) $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}$ and by assumption $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{m}$. The result then follows from (3.4.46).

Suppose $xy \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $y \notin \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$ then by (...) $y \in A^*$ whence $x \in \mathfrak{a}$. This shows that $\mathfrak{a}$ is primary.

The condition $\mathfrak{m}^n \subset \mathfrak{a}$ is clearly sufficient, and necessary in the finitely generated case by (3.4.48). □

An ideal satisfying one of the equivalent conditions above is called **$\mathfrak{m}$ -primary**, though some authors require the stronger condition.

Proposition 3.27.2 (Criteria for Dimension of Local Ring)

Let $(A, \mathfrak{m})$ be a Noetherian local ring satisfying the generalized hauptidealsatz. Then we have the following criteria for dimension

$$\dim A = \text{ht}(\mathfrak{m}) = \min\{n \mid \sqrt{(x_1, \dots, x_n)} = \mathfrak{m}\} \leq \mu(\mathfrak{m}) = \dim_{k(\mathfrak{m})} \mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2$$

where $\mu(\mathfrak{m})$ is the least number of generators of $\mathfrak{m}$ and $k(\mathfrak{m}) = A/\mathfrak{m}$.

Proof. The first equality follows because every maximal chain must terminate at a maximal ideal by (3.4.36). The second from the characterization of height for hauptidealsatz rings (3.26.12) and the equivalent definitions of $\mathfrak{m}$ -primary (3.27.1). The inequality follows because $\mathfrak{m}$ is itself $\mathfrak{m}$ -primary. The final equality follows because a minimal generating set lifts to a basis of $\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2$ (3.20.7). □

Definition 3.27.3

Let $(A, \mathfrak{m})$ be a Noetherian local ring. We say A is **regular** if

$$\dim A = \mu(\mathfrak{m}) = \dim_{k(\mathfrak{m})} \mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2$$

3.28 Local Rings of Dimension 0

Lemma 3.28.1 (Dimension 0 local ring)

Let $(A, \mathfrak{m})$ be a Noetherian local ring. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\dim A = 0$ (i.e. every prime ideal is maximal)
- b) $\mathfrak{m}^n = 0$ for some n
- c) $\mathfrak{m}^n = \mathfrak{m}^{n+1}$ for some n

If A is an integral domain then this is equivalent to A being a field.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) By (3.21.7) $\mathfrak{r} := \sqrt{(0)} = \mathfrak{p}_1 \cap \dots \cap \mathfrak{p}_n$ is a decomposition into minimal prime ideals. By assumption these are also maximal, and therefore by uniqueness $\sqrt{(0)} = \mathfrak{m}$ and the result follows from (3.4.48) as $\mathfrak{m}$ is finitely generated.

b) $\implies$ a) Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be a prime ideal then trivially $\mathfrak{m}^n \subset \mathfrak{p}$ so by (3.27.1) it is $\mathfrak{m}$ -primary i.e. $\mathfrak{m}$ is a minimal prime of $\mathfrak{p}$ whence $\mathfrak{m} = \mathfrak{p}$.

b) $\iff$ c) One direction is obvious, and the converse follows from Nakayama's Lemma (3.20.5) because $\mathfrak{m}^n$ is finitely generated. $\square$

3.29 Fractional Ideals

Definition 3.29.1

Let A be an integral domain contained in its quotient field K . An A -submodule $I \subset K$ is called a **fractional ideal** if there exists $a \in A$ such that $aI \subset A$.

We say a fractional ideal is **principal** if it is generated by some $x \in K$ as an A -module.

Proposition 3.29.2 (Operations on Fractional ideals)

Let A be an integral domain and $I, J \subset K$ fractional ideals. Then the following constructions are also fractional ideals

- a) $I + J = \{i + j \mid i \in I, j \in J\}$
- b) $IJ = \{\sum_{k=1}^n i_k j_k \mid i_k \in I, j_k \in J\}$
- c) $(I : J) = \{x \in K \mid xJ \subseteq I\}$

Proof. It is straightforward to prove that these constructions are again A -submodules of K .

Suppose that $aI \subseteq A$ and $bJ \subseteq A$, then $(ab)(I + J) \subseteq A$ and $(ab)IJ \subseteq A$. Similarly

$$(I : J)J \subseteq I \implies j(I : J) \subseteq I \implies abj(I : J) \subseteq A$$

for some $0 \neq j \in J$ □

Proposition 3.29.3

Let A be an integral domain. The collection of fractional ideals $\mathcal{I}_A$ forms a monoid under multiplication of ideals, with identity A .

Definition 3.29.4

Let A be an integral domain and I a fractional ideal. Then we say I is **invertible** if there exists a fractional ideal J such that $IJ = A$.

Proposition 3.29.5

Let A be an integral domain and I a fractional ideal. Then I is invertible if and only if $I(A : I) = A$, in which case $(A : I)$ is the unique inverse.

Proof. Uniqueness follows from general properties of monoids (...). If $I(A : I) = A$ then by definition I is invertible. Conversely suppose I is invertible, that is $IJ = A$. Then evidently $J \subseteq (A : I)$ so $A = IJ \subseteq I(A : I) \subseteq A$. Therefore $(A : I)$ is an inverse for I as required. □

Corollary 3.29.6

Let A be an integral domain. Then the invertible fractional ideals form an abelian group under multiplication.

Definition 3.29.7 (Localisation of Fractional Ideals)

Let A be an integral domain contained in its quotient field K . Let I be a fractional ideal and S a multiplicatively closed subset of A . Then define

$$S^{-1}I := \left\{ \frac{i}{s} \mid i \in I, s \in S \right\}$$

If $\mathfrak{a}$ is an ideal then $S^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$ corresponds to the usual notion (3.7.15) and is equal to the extension of $\mathfrak{a}$ under the inclusion homomorphism $A \rightarrow S^{-1}A$.

If $\mathfrak{p}$ is a prime ideal of A then as usual define

$$I_{\mathfrak{p}} := (A \setminus \mathfrak{p})^{-1} I$$

and we may write

$$\mathfrak{a}_{\mathfrak{p}} = \mathfrak{a}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$$

Proposition 3.29.8 (Localisation of Fractional Ideals)

Let A be an integral domain contained in its quotient field K . Let S be a multiplicatively closed subset of A and I a fractional ideal. Then regarding as subrings of K then $S^{-1}I$ is a fractional ideal of $S^{-1}A$. Furthermore

- a) $S^{-1}(I + J) = S^{-1}I + S^{-1}J$
- b) $S^{-1}(IJ) = (S^{-1}I)(S^{-1}J)$
- c) $S^{-1}(I : J) = (S^{-1}I : S^{-1}J)$

Proof. Evidently $S^{-1}I$ is again a fractional ideal of $S^{-1}A$.

- a) Clear because $\frac{i+j}{s} = \frac{i}{s} + \frac{j}{s}$.
- b) We have $\frac{ij}{s} = \frac{i}{s} \frac{j}{1}$ whence $S^{-1}(IJ) \subseteq (S^{-1}I)(S^{-1}J)$. Conversely we have $\frac{i}{s} \frac{j}{t} = \frac{ij}{st}$ so we have the reverse inclusion.
- c) Suppose that $\frac{x}{s} \in S^{-1}(I : J)$ and $\frac{j}{t} \in S^{-1}J$. Then $\frac{x}{s} \frac{j}{t} = \frac{xj}{st} \in S^{-1}I$ because $x \in (I : J)$. Therefore $S^{-1}(I : J) \subseteq (S^{-1}I : S^{-1}J)$. Conversely given $x \in (S^{-1}I : S^{-1}J)$ and $j \in J$. Then by definition $x \frac{j}{1} = \frac{j}{s}$ whence $sj \in (I : J)$. Therefore $x \in S^{-1}(I : J)$ as required.

□

Lemma 3.29.9

Let A be an integral domain contained in its quotient field K . Suppose I is a fractional ideal then

$$I = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{m}} I_{\mathfrak{m}}$$

In particular we have

$$A = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{m}} A_{\mathfrak{m}}$$

Proof. Evidently $I \subseteq \bigcap_{\mathfrak{m}} I_{\mathfrak{m}}$. Suppose that $x \in \bigcap_{\mathfrak{m}} I_{\mathfrak{m}}$. Consider the ideal $\mathfrak{a} := \{a \in A \mid ax \in I\}$. Suppose $\mathfrak{a}$ is proper then by (3.4.15) it is contained in a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$. As $x \in I_{\mathfrak{m}}$ we have $(A \setminus \mathfrak{m}) \cap \mathfrak{a} \neq \emptyset$ and $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}$ a contradiction. Therefore $\mathfrak{a} = A$ and in particular $x = 1 \cdot x \in I$ as required. □

Proposition 3.29.10 (Invertibility is a local property)

Let A be an integral domain with quotient field K , and I a fractional ideal of A . Then the following are equivalent

- a) I is invertible
- b) $I_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is invertible for all prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}$
- c) $I_{\mathfrak{m}}$ is invertible for all prime ideals $\mathfrak{m}$

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) By assumption and (3.29.5) $I(A : I) = A$ so by (3.29.8) $I_{\mathfrak{p}}(A_{\mathfrak{p}} : I_{\mathfrak{p}}) = A_{\mathfrak{p}}$, as required.

b) $\implies$ c) Every maximal ideal is prime (3.4.60) so we are done.

c) $\implies$ a) Let I be a fractional ideal then

$$I(A : I) = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{m}} (I(A : I))_{\mathfrak{m}} \tag{3.29.9}$$

$$= \bigcap_{\mathfrak{m}} I_{\mathfrak{m}}(A : I)_{\mathfrak{m}} \tag{3.29.8}$$

$$= \bigcap_{\mathfrak{m}} I_{\mathfrak{m}}(A_{\mathfrak{m}} : I_{\mathfrak{m}}) \tag{3.29.8}$$

$$= \bigcap_{\mathfrak{m}} A_{\mathfrak{m}} \tag{3.29.5}$$

$$= A \tag{3.29.9}$$

□

3.30 Discrete Valuation Rings

A Discrete Valuation Ring (DVR) corresponds to a regular local ring of dimension 1 and therefore regular (or in the case of perfect base field, non-singular) points on a curve. There are a number of equivalent conditions which are summarised here (see also [AM69, Proposition 9.2]).

Lemma 3.30.1

Let $(A, \mathfrak{m})$ be a local domain such that $\mathfrak{m}$ is finitely generated and $\dim A = 1$. Then for every non-zero ideal $\mathfrak{a}$ there exists some n such that $\mathfrak{m}^n \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$.

Proof. As $\dim A = 1$ every minimal prime over $\mathfrak{a}$ is equal to $\mathfrak{m}$, whence $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} = \mathfrak{m}$ (i.e. $\mathfrak{a}$ is $\mathfrak{m}$ -primary). As $\mathfrak{m}$ is finitely generated there is some n such that $\mathfrak{m}^n \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$ (3.4.48). $\square$

Proposition 3.30.2 (DVR Criteria)

Let A be an integral domain which is not a field. Then the following are equivalent.

- a) A is a valuation ring whose valuation group is order-isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}$
- b) A is a local principal ideal domain
- c) A is a Noetherian local ring with maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m} = (\pi)$ and $\dim A = 1$
- d) A is a local ring such that every ideal is of the form (π^k) for some $k \geq 0$ (and these are distinct)
- e) There exists a non-unit $\pi \in A$ such that every element $a \in A$ may be represented as $u\pi^k$ for some $u \in A^*$ and non-negative integer k .
- f) A is a Noetherian valuation ring
- g) A is a Noetherian integrally closed local domain with $\dim A = 1$
- h) A is a Noetherian regular local ring with $\dim A = 1$

In this case we say A is a **discrete valuation ring** (or **DVR**) and let $K = \text{Frac}(A)$. For every generator π of $\mathfrak{m}$, the ideals (π^n) are distinct and

- for every $x \in K^*$ there is a unique integer k and unit u such that $x = u\pi^k$, and
- there is a well-defined valuation $v : K^* \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ determined uniquely by the relation $x = u\pi^{v(x)}$

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) Consider a valuation $v : K \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ with $v^{-1}(\mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}) = A$. For any ideal $\mathfrak{a}$ choose $f \in \mathfrak{a}$ such that $v(f)$ is minimal. For $g \in \mathfrak{a}$ we have $v(g) \geq v(f) \implies v(gf^{-1}) \geq 0 \implies gf^{-1} \in A \implies g \in (f)$. Therefore $\mathfrak{a} = (f)$ is principal. Further by (3.24.2) A is a local ring.

b) $\implies$ c). By (3.21.5) $\dim A = 1$ and by assumption $\mathfrak{m} = (\pi)$. Evidently A is Noetherian.

c) $\implies$ d). By (3.28.1) the sequence (π^k) is strictly decreasing. Assume wlog that $\mathfrak{a}$ is proper and non-zero, then as $\dim A = 1$ every prime ideal is maximal and we find $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} = (\pi)$ by (3.4.46).

Suppose that $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq (\pi^k)$ for all k . Then $\pi \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \implies (\pi^k) = \mathfrak{a}$ for all sufficiently large k which contradicts the fact the sequence is strictly decreasing. Therefore we may assume $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq (\pi^k)$ for some k and there exists $a \in \mathfrak{a} \setminus (\pi^{k+1})$. Therefore $a = u\pi^k$ and by construction $u \notin (\pi) \implies u \in A^* \implies \pi^k \in \mathfrak{a}$. Therefore $\mathfrak{a} = (\pi^k)$ as required.

d) $\implies$ e). By assumption $(a) = (\pi^k)$ for some integer k , whence by (3.16.3) $a = u\pi^k$ for some $u \in A^*$. This representation is unique because the ideals (π^k) are all distinct and A is cancellable.

e) $\implies$ a). We may show easily that the integer k is uniquely defined, denote this by $v(a)$ where $a = u\pi^{v(a)}$ for $u \in A^*$. We need to show that v is a valuation. By uniqueness we deduce $v(ab) = v(a) + v(b)$. Suppose that $a, b, a+b \in A \setminus \{0\}$. Then $(\pi^{v(a+b)}) = (a+b) \subseteq (\pi^{\min(v(a), v(b))})$. As the sequence (π^k) is strictly decreasing we find $v(a+b) \geq \min(v(a), v(b))$ as required. We may extend to K^* by $v(ab^{-1}) := v(a) - v(b)$. Then $v(ab^{-1}) \geq 0 \iff v(a) \geq v(b) \iff (a) \subseteq (b) \iff b \mid a \iff ab^{-1} \in A$. Further $v(a) = 0 \iff a \notin (\pi) \iff a \in A^*$. Therefore A is the valuation ring associated to v .

d) $\implies$ f) $\implies$ b). This follows from (3.24.15).

f) $\implies$ g). A valuation ring is integrally closed (3.24.2) and we've already shown A is local with dimension 1.

g) $\implies$ c). Let $0 \neq a \in \mathfrak{m}$. As $\dim A = 1$ from (3.30.1) we know $\mathfrak{m}^n \subseteq (a)$ for some $n \geq 1$. Choose n minimal and $b \in \mathfrak{m}^{n-1} \setminus (a)$.

Let $x = a^{-1}b \in K = \text{Frac}(A)$. Evidently $x \notin A$, for otherwise $b \in (a)$; further $x\mathfrak{m} = a^{-1}b\mathfrak{m} \subseteq a^{-1}\mathfrak{m}^n \subseteq a^{-1}(a) = A$ is an ideal of A .

We claim that $x\mathfrak{m} = A$. Suppose not then $x\mathfrak{m} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}$ by (3.4.36). Then $\mathfrak{m}$ is a faithful finite $A[x]$ -module and x is integral over A (3.23.3). By assumption A is integrally closed so $x \in A$ which is a contradiction. Therefore $x\mathfrak{m} = A \implies \mathfrak{m} = x^{-1}A$. This shows that $x^{-1} = x^{-1} \cdot 1 \in A$ and that $\mathfrak{m}$ is a principal ideal.

c) $\implies$ h). By assumption A is a Noetherian local ring with $\dim A = 1$. So it remains to show that $\dim \mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2 = 1$. As $\mathfrak{m}$ is principal then $\dim \mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2 \leq 1$. If it is zero then $\mathfrak{m} = \mathfrak{m}^2$ and $\dim A = 0$ by (3.28.1), a contradiction.

h) $\implies$ c). By assumption $\dim \mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2 = 1$ and so by (3.20.7) $\mathfrak{m} = (\pi)$ for some $\pi \in \mathfrak{m} \setminus \mathfrak{m}^2$.

The final statements have already been proven. $\square$

Corollary 3.30.3

Let A be a principal ideal domain which is not a field. Then every localisation of A at a non-zero prime ideal is a DVR.

In particular $\mathbb{Z}_{(p)}$ and $k[X]_{(f)}$ are DVRs where p is prime and $f(X)$ is an irreducible polynomial.

Proposition 3.30.4

Let A be a discrete valuation ring with unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$. Then there exists a canonical group isomorphism

$$(\mathfrak{m})^- : \mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{I}_A$$

which is the unique group homomorphism mapping 1 to $\mathfrak{m}$ (and 0 to A). In particular every fractional ideal is invertible.

Write the inverse group isomorphism by $v_{\mathfrak{m}}$, which satisfies

$$\text{a) } \mathfrak{m}^{v_{\mathfrak{m}}(\mathfrak{a})} = \mathfrak{a}$$

$$\text{b) } v_{\mathfrak{m}}(\mathfrak{m}^k) = k$$

A fractional ideal I is contained in A if and only if $v_{\mathfrak{m}}(I) \geq 0$.

Proof. By (3.30.2) we may suppose $\mathfrak{m} = (\pi)$. Evidently (π^k) is a fractional ideal for every integer k and $(\pi^k)(\pi^l) = (\pi^{k+l})$, which gives the required homomorphism $k \rightarrow (\pi^k)$.

Suppose the kernel is non-trivial then there exists k which maps to A , and we may assume that k is positive (by considering the inverse). This means precisely that $\mathfrak{m}^k = A$, which may only happen when $k = 0$ because $\mathfrak{m}$ is proper.

Let I be an arbitrary fractional ideal then $aI \subseteq A$ for some $a \in A$. By (3.30.2) $a = u\pi^l$ and $aI = (\pi^k)$ for some positive integers l and k . This means $(\pi^l)I = (\pi^k)$ and therefore $I = (\pi^k)(\pi^{-l}) = (\pi^{k-l})$. This shows the homomorphism is surjective and therefore an isomorphism.

Evidently $(\pi^k) \subset A \iff k \geq 0$ since $\pi \in A$ and $\pi^{-1} \notin A \implies \pi^{-k} \notin A$. $\square$

Proposition 3.30.5

Let A be a discrete valuation ring and I, J fractional ideals. Then the following are equivalent

$$\text{a) } I \subset J$$

$$\text{b) } J \text{ divides } I \text{ (that is there exists an ideal } \mathfrak{a} \text{ such that } \mathfrak{a}J = I)$$

$$\text{c) } v_{\mathfrak{m}}(I) \geq v_{\mathfrak{m}}(J)$$

Proof. Using the results of (3.30.4) we may show (eliding the subscript $\mathfrak{m}$)

$$\text{a) } \iff \text{c) } I \subset J \iff J^{-1}I \subset A \iff v(J^{-1}I) \geq 0 \iff v(I) \geq v(J)$$

$$\text{b) } \implies \text{c) } v(I) = v(\mathfrak{a}) + v(J) \geq v(J)$$

$$\text{c) } \implies \text{b) } \text{ Define } \mathfrak{a} = \mathfrak{m}^{v(I)-v(J)} \text{ then evidently } v(\mathfrak{a}J) = v(I) \text{ whence } I = J. \quad \square$$

3.31 Dedekind Domains

We develop the theory of Dedekind Domains. These occur both as number fields and regular affine curves (over any field). The important results are the finiteness of integral closure in a finite extension, and the ramification formula of a prime ideal. In the case of regular curves over a finite field further results are needed, which we prove later in the context of affine algebras.

Proposition 3.31.1

Let A be a Noetherian integral domain of dimension 1. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is integrally closed
- b) $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is integrally closed for every prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$
- c) $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a discrete valuation ring for every non-zero prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$

In this case we say that A is a **Dedekind Domain**.

Proof. Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be non-zero prime ideal of A . Then firstly $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is Noetherian by (...) and an integral domain by (...). Then $\dim A_{\mathfrak{p}} = \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) \leq \dim A = 1$. However $(0) \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}$ so $\dim A_{\mathfrak{p}} = \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = 1$.

a) $\iff$ b) This is (3.23.10).

b) $\implies$ c) We have shown that $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a Noetherian integral domain of dimension 1. Then it is a discrete valuation ring by (3.30.2).

c) $\implies$ b) Also follows from (3.30.2), since $A_{(0)}$ is a field and therefore automatically integrally closed. $\square$

Corollary 3.31.2

Every principal ideal domain which is not a field is a Dedekind Domain. For example $k[X]$ and $\mathbb{Z}$.

Proof. This follows from (3.16.23) (3.23.12) (3.15.2). $\square$

The following is useful in the theory of algebraic curves and function fields.

Proposition 3.31.3 (Correspondence between Prime Ideals and Valuation Rings)

Let A be an integral domain with Krull dimension 1 and quotient field K . Then there is a bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \{\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft A \mid \mathfrak{p} \text{ non-zero prime}\} & \longleftrightarrow & \{A \subsetneq R \subsetneq K \text{ local rings}\} \\ \mathfrak{p} & \longrightarrow & A_{\mathfrak{p}} \\ \mathfrak{m}_R \cap A & \longleftarrow & R \end{array}$$

When A is a Dedekind domain then all such local rings (and valuation rings) are discrete valuation rings.

Proof. Suppose that $x \in \mathfrak{p}_1 \setminus \mathfrak{p}_2$. Then $x^{-1} \in A_{\mathfrak{p}_2}$ but we claim $x^{-1} \notin A_{\mathfrak{p}_1}$. For suppose $x^{-1} \in A_{\mathfrak{p}_1}$ then $\frac{ax}{b} = 1$ for $a \in A$ and $b \notin \mathfrak{p}_1$ whence $ax = b$ a contradiction. Therefore the given map is injective.

Let R be a local ring with maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}_R$. Then $\mathfrak{m}_R \cap A$ is a prime ideal, and so either (0) or a non-zero prime $\mathfrak{p}$. We have $0 \neq \frac{x}{y} \in \mathfrak{m}_R$ for some $x, y \in A$ whence $0 \neq x \in \mathfrak{m}_R$. Therefore $\mathfrak{m}_R \cap A = \mathfrak{p}$. Suppose $x \in A \setminus \mathfrak{p}$ then $x \in R \setminus \mathfrak{m}_R \implies x \in R^*$. This shows that $A_{\mathfrak{p}} \subset R$ and $\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}} \subset \mathfrak{m}_R$, and we are done by (3.24.10). $\square$

Proposition 3.31.4

Let A be a Dedekind domain. Then every fractional ideal is invertible.

Proof. Let I be an invertible ideal. By (3.29.10) it is sufficient to show that $I_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is an invertible fractional ideal of $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ for all prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}$. By (3.31.1) $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a discrete valuation ring and the result follows from (3.30.4). $\square$

Lemma 3.31.5

Let A be a Dedekind domain and $\mathfrak{a}$ a proper ideal. Then there is a well-defined group homomorphism

$$(\mathfrak{a})^{-} : \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow \mathcal{I}_A$$

mapping 1 to $\mathfrak{a}$.

Proof. By (3.31.4) the monoid $\mathcal{I}_A$ is a group, and therefore the first homomorphism exists by (3.3.6). $\square$

Lemma 3.31.6

Let A be a Dedekind domain and $\mathfrak{p}, \mathfrak{q}$ non-zero prime ideals. Then

$$(\mathfrak{p}^k)_{\mathfrak{q}} = \begin{cases} A_{\mathfrak{q}} & \mathfrak{p} \neq \mathfrak{q} \\ (\mathfrak{q}A_{\mathfrak{q}})^k & \mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{q} \end{cases}$$

Proof. When $k = 0$ then by definition $\mathfrak{p}^k = A$ and $(\mathfrak{q}A_{\mathfrak{q}})^k = A_{\mathfrak{q}}$ and so we are done.

We suppose that $k = 1$. If $\mathfrak{p} \neq \mathfrak{q}$ then as $\dim A = 1$ we have $\mathfrak{p} \not\subseteq \mathfrak{q}$. Therefore by definition $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathfrak{q}}$ contains 1 and equals $A_{\mathfrak{q}}$ as required. The case $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{q}$ follows from (3.29.7).

By (3.29.8) and (3.31.5) both left and right hand sides define group homomorphisms $\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathcal{I}_{A_{\mathfrak{q}}}$ which agree at 1 and are therefore equal. $\square$

Proposition 3.31.7 (Unique Factorisation)

Let A be a Dedekind domain. There is a well-defined abelian group isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \bigoplus_{\mathfrak{p} \in \mathcal{P}} \mathbb{Z} &\xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{I}_A \\ (e_{\mathfrak{p}}) &\longrightarrow \prod_{\mathfrak{p}: e_{\mathfrak{p}} \neq 0} \mathfrak{p}^{e_{\mathfrak{p}}} \end{aligned}$$

where $\mathcal{P}$ is the set of prime ideals of A . Write $(v_{\mathfrak{p}})$ for the inverse, then it is given explicitly by

$$v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I) = v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I_{\mathfrak{p}})$$

Further a fractional ideal I is contained in A if and only if $v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I) \geq 0$ for all prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}$.

Proof. The homomorphism exists by (3.31.5) and the universal property of the sum of abelian groups (...).

Let I be a fractional ideal and define $v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I) := v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I_{\mathfrak{p}})$ using the notation of (3.30.4). This determines a group homomorphism $v_{\mathfrak{p}} : \mathcal{I}_A \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ by (3.29.8).b). We claim for every I that $v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I)$ is zero for all but finitely many prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}$. As $I = (a)^{-1}\mathfrak{a}$ for some ideal J of A it is sufficient by multiplicativity to demonstrate this for ideals $\mathfrak{a}$. By (...) if $\mathfrak{a} \not\subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ then $\mathfrak{a}_{\mathfrak{p}} = A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ which has valuation 0. Therefore we may assume that $\mathfrak{a} \subset \mathfrak{p}$. However by (3.21.7) there are only finitely many such primes, since every non-zero prime containing $\mathfrak{a}$ must be minimal over (0) , and a-fortiori over $\mathfrak{a}$.

Observe by (3.31.6) that for distinct prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}_1, \dots, \mathfrak{p}_n$ we have the identity

$$(\mathfrak{p}_1^{r_1} \dots \mathfrak{p}_n^{r_n})_{\mathfrak{q}} = \begin{cases} (\mathfrak{p}_k A_{\mathfrak{q}})^{r_k} & \mathfrak{q} = \mathfrak{p}_k \\ A_{\mathfrak{q}} & \mathfrak{q} \neq \mathfrak{p}_k \text{ for all } k = 1 \dots n \end{cases} \quad (3.5)$$

By the first claim there is a well-defined homomorphism $\mathcal{I}_A \rightarrow \bigoplus_{\mathfrak{p} \in \mathcal{P}} \mathbb{Z}$. We claim that this is a left inverse for the given map, that is to say

$$\prod_{\mathfrak{p}: v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I) \neq 0} \mathfrak{p}^{v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I)} = I$$

Denote the left hand side by I' . When $v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I) \neq 0$ then by (3.5) we have

$$I'_{\mathfrak{p}} = (\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}})^{v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I)} = (\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}})^{v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I_{\mathfrak{p}})} = I_{\mathfrak{p}}$$

Similarly if $v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I) = 0$ by (3.30.4)

$$I'_{\mathfrak{p}} = A_{\mathfrak{p}} = I_{\mathfrak{p}}$$

We conclude by (3.29.9) that $I = I'$ as required. Finally the relation (3.5) also shows that this is a right inverse.

For the final statement by (3.29.9) we have $I \subset A \iff I_{\mathfrak{p}} \subset A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ for all prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}$, then we may use the equivalent statement over DVRs (3.30.4). $\square$

Proposition 3.31.8

Let A be a Dedekind with I, J fractional ideals. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $I \subset J$
- b) J divides I (that is there exists an ideal $\mathfrak{a}$ such that $\mathfrak{a}J = I$)
- c) $v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I) \geq v_{\mathfrak{p}}(J)$ for all prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}$

Proof. a) $\iff$ c) By (3.29.9) we have $I \subset J \iff I_{\mathfrak{p}} \subset J_{\mathfrak{p}}$ for all prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}$. Then we may use the corresponding statement for DVRs (3.30.5).

b) $\implies$ c) Follows because $v_{\mathfrak{p}}(\mathfrak{a}) \geq 0$ (3.31.7).

c) $\implies$ b) We may define $\mathfrak{a} = \prod \mathfrak{p}^{v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I) - v_{\mathfrak{p}}(J)}$ which is contained in A and by multiplicativity $v_{\mathfrak{p}}(\mathfrak{a}J) = v_{\mathfrak{p}}(I)$ for all prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}$ whence $\mathfrak{a}J = I$ by the correspondence in (3.31.7). $\square$

Proposition 3.31.9 (Integral Closure is a Dedekind Domain)

Let L/K be a finite separable extension and $A \subset K$ a subring which is a Dedekind domain with quotient field K . Let B be the integral closure of A in L , then B is a finite A -module and a Dedekind domain.

If in addition A is a principal ideal domain (e.g. a discrete valuation ring) then B is a free A -module of rank $[L : K]$.

Proof. From (3.23.24) we know B is integrally closed and $\dim B = 1$. Then the rest follows from (3.23.26). $\square$

Definition 3.31.10 (AKLB Situation)

Let L/K be a finite field extension, $A \subset K$, $B \subset L$ Dedekind domains for which $A \subset B$ is integral (equivalently B is the integral closure of A in L), $\text{Frac}(A) = K$ and $\text{Frac}(B) = L$. We refer to this situation as “AKLB”.

Lemma 3.31.11

Using the notation in (3.31.10). Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be a prime ideal of A , and $\mathfrak{b}$ a proper ideal of B . Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\mathfrak{p} \subset \mathfrak{b}$
- b) $\mathfrak{b}$ divides $\mathfrak{p}B$
- c) $\mathfrak{b} \cap A = \mathfrak{p}$

and in this case we say that $\mathfrak{b}$ divides $\mathfrak{p}$ and write $\mathfrak{b} \mid \mathfrak{p}$.

In this case $B/\mathfrak{b}$ is naturally a $A/\mathfrak{p}$ -module via the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \hookrightarrow & B \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ A/\mathfrak{p} & \hookrightarrow & B/\mathfrak{b} \end{array}$$

Proof. a) $\iff$ b) follows from (3.31.8)

a) $\implies$ c) Trivially $\mathfrak{p} \subset \mathfrak{b} \cap A$. As $1 \in \mathfrak{b}$ then $\mathfrak{b} \cap A$ is a proper ideal, and therefore equal to $\mathfrak{p}$ by maximality.

c) $\implies$ a) Immediate. $\square$

Proposition 3.31.12

Using the notation in (3.31.10). Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be a prime ideal of A . There exists at least one prime ideal $\mathfrak{q} \mid \mathfrak{p}$, and only finitely many. For every such prime ideal define the integers $e_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}} := v_{\mathfrak{q}}(\mathfrak{p}B)$, then

$$\mathfrak{p}B = \prod_{\mathfrak{q} \mid \mathfrak{p}} \mathfrak{q}^{e_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}}} = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{q} \mid \mathfrak{p}} \mathfrak{q}^{e_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}}}$$

Proof. The existence of a prime $\mathfrak{q}$ follows from the Lying Over property of integral extensions (3.23.17). The factorisation exists by (3.31.7) which also shows that there are only finitely many divisors of $\mathfrak{p}$, and the second equality holds by the Chinese Remainder Theorem (3.4.63). $\square$

Definition 3.31.13 (Ramification Index / Inertial Degree)

Using the notation in (3.31.10), suppose that $\mathfrak{q} \mid \mathfrak{p}$. Then we define the **ramification index** by

$$e_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}} = v_{\mathfrak{q}}(\mathfrak{p}B)$$

which by (...) is a positive integer. Similarly define the **inertial degree**

$$f_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}} = [B/\mathfrak{q} : A/\mathfrak{p}]$$

which we presently show to be finite.

Lemma 3.31.14

Let L/K be a finite field extension, A a subring with quotient field K and $B \supset A$ an overring with quotient field L . Suppose that $\mathfrak{p}$ is a prime ideal of A , $\mathfrak{b}$ is a proper ideal of B containing $\mathfrak{p}$ and $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a UFD. Then canonically $B/\mathfrak{b}$ is an $A/\mathfrak{p}$ -module and

$$[B/\mathfrak{b} : A/\mathfrak{p}] \leq [L : K]$$

Furthermore we have $\mathfrak{b}B_{\mathfrak{p}} \cap A_{\mathfrak{p}} = \mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ and

$$[B/\mathfrak{b} : A/\mathfrak{p}] = [B_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{b}B_{\mathfrak{p}} : A_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}]$$

Proof. Suppose that $\overline{x_1}, \dots, \overline{x_n} \in B/\mathfrak{b}$ are linearly independent over $A/\mathfrak{p}$. It is sufficient by (...) to show that $x_1, \dots, x_n$ are linearly independent over K . Suppose we have a linear dependence

$$0 = \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i x_i \quad \lambda_i \in K$$

Then by clearing denominators we may assume that $\lambda_i \in A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ not all zero. By removing the greatest common divisor of the non-zero elements we may assume that $(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n) = A_{\mathfrak{p}}$, which means at least one is not in $\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$. There is by (3.7.24) a canonical reduction map

$$\bar{\cdot} : A_{\mathfrak{p}} \rightarrow A_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}} \xrightarrow{\sim} A/\mathfrak{p}$$

In otherwords $\overline{\lambda_i} \neq 0$, which gives a linear dependence on $\overline{x_1}, \dots, \overline{x_n}$ a contradiction and we are done.

For the last statement consider the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A/\mathfrak{p} & \hookrightarrow & B/\mathfrak{b} \\ \downarrow \sim & & \downarrow \sim \\ A_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}} & \hookrightarrow & B_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{b}B_{\mathfrak{p}} \end{array}$$

For the vertical arrows we show they are isomorphism by (3.7.24). Observe that for $s \in A \setminus \mathfrak{p}$ we have by maximality $As + \mathfrak{p} = A$, whence $Bs + \mathfrak{p}B = B \implies Bs + \mathfrak{b} = A$. Then the last two statement follow immediately. $\square$

Lemma 3.31.15 (Local Form of Ramification Index / Inertial Degree)

Using the notation in (3.31.10), suppose $\mathfrak{p}$ is a prime ideal and define $A' := A_{\mathfrak{p}}$, $\mathfrak{p}' := \mathfrak{p}'A_{\mathfrak{p}}$, $B' := B_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Then A', B' is also “AKLB” and there is a bijection

$$\{\mathfrak{q} \triangleleft B : \mathfrak{q} \mid \mathfrak{p}\} \longleftrightarrow \{\mathfrak{q}' \triangleleft B'\}$$

which the ramification index and inertial degrees, i.e.

$$e_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}} = e_{\mathfrak{q}'/\mathfrak{p}'}$$

and

$$f_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}} = f_{\mathfrak{q}'/\mathfrak{p}'} \leq [L : K]$$

Further the ramification index is equal to

$$v_{\mathfrak{q}'}(\pi B')$$

where π is any uniformiser for the DVR A' .

Proof. Evidently A' has quotient field K and B' has quotient field L . By definition A' is a DVR and therefore a Dedekind domain. By (3.23.9) B' is the integral closure of A' , and therefore integrally closed. It has Krull Dimension 1 by (3.23.22) and is Noetherian by (...). Therefore we have the same situation as (3.31.10).

First consider the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \hookrightarrow & B \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ A' & \hookrightarrow & B' \end{array}$$

regarded as subrings of K and L respectively.

Then by chasing the diagram $\mathfrak{p}'B' = (\mathfrak{p}B)B'$. By (3.31.12) we have a unique factorisation

$$\mathfrak{p}B = \prod_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{q}_i^{e_i}$$

for prime ideals $\mathfrak{q}_i$ of B dividing $\mathfrak{p}$. Define $\mathfrak{q}'_i := \mathfrak{q}_i B_{\mathfrak{p}}$ then these are prime by (3.7.16) (and the fact $\mathfrak{q} \cap (A \setminus \mathfrak{p}) = \emptyset$) and contain $\mathfrak{p}'B'$ (3.31.12). Then by (3.4.51)

$$\mathfrak{p}'B' = \prod_{i=1}^n (\mathfrak{q}'_i)^{e_i}$$

The bijection of prime ideals is well-defined by (3.7.17). By uniqueness $e_{\mathfrak{q}'/\mathfrak{p}'} = e_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}}$ for all primes $\mathfrak{q} \mid \mathfrak{p}$.

The relation $f_{\mathfrak{q}'/\mathfrak{p}'} = f_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}} \leq [L : K]$ follows directly from (3.31.14). $\square$

Proposition 3.31.16 (Ramification Formula)

Using the notation of (3.31.10). For every prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ of A we have the identity

$$\sum_{\mathfrak{q} \mid \mathfrak{p}} e_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}} f_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}} = [B/\mathfrak{p}B : A/\mathfrak{p}] \leq [L : K]$$

Suppose in addition that B is a finite A -module then we have equality. In particular this holds when L/K is separable.

Proof. Recall from (3.31.9) we have the factorisation

$$\mathfrak{p}B = \prod_{\mathfrak{q} \mid \mathfrak{p}} \mathfrak{q}^{e_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}}}$$

By the Chinese Remainder Theorem (3.4.63) we have a canonical isomorphism

$$B/\mathfrak{p}B \xrightarrow{\sim} \prod_{\mathfrak{q} \mid \mathfrak{p}} B/\mathfrak{q}^{e_{\mathfrak{q}}}$$

Both $B/\mathfrak{p}B$ and $B/\mathfrak{q}^{e_{\mathfrak{q}}}$ are $A/\mathfrak{p}$ -modules, and so equating vector space dimensions we have

$$[B/\mathfrak{p}B : A/\mathfrak{p}] = \sum_{\mathfrak{q} \mid \mathfrak{p}} [B/\mathfrak{q}^{e_{\mathfrak{q}}} : A/\mathfrak{p}]$$

As $\mathfrak{p}B \subset \mathfrak{q}^e$ we have a decreasing sequence of $A/\mathfrak{p}$ -submodules

$$B/\mathfrak{q}^e \supseteq \mathfrak{q}^1/\mathfrak{q}^e \supseteq \dots \supseteq \mathfrak{q}^e/\mathfrak{q}^e = (0)$$

so by (3.4.131) we have

$$[B/\mathfrak{q}^e : A/\mathfrak{p}] = \sum_{i=1}^e [(\mathfrak{q}^{i-1}/\mathfrak{q}^e)/(\mathfrak{q}^i/\mathfrak{q}^e) : A/\mathfrak{p}]$$

We claim there is an $A/\mathfrak{p}$ -module isomorphism

$$(\mathfrak{q}^{i-1}/\mathfrak{q}^e)/(\mathfrak{q}^i/\mathfrak{q}^e) \rightarrow \mathfrak{q}^{i-1}/\mathfrak{q}^i$$

This exists as an A -module isomorphism by (3.4.106), and therefore as an $A/\mathfrak{p}$ -module isomorphism as the action factors through the quotient map $A \rightarrow A/\mathfrak{p}$. Therefore by (3.18.11)

$$\begin{aligned} [B/\mathfrak{q}^e : A/\mathfrak{p}] &= \sum_{i=1}^e [\mathfrak{q}^{i-1}/\mathfrak{q}^i : A/\mathfrak{p}] \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^e [B/\mathfrak{q} : A/\mathfrak{p}] [\mathfrak{q}^{i-1}/\mathfrak{q}^i : B/\mathfrak{q}] \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^e f_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}} [\mathfrak{q}^{i-1}/\mathfrak{q}^i : B/\mathfrak{q}] \end{aligned}$$

We claim that $[\mathfrak{q}^{i-1}/\mathfrak{q}^i : B/\mathfrak{q}] = 1$. Any non-trivial subspace of $\mathfrak{q}^{i-1}/\mathfrak{q}^i$ is a-fortiori a B -submodule, and by the isomorphism theorem yields an ideal between $\mathfrak{q}^{i-1}$ and $\mathfrak{q}^i$. Therefore it is enough to show there is no such ideal. By (3.7.35) we may localize at $\mathfrak{q}$ to consider the ring $B_{\mathfrak{q}}$. By definition this is a DVR and the result follows from (3.30.2). Therefore

$$[B/\mathfrak{p}B : A/\mathfrak{p}] = \sum_{\mathfrak{q} \mid \mathfrak{p}} e_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}} f_{\mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{p}}.$$

The inequality follows from (3.31.14).

It remains to show this equals $[B/\mathfrak{p}B : A/\mathfrak{p}] = [L : K]$ in the case B is a finite A -module. By (3.31.15) and (3.31.14) we may reduce to the case of A a discrete valuation ring, and in a particular principal ideal domain. Then by (3.23.25)

we have B is a free A -module of rank $n = [L : K]$. Let $x_1, \dots, x_n$ be such a basis, then we claim that $\overline{x_1}, \dots, \overline{x_n}$ is linearly independent over $A/\mathfrak{p}$ and therefore a basis for $B/\mathfrak{p}B$. For suppose

$$0 = \sum_{i=1}^n \overline{\lambda_i x_i} \quad \lambda_i \in A$$

then we may show that $\mathfrak{p}B = \mathfrak{p}x_1 + \dots + \mathfrak{p}x_n$ whence by definition

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i x_i = \sum_{i=1}^n \mu_i x_i$$

for some $\mu_i \in \mathfrak{p}$, from which it follows $\lambda_i = \mu_i$ and $\overline{\lambda_i} = 0$, and we are done.

The case L/K is separable is then (3.23.26). □

3.32 Affine Algebras

Definition 3.32.1 (Affine Domain)

We call a finitely-generated k -algebra an **affine algebra**. If in addition it's integral we call it an **affine domain**.

3.32.1 Reduction

Recall that $A_{\text{red}} := A/N(A)$.

Lemma 3.32.2

Let A be a k -algebra and $\mathfrak{a}$ an ideal. Then $N(A/\mathfrak{a}) = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}/\mathfrak{a}$ and there is a canonical isomorphism

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A/\mathfrak{a} & \xleftarrow{\quad} & A \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ (A/\mathfrak{a})_{\text{red}} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & A/\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \\ \overline{a + \mathfrak{a}} & \longrightarrow & (a + \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}) \end{array}$$

which is the unique morphism making the diagram commute.

Proof. For the first part $(a + \mathfrak{a})^n = a^n + \mathfrak{a}$, so $(a + \mathfrak{a}) \in N(A/\mathfrak{a}) \iff (a + \mathfrak{a})^n = 0 \iff a^n \in \mathfrak{a} \text{ some } n \iff a \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$.

The second part then follows from (3.4.58). $\square$

Proposition 3.32.3

Let A be a k -algebra then for every reduced k -algebra B there is a canonical bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Mor}(A_{\text{red}}, B) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{Mor}(A, B) \\ \phi & \rightarrow & \phi \circ \pi \end{array}$$

where $\pi : A \rightarrow A_{\text{red}}$ is the quotient map, which is natural in B . When A is reduced then π is an isomorphism.

Proof. Suppose $\tilde{\phi} : A \rightarrow B$ is a homomorphism and $a \in N(A)$. Then $0 = \tilde{\phi}(a^n) = \tilde{\phi}(a)^n$ whence $\tilde{\phi}(N(A)) \subset N(B) = (0)$, that is $N(A) \subset \ker(\tilde{\phi})$. By (3.4.56) there exists ϕ such that $\phi \circ \pi = \tilde{\phi}$. This shows the given map is surjective. As π is surjective we may also deduce that the map is injective. $\square$

Proposition 3.32.4

Let A, B be k -algebras and $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a k -algebra homomorphism, then there is a unique morphism $\phi_{\text{red}} : A_{\text{red}} \rightarrow B_{\text{red}}$ making the following diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\phi} & B \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ A_{\text{red}} & \dashrightarrow & B_{\text{red}} \end{array}$$

given by

$$\phi_{\text{red}}(a + N(A)) = \phi(a) + N(B)$$

Furthermore $(\psi \circ \phi)_{\text{red}} = \psi_{\text{red}} \circ \phi_{\text{red}}$. If ϕ is an isomorphism then so is ϕ_{red} .

Proof. In the notation of (3.32.3) ϕ_{red} is simply the morphism corresponding to $\pi_B \circ \phi$, from which existence and uniqueness follows.

Uniqueness then also shows that this is functorial. $\square$

3.32.2 Normalisation

The following normalisation results can be seen as a refinement of results on transcendence bases (Section 3.18.17).

Definition 3.32.5 (Algebraically Independent)

Let A be a k -algebra and $x_1, \dots, x_n$ elements of A . Then we say they are **algebraically independent** if one of the following equivalent conditions holds

- The unique k -algebra homomorphism $\phi : k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \rightarrow A$ such that $\phi(X_i) = x_i$ (evaluation homomorphism) is injective
- There are no non-zero polynomials $f(X_1, \dots, X_n)$ such that $f(x_1, \dots, x_n) = 0$.

Note in particular it induces an isomorphism $k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \xrightarrow{\sim} k[x_1, \dots, x_n] \subset A$.

Definition 3.32.6 (Normalising Family)

Let A be a finitely-generated k -algebra. A **normalising family** is a set $\{x_1, \dots, x_n\}$ of elements of A such that

- $x_1, \dots, x_n$ are **algebraically independent** over k
- A is a finite $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ -module (equivalently integral over $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$).

NB this is completely equivalent to specifying an integral, injective map

$$k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \hookrightarrow A$$

This may be seen as a refined transcendence base. More precisely we have the following

Proposition 3.32.7 (Relationship to Transcendence Base)

Let A be an **integral** finitely-generated k -algebra with $K := \text{Frac}(A)$. Let $S \subset A$ be a subset. Then

- If A is integral over $k[S]$ then $K/k(S)$ is algebraic
- If S is a normalising family for A then S is a transcendence basis for K/k

In particular normalising families have order $\text{trdeg}(K/k)$.

Proof. By (3.18.58) the set $\{x \in K \mid x \text{ algebraic over } k(S)\}$ forms a subfield containing A , and therefore equals K .

The final statement follows from (3.18.152). $\square$

The following is useful as it removes the necessity of showing algebraic independence in certain cases.

Corollary 3.32.8

Let A be an integral finitely-generated k -algebra with $K := \text{Frac}(A)$. Let $S \subset A$ be a subset such that

- A is integral over $k[S]$
- $\#S \leq \text{trdeg}_k(K)$

then S is a **normalising family**.

Proof. This follows from the previous result and (3.18.152). $\square$

There are a few forms of the Normalisation Lemma which we prove, of progressively stronger form.

Lemma 3.32.9 (Hypersurface Normalisation Lemma)

Let $A = k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ be a polynomial ring over an infinite field k and $0 \neq F \in A$. Then there exists $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_{n-1} \in k$ such that

- $x_i := X_i - \lambda_i F \quad 1 \leq i \leq n-1$
- $x_1, \dots, x_{n-1}, F$ is a normalising family for A
- $FA \cap k[x_1, \dots, x_{n-1}, F] = Fk[x_1, \dots, x_{n-1}, F]$

This may be viewed as a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \phi : k[Y_1, \dots, Y_n] & \xrightarrow{\sim} & k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \\ \uparrow & & \downarrow \\ k[Y_1, \dots, Y_{n-1}] & \hookrightarrow & k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/(F) \end{array}$$

where the horizontal arrows are injective, integral (and finite) and $\phi^{-1}((F)) = (Y_n)$.

Remark 3.32.10

Reversing the arrows we get the geometric picture, where horizontal arrows are finite and surjective

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbb{A}^n & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathbb{A}^n \\ \uparrow & & \downarrow \\ V(F) & \twoheadrightarrow & \mathbb{A}^{n-1} \end{array}$$

in otherwords after a linear change of variables we may express $V(F)$ as a finite covering of a standard hyperplane.

Proposition 3.32.11 (Nagata Normalisation Lemma)

Let $A = k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ be a finitely-generated k -algebra such that k is infinite. Then there exists a **normalising family** $y_1, \dots, y_d \in A$ such that each y_i is a k -linear combination of $x_1, \dots, x_n$. Further if $\mathfrak{a}_1 \triangleleft A$ is a proper ideal, then these may be chosen such that

$$\mathfrak{a}_1 \cap k[y_1, \dots, y_d] = (y_1, \dots, y_h)k[y_1, \dots, y_d]$$

for some $0 \leq h \leq d$, where $h = 0$ denotes the zero ideal.

Proposition 3.32.12 (Bourbaki Normalisation Lemma)

Let $A = k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ be a finitely-generated k -algebra such that k is infinite. Then there exists a **normalising family** $y_1, \dots, y_d \in A$ such that each y_i is a k -linear combination of $x_1, \dots, x_n$.

Furthermore for any finite chain of proper ideals in A

$$\mathfrak{a}_1 \subseteq \mathfrak{a}_2 \subseteq \dots \subseteq \mathfrak{a}_p \subsetneq A$$

the family may be chosen such that

$$\mathfrak{a}_j \cap k[y_1, \dots, y_d] = (y_1, \dots, y_{h(j)})k[y_1, \dots, y_d] \quad 1 \leq j \leq p.$$

for some non-decreasing sequence of integers $h(j)$, where $h(j) = 0$ denotes the zero ideal.

Remark 3.32.13 (Geometric Interpretation)

Note the normalisation here is equivalent to a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k[Y_1, \dots, Y_d] & \hookrightarrow & A \\ \uparrow & & \downarrow \\ k[Y_{h(1)+1}, \dots, Y_d] & \hookrightarrow & A/\mathfrak{a}_1 \\ \uparrow & & \downarrow \\ \vdots & & \vdots \\ \uparrow & & \downarrow \\ k[Y_{h(p)+1}, \dots, Y_d] & \hookrightarrow & A/\mathfrak{a}_p \end{array}$$

where the horizontal arrows are integral and injective, and the top arrow is given by

$$\phi : Y_i \rightarrow \sum_j \lambda_{ij} x_j$$

such that $\phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{a}_i) = (Y_1, \dots, Y_{h(i)})$

As before this expresses A as a finite covering of $\mathbb{A}^d$ under which each subvariety is also a finite covering of a standard linear subspace.

We first prove the weaker form of the Normalisation Lemma

Proof of (3.32.9). First decompose F into homogenous polynomials (monomials of the same degree)

$$F = F_0 + F_1 + \dots + F_m$$

and observe that the monomial X_n^m appears only in F_m . Define

$$F' := F(X_1 + \lambda_1 X_n, \dots, X_{n-1} + \lambda_{n-1} X_n, X_n)$$

Furthermore in terms of homogenous polynomials

$$F'_m = F_m(X_1 + \lambda_1 T, \dots, X_{n-1} + \lambda_{n-1} X_n, X_n)$$

and the coefficient of X_n^m in F' is simply $F'_m(0, \dots, 0, 1) = F_m(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_{n-1}, 1) \in k$. There are only finitely many values of λ such that F'_m is zero, whence there exists a λ such that X_n^m has non-zero coefficient in F' , whence F' is monic. By the previous Lemma we have $F'(x_1, \dots, x_{n-1}, X_n) = 0$, with the leading coefficient in X_n constant.

Let $B := k[x_1, \dots, x_{n-1}, F]$. Then clearly $B[X_n] = A$ and X_n is integral over B . Therefore by (3.23.4) A is a finite B -module. As $\text{trdeg}(A/k) = n$ by (3.32.8) $\{x_1, \dots, x_{n-1}, F\}$ is a normalising family, and B is isomorphic to a polynomial ring.

As B is a polynomial ring it is integrally closed (3.23.12). Then the final statement is a consequence of the following lemma (3.32.14) (essentially to prove that $V(F) \rightarrow \mathbb{A}^{n-1}$ is surjective). $\square$

Lemma 3.32.14

Let A be integrally closed, $\phi : A \hookrightarrow B$ injective and integral and $a \in A$. Then

$$(a)^{ec} = \phi^{-1}(\phi(a)B) = (a)$$

Proof. Let $K = \text{Frac}(A)$ and $L = \text{Frac}(B)$, then ϕ extends to an injection $\phi : K \hookrightarrow L$.

Generically we have $(a) \subseteq (a)^{ec}$. Suppose $a' \in (a)^{ec}$, then $\phi(a') = \phi(a)b$. Therefore $\phi(a'a^{-1}) = b$ is integral over A , whence so is $a'a^{-1}$. As A is integrally closed we have $a' \in (a)$ as required. $\square$

Before proving the stronger version of Normalisation Lemma, we need some preliminary technical results

Lemma 3.32.15

Let A be a k -algebra and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ an ideal. Then $\mathfrak{a}$ is proper iff $\mathfrak{a} \cap k = \{0\}$.

Lemma 3.32.16

Let $A = k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ be a polynomial ring and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ a proper ideal. Then TFAE

- a) $\mathfrak{a} = (X_1, \dots, X_h)$
- b) i) $X_1, \dots, X_h \in \mathfrak{a}$
- ii) $\mathfrak{a} \cap k[X_{h+1}, \dots, X_n] = \{0\}$

In this case $\mathfrak{a} \cap k[X_1, \dots, X_h] = (X_1, \dots, X_h)k[X_1, \dots, X_h]$

Proof. We claim that there is a direct sum of k -vector spaces

$$k[X_1, \dots, X_n] = (X_1, \dots, X_h) \bigoplus k[X_{h+1}, \dots, X_n]$$

from which the result largely follows. Let S be the set of monomials in which at least one of $X_1, \dots, X_h$ appears, and let T be the set for which none appears (but including 1). Then clearly $A = \langle S \rangle \oplus \langle T \rangle$ and $k[X_{h+1}, \dots, X_n] = \langle T \rangle$. We argue that $(X_1, \dots, X_h) = \langle S \rangle$. First S is stable under multiplication by $X_1, \dots, X_n$, and so $\langle S \rangle$ is an ideal. One inclusion is obvious, furthermore it's clear that $S \subseteq (X_1, \dots, X_n)$ from which the claim follows. $\square$

We may now proceed to the proof of the stronger versions of the Normalisation Lemma.

Reduction to polynomial ring case for (3.32.11), (3.32.12). We show that for both forms it is possible to reduce to the case of a polynomial ring. For let A be a finitely-generated k -algebra then we may write $A := k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}$ for some ideal $\mathfrak{a}$. Then the polynomial ring case for $p = 1$ shows the existence of an integral, injective map

$$\phi : k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m] \hookrightarrow A$$

If $\mathfrak{a}_i$ is a chain of ideals in A , then $\mathfrak{a}'_i := \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{a}_i)$ is a chain of ideals in $k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m]$. The general case for a polynomial ring shows the existence of an integral map

$$\psi : k[Z_1, \dots, Z_m] \hookrightarrow k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m]$$

such that

$$\psi^{-1}(\mathfrak{a}'_i) = (Z_1, \dots, Z_{h(i)})$$

The composition $\phi \circ \psi$ gives the required normalisation of A . Geometrically express A as a finite covering of affine space, by considering it as a subvariety of larger affine space. $\square$

Proof of (3.32.11) in the polynomial ring case. Let $A = k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ and proceed by induction on n .

Note that as $\mathfrak{a}_1$ is proper, we must have $\mathfrak{a}_1 \cap k = \{0\}$, and we may obviously also assume that $\mathfrak{a}_1 \neq (0)$ (as otherwise we may take $h = 0$).

Choose $0 \neq x_1 \in \mathfrak{a}_1$. Then by (3.32.9) there exists $t_2, \dots, t_n \in A$ such that $x_1, t_2, \dots, t_n$ is a normalising family and $(x_1) \cap B = x_1 B$ where $B := k[x_1, t_2, \dots, t_n]$. In the case that $\mathfrak{a}_1$ is principal we are done, since the choice of x_1 was arbitrary, and in this case $h(1) = 1$. In particular this covers the base case $n = 1$ because A is a PID (3.15.4).

Otherwise $B' := k[t_2, \dots, t_n]$ is a polynomial ring and $\mathfrak{a}'_1 := \mathfrak{a}_1 \cap B'$ is proper by (3.32.15). By induction on n there is a normalising family $x_2, \dots, x_n$ for B' such that $\mathfrak{a}'_1 \cap C' = (x_2, \dots, x_h)C'$ where $C' := k[x_2, \dots, x_n]$ and B' is integral over C' .

Define $C := k[x_1, \dots, x_n] = C'[x_1]$ then $x_1, t_2, \dots, t_n$ are integral over C , so B is integral over C (3.23.4), and A is integral over C (3.23.5), so by (3.32.8) $x_1, \dots, x_n$ is a normalising family for A .

We claim that $\mathfrak{a}''_1 := \mathfrak{a}_1 \cap C = (x_1, \dots, x_h)C$. Clearly $x_1, \dots, x_h \in \mathfrak{a}''_1$, and $\mathfrak{a}''_1 \cap k[x_{h+1}, \dots, x_n] = \mathfrak{a}'_1 \cap k[x_{h+1}, \dots, x_n] = \{0\}$ by (3.32.16) applied to the ring C' . Then (3.32.16) applied to the ring C demonstrates the claim. $\square$

Proof of (3.32.12) in the polynomial ring case. We can then show the case $p > 1$ by induction, for by the induction hypothesis there exists a normalising family $t_1, \dots, t_n$ for A such that

$$\begin{aligned} \mathfrak{a}_j \cap B &= (t_1, \dots, t_{h(j)})B \quad 1 \leq j \leq p-1 \\ B &:= k[t_1, \dots, t_n] \end{aligned}$$

Let $r = h(p-1)$, then by the case $p = 1$ applied to the ring $B' := k[t_{r+1}, \dots, t_n]$ and ideal $\mathfrak{a}_p \cap B'$ there exists a normalising family $x_{r+1}, \dots, x_n$ for B' such that for some $s \leq n$ (possibly equal to r to denote the zero ideal),

$$\begin{aligned} \mathfrak{a}_p \cap C' &= (x_{r+1}, \dots, x_s)C' \\ C' &:= k[x_{r+1}, \dots, x_n] \end{aligned}$$

We claim that $t_1, \dots, t_r, x_{r+1}, \dots, x_n$ is a suitable normalising family for A , with $h(p) = s$.

For define $C := k[t_1, \dots, t_r, x_{r+1}, \dots, x_n] = C'[t_1, \dots, t_r]$. Recall B' is integral over C' , and $t_1, \dots, t_r$ are obviously integral over C so $B = B'[t_1, \dots, t_r]$ is integral over C by (3.23.7). Then A is integral over C by (3.23.5), and this is a normalising family by (3.32.8), and in particular algebraically independent.

For $j \leq p-1$ and $h := h(j) \leq r$, apply (3.32.16) to the ideal $\mathfrak{a}_j \cap B$ to see $\mathfrak{a}_j \cap k[t_{h+1}, \dots, t_n] = \{0\}$ and therefore $\mathfrak{a}_j \cap k[t_{h+1}, \dots, t_r, x_{r+1}, \dots, x_n] = \{0\}$. As $t_1, \dots, t_h \in \mathfrak{a}_j$ we see by (3.32.16) that $\mathfrak{a}_j \cap C = (t_1, \dots, t_h)C$ as required.

Similarly by (3.32.16) $\mathfrak{a}_p \cap k[x_{s+1}, \dots, x_n] = \{0\}$ and clearly $t_1, \dots, t_r, x_{r+1}, \dots, x_s \in \mathfrak{a}_p$. Then by (3.32.16) again $\mathfrak{a}_p \cap C = (t_1, \dots, t_r, x_{r+1}, \dots, x_s)C$ as required. $\square$

Remark 3.32.17

In Bourbaki's proof the reduction to the polynomial ring case increases p to $p+1$, so in particular the $p = 1$ case requires the more complex reduction argument at the end of the proof. Here we use a simplified argument from [Sha00].

3.32.3 Nullstellensatz

Definition 3.32.18 (Zeros of an ideal)

Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ be an ideal and K/k a field extension. Then a point $x \in K^n$ is a **zero** of $\mathfrak{a}$ if

$$f \in \mathfrak{a} \implies f(x) = 0$$

We define the **residue field** to be

$$k(x) := k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$$

and also denote

$$k[x] := k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$$

We say it is **algebraic** if $k(x)/k$ is algebraic (necessarily finite).

The follow observation is useful

Proposition 3.32.19 (Zeros are homomorphisms)

Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ be an ideal then there is a bijection

$$\begin{aligned} \text{AlgHom}_k(k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}, K) &\longleftrightarrow \{ \text{zeros of } \mathfrak{a} \text{ in } K^n \} \\ \phi &\longrightarrow (\phi(\bar{X}_1), \dots, \phi(\bar{X}_n)) \end{aligned}$$

The following notion is useful in future

Definition 3.32.20 (Generic Point)

Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ be a prime ideal. then a point $\xi \in L^n$ is a **generic point** of $\mathfrak{a}$ if $\ker(\text{ev}_\xi) = \mathfrak{a}$. Note one always exists, because we may take $L = \text{Frac}(A)$ and $\xi_i = \bar{X}_i$.

When x is another zero of $\mathfrak{a}$ this induces a k -algebra homomorphism

$$k[\xi] \rightarrow k[x]$$

which is an isomorphism precisely when x is a generic point.

Generally we are interested in the relationship between ideals of $k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ and corresponding zeros in an extension field K/k . The following proposition is fundamental

Proposition 3.32.21 (Correspondence between ideals and zeros)

Let K/k be a field extension and $x \in K^n$. Define $\mathfrak{m}_x$ to be the kernel of the homomorphism

$$\text{ev}_x : k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \rightarrow K$$

Then

- $\mathfrak{m}_x$ is a prime ideal
- If K/k is an algebraically closed field of transcendence degree $\geq n$ then every prime ideal is of this form.
- If x_i are algebraic over k (e.g. if K/k is algebraic) then $\mathfrak{m}_x$ is maximal

In this case we have a canonical isomorphism

$$k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{m}_x \xrightarrow{\sim} k[x] \subset K$$

and when each x_i is algebraic then $k[x] = k(x)$ is a finite extension of k .

Proof. The canonical isomorphism follows from (3.11.3). Any subring of a field is an integral domain, which means $\mathfrak{p}_x$ is prime by (3.4.59).

By (3.18.57) x_i are algebraic over k if and only if $k(x_1, \dots, x_n)/k$ is algebraic (and even finite). By the same result $k[x_1, \dots, x_n] = k(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ and therefore $\mathfrak{m}_x$ is maximal by (3.4.59).

Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be a prime ideal and define $k(x) := \text{Frac}(k[x])$ and $k[x] := k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{p}$. If K has transcendence degree $\geq n$ then there is an embedding $k(x)/k \rightarrow K/k$ by (3.18.73). This restricts to an isomorphism $k[x] \xrightarrow{\sim} k[\bar{x}]$ for some $\bar{x}_i \in K$. It's clear that $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{m}_x$. $\square$

We may show that all maximal ideals correspond to zero-loci.

Lemma 3.32.22 (Zariski's Lemma)

Let k be an infinite field and A a finitely-generated k -algebra which is a field. Then A is a finite extension of k .

Proof. By Normalisation Lemma (3.32.11) there is an injective, integral map $k[X_1, \dots, X_d] \hookrightarrow A$ for some $d \geq 0$. By (3.23.14) then $k[X_1, \dots, X_d]$ is a field which implies $d = 0$. We conclude that A is algebraic over k , and by (3.18.57) finite over k . $\square$

Proposition 3.32.23 (Weak Nullstellensatz I)

Every maximal ideal of $k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}$ is of the form $\mathfrak{m}_x/\mathfrak{a}$ for $x \in \bar{k}^n$ a zero of $\mathfrak{a}$.

In addition the conclusion of Zariski's Lemma holds for all (possibly finite) coefficient fields k .

Proof. Observe that $x \in \bar{k}^n$ is a zero of $\mathfrak{a}$ if and only if $\mathfrak{a} \subset \mathfrak{m}_x$. Therefore we may reduce to the case $\mathfrak{a} = (0)$ by results on quotient rings (3.4.56).

We've already shown that $\mathfrak{m}_x$ is maximal when $x \in \bar{k}^n$ is algebraic (3.32.21). Conversely if $\mathfrak{m}$ is a maximal ideal, then $\mathfrak{m}\bar{k}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ is a proper ideal contained in some maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}' \triangleleft \bar{k}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$. If $\mathfrak{m}'$ has an algebraic zero then so does $\mathfrak{m}$ and $\mathfrak{m} \subset \mathfrak{m}_x$ for some x , which are equal by maximality.

However $\bar{k}[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{m}'$ is a finitely-generated $\bar{k}$ -algebra which is a field and $\bar{k}$ is infinite. Therefore by (3.32.22) it is $\bar{k}$, and this yields an algebraic zero of $\mathfrak{m}'$ as required.

We may generalise Zariski's Lemma to the case k is not necessarily infinite. If A is a finitely-generated k -algebra which is a field then we have shown it is isomorphic to $k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{m}_x$ for some algebraic point x . By (3.32.21) is a finite extension of k , as required. $\square$

We may make the correspondence between maximal ideals and algebraic points more precise

Proposition 3.32.24 (Weak Nullstellensatz II)

There is a bijective map

$$\begin{aligned} \bar{k}^n / \text{Aut}(\bar{k}/k) &\longrightarrow \{ \mathfrak{m} \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \text{ maximal} \} \\ x &\longrightarrow \mathfrak{m}_x \end{aligned}$$

When $x \in k^n$ then

$$\mathfrak{m}_x = (X_1 - x_1, \dots, X_n - x_n)$$

Proof. The map is surjective by (3.32.23). It's well-defined because $\mathfrak{m}_{\sigma(x)} = \mathfrak{m}_x$.

By (3.32.21) we have an isomorphism $k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{m}_x \xrightarrow{\sim} k[x_1, \dots, x_n] \subset \bar{k}$. If $\mathfrak{m}_x = \mathfrak{m}_y$ then these compose to yield an isomorphism $\sigma : k[x_1, \dots, x_n] \xrightarrow{\sim} k[y_1, \dots, y_n] \subset \bar{k}$ such that $\sigma(x_i) = y_i$. By (3.18.81) this extends to $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(\bar{k}/k)$. Therefore the given mapping is injective. $\square$

3.32.4 Morphisms of Affine Algebras

Definition 3.32.25

Let B be a k -algebra. We say that B is **algebraic** over k if for every maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m} \triangleleft B$ we have $B/\mathfrak{m} \xrightarrow{\sim} k(\mathfrak{m})$ is algebraic over k .

Proposition 3.32.26

Let B be a k -algebra, then it is algebraic in each of the following cases

- a) B is a finitely generated k -algebra
- b) B is a local k -algebra such that $k(\mathfrak{m}_B)/k$ is algebraic
- c) B is an algebraic field extension of k
- d) B is the localisation of a finitely-generated k -algebra at a maximal ideal

Proof. We prove each in turn

- a) This follows from Zariski's Lemma in the general case (3.32.23)
- b) The only maximal ideal is $\mathfrak{m}_B$ so this is obvious
- c) This is a special case of b)
- d) This follows from a) and b) because $B_{\mathfrak{m}}$ is a local ring with residue field isomorphic to $B/\mathfrak{m}$ (3.7.36).

$\square$

Proposition 3.32.27

Let $\phi : A \rightarrow B$ be a k -algebra homomorphism, with B algebraic. Then the inverse image of a maximal ideal is again maximal.

Proof. Let $\mathfrak{n}$ be a maximal ideal. By assumption $B/\mathfrak{n}$ is integral over k , and so a-fortiori $B/\mathfrak{n}$ is integral over A . Therefore $\phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{n})$ is maximal by (3.23.16). $\square$

3.32.5 Krull Dimension of Affine Algebras

The Krull Dimension of affine domains is particularly well-behaved. Specifically they are biequidimensional and therefore satisfy a co-dimension formula (3.32.35). Further there's a geometric proof of the "Hauptidealsatz" (3.32.32). We first show that it is equal to transcendence degree in the integral case.

Proposition 3.32.28

Let A be an affine algebra with normalising family $x_1, \dots, x_n$, then $\dim A = n$.

In particular every affine domain A satisfies $\dim A = \text{trdeg}(\text{Frac}(A)/k)$, and the polynomial ring $k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ has dimension n .

Proof. By definition A is integral over $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$, which is isomorphic to a polynomial ring so we may reduce to the case of polynomial ring by (3.23.22).

$\dim A \geq n$). This is clear by considering the chain of prime ideals

$$(X_1) \subsetneq (X_1, X_2) \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq (X_1, \dots, X_n)$$

$\dim A \leq n$). We may argue by the Strong Normalisation Lemma (3.32.12) and the subsequent remark that any chain of prime ideals must have length at most n , as any normalising family has order n .

Alternatively we may proceed by induction on n to show $\dim k[X_1, \dots, X_n] = n$. Consider a maximal chain

$$\mathfrak{q}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}_1 \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}_m$$

Clearly $\mathfrak{q}_0 = 0$, and $\mathfrak{q}_1 = (f)$ principal by (3.21.6). By (3.32.9) there is an integral, injective map

$$k[Y_1, \dots, Y_{n-1}] \hookrightarrow k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/(f)$$

whence $\dim(\mathfrak{q}_1) = \dim(k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/(f)) = \dim(k[Y_1, \dots, Y_{n-1}]) = n - 1$, and by definition $m - 1 \leq n - 1$. As the maximal chain was arbitrarily chosen, we have $\dim k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \leq n$. The reverse inequality was already shown so we are done.

The final statement follows from the existence of a normalising family (3.32.11) and (3.32.7)

□

Corollary 3.32.29

Let A be a finitely-generated k -algebra. Then $\dim A[T] = \dim A + 1$.

Proof. By (3.32.11) there is an injective integral ring homomorphism

$$\phi : k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \hookrightarrow A$$

where $\dim A = n$. By (3.9.5) there is a ring homomorphism

$$k[X_1, \dots, X_n][T] \hookrightarrow A[T]$$

which is injective. Further by assumption $A = k[y_1, \dots, y_r]$ so $A[T] = k[y_1, \dots, y_r, T]$ and by (3.23.4) the ring homomorphism is integral. This shows that $\phi(x_1), \dots, \phi(x_n), T$ is a normalising family and the result follows from (3.32.28). □

Corollary 3.32.30

The ideal $(X_1, \dots, X_r) \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ has dimension $n - r$.

Corollary 3.32.31

Let A be an integral finitely-generated k -algebra and $0 \neq f$ then $\dim A = \dim A_f$

The following proof is due to Tate, and presented in the Red Book [Mum99, I.7 Theorem 2].

Proposition 3.32.32 (Hypersurface has pure codimension 1)

Let A be an affine domain of dimension n and $0 \neq f \in A$. Then

$$\dim((f)) = n - 1$$

$$\text{ht}((f)) = 1$$

More precisely if $\mathfrak{p}$ is minimal over (f) then it has dimension $n - 1$ and height 1.

Proof. Consider the case $A = k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$. Suppose first that f is prime, then $\mathfrak{p} = (f)$ and by (3.32.9) there is an integral injective map

$$k[Y_1, \dots, Y_{n-1}] \hookrightarrow A/(f)$$

Therefore

$$\dim((f)) = \dim(A/(f)) \stackrel{(3.23.22)}{=} \dim(k[Y_1, \dots, Y_{n-1}]) \stackrel{(3.32.28)}{=} n - 1$$

When f is not prime then, as $k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ is a UFD, we have a prime factorisation

$$f = \prod_{i=1}^n f_i^{m_i}$$

and the minimal prime decomposition is

$$\sqrt{(f)} = (f_1) \cap \dots \cap (f_n)$$

In particular any prime minimal over (f) has the form $\mathfrak{p} = (f_i)$ for some i , and we may reduce to the case of f prime.

For an arbitrary k -algebra A we have a decomposition into minimal primes of (f)

$$\sqrt{(f)} = \mathfrak{p}_1 \cap \dots \cap \mathfrak{p}_n$$

and without loss of generality $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{p}_1$. We may localize to the case of a single prime, for choose $g \notin \mathfrak{p}$ and $g \in \mathfrak{p}_i$ for $i = 2 \dots n$. Consider the localization $A \rightarrow A_g$, then we claim that

$$\sqrt{(f/1)} = \mathfrak{p}A_g$$

For by (3.7.17) there is a correspondence between primes of A_g containing $(f/1)$ and primes of A containing f and not g , which are precisely the primes containing $\mathfrak{p}$ by (3.4.39) or (3.4.43). Therefore $\mathfrak{p}A_g$ is the only minimal prime of A_g containing $(f/1)$ and the claim follows from (3.4.46).

Note that $\dim A = \dim A_g$ as they have the same quotient field and therefore transcendence degree. Similarly $\dim(A/\mathfrak{p}) = \dim((A/\mathfrak{p})_{\bar{g}}) = \dim(A_g/\mathfrak{p}_g) = \dim(\mathfrak{p}A_g)$. So we may assume without loss of generality that $n = 1$ and $\mathfrak{p} = \sqrt{(f)}$.

By (3.32.11) there is an integral, injective map

$$\phi : B \hookrightarrow A$$

where $B = k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$, which induces an algebraic field extension

$$K := \text{Frac}(B) \hookrightarrow \text{Frac}(A) =: L$$

We claim that there exists $f_0 \in B$ such that

$$\phi^{-1}(\sqrt{f}) = \sqrt{(f_0)}$$

Observe that in this case $\sqrt{(f_0)}$ is prime and therefore the unique minimal prime over (f_0) . Therefore the result would follow from the first part and (3.23.23). Firstly for any $g \in A$ we have (3.23.18)

$$\text{Norm}_{L/K}(g) \in B \cap \phi^{-1}((g))$$

(because B is a UFD and therefore integrally closed (3.23.12)). Define $f_0 := \text{Norm}_{L/K}(f)$ then we see that $f_0 \in \phi^{-1}((f)) \implies \sqrt{(f_0)} \subseteq \phi^{-1}(\sqrt{(f)})$. Conversely if $\phi(g)^n = hf$ then $g^{n[L:K]} = \text{Norm}(\phi(g)^n) = \text{Norm}(h)f_0 \in (f_0) \implies g \in \sqrt{(f_0)}$. Therefore the reverse inclusion holds.

Finally by the codimension 1 formula (3.21.9) we have $\text{ht}((f)) = 1$. □

Remark 3.32.33

The argument is slightly less awkward in geometric language. Decompose into irreducibles

$$V(f) = Z_1 \cup \dots \cup Z_n$$

choose a principal open affine $D(g)$ which meets only Z_1 then $Z_1 \cap D(g) = V(f) \cap D(g) = V(f/1)$ is an irreducible component of $D(g)$. We argue that $\dim(X) = \dim(D(g))$ and $\dim(Z_1) = \dim(D(g) \cap Z_1)$. Further construct finite coverings

$$V(f/1) \rightarrow V(f_0) \rightarrow H$$

onto a hyperplane in $\mathbb{A}^n$.

This allows is to prove a converse to (3.21.9)

Corollary 3.32.34 (Height 1 formula)

Let A be an affine domain. Then for a prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$

$$\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = 1 \implies \dim(\mathfrak{p}) = \dim(A) - 1$$

More generally if A is an affine algebra and $\mathfrak{p}_1 \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_2$ is a saturated chain of prime ideals then

$$\dim(\mathfrak{p}_2) = \dim(\mathfrak{p}_1) - 1$$

Proof. Choose $0 \neq f \in \mathfrak{p}$ then it follows from the previous result (3.32.32). Alternatively by (3.32.11) there is an integral injective map

$$\phi : k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \hookrightarrow A$$

with $\mathfrak{q} := \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{p})$ and $n = \dim A$. Then by [Going Down](#) we have $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{q}) = 1$. By (3.21.6) $\mathfrak{q}$ is principal and by (3.32.9) there is an integral injective map

$$k[Y_1, \dots, Y_{n-1}] \hookrightarrow k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{q}$$

therefore $\dim(\mathfrak{q}) = n - 1$. By (3.23.23) this equals $\dim(\mathfrak{p})$ and we are done.

For the second statement we may consider the affine domain $A/\mathfrak{p}_1$ and observe that $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}_2/\mathfrak{p}_1) = 1$. Therefore

$$\dim(\mathfrak{p}_2) = \dim(\mathfrak{p}_2/\mathfrak{p}_1) = \dim(A/\mathfrak{p}_1) - 1 = \dim(\mathfrak{p}_1) - 1$$

□

Corollary 3.32.35 (Biequidimensionality)

Let A be an affine algebra. Then it is **quasi-biequidimensional** and satisfies the **codimension formulae** for $\mathfrak{p} \subset \mathfrak{a}$

$$\begin{aligned}\dim \mathfrak{a} &= \dim \mathfrak{p} + \text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}/\mathfrak{p}) \\ \text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) &= \text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}/\mathfrak{p}) + \text{ht}(\mathfrak{p})\end{aligned}$$

If in addition A is equidimensional (e.g. an integral domain) then it is **biequidimensional** and satisfies for all ideals $\mathfrak{a}$

$$\dim A = \dim \mathfrak{a} + \text{ht}(\mathfrak{a})$$

In particular for every prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ we have

$$\dim A = \dim A_{\mathfrak{p}} + \dim A/\mathfrak{p}$$

and for every maximal ideal

$$\dim A = \dim A_{\mathfrak{m}}$$

Proof. By (3.32.34) A satisfies the criteria in (3.21.11).e) and so is quasi-biequidimensional. The codimension formulas follow from (3.21.13). $\square$

We may also consider the following result

Proposition 3.32.36 (Generalized Hauptidealsatz for Affine Algebras)

Let A be an affine algebra and $\mathfrak{p}$ a prime ideal. Then

- a) If $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = n$ then it is minimal over some ideal $\mathfrak{a} := (x_1, \dots, x_n)$. Furthermore $\mathfrak{a}$ may be chosen such that $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{a}) = n$ and every minimal prime is of height n
- b) We have the following characterization of height of a prime ideal

$$\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) = \min\{n \mid \mathfrak{p} \text{ minimal over } (x_1, \dots, x_n)\}$$

In particular if $\mathfrak{p}$ is minimal over $(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ then $\text{ht}(\mathfrak{p}) \leq n$.

Furthermore the same result holds for localization of A at any prime ideal.

Proof. This is largely restatement of results in Section 3.26. By (3.32.32) we have $A/\mathfrak{p}$ is **hauptidealsatz** for every prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$. Furthermore by (3.32.35) A is quasi-biequidimensional and so catenary (3.21.11). Then by (3.26.4) this means A is a generalized hauptidealsatz ring (and so is every localization $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$).

Then a) and b) follows from (3.26.12). $\square$

Corollary 3.32.37

Let A be an affine algebra and $\mathfrak{p}$ a prime ideal. Denote the unique maximal ideal of $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ by $\mathfrak{m} := \mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Then

$$\dim A_{\mathfrak{p}} = \min\{n \mid \sqrt{(x_1, \dots, x_n)} = \mathfrak{m}\} \leq \dim_{k(\mathfrak{m})} \mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2$$

with equality iff $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a regular local ring.

Proof. By (3.32.36) $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a Noetherian local ring satisfying the generalized hauptidealsatz. Therefore the result follows by (3.27.2). $\square$

3.32.5.1 ** Biequidimensionality by Strong Normalisation **

We may prove more directly the biequidimensionality property by using the strong form of the Normalisation Lemma (3.32.12) and Going Down (3.23.19). First we prove a technical result

Lemma 3.32.38 (Saturated pairs)

Let $\phi : B \rightarrow A$ be an integral map and $\mathfrak{p}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_1$ prime ideals lying over $\mathfrak{q}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}_1$. Then

- a) $\mathfrak{q}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}_1$ saturated $\implies \mathfrak{p}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_1$ saturated.
- b) $B/\mathfrak{q}_0$ integrally closed and $\mathfrak{p}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_1$ saturated $\implies \mathfrak{q}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}_1$ saturated

We may relax the condition in b) to the existence of another integral map $\psi : C \rightarrow B$ such that $C/\psi^{-1}(\mathfrak{q}_0)$ is integrally closed.

Proof. The first follows by incomparability (3.23.17). The second follows by applying Going Down (3.23.19) to the integral map $B/\mathfrak{q}_0 \hookrightarrow A/\mathfrak{p}_0$. More precisely if $\mathfrak{q}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{q} \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}_1$ then $(0) \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}/\mathfrak{q}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}_1/\mathfrak{q}_0$ whence there exists $\mathfrak{p}$ such that $(0) \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{p}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_1/\mathfrak{p}_0$. This means $\mathfrak{p}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{p} \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_1$, a contradiction.

The final statement can be demonstrated by applying $b)$ to $C \rightarrow A$ and then $a)$ to $B \rightarrow A$. $\square$

Proposition 3.32.39

Let A be an affine domain, then every maximal chain has order $n = \dim A$, i.e. A is **irreducible** and **biequidimensional**.

Proof of (3.32.39). Consider a maximal chain $\mathfrak{p}_0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_1 \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_m$. Clearly $\mathfrak{p}_m$ is maximal by (3.4.36), and as A is integral $\mathfrak{p}_0 = 0$. Apply (3.32.12) to find an integral, injective map

$$\phi : k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \hookrightarrow A$$

such that

$$\mathfrak{q}_i := \phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{p}_i) = (X_1, \dots, X_{h(i)}) \quad 0 \leq i \leq m$$

Note $n = \dim A$ by (3.32.28). Clearly $h(0) = 0$ and by (3.23.16) $\mathfrak{q}_m$ is maximal so $h(m) = n$. Observe that

$$k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{q}_i \xrightarrow{\sim} k[X_{h(i)+1}, \dots, X_n]$$

is integrally closed for all i (3.23.12). Therefore we may apply (3.32.38) to ϕ and each pair $\mathfrak{p}_i \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_{i+1}$, to see that each chain $\mathfrak{q}_i \subsetneq \mathfrak{q}_{i+1}$ is saturated. This can only happen if $h(j) = j$ and therefore $m = n$. $\square$

3.32.6 Derivations of Affine Algebras

The notion of derivations is as useful as a coordinate-free construction of the “tangent space” for both differentiable manifolds and algebraic varieties. We review the theory of derivations here primarily focusing on fields and f.g. k -algebras.

Proposition 3.32.40 (Derivations of Polynomial Algebra)

Let $A = k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ be a polynomial algebra and M an (A, B) -bimodule. Then we have an (A, B) -bimodule isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{Der}_k(A, M) &\cong M^n \\ D &\rightarrow (D(X_1), \dots, D(X_n)) \\ \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{\partial}{\partial X_i} \cdot v_i &\leftarrow v \end{aligned}$$

When M has a B -basis $\{m_1, \dots, m_r\}$ then $\mathrm{Der}_k(A, M)$ also has a B -basis

$$\left\{ \frac{\partial}{\partial X_i} \cdot m_j \right\}_{i=1 \dots n, j=1 \dots r}$$

In particular $\dim_K \mathrm{Der}_k(A, K) = n$.

Proof. The first map is clearly well-defined and by (...) injective. The inverse map is well-defined because we have shown $\frac{\partial}{\partial X_i} \in \mathrm{Der}_k(A, A)$. The chain rule (3.25.8) shows that the maps are mutually inverse (the other direction following simply from orthogonality of the partial derivatives).

The final statement is straightforward. $\square$

We may generalise this as follows, so that we may interpret derivations as tangent vectors

Proposition 3.32.41 (Derivations = Tangent Vectors)

Let $A = k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}$ be a f.g. k -algebra and M an A -module. Then we have an A -module isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{Der}_k(A, M) &\cong \left\{ v \in M^n \mid \sum_{i=1}^n \overline{\frac{\partial F}{\partial X_i}} v_i = 0 \quad \forall F \in \mathfrak{a} \right\} \subset M^n \\
D &\longrightarrow (D(\overline{X}_1), \dots, D(\overline{X}_n)) \\
\sum_{i=1}^n \overline{\frac{\partial}{\partial X_i}} \cdot v_i &\longleftarrow v
\end{aligned}$$

If $\mathfrak{a} = \langle F_1, \dots, F_m \rangle$ then this is equal to the kernel of the A -module homomorphism

$$\begin{pmatrix} \overline{\frac{\partial F_1}{\partial X_1}} & \cdots & \overline{\frac{\partial F_1}{\partial X_n}} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \overline{\frac{\partial F_m}{\partial X_1}} & \cdots & \overline{\frac{\partial F_m}{\partial X_n}} \end{pmatrix} : M^n \rightarrow M^m$$

When M is an (A, B) -bimodule then this is also an (A, B) -bimodule isomorphism.

Proof. According to (3.25.8) we have the following relationship for all $F \in k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$

$$D(\overline{F}) = D(F(\overline{X}_1, \dots, \overline{X}_n)) = \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{\partial F}{\partial X_i}(\overline{X}_i) D(\overline{X}_i) = \sum_{i=1}^n \overline{\frac{\partial F}{\partial X_i}} D(\overline{X}_i)$$

When $F \in \mathfrak{a}$ we have $\overline{F} = 0 \implies D(\overline{F}) = 0$, whence the first map is well-defined. Similarly for $v \in RHS$ we see by definition that

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \overline{\frac{\partial}{\partial X_i}} \cdot v_i$$

is zero on $\mathfrak{a}$, so determines a well-defined derivation on A . In the same way we see that the maps are mutually inverse.

Suppose v is in the kernel of the given matrix. For any $G \in \mathfrak{a}$ we have by hypothesis $G = \sum_{j=1}^m F_j H_j$ for some $H_j \in k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
\sum_{i=1}^n \overline{\frac{\partial G}{\partial X_i}} v_i &= \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^m \left(\overline{F_j} \overline{\frac{\partial H_j}{\partial X_i}} + H_j \overline{\frac{\partial F_j}{\partial X_i}} \right) v_i \\
&= \sum_{j=1}^m \sum_{i=1}^n \overline{\frac{\partial F_j}{\partial X_i}} v_i \\
&= 0
\end{aligned}$$

where we have used the fact that $\overline{F_j} = 0$. As G was arbitrary this shows v is in the right-hand side of the isomorphism, and the reverse inclusion is immediate as $F_j \in \mathfrak{a}$. $\square$

Proposition 3.32.42 (Lifting for separable algebraic extensions)

Let L/K be a separable algebraic (resp. separably generated) extension (over k) and V an L -module. Then there is an isomorphism (resp. epimorphism) of L -modules

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{Der}_k(L, V) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Der}_k(K, V) \\
D &\rightarrow D|_K
\end{aligned}$$

Proof. Consider $L[V]$ the k -algebra with ideal $N := 0 \times V$ such that $N^2 = 0$ and $L[V]/N \cong L$. Furthermore a derivation $D : K \rightarrow V$ corresponds to a unique k -algebra homomorphism $\phi_D : K \rightarrow K[V] \hookrightarrow L[V]$ by (3.25.5) so we have the following commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
K & \xrightarrow{\phi_D} & L[V] \\
\downarrow & \nearrow & \downarrow \pi_1 \\
L & \xlongequal{\quad} & L
\end{array}$$

In the algebraic case by (3.25.15) there is a unique homomorphism $\phi_{\tilde{D}} : L \rightarrow L[V]$ completing the diagram, and in particular by (3.25.5) there is a derivation $\tilde{D} : L \rightarrow V$ extending D . Uniqueness follows from that of $\phi_{\tilde{D}}$.

The separably generated case is similar, except without uniqueness. $\square$

Corollary 3.32.43

Let K/k be a separably generated extension, A a K -algebra and M an A -module then

$$\mathrm{Der}_k(A, M) = \mathrm{Der}_K(A, M)$$

Proof. Recall (3.25.1) that a derivation D is K -linear iff it vanishes on K . So we may reduce to the case $A = K$ by considering the restriction $D|_K$.

Therefore it's sufficient to show that $\mathrm{Der}_k(K, M) = \mathrm{Der}_K(K, M) = 0 = \mathrm{Der}_k(k, M)$, but this follows immediately from (3.32.42). $\square$

Proposition 3.32.44

Suppose K/k is **separably generated** (e.g. if k is perfect and K finitely generated) then we have equality

$$\mathrm{trdeg}_k(K) = \dim_K \mathrm{Der}_k(K)$$

Proof. By hypothesis we have a transcendence basis $\eta_1, \dots, \eta_n$ such that $n = \mathrm{trdeg}_k(K)$ and $K/k(\eta_1, \dots, \eta_n)$ is algebraic and separable.

Therefore we have

$$\mathrm{Der}_k(K) \stackrel{(3.32.42)}{\cong} \mathrm{Der}_k(k(\eta_1, \dots, \eta_n), K) \stackrel{(3.25.9)}{\cong} \mathrm{Der}_k(k[\eta_1, \dots, \eta_n], K)$$

which then has dimension n by (3.32.40). $\square$

Lemma 3.32.45

Let A be a k -algebra and $\mathfrak{m}$ an ideal. Then $\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2$ is a $k(\mathfrak{m})$ -module with action given by

$$(a + \mathfrak{m}) \cdot (b + \mathfrak{m}^2) = (ab + \mathfrak{m}^2)$$

for all $a \in A$ and $b \in \mathfrak{m}$.

Proof. Suppose $a - a' \in \mathfrak{m}$ and $b - b' \in \mathfrak{m}^2$ then

$$ab - a'b' = (a - a')(b - b') + a'(b - b') + b'(a - a') \in \mathfrak{m}^2$$

this shows that the action is well-defined. The properties of a module are straightforward. $\square$

Lemma 3.32.46

Let A be a k -algebra and $\mathfrak{m}$ a maximal ideal. Then there is an isomorphism of A -algebras

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
A & \xrightarrow{\quad} & A/\mathfrak{m}^2 \\
\downarrow \pi_1 & \searrow \pi_2 & \downarrow \\
k(\mathfrak{m}) & \xrightarrow[\sim]{\psi} & k(\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2)
\end{array}$$

Further there is an isomorphism of A -modules

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathrm{Der}_k(A/\mathfrak{m}^2, k(\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2)) & \rightarrow & \mathrm{Der}_k(A, k(\mathfrak{m})) \\
D & \rightarrow & x \rightarrow \psi^{-1}(D(\bar{x}))
\end{array}$$

Proof. The first statement follows from (3.4.58) with $\mathfrak{a} = \mathfrak{m}^2$ and $\mathfrak{b} = \mathfrak{m}$.

Define $\widehat{D}(x) := \psi^{-1}(D(\overline{x}))$. By hypothesis $D(\overline{xy}) = \pi_2(x)D(\overline{y}) + \pi_2(y)D(\overline{x})$. Therefore

$$\widehat{D}(xy) = \pi_1(x)\psi^{-1}(D(\overline{y})) + \pi_1(y)\psi^{-1}(D(\overline{x})) = \pi_1(x)\widehat{D}(\overline{y}) + \pi_1(y)\widehat{D}(\overline{x})$$

and so $\widehat{D}$ is a well-defined derivation. Suppose $\widehat{D} \in \text{Der}_k(A, k(\mathfrak{m}))$ then by the product rule $\mathfrak{m}^2 \subset \ker(\widehat{D})$ so there is a derivation $D' : A/\mathfrak{m}^2 \rightarrow k(\mathfrak{m})$ such that $D'(\overline{x}) = \widehat{D}(x)$. Define $D := \psi \circ D'$, then evidently the image of this derivation is $\widehat{D}$ and so the map is surjective.

Suppose $\widehat{D} = 0$ then as ψ is an isomorphism $D \circ \overline{\cdot} = 0$. As the reduction map is surjective we deduce that $D = 0$. Therefore the map is injective, bijective and an isomorphism. $\square$

Lemma 3.32.47

Let A be a k -algebra and $\mathfrak{m}$ an ideal. Then there is an isomorphism of A -modules

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}_{k(\mathfrak{m})}(\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2, k(\mathfrak{m})) &\rightarrow \text{Hom}_{k(\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2)}((\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2)/(\mathfrak{m}^2/\mathfrak{m}^2), k(\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2)) \\ \theta &\rightarrow \psi \circ \theta \circ i^{-1} \end{aligned}$$

where $i : \mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2 \rightarrow (\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2)/(\mathfrak{m}^2/\mathfrak{m}^2)$ is a ring isomorphism such that

$$i(\pi_1(a) \cdot x) = \pi_2(a) \cdot i(x)$$

Proof. Then for $x \in (\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2)/(\mathfrak{m}^2/\mathfrak{m}^2)$, $a \in A$ and $\theta \in \text{Hom}_{k(\mathfrak{m})}(\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2, k(\mathfrak{m}))$

$$\begin{aligned} (\psi \circ \theta \circ i^{-1})(\pi_2(a) \cdot x) &= (\psi \circ \theta)(\pi_1(a) \cdot i^{-1}(x)) \\ &= \psi(\pi_1(a)\theta(i^{-1}(x))) \\ &= \pi_2(a)(\psi \circ \theta \circ i^{-1})(x) \end{aligned}$$

so that the map is well-defined. Similarly if $\theta' \in \text{Hom}_{k(\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2)}((\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2)/(\mathfrak{m}^2/\mathfrak{m}^2), k(\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2))$

$$\begin{aligned} (\psi^{-1} \circ \theta' \circ i)(\pi_1(a) \cdot x) &= (\psi^{-1} \circ \theta')(\pi_2(a) \cdot i(x)) \\ &= \psi^{-1}(\pi_2(a)\theta'(i(x))) \\ &= \pi_1(a)(\psi^{-1} \circ \theta' \circ i)(x) \end{aligned}$$

so the inverse map is well-defined. $\square$

Proposition 3.32.48 (Tangent space is dual to Cotangent space)

Let A be a k -algebra and $\mathfrak{m} \triangleleft A$ a maximal ideal with residue field $k(\mathfrak{m}) := A/\mathfrak{m}$. There is a homomorphism of $k(\mathfrak{m})$ -modules

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Der}_k(A, k(\mathfrak{m})) &\longrightarrow \text{Hom}_{k(\mathfrak{m})}(\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2, k(\mathfrak{m})) \\ D &\longrightarrow \theta_D : \overline{x} \rightarrow D(x) \end{aligned}$$

When $k(\mathfrak{m})/k$ is separably generated then this is an isomorphism. In particular this holds when k is perfect and $k(\mathfrak{m})/k$ is finitely generated.

Proof. The map θ_D is well-defined because D annihilates $\mathfrak{m}^2$ by the product rule. It remains to show the map is bijective when $k(\mathfrak{m})/k$ is separably generated.

We first claim we can reduce to the case $\mathfrak{m}^2 = 0$. For consider $A' := A/\mathfrak{m}^2$ and $\mathfrak{m}' = \mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2$ and the commutative diagram of A -module homomorphisms

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Der}_k(A', k(\mathfrak{m}')) & \longrightarrow & \text{Hom}_{k(\mathfrak{m}')}(\mathfrak{m}'/\mathfrak{m}'^2, k(\mathfrak{m}')) \\ \wr \downarrow & & \wr \downarrow \\ \text{Der}_k(A, k(\mathfrak{m})) & \longrightarrow & \text{Hom}_{k(\mathfrak{m})}(\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2, k(\mathfrak{m})) \end{array}$$

The horizontal maps have already been defined and the vertical maps are defined in (3.32.46) and (3.32.47). The diagram evidently commutes, so therefore it is sufficient to show that the top map is an isomorphism.

We revert to the original notation, but with the additional assumption that $\mathfrak{m}^2 = 0$. By (3.25.16) there is a map $j : k(\mathfrak{m}) \rightarrow A$ such that $\pi \circ j$ is the identity, where $\pi : A \rightarrow A/\mathfrak{m} = k(\mathfrak{m})$ is the canonical projection. In other words

there is a subfield $k \subseteq \hat{k} \subseteq A$ such that $\hat{k} \cong k(\mathfrak{m})$ under π . As j is a section of π we have a direct sum of k -vector spaces

$$A = \text{Im}(j) \oplus \ker(\pi) = \hat{k} \oplus \mathfrak{m}$$

Given $\theta \in \text{Hom}_{k(\mathfrak{m})}(\mathfrak{m}, k(\mathfrak{m}))$ define

$$D_\theta(\lambda + x) := \theta(x) \quad \lambda \in \hat{k}, x \in \mathfrak{m}$$

It satisfies the product rule for

$$\begin{aligned} D_\theta((\lambda + x)(\lambda' + x')) &= \theta(\lambda'x + \lambda x') \\ &= \pi(\lambda')\theta(x) + \pi(\lambda)\theta(x') \\ &= \pi(\lambda' + x')\theta(x) + \pi(\lambda + x)\theta(x') \\ (\lambda' + x') \cdot D_\theta(\lambda + x) + (\lambda + x) \cdot D_\theta(\lambda' + x') \end{aligned}$$

Therefore the given map is surjective.

As $k(\mathfrak{m})/k$ is separably generated then by (3.32.43) any derivation D is $\hat{k}$ -linear. Therefore

$$D(\lambda + x) = D|_{\mathfrak{m}}(x) \quad \lambda \in \hat{k}, x \in \mathfrak{m}$$

which shows that the given map is injective. □

Remark 3.32.49

The proof is substantially simpler when $k(\mathfrak{m}) = k$, for example when k is algebraically closed.

The argument follows the suggestion of [Har13, Ex 8.1], but using the simpler result [Mat70, Prop 28.I] to argue more directly.

3.32.7 Linearly Disjoint Algebras

Definition 3.32.50

Let $A/k, B/k$ be k -algebras and homomorphisms $i : A/k \rightarrow \Omega/k, j : B/k \rightarrow \Omega/k$ (typically being inclusion). Then we say that A and B are **linearly disjoint in Ω** if the canonical map

$$\begin{aligned} A \otimes_k B &\rightarrow \Omega \\ a \otimes b &\rightarrow i(a)j(b) \end{aligned}$$

is injective. As the canonical maps $A, B \rightarrow A \otimes_k B$ are injective by (3.5.41) this implies i, j must be injective. In the case that Ω is integral (resp. reduced) then A, B are also necessarily integral (resp. reduced).

Recall that every k -module is free (3.4.126), moreover by (3.5.23) a basis of $A \otimes_k B$ may be formed by tensor product of bases for A and B .

Example 3.32.51

Let K/k be a non-trivial field extension then K is not linearly disjoint with itself. For $1, x$ a linearly independent subset of K and may be extended to a basis. Given the remark on the basis of the tensor product we see $1 \otimes x \neq x \otimes 1$. On the other hand the image of $1 \otimes x - x \otimes 1$ in Ω is clearly 0. The same consideration shows that $A \cap B = k$.

Remark 3.32.52

The notion of linear disjointness in general depends on the embeddings in Ω/k . For example $k(t)$ and $k(s)$ are linearly disjoint in $k(s, t)$, but not when both are identified with $k(x)$.

Proposition 3.32.53

Let $i : A/k \rightarrow \Omega/k$ and $j : B/k \rightarrow \Omega/k$ be algebra homomorphisms. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A/k and B/k are linearly disjoint in Ω/k
- b) If $S \subset A$ is linearly independent over k then $i(S)$ is linearly independent over B
- b') If $T \subset B$ is linearly independent over k then $j(T)$ is linearly independent over A
- c) There is a k -basis $\{a_\lambda\}_{\lambda \in \Lambda}$ of A for which $\{i(a_\lambda)\}_{\lambda \in \Lambda}$ is linearly independent over B
- c') There is a k -basis $\{b_\lambda\}_{\lambda \in \Lambda}$ of B for which $\{j(b_\lambda)\}_{\lambda \in \Lambda}$ is linearly independent over A

Proof. $a) \implies b)$ By (3.5.30) and (3.5.31) there is an injective map

$$\begin{aligned} B^{(S)} &\hookrightarrow A \otimes_k B \\ (b_s)_{s \in S} &\rightarrow \sum_{s \in S} s \otimes b_s \end{aligned}$$

By hypothesis the composite with $A \otimes_k B \hookrightarrow \Omega$ is injective which is precisely the required conclusion.

$b) \implies c)$ By (3.4.126) there exists a basis which by hypothesis is linearly independent over B

$c) \implies a)$ By (3.5.23) there is an isomorphism

$$B^{(\Lambda)} \cong A \otimes_k B$$

and the canonical map into Ω is identified with $(b_\lambda)_{\lambda \in \Lambda} \rightarrow \sum i(a_\lambda)j(b_\lambda)$. The hypothesis means precisely that this map is injective.

We immediately have the symmetric result $a) \iff b') \iff c')$. □

In cases where both algebras are fields and one is algebraic then linear disjointness can be characterized by a property of the tensor product. In particular it does not depend on the *ambient algebra* Ω/k .

Lemma 3.32.54

Let A be a finite-dimensional k -algebra with no zero-divisors. Then A is a field.

Proof. By assumption multiplication by a non-zero element x is injective and k -linear. Therefore by (3.4.137) it is surjective and x has an inverse as required. □

Proposition 3.32.55

Let K/k be a field extension and k'/k an algebraic field extension. Then the following are equivalent

- a) K and k' are linearly disjoint with respect to every embedding into an algebra Ω/k
- b) K and k' are linearly disjoint with respect to some common field extension Ω/k
- c) $K \otimes_k k'$ is an integral domain
- d) $K \otimes_k k'$ is a field

Proof. $a) \implies b)$ We may take $\Omega := (K \otimes_k k')/\mathfrak{m}$.

$b) \implies c)$ As Ω is assumed to be a field it is certainly integral, and therefore so is $K \otimes_k k'$ being a subring.

$c) \implies d)$ As every element of the tensor product is a finite linear combination of elementary tensors we may reduce to the case k' is finitely generated. Then by (3.18.57) k' is finite over k and therefore by (3.5.23) $K \otimes_k k'$ is finite over K . By (3.32.54) it is a field.

$d) \implies a)$ This is immediate because the kernel is an ideal which must be (0) . □

3.32.8 Finiteness of Integral Closure

Remark 3.32.56

In what follows we are interested in the integral closure of affine domains in finite extensions of the quotient field. Similar results are obtained for Dedekind Domains (3.31.9) with the restriction that the field extension is separable. Although this holds over number fields where the characteristic is zero, this will not in general be the case for varieties over finite fields, as for example $\mathbb{F}_p(t)$ admits the inseparable extension $\mathbb{F}_p(t^{1/p})$. However the finiteness still holds, because it's easy to see that the integral closure of $\mathbb{F}_p[t]$ is simply $\mathbb{F}_p[t^{1/p}]$. This generalises because every purely inseparable extension is contained in an extension obtained by adjoining p -th roots of unity.

Proposition 3.32.57 (Normalisation over Finite Fields)

Let k be a (possibly) finite field and $A = k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ by a finitely-generated k -algebra. Then there exists a normalising family $z_1, \dots, z_d \in A$ such that $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ is integral over $k[z_1, \dots, z_d]$.

Proof. TODO □

Proposition 3.32.58 (Affine Domain are Japanese Rings)

Let A be an affine domain over k with $K = \text{Frac}(A)$ and L/K a finite extension. Then $\overline{A}^L$ is a finite A -module and Noetherian with quotient field L .

Furthermore $\dim \overline{A}^L = \dim A$.

Proof. Suppose $A = k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$, apply the normalisation lemma (3.32.57) to obtain a lattice of subrings

$$\begin{array}{c} L \\ | \\ K \\ | \\ A \\ | \\ A' := k[z_1, \dots, z_d] \end{array}$$

where $z_1, \dots, z_d$ are algebraically independent over k . We claim it is enough to show that the $\overline{A'}^L$ is a finite A' -module. For A is finite and integral over A' . Therefore by (3.23.28)

$$\overline{A}^L = \overline{A'}^L$$

is finite over A' , and a-fortiori over A .

Therefore without loss of generality we may assume that $x_1, \dots, x_n$ are algebraically independent over k and A is integrally closed (3.23.12).

By (3.18.85) we may find a finite extension L'/L such that L'/K is normal. So by (3.23.29) we may assume without loss of generality that L/K is normal.

By (...) we may decompose this into a tower $M/L/K$ such that M/L is Galois and L/K is purely inseparable.

We first show that the integral closure of A in L is a finite A -module. When $L = K$ this is trivial because A is already integrally closed in its quotient field K . Therefore we may assume $L \neq K$ and the characteristic p is non-zero (3.18.115). $L = K(y_1, \dots, y_n)$ is finitely generated and by definition $y_i^q \in K$ for some p -th power q . Therefore L is contained in $L' := k(x_1^{1/q}, \dots, x_n^{1/q})$ which is again a finite purely inseparable extension of K . The elements $x_1^{1/q}, \dots, x_n^{1/q}$ are again algebraically independent so that the ring $A' := k[x_1^{1/q}, \dots, x_n^{1/q}]$ is integrally closed (3.23.12) with quotient field L' . Evidently A' is finite and integral over A (3.23.4) therefore (3.23.28) $\overline{A}^{L'} = \overline{A'}^{L'} = A'$ is finite over A . By (3.23.29) then $\overline{A}^L$ is finite over A and $\overline{A}^L$ has quotient field L (3.23.24). As A is Noetherian then so is $\overline{A}^L$.

By transitivity we may then reduce to the case L/K is separable which was proven in (3.23.26). □

Corollary 3.32.59

Let A be an affine domain of Krull dimension 1, with quotient field K and L/K a finite extension. Then the integral closure $\overline{A}^L$ is a finite A -module and a Dedekind domain.

3.33 Algebraic Function Fields

We develop the theory of “function fields”, closely related to the notion of complete (or projective) regular algebraic curves (...). Principal references are

- Introduction to the Theory of Algebraic Functions of One Variable [Che51]
- Algebraic Function Fields and Codes [Sti09]

However we use the theory of Dedekind domains and affine algebras to simplify the proof of some technical results.

Proposition 3.33.1

Let K/k be a field extension. Then the following are equivalent

- K/k is finitely generated with transcendence degree 1.
- There exists a transcendental element $x \in K/k$ such that $K/k(x)$ is finite.

In this case we say that K/k is an **algebraic function field**. We typically assume that k is perfect (either a number field or a finite field).

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) By (3.18.150) a transcendence base consists of a single element x . By assumption $K/k(x)$ is algebraic and finitely generated, hence also finite (3.18.57).

b) $\implies$ a) Evidently $\{x\}$ is a transcendence base. By assumption $K/k(x)$ is finite and therefore certainly finitely generated, whence so is K/k . $\square$

Definition 3.33.2 (Algebraic Function Field)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field. Denote by $\tilde{k}$ the **field of constants**

$$\tilde{k} := \bar{k} \cap K = \{x \in K \mid x \text{ algebraic over } k\}$$

By (...) $K/\tilde{k}$ is relatively algebraically closed. We say that K/k is **geometrically integral** if $k = \tilde{k}$ (c.f. (3.35.38)).

Definition 3.33.3 (Place of an Algebraic Function Field)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field. By a **place** of K/k we refer to a valuation ring $\mathcal{O}_P$ such that $k \subsetneq \mathcal{O}_P \subsetneq K$. By (3.24.2) this is a local ring with unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}_P$.

From (3.4.13) we verify immediately that $k \cap \mathfrak{m}_P = (0)$.

For every $x \in K$ we say that x is regular at a place P if $x \in \mathcal{O}_P$.

Proposition 3.33.4

Let K/k be a function field and $k \subsetneq \mathcal{O}_P \subsetneq K$ a valuation ring. Then $\tilde{k} \subset \mathcal{O}_P$ and $\tilde{k} \cap \mathfrak{m}_P = (0)$

Proof. By definition $\tilde{k}$ is the integral closure of k in K , so $\tilde{k} \subset \mathcal{O}_P$ by (3.24.11). Suppose $0 \neq x \in \tilde{k}$ then x is invertible in $\mathcal{O}_P$ and therefore x is not contained in any proper ideal, and in particular $x \notin \mathfrak{m}_P$. $\square$

In order to use the theory of Dedekind domains and affine algebras we establish a connection between valuation rings and a certain “affine” subring.

Proposition 3.33.5

Let K/k be an algebraic function field and $f \in K \setminus \tilde{k}$ transcendental. Then the integral closure $\overline{k[f]}$ in K is a Dedekind domain with quotient field K and a finite $k[f]$ -module. There is a correspondence

$$\begin{aligned} \{\mathfrak{B} \triangleleft \overline{k[f]}\} &\longleftrightarrow \{\mathcal{O}_P \subsetneq K \mid f \in \mathcal{O}_P\} \\ \mathfrak{B} &\longrightarrow \overline{k[f]}_{\mathfrak{B}} \\ \mathfrak{m}_P \cap \overline{k[f]} &\longleftarrow \mathcal{O}_P \end{aligned}$$

In particular every $\mathcal{O}_P$ is a discrete valuation ring, and the residue degree satisfies

$$[k(\mathfrak{m}_P) : k] = [k(\mathfrak{B}) : k] \leq [K : k(f)]$$

Therefore we may associate to each place P a discrete valuation

$$v_P : K \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z} \cup \{\infty\}$$

which is zero on k and $v_P(f) = \infty \iff f \notin \mathcal{O}_P \iff f^{-1} \in \mathfrak{m}_P$.

Proof. By (3.31.2) $k[f] \subset K$ is a Dedekind domain and so by (3.32.59) $B := \overline{k[f]}^K$ is a Dedekind domain and finite $k[f]$ -module. As $\mathcal{O}_P$ is a valuation ring, it is integrally closed (3.24.2) and as it contains $k[f]$, also contains B . Then we may deduce this correspondence from (3.31.3) and the inequality from (3.31.15). $\square$

Corollary 3.33.6

Let K/k be an algebraic function field. Then the field of constants $\bar{k}/k$ has finite degree.

Proof. For any place P we have an embedding $\bar{k}/k \hookrightarrow k(\mathfrak{m}_P)/k$ which is finite (3.33.5). $\square$

We prove a number of facts in analogy with algebraic curves.

Lemma 3.33.7 (Every function has a zero)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field and $0 \neq f \in K$ transcendental. Then f has between 1 and $[K : k(f)]$ zeros (resp. poles).

Proof. Clearly $k[f]$ is a polynomial ring with maximal ideal (f) . Therefore by (3.24.9) there is a valuation ring $\mathcal{O}_P \supset k[f]$ such that $\mathfrak{m}_P \cap k[f] = (f)$, which means f has at least one zero.

Recall by (3.33.5) that zeros of f correspond to the maximal ideals of $\overline{k[f]}$ containing f . These are precisely the prime divisors of (f) (see (3.31.11)), so the bound follows from (3.31.16).

The statement about poles of f follows immediately because these are precisely zeros of f^{-1} and $k(f) = k(f^{-1})$. $\square$

Proposition 3.33.8

Let K/k be an algebraic function field generated by a single element x . Then every valuation ring $k \subsetneq \mathcal{O} \subsetneq K$ is of the form

- a) $\mathcal{O}_{p(x)} := k[x]_{p(x)}$ where $p \in k[X]$ is an irreducible monic polynomial, or
- b) $\mathcal{O}_\infty := \left\{ \frac{f(x)}{g(x)} \mid \deg f \leq \deg g \right\}$

and in particular is a discrete valuation ring.

Proof. It is clear that both $\mathcal{O}_{p(x)}$ and $\mathcal{O}_\infty$ are valuation rings.

Let $\mathcal{O}$ be a valuation ring with maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$. Suppose firstly that $x \in \mathcal{O}$. Then $k[x] \subset \mathcal{O}$ and the ideal $k[x] \cap \mathfrak{m} =: (p(x))$ is principal. There is an injective k -algebra homomorphism $k[x]/(p(x)) \hookrightarrow k(\mathfrak{m})$ whence $(p(x))$ is prime (3.4.59). As $k(\mathfrak{m})/k$ is algebraic (3.33.5) we must have $0 \neq p$ and therefore p is irreducible (3.16.11). Suppose $g(x) \notin (p(x))$ then $g(x) \notin \mathfrak{m} \implies g(x)^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}$ (3.24.2). Therefore $\mathcal{O}_{p(x)} \subset \mathcal{O}$. As valuation rings are maximal local rings (3.24.10) we conclude that they are equal.

Alternatively suppose that $x \notin \mathcal{O}$ then by (3.24.2) $t := x^{-1} \in \mathfrak{m} \subset \mathcal{O}$. Therefore by the previous part $\mathcal{O} = \mathcal{O}_{p(t)}$ for some irreducible monic polynomial $p \in k[X]$ determined by the relation $\mathfrak{m} \cap k[t] = (p(t))$. As $t \in \mathfrak{m}$ we conclude that $p(t) = t$. Finally we may verify that $\mathcal{O}_t = \mathcal{O}_\infty$.

Recall that for x transcendental then $k[x]$ is isomorphic to the polynomial ring $k[X]$, which is a principal ideal domain (3.15.4). Therefore by (3.30.3) $\mathcal{O}_{p(x)}$ and $\mathcal{O}_\infty$ are discrete valuation rings. $\square$

3.33.1 Riemann-Roch Theorem

In what follows we generally assume that $\bar{k} = k$ (i.e. K is geometrically integral).

Definition 3.33.9 (Divisors)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field. Denote by $\text{Div}(K)$ the free abelian group generated by the places of K/k (**divisor group**). The elements are written as a formal sum

$$D = \sum_P n_P P$$

with all but finitely many coefficients $n_P = 0$. Define the **degree** homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Div}(K) &\longrightarrow \mathbb{Z} \\ \sum_P n_P P &\longrightarrow \sum_P n_P \cdot [k(\mathfrak{m}_P) : k] \end{aligned}$$

We may also define $v_P(D) := n_P$. Finally we may define a partial order

$$D \leq D' \iff v_P(D) \leq v_P(D') \quad \forall P$$

Definition 3.33.10 (Riemann-Roch Space)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field and D a divisor. Define the **Riemann-Roch Space** associated to D by

$$L(D) := \{x \in K^\star \mid (x) \geq -D\} \cup \{0\}$$

and define

$$\ell(D) := \dim_k L(D)$$

(we shortly show it is a k -vector subspace of K)

Definition 3.33.11 (Principal Divisors)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field and $x \in K^\star$. Then define the **zero divisor** (resp. **pole divisor**, **principal divisor**) of x as follows

$$\begin{aligned} (x)_0 &:= \sum_{P: v_P(x) > 0} v_P(x)P, \\ (x)_\infty &:= \sum_{P: v_P(x) < 0} (-v_P(x))P, \\ (x) &:= (x)_0 - (x)_\infty = \sum_P v_P(x)P. \end{aligned}$$

which is well-defined by (3.33.7).

Observe similarly $x \in k^\star \iff (x) = 0$. Define the subgroup of principal divisors by

$$\text{Princ}(K) := \{(x) \mid x \in K^\star\}$$

and the quotient group $\text{Cl}(K) := \text{Div}(K)/\text{Princ}(K)$ is called the **divisor class group**. We say two divisors D and D' are **linearly equivalent** if there exists $x \in K^\star$ such that $D - D' = (x)$, equivalently if they become equal in the divisor class group. This is written $D \sim D'$.

We presently prove that these concepts are well-defined, namely every function $x \in K^\star$ has only finitely many zeros. More precisely we can show

Proposition 3.33.12 (Principal Divisors have degree zero)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field and $x \in K \setminus \tilde{k}$ transcendental. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \deg((x)_0) = \deg((x)_\infty) &= [K : k(x)] \\ \deg((x)) &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

In particular there is a well-defined homomorphism

$$\deg : \text{Cl}(K) \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}$$

Proof. Recall (3.33.5) $k[x]$ is a Dedekind domain and $\overline{k[x]}$ is a finite $k[x]$ -module, and every place $\mathcal{O}_P$ containing x corresponds to prime ideal $\mathfrak{B}$ of $\overline{k[x]}$. By (3.31.15) then $v_P(x)$ is equal to the ramification index $e_{\mathfrak{B}/(x)}$, and the inertial degree is $f_{\mathfrak{B}/(x)} = [k(\mathfrak{m}_P) : k]$. Therefore $\deg((x)_0) = [K : k(x)]$ by (3.31.16).

The rest follows easily because $k(x) = k(x^{-1})$ and $(x)_\infty = (x^{-1})_0$. $\square$

Proposition 3.33.13

Let K/k be an algebraic function field and D a divisor. Then

- a) $L(D)$ is a k -vector subspace of K
- b) If $D \sim D'$ then $L(D) = L(D')$
- c) $L(0) = \tilde{k}$ so under our standing assumption $\ell(0) = 1$.
- d) If $D < 0$ then $L(D) = \{0\}$

Proof. a) Given $x, y \in L(D)$ then by the strict triangle inequality for valuations $v_P(x + y) \geq \min(v_P(x), v_P(y)) \geq v_P(D)$. Similarly for $\lambda \in k$ we have $v_P(\lambda x) = v_P(\lambda) + v_P(x) = v_P(x)$ (3.33.5).

b) By definition $D' = D + (x)$ we may define a mapping

$$\begin{aligned} L(D) &\longrightarrow L(D') \\ y &\longrightarrow yx \end{aligned}$$

Then

$$v_P(yx) = v_P(x) + v_P(y) \geq v_P(x) + v_P(D) = v_P(D')$$

so this is well-defined. As x^{-1} defines the inverse map it is a bijection.

c) By (3.33.5).a) $\tilde{k} \subset L(0)$. Suppose $x \in K \setminus \tilde{k}$ then by definition x is transcendental and so is x^{-1} . By (3.33.7) x^{-1} has a zero P , i.e. $v_P(x^{-1}) > 0 \implies v_P(x) < 0$. Therefore by definition $x \notin L(0)$ as required.

d) If $x \in \tilde{k}^*$ then $(x) = 0$ whence $x \notin L(D)$. If $x \in K \setminus \tilde{k}$ then as before x has a pole therefore $x \notin L(D)$ as required. $\square$

Lemma 3.33.14

Let K/k be an algebraic function field and $D \leq D'$ divisors. Then $L(D) \subset L(D')$ and

$$\dim_k L(D')/L(D) \leq \deg(D') - \deg(D)$$

In particular $\ell(D)$ is finite and we have

$$\deg(D) - \ell(D) \leq \deg(D') - \ell(D')$$

Proof. Consider a divisor D and suppose $D' := D + P$ for some P possibly in the support of D . Let π be a uniformiser for $\mathcal{O}_P$ and define $t = \pi^{v_P(D')}$. We then have a well-defined map

$$\begin{aligned} \psi : L(D') &\longrightarrow k(\mathfrak{m}_P) \\ x &\longrightarrow xt + \mathfrak{m}_P \end{aligned}$$

Observe that $\psi(x) = 0 \iff xt \in \mathfrak{m}_P \iff v_P(xt) > 0 \iff v_P(x) + v_P(D') > 0 \iff v_P(x) > -v_P(D) \iff x \in L(D)$. Therefore $\ker(\psi) = L(D)$ and so

$$\dim_k(L(D')/L(D)) \leq [k(\mathfrak{m}_P) : k] = \deg(D') - \deg(D)$$

Now suppose $D'' = D' + Q$, then by the isomorphism theorem for vector spaces (...)

$$\begin{aligned} \dim_k(L(D'')/L(D)) &= \dim_k(L(D'')/L(D')) + \dim_k(L(D')/L(D)) \\ &\leq \deg(D'') - \deg(D') + \deg(D') - \deg(D) \\ &= \deg(D'') - \deg(D) \end{aligned}$$

from which it follows the general case. $\square$

Proposition 3.33.15 (Dimension Upper Bound)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field and D a divisor. Then

$$\ell(D) \leq \deg(D_+) + \dim_k \tilde{k}$$

where D_+ is the positive part of D .

Proof. $L(D) \subset L(D_+)$ so it is enough to show the result for positive divisors. As $L(0) = \tilde{k}$ (...) the result follows from (3.33.14). $\square$

We say that the function $\deg(D) - \ell(D)$ is increasing, we also show it is bounded above.

Lemma 3.33.16 (Dimension Lower Bound I)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field. There exists a positive divisor B and integer $\gamma \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$\deg(mB) - \ell(mB) \leq \gamma$$

for all positive integers m .

Proof. Let $x \in K$ be transcendental and define $B := (x)_\infty$ with $\deg(B) = n$. It's positive by (...). Let $u_1, \dots, u_n$ be a $k(x)$ -basis for K and a divisor $C \geq 0$ such that $(u_i) \geq -C$. Then we claim that for all integers m the elements $\{x^i u_j \mid 0 \leq i \leq m, 1 \leq j \leq n\}$ are linearly independent over k . But this follows immediately because suppose

$$\sum_{i,j} \lambda_{ij} x^i u_j = 0$$

then

$$\sum_{j=1}^n \left(\sum_{i=0}^m \lambda_{ij} x^i \right) u_j = 0$$

and by linear independence we have $\lambda_{ij} = 0$.

Further $x^i \in L(iB) \implies x^i \in L(mB)$ and $u_j \in L(C) \implies x^i u_j \in L(mB + C)$. Therefore $\ell(mB + C) \geq n(m+1) = \deg(mB) + n$ for all positive integers m .

On the other hand by (3.33.14) we have $\ell(mB + C) \leq \ell(mB) + \deg(C)$. Therefore

$$\deg(mB) - \ell(mB) \leq \deg(C) - n$$

□

We may extend this result to all divisors by way of the following lemma.

Lemma 3.33.17

Let K/k be an algebraic function field, B a fixed positive divisor and D an arbitrary divisor. Then there exists a divisor D' such that $D \leq D'$, $D' \sim D''$ and $D'' \leq mB$ for some $m \geq 0$.

Proof. Choose a positive divisor $D' \geq D$, then

$$\deg(mB - D') - \ell(mB - D') \leq \deg(mB) - \ell(mB) \leq \gamma$$

for all positive integers m . This means

$$\ell(mB - D') \geq m \deg(B) - \deg(D') - \gamma$$

which is positive for sufficiently large m . Therefore we may choose $0 \neq z \in L(mB - D')$. Let $D'' = D' - (z)$. By definition

$$(z) \geq D' - mB \implies D'' \leq mB$$

as required. □

Proposition 3.33.18 (Genus is well-defined)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field. Then there exists a positive integer γ such that

$$\deg(D) - \ell(D) \leq \gamma$$

for all divisors D .

Proof. Then using the notation of (3.33.17) we have

$$\begin{aligned} \deg(D) - \ell(D) &\stackrel{(3.33.14)}{\leq} \deg(D') - \ell(D') \\ &\stackrel{(3.33.12)(3.33.13)}{=} \deg(D'') - \ell(D'') \\ &\stackrel{(3.33.14)}{\leq} \deg(mB) - \ell(mB) \\ &\stackrel{(3.33.16)}{\leq} \gamma \end{aligned}$$

□

Definition 3.33.19 (Genus of a Function Field)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field with $\tilde{k} = k$. Define the **genus** by

$$g := \max \{ \deg(D) - \ell(D) + 1 \mid D \in \text{Div}(K) \}$$

Note as $\ell(0) = 1$ the genus g is non-negative. For any divisor $D \in \text{Div}(K)$ define the **index of specialty** as follows

$$i(D) := \ell(D) - \deg(D) + g - 1$$

which by definition is a non-negative integer. This satisfies a few key properties (3.33.14)

- a) $i(0) = g$
- b) $i(D) \geq 0$
- c) $D \sim D' \implies i(D) = i(D')$
- d) $D' \geq D \implies i(D') \leq i(D)$

The Riemann-Roch theorem then takes the following form

$$\ell(D) - i(D) = \deg(D) - g + 1$$

The full Riemann-Roch amounts to an explicit form of $i(D)$. In order to do this we identify it as the dimension of a certain vector space.

Definition 3.33.20 (Repartitions)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field. Define the K -algebra of **repartitions** of K by

$$\mathcal{A}_K := \{(\alpha_P)_{P \in \mathbb{P}_K} \mid \alpha_P \in K \text{ and } \alpha_P \in \mathcal{O}_P \text{ for all but finitely many places } P\}$$

For every divisor $D \in \text{Div}(K)$ define the K -subspace

$$\mathcal{A}_K(D) := \{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}_K \mid v_P(\alpha_P) \geq -v_P(D) \text{ for all } P \in \mathbb{P}_K\}$$

There is a canonical K -algebra homomorphism

$$K \hookrightarrow \mathcal{A}_K$$

which is well-defined by (...). Then clearly we have $K \cap \mathcal{A}_K(D) = L(D)$.

We prove a number of results

Lemma 3.33.21

Let K/k be an algebraic function field. For divisors D, D' such that $D \leq D'$ we

- a) $\dim_k \mathcal{A}_K(D')/\mathcal{A}_K(D) = \deg(D') - \deg(D)$
- b) $\dim_k ((\mathcal{A}_K(D') + K)/(\mathcal{A}_K(D) + K)) = i(D) - i(D')$

Proof. We prove each in turn.

a) By the isomorphism theorem for k -modules it's enough to demonstrate this for the case $D' = D + P$. Let π be a uniformiser for $\mathcal{O}_P$ and let $r := v_P(D) + 1 = v_P(D')$. Then define the k -linear map

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{A}_K(D') &\longrightarrow k(\mathfrak{m}_P) \\ \alpha &\longrightarrow (\pi^r \alpha_P)(P) \end{aligned}$$

By definition we have $v_P(\alpha_P) \geq -v_P(D') \implies v_P(\pi^r \alpha_P) \geq 0 \implies \pi^r \alpha_P \in \mathcal{O}_P$ so that this map is well-defined. Further $\pi^r \alpha_P \in \mathfrak{m}_P \iff v_P(\pi^r \alpha_P) > 0 \iff v_P(D) + 1 + v_P(\alpha_P) > 0 \iff v_P(\alpha_P) \geq -v_P(D)$ whence the kernel is precisely $\mathcal{A}_K(D)$. It is clearly surjective because given $f \in \mathcal{O}_P$ we may consider the repartition given by

$$(1, \dots, 1, \pi^{-r} f, 1, \dots)$$

which clearly maps to f under this map. Therefore by the isomorphism theorem we have

$$\dim_k \mathcal{A}_K(D')/\mathcal{A}_K(D) = [k(\mathfrak{m}_P) : k] = \deg(D') - \deg(D)$$

b) We claim there is an exact sequence of k -modules

$$0 \longrightarrow L(D')/L(D) \xrightarrow{\sigma_1} \mathcal{A}_K(D')/\mathcal{A}_K(D) \xrightarrow{\sigma_2} (\mathcal{A}_K(D') + K)/(\mathcal{A}_K(D) + K) \rightarrow 0$$

from which the result follows immediately by comparing dimensions. The first map is given by

$$\sigma_1([f]) := (v_P(f))_{P \in \mathbb{P}_K}$$

which is obviously well-defined and injective. The map σ_2 is clearly well-defined and surjective. Further it is evident that $\sigma_2 \circ \sigma_1 = 0$. Therefore it only remains to show that $\ker(\sigma_2) \subset \text{im}(\sigma_1)$. Suppose $\alpha \in \mathcal{A}_K(D')$ then $\sigma_2(\alpha) = 0 \implies \alpha - (f) \in \mathcal{A}_K(D) \implies (f) \in \mathcal{A}_K(D')$ for some $f \in K$. Then by definition this means $f \in L(D')$ and $\sigma_1(f) = \alpha$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.33.22 (Riemann's Theorem)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field. Suppose $i(D_0) = 0$ (there always exists such a divisor) then

- a) $\deg(D) > l(D_0) \implies i(D) = 0$
- b) $\mathcal{A}_K = \mathcal{A}_K(D_0) + K$

Proof. We prove each in turn

- a) For an arbitrary divisor D we have

$$\begin{aligned} l(D - D_0) &= i(D - D_0) + \deg(D - D_0) - g + 1 \\ &\geq 0 + \deg(D) - l(D_0) \end{aligned}$$

So when $\deg(D) > l(D_0)$ we have $l(D - D_0) > 0$. Choose $0 \neq f \in L(D - D_0)$. Then we may define $D' := D + (f) \geq D_0$. Then by (...) $i(D) = i(D') \leq i(D_0) = 0$ whence $i(D) = 0$.

- b) Given $\alpha \in \mathcal{A}_K$ choose $D \geq D_0$ such that $\alpha \in \mathcal{A}_K(D)$. Then by (3.33.19) $i(D) \leq i(D_0) = 0$ and therefore $i(D) = 0$. By (3.33.21).b) $\mathcal{A}_K(D) + K = \mathcal{A}_K(D_0) + K \implies \alpha \in \mathcal{A}_K(D_0) + K$ as required.

□

Proposition 3.33.23 (Explicit form of $i(D)$)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field and $D \in \text{Div}(K)$. Then

$$i(D) = \dim_k(\mathcal{A}_K / (\mathcal{A}_K(D) + K))$$

Proof. By (3.33.22).a) there exists some divisor $D' \geq D$ such that $i(D') = 0$. Then by the same result $\mathcal{A}_K = \mathcal{A}_K(D') + K$. The formula then follows from (3.33.21).b). □

Definition 3.33.24 (Weil Divisors)

Let K/k be an algebraic function field and $D \in \text{Div}(K)$. Define

$$\Omega_K(D) := \{\omega \in \text{Hom}_k(\mathcal{A}_K, k) \mid \mathcal{A}_K(D) + K \subset \ker(\omega)\}$$

As divisors form a directed system we may form the union of **Weil Divisors**

$$\Omega_K := \bigcup_{D \in \text{Div}(K)} \Omega_K(D) \subset \text{Hom}_k(\mathcal{A}, k)$$

Proposition 3.33.25

Let K/k be an algebraic function field. Then there is a canonical isomorphism

$$\text{Hom}_k(\mathcal{A}_K / (\mathcal{A}_K(D) + K), k) \xrightarrow{\sim} \Omega_K(D)$$

In particular $i(D) = \dim_k \Omega_K(D)$.

3.34 Jacobson Rings

Definition 3.34.1 (Jacobson Radical)

Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ be an ideal. Define the **Jacobson Radical** of $\mathfrak{a}$ to be

$$\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}^J := \bigcap_{\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}} \mathfrak{m}$$

Note by (3.4.46) and (3.4.60)

$$\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \subseteq \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}^J$$

Proposition 3.34.2 (Jacobson Ring)

Let A be a ring the following are equivalent

- a) For any ideal $\mathfrak{a}$, $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}^J$
- b) For any radical ideal $\mathfrak{a} = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}^J$
- c) For any prime ideal $\mathfrak{p} = \sqrt{\mathfrak{p}}^J$

We say such a ring is a **Jacobson ring**.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) This clear because in this case $\mathfrak{a} = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$.

b) $\implies$ c) This is clear because a prime ideal is radical.

c) $\implies$ a) By (3.4.46)

$$\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}} \mathfrak{p} = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}} \mathfrak{m} = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}} \mathfrak{m}$$

as required □

We prove the Weak Nullstellensatz implies the following result

Proposition 3.34.3 (Strong Nullstellensatz)

Let A be a finitely-generated k -algebra. Then it is a Jacobson ring.

Proof. □

3.35 Affine Algebras under Base Change

This section covers what happens to a k -algebra A under base change, that is $A_{(L)}$ for L/k a field extension. Principally given an integral k -algebra A we would like to ensure that $A_{(L)}$ is reduced (which is related to separability), irreducible and therefore integral. We follow [Sta15] but large parts of exposition are from [Bou89].

Definition 3.35.1 (Geometrically Reduced / Integral Algebra)

A k -algebra A is

- **geometrically integral** (resp. **irreducible**, **reduced**) if the ring $A \otimes_k L$ is **integral** (resp. **irreducible**, **reduced**) for every field extension L/k .
- **algebraically integral** (resp. **irreducible**, **reduced**) if the ring $A \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is **integral** (resp. **irreducible**, **reduced**).

A few remarks about the important results and notation in the literature

- As in (3.4.66) we see that **integral** $\iff$ **irreducible** and **reduced**.
- These are shown to be equivalent (3.35.23), (3.35.33) and (3.35.41). In fact it is sufficient to check the properties for all finite extensions.
- [Liu06] uses the “algebraic” form
- [Bou89] uses the term “separable” for “geometrically reduced”, as this coincides with the notion of separable for algebraic extensions (3.35.16)
- Similarly [Bou89] and [Lan11] use the term “regular” for geometrically integral

We make implicit use of the following results throughout

Proposition 3.35.2

Let A, B be k -algebras, then the structural morphisms $A \rightarrow A \otimes_k B$ and $B \rightarrow A \otimes_k B$ are injective. Furthermore if A' and B' are k -subalgebras then the canonical homomorphism

$$A' \otimes_k B' \rightarrow A \otimes_k B$$

is injective.

Proof. This is (3.5.30) and (3.5.41) □

Proposition 3.35.3

Let A, B be k -algebras. Let $\{a_i\}_{i \in I}$ be a k -linearly independent subset (resp. basis) of A and $\{b_j\}_{j \in J}$ be a k -linearly independent subset (resp. basis) of B . Then $\{a_i \otimes b_j\}_{(i,j) \in I \times J}$ is a k -linearly independent subset (resp. basis) of $A \otimes_k B$.

Furthermore $\{a_i \otimes 1\}_{i \in I}$ is a B -linearly independent subset (resp. basis) of $A \otimes_k B$.

Proof. The first statement is (3.5.31). For the last statement extend $\{a_i\}_{i \in I}$ to a basis (2.3.7) and apply (3.5.26). □

Proposition 3.35.4

Let A, B be k -algebras. Then $A \otimes_k B$ is the union of subrings of the form a) $A \otimes_k B'$, b) $A' \otimes_k B$ or c) $A' \otimes_k B'$ where A' and B' are finitely-generated k -subalgebras of A and B respectively.

If K/k is an algebraic field extension then $A \otimes_k K$ is the union of subrings of the form $A \otimes_k k'$ where k'/k are finite subextensions.

Proof. An arbitrary element $z \in A \otimes_k B$ is a finite sum of elementary tensors. Therefore the result follows from (3.35.2). □

The final statement follows from recalling finitely generated algebraic extensions are finite (3.18.57). □

Proof. □

3.35.1 Etale Algebras

Definition 3.35.5

Let A be a finite-dimensional k -algebra. Then define the **separable degree** as follows

$$[A : k]_s := \# \operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A, \bar{k})$$

We say that A is **etale** if this equals the dimension of A as a k -vector space

$$[A : k]_s = [A : k]$$

Recall a finite field extension K/k is **etale** if and only if it is separable (3.18.90).

Lemma 3.35.6

Let A be a finite-dimensional k -algebra and K/k a field extension. Then

$$[\operatorname{Hom}_k(A, K) : K] = [A^\vee : k] = [A : k]$$

More precisely if $\{a_1, \dots, a_n\}$ is a k -basis for A then $\{a_1^\vee, \dots, a_n^\vee\}$ is a K -basis for $\operatorname{Hom}_k(A, K)$.

Proof. This is simply a special case of (3.5.27). □

Corollary 3.35.7 (Separable degree is finite)

Let A be a finite-dimensional k -algebra then $\# \operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A, K) \leq [A : k]$ for every field extension K/k .

Proposition 3.35.8 (Image of A is finite-dimensional)

Let A be a finite-dimensional k -algebra and Ω/k a field extension. Then there exists a finite subextension K/k such that

$$\operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A, K) = \operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A, \Omega)$$

If Ω contains $\bar{k}$ then these are both equal to $\operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A, \bar{k})$.

Proof. By (...) $\phi(A)$ has finite degree over k and therefore finitely-generated and algebraic as a k -algebra. Therefore $\phi(A) = k[a_1, \dots, a_n] = k(a_1, \dots, a_n)$ is a finite-dimensional field by (3.18.57).

We may take the compositum of all these images (since there are only finitely many) to obtain the finite extension K/k .

If Ω contains $\bar{k}$ then trivially

$$\operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A, K) \subseteq \operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A, \bar{k}) \subseteq \operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A, \Omega)$$

whence they are all equal. □

Proposition 3.35.9 (Etale-ness is preserved under base extension)

Let A be a finite-dimensional k -algebra and K/k a field extension then

$$\begin{aligned} [A \otimes_k K : K] &= [A : k] \\ [A \otimes_k K : K]_s &= [A : k]_s \end{aligned}$$

In particular A is etale if and only if $A \otimes_k K$ is.

Proof. The first equality follows from (3.5.26) and (3.4.109).

For the second equality we see that by (3.35.8) and (3.5.38)

$$\operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A, \bar{k}) = \operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A, \bar{K}) \cong \operatorname{AlgHom}_K(A \otimes_k K, \bar{K})$$

□

Lemma 3.35.10

Let $A = A_1 \times \dots \times A_d$ be a finite product of finite-dimensional k -algebras. Then A is etale if and only if each A_i is.

Proof. This follows because

$$\operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A_1 \times \dots \times A_d, \bar{k}) \cong \operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A_1, \bar{k}) \times \dots \times \operatorname{AlgHom}_k(A_d, \bar{k})$$

and a similar consideration for the dimension over k . □

Lemma 3.35.11

Let A be a finite-dimensional k -algebra. The following are equivalent

- a) A is reduced
- b) $A \cong L_1 \times \dots \times L_n$ for some finite extensions L_i/k

Further A is etale if and only if each L_i/k is separable. If k is perfect then A is automatically etale.

Proof. One direction is obvious. Suppose conversely that A is reduced. If $\dim_k A = 1$ then any proper ideal must have strictly lower dimension and therefore A is a field. It is therefore sufficient to show (by induction on dimension) that if A is not a field then $A \cong A_1 \times A_2$ for two (non-zero) k -algebras A_1, A_2 .

Suppose A is not a field and let $\mathfrak{a}$ be a non-zero proper ideal of A which has minimal dimension over k as a vector space. As A is reduced, and by minimality, we have $\mathfrak{a}^2 = \mathfrak{a}$. By Nakayama's Lemma (3.20.5) there is $e \in \mathfrak{a}$ such that $ex = x$ for all $x \in \mathfrak{a}$ and in particular $e^2 = e$ and $\mathfrak{a} = Ae$. By assumption $e \neq 0, 1$. Define $f := 1 - e \neq 0, 1$ then evidently $f^2 = f$ and $ef = 0$. The homomorphism of A -modules

$$\begin{aligned} A &\rightarrow Ae \times Af \\ a &\rightarrow (ae, af) \end{aligned}$$

is injective because $ae + af = a$ and surjective because the image of $a_1e + a_2f$ is (a_1e, a_2f) . The sub-modules Ae and Af are actually sub-rings by the idempotence property and the given map is an isomorphism of rings.

The last statement follows from (3.35.10) and (3.18.115). $\square$

Lemma 3.35.12

Let A be a finite-dimensional k -algebra and Ω/k a field extension containing $\bar{k}$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is etale
- b) $A \otimes_k \Omega \cong \Omega^n$ as an Ω -algebra

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) By (3.35.8) $\# \text{AlgHom}_k(A, \Omega) = \# \text{AlgHom}_k(A, \bar{k}) =: [A : k]_s = [A : k]$ with the last equality because A is assumed etale. Then defining $B := A \otimes_k \Omega$

$$\# \text{AlgHom}_\Omega(B, \Omega) \stackrel{(3.5.38)}{=} \# \text{AlgHom}_k(A, \Omega) = [A : k] \stackrel{(3.5.16)}{=} [B : \Omega] = [B^\vee : \Omega]$$

By (3.18.142) and (3.4.127) we see that $\text{AlgHom}_\Omega(B, \Omega)$ is a Ω -basis for $B^\vee$. Denote this basis by $\phi_1, \dots, \phi_n$ then by (3.4.109) this corresponds to a basis $e_1, \dots, e_n$ of B . Then the algebra isomorphism is exhibited explicitly by

$$\begin{aligned} B &\cong \Omega^n \\ b &\rightarrow (\phi_1(b), \dots, \phi_n(b)) \end{aligned}$$

b) $\implies$ a) We may show that the algebra homomorphisms are just the projections $\pi_i : \Omega^n \rightarrow \Omega$, so that $\# \text{AlgHom}_\Omega(B, \Omega) = [B : \Omega]$. As before then $[A : k]_s = \# \text{AlgHom}_k(A, \bar{k}) = \# \text{AlgHom}_k(A, \Omega) = \# \text{AlgHom}_\Omega(B, \Omega) = [B : \Omega] = [A : k]$ which shows that A is etale. $\square$

Proposition 3.35.13 (Etale Criteria)

Let A be a finite-dimensional k -algebra. The following are equivalent

- a) A is etale
- b) A is geometrically reduced
- c) $A \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is reduced
- d) $A \otimes_k K$ is reduced for some perfect field extension K/k
- e) $A \cong L_1 \times \dots \times L_n$ for L_i/k finite separable extensions

In particular A is reduced.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) Consider a field extension L/k and the tower of extensions $\bar{L}/L/k$. Then by (3.35.12) $A \otimes_k \bar{L} \cong \bar{L}^n$ is evidently reduced. By (...) $A \otimes_k L \subset A \otimes_k \bar{L}$ is a subring and therefore also reduced.

b) $\implies$ c) immediate.

c) $\implies$ d) immediate as $\bar{k}$ is perfect.

d) $\implies$ a) By (3.35.11) $A \otimes_k K$ is an étale K -algebra so by (3.35.9) A is étale.

e) $\implies$ a) Follows immediately from (3.35.10).

a) $\implies$ e) We know that A is reduced so the result follows from (3.35.11). $\square$

Corollary 3.35.14

Let A be a finite-dimensional k -algebra and k perfect. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is étale
- b) A is reduced
- c) A is geometrically reduced
- d) $A \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is reduced.

For completeness we summarize the relationship between the different notions of separability

Corollary 3.35.15 (Equivalent definitions of separability)

Let K/k be a finite extension. Then the following are equivalent

- a) K/k is separable algebraic (3.18.63)
- b) K/k is étale
- c) K/k is geometrically reduced
- d) $K \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is reduced

When k is perfect every field extension is separable.

Proof. We have already shown $b) \iff c) \iff d)$. Furthermore $a) \iff b)$ is (3.18.90). $\square$

Corollary 3.35.16 (Equivalent definitions of separability)

Let K/k be an algebraic extension. Then the following are equivalent

- a) K/k is separable algebraic (3.18.63)
- b) Every finite subextension of K/k is étale
- c) K/k is geometrically reduced
- d) $K \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is reduced

In particular an algebraic extension of a perfect field k is geometrically reduced.

Proof. This follows directly from (3.35.15) because each property has “finite character”, i.e. holds if and only if it holds for every finite subextension.

The last statement follows from (3.18.115). $\square$

3.35.2 Geometrically Reduced Algebras

Reference is [Bou89, Section V.15.4]. The main results of this section are (3.35.23) and (3.35.25). Observe that if k is perfect every extension K/k satisfies MacLane’s Criterion and is therefore Geometrically Reduced.

Lemma 3.35.17

Let A be a reduced k -algebra. Define the canonical map

$$i : A \hookrightarrow \prod_{\mathfrak{p}} k(\mathfrak{p})$$

where $\mathfrak{p}$ runs over all prime ideals of A . Then i is injective. Furthermore for any k -algebra B we have a canonical embedding

$$A \otimes_k B \hookrightarrow \prod_{\mathfrak{p}} (k(\mathfrak{p}) \otimes_k B)$$

Proof. Evidently $\ker(i) = \bigcap \mathfrak{p}$ which by (3.4.46) is (0). The final statement follows from considering the maps

$$A \otimes_k B \xrightarrow{i \otimes 1_B} \left(\prod_{\mathfrak{p}} k(\mathfrak{p}) \right) \otimes_k B \hookrightarrow \prod_{\mathfrak{p}} (k(\mathfrak{p}) \otimes_k B)$$

The first map is injective by (3.5.25) and the second by (...). □

Proposition 3.35.18

Let A be reduced k -algebra and B an geometrically reduced k -algebra, then $A \otimes_k B$ is reduced.

Proof. By the previous Lemma we have an embedding

$$A \hookrightarrow \prod (k(\mathfrak{p}) \otimes_k B)$$

As B is geometrically reduced this shows that $A \otimes_k B$ is reduced. □

Corollary 3.35.19

Let k be a perfect field and A, B reduced k -algebras. Then $A \otimes_k B$ is reduced.

Lemma 3.35.20

Let A be a geometrically reduced k -algebra and K the total ring of fractions. Then K is geometrically reduced.

Conversely if A is integral and K is geometrically reduced, then A is geometrically reduced.

Proof. Let L/k be a field extension and consider a nilpotent element $x \in K \otimes L$. Then by definition

$$x = \sum_{i=1}^n (a_i s_i^{-1}) \otimes \lambda_i \quad a_i \in A, s_i \notin Z(A), \lambda_i \in L$$

Let $s = s_1 \dots s_n$ then $x \cdot (s \otimes 1) \in A \otimes L \subset K \otimes L$. Then $x \cdot (s \otimes 1)$ is nilpotent and so by definition zero. As $(s \otimes 1)$ is invertible we see $x = 0$ as required.

For the converse $A \subset K$ and therefore $A \otimes_k L \subset K \otimes_k L$. □

Lemma 3.35.21

Let K/k be a separably generated field extension. Then K/k is geometrically reduced.

Proof. Consider first the case $K = k(\mathcal{B})$ is purely transcendental. Then for L/k we have $k[\mathcal{B}] \otimes L \cong L[\mathcal{B}]$ is evidently reduced. We may then demonstrate directly that $k(\mathcal{B}) \otimes_k L$ is reduced.

For the general case

$$K \otimes_k L \cong K \otimes_{k(\mathcal{B})} (k(\mathcal{B}) \otimes_k L)$$

We have shown that $k(\mathcal{B}) \otimes_k L$ is reduced and by (3.35.16) $K/k(\mathcal{B})$ is geometrically reduced as by assumption it is separable. By (3.35.18) $K \otimes_k L$ is reduced and K is geometrically reduced as required. □

Lemma 3.35.22

Let A be a reduced k -algebra for which k is perfect. Then A is geometrically reduced.

Proof. We prove the result in increasing generality

- a) We first consider the case $A = K/k$ is a finitely generated field extension. By (3.18.159) K/k is separably generated and so by (3.35.21) it is geometrically reduced.
- b) When A is a finitely-generated k -algebra by (3.35.17) there is a canonical embedding

$$A \otimes_k L \hookrightarrow \prod_{\mathfrak{p}} (k(\mathfrak{p}) \otimes_k L)$$

By assumption $k(\mathfrak{p})$ is finitely generated and so by the first part is geometrically reduced. Therefore $A \otimes_k L$ is reduced as required.

- c) The general case follows from b) and the reduction to the finitely generated case (3.35.4). □

Proposition 3.35.23 (MacLane's Criterion for Algebras)

Let A be a k -algebra. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is geometrically reduced
- b) $A \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is reduced
- c) $A \otimes_k k^{p^{-\infty}}$ is reduced
- d) $A \otimes_k K$ is reduced for some perfect extension K/k
- e) $A \otimes_k k^{p^{-1}}$ is reduced
- f) $A \otimes_k k'$ is reduced for every finite subextension k'/k of $k^{p^{-1}}/k$
- g) The following k -module homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} m : A \otimes_k k^{p^{-1}} &\rightarrow A \\ a \otimes \lambda &\rightarrow \lambda^p a^p \end{aligned}$$

is injective (that is $k^{p^{-1}}$ and A are linearly disjoint with respect to the p -th power embedding into A)

- h) A satisfies Maclane's Criterion (3.18.155)

In particular when k is perfect then this is equivalent to A being reduced.

Proof. The case $p = 1$ is simply (3.35.22) because $k^p = k = k^{p^{-1}} = k^{p^{-\infty}}$ is perfect and $g)$ is equivalent to A being reduced. Therefore we assume $p > 1$.

a) $\implies$ b) By definition

b) $\implies$ c) By (3.18.73) there is an embedding $k^{p^{-\infty}} \hookrightarrow \bar{k}$ whence an embedding $A \otimes_k k^{p^{-1}} \hookrightarrow A \otimes_k \bar{k}$

c) $\implies$ d) By (3.18.112) $k^{p^{-\infty}}$ is perfect

d) $\implies$ e) By (3.18.113) there is an embedding $k^{p^{-1}} \hookrightarrow K$ whence an embedding $A \otimes_k k^{p^{-1}} \hookrightarrow A \otimes_k K$.

e) $\implies$ f) this is immediate as we have an embedding $A \otimes_k k' \hookrightarrow A \otimes_k k^{p^{-1}}$

f) $\iff$ g) Suppose $x := \sum_i \lambda_i \otimes a_i \in A \otimes_k k^{p^{-1}}$ is a finite sum then we may consider the finite subextension $k' := k(\{a_i\}_i)$. Observe that

$$x^p = \sum_i \lambda_i^p \otimes a_i^p = \sum_i 1 \otimes \lambda_i^p a_i^p = 1 \otimes \left(\sum_i \lambda_i^p a_i^p \right) =: 1 \otimes m(x)$$

Therefore we see $A \otimes_k k'$ is reduced for every such k' iff $m(x)$ is injective.

g) $\iff$ h) Consider the Frobenius morphisms $i : k^{p^{-1}} \rightarrow A$ and $j : A \rightarrow A$. Then g) is equivalent to $k^{p^{-1}}$ and A being linearly disjoint in A with respect to i, j and the result follows from the characterization of linear disjointness (3.32.53).

h) $\implies$ a) Let $\{a_i\}_{i \in I}$ be a k -basis for A then by (3.5.26) $\{a_i \otimes 1\}_{i \in I}$ is an L -basis for $A \otimes_k L$. Given $x \in A \otimes_k L$ we have

$$x = \sum_{i \in I} a_i \otimes \lambda_i \quad \lambda_i \in L$$

and

$$x^p = \sum_{i \in I} \lambda_i^p \otimes a_i^p = \sum_{i \in I} \lambda_i^p (a_i^p \otimes 1)$$

By assumption $\{a_i^p\}_{i \in I}$ is k -linearly independent and therefore $\{a_i^p \otimes 1\}_{i \in I}$ is L -linearly independent. Therefore $x^p = 0 \implies \lambda_i^p = 0$ for all $i \in I \implies \lambda_i = 0$ for all $i \in I \implies x = 0$, as L is reduced. It follows from (3.18.156) that $A \otimes_k L$ is reduced, as we assumed that $p > 1$. $\square$

Corollary 3.35.24 (Maclane's Criterion for Fields)

Let K/k be a field extension with characteristic exponent p . Then the following are equivalent

- a) K/k is geometrically reduced
- b) $K \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is reduced
- c) $K \otimes_k k^{p^{-1}}$ is reduced

- d) $K \otimes_k k^{p^{-\infty}}$ is reduced
- e) $K \otimes_k k'$ is reduced for some perfect extension k'/k
- f) K and $k^{p^{-1}}$ are linearly disjoint (with respect to some common field extension)
- g) $K \otimes_k k^{p^{-1}}$ is an integral domain
- h) $K \otimes_k k^{p^{-1}}$ is a field
- i) K/k satisfies Maclane's Criterion (3.18.155)

Observe i) has finite character in the sense it holds if and only if it holds for every finitely-generated subextension.

In particular when k is perfect every extension is geometrically reduced.

Proof. By (3.35.23) a) – f), i) are equivalent (using (3.32.55) to generalise the linear disjoint condition to any ambient field) and by (3.32.55) again f) – h) are equivalent. $\square$

Proposition 3.35.25 (Separable Field Extensions)

Let K/k be a field extension. Then the following are equivalent

- a) K/k is geometrically reduced
- b) $K \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is reduced
- c) K/k satisfies Maclane's Criterion (3.18.155)
- d) Every finitely generated subextension K/k is separably generated

In particular if k is perfect every field extension satisfies these properties.

Proof. By (3.35.24) we have a) $\iff$ b) $\iff$ c). Further c) $\implies$ d) is Lemma (3.18.159), since every subextension satisfies Maclane's Criterion. For d) $\implies$ a) observe that every finitely generated subextension is geometrically reduced by (3.35.21). We may use (3.35.2) to argue that K/k is geometrically reduced. $\square$

Corollary 3.35.26

Let K/k be a finitely generated field extension. Then the following are equivalent.

- a) K/k is geometrically reduced
- b) $K \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is reduced
- c) K/k satisfies Maclane's Criterion (3.18.155)
- d) Every finitely generated subextension of K/k is separably generated
- e) K/k is separably generated

Proof. We've already shown equivalence of a) – d) and clearly d) $\implies$ e). Finally e) $\implies$ a) is simply (3.35.21). $\square$

3.35.3 Geometrically Irreducible Algebras

The reference for this section is [Sta15, 00I2] presented here with more elementary proof of Proposition (3.35.31).

Lemma 3.35.27

Let A, B be k -algebras. If $a \otimes 1 \in A \otimes_k B$ is a zero-divisor then so is a .

Proof. Consider a basis $\{a_i\}_{i \in I}$ for A such that $a_{i_0} = a$. If a is not a zero-divisor then we may show directly that $\{aa_i\}_{i \in I}$ is linearly independent. Then by extending to a basis of A we may use (3.5.26) to show that $\{(aa_i) \otimes 1\}_{i \in I}$ is B -linearly independent. We see immediately that $a \otimes 1$ is not a zero-divisor as required. $\square$

Lemma 3.35.28

Let A be a ring and $\mathfrak{a} \subset N(A)$ a locally nilpotent ideal. Then A is irreducible iff $A/\mathfrak{a}$ is irreducible.

Lemma 3.35.29

Let $A \subset B$ be a subring of an irreducible ring. Then A is irreducible.

In particular if B is a geometrically irreducible k -algebra, then so is any subalgebra.

Proof. By (3.22.7) every minimal prime in A is the contraction of a minimal prime. As there is precisely one minimal prime of B then we are done. $\square$

The final statement follows because the canonical map $A \otimes_k L \rightarrow B \otimes_k L$ is injective. $\square$

When k is algebraically closed then nothing interesting happens.

Lemma 3.35.30

Let A, B be irreducible (resp. integral) k -algebras with k algebraically closed. Then $A \otimes_k B$ is irreducible (resp. integral).

In particular A is a geometrically irreducible (resp. integral) k -algebra.

Proof. Observe that $N(A) \otimes_k B + A \otimes_k (B) \subset N(A \otimes_k B)$. For $(n \otimes \lambda)^m = n^m \otimes \lambda^m = 0$ and we may use (...) to argue any linear combination of such elements is nilpotent. By (...) we have an isomorphism

$$A/N(A) \otimes_k B/N(B) \cong (A \otimes_k B)/(N(A) \otimes_k B + A \otimes_k N(B))$$

Then by (3.35.28) $A/N(A) \otimes_k B/N(B)$ is irreducible iff $A \otimes_k B$ is. Therefore we may consider only the case A, B reduced and therefore integral, and show that $A \otimes_k B$ is integral and a-fortiori irreducible.

If $A \otimes_k B$ were not integral it would contain a non-trivial zero divisor, and this would also be true for $A' \otimes_k B'$ for some finitely generated subalgebras A' and B' . Therefore we may assume wlog that A and B are finitely generated.

To simplify the argument choose a k -basis $\{b_i\}_{i \in I}$ for B . By (...) $\{1 \otimes b_i\}_{i \in I}$ is an A -basis for $A \otimes_k B$. Therefore if we have a product of elements equal to 0 then may write it as follows

$$\left(\sum_i a_i \otimes b_i \right) \left(\sum_i a'_i \otimes b_i \right) = 0$$

for some $a_i, a'_i \in A$ all but finitely many zero. Let $\mathfrak{m} \triangleleft A$ be a maximal ideal, then by the Weak Nullstellensatz (3.32.23) the structural morphism $k \rightarrow A/\mathfrak{m}$ is an isomorphism. Reduce the equation to $A/\mathfrak{m} \otimes_k B \cong B$ to find

$$\left(\sum_i \bar{a}_i b_i \right) \left(\sum_i \bar{a}'_i b_i \right) = 0$$

As k is an integral domain, and b_i are linearly independent we find $\bar{a}_i, \bar{a}'_i = 0$. As $\mathfrak{m}$ was arbitrary we find $a_i, a'_i \in \bigcap \mathfrak{m}$ for all i . By assumption (0) is prime and so by the Strong Nullstellensatz (3.34.3) we find $a_i = a'_i = 0$. This shows that $A \otimes_k B$ is integral as required.

The last statement follows because a field K/k is always irreducible. $\square$

Proposition 3.35.31 (Extension of Scalars is Flat)

Let A be a k -algebra and $L/K/k$ a tower of field extensions. Then the canonical ring homomorphism

$$A \otimes_k K \rightarrow A \otimes_k L$$

satisfies *Going Down*. Further we have a well-defined surjective map of minimal primes

$$\text{MinPrime}(A \otimes_k L) \rightarrow \text{MinPrime}(A \otimes_k K)$$

given by the inverse image.

Proof. By (...) there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A \otimes_k K & \longrightarrow & A \otimes_k L \\ & \searrow & \downarrow \sim \\ & & (A \otimes_k K) \otimes_K L \end{array}$$

Therefore it is enough to show that $A \rightarrow A \otimes_k K$ satisfies going down. Suppose $\mathfrak{p}_1 \subseteq \mathfrak{p}_2 = \mathfrak{q}_2^\circ$. There is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A/\mathfrak{p}_1 & \xrightarrow{\alpha} & A/\mathfrak{p}_1 \otimes_k K \\ \pi \uparrow & & \pi \otimes 1 \uparrow \\ A & \xrightarrow{\beta} & A \otimes_k K \end{array}$$

where (3.5.42) shows that $\ker(\pi \otimes 1) = \mathfrak{p}_1^e$.

Let $\tilde{\mathfrak{q}}_1$ be a minimal prime of $A/\mathfrak{p}_1 \otimes_k K$ contained in $\tilde{\mathfrak{q}}_2 := (\pi \otimes 1)(\mathfrak{q}_2)$ by (3.4.43). Define $\mathfrak{q}_1 := (\pi \otimes 1)^{-1}(\tilde{\mathfrak{q}}_1)$ then $\mathfrak{q}_1$ is a prime minimal over $\mathfrak{p}_1^e$. As $\pi \otimes 1$ is surjective it is contained in $\mathfrak{q}_2$. We require to prove that $\beta^{-1}(\mathfrak{q}_1) = \mathfrak{p}_1$, which we readily see is implied by $\alpha^{-1}(\tilde{\mathfrak{q}}_1) = (0)$.

By (3.4.44) $\tilde{\mathfrak{q}}_1$ consists of zero divisors and by (3.35.27) so does $\alpha^{-1}(\tilde{\mathfrak{q}}_1)$. As $A/\mathfrak{p}_1$ is an integral domain we see that this equals (0) and we are done.

This immediately shows that the inverse image of a minimal prime is again a minimal prime. By (3.22.7) every minimal prime is a contracted minimal prime. $\square$

Lemma 3.35.32 (Purely Inseparable Extensions of Scalars are Homeomorphisms)

Let k be a field with characteristic exponent p , A a k -algebra and k'/k a purely inseparable field extension. Consider the structural algebra homomorphism

$$\phi : A \rightarrow A \otimes_k k'$$

Then ϕ induces an order-preserving bijection between prime ideals

$$\mathfrak{q}^c \leftarrow \mathfrak{q}$$

In particular A is irreducible iff $A \otimes_k k'$ is.

Furthermore a purely inseparable extension is geometrically irreducible.

Proof. If $p = 1$ then k'/k is trivial and the statement is obvious. So we may assume wlog that $p > 1$.

If ϕ were surjective then we would have equality $\mathfrak{q}^{ce} = \mathfrak{q}$ and which would imply the map of prime ideals is injective. However we note that ϕ is “almost” surjective, namely for every $z = \sum_{i=1}^N a_i \otimes \lambda_i$ there exists $n \geq 0$ such that $z^{p^n} \in \phi(A)$. For k'/k is purely inseparable so by definition there is some $n \geq 0$ such that $\lambda_i^{p^n} \in k$ for all $i = 1 \dots N$. In this case $z^{p^n} = \sum_{i=1}^N a_i^{p^n} \lambda_i^{p^n} \otimes 1$ which is in the image of A as required.

This allows us to argue the map is injective for suppose $\mathfrak{p} := \mathfrak{q}^c = (\mathfrak{q}')^c$ and $z \in \mathfrak{q} \setminus \mathfrak{q}'$. Then by the previous argument $z^{p^n} = \phi(x) \implies z^{p^n} \in \mathfrak{q} \implies z^{p^n} \in \mathfrak{q}' \implies z \in \mathfrak{q}'$ which is a contradiction. Therefore contraction of prime ideals is injective.

Finally we may observe that ϕ is integral (3.23.20) and injective (3.35.2). Therefore it satisfies the lying over property (3.23.17) and so every prime ideal in A is contracted and the given map is surjective. $\square$

The following result shows it is sufficient to ensure that A remains irreducible under a finite separable base change.

Proposition 3.35.33

Let A be an k -algebra. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is geometrically irreducible
- b) $A \otimes_k k'$ is irreducible for every finite separable extension k'/k
- c) $A \otimes_k k^{sep}$ is irreducible
- d) $A \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is irreducible

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) immediate

b) $\implies$ c) Suppose $\mathfrak{q}_1, \mathfrak{q}_2$ are minimal prime ideals of $A \otimes_k k^{sep}$. Let $k^{sep}/k'/k$ be a fixed finite separable extension and consider the subring

$$A \otimes_k k' \subset A \otimes_k k^{sep}$$

together with the prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}_i := \mathfrak{q}_i \cap (A \otimes_k k')$. By (3.35.31) the prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}_i$ are minimal and therefore $\mathfrak{p}_1 = \mathfrak{p}_2$ by assumption. As k'/k was an arbitrary finite subextension we may conclude by (3.35.4) that $\mathfrak{q}_1 = \mathfrak{q}_2$ and $A \otimes_k k^{sep}$ is irreducible.

c) $\implies$ d) By (...) $A \otimes_k \bar{k} \cong (A \otimes_k k^{sep}) \otimes_{k^{sep}} \bar{k}$ and so is irreducible by (3.35.32), since $\bar{k}/k^{sep}$ is purely inseparable (3.18.110).

d) $\implies$ a) Let K/k be a field extension then we may identify $\bar{k}$ and K as subextensions of $\bar{K}/k$. Then $A \otimes_k \bar{K} \cong (A \otimes_k \bar{k}) \otimes_{\bar{k}} \bar{K}$. By (3.35.30) $A \otimes_k \bar{K}$ is irreducible. Finally from (3.35.31) we see that $A \otimes_k K$ is irreducible as required. $\square$

Proposition 3.35.34

Let A be a geometrically irreducible K -algebra and K/k a geometrically irreducible field extension. Then A/k is geometrically irreducible.

Proof. It is sufficient by (3.35.33) to consider base change by a finite separable extension k'/k . Observe by transitivity

$$A \otimes_k k' \cong A \otimes_K (K \otimes_k k')$$

so it would be sufficient to show that $K \otimes_k k'$ is a field. By hypothesis $K \otimes_k k'$ is irreducible. Furthermore k'/k is geometrically reduced (3.35.15) whence $K \otimes_k k'$ is reduced and therefore an integral domain. Using the fact k'/k is algebraic we may conclude from (3.32.55) that $K \otimes_k k'$ is a field. and we are done. $\square$

Proposition 3.35.35 (Primary Extension)

Let K/k be a field extension. Then K/k is geometrically irreducible if and only if it is relatively separably closed.

In this case the subfield of algebraic elements is purely inseparable over k . In particular an algebraic extension is geometrically irreducible if and only if it is purely inseparable.

*We say such an extension is **primary**.*

Proof. Suppose that K/k is relatively separably closed. By (3.35.33) it is enough to show that $K \otimes_k k'$ is irreducible for every finite separable extension k'/k .

Let $K/K'/k$ be the relative algebraic closure then K/K' is relatively algebraically closed (3.18.59) and K'/k is purely inseparable because $K_s = k$ by hypothesis (3.18.108). Observe K'/k is geometrically irreducible (3.35.32) so by (3.35.34) it is enough to show that K/K' is geometrically irreducible. This reduces to the case that K/k is relatively algebraically closed.

As before it is sufficient to consider base change by a finite separable extension k'/k . By (3.18.89) $k' = k(\alpha)$ is simple. Let $m(X)$ be the minimal polynomial for α then $k(\alpha) \cong k[X]/(m)$. From (3.35.36) $m(X)$ remains irreducible in $K[X]$ and therefore

$$K \otimes_k k(\alpha) \cong K[X]/(m)$$

is a field and in particular irreducible.

Conversely suppose that K/k is geometrically irreducible and $\alpha \in K$ is separable. Then $k(\alpha)$ is geometrically irreducible by (3.35.29). Therefore by the Chinese Remainder Theorem (3.4.62)

$$k(\alpha) \otimes_k \bar{k} \cong k[X]/(m_\alpha) \otimes_k \bar{k} \cong \bar{k}[X]/(m_\alpha) \cong \bar{k}[X]/(X - \alpha_1)^{n_1} \times \dots \times \bar{k}[X]/(X - \alpha_r)^{n_r}$$

is irreducible where $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_r$ are the distinct roots in $\bar{k}$. This implies $r = 1$ and therefore α is purely inseparable (3.18.100). Being both separable and purely inseparable $\alpha \in k$ (3.18.101) as required. $\square$

We made use of

Lemma 3.35.36

Let K/k be a field extension such that k is algebraically closed in K . Then every irreducible polynomial $f \in k[X]$ remains irreducible in $K[X]$.

Proof. Consider the extension $\bar{K}$ which contains $\bar{k}$. And suppose $g \mid f$ in $K[X]$. As f splits completely in $\bar{k}$ then by unique factorisation in $\bar{K}[X]$ the coefficients of g lie in $K \cap \bar{k} = k$. Therefore by irreducibility $g = f$ or is constant. In particular f is irreducible in $K[X]$. $\square$

Proposition 3.35.37

Let A be an integral k -algebra and $K := \text{Frac}(A)$. Then A is geometrically irreducible iff K is geometrically irreducible.

Proof. Suppose K is geometrically irreducible and consider an arbitrary field extension L/k . Then we have an embedding $A \otimes_k L \hookrightarrow K \otimes_k L$, and therefore an embedding $(A \otimes_k L)_{\text{red}} \hookrightarrow (K \otimes_k L)_{\text{red}}$. By assumption these are integral and we conclude that $(A \otimes_k L)$ is irreducible.

Conversely suppose $A \otimes_k L$ is irreducible then define $\Omega := \text{Frac}((A \otimes_k L)_{\text{red}})$. As $L \hookrightarrow (A \otimes_k L)$ is injective and L is reduced we have a canonical map $L \hookrightarrow \Omega$. Similarly we have a canonical map $A \hookrightarrow \Omega$ and therefore a map $K \hookrightarrow \Omega$. Therefore we have a well-defined ring homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \psi : K \otimes_k L &\rightarrow \Omega \\ ab^{-1} \otimes \lambda &\rightarrow (a \otimes \lambda) \cdot (b \otimes 1)^{-1} \end{aligned}$$

We must show that if $x \in \ker(\psi)$ then x is nilpotent. By definition

$$x = \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i \otimes \mu_i$$

We may find $a \in A$ such that $y = ax$ is the form

$$y = \sum_{i=1}^n a_i \otimes \mu_i \in A \otimes_k L$$

We observe $y \in \ker(A \otimes_k L \rightarrow \Omega)$ whence y , and therefore x , is nilpotent. This means we have an embedding

$$(K \otimes_k L)_{\text{red}} \hookrightarrow \Omega$$

which means $(K \otimes_k L)_{\text{red}}$ is integral and therefore $K \otimes_k L$ is irreducible. $\square$

Proposition 3.35.38

Let A be an integral k -algebra and $K := \text{Frac}(A)$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is geometrically irreducible
- b) $A \otimes_k k'$ is irreducible for every finite separable extension k'/k
- c) $A \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is irreducible
- d) K is geometrically irreducible
- e) K is relatively separably closed

Proof. We may combine (3.35.33), (3.35.37) and (3.35.35). $\square$

3.35.4 Geometrically Integral Algebras

Clearly a geometrically (resp. algebraically) integral algebra is integral, we are interested in providing sufficient conditions for the reverse implication.

Proposition 3.35.39

Let A be a geometrically integral k -algebra and B an integral k -algebra. Then $A \otimes_k B$ is an integral domain.

Proof. Let $L = \text{Frac}(B)$ then $A \otimes_k B$ is a subring of $A \otimes_k L$ and we are done. $\square$

Proposition 3.35.40 (Criteria for Geometrically Integral in terms of Quotient Field)

Let A be an integral k -algebra and $K := \text{Frac}(A)$. Then $A \otimes_k L$ is integral if and only if $K \otimes_k L$ is integral.

In particular A is geometrically (resp. algebraically) integral if and only if K is geometrically (resp. algebraically) integral.

Proof. This follows exactly the same lines as (3.35.37). $\square$

Proposition 3.35.41 (Criteria to be Geometrically Integral)

Let A be a k -algebra. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is geometrically integral
- b) A is geometrically reduced and irreducible
- c) $A \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is an integral domain
- d) $A \otimes_k k'$ is an integral domain for every finite extension k'/k

Note we may restrict d) to only finite separable, and finite purely inseparable extensions of height at most 1.

Proof. This is largely a collection of existing results. $a) \iff b)$ is by definition and (3.4.67). Then $b) \iff c) \iff d)$ is from the reduced (3.35.23) and irreducible (3.35.33) cases, together with the trivial observation that reduced + irreducible $\iff$ integral (3.4.67). $\square$

Proposition 3.35.42 (Regular Extension)

Let K/k be a finitely generated field extension. Then the following are equivalent

- a) K/k is geometrically integral
- b) K/k is separably generated and relatively separably closed
- c) K/k is separably generated and relatively algebraically closed

- d) $K \otimes_k k'$ is an integral domain for every finite extension k'/k
- e) $K \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is an integral domain
- f) $K \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is a field

We say such an extension is **regular**.

Proof. $a) \implies b)$ is (3.35.26) and (3.35.35). $c) \implies b)$ is immediate. For the converse suppose $\alpha \in K/k$ is algebraic then $k(\alpha)/k$ is geometrically reduced (3.35.26) and therefore separable algebraic (3.35.15). By hypothesis $\alpha \in k$ as required. $a) \iff d) \iff e)$ was already proven in (3.35.41), and $e) \iff f)$ was proven in (3.32.55). $\square$

Corollary 3.35.43

Let A be a finitely-generated integral k -algebra and K the quotient field. Then the following are equivalent

- a) A is geometrically integral
- b) K/k is geometrically integral
- c) K/k is separably generated and relatively separably closed
- d) $K \otimes_k k'$ is an integral domain for every finite extension k'/k
- e) $K \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is an integral domain
- f) $K \otimes_k \bar{k}$ is a field

Proof. $a) \iff b)$ is (3.35.40) and the rest is (3.35.42). $\square$

Chapter 4

Topology and Sheaves

4.1 Topological Spaces

References :

- General Topology [Kel71, Chap. 1]
- General Topology [Wil70]

Topology is useful in algebraic geometry, but often the natural topologies are usually much coarser so the theory looks rather different.

Definition 4.1.1 (Topological Space)

A topological space $(X, \mathcal{T}_X)$ consists of a set X and family of open sets $\mathcal{T}_X \subseteq \mathcal{P}(X)$ satisfying the following properties

- $X, \emptyset \in \mathcal{T}_X$
- $U_i \in \mathcal{T}_X \implies \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i \in \mathcal{T}_X$
- $U, V \in \mathcal{T}_X \implies U \cap V \in \mathcal{T}_X$

A subset $Z \subset X$ is said to be closed iff $X \setminus Z$ is open. We may equivalently define the topology in terms of closed sets.

Proposition 4.1.2

Let X be a topological space. Both the open sets and closed sets form a [distributive lattice](#) under inclusion.

Definition 4.1.3 (Subspace topology)

Let $Y \subset X$, then we may define the **subspace topology** on Y by

$$\mathcal{T}_Y := \{U \cap Y \mid U \in \mathcal{T}_X\}$$

when Y is open then this is given by

$$\mathcal{T}_Y = \{U \subseteq Y \mid U \in \mathcal{T}_X\}$$

Definition 4.1.4 (Base)

We say $\mathcal{B} \subseteq \mathcal{P}(X)$ is a base (of open sets) on X if

- For every $x \in X$ there is a $U \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $x \in U$
- Suppose $U, V \in \mathcal{B}$ and $x \in U \cap V$ then there exists $W \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $x \in W \subseteq U \cap V$

Proposition 4.1.5 (Topology generated by a base)

Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a base, then the following is a topology on X

$$\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{B}} := \left\{ \bigcup_{U_i \in I} U_i \mid I \subseteq \mathcal{B} \right\}$$

i.e. the set of arbitrary unions of sets in $\mathcal{B}$.

Proposition 4.1.6 (Base generating topology)

A base $\mathcal{B}$ satisfies $\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{B}} = \mathcal{T}_X$ if and only if

- $\mathcal{B} \subset \mathcal{T}_X$
- or every $x \in U$ and $U \in \mathcal{T}_X$ there exists $V \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $x \in V \subseteq U$.

In this case we say $\mathcal{B}$ is a base for (the topology on) X .

Proposition 4.1.7 (Subbase for a topology)

Let X be a set and $\mathcal{B}$ be an arbitrary family of subsets. Then there exists a topology $\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{B}}$ such that

- $\mathcal{B} \subset \mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{B}}$
- For every topology $\mathcal{T}'$ containing $\mathcal{B}$ we have $\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{B}} \subset \mathcal{T}'$.

We say that $\mathcal{B}$ is a **subbase** for the topology $\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{B}}$. Explicitly $\mathcal{T}_{\mathcal{B}}$ consists of arbitrary unions of finite intersections of elements of $\mathcal{B}$.

Proposition 4.1.8 (Base for subspace topology)

Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space, and $Y \subset X$ has the subspace topology $\mathcal{T}_Y$ (4.1.3). If $\mathcal{B}$ is a base for $(X, \mathcal{T})$ then

$$\mathcal{B}_Y := \{U \cap Y \mid U \in \mathcal{B}\}$$

is a base for $(Y, \mathcal{T}_Y)$.

Definition 4.1.9 (Adherent point)

For $Y \subset X$ we say x is an **adherent point** of Y if every open neighbourhood of x intersects Y .

Similarly we say x is a **limit point** (or **accumulation point**) for Y if every open neighbourhood of x intersects Y at a point other than x .

Proposition 4.1.10 (Closed point)

Let $x \in X$ then TFAE

- $\{x\}$ is closed
- For every $y \neq x$ there is $U \ni y$ such that $x \notin U$.

Definition 4.1.11

For a topological space X let X_0 denote the subset of closed points.

Definition 4.1.12 (Open Embedding)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map of topological spaces. We say it is an **open embedding** if one of the following equivalent conditions holds

- a) $f(X)$ is open and f is a homeomorphism onto its image
- b) f is continuous, open and injective.

4.1.1 Axioms of Countability

Definition 4.1.13 (Neighbourhood)

Let X be a topological space and $x \in X$. We say a set $V \subset X$ is a **neighbourhood** of x if $x \in U \subset V$ for some open set U . We write $\mathcal{U}_x$ for the neighbourhoods of x , and $\mathcal{O}_x$ for the open neighbourhoods of x .

We say that a collection of neighbourhoods $\mathcal{B}_x$ is a **local base** for x if every neighbourhood $U \in \mathcal{U}_x$ contains some neighbourhood $V \in \mathcal{B}_x$. For example $\mathcal{O}_x$ is a local base.

Definition 4.1.14 (First-Countable)

Let X be a topological space. X is **first countable** if every point $x \in X$ has a countable local base.

Definition 4.1.15 (Second-Countable)

Let X be a topological space. X is **second countable** if there exists a countable basis. Evidently this is stronger than first countability.

Example 4.1.16

For example a metric space is always first countable as we may consider balls of radius $1/n$.

Further $\mathbb{R}$ is second countable as we may consider open intervals with rational endpoints.

4.1.2 Closure

Definition 4.1.17 (Adherent Point)

Let X be a topological space and $Y \subset X$. We say that $x \in X$ is an **adherent point** of Y , if $U \in \mathcal{U}_x \implies U \cap Y \neq \emptyset$.

We say that x is a **sequential limit point** of Y if there exists a sequence $x_n \in Y$ such that $x_n \rightarrow x$.

Proposition 4.1.18 (Adherent Point)

Let X be a topological space. Then every sequential limit point is an adherent point. If X is first countable the converse holds.

Proof. The first implication is straightforward. For the latter, consider a countable local base at x given by U_n . We may assume wlog that it is decreasing. Then by assumption we may choose $x_n \in U_n \cap Y$. For any $V \in \mathcal{B}_x$ we have $U_N \subset V$ for some N , and therefore $n \geq N \implies x_n \in U_n \implies x_n \in V$. Therefore $x_n \rightarrow x$. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.19 (Topological Closure)

Let $Y \subset X$ then the following equality holds

$$\bigcap_{\substack{Z \supseteq Y \\ Z \text{ closed}}} Z = \{x \in X \mid x \text{ adherent point of } Y\}$$

We denote this by $\bar{Y}$ (or $\text{cl}_X(Y)$ to emphasise the ambient space X) and refer to it as the **closure** of Y in X . Furthermore the following properties hold

- a) $Y \subseteq \bar{Y}$ and $\bar{Y}$ is closed
- b) $Y = \bar{Y}$ if and only if Y is closed
- c) $(Y \cap U \neq \emptyset \iff \bar{Y} \cap U \neq \emptyset)$ for any U open

When X is first countable then $\bar{Y}$ is the set of sequential limit points of Y .

Proof. Suppose Z is a closed set containing Y and x is an adherent point of Y . Then $x \notin Z \implies x \in X \setminus Z \implies (X \setminus Z) \cap Y \neq \emptyset$ a contradiction. Conversely assume $x \notin \bar{Y}$ then there exists $Z \supseteq Y$ closed such that $x \notin Z \implies x \in X \setminus Z$. This means x is not an adherent point.

- a) An arbitrary intersection of closed sets is closed
- b) This follows because $\bar{Y}$ is the smallest closed superset.
- c) One implication is clear because $Y \subseteq \bar{Y}$. Conversely if $x \in \bar{Y} \cap U$ then x must be a limit point of Y hence $U \cap Y \neq \emptyset$ as required.

□

Corollary 4.1.20

Let X be a first countable topological space. Then $\text{cl}_X(Y)$ is the set of sequential limit points of Y .

Proposition 4.1.21 (Closure in Subspace Topology)

Let X be a topological space and Y a subset. For $Z \subset Y$ we have

$$\text{cl}_Y(Z) = \text{cl}_X(Z) \cap Y$$

Proof. By (4.1.19) $\text{cl}_X(Z)$ is a closed subset of X and therefore $\text{cl}_X(Z) \cap Y$ is a closed subset of Y in the subspace topology. Therefore $\text{cl}_Y(Z) \subset \text{cl}_X(Z) \cap Y$ by minimality. Similarly $\text{cl}_Y(Z) = W \cap Y$ for W closed in X . By minimality $\text{cl}_X(Z) \subset W \implies \text{cl}_X(Z) \cap Y \subset W \cap Y = \text{cl}_Y(Z)$. □

Proposition 4.1.22

Let X be a topological space with $X = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$ an open cover. Let $Y \subset X$ be a subset then Y is closed in X if and only if $Y \cap U_i$ is closed in U_i for all $i \in I$.

Proof. One direction is obvious by definition of the subspace topology. Conversely $U_i \setminus (Y \cap U_i)$ is open in U_i and therefore in X . We see that

$$X \setminus Y = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i \setminus (Y \cap U_i)$$

is open and therefore Y is closed. □

Proposition 4.1.23

Let $Y_1, \dots, Y_n$ be subsets of a topological space X . Then

$$\overline{Y_1 \cup \dots \cup Y_n} = \bar{Y}_1 \cup \dots \cup \bar{Y}_n$$

Proof. By induction it is sufficient to demonstrate the case $n = 2$. $\overline{Y_1 \cup Y_2}$ is a closed set containing both Y_1 and Y_2 . Therefore by definition

$$\bar{Y}_1 \cup \bar{Y}_2 \subset \overline{Y_1 \cup Y_2}$$

On the other hand $\bar{Y}_1 \cup \bar{Y}_2$ is closed and contains $Y_1 \cup Y_2$. Therefore the reverse inclusion follows immediately. □

Proposition 4.1.24 (Dense subset)

Let $Y \subset X$ then the following are equivalent

- a) $\bar{Y} = X$
- b) $Y \cap U \neq \emptyset$ for any $U \subset X$ open

In this case we say Y is **dense**.

Proof. 1 $\implies$ 2) Follows from (4.1.19).c)

2 $\implies$ 1). Suppose $Y \subseteq \bar{Y} \subsetneq X$ then $X \setminus \bar{Y}$ is an open set not intersecting Y a contradiction. $\square$

4.1.3 Continuous Maps

Proposition 4.1.25 (Continuous at a point)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ a map of topological spaces and $x \in X$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $V \in \mathcal{U}_{f(x)} \implies f^{-1}(V) \in \mathcal{U}_x$
- b) $V \in \mathcal{B}_{f(x)} \implies f^{-1}(V) \in \mathcal{U}_x$
- c) $V \in \mathcal{U}_{f(x)} \implies \exists U \in \mathcal{U}_x$ s.t. $f(U) \subseteq V$
- d) $V \in \mathcal{B}_{f(x)} \implies \exists U \in \mathcal{B}_x$ s.t. $f(U) \subseteq V$

where $\mathcal{B}_{f(x)}$ is any local base at $f(x)$ and $\mathcal{B}_x$ is any local base at x . We say that f is **continuous** at x .

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) is obvious. Suppose b) holds and $V \in \mathcal{U}_{f(x)}$ then by definition there exists $V' \in \mathcal{B}_{f(x)}$ such that $V' \subset V$. By hypothesis $f^{-1}(V') \in \mathcal{U}_x$ from which it follows that $f^{-1}(V) \in \mathcal{U}_x$.

a) $\implies$ c) $f(f^{-1}(V)) \subseteq V$

c) $\implies$ d) By definition there exists $U' \in \mathcal{B}_x$ such that $U' \subseteq U \implies f(U') \subseteq f(U) \subseteq V$

d) $\implies$ b) Observe that $f(U) \subseteq V \implies U \subseteq f^{-1}(V)$ whence $f^{-1}(V) \in \mathcal{U}_x$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.26

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $g : Y \rightarrow Z$ be maps of topological spaces such that f is continuous at x and g is continuous at $f(x)$. Then $g \circ f$ is continuous at x .

Proposition 4.1.27 (Characterisation of Continuous Maps)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map of topological spaces. Then the following are equivalent

- a) f is continuous at all points $x \in X$
- b) $V \subset Y$ open $\implies f^{-1}(V) \subset X$ is open
- c) $Z \subset Y$ closed $\implies f^{-1}(Z) \subset X$ is closed

Let $\mathcal{B}_1, \mathcal{B}_2$ be bases of open sets for X and Y respectively. Then this is equivalent to the following condition

$$\forall V \in \mathcal{B}_2, \text{ and } x \in f^{-1}(V), \exists U \in \mathcal{B}_1 \text{ s.t. } x \in U \subset f^{-1}(V)$$

Proposition 4.1.28

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map of topological spaces and $X = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$ an open cover. Then f is continuous iff $f|_{U_i}$ is continuous for all $i \in I$.

Proof. Observe that $f^{-1}(V) = \bigcup_{i \in I} f^{-1}(V) \cap U_i = \bigcup_{i \in I} (f|_{U_i})^{-1}(V)$. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.29

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map of topological spaces. Then f is continuous iff

$$f(\bar{Z}) \subset \overline{f(Z)}$$

for all subsets $Z \subset X$.

Proof. Suppose f is continuous and $f(Z) \subset W$ is closed. Then by (4.1.27) $Z \subset f^{-1}(W)$ is closed. By definition $\bar{Z} \subset f^{-1}(W) \implies f(\bar{Z}) \subset f(f^{-1}(W)) \subset W$. As W was an arbitrary closed set containing $f(Z)$ we find by definition $f(\bar{Z}) \subset \overline{f(Z)}$.

Conversely suppose $W \subset Y$ is closed and $Z := f^{-1}(W)$. Then $f(\bar{Z}) \subset \overline{f(Z)} = \overline{W \cap \text{Im}(f)} \subset W \implies f^{-1}(f(\bar{Z})) \subset Z \implies \bar{Z} \subset Z \implies \bar{Z} = Z$ and therefore Z is closed. Therefore f is continuous by (4.1.27). $\square$

4.1.4 Quasi-Homeomorphism

Proposition 4.1.30 (Quasi-Homeomorphism)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map. The following are equivalent

- a) The map $W \rightarrow f^{-1}(W)$ is a bijection between open sets
- b) The map $Z \rightarrow f^{-1}(Z)$ is a bijection between closed sets

In this case we say f is a **quasi-homeomorphism**. Such a map induces a bijection between irreducible sets, respectively irreducible components.

Proof. This follows by taking complements and observing $X \setminus f^{-1}(A) = f^{-1}(Y \setminus A)$. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.31 (Induced Quotient)

Let $\pi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a surjective map where X is a topological space. The family

$$\mathcal{T}_Y := \{U \subset Y \mid \pi^{-1}(U) \in \mathcal{T}_X\}$$

is a well-defined topology on Y . Suppose that $\pi^{-1}(\pi(V)) \subset V$ for all V open (resp. closed) subsets of X . Then π is both open, closed and a quasi-homeomorphism.

Proof. As arbitrary intersections and unions commute with inverse image we see that $\mathcal{T}_Y$ is a well-defined topology.

As π is surjective we have $\pi(\pi^{-1}(U)) = U$ for all open subsets $U \subset Y$. Generically $V \subset \pi^{-1}(\pi(V))$ and by assumption the reverse inclusion holds. Therefore we see π induces a quasi-homeomorphism. This also shows π is open and therefore closed. $\square$

4.1.5 Kolmogorov Spaces

Definition 4.1.32

Let X be a topological space. We say that X is **Kolmogorov** or T_0 if for all distinct pairs $x, y \in X$ there exists an open set U such that either $x \in U$ and $y \notin U$, or $x \notin U$ and $y \in U$.

Proposition 4.1.33 (Indistinguishable points)

Let X be a topological space and $x, y \in X$. The following are equivalent

- a) $\overline{\{x\}} = \overline{\{y\}}$
- b) $x \in \overline{\{y\}}$ and $y \in \overline{\{x\}}$
- c) Every closed $Z \subset X$ contains both or neither of x, y
- d) Every open $U \subset X$ contains both or neither of x, y

We say x, y are **topologically indistinguishable**, otherwise we say x and y are **distinguishable**.

X is Kolmogorov iff every pair of points are distinguishable.

Being indistinguishable determines an equivalence relation on X , and we denote by $X_0 := X / \sim$ the **Kolmogorov Quotient**.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) Clear

b) $\implies$ a) By definition of closure $x \in \overline{\{y\}} \iff \overline{\{x\}} \subset \overline{\{y\}}$.

c) $\iff$ d) Follows by taking complements

c) $\implies$ b) Suppose $x \in Z$ for Z closed then by hypothesis $y \in Z$. As Z was arbitrary we see that $y \in \overline{\{x\}}$, and symmetrically $x \in \overline{\{y\}}$.

b) $\implies$ c) By assumption $x \in Z \implies y \in Z$ for Z closed and symmetrically $y \in Z \implies x \in Z$. $\square$

Definition 4.1.34 (Kolmogorov Quotient)

Let X be a topological space. The set X_0 of equivalence classes of topologically indistinguishable points is the **Kolmogorov Quotient**

Proposition 4.1.35 (Kolmogorov Quotient Properties)

Let X be a topological space and X_0 be the Kolmogorov Quotient with quotient map $\pi : X \rightarrow X_0$. Relative to the induced topology

$$\mathcal{T}_{X_0} := \{W \subset X_0 \mid \pi^{-1}(W) \in \mathcal{T}_X\}$$

π is a quasi-homeomorphism and an open and closed map. Further X_0 is Kolmogorov.

Proof. By (4.1.31) it is sufficient to show that $\pi^{-1}(\pi(U)) \subset U$ for all open subsets $U \subset X$. Suppose $x \in \pi^{-1}(\pi(U))$ then $\pi(x) = \pi(y)$ for some $y \in U$. Then by definition of π , x and y are indistinguishable and so $x \in U$.

Suppose $\pi(x) \neq \pi(y)$ then by definition there exists an open set $U \subset X$ such that $x \in U$ and $y \notin U$. As π is open then $\pi(U)$ is open. By construction $\pi(x) \in \pi(U)$ and $\pi(y) \notin \pi(U)$. This shows that X_0 is Kolmogorov. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.36 (Kolmogorov Quotient Functoriality)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map, then there is a unique (continuous) map $f_0 : X_0 \rightarrow Y_0$ such that the following diagram commutes

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{f} & Y \\ \downarrow \pi & & \downarrow \pi \\ X_0 & \xrightarrow{f_0} & Y_0 \end{array}$$

Proof. Given $x, x' \in X$ and suppose $f(x) \not\sim f(x')$. Then there exists an open set U such that $f(x') \in U$ and $f(x) \notin U$. Therefore $x' \in f^{-1}(U)$ and $x \notin f^{-1}(U)$ and $x \not\sim x'$. Equivalently $x \sim x' \implies f(x) \sim f(x')$. Therefore the map

$$f_0([x]) = [f(x)]$$

is well-defined.

For $W_0 \subset Y_0$ we have $\pi^{-1}(f_0^{-1}(W_0)) = f^{-1}(\pi^{-1}(W_0))$ is open. As π is surjective and open $f_0^{-1}(W) = \pi(\pi^{-1}(f_0^{-1}(W_0)))$ is open, and therefore f_0 is continuous.

Any such f_0 satisfies $\{f_0(x_0)\} = \pi(f(\pi^{-1}(\{x_0\})))$ and so is unique. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.37

Let X be a topological space with open cover $X = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$. If every U_i is Kolmogorov with respect to the subspace topology then so is X .

Proof. Consider $x, y \in X$. We may assume wlog that $x, y \in U_i$ for some i (otherwise we would be done). Then by assumption there exists $V \subset U_i$ such that $x \in V$ and $y \notin V$, whence $x \in V$ and $y \notin V$ as required. $\square$

4.1.6 Symmetric Spaces

Definition 4.1.38

Let X be a topological space. We say that x is **quasi-closed** if $y \in \overline{\{x\}} \implies x \in \overline{\{y\}}$.

Proposition 4.1.39 (Symmetric Topology)

Let X be a topological space. Then the following are equivalent

- a) For all $x \in X$ we have $\overline{\{x\}} = \{y \in X \mid y \text{ topologically indistinguishable from } x\}$,
- b) For all $x, y \in X$ $x \in \overline{\{y\}} \implies y \in \overline{\{x\}}$ (i.e. every point is **quasi-closed**),
- c) Every open neighbourhood U of x contains $\overline{\{x\}}$,
- d) X is partitioned by sets of the form $\overline{\{x\}}$, indexed by X_0 .

In this case we say that X is **symmetric** or R_0 . Further $x \in \overline{\{y\}}$ if and only if x and y become equal in X_0 .

Proposition 4.1.40

Let X be a symmetric topological space and $x, y \in X$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) x and y are topologically indistinguishable,
- b) $x \in \overline{\{y\}}$,
- c) $y \in \overline{\{x\}}$,
- d) $\overline{\{x\}} = \overline{\{y\}}$,
- e) x and y become equal in the Kolmogorov Quotient X_0

Proposition 4.1.41 (Open Subspace is Symmetric)

Let X be a symmetric space and $U \subset X$ an open subset. Then U is symmetric and for every $x \in U$ we have

$$\text{cl}_X(\{x\}) = \text{cl}_U(\{x\})$$

Proof. By (4.1.21) we have $\text{cl}_U(\{x\}) = \text{cl}_X(\{x\}) \cap U$, so these are equal by (4.1.39).c). We conclude that the sets $\overline{\{x\}}$ partition U so that U is also symmetric. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.42 (Symmetric Open Cover $\implies$ Symmetric)

Let X be a topological space with open cover $\bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ such that U_i are symmetric in the subspace topology. Then X is symmetric.

Proof. Suppose $x \in \text{cl}_X(\{y\})$ then by (4.1.41) we have $x \in \text{cl}_{U_i}(\{y\})$, whence $y \in \text{cl}_{U_i}(\{x\})$ by (4.1.39) and $y \in \text{cl}_X(\{x\})$. Therefore by (4.1.39) we have X is symmetric. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.43

Let X be a topological space. Then the following are equivalent

- a) X is both Symmetric and Kolmogorov
- b) Every point $x \in X$ is closed.

Corollary 4.1.44

Let X be a symmetric topological space. Then every point of X_0 is closed.

4.1.7 Hausdorff Spaces

Definition 4.1.45

Let X be a topological space. We say that X is **Hausdorff** if for all distinct pairs $x, y \in X$ there exists open neighbourhoods U, V of x and y respectively such that $U \cap V = \emptyset$.

Observe that **Hausdorff** $\implies$ **Kolmogorov**, but not conversely (e.g. co-finite topology).

4.1.8 Convergent Sequences

Proposition 4.1.46 (Convergent Sequence)

Let X be a topological space, (x_n) a sequence in X and $x \in X$. Let $\mathcal{B}_x$ be a local base for x . Then the following are equivalent

- a) For every $V \in \mathcal{U}_x$ there exists N such that

$$n \geq N \implies a_n \in V$$

- b) For every $V \in \mathcal{B}_x$ there exists N such that

$$n \geq N \implies a_n \in V$$

- c) The function

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{N} \cup \{\infty\} &\rightarrow X \\ n &\rightarrow x_n \\ \infty &\rightarrow x \end{aligned}$$

is continuous at ∞ with respect to the topology on $\mathbb{N} \cup \{\infty\}$ given by open sets of the form $\{N, N+1, \dots\} \cup \{\infty\}$ and arbitrary subsets of $\mathbb{N}$.

In this case we say that $x_n \rightarrow x$.

Proposition 4.1.47 (Continuous $\implies$ Sequentially Continuous)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map and $x_n \rightarrow x$ a sequence in X . Then $f(x_n) \rightarrow f(x)$.

Proof. If we regard the sequence as a continuous map $\mathbb{N} \cup \infty$ (4.1.46) then the result follows from (4.1.26). $\square$

Proposition 4.1.48 (Limits are Unique in Kolmogorov Spaces)

Let X be a Kolmogorov topological space. Then limits of sequences are unique.

Proposition 4.1.49 (Sequentially Continuous $\implies$ Continuous)

Let X, Y be topological spaces, $f : X \rightarrow Y$ a map and $x \in X$ a point with a countable local base $\mathcal{B}_x$. Suppose that for all sequences $x_n \rightarrow x$ we have $f(x_n) \rightarrow f(x)$. Then f is continuous at x .

In particular if X is first countable then $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is continuous iff it is sequentially continuous.

Proof. Consider a point $x \in X$ and $y := f(x)$. By hypothesis $\mathcal{B}_x = \{U_n\}$ is countable. By replacing with the base $U'_n := \bigcap_{k=1}^n U_k$ we may suppose that

$$U_1 \supseteq U_2 \supseteq \dots \supseteq U_n \supseteq \dots$$

is decreasing. Suppose f is not continuous at x then by (4.1.25).d) there exists $V \in \mathcal{U}_{f(x)}$ such that $f(U_n) \setminus V \neq \emptyset$ for all n . Therefore we may choose $x_n \in U_n$ such that $f(x_n) \notin V$. Consider $U \in \mathcal{U}_x$ then by definition there is some N such that $U_N \subseteq U$. Furthermore $n \geq N \implies U_n \subseteq U_N \subseteq U \implies x_n \in U$. Therefore $x_n \rightarrow x$. By construction $f(x) \in V$ but $f(x_n) \notin V$ for all n and in particular $f(x_n) \not\rightarrow f(x)$. $\square$

4.1.9 Irreducible Topological Spaces

References :

a) [Bou98a, Chapter II §4.2]

b) [Sta15, 004U]

Proposition 4.1.50 (Irreducible space)

Let X be a topological space. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $X = Z_1 \cup Z_2$ closed implies either $Z_1 = X$ or $Z_2 = X$
- b) $U, V \neq \emptyset \implies U \cap V \neq \emptyset$ for open sets U, V
- c) $U \neq \emptyset \implies \bar{U} = X$ i.e. every non-empty open set is *dense*

and we say X is irreducible.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) Suppose U, V are open sets such that $U \cap V = \emptyset$. Then $X = (X \setminus U) \cup (X \setminus V)$. By hypothesis $X = (X \setminus U)$ or $X = (X \setminus V)$ whence either U or V is empty.

b) $\implies$ a) Similar.

c) $\iff$ b) Follows directly from (4.1.24) $\square$

Proposition 4.1.51 (Irreducible Subset)

Let $Y \subset X$ be a subset of a topological space. Then the following conditions on Y are equivalent

- a) Y is irreducible in the subspace topology.
- b) $Y \subseteq Z_1 \cup Z_2 \implies Y \subseteq Z_1$ or $Y \subseteq Z_2$ where Z_1, Z_2 are closed subsets of X
- c) $U \cap Y \neq \emptyset, V \cap Y \neq \emptyset \implies (U \cap V) \cap Y \neq \emptyset$ for U, V open

and we say Y is an **irreducible subset**.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b). Suppose that Y is irreducible in the subspace topology and $Y \subseteq Z_1 \cup Z_2$. This implies $Y = (Z_1 \cap Y) \cup (Z_2 \cap Y)$ is a decomposition of closed sets. So either $Z_1 \cap Y = Y$ or $Z_2 \cap Y = Y \implies Y \subseteq Z_1$ or $Y \subseteq Z_2$ as required.

b) $\implies$ a). Suppose that $Y = (Z_1 \cap Y) \cup (Z_2 \cap Y)$. Then $Y \subseteq Z_1 \cup Z_2$, and for example $Y \subseteq Z_1$, which implies $Z_1 \cap Y = Y$. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.52

Let $Y \subset X$ be a **closed** subset then the following are equivalent

- a) Y is an irreducible subset
- b) $Y = Z_1 \cup Z_2 \implies Y = Z_1$ or $Y = Z_2$ where Z_1, Z_2 are closed subsets of X
- c) $Y \subseteq Z_1 \cup Z_2 \implies Y \subseteq Z_1$ or $Y \subseteq Z_2$ where Z_1, Z_2 are closed subsets of X

In other words in the lattice of closed subsets, the irreducible subsets are precisely the *join-prime* subsets.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b). Clearly Z_1, Z_2 are also closed subsets of Y , so the result follows by definition.

b) $\iff$ c). This is (2.4.2).

c) $\implies$ a). This was already proven in (4.1.51). $\square$

Remark 4.1.53

Singletons $\{x\}$ are always irreducible.

Definition 4.1.54 (Irreducible Component)

We say that Y is an irreducible component if it is a maximal irreducible subset.

Proposition 4.1.55

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map and $Z \subset X$ irreducible. Then $f(Z)$ is irreducible in Y .

Proof. Suppose $f(Z) \subset Y_1 \cup Y_2$ for Y_1, Y_2 closed. Then $Z \subset f^{-1}(f(Z)) \subset f^{-1}(Y_1) \cup f^{-1}(Y_2)$. Then by (4.1.51).b) wlog $Z \subset f^{-1}(Y_1)$ therefore $f(Z) \subset f(f^{-1}(Y_1)) \subset Y_1$. Therefore by the same criterion $f(Z)$ is irreducible. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.56

Let $Y \subset X$. Then Y is irreducible iff $\overline{Y}$ is.

Proof. This follows from (4.1.51).b) and (4.1.19) that $Y \subset Z \iff \overline{Y} \subset Z$. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.57 (Decomposition into Irreducible Components)

A topological space X may be decomposed into irreducible components. More precisely

- a) Every irreducible component is closed
- b) Every irreducible closed subset is contained in an irreducible component
- c) X is the union of irreducible components

Proof. We prove each in turn

- a) By (4.1.56) $\overline{Y}$ is irreducible and closed, so by maximality $Y = \overline{Y}$ is closed.
- b) We may show that the lattice of closed subsets is chain complete so we may use to show that the lattice of irreducible closed subsets is also chain complete (2.4.4). Therefore we may apply (2.1.55) to find an irreducible component.
- c) As $\{x\}$ is irreducible every element is contained in an irreducible component by b).

$\square$

Corollary 4.1.58

For $x \in X$ the closure $\overline{\{x\}}$ is an irreducible closed subset.

Corollary 4.1.59

X is irreducible if and only if it has a single irreducible component.

Definition 4.1.60 (Generic Point)

Let Z be an irreducible closed subset of X , then we say $\eta \in X$ is a generic point of Z if $Z = \overline{\{\eta\}}$.

Proposition 4.1.61

Let X be an irreducible space then every open subset U is irreducible.

Proof. By (4.1.50) U is dense in X . Therefore by (4.1.56) U is irreducible. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.62

Let $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n X_i$ where X_i are irreducible closed subsets, and mutually incomparable. Then the X_i are the irreducible components of X .

Proof. For any irreducible closed subset E we have by (4.1.52) $E \subset X_i$ for some i . In particular every irreducible component is contained in some X_i . On the other hand every X_j is contained in an irreducible component by (4.1.57). By incomparability we deduce that each X_i is an irreducible component, and that the set is complete. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.63

Let $Y \subset X$ such that $Y = \bigcup_{i=1}^n Y_i$ where Y_i are the irreducible components of Y . Then the set of irreducible components of $\overline{Y}$ is $\{\overline{Y_i}\}_{i=1 \dots n}$, and these are distinct.

Proof. By (4.1.56) $\overline{Y_i}$ are irreducible subsets which, by (4.1.23) cover $\overline{Y}$. By (4.1.57) Y_i is closed in Y and so by (4.1.21) $\overline{Y_i} \cap Y = Y_i$. This shows that the $\overline{Y_i}$ are distinct and also incomparable. Then (4.1.62) shows that these must be the irreducible components. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.64

Let $U \subset X$ be an open subset. There is an order isomorphism

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \{Y \subset U \mid Y \text{ irreducible, closed and non-empty}\} & \longleftrightarrow & \{Z \subset X \mid Z \text{ irreducible and closed and } Z \cap U \neq \emptyset\} \\ Y & \rightarrow & \text{cl}_X(Y) \\ Z \cap U & \leftarrow & Z \end{array}$$

which restricts to irreducible components.

Proof. By (4.1.56) the first map is well-defined. Conversely $Z \cap U$ is closed in U and open in Z , so irreducible by (4.1.61).

By (4.1.50) $Z \cap U$ is dense in Z , that is $Z = \text{cl}_Z(Z \cap U) \stackrel{(4.1.21)}{=} \text{cl}_X(Z \cap U) \cap Z \implies Z \subset \text{cl}_X(Z \cap U)$, and so by minimality they are equal.

By (4.1.21) $\text{cl}_X(Y) \cap U = \text{cl}_U(Y) = Y$. Therefore the maps are mutually inverse and order preserving. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.65

Suppose X is a topological space with open cover $\bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$ such that

- a) U_i is irreducible for all $i \in I$ and
- b) $U_i \cap U_j$ is non-empty for all $i, j \in I$.

Then X is irreducible.

Proof. Suppose that $X = Z_1 \cup Z_2$. Pick some $i \in I$ then by (4.1.51) wlog $U_i \cap Z_1 \neq \emptyset$. Similarly for all $j \in J$ by assumption $U_i \cap U_j$ is a non-empty open subset of U_j and therefore dense (4.1.50). Further $U_i \cap U_j$ is contained in the closed subset $Z_1 \cap U_j$. We conclude that $U_j \subset Z_1 \cap U_j$. Therefore $X \subset Z_1$. By (4.1.51) we further conclude that X is irreducible. $\square$

4.1.10 Noetherian Topological Spaces**Definition 4.1.66** (Noetherian)

A topological space X is **Noetherian** if the lattice of closed subsets is **Artinian** (i.e. satisfies the descending chain condition).

Proposition 4.1.67 (Decomposition into Irreducibles)

Let X be a Noetherian topological space. Then every closed subset Y may be expressed uniquely as a finite, **incomparable** union of irreducible closed subsets. These are precisely the irreducible components of Y .

In particular X has only finitely many irreducible components.

Proof. The lattice of closed subsets is distributive and Artinian by definition. Therefore the result follows from (4.1.52) and (2.4.7). $\square$

Proposition 4.1.68

Let X be a Noetherian topological space and $Y \subset X$. Then Y is Noetherian.

Proposition 4.1.69

Let $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^N X_i$ be topological space such that X_i is Noetherian under the subspace topology. Then X is Noetherian.

Proof. Let $\{Z_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ be a descending chain of closed subsets of X . By definition $\{Z_n \cap X_i\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ terminates for $n \geq m_i$. Then for $n \geq \max(m_1, \dots, m_N)$ the sequence $\{Z_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ also terminates. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.70

Let X be a Noetherian topological space and $U \subset X$ an open subset. Then there is a bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \{Y \subset U \mid Y \text{ closed and non-empty}\} & \longleftrightarrow & \{Z \subset X \mid Z \text{ closed and every irreducible component meets } U\} \\ Y & \rightarrow & \text{cl}_X(Y) \\ Z \cap U & \leftarrow & Z \end{array}$$

which is order preserving and restricts to closed irreducible subsets and irreducible components.

Proof. By (4.1.68) and (4.1.67) $Y = Y_1 \cup \dots \cup Y_n$ where Y_i are the irreducible components of Y . Then by (4.1.63) the irreducible components of $\overline{Y}$ are $\overline{Y_i}$, which evidently intersect U . Furthermore by definition $Z \cap U$ is closed in U and the maps are well-defined.

By (4.1.64) the maps restricts to closed irreducible subsets (resp. components) and are bijections, in particular for Z irreducible closed we have $\overline{Z \cap U} = Z$.

By (4.1.21) $\overline{Y} \cap U = Y$. For the case Z is closed then as before $Z = Z_1 \cup \dots \cup Z_n$ is a decomposition into irreducible components. By assumption $Z_i \cap U \neq \emptyset$ for all $i = 1 \dots n$. Therefore by the irreducible case (4.1.64) and (4.1.23)

$$\overline{Z \cap U} = \overline{Z_1 \cap U} \cup \dots \cup \overline{Z_n \cap U} = Z_1 \cup \dots \cup Z_n = Z.$$

Therefore the maps are mutually inverse as required. $\square$

4.1.11 Krull Dimension

References :

- Éléments de géométrie algébrique IV [Gro64, Chap. 0 §14.4.1]
- Some remarks on biequidimensionality of topological spaces and Noetherian schemes [Hei17]

For a Noetherian topological space X the closed subsets form an Artinian, distributive lattice. Furthermore the irreducible subsets are precisely the join-prime elements by (4.1.52). Therefore we may use the notions of Krull Lattice developed in Section 2.5.

Definition 4.1.71 (Chain of irreducibles)

Let X be a Noetherian topological space. A **chain** of irreducible closed subsets

$$Z_0 \subsetneq Z_1 \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq Z_n$$

is said to have **length** n . A chain is **saturated** if there is no proper refinement, that is if Y is irreducible then

$$Z_i \subseteq Y \subseteq Z_{i+1} \implies Y = Z_i \text{ or } Y = Z_{i+1}.$$

If in addition Z_n (resp. Z_0) is maximal (resp. minimal) then the chain is **maximal**.

Definition 4.1.72 (Krull Lattice of Closed Subsets)

Let X be a topological space.

- The **Krull dimension** $\dim X$ of X is the maximal length of all chains of irreducible closed subsets. Note this may be ∞ .
- The **height** or **codimension** of an irreducible closed subset $Y \subseteq X$, denoted $\text{codim}(Y, X)$, is the maximal length of chains of irreducible subsets containing Y .
- When Y is not irreducible we write

$$\text{codim}(Y, X) = \inf_{\alpha} \text{codim}(Y_{\alpha}, X)$$

where Y_{α} varies among the irreducible components of Y .

If $\dim X < \infty$ then we say X is **finite-dimensional**. In this case it's clear the closed subsets of a topological space form a **Krull Lattice** where the irreducible closed subsets are precisely the join-prime elements of the lattice.

Note any saturated chain for $Y \subset X$ must start at Y and terminate at an irreducible component of X . In particular if X is irreducible then a saturated chain must terminate at X .

Proposition 4.1.73 (Extending Chains)

Let X be a finite-dimensional topological space. Then

- Every chain is contained in a saturated chain with the same endpoints
- Every chain is contained in a maximal chain

Proposition 4.1.74 (Simple properties of (co-)dimension)

Let X be a topological space. Then the following properties hold

- a) $\dim(X) = \sup_{\alpha} \dim(X_{\alpha})$ where X_{α} are the irreducible components of X
- b) $\operatorname{codim}(Y, X) = \sup_{\alpha} \operatorname{codim}(Y, X_{\alpha})$ where X_{α} are the irreducible components of X containing Y
- c) $\dim Y + \operatorname{codim}(Y, X) \leq \dim X$ for every closed subset $Y \subset X$
- d) $\operatorname{codim}(Y, Z) + \operatorname{codim}(Z, T) \leq \operatorname{codim}(Y, T)$ for $Y \subset Z \subset T$ irreducible closed subsets
- e) $Y \subsetneq Z$ is a saturated chain of irreducible closed subsets if and only if $\operatorname{codim}(Y, Z) = 1$.
- f) Let Y be a closed subset of X . Then $\operatorname{codim}(Y, X) = 0 \iff$ every irreducible component of Y is an irreducible component of X . In particular if X is irreducible then $\operatorname{codim}(Y, X) = 0 \iff Y = X \iff \dim X = \dim Y$.

In particular if X is finite-dimensional then all codimensions are also finite.

Proposition 4.1.75

Let X be an irreducible topological space and $Y \subset X$ a closed subset. Then $\dim Y \leq \dim X$ with equality iff $Y = X$.

Proof. The inequality follows from (4.1.74).b). If $\dim Y = \dim X$ then by c) $\operatorname{codim}(Y, X) = 0$ and so by f) we have $Y = X$. $\square$

Definition 4.1.76 (Properties)

Let X be a topological space of finite dimension. Then we say X is

- **Equidimensional** if all irreducible components of X have the same dimension
- **Equicodimensional** if $\operatorname{codim}(Y, X)$ is constant as Y varies over minimal irreducible subsets of X
- **Biequidimensional** if all maximal chains of irreducible subsets have the same length.
- **Quasi-Biequidimensional** if every irreducible component is biequidimensional
- **Catenary** if any two saturated chains with the same endpoints, say Y and Z , have the same length, namely $\operatorname{codim}(Y, Z)$

Observe that **quasi-biequidimensional** + **equidimensional** $\iff$ **biequidimensional** and **irreducible** $\implies$ **equidimensional**

Proposition 4.1.77 (Equivalent characterisations of biequidimensional)

Suppose X is a topological space of finite dimension. Then the following are equivalent

- a) X is quasi-biequidimensional
- b) X is catenary and every irreducible component is equicodimensional
- c) X satisfies the codimension formula for $Z \subset Y$ irreducible

$$\dim Y = \dim Z + \operatorname{codim}(Z, Y)$$

- d) X satisfies c) in the case $\operatorname{codim}(Z, Y) = 1$

Furthermore for irreducible subsets $Z \subset Y$

$$\operatorname{codim} Z = \operatorname{codim}(Z, Y) + \operatorname{codim} Y$$

Proof. This is a translation of (2.5.11) to the topological case. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.78 (Codimension Formula)

Suppose X is a quasi-biequidimensional topological space. Then for every subset $Z \subset X$ which is irreducible and closed, and every closed subset $Y \subset Z$ the following relations hold.

$$\begin{aligned} \dim Z &= \dim Y + \operatorname{codim}(Y, Z) \\ \operatorname{codim} Y &= \operatorname{codim}(Y, Z) + \operatorname{codim} Z \end{aligned}$$

Further every closed subset is also quasi-biequidimensional.

Proof. This follows from (2.5.13) and (2.5.15). $\square$

Proposition 4.1.79

Suppose $X = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$. Then $\dim X = \sup_{i \in I} \dim U_i$.

Proof. By (4.1.64) a chain of irreducible closed subsets of U_i lifts to a chain of the same length in X . Therefore $\dim U_i \leq \dim X$ for all $i \in I$ whence $\sup_{i \in I} \dim U_i \leq \dim X$. Similarly given a chain of irreducible closed subsets

$$X_0 \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq X_n \subseteq X$$

choose i such that $X_0 \cap U_i \neq \emptyset$. Then (4.1.70) shows that this restricts to a chain of the same length in U_i . Therefore $\dim X \leq \dim U_i \leq \sup_{i \in I} \dim U_i$. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.80

Let X be a catenary topological space and $U \subset X$ an open subset. Then U is catenary.

Proof. Consider $Z \subset Y \subset U$ irreducible closed subsets. Then for any saturated chain

$$Z = Z_0 \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq Z_n = Y$$

we have by (4.1.64)

$$\overline{Z} = \overline{Z_0} \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq \overline{Z_n} = \overline{Y}$$

a saturated chain in X . As X is catenary we find $n = \text{codim}(\overline{Z}, \overline{Y})$. As the chain was arbitrary we find U is catenary. $\square$

Lemma 4.1.81

Suppose that X is a topological space and $x \in X$ is *quasi-closed*. Then $\dim \overline{\{x\}} = 0$.

Conversely suppose Z is an irreducible closed set of dimension 0. Then $Z = \overline{\{z\}}$ for all $z \in Z$ and Z consists of quasi-closed elements.

Proof. By (4.1.58) $\overline{\{x\}}$ is irreducible. Suppose $\emptyset \neq Z \subset \overline{\{x\}}$ is closed then $y \in Z \implies x \in \overline{\{y\}} \subset Z$ whence $\overline{\{x\}} = Z$. This shows that $\dim \overline{\{x\}} = 0$.

Conversely if $\dim Z = 0$ then $\overline{\{z\}} \subset Z$ is an irreducible subset for all $z \in Z$, whence they are equal. This also shows that z is quasi-closed. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.82

Let X be a Noetherian topological space and Z a closed subset. Then

$$\dim Z = 0 \iff Z = \overline{\{z_1\}} \cup \dots \cup \overline{\{z_n\}}$$

for some $z_1, \dots, z_n \in Z$ quasi-closed.

Proof. By (4.1.67) $Z = Z_1 \cup \dots \cup Z_n$ for Z_i is a decomposition into irreducible components. By (4.1.74).a) $\dim Z_i = 0$, so by (4.1.81) $Z_i = \overline{\{z_i\}}$.

Conversely $Z = \overline{\{z_1\}} \cup \dots \cup \overline{\{z_n\}}$ is a decomposition into irreducible closed subsets which are incomparable (4.1.81). By (4.1.62) these are the irreducible components. Therefore

$$\dim Z \stackrel{(4.1.74).a)}{=} \sup_i \dim \overline{\{z_i\}} \stackrel{(4.1.81)}{=} 0$$

$\square$

Proposition 4.1.83 (Curves have co-finite topology)

Let X be an irreducible, Noetherian and symmetric topological space such that $\dim X = 1$. Then X_0 has the cofinite topology.

Proof. We may reduce to the case $X = X_0$ is Kolmogorov, then by (4.1.43) every point $x \in X$ is closed.

Suppose $Z \subset X$ is finite then $Z = \bigcup_{z \in Z} \{z\}$ is a finite union of closed subsets and therefore closed. Conversely if $Z \subset X$ is closed and proper then by (4.1.74).f) $\dim Z = 0$ and therefore Z is finite by (4.1.82). $\square$

Proposition 4.1.84

Let X be a symmetric topological space. Then there is a correspondence

$$\begin{aligned} X_0 &\longleftrightarrow \{W \subset X \mid \dim W = 0 \text{ closed and irreducible}\} \\ x &\longrightarrow \overline{\{x\}} \end{aligned}$$

4.1.12 Product Topology

Definition 4.1.85 (Product Topology)

Let $\{X_i\}_{i \in I}$ be a family of topological spaces. The **product topology** is the topology generated by the base of open sets of the form

$$\prod_{i \in I} U_i$$

where $U_i \subset X_i$ is open and only finitely many are proper subsets of X_i .

Proposition 4.1.86

Let $\{X_i\}_{i \in I}$ be family of topological spaces. The family of sets given in (4.1.85) is a base. The topology generated is the smallest family of subsets for which the projection maps

$$\pi_i : \prod_{i \in I} X_i \rightarrow X_i$$

are continuous. Furthermore if each X_i is Hausdorff (resp. Kolmogorov), then so is the product.

Proposition 4.1.87 (Product of Sequences)

Let $X_1, \dots, X_m$ be a family of topological spaces and $a_n^i \rightarrow \alpha^i$ for $i = 1 \dots m$. Then $(a_n^1, \dots, a_n^m) \rightarrow (\alpha^1, \dots, \alpha^m)$.

Proposition 4.1.88 (Diagonal is Closed)

Let X be a topological space. Then X is Hausdorff if and only if $\{(x, x) \mid x \in X\}$ is closed in $X \times X$.

Proposition 4.1.89

Let $f, g : X \rightarrow Y$ be continuous maps and Y a Hausdorff space. Then

$$\{x \in X \mid f(x) = g(x)\}$$

is closed.

Proof. The level set is $(f \times g)^{-1}(\Delta_Y)$ which by (4.1.88) is closed. □

4.1.13 Quasi-Compactness

Definition 4.1.90 (Cluster Point of a Sequence)

Let (x_n) be a sequence in a topological space X . We say that $x \in X$ is

- a) a **cluster point** (or **accumulation point**) of x_n if for every $U \in \mathcal{O}_x$ the set $\{m \in \mathbb{N} \mid x_m \in U\}$ is infinite
- b) a **subsequential limit** of x_n if there exists some subsequence $x_{n_k} \rightarrow x$

In general the latter implies the former, and if X is first countable the concepts are equivalent as we will see.

Lemma 4.1.91 (Cluster Point is Subsequential Limit Point)

Let X be a first countable topological space and x a cluster point of a sequence (x_n) . Then there exists some subsequence x_{n_k} such that $x_{n_k} \rightarrow x$.

Proof. Let (U_n) be a local base at x . By replacing it with $U'_n := U_1 \cap \dots \cap U_n$ we may assume it is without loss of generality decreasing. Define $n_0 = 0$ and n_k inductively by

$$n_k := \min\{m > n_{k-1} \mid x_m \in U_k\}$$

which is well-defined precisely because x is a cluster point. Then $x_{n_k} \in U_k$ which shows that $x_{n_k} \rightarrow x$ as required. □

Definition 4.1.92

Let X be a topological space. We say it is

- a) **Quasi-Compact** if every open cover of X has a finite subcover
- b) **Countably Quasi-Compact** if every countable open cover of X has a finite subcover
- c) **Sequentially Quasi-Compact** if every sequence (x_n) in X has a convergent subsequence

If in addition X is Hausdorff (e.g. a metric space) we say that X is compact (resp. countably compact, sequentially compact).

Proposition 4.1.93 (Criteria for Countable Compactness)

Let X be a topological space. Then the following are equivalent

- a) X is countably quasi-compact

- b) Let $\{Z_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ be a countable collection of closed subsets such that every finite set has non-empty intersection. Then the intersection $\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} Z_n$ is non-empty
- c) For every increasing sequence of proper open subsets

$$U_1 \subseteq U_2 \subseteq \dots \subseteq U_n \subseteq \dots$$

the union $\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} U_n$ is proper.

- d) For every decreasing sequence of non-empty closed subsets

$$Z_1 \supseteq Z_2 \supseteq \dots \supseteq Z_n \supseteq \dots$$

the intersection $\bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} Z_n$ is non-empty

Proof. a) $\iff$ b) and c) $\iff$ d) are simple consequences of De Morgan's laws. For a) $\implies$ c) suppose $\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} U_n = X$ then by assumption $U_{n_1} \cup \dots \cup U_{n_k} = X$, and by the increasing assumption $U_{n_k} = X$ which is a contradiction.

For c) $\implies$ a), suppose we have an open cover $X = \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} U_n$ define the increasing open cover

$$U'_n := \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$$

by the contrapositive U'_n is not proper for some n , which means precisely that there is a finite subcover. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.94

Let X be a topological space. Then sequentially quasi-compact $\implies$ countably quasi-compact. Under the assumption of first countability the converse holds.

Proof. $\implies$) Consider a countable open cover $X = \bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} U_n$ with no finite subcover. Then there exists $x_n \in X \setminus \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$. By assumption there is a convergent subsequence $x_{n_k} \rightarrow x$. We have $x \in U_N$ for some N but $n_k \geq N \implies x_{n_k} \notin U_N$.

$\Leftarrow$) Consider a sequence (x_n) and define

$$Z_n := \overline{\{x_k : k > n\}}$$

which is a decreasing sequence of non-empty closed subsets. By the countable compactness criteria (4.1.93) $Z := \bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} Z_n$ is non-empty. However we may show this is precisely the set of cluster points of (x_n) , i.e. there exists a cluster point $x \in Z$. By (4.1.91) there exists a subsequence such that $x_{n_k} \rightarrow x$ as required. $\square$

Lemma 4.1.95 (Lindelof Lemma)

Let X be a second countable topological space. Then every open cover has a countable subcover.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a countable base and $\{U_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}}$ an open cover of X . Note for every U_α we have some subfamily $\mathcal{B}_\alpha \subset \mathcal{B}$ such that $U_\alpha = \bigcup \mathcal{B}_\alpha$. Consider $\mathcal{B}' := \bigcup \{\mathcal{B}_\alpha \mid \alpha \in \mathcal{A}\} \subset \mathcal{B}$. By definition for every $V \in \mathcal{B}'$ we have $V \subset U_\alpha$ for some $\alpha \in \mathcal{A}$. In other words there exists a map $f : \mathcal{B}' \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$ such that $V \subset U_{f(V)}$. We may verify that $\{U_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in \text{Im}(f)}$ is a countable subcover. $\square$

We summarise the relationships between the concepts

Proposition 4.1.96

Let X be a topological space. Then

- a) Quasi-Compact, Sequentially Quasi-Compact $\implies$ Countably Quasi-compact
- b) First Countable and (Countably) Quasi-Compact $\implies$ Sequentially Quasi-Compact
- c) Second Countable and Countably or Sequentially Quasi-Compact $\implies$ Quasi-Compact

Proof. a) The first implication is obvious and the second implication is (4.1.94)

b) This is (4.1.94)

c) This follows from (4.1.95) and a)

$\square$

Proposition 4.1.97 (Compact subsets of Hausdorff Spaces are Closed)

Let X be a Hausdorff topological space and $Y \subset X$ a subset compact with respect to the subspace topology. Then Y is closed.

Proof. Fix $x \in X \setminus Y$. Then for every $y \in Y$ by assumption there exists disjoint open subsets $x \in U_y$ and $y \in V_y$. Then $\{V_y \cap Y \mid y \in Y\}$ is an open cover for Y , so there exists a finite set of points $y_1, \dots, y_n$ such that $Y \subseteq V_{y_1} \cup \dots \cup V_{y_n}$. Furthermore

$$U := U_{y_1} \cap \dots \cap U_{y_n}$$

is an open neighbourhood of x disjoint from each V_{y_i} and therefore disjoint from Y . By (4.1.19) we see that $x \notin \overline{Y}$, which shows $Y = \overline{Y}$, i.e. Y is closed. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.98 (Closed subsets of Compact Spaces are Compact)

Let X be a quasi-compact topological space and $Y \subset X$ a closed subset. Then Y is quasi-compact under the subspace topology.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{U} := \{U_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}}$ be an open cover for Y . Then by definition $U_\alpha = U'_\alpha \cap Y$ where $U'_\alpha \subset X$ are open. Evidently

$$\mathcal{U}' : \{U'_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} \cup \{X \setminus Y\}$$

is an open cover of X . Therefore by assumption it has a finite subcover, which immediately yields a finite subcover of Y as required. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.99 (Image of a Compact Space is Compact)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map of topological spaces where X is quasi-compact. Then the image $f(X)$ is quasi-compact.

Further if Y is Hausdorff then f is an open map (i.e. $f(U)$ is open for every open $U \subset X$). If in addition f is injective then it is a homeomorphism onto its image.

Proof. We may assume without loss of generality that $f(X) = Y$. Let $\{U_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}}$ be an open cover of Y . In other words $f(X) \subseteq \bigcup_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} U_\alpha \implies X \subseteq \bigcup_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} f^{-1}(U_\alpha)$. By assumption we have a finite subcover

$$X \subseteq f^{-1}(U_{\alpha_1}) \cup \dots \cup f^{-1}(U_{\alpha_n})$$

which implies

$$f(X) \subseteq U_{\alpha_1} \cup \dots \cup U_{\alpha_n}$$

since f is assumed to be surjective, and we see that $f(X)$ is compact. $\square$

Analogously we have similar results for sequentially compact spaces, which may be conceptually simpler.

Proposition 4.1.100

Let X be a first countable Kolmogorov space and $Y \subset X$ a subset of a sequentially compact with respect to the subspace topology. Then Y is closed.

Proof. Consider $x \in \overline{Y}$ then by (4.1.19) there is some sequence $x_n \rightarrow x$. Further by assumption there is some subsequence $x_{n_k} \rightarrow y \in Y$. By uniqueness of limits (4.1.48) we have $x = y$, and in particular $\overline{Y} = Y$ is closed. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.101

Let X be a sequentially compact topological space, and $Y \subset X$ a closed subset. Then Y is sequentially compact.

Proof. Let $x_n \in Y$ be a sequence. By assumption it has a convergent subsequence $x_{n_k} \rightarrow x$ where $x \in X$. By (4.1.18) x is an adherent point of Y and therefore lies in Y by (4.1.19). $\square$

Proposition 4.1.102

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map of topological spaces where X is sequentially compact. Then the image $f(X)$ is sequentially compact.

Proof. Let $y_n = f(x_n)$ be a sequence in $f(X)$. Then by assumption $x_{n_k} \rightarrow x$, and therefore by (...) $y_{n_k} \rightarrow f(x)$. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.103

Let X be a topological space with an open cover $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ such that U_i is quasi-compact under the subspace topology. Then X is quasi-compact.

Proof. Let $X = \bigcup_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} V_\alpha$ then $U_i = \bigcup_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} (V_\alpha \cap U_i)$. By assumption there is some finite subset $\mathcal{A}_i \subset \mathcal{A}$ such that $U_i = \bigcup_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}_i} (V_\alpha \cap U_i)$. Then

$$X = \bigcup_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}_1 \cup \dots \cup \mathcal{A}_n} V_\alpha$$

Therefore X is quasi-compact. $\square$

Proposition 4.1.104 (Noetherian $\iff$ Hereditarily Quasi-Compact)

Let X be a topological space. Then X is Noetherian if and only if every open subset is quasi-compact.

Proof. $\implies$) By (4.1.68) every open subset is Noetherian, so it is enough to show that X is quasi-compact. By definition the lattice of open subsets is Noetherian and by (2.1.62) this holds iff every family of open subsets has a maximal element.

Suppose that we have an open cover $X = \bigcup_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} U_\alpha$. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be the family of open subsets expressible as a finite union of sets U_α . By assumption it has a maximal element

$$U := U_{\alpha_1} \cup \dots \cup U_{\alpha_n}$$

Suppose that $U \subsetneq X$ is proper then choose $x \in X \setminus U$. By hypothesis there is some α_{n+1} such that $x \in U_{\alpha_{n+1}}$. Then $U \subsetneq U \cup U_{\alpha_{n+1}} \in \mathcal{F}$, contradicting maximality. Therefore $U = X$ and X is quasi-compact as required.

$\impliedby$) Omitted. □

4.1.14 Connectedness

Definition 4.1.105

We say a topological space X is **disconnected** if $X = U \cup V$ for two non-empty, disjoint open subsets U, V . Otherwise we say X is **connected**.

Proposition 4.1.106

Let X be a topological space. The following are equivalent

- a) X is connected
- b) The only subsets which are both open and closed are X and $\emptyset$

Proposition 4.1.107

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map and X connected. Then $f(X)$ is also connected.

4.1.15 Order Topology

Definition 4.1.108 (Order Topology)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a totally ordered set. Then the **order topology** is the topology generated by the subbase of half-open intervals

$$\{y \in X \mid y < x\} \text{ and } \{y \in X \mid y > x\}$$

for $x \in X$.

Proposition 4.1.109 (Base for order topology)

Let $(X, \leq)$ be a totally ordered set. Then the sets of the form

$$\{y \in X \mid y < x\}, \{y \in X \mid y > x\} \text{ and } \{y \in X \mid x < y < z\}$$

for $x, z \in X$ constitute a base for the order topology.

4.2 Sheaves

For what follows we assume $\mathcal{C}$ is an [algebraic category](#).

Definition 4.2.1

A $\mathcal{C}$ -valued sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ on a topological space X is a mapping

$$U \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}(U) \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$$

together with a collection of restriction morphisms $\rho_{UV} \in \text{Mor}(\mathcal{F}(U), \mathcal{F}(V))$, for any pair of open sets $V \subset U$ satisfying the following properties

a) $\rho_{VW} \circ \rho_{UV} = \rho_{UW}$. Write

$$\sigma|_V := \rho_{UV}(\sigma)$$

b) For any open set U , open cover $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$ and $\sigma, \tau \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ satisfying

$$\sigma|_{U_i} = \tau|_{U_i} \quad \forall i \in I$$

then $\sigma = \tau$.

c) Consider any open set U and any open covering $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$ and elements $\sigma_i \in \mathcal{O}_X(U_i)$ satisfying

$$\sigma_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = \sigma_j|_{U_i \cap U_j} \quad \forall i, j \in I$$

Then there exists an element $\sigma \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ such that $\sigma|_{U_i} = \sigma_i$. Moreover in this case the extension σ is unique.

Elements of $\mathcal{F}(U)$ are called sections.

If it only satisfies the first property, then it is called a “presheaf”. If it also satisfies the second then it is called a “separated presheaf”.

The following will be useful later

Definition 4.2.2 ($\mathcal{B}$ -sheaf)

Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a [base](#) for X , which is closed under finite intersection. We say a $\mathcal{B}$ -sheaf is a mapping

$$\mathcal{B} \ni U \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U)$$

which satisfies the sheaf axioms.

As before if it only satisfies the first property it is called a $\mathcal{B}$ -presheaf.

Definition 4.2.3 (Morphism of sheaves)

Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be (pre)-sheaves on a topological space X . The a morphism $\phi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ consists of a family of morphisms

$$\phi_U : \mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(U)$$

such that $\rho_{UV} \circ \phi_U = \phi_V \circ \rho_{UV}$ for all $V \subseteq U$ open. We say that

- ϕ is injective if ϕ_U is injective for all U
- ϕ is an isomorphism if ϕ_U is an isomorphism for all U (iff it has a two-sided inverse)

Definition 4.2.4 (Category of sheaves)

Let X be a topological space and $\mathcal{B}$ a base for X . Then we denote the category of presheaves by

$$\text{PSh}(X; \mathcal{B})$$

and the (full subcategory) of sheaves by

$$\text{Sh}(X; \mathcal{B})$$

When $\mathcal{B} = \mathcal{T}_X$ we may omit $\mathcal{B}$.

Definition 4.2.5 (Stalk of a (pre)sheaf)

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a $(\mathcal{B})$ -presheaf and $Z \subset X$ an irreducible subset. Define the stalk $\mathcal{F}_Z$ to be the *directed limit*

$$\mathcal{F}_Z := \varinjlim_{Z \cap U \neq \emptyset} \mathcal{F}(U)$$

under the directed system $\{\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(V)\}_{V \subseteq U}$. Note this is directed by (4.1.51).c) because open sets intersecting Z are closed under finite intersection. Explicitly this may be constructed as

$$\mathcal{F}_Z := \{(U, \sigma) \mid \sigma \in \mathcal{F}(U)\} / \sim$$

where $(U, \sigma) \sim (V, \tau)$ if there is an open set W such that $Z \subset W \subset U \cap V$ and $\sigma|_W = \tau|_W$. It comes equipped with a family of morphisms $\rho_{U,Z} : \mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_Z$ such that

$$\rho_{V,Z} \circ \rho_{U,V} = \rho_{U,Z}$$

Moreover for any open set U and family of morphisms $\{\phi_V : \mathcal{F}(V) \rightarrow A\}_{V \subseteq U}$ there is a unique morphism $\phi_Z : \mathcal{F}_Z \rightarrow A$ such that $\phi_U = \phi_Z \circ \rho_{U,Z}$.

As a special case we may consider $Z = \{x\}$ and write this as $\mathcal{F}_x$.

Lemma 4.2.6 (Lifting Stalks)

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a $\mathcal{B}$ -presheaf and $\sigma \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ and $\tau \in \mathcal{F}(V)$ be sections such that $x \in U \cap V$.

- Then $\sigma_x = \tau_x$ if and only if there is a neighbourhood $x \in W \subseteq U \cap V$ such that $\sigma|_W = \tau|_W$.
- If $\sigma_x = \tau_x$ for all $x \in U \cap V$, then there is an open cover $U \cap V = \bigcup_i U_i$ such that $\sigma|_{U_i} = \tau|_{U_i}$.
- If in addition $\mathcal{F}$ is separated then $\sigma|_{U \cap V} = \tau|_{U \cap V}$.

Proposition 4.2.7

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a $\mathcal{B}_1$ -presheaf on X , and $\mathcal{B}_2 \subseteq \mathcal{B}_1$ another base for the topology on X . Then there is a well-defined, canonical, isomorphism

$$\rho_x : (\mathcal{F}|_{\mathcal{B}_2})_x \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_x$$

It satisfies

$$[(U, \sigma)]_{x, \mathcal{B}_2} \rightarrow [(U, \sigma)]_{x, \mathcal{B}_1}$$

for all $U \in \mathcal{B}_2$ and $\sigma \in \mathcal{F}(U)$.

Proof. The given map is clearly well-defined because $\mathcal{B}_2 \subseteq \mathcal{B}_1$

Suppose $[(U, \sigma)] = [(V, \tau)]$ in $\mathcal{F}_x$ then by definition there exists an open set $W \in \mathcal{B}_1$ such that $x \in W$, $W \subset U \cap V$ such that $\sigma|_W = \tau|_W$. By (4.1.6) there is $W' \in \mathcal{B}_2$ such that $x \in W'$ and $W' \subseteq W$. As $\sigma|_{W'} = \tau|_{W'}$, this shows that $(U, \sigma) \sim (V, \tau)$ in $(\mathcal{F}|_{\mathcal{B}_2})_x$, and therefore ρ_x is injective.

Similarly consider $[(U, \sigma)] \in \mathcal{F}_x$ with $U \in \mathcal{B}_1$. By (4.1.6) there is $V \in \mathcal{B}_2$ such that $x \in V$ and $V \subseteq U$. Therefore $[(U, \sigma)] = [(V, \sigma|_V)]$ and the map is surjective. $\square$

Proposition 4.2.8

Let $\phi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism of $(\mathcal{B})$ -pre-sheaves then there exists a unique map on stalks

$$\phi_x : \mathcal{F}_x \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_x$$

such that $\phi(\sigma)_x = \phi_x(\sigma_x)$ for all $\sigma \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ and U neighbourhoods of x . Furthermore if $\psi : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{H}$ is another morphism of (pre-)sheaves then

$$\psi_x \circ \phi_x = (\psi \circ \phi)_x$$

Definition 4.2.9 (Push-forward sheaf)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map and $\mathcal{F}$ a sheaf on X . Then we may define the push-forward sheaf on Y by

$$(f_*\mathcal{F})(V) = \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}V)$$

Proposition 4.2.10 (Stalks on a push-forward sheaf)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map and $\mathcal{F}$ a sheaf on X . Then for $Z \subset Y$ irreducible there is a unique morphism

$$\rho_Z : (f_*\mathcal{F})_{f(Z)} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_Z$$

such that $\rho_Z(\sigma_{f(Z)}) = \sigma_Z$ for all $\sigma \in \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}V)$ and V nbhds of $f(Z)$.

Proposition 4.2.11 (Injective Morphism of Sheaves)

Let $\phi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism of sheaves on X . Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\phi_U : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is injective for all open sets $U \subset X$
- b) $\phi_x : \mathcal{F}_x \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_x$ is injective for all $x \in X$

Proposition 4.2.12 (Isomorphism of Sheaves)

Let $\phi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism of sheaves on X . Then the following are equivalent

- a) ϕ is an isomorphism in the category of sheaves
- b) $\phi_U : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is an isomorphism for all open subsets $U \subset X$
- c) $\phi_x : \mathcal{F}_x \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_x$ is an isomorphism for all $x \in X$

4.2.1 Sheafification**Proposition 4.2.13** (Sheafification)

Given a $\mathcal{B}$ -presheaf $\mathcal{F}$ define the sheafification $\mathcal{F}^+$ on $\mathcal{T}_X$ by

$$\mathcal{F}^+(U) := \{(s_x)_{x \in U} \mid \exists U_i \text{ s.t. } U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i \text{ and } \sigma_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i) \text{ s.t. } s_x \in \mathcal{F}_x \text{ s.t. } s_x = (\sigma_i)_x \quad \forall x \in U_i\}$$

We say the section s is determined by the sections $\{(U_i, \sigma_i)\}_{i \in I}$. This constitutes a functor

$$(-)^+ : \text{PSh}(X; \mathcal{B}) \rightarrow \text{Sh}(X)$$

Furthermore there is a natural transformation $\eta : \mathbf{1} \Rightarrow (-)^+|_{\mathcal{B}}$ given by

$$\begin{aligned} \eta : \mathcal{F} &\longrightarrow (\mathcal{F}^+)|_{\mathcal{B}} \\ \sigma &\longrightarrow (\sigma_x)_{x \in U} \end{aligned}$$

which is an isomorphism if and only if $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf. It satisfies a natural universal property, which may be formalised as saying that $(-)^+$ is *left-adjoint* to $(-)|_{\mathcal{B}}$, namely there is a natural bijection

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}(\mathcal{F}^+, \mathcal{G}) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Mor}(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}|_{\mathcal{B}}) \\ \alpha &\longrightarrow \alpha|_{\mathcal{B}} \circ \eta_{\mathcal{F}} \\ \epsilon_{\mathcal{G}} \circ \beta^+ &\longleftarrow \beta \end{aligned}$$

where we have used the counit natural transformation, which is in fact an isomorphism,

$$\begin{aligned} \epsilon_{\mathcal{G}} : (\mathcal{G}|_{\mathcal{B}})^+ &\xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{G} \\ (\rho_x(\sigma_x)) &\longleftarrow \sigma \end{aligned}$$

Finally there is an isomorphism of stalks which commutes with restrictions, namely for all $U \in \mathcal{B}$ and $x \in U$ there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{F}(U) & \xrightarrow{\eta_U} & \mathcal{F}^+(U) \\ \rho_x \downarrow & & \downarrow \rho_x \\ \mathcal{F}_x & \xrightarrow{\eta_x} & (\mathcal{F}^+)_x \end{array}$$

where the bottom arrow is uniquely determined by this condition.

Proof. $\mathcal{F}^+$ is clearly a sheaf. The fact $(-)^+$ is functorial follows from (4.2.8), namely $\alpha^+((s_x)) = (\alpha_x(s_x))$. It's well-defined for suppose s is determined by sections (U_i, σ_i) then $\alpha^+((s_x))$ is determined by the sections $(U_i, \alpha_{U_i}(\sigma_i))$.

In order to define η and ϵ first consider the following. Let $\mathcal{B}_2 \subseteq \mathcal{B}_1$ be bases for X , $\mathcal{F}$ a $\mathcal{B}_1$ -presheaf and $U \in \mathcal{B}_1$ an open subset. Then define the morphism

$$\begin{aligned} \Phi_{\mathcal{F}, U}^{\mathcal{B}_2} : \mathcal{F}(U) &\rightarrow (\mathcal{F}|_{\mathcal{B}_2})^+(U) & U \in \mathcal{B}_1 \\ \sigma &\rightarrow (\rho_x^{-1}(\sigma_x))_{x \in U} \end{aligned}$$

where we have used the isomorphism from (4.2.7) $\rho_x : (\mathcal{F}|_{\mathcal{B}_2})_x \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_x$.

We claim Φ is well-defined. For if $U \in \mathcal{B}_1$ there is an open cover $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$ with $U_i \in \mathcal{B}_2$. For any $\sigma \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ define $\sigma_i := \sigma|_{U_i}$. Then $x \in U_j$ for some j and $\sigma_x = [(U, \sigma)]_{x, \mathcal{B}_1} = [(U_j, \sigma_j)]_{x, \mathcal{B}_1}$ and therefore $\rho_x^{-1}(\sigma_x) = [(U_j, \sigma_j)]_{x, \mathcal{B}_2}$. In other words the given section is supported by $\{(U_i, \sigma_i)\}_{i \in I}$ as required.

We claim $\Phi_{\mathcal{F}, U}$ is an isomorphism for all U if and only if $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf. Suppose $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf, and $\rho_x^{-1}(\sigma_x) = \rho_x^{-1}(\tau_x)$ for all $x \in U$, then $\sigma_x = \tau_x$. By (4.2.6) we see $\sigma = \tau$. Therefore the mapping is injective.

Similarly let $(s_x) \in (\mathcal{F}|_{\mathcal{B}_2})^+(U)$ be determined by sections (U_i, σ_i) with $\sigma_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ and $U_i \in \mathcal{B}_2$. Then $s_x = [(U_i, \sigma_i)]_{x, \mathcal{B}_2} = [(U_j, \sigma_j)]_{x, \mathcal{B}_2}$ for all $x \in U_i \cap U_j$ so, applying ρ_x , $(\sigma_i)_x = (\sigma_j)_x$ for all $x \in U_i \cap U_j$. By (4.2.6) we see that $\sigma_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = \sigma_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$, so by hypothesis there is an element σ such that $\sigma|_{U_i} = \sigma_i$. In particular $\sigma_x = (\sigma_i)_x$ and $\rho_x^{-1}(\sigma_x) = \rho_x^{-1}((\sigma_i)_x) = s_x$ and the mapping is surjective as required.

Conversely suppose $\Phi_{\mathcal{F}, U}$ is an isomorphism for all U - TODO.

Finally we may define the unit and counit natural transformations as follows

$$\begin{aligned} \epsilon_{\mathcal{G}, U} &:= (\Phi_{\mathcal{G}, U}^{\mathcal{B}})^{-1} & U \in \mathcal{T}_X \\ \eta_{\mathcal{F}, U} &:= \Phi_{\mathcal{F}, U}^{\mathcal{B}} & U \in \mathcal{B} \end{aligned}$$

By abstract nonsense (2.6.52) we may show an adjoint relationship arising from η, ϵ if

- $\epsilon_{\mathcal{G}}|_{\mathcal{B} \circ \eta_{\mathcal{G}}|_{\mathcal{B}}} = 1_{\mathcal{G}|_{\mathcal{B}}}$
- The following map is injective

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}(\mathcal{F}^+, \mathcal{G}) &\rightarrow \text{Mor}(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}|_{\mathcal{B}}) \\ \alpha &\rightarrow \alpha|_{\mathcal{B} \circ \eta_{\mathcal{F}}} \end{aligned}$$

The first follows by definition of η and ϵ . The second is essentially because $\mathcal{G}$ is separated. For suppose α_1 and α_2 are two morphisms such that $\alpha_1|_{\mathcal{B} \circ \eta} = \alpha_2|_{\mathcal{B} \circ \eta}$. Consider a section $s(x) \in \mathcal{F}^+(U)$. Then it is supported by sections (σ_i, U_i) for $U_i \in \mathcal{B}$ and $\sigma_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$. This means precisely that $s|_{U_i} = \eta(\sigma_i)$. Then the assumption on α_1, α_2 shows that

$$\alpha_1(s)|_{U_i} = \alpha_1|_{U_i}(s|_{U_i}) = \alpha_2|_{U_i}(s|_{U_i}) = \alpha_2(s)|_{U_i}$$

Finally by the separatedness condition we have $\alpha_1 = \alpha_2$ and the given map is injective. This completes the requirements to show the adjoint relationship.

By the universal property of direct limits, the maps $\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^+(U) \rightarrow (\mathcal{F}^+)_x$ induce a map η_x making the diagram commute, given by $\eta_x(\sigma_x) = \eta(\sigma)_x$. If $\eta_x(\sigma_x) = \eta(\sigma)_x = \eta(\tau)_x = \eta_x(\tau_x)$ then by (4.2.6) there is a nbhd $x \in W$ such that $\eta(\sigma)|_W = \eta(\tau)|_W$ and in particular $\sigma_x = \eta(\sigma)(x) = \eta(\tau)(x) = \tau_x$ so the map is injective. Given $s_x \in (\mathcal{F}^+)_x$ then by (4.2.6) there is $x \in U$ and a corresponding section $s \in (\mathcal{F}^+)(U)$. By assumption there exists $x \in U_i \in \mathcal{B}$ and $\sigma \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ such that $s(y) = \sigma_y$ for all $y \in U_i$. In other words $s|_{U_i} = \eta_{U_i}(\sigma)$ and therefore $s_x = (s|_{U_i})_x = \eta_{U_i}(\sigma)_x = \eta_x(\sigma_x)$. Therefore the map is surjective. $\square$

Remark 4.2.14

This motivates the term “sheaf” namely we view it as a “bundle” of “stalks” and sections are “slices” through the sheaf. It's possible to impose a topology on $\coprod_{x \in X} \mathcal{F}_x$ such the sections of $\mathcal{F}^+$ are precisely the continuous maps $\sigma : U \rightarrow \coprod_{x \in U} \mathcal{F}_x$ with $\sigma(x) \in \mathcal{F}_x$.

We note a corollary, which may be proved more directly

Corollary 4.2.15

The functor

$$(-)|_{\mathcal{B}}: \mathrm{Sh}(X) \rightarrow \mathrm{PSh}(X; \mathcal{B})$$

is full and faithful.

Proof. This follows because it is a right-adjoint with a counit isomorphism by (2.6.51). $\square$

Corollary 4.2.16

There is an *equivalence of categories*

$$\mathrm{Sh}(X; \mathcal{B}) \xrightleftharpoons[(-)^+]{(-)|_{\mathcal{B}}} \mathrm{Sh}(X)$$

4.2.2 Inverse Image Functor**Definition 4.2.17** (Inverse Image Sheaf)

Let $f: X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map and $\mathcal{G}$ a presheaf on Y . We define as follows the **inverse image sheaf**

$$(f^{-1}\mathcal{G})(U) := \left\{ s: U \rightarrow \coprod_{x \in U} \mathcal{G}_{f(x)} \mid \forall x \in U \exists V \in \mathcal{O}_{f(x)} \text{ and } \sigma \in \mathcal{G}(V) \text{ s.t. } s(y) = \sigma_y \text{ for all } y \in f^{-1}(V) \right\}$$

By definition it is a sheaf. Furthermore we see there is a canonical isomorphism

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (f^{-1}\mathcal{G})_x & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{G}_{f(x)} \\ (U, s) & \rightarrow & s(x) \end{array}$$

4.3 Space with Functions

Definition 4.3.1 (Space with functions)

Let X be a topological space and $\mathcal{O}_X$ be a subsheaf of the $\bar{k}$ -valued functions on X (which is a sheaf of k -algebras). Then we say $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ is a **space with functions**. Additionally it's **local** if it satisfies the condition

- a) For every $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ we have $D(f) := \{f \neq 0\}$ is open and $\frac{1}{f} \in \mathcal{O}_X(D(f))$.

Note that the sheaf restriction maps $\rho_{UV} : \mathcal{O}_X(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(V)$ correspond simply to restrictions of functions.

In the latter case X is locally ringed space over k because $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is a local k -algebra with maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}$ consisting of stalks vanishing at x .

A **regular morphism** or **regular map** $(X, \mathcal{O}_X) \rightarrow (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ is a continuous function $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ such that

$$g \in \mathcal{O}_Y(U) \implies g \circ \phi \in \mathcal{O}_X(\phi^{-1}(U))$$

This determines a morphism of sheaves

$$\phi^\# : \mathcal{O}_Y \longrightarrow \phi_* \mathcal{O}_X$$

We say a regular morphism is **dominant** if $\phi(X)$ is dense in Y .

An isomorphism is a homeomorphism and induces an isomorphism of sheaves, or equivalently has a two-sided regular inverse.

Proposition 4.3.2

The composition of regular maps is well-defined and associative.

4.3.1 Local Rings

Definition 4.3.3 (Local Ring)

Let X be a local space with functions and $W \subset X$ an irreducible closed subset. Then we define the **local ring** at W to be (see (4.2.5))

$$\mathcal{O}_{X,W} := \varinjlim_{U \cap W \neq \emptyset} \mathcal{O}_X(U)$$

If $\overline{W} = \overline{W'}$ then $\mathcal{O}_{X,W} = \mathcal{O}_{X,W'}$, so for example $\mathcal{O}_{X,W} = \mathcal{O}_{X,\overline{W}}$.

It is a local ring with unique maximal ideal

$$\mathfrak{m}_{X,W} := \{[(V, \sigma)] \mid V \cap W \neq \emptyset, \sigma \in \mathcal{O}_X(V), \sigma(x) = 0 \forall x \in V \cap W\}$$

Define the **residue field**

$$k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}) := \mathcal{O}_{X,W} / \mathfrak{m}_{X,W}$$

In the case $W = \{x\}$ we write $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$, $\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}$ and $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x})$.

Proof. Consider $(V, \sigma) \in \mathcal{O}_{X,W} \setminus \mathfrak{m}_{X,W}$. Then by definition $D(\sigma) \cap W \neq \emptyset$ and $(D(\sigma), \sigma^{-1})$ is an explicit inverse. $\square$

Corollary 4.3.4 (Field of Rational Functions)

Let X be an irreducible space with functions. Then $\mathcal{O}_{X,X} =: k(X)$ is a field, which we call the **field of rational functions**.

Proposition 4.3.5 (Stalk Maps)

Suppose $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ is a regular morphism and $Z \subset \overline{\phi(W)}$. Then there exists a unique (local) k -algebra homomorphism $\phi_W : \mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ such that the following diagram commutes

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_Y(V) & \xrightarrow{\rho \circ \phi_V^\#} & \mathcal{O}_X(U) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} & \dashrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_{X,W} \end{array}$$

for all open sets $V \subset Y$ for which $V \cap Z \neq \emptyset$ and some $U \subset \phi^{-1}(V)$ for which $U \cap W \neq \emptyset$. This is functorial in the sense that

$$(\psi \circ \phi)_W = \psi_Z \circ \phi_W$$

Proof. If V meets Z then by (4.1.19) $\phi^{-1}(V)$ meets W . Therefore the vertical maps are well-defined. We define

$$\phi_W((V', \sigma)) := (\phi^{-1}(V'), \sigma \circ \phi)$$

and immediately verify it is well-defined and ensures the diagram commutes. $\square$

Proposition 4.3.6 (Stalk Maps II)

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of local spaces with functions. Suppose $y \in \overline{\{\phi(x)\}}$. Then there is a unique local algebra homomorphism $\phi_x : \mathcal{O}_{Y,\phi(x)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ making the following diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_Y(V) & \xrightarrow{\phi_V^\sharp} & \mathcal{O}_X(U) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathcal{O}_{Y,\phi(x)} & \dashrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \end{array}$$

for all open neighbourhoods V of $\phi(x)$ and some open neighbourhood $U \subset \phi^{-1}(V)$ of x . This is functorial in the sense that

$$(\psi \circ \phi)_x = \psi_{\phi(x)} \circ \phi_x$$

Proof. This follows immediately from (4.3.5). □

Proposition 4.3.7 (Stalk Maps Function Field)

Let X, Y be irreducible local spaces with functions and $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ a dominant regular morphism. Then there is a unique homomorphism $\phi_* : k(Y) \hookrightarrow k(X)$ making the following diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_Y(V) & \xrightarrow{\phi_V^\sharp} & \mathcal{O}_X(U) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ k(Y) & \xhookrightarrow[\phi_*]{} & k(X) \end{array}$$

for all non-empty open subsets $V \subset Y$ and some non-empty open subset $U \subset \phi^{-1}(V)$. This is functorial in the sense that

$$(\phi \circ \psi)_* = \psi_* \circ \phi_*$$

Proof. This follows immediately from (4.3.5) with $W = X$ and $T = Y$. □

Proposition 4.3.8

Let X be a local space with functions and Z, W be irreducible subsets such that $Z \subset \overline{W}$. Then there is a canonical homomorphism $\mathcal{O}_{X,Z} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ making the following diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_X(U) & & \\ \downarrow & \searrow & \\ \mathcal{O}_{X,Z} & \dashrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_{X,W} \end{array}$$

for all open subsets U of X meeting Z .

This holds in particular when X is irreducible we may take $W = X$ and $\mathcal{O}_{X,W} = k(X)$.

Proof. This follows immediately from (4.3.5) by considering the case $\phi = 1_X$. □

Proposition 4.3.9 (Stalk Maps under Specialisation)

Let X, Y be irreducible local spaces with functions, $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ a dominant regular morphism and $x \in X$ such that $y \in \overline{\{\phi(x)\}}$. Then for all neighbourhoods V of $\phi(x)$ we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_Y(V) & \xrightarrow{\phi_V^\sharp} & \mathcal{O}_X(\phi^{-1}(V)) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathcal{O}_{Y,y} & \xrightarrow{\phi_x} & \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ k(Y) & \xhookrightarrow[\phi_*]{} & k(X) \end{array}$$

Lemma 4.3.10 (Evaluation of Stalks)

Let X be a local space of functions and $x \in X$. Then there is a unique function

$$\text{ev}_x : k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}) \hookrightarrow \bar{k}$$

making the following diagram commute for all open neighbourhoods U of x

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
\mathcal{O}_X(U) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_{X,x} & \longrightarrow & k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}) \\
& & & & \downarrow \text{ev}_x \\
& \searrow \text{ev}_x & & & \bar{k}
\end{array}$$

This is functorial in the sense that for a regular morphism $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
k(\mathfrak{m}_{Y,\phi(x)}) & \xrightarrow{\phi_x} & k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}) \\
\downarrow \text{ev}_{\phi(x)} & & \downarrow \text{ev}_x \\
\bar{k} & \xlongequal{\quad} & \bar{k}
\end{array}$$

4.3.2 Open Immersions

Definition 4.3.11 (Open Immersion)

Let X, Y be spaces with functions. Then we say a regular map $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ is an **open immersion** if

- a) ϕ is an **open embedding**, and
- b) ϕ induces an isomorphism of sheaves

$$\phi_* (\mathcal{O}_Y|_{\phi(X)}) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_X$$

Proposition 4.3.12 (Open Subspace)

Let X be a (local) space of functions and $U \subset X$ an open subset. Then $(U, \mathcal{O}_X|_U)$ is a (local) space of functions which we call an **open subspace**. We may write $\mathcal{O}_U := \mathcal{O}_X|_U$.

The inclusion $i : U \hookrightarrow X$ is an open immersion and an open immersion $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ induces an isomorphism between X and the open subvariety $\phi(X)$.

Proposition 4.3.13

Let X be a space of functions and $V \subset U$ open subsets. Then $(V, \mathcal{O}_U|_V) = (V, \mathcal{O}_X|_V)$.

Proposition 4.3.14

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be an open embedding and $Z \subset Y$ closed. Then Z is irreducible iff $\phi^{-1}(Z)$ is irreducible.

In particular if Y is irreducible then so is X .

Proof. We may reduce to the case $X = U$ is an open subset of Y . Then it follows from (4.1.64) and (4.1.61). $\square$

Proposition 4.3.15

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular open embedding. Then the following are equivalent

- a) ϕ is an open immersion
- b) for every irreducible subset $W \subset X$ the canonical map

$$\mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,W}$$

is an isomorphism for all Z such that $\bar{Z} = \overline{\phi(W)}$

- c) b) holds for some Z such that $\bar{Z} = \overline{\phi(W)}$

In particular for all open subsets $V \subset Y$ and $U \subset \phi^{-1}(V)$ such that $U \cap W \neq \emptyset$ we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{O}_Y(V) & \xrightarrow{\phi^\#} & \mathcal{O}_X(U) \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow \\
\mathcal{O}_{Y,\phi(W)} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_{X,W}
\end{array}$$

Proof. b) $\implies$ a) By definition we may factor into a regular homeomorphism $X \xrightarrow{\sim} V \subset Y$. It is an isomorphism of spaces by (4.2.12).

a) $\implies$ b) We may reduce to the case that $X \subset Y$ is an open subset. Because an open subset of X intersects W if and only if it intersects Z we find that the map is bijective.

c) $\iff$ b) we simply observe that if $\bar{Z} = \bar{Z}'$ then the canonical maps are the same. $\square$

Proposition 4.3.16

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a dominant open immersion. If Y is irreducible, then so is X and the map

$$\phi_* : k(Y) \hookrightarrow k(X)$$

is an isomorphism.

In particular if X is irreducible and $U \subset X$ is a non-empty open subset, then there is a canonical isomorphism

$$k(X) \xrightarrow{\sim} k(U)$$

Proof. By (4.3.14) X is irreducible, so it is a special case of (4.3.15). $\square$

Proposition 4.3.17 (Stalk Maps under Open Immersions I)

Let X be a local space with functions, $U \subset X$ an open subset and $W \subset X$ a irreducible closed subset such that $U \cap W \neq \emptyset$. Then $U \cap W$ is an irreducible subset of U and we have canonical isomorphisms of stalks making the following diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_X(V) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_U(U \cap V) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathcal{O}_{X,W} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_{U,W \cap U} \end{array}$$

for all open $V \subset X$ for which $V \cap W \neq \emptyset$.

Proof. The inclusion $i : U \hookrightarrow X$ is an open immersion, so $U \cap W$ is irreducible by (4.1.64). This is then a special case of (4.3.15). $\square$

Lemma 4.3.18

Let U, Z be subsets of a topological space X , with U open. Then

$$\overline{Z} \cap U \subset \overline{Z \cap U}$$

Proof. Suppose $x \in \overline{Z} \cap U$ and V is an open subset containing x . Then $U \cap V$ is an open set containing x and therefore by (4.1.19) $Z \cap U \cap V \neq \emptyset$. As V was an arbitrary neighbourhood of x we conclude that $x \in \overline{Z \cap U}$. $\square$

Proposition 4.3.19 (Restricting Stalk Maps to Open Subspaces)

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of local space with functions. Suppose $U \subset X$ and $V \subset Y$ are open subsets such that $U \subset \phi^{-1}(V)$, and $W \subset X$, $Z \subset Y$ are irreducible subsets such that $Z \subset \phi(W)$ and $U \cap W \neq \emptyset$. Then $\phi(W \cap U) \subset \overline{Z \cap V}$ and there is a commutative cube for every open set $V' \subset V$ such that $V' \cap Z \neq \emptyset$ and $U' \subset \phi^{-1}(V')$ such that $U' \cap W \neq \emptyset$

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & \mathcal{O}_X(U') & \xrightarrow{\quad} & \mathcal{O}_U(U \cap U') & \\ & \uparrow \phi^\# & & \uparrow (\phi|_U)^\# & \\ \mathcal{O}_Y(V') & \xrightarrow{\quad} & \mathcal{O}_V(V') & & \\ & \downarrow & & \downarrow & \\ & \mathcal{O}_{X,W} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_{U,W \cap U} & \\ & \uparrow \phi_W & & \uparrow (\phi|_U)_{W \cap U} & \\ \mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_{V,Z \cap V} & & \end{array}$$

where the stalk isomorphisms are defined in (4.3.17) and $(\phi|_U)_{W \cap U}$ is the unique (local) homomorphism making the bottom square (or right side) commute

Proof. Observe by (4.3.18) that

$$\phi(W \cap U) \subset \phi(W) \cap V \subset \overline{Z \cap V} \subset \overline{Z \cap U}$$

which means the stalk map of $\phi|_U$ is well-defined. The sides of the cube are well-defined and commute by (4.3.17) and (4.3.5), and the top by definition. As the horizontal arrows are isomorphisms then we see that the bottom square commutes, and $(\phi|_U)_{W \cap U}$ is the unique homomorphism for which this is the case. $\square$

4.3.3 Closed Immersions

Definition 4.3.20 (Closed Immersion)

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of spaces with functions. We say that ϕ is a **closed immersion** if

- a) ϕ is a homeomorphism onto a closed subset $\phi(X)$ of Y
- b) For all $x \in X$ we have the induced map on stalks

$$\mathcal{O}_{Y, \phi(x)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X$$

is surjective.

Proposition 4.3.21 (Closed Subset Structure Sheaf)

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a space of functions and $Z \subset X$ a closed subset. Then there exists a unique sheaf of functions $\mathcal{O}_Z$ such that the inclusion $j : Z \rightarrow X$ is a closed immersion.

More precisely for $U \subset Z$ an open subset

$$\mathcal{O}_Z(U) := \{f : U \rightarrow \bar{k} \mid f(y) = g_i(y) \forall y \in Z \cap U_i \text{ for some } g_i \in \mathcal{O}_X(U_i) \text{ where } Z \cap \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i = U\}$$

Proof. Evidently j is a homeomorphism onto Z . We first show that j is regular. Suppose $g \in \mathcal{O}_X(U')$ then by definition we have $g \circ j \in \mathcal{O}_Z(j^{-1}(U')) = \mathcal{O}_Z(U' \cap Z)$.

Given $(V, f) \in \mathcal{O}_{Z, z}$ by taking a smaller open subset we may suppose that $f(y) = g(y)$ for all $y \in V$ for some $g \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ and $U \cap Z = V$. Then the image of (U, g) under the stalk map is $(U \cap Z, g \circ j)$ which is precisely (V, f) . Therefore the stalk map j_z is surjective for all $z \in Z$.

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf of functions for which j is a (regular) closed immersion and suppose $f \in \mathcal{O}_Z(U)$. Then $f|_{U_i \cap Z}(y) = g_i(y)$ for all $y \in Z \cap U_i$ and $g_i \in \mathcal{O}_X(U_i)$. By assumption $f|_{U_i \cap Z} = g_i \circ j \in \mathcal{F}(U_i \cap Z)$. By the sheaf condition we have $f \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ which shows $\mathcal{O}_Z$ is a subsheaf of $\mathcal{F}$.

We need to show that the inclusion of sheaves $\mathcal{O}_Z \hookrightarrow \mathcal{F}$ is an isomorphism. By (4.2.11) and (4.2.12) it is enough to show that it is surjective on stalks. However this follows by assumption by observing the composition $\mathcal{O}_{X, j(z)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{Z, z} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_z$ is surjective. $\square$

Remark 4.3.22

This can be defined formally as $j^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_X/\mathcal{I})$ where $\mathcal{I}$ is the presheaf of regular functions which vanish on Z . We show in Section 5.2.6 that this is consistent with the concept of affine subvariety.

Proposition 4.3.23

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of spaces with functions. Then the following are equivalent

- a) ϕ is a closed immersion
- b) $\phi(X)$ is closed and ϕ determines an isomorphism $X \xrightarrow{\sim} \phi(X)$ of spaces with functions using the structure defined in (4.3.21)

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) By definition $\phi(X)$ is closed and ϕ determines a homeomorphism onto $\phi(X)$. Let $Z := \phi(X)$ and $\mathcal{O}_Z$ denote the canonical structure sheaf. There is a well-defined map

$$\mathcal{O}_Z(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(\phi^{-1}(U))$$

which is injective, and therefore injective on stalks (4.2.11). By (4.2.12) we need only show that the map $\mathcal{O}_{Z, \phi(x)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X, x}$ is surjective. However by hypothesis the composite map

$$\mathcal{O}_{Y, \phi(x)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{Z, \phi(x)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_x$$

is surjective from which the result follows.

b) $\implies$ a) Evidently ϕ is a homeomorphism onto $\phi(X)$. Further we have a sequence of stalk maps

$$\mathcal{O}_{Y, \phi(x)} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_{\phi(X), \phi(x)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X, x}$$

where the first is surjective by (4.3.21) and the second is an isomorphism by assumption. Therefore the composite is surjective and ϕ is a closed immersion. $\square$

4.3.4 Locally Closed Subspace

Lemma 4.3.24 (Locally Closed Structure Sheaf)

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a space with functions, $(Z, \mathcal{O}_Z)$ a closed subset with canonical structure defined in (4.3.21) and $(U, \mathcal{O}_U)$ an open subset with canonical structure (4.3.12). Then

$$\mathcal{O}_Z|_{Z \cap U} = \mathcal{O}_U|_{Z \cap U}$$

4.3.5 Glueing

Proposition 4.3.25 (Patching Topologies)

Let $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ be a set with topologies given for each U_i . Suppose that for all $i, j = 1 \dots n$ the following properties hold

- $U_i \cap U_j$ is open in U_i , and
- the identity map $1 : U_i \cap U_j \rightarrow U_i \cap U_j$ is continuous with respect to the subspace topologies on U_i and U_j respectively.

Then there is a unique topology on X such that

- the U_i are open in X ,
- the topology on U_i coincides with the subspace topology from X

More precisely it is given by

$$\{U \subset X \mid U \cap U_i \text{ open in } U_i \text{ for all } i = 1 \dots n\}$$

Proposition 4.3.26 (Glueing Topologies)

Let $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ be a set together with bijections $\theta_i : U_i \xrightarrow{\sim} W_i$ where W_i are topological spaces. Suppose that for all $i, j = 1 \dots n$ the following properties hold

- $\theta_i(U_i \cap U_j)$ is open in W_i ,
- the map $\theta_{ij} := \theta_j \circ \theta_i^{-1} : \theta_i(U_i \cap U_j) \rightarrow \theta_j(U_i \cap U_j)$ is continuous.

Then there is a unique topology on X such that

- U_i are open in X ,
- θ_i is a homeomorphism with respect to the subspace topology on U_i for all $i = 1 \dots n$.

More precisely the topology is given by

$$\{U \subset X \mid \theta_i(U \cap U_i) \text{ is open in } W_i \text{ for all } i = 1 \dots n\}$$

Proposition 4.3.27 (Glueing Regular Maps)

Let X, Y be spaces with functions and $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ an open cover. Suppose there exists regular maps

$$\phi_i : (U_i, \mathcal{O}_X|_{U_i}) \rightarrow (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$$

which satisfy $\phi_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = \phi_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ for all $i, j = 1 \dots n$. Then there exists a unique map $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ such that $\phi|_{U_i} = \phi_i$, which is regular.

Proof. As a function ϕ is clearly well-defined and unique. It is continuous by (4.1.28). Suppose $g \in \mathcal{O}_Y(V)$ then by definition $(g \circ \phi)|_{\phi^{-1}(V) \cap U_i} = g \circ \phi_i \in \mathcal{O}_{U_i}(\phi^{-1}(V) \cap U_i) = \mathcal{O}_X(\phi^{-1}(V) \cap U_i)$. As $\mathcal{O}_X$ is a sheaf this shows that $g \circ \phi$ is regular as required. $\square$

Chapter 5

Algebraic Geometry

I develop theory of varieties over a non-algebraically closed field k which more closely resembles “Faisceaux algébriques cohérents” [Ser55] than say EGA, and therefore is a bit more elementary because the structure sheaf consists of functions into a single ambient field $\bar{k}$ (and perhaps psychologically because the underlying set consists of solutions to equations rather than Galois orbits of solutions). By dealing with irreducible subsets rather than just points then we can also avoid the use of generic points or a large ambient field of infinite transcendence degree. I summarise the features of this exposition versus other popular expositions from which I sourced the material / inspiration

Author	Book	Non-Algebraically Closed Field	Abstract Variety	Real Functions	Arithmetic Case
J.P. Serre	Faisceaux algébriques cohérents [Ser55]	No	Yes	Yes	No
J.S. Milne	Algebraic Geometry [Mil17]	No	Yes	No	No
R. Hartshorne	Algebraic Geometry [Har13, Chapter I]	No	No	Yes	No
George R. Kempf	Algebraic Varieties	No	Yes	Yes	No
A. Grothendieck	Éléments de géométrie algébrique	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
	These Notes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No

5.1 Affine Varieties

In order to generalise the usual notions to non-algebraically closed field, and develop a “coordinate-free” approach, we introduce the following concept

Definition 5.1.1

Let A be a finitely generated k -algebra and $\mathfrak{m}$ a maximal ideal. Recall (3.32.21) that $k(\mathfrak{m})/k$ is an algebraic (indeed finite) field extension, and we call it the **residue field** for $\mathfrak{m}$.

Now we may introduce the Zero-Loci and study relationships to ideals

Proposition 5.1.2 (Correspondence between Zero-Loci and Ideals)

Let $A = k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ be the polynomial ring in n -variables over a field k . For a set $S \subset k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ and an algebraic extension K/k define the **zero-locus**

$$V_K(S) := \{\alpha \in K^n \mid f(\alpha) = 0 \quad \forall f \in S\}.$$

Similarly for a subset $Y \subset K^n$ define

$$I_k(Y) := \{f \in A \mid f(y) = 0 \quad \forall y \in Y\}$$

The pair of maps V_K, I_k constitute a **Galois Connection**

$$\mathcal{I}(k[X_1, \dots, X_n]) \xrightleftharpoons[V_K]{I_k} \mathcal{P}(K^n)$$

namely they satisfy

1. V_K and I_k are order-reversing
2. $S \subseteq I_k(V_K(S))$
3. $Y \subseteq V_K(I_k(Y))$

Furthermore (omitting the subscripts)

4. $VIV = V$ and $IVI = I$
5. $I(Y)$ is a radical ideal and $\sqrt{\langle S \rangle} \subseteq I(V(S))$
6. $V(S) = V(\langle S \rangle) = V(\sqrt{\langle S \rangle})$ and $V(\mathfrak{a}) = V(\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}})$
7. $\bigcap_i V(S_i) = V(\bigcup_i S_i)$ and $\bigcap_i V(\mathfrak{a}_i) = V(\sum_i \mathfrak{a}_i)$
8. $\bigcap_i I(W_i) = I(\bigcup_i W_i)$
9. $V(\mathfrak{a}) \cup V(\mathfrak{b}) = V(\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}) = V(\mathfrak{ab})$
10. $V((0)) = K^n$ and $V(A) = \emptyset$

The sets of the form $V_K(\mathfrak{a})$ constitute the closed sets of a **topology** on K^n , denoted by $\text{Zar}_k(K^n)$. In this case we have the following form for the **topological closure**

$$V_K(I_k(Y)) = \overline{Y}$$

Furthermore

$$I_k(Y) = I_k(\overline{Y})$$

Proof. We make use of general results on Galois connections (Section 2.1.6), though many results may be shown more directly. The fact it's a Galois connection follows from (2.1.53).

1-3. These follow (2.1.49)

4. This follows from (2.1.51).

5. It's clear that $I(Y)$ is an ideal. It is radical because K is reduced (...). The second statement is straightforward.

6. This follows from (2.1.52) by considering the closure operators $\sqrt{\langle - \rangle}$ and $\langle - \rangle$.

7. The first equality follows from (2.1.54). The second equality follows from (3.4.28).
8. This follows from (2.1.54).
9. Observe that $\mathfrak{m}_x$ is prime (because K is an integral domain) and $x \in V(\mathfrak{a}) \iff \mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_x$. the result follows from (3.4.37) because $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_x \vee \mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_x \iff \mathfrak{a}\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_x \iff \mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_x$

The family of sets $\text{Zar}_k(K^n) := \text{Im}(V_K)$ constitute the closed sets of a topology precisely because they are closed under arbitrary intersections and finite unions. Furthermore by (2.1.51) $V_K \circ I_k$ is a closure operator with image precisely the closed sets. Therefore by (2.1.40)

$$(V_K \circ I_k)(Y) = \bigcap_{Y \subseteq Z \in \text{Zar}_k(K^n)} Z$$

which is the definition of the **topological closure**. The last statement follows by applying I_k and using 4.. □

For a fixed ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ we may vary the field K to obtain families of solutions in different fields.

Definition 5.1.3 (Algebraic Set and L -valued points)

Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ be a **radical** ideal. For every k -algebra R define the R -valued points by

$$V(\mathfrak{a})(R) := \{r \in R^n \mid f(r_1, \dots, r_n) = 0 \quad \forall f \in \mathfrak{a}\}$$

Definition 5.1.4 (Affine Variety)

Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ be a **radical** ideal. The family $X(-) := V(\mathfrak{a})(-)$ is called an **affine variety** to which we associate the **coordinate ring** $k[X] := k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}$, which is a reduced f.g. k -algebra. Note the elements of $k[X]$ may be regarded as R -valued functions on the R -valued points $X(R)$.

Note we may regard this as a functor, suppose we have compatible maps $i_{jk} : K_j/k \rightarrow K_k/k$ then these induce compatible maps

$$X(i_{jk}) : X(K_j) \rightarrow X(K_k)$$

Definition 5.1.5 (Residue Field)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and L/k a field extension. For a point $x \in X(L)$ define the **residue field** to be

$$k(x) := k[x_1, \dots, x_n] \subset L/k$$

and the degree of x to be

$$\deg(x) := [k(x) : k]$$

Furthermore we define

$$\mathfrak{M}_{X,x} := I_k(\{(x)\})$$

for $x \in X(L)$. When x is algebraic then $\deg(x)$ is finite and $\mathfrak{M}_{X,x} = \mathfrak{m}_x/\mathfrak{a}$ is maximal (3.32.21).

Remark 5.1.6

$\mathbb{A}_k^n := V((0))$ is an affine variety and $\mathbb{A}_k^n(L) = L^n$.

Proposition 5.1.7 (Rational Points are Algebra Homomorphisms)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and R a k -algebra. Then there is a bijection

$$\{x \in X(R)\} \longleftrightarrow \text{AlgHom}_k(k[X], R)$$

Proof. Given $x \in X(R)$ then the evaluation map $\text{ev}_x : k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \rightarrow R$ contains $\mathfrak{a}$ by definition and therefore (3.11.3) yields a unique map $\phi_x : k[X] \rightarrow R$ such that $\phi_x(\bar{X}_i) = x_i$.

Similarly given an algebra homomorphism $\phi : k[X] \rightarrow R$ we may define $x = (\phi(\bar{X}_1), \dots, \phi(\bar{X}_n))$. Then by uniqueness these are mutual inverses. □

For completeness we also consider affine subvarieties in the same way as before

Proposition 5.1.8 (Affine subvarieties)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ be an affine variety and $A := k[X]$ the coordinate ring. For any ideal $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft A$ and field extension K/k define the **zero-locus** by

$$V_K(\mathfrak{b}) := \{(x) \in X(K) \mid f(x) = 0 \quad \forall f \in \mathfrak{b}\}$$

Similarly for a subset $Y \subset X(K)$ define

$$I_k(Y) := \{f \in k[X] \mid f(x) = 0 \quad \forall x \in Y\}$$

Suppose $\pi : k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \rightarrow k[X]$ is the quotient map. Then we have the following properties

$$\begin{aligned} V_K(\mathfrak{b}) &= V_K(\pi^{-1}(\mathfrak{b})) \cap X(K) \\ I_k(Y \cap X(K)) &= \pi(I_k(Y)) \quad Y \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n(K) \\ I_k(V_K(\mathfrak{b})) &= \pi(I_k(V_K(\pi^{-1}(\mathfrak{b})))) \end{aligned}$$

The pair (V_K, I_k) satisfies the same properties as (...). The image of V_K forms the closed sets of a topology on $X(K)$ which coincides with the subspace topology from $\mathbb{A}_k^n(K)$.

We may now generalize the Weak Nullstellensatz to arbitrary affine varieties and non-algebraically closed fields K/k .

Proposition 5.1.9 (Galois Group Action)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and K/k a normal algebraic field extension (e.g. $\bar{k}$). There is a well-defined group action

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Aut}(K/k) \times X(K) &\rightarrow X(K) \\ (\sigma, (x_1, \dots, x_n)) &\rightarrow (\sigma(x_1), \dots, \sigma(x_n)) \end{aligned}$$

For $x, y \in X(K)$ the following are equivalent

- a) x and y are topologically indistinguishable
- b) $x = \sigma(y)$ for some $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(K/k)$
- c) $x \in \overline{\{y\}}$
- d) $y \in \overline{\{x\}}$
- e) $\overline{\{x\}} = \overline{\{y\}}$
- f) $\mathfrak{M}_{X,x} = \mathfrak{M}_{X,y}$

For every point x we have

$$V_K(\mathfrak{M}_{X,x}) = \overline{\{x\}} = \{\sigma(x) \mid \sigma \in \text{Aut}(K/k)\}$$

and x is quasi-closed (4.1.81) and therefore $X(K)$ is *symmetric*. Denote the set of Galois Orbits by $X_0(K)$ then the quotient map

$$\pi : X(K) \rightarrow X_0(K)$$

is precisely the Kolmogorov Quotient (4.1.35) and in particular a quasi-homeomorphism.

Proof. Given $F \in \mathfrak{a}$ we have $\sigma(F(x)) = F(\sigma(x))$. This shows that $x \in X(K) \implies \sigma(x) \in X(K)$. Further it's clear that $\sigma(\tau(x)) = (\sigma \circ \tau)(x)$ so the group action is well-defined.

By (4.1.33) a) $\iff$ e) $\implies$ c), d). By (5.1.2) $V(\mathfrak{M}_{X,x}) = \overline{\{x\}}$ and $I(\overline{\{x\}}) = \mathfrak{M}_{X,x}$. So e) $\iff$ f). Suppose $\mathfrak{M}_{X,x} = \mathfrak{M}_{X,y}$ then this means there exists an isomorphism $k(x) \cong k(y) \subset K$ which lifts to an element of $\text{Aut}(K/k)$ by (3.18.81), so f) $\implies$ b). Conversely b) $\implies$ f) is straightforward. If $x \in \overline{\{y\}} = V(\mathfrak{M}_{X,y})$ then $\mathfrak{M}_{X,y} \subset \mathfrak{M}_{X,x}$ whence they are equal by maximality, so c), d) $\implies$ f). $\square$

Corollary 5.1.10

Let k be an algebraically closed field and X an affine variety. Then $X(k)$ is a Kolmogorov topological space.

Proposition 5.1.11 (Generalized Weak Nullstellensatz)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety. There is a bijection between maximal ideals and Galois orbits of points

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Specm}(k[X]) &\longleftrightarrow X_0(\bar{k}) = X(\bar{k})/\text{Aut}(\bar{k}/k) \\ \mathfrak{M} &\longrightarrow [V_K(\mathfrak{M})] \\ \mathfrak{M}_{X,x} &\longleftarrow [x] \end{aligned}$$

Proof. We may deduce this from (3.32.24) by observing that $x \in X(\bar{k}) \iff \mathfrak{a} \subset \mathfrak{m}_x$, $\mathfrak{M}_{X,x} = \mathfrak{m}_x/\mathfrak{a}$ and using the correspondence of ideals of quotient ring (3.4.56)

$$\{\mathfrak{M} \in \text{Specm}(k[X_1, \dots, X_n]) \mid \mathfrak{a} \subset \mathfrak{M}\} \longleftrightarrow \text{Specm}(k[X]).$$

$\square$

Lemma 5.1.12 (Rabinowitsch Trick)

Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A$ and $f \in A$. Consider the ring $B = A[Y]$. If $\mathfrak{a}B + (1 - Yf) = B$ then $f \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$.

Proof. The hypothesis implies

$$1 = (1 - Yf)g(Y) + ah(Y)$$

for $a \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $h(Y) \in A[Y]$. Consider the quotient map $\bar{\cdot} : A \rightarrow A/\mathfrak{a}$ and the corresponding map $A[Y] \rightarrow (A/\mathfrak{a})[Y]$. Applying this to the above shows $1 - Y\bar{f}$ is invertible in $(A/\mathfrak{a})[Y]$. So by (3.9.4) $\bar{f}$ is nilpotent in $(A/\mathfrak{a})$ whence $f \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$. $\square$

Proposition 5.1.13 (Strong Nullstellensatz)

Let X be an affine variety and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X]$. Then

$$I_k V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{a}) = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}^J = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$$

In particular the $\bar{k}$ -radical ideals are precisely the radical ideals. and there is a dual isomorphism

$$\text{Rad}(k[X]) \longleftrightarrow \text{Zar}_k(X(\bar{k}))$$

Proof. Observe that $x \in V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{a})$ if and only if $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{M}_{X,x}$. Therefore

$$I_k(V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{a})) = \bigcap_{x \in V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{a})} I_k(\{x\}) = \bigcap_{\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{M}_{X,x}} \mathfrak{M}_{X,x}$$

Therefore by the correspondence in (5.1.11) this is equal to precisely $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}^J$.

For the second equality we consider first the case $X = \mathbb{A}_k^n$ and $k[X] = k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$. Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X]$ and choose $f \in I_k V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{a})$. Consider the ring $B := k[X_1, \dots, X_n, Y]$ and the ideal $\tilde{\mathfrak{a}} = \mathfrak{a}B + (1 - Yf)$. Clearly this has no zeros in $\bar{k}^{n+1}$, so by the Weak Nullstellensatz (3.32.24) it is not proper. By the (5.1.12) $f \in \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$ as required. The reverse inclusion is clear.

Now suppose that $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$, $k[X] = k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft k[X]$ is proper. Using (5.1.8) and (3.4.50) together with the result just proven, shows

$$I_k(V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{b})) = \pi(I_k V_{\bar{k}}(\pi^{-1}\mathfrak{b})) = \pi(\sqrt{\pi^{-1}(\mathfrak{b})}) = \sqrt{\mathfrak{b}}$$

where $\pi : k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \rightarrow k[X]$ is canonical surjective morphism. $\square$

Corollary 5.1.14

Let $k[X]$ be any finitely generated reduced k -algebra, then $k[X]$ is a *Jacobson ring*, i.e.

$$\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}^J$$

In particular the intersection of all maximal ideals is zero

$$\bigcap_{\mathfrak{m}} \mathfrak{m} = 0$$

5.1.1 Topological Properties

Proposition 5.1.15 (Principal Open Sets)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety over k . For every $f \in k[X]$ the sets

$$D(f) := X(\bar{k}) \setminus V_{\bar{k}}((f)) = \{(x) \in X(\bar{k}) \mid f(x) \neq 0\}$$

form a base for the Zariski topology $\text{Zar}_k(X(\bar{k}))$.

Proof. Let $U = X(\bar{k}) \setminus V(\mathfrak{b})(\bar{k})$ be a non-empty open set. For every $x \in U$ there by definition exists $f \in \mathfrak{b}$ such that $f(x) \neq 0$. Therefore $D(f)$ is a neighbourhood of x in the Zariski topology. $\square$

The topological notion of irreducibility is important, and may be reduced to a purely algebraic statement on the coordinate ring.

Proposition 5.1.16 (Criterion for Irreducibility)

Let X be an affine variety (e.g. $\mathbb{A}_k^n$) and $Y = V(\mathfrak{b})$ an affine subvariety corresponding to a radical ideal $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft k[X]$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $Y(\bar{k})$ is an irreducible subset of $X(\bar{k})$

- b) $Y_0(\bar{k})$ is an irreducible subset of $X_0(\bar{k})$
- c) $\mathfrak{b}$ is prime
- d) $k[Y]$ is an integral domain.

Proof. Suppose X is not irreducible. Then we have $X \subseteq V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{b}) \cup V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{c})$ a non-trivial decomposition into closed subsets (and associated ideals). Then by the dual isomorphism we have also $\mathfrak{a} \subsetneq \mathfrak{b}$ and we may choose $f \in \mathfrak{b} \setminus \mathfrak{a}$ and similarly $g \in \mathfrak{c} \setminus \mathfrak{a}$. However fg vanishes on $X(\bar{k})$ and so we have $fg \in \mathfrak{a}$. Therefore $\mathfrak{a}$ is not prime.

Conversely suppose X is irreducible and $\mathfrak{b}\mathfrak{c} \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$. Then $X \subseteq V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{b}) \cup V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{c})$. By irreducibility we have $X \subseteq V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{b})$, whence applying $I_{\bar{k}}(-)$ we see $\mathfrak{b} \subseteq I_{\bar{k}}V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{b}) \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$ (since $\mathfrak{a}$ is radical). Therefore $\mathfrak{a}$ is prime. $\square$

When $W \subset X$ is an irreducible subset then write $\mathfrak{M}_{X,W} := I(W)$, by the previous result this equals $I(\overline{W})$ and $\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}$ is a prime ideal.

Proposition 5.1.17

Let X be an affine variety, W, Z be subsets of $X(\bar{k})$. Then

$$W \subset \overline{Z} \iff \mathfrak{M}_{X,Z} \subset \mathfrak{M}_{X,W}$$

and

$$\overline{W} = \overline{Z} \iff \mathfrak{M}_{X,Z} = \mathfrak{M}_{X,W}$$

Proof. Observe that $V(\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}) = \overline{W}$ by (5.1.2). Therefore the result follows immediately from the same result. $\square$

Proposition 5.1.18 (Points are Closed)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and $x \in X(\bar{k})$. Then

$$\overline{\{x\}} = V(\mathfrak{M}_{X,x}) = \{\sigma(x) \mid \sigma \in \text{Aut}(\bar{k}/k)\}$$

is irreducible and finite of order $[k(x) : k]_s$. Further X is a *symmetric space*.

Proof. The equalities are proven in (5.1.9). Further $\overline{\{x\}}$ is irreducible by (4.1.58). We may replace $\text{Aut}(\bar{k}/k)$ with $\text{Mor}_k(k(x), \bar{k})$ to determine the order.

Clearly X is symmetric because it satisfies criteria (4.1.39).b). $\square$

Proposition 5.1.19 (Closed sets $\longleftrightarrow$ radical ideals)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety. Recall (5.1.13) there is a dual lattice isomorphism between radical ideals and “Zariski”-closed subsets of $X(\bar{k})$ (and indeed $X_0(\bar{k})$).

$$\text{Rad}(k[X]) \xleftrightarrow[V_{\bar{k}}(-)]{I_{\bar{k}}(-)} \text{Zar}_k(X(\bar{k}))$$

Under this isomorphism we have

- maximal ideals correspond to $\text{Aut}(\bar{k}/k)$ -orbits of $X(\bar{k})$ (or elements of $X_0(\bar{k})$)
- prime ideals of $k[X]$ correspond to irreducible subsets of $X(\bar{k})$ (and therefore of $X_0(\bar{k})$)
- minimal prime ideals of $k[X]$ correspond to *irreducible components* of $X(\bar{k})$ (and therefore of $X_0(\bar{k})$)

Recall that prime ideals are precisely the *meet-prime* radical ideals and irreducible subsets are precisely the *join-prime* closed subsets (see (4.1.52)). Therefore we have a dual isomorphism between the *Krull Lattice* of radical ideals of $k[X]$ and the Krull Lattice of closed subsets of $X(\bar{k})$.

Proof. The content of the Strong Nullstellensatz is precisely that $I_{\bar{k}}(-) \circ V_{\bar{k}}(-) = \mathbf{1}$. The other direction was already proven so we have a dual order isomorphism. The statement about maximal ideals was already shown in (5.1.11) and prime ideals in (5.1.16). Then as irreducible components are precisely maximal irreducible subsets the final statement follows from the dual order isomorphism. $\square$

Corollary 5.1.20

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety. There is a bijective correspondence between affine subvarieties of X and closed subsets of $X(\bar{k})$.

Definition 5.1.21 (Irreducible Affine Variety)

We say an affine variety $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ is **integral** or **irreducible** if the topological space $X(\bar{k})$ is irreducible.

This is the case precisely when $\mathfrak{a}$ is prime, or when $k[X]$ is an integral domain by (5.1.19), or equivalently irreducible (3.4.67), since it is assumed to be reduced.

Note trivially that $\mathbb{A}_k^n$ is irreducible.

Proposition 5.1.22 (Decomposition into Irreducible Components)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety then the topological space $X(\bar{k})$ is **Noetherian**. Furthermore it has finitely many irreducible components X_i and the decomposition

$$X(\bar{k}) = X_1 \cup \dots \cup X_n$$

is the unique **incomparable** decomposition into irreducible closed subsets.

Proof. By Hilbert's Basis Theorem (3.14.7) $k[X]$ is a Noetherian ring, so by (5.1.19) $X(\bar{k})$ is **Noetherian**. The result then follows from (4.1.67) $\square$

Proposition 5.1.23 (Subspace Topology)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ an affine variety and $Y = V(\mathfrak{b})$ an affine subvariety. Then there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \left\{ \mathfrak{c} \in \text{Rad}(k[X]) \mid \mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{c} \right\} & \xrightleftharpoons[I]{V} & \left\{ Z \in \text{Zar}_k(X(\bar{k})) \mid Z \subseteq Y(\bar{k}) \right\} \\ \pi^{-1} \uparrow \downarrow \pi & & \parallel \\ \text{Rad}(k[X]/\mathfrak{b}) & \xrightleftharpoons[I]{V} & \text{Zar}_k(Y(\bar{k})) \end{array}$$

under which prime ideals correspond to irreducible subsets and the horizontal arrows induce dual isomorphisms.

In particular the subspace topology for $Y(\bar{k})$ coincides with the Zariski topology.

Proof. The left hand arrows are mutual inverses by (3.4.56). The horizontal maps are dual isomorphisms by (5.1.19). The equality then follows from (5.1.8). $\square$

Proposition 5.1.24

Let X be an affine variety. The correspondence between points and ideals (5.1.11) restricts as follows

$$\text{Specm}(k[X]_f) \longleftrightarrow \{ \mathfrak{M} \in \text{Specm}(k[X]) \mid f \notin \mathfrak{M} \} \longleftrightarrow D(f)_0 := D(f) / \text{Aut}(\bar{k}/k)$$

More precisely a point $x \in D(f)$ corresponds to the maximal ideal $(\mathfrak{M}_{X,x})_f$ of $k[X]_f$.

Proof. For the first correspondence consider the localisation map $i : k[X] \rightarrow k[X]_f$. By (3.7.25) the extension of a maximal ideal not containing f is maximal. Conversely i satisfies the hypotheses of (3.32.27) so the inverse image of a maximal ideal is maximal. This shows the inverse image of a maximal ideal is maximal, not containing f . Therefore the correspondence of prime ideals (3.7.30) restricts to maximal ideals.

The second correspondence is immediate from (5.1.11) because $f \notin \mathfrak{M}_{X,x} \iff f(x) \neq 0$. $\square$

5.1.2 Structure Sheaf**Definition 5.1.25** (Sheaf of Regular Functions)

Let X be an affine variety, $U \subset X(\bar{k})$ an open subset and $f : U \rightarrow \bar{k}$. We say that f is **regular** if for every $x \in U$ there exists $g, h \in k[X]$ and an open neighbourhood V of x such that

$$f(y) = \frac{g(y)}{h(y)} \quad \forall y \in V$$

We denote the **structure sheaf** by

$$\mathcal{O}_X(U) := \{ f : U \rightarrow \bar{k} \mid f \text{ regular} \}$$

which is a sheaf of k -algebras.

If $U \subset X$ is an open subset then we denote the structure sheaf by the restriction

$$\mathcal{O}_U := \mathcal{O}_X|_U$$

Proposition 5.1.26 (Sections are localisation of coordinate ring)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and $f \in k[X]$. There is a canonical isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \rho_f : k[X]_f &\xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_X(D(f)) \\ \frac{g}{f^n} &\longrightarrow \frac{g(-)}{f(-)^n} \end{aligned}$$

Furthermore $D(g) \subseteq D(f) \iff S_f \subseteq \overline{S_g}$ and we have the following commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k[X]_f & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_X(D(f)) \\ i_{S_f S_g} \downarrow & & \downarrow (-)|_{D(g)} \\ k[X]_g & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_X(D(g)) \end{array}$$

In particular there is a canonical isomorphism

$$k[X] \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_X(X)$$

Proof. The map is trivially well-defined and injective. Consider a regular map $\sigma \in \mathcal{O}_X(D(f))$. Consider the ideal

$$\mathfrak{a} := \{g \in k[X] \mid g\sigma \in \text{Im}(i_f)\}$$

It is enough to show $f \in \mathfrak{a}$. Suppose $f \notin \mathfrak{a}$ then it's contained in a maximal ideal which is of the form $\mathfrak{M}_{X,x}$ for some $x \in X(\bar{k})$ by (5.1.11). By definition $x \in D(f)$ and there is an open neighbourhood $W \subseteq D(f)$ and elements $h_1, h_2 \in k[X]$ such that

$$\sigma(y) = \frac{h_1(y)}{h_2(y)} \quad \forall y \in W$$

Choose $h_3 \in k[X]$ such that $x \in D(h_3) \subseteq W$ then clearly

$$\sigma(y) = \frac{(h_1 h_3)(y)}{(h_2 h_3)(y)} \quad \forall y \in D(h_3)$$

and in particular $(h_2 h_3 \sigma)(y) = (h_1 h_3)(y)$ for all $y \in D(f)$. Therefore $h_2 h_3 \in \mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_x$ which implies $h_2(x) = 0$ or $h_3(x) = 0$ a contradiction.

Therefore $f \in \mathfrak{a}$ and clearly $\sigma \in \text{Im}(i_f)$ as required. $\square$

Corollary 5.1.27

Suppose $f \in k[X]$ is a regular function then $f \neq 0 \implies D(f) \neq \emptyset$.

In what follows we may systematically identify $\mathcal{O}_X(X)$ and $k[X]$, and we formalise this in the following result.

Proposition 5.1.28 (Properties of the Structure Sheaf)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and let $\hat{\cdot} : k[X] \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_X(X)$ be the canonical isomorphism defined in (5.1.26). Then the following properties hold

a) For all $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$ we have $D(f) = \{x \in U \mid f(x) \neq 0\}$ is open and $f|_{D(f)}$ is invertible.

b) For an irreducible subset $W \subset X$ define the prime ideal

$$\mathfrak{M}_{X,W} := \{f \in \mathcal{O}_X(X) \mid f(x) = 0 \quad \forall x \in W\}$$

c) For $x \in X$ we have $\mathfrak{M}_{X,x}$ is maximal and every maximal ideal is of this form

d) For $W, Z \subset X$ be irreducible subsets then

$$\mathfrak{M}_{X,Z} \subset \mathfrak{M}_{X,W} \iff W \subset \overline{Z}$$

and

$$\mathfrak{M}_{X,Z} = \mathfrak{M}_{X,W} \iff \overline{W} = \overline{Z}$$

In particular $\mathfrak{M}_{X,W} = \mathfrak{M}_{X,\overline{W}}$

e) For all $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$ we have a canonical isomorphism

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_X(X) & & \\ \downarrow & \searrow \rho_{XD(f)} & \\ \mathcal{O}_X(X)_f & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_X(D(f)) \end{array}$$

which is the unique homomorphism making this diagram commute

For X an affine variety we denote by $\overline{X}_1, \dots, \overline{X}_n$ the image of the coordinate functions under $\hat{\cdot}$.

5.1.3 Regular Morphisms of Affine Varieties

Definition 5.1.29 (Regular Morphism of Affine Varieties)

Let $X \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$, $Y \subset \mathbb{A}_k^m$ be affine varieties and $\phi : X(\bar{k}) \rightarrow Y(\bar{k})$ a function. Then we say that ϕ is a **regular morphism** (at x) if $\pi_j \circ \phi$ is regular (at x) in the sense of (5.1.25) for $j = 1 \dots m$.

A regular morphism is an isomorphism if it has a two-sided inverse which is also regular.

Note a regular function $X \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is completely equivalent to a regular morphism $X \rightarrow \mathbb{A}_k^1$.

Proposition 5.1.30 (Regular Morphisms of Affine Varieties)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ and $Y = V(\mathfrak{b})$ be affine varieties. Then there is a bijection

$$\begin{aligned} \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_Y(Y), \mathcal{O}_X(X)) &\longleftrightarrow \{ \phi : X \rightarrow Y \mid \phi \text{ regular} \} \\ \phi^\# &\rightarrow (\phi^\#(\bar{Y}_1)(-), \dots, \phi^\#(\bar{Y}_m)(-)) \\ \bar{G} \rightarrow G(\pi_1 \circ \phi, \dots, \pi_m \circ \phi_m) &\leftarrow \phi \end{aligned}$$

Proof. Let $\phi^\#$ be a k -algebra homomorphism, then $\phi^\#(\bar{Y}_i) \in \mathcal{O}_Y(Y)$ is a regular function. Therefore by definition the first map is well-defined. Conversely $\pi_j \circ \phi$ is regular so corresponds to an element of $\phi_j \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$ and the second map is well-defined. As ϕ is uniquely determined by $\phi^\#(\bar{Y}_j)$ for $j = 1 \dots m$ we see that the maps are mutually inverse. $\square$

Lemma 5.1.31

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of affine varieties and $W \subset X$ an irreducible subset. Then

$$(\phi^\#)^{-1}(\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}) = \mathfrak{M}_{Y,\phi(W)} = \mathfrak{M}_{Y,\overline{\phi(W)}}$$

Proof. This follows immediately from the definitions and (5.1.28). $\square$

Proposition 5.1.32

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of affine varieties and $W \subset X$, $Z \subset Y$ irreducible. Then

$$Z \subset \overline{\phi(W)} \iff (\phi^\#)^{-1}(\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}) \subset \mathfrak{M}_{Y,Z}$$

and

$$\bar{Z} = \overline{\phi(W)} \iff (\phi^\#)^{-1}(\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}) = \mathfrak{M}_{Y,Z}$$

Proof. This follows from (5.1.28) and (5.1.31). $\square$

Proposition 5.1.33

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of affine varieties and $x \in X$, $y \in Y$ points. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $y \in \overline{\{\phi(x)\}}$
- b) $\phi(x) \in \overline{\{y\}}$
- c) $\overline{\{\phi(x)\}} = \overline{\{y\}}$
- d) $(\phi^\#)^{-1}(\mathfrak{M}_{X,x}) = \mathfrak{M}_{Y,y}$

When k is algebraically closed then this is equivalent to $\phi(x) = y$.

Proof. We have a) – c) are equivalent because Y is symmetric (5.1.9) (4.1.40), and then c) $\iff$ d) follows from (5.1.32). $\square$

Corollary 5.1.34

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of affine varieties. Then ϕ is continuous.

Proof. Observe that $\phi^{-1}(D(f)) = D(f \circ \phi) = D(\phi^\#(f))$ so we are done by (5.1.15) and (4.1.27). $\square$

Corollary 5.1.35

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ and $\psi : Y \rightarrow Z$ be regular morphisms of affine varieties. Then $\psi \circ \phi$ is regular and

$$(\psi \circ \phi)^\# = \phi^\# \circ \psi^\#$$

Proposition 5.1.36 (Affine Varieties form a Category)

The collection of affine varieties together with regular morphisms form a category $\mathbf{AffVar}_k$. Furthermore there is an equivalence of categories

$$\mathbf{AffVar}_k \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbf{ReducedFgAlg}_k^{op}$$

Proof. By using the correspondence with k -algebra homomorphisms (5.1.30) we may show that the law of composition for regular morphisms also satisfy the axioms of a category. We have therefore shown that the assignment $X \rightarrow k[X]$ is full and faithful functor. To show it is essentially surjective consider a reduced finitely-generated k -algebra A . Then by definition $A \cong k[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}$ for some ideal $\mathfrak{a}$. As A is reduced we see $\mathfrak{a}$ is radical and therefore A is the coordinate ring of the affine variety $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ and by definition $k[X] \cong A$. $\square$

Lemma 5.1.37

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of affine varieties. Suppose that $V \subset Y$ is open and $f : V \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is regular. Then $f \circ \phi : \phi^{-1}(V) \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is regular.

In other words there is a well-defined functor

$$\mathbf{AffVar}_k \longrightarrow \mathbf{LocalSpaceFunctions}_k$$

which we show is full and faithful in (5.1.39).

Proposition 5.1.38 (Principal Open Sets are Affine)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$. Define $Y := V(\mathfrak{a}^e + (1 - X_{n+1}F)) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^{n+1}$ where $f = \bar{F}$ and $F \in k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$. Then there is an isomorphism of spaces with functions

$$\begin{aligned} \theta : (D(f), \mathcal{O}_X|_{D(f)}) &\rightarrow (Y(\bar{k}), \mathcal{O}_Y) \\ (x_1, \dots, x_n) &\rightarrow \left(x_1, \dots, x_n, \frac{1}{F(x_1, \dots, x_n)} \right) \end{aligned}$$

Proof. Observe $V(\mathfrak{a}^e + (1 - X_{n+1}F)) = V(\mathfrak{a}^e) \cap V(1 - X_{n+1}F)$. Therefore θ is well-defined. Conversely given $(x_1, \dots, x_{n+1}) \in V(\mathfrak{a}^e + (1 - X_{n+1}F)) = V(\mathfrak{a}^e) \cap V(1 - X_{n+1}F)$, by definition $(x_1, \dots, x_n) \in V(\mathfrak{a})$ and $F(x_1, \dots, x_n)x_{n+1} = 1 \implies F(x_1, \dots, x_n) \neq 0$. Therefore the inverse map is well-defined. Evidently this restricts to a bijection

$$D(\bar{G}) \cap D(F) \longleftrightarrow D(G) \cap V(\mathfrak{a}^e + (1 - X_{n+1}F))$$

By (5.1.24) and (4.1.27) θ is a homeomorphism.

Suppose that $V \subset Y$ is open and $g : V \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is regular, then for every $y \in V$ there is some neighbourhood W for which

$$g(z_1, \dots, z_{n+1}) = \frac{P(z_1, \dots, z_{n+1})}{Q(z_1, \dots, z_{n+1})} \quad \forall z \in W$$

where $P, Q \in k[Y_1, \dots, Y_{n+1}]$ and $Q(z) \neq 0$. Define the rational functions in $k(X_1, \dots, X_n)$ as follows

$$\begin{aligned} R(X_1, \dots, X_n) &:= P(X_1, \dots, X_n, F(X_1, \dots, X_n)^{-1}) \\ S(X_1, \dots, X_n) &:= Q(X_1, \dots, X_n, F(X_1, \dots, X_n)^{-1}) \end{aligned}$$

Let $U := \theta^{-1}(W)$. Then evidently $R(x) = P(\theta(x))$ and $S(x) = Q(\theta(x))$ for all $x \in U$. In particular we deduce that $S(\theta^{-1}(y)) \neq 0 \implies S \neq 0$ and that $g \circ \theta$ is regular at $\theta^{-1}(y)$. The converse is straightforward so we deduce that θ is an isomorphism. $\square$

When considering regular maps over an open subset of an affine variety, there are two plausible definitions which we show are equivalent.

Proposition 5.1.39 (Quasi-affine Morphisms)

Let $X \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$, $Y \subset \mathbb{A}_k^m$ be affine varieties, $U \subset X(\bar{k})$ an open subset and $\phi : U \rightarrow Y(\bar{k})$ a function. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\pi_j \circ \phi$ is regular for all $j = 1 \dots m$.
- b) ϕ determines a regular morphism $(U, \mathcal{O}_X|_U) \rightarrow (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ of spaces with functions.

Proof. b) $\implies$ a) follows trivially because $\pi_j : Y(\bar{k}) \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is regular

a) $\implies$ b) Firstly we observe that for any $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$ for which $D(f) \subset U$ there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} D(f) & \xrightarrow{\phi|_{D(f)}} & Y(\bar{k}) \\ \sim \downarrow \theta & \nearrow \tilde{\phi}_f & \\ V(\mathfrak{a}^e + (1 - X_{n+1}F)) & & \end{array}$$

where θ is defined in (5.1.38) and $\tilde{\phi}_f(x_1, \dots, x_{n+1}) = \phi(x_1, \dots, x_n)$. By definition $\tilde{\phi}_f$ is a regular morphism of affine varieties and therefore determines a regular morphism of spaces of functions (5.1.37). As θ is a regular isomorphism we find that $\phi|_{D(f)}$ is a regular morphism of spaces of functions. As the $D(f)$ form a base on the topology of U we may conclude from (4.3.27) that ϕ is a regular morphism of spaces with functions. $\square$

Corollary 5.1.40

Let X be an affine variety, $U \subset X$ an open subset and $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$. Then the set

$$D(f) := \{x \in U \mid f(x) \neq 0\}$$

is open and $f|_{D(f)}$ is invertible.

Proof. By (5.1.39) we may regard f as a regular morphism $(U, \mathcal{O}_X|_U) \rightarrow \mathbb{A}_k^1(\bar{k})$, and it is in particular continuous. Then $\{0\} = V(X_1)$ is a closed subset of $\mathbb{A}_k^1(\bar{k})$ and so $D(f) = U \setminus f^{-1}(\{0\})$ is an open subset. It is clear by the definition of the structure sheaf that $f|_{D(f)}$ is invertible. $\square$

Corollary 5.1.41 (Affine Mapping Property)

Let X, Y be affine varieties. Then there are bijections

$$\text{Mor}(X, Y) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Mor}((X, \mathcal{O}_X), (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_Y(Y), \mathcal{O}_X(X))$$

where the second map is given by $\phi_Y^\#$. Furthermore these are natural in either X or Y , and preserve isomorphisms.

Proof. The first map is well-defined by (5.1.39) and evidently injective. The composite map is bijective by (5.1.30), which shows the first map is surjective and hence bijective. We conclude trivially the second map is also a bijection. $\square$

Proposition 5.1.42 (Equaliser is Closed)

Let $\phi, \psi : X \rightarrow Y$ be regular morphisms of affine varieties. Then the equaliser

$$\{x \in X(\bar{k}) \mid \phi(x) = \psi(x)\}$$

is closed.

Proof. By applying the projections we may reduce to the case $Y = \mathbb{A}_k^1$. Then $\phi - \psi$ is regular and the equaliser is the inverse image of $\{0\}$ which is evidently closed in $\mathbb{A}_k^1$. As regular maps are continuous then we are done. $\square$

Proposition 5.1.43

Let $Y = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and $Z := V(\mathfrak{b})$ a closed subvariety for $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[Y]$. Then the space of functions $(Z, \mathcal{O}_Z)$ coincides with the notion of a closed subspace (4.3.21).

Further the inclusion map $i : Z \hookrightarrow Y$ is regular and the induced map

$$i_Y^\# : \mathcal{O}_Y(Y) \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_Z(Z)$$

is a surjective homomorphism with kernel precisely $\rho(\mathfrak{b})$ where $\rho : k[Y] \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_Y(Y)$ is the canonical isomorphism.

Proof. We have a surjective homomorphism $\pi : k[Y] \rightarrow k[Z] := k[Y]/\mathfrak{b}$ with kernel precisely $\mathfrak{b}$. Suppose $f \in \mathcal{O}_Y(U)$ is a regular map, then we wish to show that $f|_{U \cap Z}$ is regular. But if f is given locally by a ratio $\frac{g}{h}$ then $f|_{U \cap Z} = i_U^\#(f)$ is given locally by the ratio $\frac{\pi(g)}{\pi(h)}$. And because π is surjective this means $i_Y^\#$ is surjective. Furthermore we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_Y(Y) & \xrightarrow{i^\#} & \mathcal{O}_Z(Z) \\ \sim \uparrow \rho & & \sim \uparrow \rho \\ k[Y] & \xrightarrow{\pi} & k[Z] \end{array}$$

from which the properties of $i_Y^\#$ follows immediately.

Recall that the Zariski topology on Z coincides with the subspace topology (4.3.21), and we have shown the notion of regular function coincides with the closed subspace definition (4.3.23). Therefore the topology on Z and structure sheaves $\mathcal{O}_Z$ coincide. $\square$

Proposition 5.1.44

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of affine varieties. Then ϕ is a closed immersion (4.3.23) if and only if $\phi^\#$ is surjective.

Proof. Suppose that $\phi^\sharp$ is surjective and let $Z := V(\ker(\phi^\sharp))$ be a closed subset of Y . Then $i : Z \hookrightarrow Y$ is regular and we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_Y(Y) & \xrightarrow{\phi^\sharp} & \mathcal{O}_X(X) \\ \downarrow i^\sharp & \nearrow \tilde{\phi}^\sharp & \\ \mathcal{O}_Z(Z) & & \end{array}$$

By (5.1.43) $\ker(i^\sharp) = \ker(\phi^\sharp)$, so $\tilde{\phi}^\sharp$ exists and is an isomorphism by (3.4.56). By (5.1.41) there exists a corresponding regular morphism $\tilde{\phi} : X \rightarrow Z$ which is an isomorphism which satisfies $i \circ \tilde{\phi} = \phi$. By the criteria in (4.3.23) this means ϕ is a closed immersion.

Conversely if ϕ is a closed immersion then by definition $\phi = i \circ \tilde{\phi}$ for $i : Z \hookrightarrow Y$ the inclusion of a closed subset where $\tilde{\phi}$ is a regular isomorphism. By (5.1.41) $\tilde{\phi}^\sharp \circ i^\sharp = \phi^\sharp$ and $\tilde{\phi}^\sharp$ is an isomorphism, which shows that $\phi^\sharp$ is surjective. $\square$

5.1.4 Dominant Morphisms

Definition 5.1.45

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of affine varieties. Then we say it is

- **finite** if $\phi_Y^\sharp : \mathcal{O}_Y(Y) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(X)$ is module-finite (equivalently integral)
- **dominant** if $\phi(X(\bar{k}))$ is dense in $Y(\bar{k})$

Proposition 5.1.46 (Criteria for dominant morphisms)

A regular morphism $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ is dominant if and only if $\phi_Y^\sharp : \mathcal{O}_Y(Y) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(X)$ is injective. In particular when both X and Y are integral then this induces a field extension

$$\phi_\star : k(Y) \hookrightarrow k(X)$$

Proof. Recall $\phi(X)$ is dense precisely when the closure $\overline{\phi(X)} = Y$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \ker(\phi_Y^\sharp) = I_k(\phi(X)) &\implies V_{\bar{k}}(\ker(\phi^\sharp)) = V_{\bar{k}}(I_k(\phi(X))) = \overline{\phi(X)} \\ &\implies \sqrt{\ker(\phi^\sharp)} = I_k(\overline{\phi(X)}) \end{aligned}$$

by (5.1.2) and (5.1.13). If $\ker(\phi_Y^\sharp) = 0$ then clearly $\overline{\phi(X)} = Y$. Conversely if this holds then

$$\sqrt{\ker(\phi_Y^\sharp)} = I_k(Y(\bar{k})) = I_k(V_{\bar{k}}(0)) = \sqrt{(0)} = (0)$$

as $\mathcal{O}_Y(Y)$ is reduced, whence $\ker(\phi_Y^\sharp) = 0$. $\square$

5.1.5 Dimension

Definition 5.1.47 (Dimension)

Let X be an affine variety. Then we define the dimension to be

$$\dim X := \dim X(\bar{k}) = \dim X_0(\bar{k})$$

where this is the Krull Dimension (4.1.72) of the $\bar{k}$ -rational points with the k -Zariski topology. This is the supremum of dimension over all irreducible components by (4.1.74).

We say X is of **pure dimension** n if all irreducible components have the same dimension n . Note an integral variety is always of pure dimension.

We say $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ is an **affine curve** if it is of pure dimension 1.

Proposition 5.1.48 (Dimension of subspace)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and $Y = V(\mathfrak{b})$ an affine subvariety. Then

- a) $\dim Y = \dim(\mathfrak{b}) = \dim k[X]/\mathfrak{b} = \dim k[Y]$
- b) $\text{codim}(Y, X) = \text{ht}(\mathfrak{b})$

Further when $Y = V(\mathfrak{p})$ is integral then $\text{codim}(Y, X) = \dim k[X]_{\mathfrak{p}}$.

Proof. a) follows from (5.1.23).

b) follows similarly by observing that the definition of ideal height (3.21.1) is dual to the topological definition of codimension (4.1.72). The last statement follows from (3.21.5). $\square$

Corollary 5.1.49

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety then $\dim X = \dim k[X]$. In particular $\dim \mathbb{A}_k^n = n$.

Proof. The first statement is a consequence of (5.1.48) in the case $\mathfrak{b} = (0)$. The dimension for $\mathbb{A}_k^n$ then follows (3.32.28). $\square$

As we showed in Section 3.32.5 the lattice of irreducible subsets is particularly well behaved.

Proposition 5.1.50 (Biequidimensional Algebraic Sets)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety. Then $X(\bar{k})$ is quasi-biequidimensional.

Further X is equidimensional (e.g. integral) iff it is biequidimensional. In this case for every closed subset $Y = V(\mathfrak{b})$ the codimension formula is satisfied

$$\dim X = \dim Y + \text{codim}(Y, X)$$

or in algebraic terms

$$\dim k[X] = \dim \mathfrak{b} + \text{ht}(\mathfrak{b})$$

Proof. We've observed that the lattice of radical (resp. prime) ideals of $k[X]$ is isomorphic to the lattice of closed (resp. irreducible) subsets of $X(\bar{k})$. Therefore by (3.32.35) $X(\bar{k})$ is quasi-biequidimensional.

In the equidimensional case, the codimension formula follows from (4.1.78) and the algebraic version from (5.1.48). $\square$

In the integral case we recover the “classical” field-theoretic version of dimension

Proposition 5.1.51 (Dimension of Function Field)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{p})$ be an integral affine variety. Then

$$\dim X = \dim k[X] = \text{trdeg}(\text{Frac}(k[X])/k)$$

Proof. We have already shown that $\dim X = \dim k[X]$. The second equality follows from Noether Normalisation (3.32.28). $\square$

Proposition 5.1.52

Let X be an affine variety and $Z \subset X$ a closed subset. Then the following are equivalent

a) $\dim Z = 0$

b) Z is finite

More precisely

$$Z = \overline{\{x_1\}} \cup \dots \cup \overline{\{x_n\}}$$

for a finite number of points $x_1, \dots, x_n \in Z$.

Proof. This follows from (4.1.82) and (5.1.18). $\square$

Proposition 5.1.53 (Hypersurfaces)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and $f \in k[X]$. Define the **hypersurface** $Y := V(f)$ then $\dim Y = n - 1$ (and Y is equidimensional).

Conversely if $k[X]$ is a UFD and $Y \subset X$ is an irreducible closed subset of dimension 1, then Y is a hypersurface.

Proof. TODO. $\square$

5.1.6 Local Rings

Definition 5.1.54 (Local Ring)

Let X be an affine variety and $W \subset X(\bar{k})$ be an irreducible subset. Then we define the **local ring** at W to be

$$\mathcal{O}_{X,W} := \varinjlim_{U \cap W \neq \emptyset} \mathcal{O}_X(U)$$

It is a local ring with unique maximal ideal

$$\mathfrak{m}_{X,W} = \{(U, \sigma) \mid \sigma(x) = 0 \ \forall x \in W\}.$$

In the case $W = \{(x)\}$ then we write it as $(\mathcal{O}_{X,x}, \mathfrak{m}_{X,x})$.

Proof. First of all the family of open sets such that $U \cap W \neq \emptyset$ is directed by reverse inclusion precisely because W is irreducible, see (4.1.51).

Any section $\sigma \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ is continuous with respect to the cofinite topology on k . Therefore $D(\sigma) := \sigma^{-1}(k \setminus \{0\}) \subset U$ is an open set and $\sigma \notin \mathfrak{m}_{X,W} \implies D(\sigma) \cap W \neq \emptyset$. Then evidently $[(D(\sigma), \sigma^{-1})]$ is a multiplicative inverse for (U, σ) and by (...) $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ is a local ring with unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}$. $\square$

Corollary 5.1.55 (Field of Rational Functions)

Let X be an integral affine variety. Then $\mathcal{O}_{X,X} =: k(X)$ is a field, which we denote as **field of rational functions**.

Proof. Evidently $\mathfrak{m}_{X,X} = (0)$. Explicitly (V, σ) has inverse $(D(\sigma), \sigma^{-1})$. $\square$

Proposition 5.1.56 (Local Ring is Localization of Coordinate Ring)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and $W \subset X(\bar{k})$ an irreducible subset with prime ideal $\mathfrak{M}_{X,W} := I(W)$. For all such W we have a canonical local isomorphism

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_X(X) & & \\ \downarrow & \searrow \rho_W & \\ \mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_{X,W} \\ & \downarrow & \\ & \frac{f}{g} \longmapsto \left[\left(D(g), \frac{f}{g} \right) \right] & \end{array}$$

The inverse image of $\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}$ is $\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}$ and $\mathfrak{M}_{X,W} \mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}}$ respectively. This induces isomorphisms

$$\mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}} / \mathfrak{M}_{X,W} \mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}} \xrightarrow{\sim} k(\mathfrak{M}_{X,W} \mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}}) \xrightarrow{\sim} k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W})$$

Further we have

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,W} = \text{ht}(\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}) = \text{codim}(W, X) = \dim X - \dim W$$

In particular

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \dim X$$

Proof. This is a formal consequence of generic facts regarding localization and direct limits

$$\mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{p}} \stackrel{(3.7.37)}{\cong} \varinjlim_{f \notin \mathfrak{p}} \mathcal{O}_X(X)_f \cong \varinjlim_{D(f) \cap W \neq \emptyset} \mathcal{O}_X(D(f)) \stackrel{(2.6.47)}{\cong} \varinjlim_{U \cap W \neq \emptyset} \mathcal{O}_X(U)$$

We may demonstrate this more directly. For it is surjective because the principal open sets form a basis and by (5.1.26), observing that $f \notin \mathfrak{p} \iff D(f) \cap V(\mathfrak{p}) \neq \emptyset$. Suppose $\frac{g}{f}$ and $\frac{g'}{f'}$ have the same image then there is some h such that $D(h) \subseteq D(ff') = D(f) \cap D(f')$ and $h \notin \mathfrak{p}$ such that $\frac{g}{f} = \frac{g'}{f'}$ are equal in $k[X]_h$ and a-fortiori in $k[X]_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Therefore the map is injective as required.

The first two dimension identities follow from (5.1.48) the third from (5.1.50). The final identity follows from (5.1.52). $\square$

Corollary 5.1.57

Let X be an irreducible variety then there is a canonical isomorphism with the field of rational functions

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_X(X) & & \\ \downarrow & \searrow & \\ \text{Frac}(\mathcal{O}_X(X)) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & k(X) \end{array}$$

Proposition 5.1.58

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of affine varieties. Suppose $W \subset X$ is irreducible and $Z \subset \overline{\phi(W)}$ for some irreducible $Z \subset Y$. Then the stalk map $\phi_W : \mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ (see (4.3.5)) makes the following diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_Y(Y) & \xrightarrow{\phi^\#} & \mathcal{O}_X(X) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} & \xrightarrow{\phi_W} & \mathcal{O}_{X,W} \\ \downarrow \sim & & \downarrow \sim \\ \mathcal{O}_Y(Y)_{\mathfrak{M}_{Y,Z}} & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}} \end{array}$$

where the bottom arrow is the localisation map induced by $\phi^\#$ (3.7.20). In fact it is the unique map making either square commute.

Proposition 5.1.59

Let X be an integral affine variety, $W = V(\mathfrak{M}_{X,W})$ an irreducible subset. Then there are canonical injections

$$\mathcal{O}_X(X) \hookrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,W} \hookrightarrow k(X)$$

and the restriction maps are injective. Further there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & \mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}} & \hookrightarrow & \text{Frac}(\mathcal{O}_X(X)) \\ & \nearrow & \downarrow \sim & & \downarrow \sim \\ \mathcal{O}_X(X) & \hookrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_{X,W} & \hookrightarrow & k(X) \end{array}$$

which shows $k(X)$ is a quotient field for $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ and $\mathcal{O}_X(X)$.

Proof. We first show the restriction maps are injective. Suppose $\sigma|_V = 0$. Note that V is dense (4.1.50), σ is continuous (5.1.34) with respect to the k -Zariski topology on $\bar{k}$ so that $\sigma^{-1}(\{0\})$ is closed. By definition this contains V and therefore also $\text{cl}_U(V) = \text{cl}_X(V) \cap U = U$. We conclude $\sigma = 0$ and the restriction maps are injective. The same argument shows that the remaining maps are injective.

The vertical maps are isomorphisms by (5.1.56), and we may verify directly the diagram commutes. $\square$

Therefore if it's convenient to do so we may identify $\mathcal{O}_X(X)$ and $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ as subrings of $k(X)$.

Proposition 5.1.60

Let X be an affine variety and $W \subset X$ an irreducible closed subset. Then the minimal primes of $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ are in bijection with the irreducible components of X containing W .

$\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ is an integral domain if and only if W lies in a unique irreducible component.

Proof. By (5.1.56) and (3.7.35) the minimal primes of $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ correspond to minimal primes of $k[X]$ contained in $\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}$. These correspond to irreducible components of X containing $\overline{W}$ (and hence W) by (5.1.19).

As $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ is reduced, it is an integral domain iff it has a unique minimal prime ideal (3.4.67). $\square$

Proposition 5.1.61

Let X be an affine variety, R an algebraic k -algebra (3.32.25) and $\phi : \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \rightarrow R$ a k -algebra homomorphism. Then $\phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{m}_R) = \mathfrak{m}_{X,x}$ and therefore factors through $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x})$

This in particular this includes the case R is an algebraic field extension.

Proof. See (3.32.27). $\square$

5.1.7 Rational Points**Proposition 5.1.62** (K -rational points)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and K an algebraic field extension. Then there are natural bijections

$$\begin{aligned} X(K) &\longleftrightarrow \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_X(X), K) \\ &\longleftrightarrow \{(\mathfrak{M}, \phi) \mid \mathfrak{M} \in \text{Specm}(\mathcal{O}_X(X)) \quad \phi : \mathcal{O}_X(X)/\mathfrak{M} \hookrightarrow K\} \\ &\longleftrightarrow \{(x, \phi) \mid x \in X_0(\bar{k}) \quad \phi : k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}) \hookrightarrow K\} \\ &\longleftrightarrow \{(x, \phi) \mid x \in X_0(\bar{k}) \quad \phi : \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \rightarrow K\} \end{aligned}$$

Proof. The first correspondence is simply (5.1.7) and (5.1.26).

For the second correspondence consider a k -algebra homomorphism $\phi : \mathcal{O}_X(X) \rightarrow K$. By (3.32.27) we have $\ker(\phi) =: \mathfrak{M}$ is maximal, which induces a homomorphism $\mathcal{O}_X(X)/\mathfrak{M} \hookrightarrow K$. Evidently this correspondence is injective and surjective.

By (5.1.11) there is a bijection $\text{Specm}(\mathcal{O}_X(X)) \leftrightarrow X_0(\bar{k})$. Further there is an isomorphism $\mathcal{O}_X(X)/\mathfrak{M}_{X,x} \cong k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x})$ (5.1.56) from which the third correspondence is well-defined and bijective.

The final correspondence follows from (5.1.61) because all such homomorphisms factor through $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x})$. $\square$

5.1.8 Generic Points

When considering irreducible subsets $W \subset X$ there is another way of looking at these in terms of “generic points”.

Definition 5.1.63 (Generic Point)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety and $(\xi) \in X(\Omega)$ for some extension field Ω/k . Then we may define the irreducible subset of $X(\bar{k})$

$$W_\xi := V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{p}_\xi) = \left\{ (x) \in X(\bar{k}) \mid \forall f \in k[X] (f(\xi) = 0 \implies f(x) = 0) \right\}$$

There are canonical isomorphisms

$$k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}) \xrightarrow{\sim} k[X]_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}k[X]_{\mathfrak{p}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Frac}(k[X]/\mathfrak{p}) \xrightarrow{\sim} k(\xi)$$

We say that (ξ) is a **generic point** corresponding to the irreducible closed subset W_ξ . Moreover every irreducible subset is of this form for we may simply consider $\Omega := \text{Frac}(k[X]/\mathfrak{p})$ and $\xi = (\bar{X}_1, \dots, \bar{X}_n)$.

If $(x) \in W_\xi$ then we say that (x) is a **specialization** of (ξ) and this induces the specialization homomorphism

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k[X]/\mathfrak{p}_\xi & \longrightarrow & k[X]/\mathfrak{m}_x \\ \wr \parallel & & \wr \parallel \\ k[\xi] & \dashrightarrow & k[x] \end{array}$$

If $W_\xi = X$ then we say simply (ξ) is a generic point.

5.1.9 Tangent Space and Non-Singular Points

We propose two definitions for the tangent space and show that under mild technical conditions they are naturally isomorphic. The latter definition may be identified geometrically.

Definition 5.1.64

Let X be an affine variety and let $W \subset X$ be an irreducible subset. We define the **cotangent space** at W to be the $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W})$ -vector space

$$T_W^*X := \mathfrak{m}_{X,W}/\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}^2$$

and the **tangent space** to be the $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W})$ -vector space

$$T_WX := \text{Der}_k(\mathcal{O}_{X,W}, k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}))$$

For points this has a concrete interpretation

Proposition 5.1.65 (Concrete interpretation of Tangent Space)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ be an affine variety and $x \in X(\bar{k})$. Then there are natural $k(x)$ -module isomorphisms

$$\begin{array}{ccc} T_xX \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Der}_k(k[X], k(x)) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \left\{ v \in k(x)^n \mid \sum_{i=1}^n v_i \frac{\partial F}{\partial X_i}(x) = 0 \quad \forall F \in \mathfrak{a} \right\} \\ D & \rightarrow & (D(\bar{X}_1), \dots, D(\bar{X}_n)) \end{array}$$

where we have used the identification $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}) \cong k(x)$ and the k -algebra homomorphism $k[X] \rightarrow k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x})$. Suppose $\mathfrak{a} = \langle F_1, \dots, F_m \rangle$ then the right hand side is the kernel of the following $k(x)$ -module homomorphism

$$\begin{pmatrix} \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial X_1}(x) & \dots & \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial X_n}(x) \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \frac{\partial F_m}{\partial X_1}(x) & \dots & \frac{\partial F_m}{\partial X_n}(x) \end{pmatrix} : k(x)^n \rightarrow k(x)^m$$

In particular

$$\dim_{k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x})} T_x X = n - \operatorname{rk} \left(\frac{\partial F_i}{\partial X_j}(x) \right)$$

Proof. Recall by (5.1.56) and (5.1.63) that $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} \cong k[X]_{\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}}$ and $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}) \cong k(x)$ so we have isomorphisms

$$\operatorname{Der}_k(\mathcal{O}_{X,x}, k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x})) \cong \operatorname{Der}_k(k[X]_{\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}}, k(x)) \stackrel{(3.25.9)}{\cong} \operatorname{Der}_k(k[X], k(x))$$

and the remaining isomorphism is from (3.32.41) □

Proposition 5.1.66 (Dimension Formula of Tangent Space)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ be an integral affine variety, $W \subset X$ an irreducible subset. Suppose that $\mathfrak{a} = \langle F_1, \dots, F_m \rangle$ and let $\xi := (\overline{X}_1, \dots, \overline{X}_n) \in k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W})^n$ be the image of the coordinate functions. Then we have the dimension formula

$$\dim T_W X = \dim \operatorname{Der}(k[X], k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W})) = n - \operatorname{rk} \left(\frac{\partial F_i}{\partial X_j}(\xi) \right)$$

Suppose that $Z \subset W$ is an irreducible subset then we have the inequality

$$\dim T_Z X \geq \dim T_W X$$

and

$$\dim T_W X \geq \dim T_X X = \dim \operatorname{Der}(k(X))$$

which equals $\dim X$ when $k(X)$ is separably generated (e.g. k is perfect).

Proof. We have isomorphisms

$$\begin{aligned} \dim T_W X &:= \dim \operatorname{Der}_k(\mathcal{O}_{X,W}, k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W})) \\ &\stackrel{(5.1.56)}{\longrightarrow} \dim \operatorname{Der}_k(\mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}}, k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W})) \\ &\stackrel{(3.25.9)}{\longrightarrow} \dim \operatorname{Der}_k(\mathcal{O}_X(X), k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W})) \\ &\stackrel{(5.1.26)}{\longrightarrow} \dim \operatorname{Der}_k(k[X], k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W})) \end{aligned}$$

and the rank formula follows from (3.32.41) and (3.4.135).

Let ζ be the corresponding generic point of Z , then because $\mathfrak{m}_{X,W} \subset \mathfrak{m}_{X,Z}$ we may construct a k -algebra homomorphism $k[\zeta] \rightarrow k[\zeta]$. So by the determinant criteria of rank (3.6.40) we deduce that

$$\operatorname{rk} \left(\frac{\partial F_i}{\partial X_j}(\zeta) \right) \leq \operatorname{rk} \left(\frac{\partial F_i}{\partial X_j}(\xi) \right)$$

from which the inequality follows.

Observe that $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,X}) =: k(X)$ and $T_X X \xrightarrow{\sim} \operatorname{Der}_k(k[X], k(X)) \xrightarrow{\sim} \operatorname{Der}_k(k(X))$. When $k(X)$ is separably generated this equals $\dim X$ by (3.32.44). □

Proposition 5.1.67 (Duality between Tangent and Cotangent Space)

Let X be an affine variety and $W \subset X$ be an irreducible subset. There is a canonical $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W})$ -module homomorphism

$$T_W X \longrightarrow (T_W^* X)^\vee$$

Under the condition that $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W})/k$ is separably generated (e.g. k is perfect) then this map is an isomorphism. In particular $\dim T_W X = \dim T_W^* X$ by (3.4.109).

Proof. This follows directly from (3.32.48) by considering the local ring $A := \mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ with maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}$. □

Lemma 5.1.68

Let A be a reduced ring with minimal prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ and prime ideal $\mathfrak{q} \supset \mathfrak{p}$ containing no other minimal prime ideals. Suppose that

$$\phi : A \rightarrow B$$

is a surjective ring homomorphism with $\ker(\phi) = \mathfrak{p}$. Then ϕ induces an isomorphism of rings

$$\tilde{\phi} : A_{\mathfrak{q}} \rightarrow B_{\phi(\mathfrak{q})}$$

which is the unique morphism commuting with ϕ .

Proof. The map $\tilde{\phi}$ exists and has kernel $\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{q}}$ by (3.7.5). We need simply to show that $\mathfrak{p}A_{\mathfrak{q}} = (0)$. By (3.7.35) it is the unique minimal prime ideal of $A_{\mathfrak{q}}$. As $A_{\mathfrak{q}}$ is reduced then we are done by (3.4.46). $\square$

Proposition 5.1.69

Let X be an affine variety, W an irreducible subset contained in precisely one irreducible component X_{α} . Then there is a canonical isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{O}_{X,W} &\xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_{X_{\alpha},W} \\ (U, \sigma) &\longrightarrow (U \cap X_{\alpha}, \sigma|_{X_{\alpha} \cap U}) \end{aligned}$$

and in particular an isomorphism of tangent spaces

$$T_W X \xrightarrow{\sim} T_W X_{\alpha}$$

Proof. The regular map $i : X_{\alpha} \hookrightarrow X$ corresponds to a ring homomorphism $i^{\#}$ with kernel $\mathfrak{M}_{X, X_{\alpha}}$ by (5.1.43). By (...) we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_X(X) & \xrightarrow{i^{\#}} & \mathcal{O}_{X_{\alpha}}(X_{\alpha}) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathcal{O}_{X,W} & \xrightarrow{i_W} & \mathcal{O}_{X_{\alpha},W} \\ \downarrow \sim & & \downarrow \sim \\ \mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}} & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_{X_{\alpha}}(X_{\alpha})_{\mathfrak{M}_{X_{\alpha},W}} \end{array}$$

and by (5.1.68) we deduce that the stalk map is an isomorphism. $\square$

Definition 5.1.70 (Non-Singular Points)

Let X be an affine variety and $W \subset X$ be an irreducible subset. We say that X is **non-singular** at W if

- a) W is contained in only one irreducible component X_{α} , and
- b) $\dim T_W X = \dim \operatorname{Der}_k(k(X_{\alpha}))$

Note that by (5.1.60) a) $\iff \mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ is an integral domain.

Recall by (5.1.66) that $\dim T_W X = \dim T_W X_{\alpha} \geq \dim \operatorname{Der}_k(k(X_{\alpha}))$ and in the case of k perfect this equals $\dim X_{\alpha}$.

We may now show the following important result

Proposition 5.1.71 (Non-Singular Point)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ be an affine variety then the non-singular points form an open dense subset of X .

Proof. We may reduce to the case of X irreducible. Let $\Omega := k(X)$ and $\xi := (\bar{X}_1, \dots, \bar{X}_n) \in X(\Omega)$ and suppose $\mathfrak{p} = \langle F_1, \dots, F_m \rangle \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ is the ideal defining X . Then

$$\operatorname{Der}(\Omega) \stackrel{(3.25.9)}{=} \operatorname{Der}(k[X], \Omega) \stackrel{(3.32.41)}{\cong} \ker \left(\frac{\partial F_i}{\partial X_j}(\xi) \right)$$

For $x \in X(\bar{k})$ there is a k -algebra homomorphism $k[\xi] \rightarrow k[x]$ and so by the determinant criteria of rank (3.6.40) we see

$$\operatorname{rk} \left(\frac{\partial F_i}{\partial X_j}(x) \right) \leq \operatorname{rk} \left(\frac{\partial F_i}{\partial X_j}(\xi) \right)$$

Suppose the rank of the right hand side is r and consider the r -minors $g_1, \dots, g_m \in k[X]$. Then by the same result at least one is non-zero and the set of non-singular points is given by

$$\bigcup_p D(g_p)$$

which is non-empty by (5.1.27). $\square$

Proposition 5.1.72 (Non-Singular Variety)

Let X be an integral affine variety. Then the following are equivalent

- a) X is non-singular at all points $x \in X(\bar{k})$

b) X is non-singular at all irreducible subsets $W \subset X(\bar{k})$

In this case we say that X is a **non-singular affine variety**.

Proof. Evidently $b) \implies a)$ because $T_x X = T_{\overline{\{x\}}} X$. Conversely given any $x \in W$ we have by (5.1.66)

$$T_x X \geq T_W X \geq \dim \operatorname{Der}(k(X))$$

whence they are both equal. □

Definition 5.1.73 (Regular Point)

Let X be an affine variety and $W \subset X$ an irreducible subset. Then we say that W is **regular** if

a) W is contained in precisely one irreducible component X_α , and

b) $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ is a regular local ring (i.e. $\dim T_W^* X = \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,W}$)

We say X is **regular** if all it is regular at all irreducible subsets.

Fortunately these concepts are typically equivalent.

Proposition 5.1.74 (Regular = Non-Singular in Perfect Case)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ an affine variety with k perfect and $W \subset X$ an irreducible subset. Then

$$\dim T_W^* X = \dim T_W X$$

and the following are equivalent

a) X is regular at W

b) X is non-singular at W

c) $\dim T_W X = \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,W} = \operatorname{codim}(W, X)$

When $\operatorname{codim}(W, X) = 1$ this is equivalent to $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ being a discrete valuation ring.

Proof. Recall by (5.1.56) that $\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \dim X$ and by definition $T_x^* X = \mathfrak{m}_{X,x} / \mathfrak{m}_{X,x}^2$. Further by definition (x) is regular iff $\dim T_x^* X = \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$. Finally by (5.1.67) $\dim T_x^* X = \dim T_x X$ so we see $a) \iff c)$.

Similarly $b) \iff c)$ is essentially by definition. The final statement follows from (3.30.2). □

Example 5.1.75 (Simple Points of a Plane Curve)

The canonical example is a plane curve $k[X] = k[X, Y]/(F(X, Y))$ which has dimension 1 (...). Given $(x) \in X(K)$ we see that

$$T_x X = \{(\alpha, \beta) \in k(x)^2 \mid 0 = \alpha \frac{\partial F}{\partial X}(x) + \beta \frac{\partial F}{\partial Y}(x)\}$$

Clearly this has dimension 1 (in which case (x) is a **simple point**) unless both the partial derivatives vanish at (x) in which case it has dimension 2.

Clearly $F(X, Y) = Y^2 - X^3$ has a non-simple point at $(0, 0)$ but $F(X, Y) = Y - X^2$ has simple points everywhere.

5.1.10 Zeta Function over Finite Fields

For this section let $k = \mathbb{F}_p$ with algebraic closure $\bar{k}$. Then for every $n \geq 1$ by (...) $\bar{k}$ has a unique subfield k_n of degree n , and order p^n . Furthermore we have the following properties

a) $k_m \subseteq k_n \iff [k_m : k] \mid [k_n : k] \iff m \mid n$

b) $[k_n : k_m] = n/m$

c) k_n/k_m is Galois with the group of automorphisms generated by ϕ^m for all integers $m \mid n$, and the Galois group has order n/m .

d) every finite subextension is of this form

Lemma 5.1.76

Let $x_1, \dots, x_N \in \bar{k}$. Then

$$k(x_1, \dots, x_N) = k_n$$

where

$$n := \text{lcm}_i [k(x_i) : k]$$

Proof. By definition $[k(x_i) : k] \mid n$ whence $k(x_i) \subseteq k_n$ by the previous observations, and therefore $k(x_1, \dots, x_N) \subseteq k_n$.

Similarly as $k(x_i) \subset k(x_1, \dots, x_N)$ we have $[k(x_i) : k] \mid [k(x_1, \dots, x_N) : k]$. Then by definition $r \mid [k(x_1, \dots, x_N) : k]$ which shows $k_n \subset k(x_1, \dots, x_N)$. $\square$

The following result shows that the number of rational points over a finite field may be characterized by algebraic properties of the coordinate ring $k[X]$. This is essentially because maximal ideals correspond to Galois orbits of rational points and we may count rational points by summing over Galois orbits.

Proposition 5.1.77 (Counting Rational Points)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^N$ be an affine variety. Then for all integers $n \geq 1$ we have the following relation

$$\#X(k_n) = \sum_{d \mid n} d \times \#\{\mathfrak{m} \mid \dim_k k(\mathfrak{m}) = d\}$$

Proof. For $(x) \in X(\bar{k})$, then by the previous discussion

$$(x) \in X(k_n) \iff k(x) \subseteq k_n \iff \dim_k k(x) \mid n$$

This shows that

$$\begin{aligned} \#X(k_n) &= \sum_{d \mid n} \#\{(x) \in X(k_n) \mid \dim_k k(x) = d\} \\ &= \sum_{d \mid n} \#\{(x) \in X(k_d) \mid \dim_k k(x) = d\} \end{aligned} \quad (5.1)$$

By (5.1.11) we have a bijection

$$X(k_d)/\text{Gal}(k_d/k) \xrightarrow{\sim} \{\mathfrak{m} \mid \dim_k k(\mathfrak{m}) = d\}$$

As we have an isomorphism $k(x) \cong k(\mathfrak{m}_x)$ this restricts to a bijection

$$\{(x) \in X(k_d) \mid \dim_k k(x) = d\}/\text{Gal}(k_d/k) \xrightarrow{\sim} \{\mathfrak{m} \mid \dim_k k(\mathfrak{m}) = d\}$$

We claim that the action of $\text{Gal}(k_d/k) = \langle \phi \rangle$ is free. For suppose $(x) \in X(k_d)$ such that $\dim_k k(x) = d$ and $\phi^r(x_i) = x_i$ for $i = 1 \dots N$ and $0 < r \leq d$. Then by (3.18.120) we have $x_i \in k_r$ whence $\dim_k k(x) \leq r$. This shows we must have $r = d$ and in particular only the identity automorphism fixes (x) .

Therefore we see that

$$\#\{(x) \in X(k_d) \mid \dim_k k(x) = d\} = \#\text{Gal}(k_d/k) \times \#\{\mathfrak{m} \mid \dim_k k(\mathfrak{m}) = d\}$$

From (3.18.123) we recall $\text{Gal}(k_d/k)$ is cyclic of order d so we may combine this with (5.1) to obtain the required result. $\square$

Proposition 5.1.78 (Zeta function of an affine variety over a finite field)

Formally as elements of the power series ring $\mathbb{Q}[[T]]$ we have

$$Z(X, T) := \prod_{\mathfrak{m} \in \text{Specm}(k[X])} (1 - T^{\deg(\mathfrak{m})})^{-1} = \exp \left(\sum_{m=1}^{\infty} \frac{\#X(k_m)}{m} T^m \right)$$

Proof. Define

$$b_d := \#\{\mathfrak{m} \mid \dim_k k(\mathfrak{m}) = d\}$$

Let $Z(X, T)$ be the right hand side then

$$\begin{aligned} \log(Z(X, T)) &= \sum_{m=1}^{\infty} \#X(k_m) \frac{T^m}{m} \\ &= \sum_{m=1}^{\infty} \sum_{d|m} (d \times b_d) \frac{T^m}{m} \\ &= \sum_{d=1}^{\infty} b_d \sum_{r=1}^{\infty} \frac{T^{rd}}{r} \\ &= - \sum_{d=1}^{\infty} b_d \log(1 - T^d) \end{aligned}$$

□

Example 5.1.79

For $X(k) = k^n$ we have $\#X(k_m) = p^{mn}$. Then

$$Z(X, T) = \exp \left(\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{p^{mn} T^m}{m} \right) = \exp(-\log(1 - p^n T)) = \frac{1}{1 - p^n T}$$

5.1.11 Base Change

Definition 5.1.80 (Affine Base Change)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ be an affine variety over k and K/k a field extension. Consider the canonical ring homomorphism

$$i_{kK} : k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \hookrightarrow K[X_1, \dots, X_n]$$

and let $\mathfrak{a}^e := \mathfrak{a}K[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ denote the extension under this map.

Further define the **base change** of X with respect to K/k to be the affine variety

$$X_K := V(\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}^e}) \subset \mathbb{A}_K^n$$

Proposition 5.1.81 (Coordinate Ring of Base Change)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ be an affine variety over k and K/k a field extension. There is a canonical K -algebra isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} (k[X] \otimes_k K)_{\text{red}} &\xrightarrow{\sim} K[X_K] \\ \overline{F} \otimes \lambda &\rightarrow \lambda \cdot i_{kK}(\overline{F}) \end{aligned}$$

Proof. By (3.5.42) we have K -algebra isomorphisms

$$k[X] \otimes_k K \xrightarrow{\sim} (k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \otimes_k K) / \mathfrak{a}^e \xrightarrow{\sim} K[X_1, \dots, X_n] / \mathfrak{a}^e$$

By (3.32.4) and (3.32.2) this determines a unique K -algebra isomorphism

$$(k[X] \otimes_k K)_{\text{red}} \xrightarrow{\sim} (K[X_1, \dots, X_n] / \mathfrak{a}^e)_{\text{red}} \xrightarrow{\sim} K[X_1, \dots, X_n] / \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}^e} =: K[X_K]$$

□

It may be interesting to understand the cases when $\mathfrak{a}^e$ remains radical under the base change.

Proposition 5.1.82

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety. Then the extension $\mathfrak{a}^e$ under $A \rightarrow A \otimes_k K$ remains radical under any of the following conditions

- a) $k[X]$ is geometrically reduced
- b) K/k is geometrically reduced (e.g. separably generated)
- c) k is perfect.

Proof. By (3.5.42) we have an isomorphism

$$K[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}^e \xrightarrow{\sim} k[X] \otimes_k K$$

so that $\mathfrak{a}^e$ is radical iff $k[X] \otimes_k K$ is reduced. Then we may reduce to results in Section 3.35.2. $\square$

We are particularly interested when the variety remains integral (equivalently irreducible) under base change.

Definition 5.1.83 (Geometrically Integral)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine variety over k . Then we say X is **geometrically integral** if X_K is integral for all field extensions K . By (...) this is equivalent to $k[X]$ being geometrically irreducible.

Proposition 5.1.84 (Criteria to be Geometrically Integral)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ be an integral affine variety. Then the following are equivalent

- a) X is geometrically integral
- b) $X_{\bar{k}}$ is integral
- c) $X_{k'}$ is integral for every finite separable extension k'/k
- d) $k[X]$ is geometrically irreducible.
- e) $k[X] \otimes \bar{k}$ is irreducible
- f) $k[X] \otimes k'$ is irreducible for every finite separable extension k'/k .
- g) $k(X)/k$ is relatively separably closed

Proof. We have a) $\iff$ d), b) $\iff$ e) and c) $\iff$ f) are straightforward since a ring A is irreducible iff A_{red} is integral.

For d) $\iff$ e) $\iff$ f) $\iff$ g) we may use (3.35.38). $\square$

Proposition 5.1.85

Let $X = \mathbb{A}_n^k$. Then there is a canonical isomorphism $X_K \cong \mathbb{A}_n^K$. In particular X is geometrically integral.

Proposition 5.1.86

Let $X \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ be an affine variety, K/k a field extension and R a K -algebra. Then there is a bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X(R_{(k)}) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & X_K(R) \\ \downarrow \sim & & \downarrow \sim \\ \text{AlgHom}_k(k[X], R_{(k)}) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{AlgHom}_K(K[X_K], R) \\ \phi & \longrightarrow & \lambda \cdot \bar{F} \rightarrow \lambda \cdot \phi(\overline{i_{kK}(F)}) \end{array}$$

for $F \in k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$, where the vertical arrows are given by (...).

Corollary 5.1.87

Let X be an affine variety and $L/K/k$ a tower of extensions, then we may identify $X(L)$ with $X_K(L)$.

Proposition 5.1.88

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ an affine variety and $\bar{k}/K/k$ a tower of extensions. Then after identifying $X(\bar{k})$ with $X_K(\bar{k})$ we have the following properties

- a) U open in $X(\bar{k}) \implies U$ open in $X_K(\bar{k})$,
- b) There is a well-defined K -algebra homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathcal{O}_X(U) \otimes_k K)_{\text{red}} &\rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X_K}(U) \\ f \otimes \lambda &\rightarrow \lambda \cdot f \end{aligned}$$

which is an isomorphism when $U = X$,

- c) sets of the form $D(\sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i f_i)$ are open in $X_K(\bar{k})$ and form a base for the Zariski topology.

Proof. a) A closed subset of $X(\bar{k})$ is of the form $Z = V(\mathfrak{b})$ for $\mathfrak{b} \subset \mathfrak{a}$. Then evidently $Z = V(\mathfrak{b}^e)$ and so it is closed as a subset of $X_K(\bar{k})$

- b) By definition we have an open cover $U = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ and polynomials $g_i, h_i \in k[X]$ such that $f|_{U_i} = \frac{g_i}{h_i}$. This shows that $\lambda \cdot f$ is also regular. The map is an isomorphism on global sections by (5.1.81).
- c) By (5.1.39) $f := \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i f_i$ is continuous. As $\{0\}$ is a closed subset of $\bar{k}$ in the Zariski (co-finite) topology this shows that $D(f)$ is open. These form a base because $D(fg) = D(f) \cap D(g)$, and specifically for the Zariski topology by (5.1.15) and b).

□

5.1.12 Valuation Rings on the Function Field

Proposition 5.1.89

Let K/k be a field extension and R a valuation ring of K/k . Then there exists a valuation ring $R' \subset R$ such that $k(\mathfrak{m}_{R'})/k$ is algebraic and $\mathfrak{m}_{R'} = \mathfrak{m}_R \cap R'$.

Proof. By (3.24.8) the identity map $1 : k \rightarrow \bar{k}$ extends to a ring homomorphism $S \rightarrow \bar{k}$ where $(S, \mathfrak{m}_S)$ is a valuation ring of $k(\mathfrak{m}_R)/k$. Considering the quotient map $\pi : R \rightarrow k(\mathfrak{m}_R)$ let $R' := \pi^{-1}(S)$. The restriction map

$$\pi' : R' \rightarrow S \rightarrow k(\mathfrak{m}_S)$$

is surjective, and so the kernel $\mathfrak{m}_{R'} := \ker(\pi') = \mathfrak{m}_R \cap R'$ is a maximal ideal of R' and $k(\mathfrak{m}_{R'}) \cong k(\mathfrak{m}_S)$. Observe that by $R' \subseteq R$ and $\mathfrak{m}_R \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_{R'}$. If $x \notin R$ then $x^{-1} \in \mathfrak{m}_R \implies x^{-1} \in R$ by (3.24.2). If $x \in R \setminus R'$ then $\pi(x) \notin S \implies \pi(x^{-1}) \in S \implies x^{-1} \in R'$. Therefore we conclude that R' is a valuation ring with maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}_{R'}$ and algebraic residue field as required. □

The following result was proven in the case of a finitely generated k -algebra (3.32.28), where equality holds. In general only the inequality holds by considering for example the case $\dim K = 0$. The proof below is taken from [Rey11].

Lemma 5.1.90

Let R be a subring of a finitely generated field extension K/k . Then $\dim R \leq \text{trdeg}(K/k)$.

Proof. Consider a chain of prime ideals

$$\mathfrak{p}_0 \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_n \subset R$$

Choose $x_i \in \mathfrak{p}_i \setminus \mathfrak{p}_{i-1}$ and define $A := k[x_1, \dots, x_n] \subset R$ with $K' := \text{Frac}(A) \subset K$. Then there is a chain of prime ideals of A

$$\mathfrak{p}_0 \cap A \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_n \cap A$$

whence $n \leq \dim A \stackrel{(3.32.28)}{=} \text{trdeg}(K'/k) \stackrel{(3.18.151)}{\leq} \text{trdeg}(K/k)$. Taking supremum over n we reach the required result. □

Lemma 5.1.91

Let $R \subseteq S$ be proper valuation rings of K with $\dim R < \infty$. Then $\dim S \leq \dim R$, with equality iff $R = S$.

Proof. Firstly we claim that $\mathfrak{m}_S \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_R$. For $x \in \mathfrak{m}_S \implies x^{-1} \notin S \implies x^{-1} \notin R \implies x \in \mathfrak{m}_R$.

Secondly if $R \subsetneq S$ then $\mathfrak{m}_S \subsetneq \mathfrak{m}_R$. For given $x \in S \setminus R$ we have $x^{-1} \in \mathfrak{m}_R \implies x^{-1} \in S \implies x^{-1} \in S^\star \implies x^{-1} \notin \mathfrak{m}_S$.

Let $\mathfrak{p}_0 \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_n$ be a chain of prime ideals in S . As these are contained in $\mathfrak{m}_S$, they are also contained in $\mathfrak{m}_R$ and therefore R . Therefore this constitutes a chain of prime ideals in R from which we deduce the inequality. Further if $R \subsetneq S$ then we may always extend the chain by at least one prime ideal, namely $\mathfrak{m}_R$. □

Proposition 5.1.92

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ be an integral affine variety, and $\mathcal{O}_X(X) \subset R \subset k(X)$ a valuation ring. Then there exists a point $x \in X(\bar{k})$ such that R dominates $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$. Further $\dim R \leq \dim X$ with equality iff $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} = R$ as subrings of $k(X)$.

Proof. By (5.1.89) we may assume that $k(\mathfrak{m}_R)/k$ is algebraic. Choose any embedding $k(\mathfrak{m}_R)/k \hookrightarrow \bar{k}/k$ (3.18.73). Then there is a composite k -algebra homomorphism

$$\mathcal{O}_X(X) \hookrightarrow R \rightarrow k(\mathfrak{m}_R) \hookrightarrow \bar{k}$$

Let x_i be the image of the affine coordinates $\bar{X}_i$ under this homomorphism. The image $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ is a (finite) field extension of k by (3.18.57). Then under this map the image of f is $f(x)$, so the kernel is precisely $\mathfrak{M}_{X,x} = \mathfrak{m}_R \cap \mathcal{O}_X(X)$. Suppose that $f \notin \mathfrak{M}_{X,x}$ then $f \notin \mathfrak{m}_R \implies f^{-1} \in R$. In particular we conclude that $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,x}} \subset R$. Further $\mathfrak{m}_{X,x} = \mathfrak{M}_{X,x} \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_R R \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_R$, so R dominates $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ by (3.24.3).

The final statement follows from (5.1.91) and $\dim X = \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ (5.1.56). □

5.1.13 Products of Affine Varieties

In what follows we let A_{red} denote the reduced ring (resp k -algebra) $A/N(A)$.

Proposition 5.1.93

There is a canonical isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \psi : k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \otimes_k k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m] &\xrightarrow{\sim} k[X_1, \dots, X_n, Y_1, \dots, Y_m] \\ F(X_1, \dots, X_n) \otimes G(Y_1, \dots, Y_m) &\rightarrow F(X_1, \dots, X_n)G(Y_1, \dots, Y_m) \end{aligned}$$

Let $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ and $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m]$ be ideals. Then there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \otimes_k k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m] & \xrightarrow[\sim]{\psi} & k[X_1, \dots, X_n, Y_1, \dots, Y_m] \\ \downarrow \pi_1 \otimes \pi_2 & & \downarrow \\ \frac{k[X_1, \dots, X_n]}{\mathfrak{a}} \otimes_k \frac{k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m]}{\mathfrak{b}} & \xrightarrow[\sim]{\bar{\psi}} & \frac{k[X_1, \dots, X_n, Y_1, \dots, Y_m]}{\mathfrak{a}^e + \mathfrak{b}^e} \\ \overline{F \otimes G} & \longrightarrow & \overline{F(X_1, \dots, X_n)G(Y_1, \dots, Y_m)} \end{array}$$

where the bottom arrow is uniquely determined and an isomorphism. The nilradical of the right hand side is $\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}^e + \mathfrak{b}^e}/(\mathfrak{a}^e + \mathfrak{b}^e)$ and so there is a corresponding isomorphism

$$\left(\frac{k[X_1, \dots, X_n]}{\mathfrak{a}} \otimes_k \frac{k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m]}{\mathfrak{b}} \right)_{\text{red}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \frac{k[X_1, \dots, X_n, Y_1, \dots, Y_m]}{\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}^e + \mathfrak{b}^e}}$$

Proof. By (3.5.37) there is a unique k -algebra homomorphism ψ such that $\psi(F \otimes 1) = F$ and $\psi(1 \otimes G) = G$, whence $\psi(F \otimes G) = FG$. Similarly there is an inverse morphism ϕ such that $\phi(X_i) = X_i \otimes 1$ and $\phi(Y_j) = 1 \otimes Y_j$. Evidently $\phi(F(X_1, \dots, X_n)) = F \otimes 1$ and $\phi(G(Y_1, \dots, Y_m)) = 1 \otimes G$. This shows that $\phi \circ \psi = \mathbf{1}$. Similarly $(\psi \circ \phi)(X_i) = X_i$ and $(\psi \circ \phi)(Y_j) = Y_j$. This shows that $\psi \circ \phi = \mathbf{1}$ as required.

There is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k[X_1, \dots, X_n] & \xrightarrow{i} & k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \otimes_k k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m] \\ & \searrow & \downarrow \psi \\ & & k[X_1, \dots, X_n, Y_1, \dots, Y_m] \end{array}$$

By (3.5.42) $\mathfrak{a} \otimes k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m]$ is the extension of $\mathfrak{a}$ under i . As the diagram commutes we may show that $\psi(\mathfrak{a} \otimes k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m]) = \mathfrak{a}^e$ and similarly $\psi(k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \otimes \mathfrak{b}) = \mathfrak{b}^e$. Therefore by (3.4.51)

$$\psi(\mathfrak{a} \otimes k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m] + k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \otimes \mathfrak{b}) = \mathfrak{a}^e + \mathfrak{b}^e$$

By (3.5.29) $\ker(\pi_1 \otimes \pi_2) = \mathfrak{a} \otimes k[Y_1, \dots, Y_m] + k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \otimes \mathfrak{b}$ therefore $\bar{\psi}$ exists and is an isomorphism by (...). $\square$

Lemma 5.1.94

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ and $Y = V(\mathfrak{b}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^m$. Consider the affine variety $\widetilde{X \times Y} := V(\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}^e + \mathfrak{b}^e}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^{n+m}$. The projection maps

$$\begin{aligned} \pi_X : \widetilde{X \times Y}(\bar{k}) &\rightarrow X(\bar{k}) \\ \pi_Y : \widetilde{X \times Y}(\bar{k}) &\rightarrow Y(\bar{k}) \end{aligned}$$

are regular and there is an isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathcal{O}_X(X) \otimes_k \mathcal{O}_Y(Y))_{\text{red}} &\xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_{\widetilde{X \times Y}}(\widetilde{X \times Y}) \\ f \otimes g &\rightarrow (f \circ \pi_X) \cdot (g \circ \pi_Y) \end{aligned}$$

where $\pi_X : \widetilde{X \times Y}(\bar{k}) \rightarrow X(\bar{k})$ and $\pi_Y : \widetilde{X \times Y}(\bar{k}) \rightarrow Y(\bar{k})$ are the obvious regular projection maps.

Proof. It's straightforward to show that π_X and π_Y are regular using the definition (5.1.29). By (5.1.93) and (5.1.26) there is a unique morphism making the following diagram commute which must be an isomorphism, and we simply need to check it is of the required form.

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
(k[X] \otimes_k k[Y])_{\text{red}} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \widetilde{k[X \times Y]} \\
\downarrow \sim & & \downarrow \sim \\
(\mathcal{O}_X(X) \otimes_k \mathcal{O}_Y(Y))_{\text{red}} & \dashrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_{\widetilde{X \times Y}}(\widetilde{X \times Y})
\end{array}$$

Given $f \in k[X]$ and $g \in k[Y]$ where $f = \overline{F}$ and $g = \overline{G}$. Then the image of $f \otimes g$ is simply $h := \overline{F(X_1, \dots, X_n)G(Y_1, \dots, Y_n)}$ and

$$h(x_1, \dots, x_n, y_1, \dots, y_m) = f(x_1, \dots, x_n)g(y_1, \dots, y_m)$$

from which the result follows. $\square$

Proposition 5.1.95 (Affine Product)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ and $Y = V(\mathfrak{b}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^m$ be affine varieties. Then there is a bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
X(\bar{k}) \times Y(\bar{k}) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \widetilde{X \times Y}(\bar{k}) \\
(x, y) & \rightarrow & (x_1, \dots, x_n, y_1, \dots, y_m)
\end{array}$$

Define $(X(\bar{k}) \times Y(\bar{k}), \mathcal{O}_{X \times Y})$ as a local space of functions such that this bijection is a regular isomorphism.

The projection maps $\pi_X : X \times Y \rightarrow X$ and $\pi_Y : X \times Y \rightarrow Y$ are regular and for every affine variety Z we have a natural bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\text{Mor}((Z, \mathcal{O}_Z), (X \times Y, \mathcal{O}_{X \times Y})) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{Mor}((Z, \mathcal{O}_Z), (X, \mathcal{O}_X)) \times \text{Mor}((Z, \mathcal{O}_Z), (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)) \\
f & \rightarrow & ((\pi_X \circ f), (\pi_Y \circ f))
\end{array}$$

Proof. Evidently it is enough to prove all the same properties for $\widetilde{X \times Y}$, as then they follow immediately for $X \times Y$ by composing with θ , which is by construction a regular isomorphism. We have natural isomorphisms

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{Mor}(Z, \widetilde{X \times Y}) & \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_{\widetilde{X \times Y}}(\widetilde{X \times Y}), \mathcal{O}_Z(Z)) \\
& \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{AlgHom}_k((\mathcal{O}_X(X) \otimes_k \mathcal{O}_Y(Y))_{\text{red}}, \mathcal{O}_Z(Z)) \\
& \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_X(X) \otimes_k \mathcal{O}_Y(Y), \mathcal{O}_Z(Z)) \\
& \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_X(X), \mathcal{O}_Z(Z)) \times \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_Y(Y), \mathcal{O}_Z(Z)) \\
& \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Mor}(Z, X) \times \text{Mor}(Z, Y)
\end{aligned}$$

by (5.1.94) and (5.1.30). We may verify that the image of $1_{\widetilde{X \times Y}}$ is (π_X, π_Y) and so the result follows from naturality in Z . $\square$

Proposition 5.1.96 (Affine Varieties are Separated)

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular map of affine varieties. Then the graph

$$\Gamma_f(K) := \{(x, f(x)) \mid x \in X(K)\}$$

is a closed subset of $(X \times Y)(K)$. In particular the diagonal

$$\Delta_X := \{(x, x) \mid x \in X(K)\}$$

is a closed subset of $(X \times X)(K)$.

Proof. Let $\overline{X}_1, \dots, \overline{X}_n$ and $\overline{Y}_1, \dots, \overline{Y}_m$ be the coordinate functions of $k[X \times Y]$. Further we may suppose that $f = (\overline{F}_1, \dots, \overline{F}_m)$ for $F_j \in k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$. Then Γ_f is the zero locus of the ideal

$$\langle \overline{Y}_1 - F_1(\overline{X}_1, \dots, \overline{X}_n), \dots, \overline{Y}_m - F_m(\overline{X}_1, \dots, \overline{X}_n) \rangle$$

$\square$

Proposition 5.1.97 (Criteria for Product to be Integral)

Let X, Y be integral affine varieties such that either X or Y is geometrically integral (e.g. if k is algebraically closed). Then $X \times Y$ is integral.

Proof. See (3.35.39). $\square$

5.1.14 Affine Curves

Definition 5.1.98

An **affine curve** is an integral affine variety of dimension 1.

For example an irreducible polynomial $F(X, Y)$ yields an affine curve and is known as a plane curve. The singular points are precisely the common roots of

$$F, \frac{\partial F}{\partial X}, \frac{\partial F}{\partial Y}$$

in $\bar{k}^2$. If there are no such roots then the affine curve is non-singular.

Proposition 5.1.99 (Characterisation Regular Point on a curve)

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an affine curve and $x \in X(\bar{k})$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) x is regular
- b) $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is a discrete valuation ring
- c) $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is an integrally closed domain

When k is perfect then this is equivalent to x being a non-singular point.

Proof. Note that by assumption X is integral, so $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is an integral domain by (5.1.60).

a) – c) then follows directly from (3.30.2) and the fact $\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \dim X = 1$ (5.1.56). The final statement follows from (5.1.74). $\square$

Proposition 5.1.100

Let $X = V(\mathfrak{a})$ be a regular affine curve. Then there exists a bijection

$$X_0 := X(\bar{k}) / \text{Aut}(\bar{k}/k) \longleftrightarrow \{ \mathcal{O}_X(X) \subset R \subsetneq k(X) \mid R \text{ valuation ring} \}$$

Proof. The map $x \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is well-defined by (5.1.99), (5.1.9) and (5.1.59). If $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \mathcal{O}_{X,y}$ then $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}^* = \mathcal{O}_{X,y}^* \implies \mathfrak{m}_{X,x} = \mathfrak{m}_{X,y} \implies \mathfrak{M}_{X,x} = \mathfrak{M}_{X,y} \implies x \sim y$ by (5.1.9) so the map is injective.

To show surjectivity, observe by (5.1.92) there exists $x \in X(\bar{k})$ such that $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} \subseteq R$. Furthermore by repeated application of (5.1.91) we see

$$0 < \dim R \leq \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \stackrel{(5.1.56)}{=} \dim X = 1$$

This forces $\dim R = \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} = 1$ and so $R = \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ by the same result. $\square$

5.2 Abstract Varieties

In order to deal with affine, quasi-affine, projective and quasi-projective varieties uniformly it is convenient to define an abstract variety. Further some constructions are more natural in this setting (for example product variety). This is analogous to the notion of manifold, and much closer to the notion of scheme. Some differences

- a) Sections of the structure sheaf are concrete $\bar{k}$ -valued functions rather than abstract elements of a ring in the case of a scheme.
- b) When k is not algebraically closed the underlying topological space of the corresponding scheme is the Kolmogorov Quotient (sober-ified to include all the possible generic points). When k is algebraically closed the only difference is the inclusion of generic points.
- c) Varieties here are always Noetherian (i.e. there is a finite affine cover and the affines are themselves Noetherian).

The differences are primarily psychological and almost all the theory carries over *mutatis mutandis* to the scheme setting, with additional hypotheses where necessary.

Definition 5.2.1 (Abstract Variety)

A **variety** over a field k is a *space with functions* $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ such that

- There exists a finite open cover $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ together with isomorphisms

$$\theta_i : (U_i, \mathcal{O}_X|_{U_i}) \cong (X_i(\bar{k}), \mathcal{O}_{X_i})$$

for some affine varieties $X_1, \dots, X_n$ in the sense of (5.1.4).

The sheaf $\mathcal{O}_X$ is called the **structure sheaf** or **sheaf of regular functions**. A regular morphism is then a morphism of space with functions.

It is immediate that every affine variety is an abstract variety.

Proposition 5.2.2

A variety $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ is a local space with functions. That is for all $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$, the set

$$D(f) := \{x \in U \mid f(x) \neq 0\}$$

is open and $f|_U$ is invertible.

Proof. We have an open affine cover $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$. Then we have

$$D(f) = \bigcup_{i=1}^n D(f|_{U_i})$$

By (5.1.40) $D(f|_{U_i})$ is open and $f|_{U_i}$ is invertible. We deduce that $D(f)$ is open, and using the sheaf conditions that $f|_{D(f)}$ is invertible. $\square$

Definition 5.2.3 (Affine (Abstract) Variety)

Let X be a space of functions. We say it is an **affine variety** if it is isomorphic to $(Y(\bar{k}), \mathcal{O}_Y)$, where Y is an affine variety in the sense of (5.1.4) and $\mathcal{O}_Y$ is the corresponding sheaf of regular functions (5.1.25).

Proposition 5.2.4

Let X be a variety and $f : X \rightarrow \bar{k}$ be a function. Then it is regular iff the corresponding map $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{A}_k^1(\bar{k})$ is a regular morphism of abstract varieties.

Proof. Suppose that $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{A}_k^1(\bar{k})$ is a regular morphism. Evidently the identity map $1 : \mathbb{A}_k^1(\bar{k}) \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is a regular function. Therefore by definition $f : X \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is a regular function.

Conversely if $f : X \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is regular then so is $f|_U$ for every affine open subset $U \subset X$. By (5.1.29) and (5.1.39) this a regular morphism of abstract varieties $U \rightarrow \mathbb{A}_k^1(\bar{k})$. By (4.3.27) we have f is a regular morphism. $\square$

5.2.1 Topological Properties

Definition 5.2.5 (Integral Variety)

We say a variety X is **integral** (or **irreducible**) if it is irreducible as a topological space.

Proposition 5.2.6 (Criteria for Integrality)

Let X be a variety. Then the following are equivalent

- a) X is integral

b) $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ is integral for every open subset $U \subset X$

Proposition 5.2.7 (Varieties are Noetherian and Hereditarily Quasi-Compact)

Let X be a variety. Then X is Noetherian as a topological space and every open subset is quasi-compact (and Noetherian).

Proof. (4.1.69) and (4.1.104). □

Corollary 5.2.8

Let X be a variety. Then it may be expressed uniquely as a finite union of (closed) irreducible components.

$$X = X_1 \cup \dots \cup X_n$$

Proof. See (4.1.67). □

Proposition 5.2.9

Suppose $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ is a space with functions such that $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ and $(U_i, \mathcal{O}_X|_{U_i})$ is a variety. Then so is $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$.

Proof. Each U_i is a finite union of affine varieties and therefore so is X . □

Proposition 5.2.10

Let X be a variety. The (affine) principal open subsets form a base for the topology on X .

Proof. □

Proposition 5.2.11 (Varieties are Symmetric)

Let X be a variety. Then X is *symmetric* as a topological space and $\overline{\{x\}}$ is finite for all $x \in X$. When k is algebraically closed then every point is closed and therefore X is Kolmogorov.

Furthermore for every open neighbourhood U of x we have $\overline{\{x\}} = \text{cl}_U(\{x\})$.

Proof. That X is symmetric is from (4.1.42) and the affine case (5.1.18). The last statement follows from (4.1.41), then finiteness follows from the affine case. □

Proposition 5.2.12 (Closed Subsets of Dimension 0)

Let X be a variety and $Z \subset X$ a closed subset. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\dim Z = 0$
- b) $Z = \overline{\{z_1\}} \cup \dots \cup \overline{\{z_n\}}$ for some $z_1, \dots, z_n \in Z$
- c) Z is finite

Proof. Recall X is Noetherian (5.2.7) and therefore by (4.1.82) we have a) $\iff$ b). Then b) $\implies$ c) is (5.2.11) and conversely if Z is finite then $Z = \bigcup_{z \in Z} \overline{\{z\}}$ is a finite union. □

Definition 5.2.13 (Separated Variety)

Let X be a variety. Then we say X is **separated** if for every affine variety Z and pair of morphisms $\phi_1, \phi_2 : Z \rightrightarrows X$ the equaliser

$$\{z \in Z \mid \phi_1(z) = \phi_2(z)\}$$

is closed in Z .

By (5.1.42) every affine variety is separated.

Proposition 5.2.14

Let X be a separated variety and Z a variety. Then the equaliser of any two maps $\phi_1, \phi_2 : Z \rightrightarrows X$ is closed.

Proof. By definition $Z = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ where U_i is affine. By assumption the equaliser of $\phi_1|_{U_i}, \phi_2|_{U_i} : U_i \rightrightarrows X$ is closed. As a finite union of closed sets is closed, we are done. □

5.2.2 Local Ring

We recall the definition of local ring (4.3.3) for a variety X with irreducible subset W

$$\mathcal{O}_{X,W} := \varinjlim_{U \cap W \neq \emptyset} \mathcal{O}_X(U).$$

Note that if $\overline{W'} = \overline{W}$ then $\mathcal{O}_{X,W} = \mathcal{O}_{X,W'}$, so for example $\mathcal{O}_{X,W} = \mathcal{O}_{X,\overline{W}}$.

In the case $W = \{x\}$ we write $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ for the local ring and $\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}$ and $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x})$ for the maximal ideal and residue field respectively.

In the case $X = W$ is irreducible then we recover the **field of rational functions** written $k(X)$. For a variety we can make stronger statement about the structure of $k(X)$

Proposition 5.2.15

Let X be an integral variety, $x \in X$ and U an open neighbourhood of x . Then there are canonical injections

$$\mathcal{O}_X(U) \hookrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \hookrightarrow k(X)$$

which makes $k(X)$ the field of fractions for $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$. When U is affine then $k(X)$ is also the field of fractions for $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$. These maps commute with the restriction maps on $\mathcal{O}_X$, which are also injective.

Proof. By restricting to an affine open cover we may check that the restriction maps ρ_{UV} are injective. This shows that the first map is injective because every stalk can be lifted to some open neighbourhood.

Let U be an affine open neighbourhood of x then by (4.3.16) $k(X) \xrightarrow{\sim} k(U)$. We may deduce from the affine case (5.1.59) that $k(X)$ is the field of fractions for $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ and $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$. $\square$

As $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is isomorphic to the local ring of an affine neighbourhood we can recover many statements from the affine case.

Proposition 5.2.16

Let X be a variety and $W \subset X$ an irreducible subset. Then the following are equivalent

- a) W is contained in only one irreducible component
- b) $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ is an integral domain

Proof. Firstly we may reduce to the case W is closed by considering $\overline{W}$. As X is a variety, $W \cap U \neq \emptyset$ for U affine. By (4.1.64) we may reduce to the case X is affine, which is (5.1.60). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.17 (Dominant Morphisms induce Function Field Maps)

Let X, Y be integral varieties and $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ a dominant regular morphism. Then there is a canonical injective k -algebra homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \phi_* : k(Y) &\hookrightarrow k(X) \\ (V, \sigma) &\mapsto (\phi^{-1}(V), \sigma \circ \phi) \end{aligned}$$

This is functorial in the sense that

$$(\phi \circ \psi)_* = \psi_* \circ \phi_*$$

If ϕ is an open immersion then ϕ_* is an isomorphism.

Proof. See (4.3.7) and (4.3.16). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.18 (Function Field Maps are compatible)

Let X, Y be integral varieties, $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ a dominant regular morphism and $y \in \overline{\{\phi(x)\}}$. Then for all neighbourhoods V of y we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_Y(V) & \xrightarrow{\phi_V^\sharp} & \mathcal{O}_X(\phi^{-1}(V)) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathcal{O}_{Y,\phi(x)} & \xrightarrow{\phi_x} & \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ k(Y) & \xrightarrow{\phi_*} & k(X) \end{array}$$

In particular when identified as subrings of $k(X)$ and $k(Y)$ we have the identities

$$\phi_{\star}^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_{X,x}) = \mathcal{O}_{Y,\phi(x)}$$

and

$$\phi_{\star}^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_X(\phi^{-1}(V))) = \mathcal{O}_Y(V)$$

Proof. See (4.3.9) and (5.2.15). □

Lemma 5.2.19

For a variety X , R an algebraic k -algebra and $\phi : \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \rightarrow R$ a k -algebra homomorphism. Then $\phi^{-1}(\mathfrak{m}) = \mathfrak{m}_{X,x}$ for every maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m} \triangleleft R$.

Proof. Restatement of (5.1.61), since $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is isomorphic to local ring of affine neighbourhood. □

Proposition 5.2.20 (Equivalent Points)

Let X be a variety and $x, y \in X$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) x, y are topologically indistinguishable
- b) $x \in \overline{\{y\}}$
- c) $y \in \overline{\{x\}}$
- d) $\overline{\{x\}} = \overline{\{y\}}$
- e) $[x] = [y]$ in the Kolmogorov Quotient X_0

When X is integral these are equivalent to $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \mathcal{O}_{X,y}$ as subrings of $k(X)$.

Proof. By (5.2.11) X is symmetric and the equivalent conditions a) – e) follow from (4.1.40).

If $x \sim y$ then by definition $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \mathcal{O}_{X,y}$.

Conversely suppose $f \in \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \setminus \mathcal{O}_{X,y}$ in $k(X)$. In some open neighbourhood U of x we have $f = \frac{g}{h}$ for $g, h \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ and $h(x) \neq 0$. By definition we must have $h(y) = 0$. Therefore $D(h)$ contains x but not y , and therefore x and y are not topologically indistinguishable. □

5.2.3 Affine Varieties

We restate various results relating to “abstract” affine varieties to avoid the need to switch notations later on.

Proposition 5.2.21 (Properties of the Structure Sheaf)

Let X be an abstract variety $U \subset X$ an affine open subset. Then the following properties hold

- a) For all irreducible subsets $W \subset U$ we have $\mathfrak{M}_{U,W} := \{f \in \mathcal{O}_X(U) \mid f|_W = 0\}$ is a prime ideal of $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$. Further we have a canonical local isomorphism

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_X(U) & & \\ \downarrow & \searrow \rho_W & \\ \mathcal{O}_X(U)_{\mathfrak{M}_{U,W}} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_{X,W} \end{array}$$

which is the unique homomorphism making this diagram commute.

The inverse image of $\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}$ is $\mathfrak{M}_{U,W}\mathcal{O}_X(U)_{\mathfrak{M}_{U,W}}$ and $\mathfrak{M}_{U,W}$ in $\mathcal{O}_X(U)_{\mathfrak{M}_{U,W}}$ and $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ respectively.

When $W \subset \overline{\{x\}}$ then $\mathfrak{M}_{U,W} = \mathfrak{M}_{U,x}$ is a maximal ideal.

- b) There is a well-defined bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U_0 & \longleftrightarrow & \text{Specm}(\mathcal{O}_X(U)) \\ x & \rightarrow & \mathfrak{M}_{U,x} \end{array}$$

Further $\mathfrak{M}_{U,x} = \mathfrak{M}_{U,x'} \iff x \in \overline{\{x'\}} \iff x$ and x' are topologically indistinguishable.

- c) For all $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ we have $(D(f), \mathcal{O}_X|_{D(f)})$ is an affine variety. Further we have a canonical isomorphism

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{O}_X(U) & & \\
\downarrow & \searrow \rho_{XD(f)} & \\
\mathcal{O}_X(U)_f & \dashrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_X(D(f))
\end{array}$$

which is the unique homomorphism making this diagram commute. For irreducible $W \subset D(f)$, under this isomorphism the inverse image of $\mathfrak{M}_{D(f),W}$ is $(\mathfrak{M}_{U,W})_f$. Similarly the following diagram commutes

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{O}_X(U)_f & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_X(D(f)) \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow \\
\mathcal{O}_X(U)_{\mathfrak{M}_{U,W}} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_{X,W}
\end{array}$$

and the inverse image of $\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}$ is $\mathfrak{M}_{D(f),W}$ and $(\mathfrak{M}_{U,W})_f$ in $\mathcal{O}_X(D(f))$ and $\mathcal{O}_X(U)_f$ respectively.

- d) Suppose X, Y are affine varieties and $W \subset X$ is irreducible and $Z \subset \overline{\phi(W)}$ for some irreducible $Z \subset Y$. Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism. Then the stalk map $\phi_W : \mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ (see (4.3.5)) makes the following diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{O}_Y(Y) & \xrightarrow{\phi^\#} & \mathcal{O}_X(X) \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow \\
\mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} & \xrightarrow{\phi_W} & \mathcal{O}_{X,W} \\
\downarrow \sim & & \downarrow \sim \\
\mathcal{O}_Y(Y)_{\mathfrak{M}_{Y,Z}} & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}}
\end{array}$$

where the bottom arrow is the localisation map induced by $\phi^\#$ (3.7.20). In fact it is the unique map making either square commute.

Proposition 5.2.22 (Affine Mapping Property)

Let Y be an affine variety, and X a variety. Then there is a canonical bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\text{Mor}(X, Y) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_Y(Y), \mathcal{O}_X(X)) \\
\phi & \rightarrow & \phi_Y^\#
\end{array}$$

When X is affine and $Z \subset Y$, $W \subset X$ are irreducible subsets, then

$$Z \subset \overline{\phi(W)} \iff (\phi_Y^\#)^{-1}(\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}) \subset \mathfrak{M}_{Y,Z}$$

Proof. When X is affine then this is just (5.1.30) and (5.1.32). In general suppose $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ is an affine covering then we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\text{Mor}(X, Y) & \xrightarrow{(-)^\#} & \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_Y(Y), \mathcal{O}_X(X)) \\
\downarrow \alpha & & \downarrow \beta \\
\prod_{i=1}^n \text{Mor}(U_i, Y) & \xrightarrow{\gamma} & \prod_{i=1}^n \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_Y(Y), \mathcal{O}_X(U_i))
\end{array}$$

where $\alpha(\phi)_i = \phi|_{U_i}$ and $\beta(\psi)_i = \rho_{XU_i} \circ \psi$ and γ is the same definition as $(-)^\#$.

By the affine case γ is bijective, and evidently α is injective. Therefore $\beta \circ (-)^\#$ is injective, whence $(-)^\#$ is injective. To show surjectivity consider $\psi \in \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_Y(Y), \mathcal{O}_X(X))$ then as γ is bijective we have maps $\phi_i : U_i \rightarrow X$ such that $(\phi_i)^\# = \rho_{YU_i} \circ \psi$. Suppose $V \subset U_i \cap U_j$ is affine then

$$(\phi_i|_V)^\# = \rho_{U_i V} \circ \rho_{XU_i} \circ \psi = \rho_{XV} \circ \psi$$

Therefore $(\phi_i|_V)^\# = (\phi_j|_V)^\#$ and from the affine case $\phi_i|_V = \phi_j|_V$. As the open affines form a base (5.2.10) we conclude $\phi_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = \phi_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$. Therefore there exists a morphism $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ such that $\phi|_{U_i} = \phi_i$ and therefore $\beta(\phi^\#) = \beta(\psi)$. Evidently β is injective and so $\phi^\# = \psi$. $\square$

Corollary 5.2.23

There is a full and faithful contravariant functor

$$\mathbf{AbstractAffVar}_k \longrightarrow \mathbf{ReducedFGAlgebras}_k$$

which in particular preserves and reflects isomorphisms

Corollary 5.2.24

Let X be an affine variety, Y a variety and $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$. Then there is a canonical bijection

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}(D(f), Y) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_Y(Y), \mathcal{O}_X(X)_f) \\ \phi &\longrightarrow \theta_f \circ \phi_Y^\# \end{aligned}$$

where $\theta_f : \mathcal{O}_X(D(f)) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_X(X)_f$ is the isomorphism (5.2.21).c). The image of $i : D(f) \rightarrow X$ is simply the canonical localisation map.

Suppose Y is affine and $W \subset D(f)$, $Z \subset Y$ are irreducible subsets. Then $Z \subset \overline{\phi(W)} \iff (\theta_f \circ \phi_Y^\#)^{-1}((\mathfrak{M}_{X,W})_f) \subset \mathfrak{M}_{Y,Z}$.

Proof. We may apply (5.2.22). □

Corollary 5.2.25

Let X be an affine variety and $\phi, \psi : X \rightarrow Y$ regular morphisms, and $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$. Then $\phi|_{D(f)} = \psi|_{D(f)}$ if and only if $\rho_f \circ \phi^\# = \rho_f \circ \psi^\#$, where $\rho_f : \mathcal{O}_X(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(X)_f$ is the canonical localisation map.

Proof. Denote by $i : D(f) \hookrightarrow X$ the inclusion then by (5.2.22) $\phi|_{D(f)} = \psi|_{D(f)} \iff \phi \circ i = \psi \circ i \iff i^\# \circ \phi^\# = i^\# \circ \psi^\#$ where $i^\# : \mathcal{O}_X(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{D(f)}(D(f))$ is simply the restriction map. We may compose this with the isomorphism (5.2.21).c) to get the required result. □

There are some properties of affine varieties with generalise

Proposition 5.2.26

Let X be an affine variety and $f_1, \dots, f_r \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^r D(f_i)$
- b) $(f_1, \dots, f_r) = \mathcal{O}_X(X)$

Proof. We may reduce to the case of X a concrete affine variety. Then

$$X = \bigcup_{i=1}^r D(f_i) \iff \emptyset = \bigcap_{i=1}^r V(f_i) = V(f_1, \dots, f_r) \iff k[X] = IV(f_1, \dots, f_r) = \sqrt{(f_1, \dots, f_r)} \iff k[X] = (f_1, \dots, f_r)$$

where we have identified $\mathcal{O}_X(X)$ and $k[X]$. □

Proposition 5.2.27

Let X be a variety and $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$. There is a canonical isomorphism

$$\mathcal{O}_X(X)_f \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_X(D(f))$$

Proof. The following is adapted from [Liu06, Prop. 2.3.12].

Recall (5.2.2) that $D(f)$ is an open subset and $f|_{D(f)}$ is invertible. This shows that the homomorphism is well-defined, and we simply need to show it is bijective, with the case X affine already proven (5.1.28).

Let $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ be an affine open covering then $D(f) = \bigcup_{i=1}^n D(f|_{U_i})$. By the affine case we have an isomorphism

$$\mathcal{O}_X(U_i)_{f|_{U_i}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_X(D(f|_{U_i}))$$

By the sheaf conditions we have an exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}_X(X)$ -modules

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(X) \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \mathcal{O}_X(U_i) \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{i,j=1}^n \mathcal{O}_X(U_i \cap U_j)$$

Localising at $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$ is exact (3.7.11) and commutes with direct sums (...) so we obtain the exact sequences

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_X(X)_f & \longrightarrow & \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \mathcal{O}_X(U_i)_{f|_{U_i}} & \longrightarrow & \bigoplus_{i,j=1}^n \mathcal{O}_X(U_i \cap U_j)_{f|_{U_i \cap U_j}} \\ & & \downarrow \alpha & & \downarrow \beta & & \downarrow \gamma \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_X(D(f)) & \longrightarrow & \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \mathcal{O}_X(D(f|_{U_i})) & \longrightarrow & \bigoplus_{i,j=1}^n \mathcal{O}_X(D(f|_{U_i \cap U_j})) \end{array}$$

where α, β, γ are just the canonical maps already defined. By the affine case β is an isomorphism. We claim that diagram chasing shows α is injective, for suppose that $\alpha(x) = 0$ then $\alpha(x)|_{D(f|_{U_i})} = 0$ whence $x|_{U_i} = 0$, and by exactness $x = 0$. As $U_i \cap U_j$ is a variety, then we conclude γ is also injective.

We further claim that α is surjective, for given $y \in \mathcal{O}_X(D(f))$ then there exists $x_i \in \mathcal{O}_X(U_i)_{f_i}$ such that $\beta(x_i) = y|_{D(f|_{U_i})}$. From injectivity of γ and exactness of the bottom sequence we conclude that $x_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = x_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$, and so by exactness of the top sequence there is $x \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)_f$ such that $x|_{U_i} = x_i$. Consequently $\alpha(x)|_{D(f|_{U_i})} = y|_{D(f|_{U_i})}$. Exactness of the bottom sequence shows that $\alpha(x) = y$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.28

Let X be a variety and suppose $f_1, \dots, f_r \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$ generate $\mathcal{O}_X(X)$. If $D(f_i)$ is an affine variety for all $i = 1 \dots r$ then so is X . Furthermore

$$X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n D(f_i)$$

Proof. First we claim that $\mathcal{O}_X(X)$ is a reduced finitely generated k -algebra. Recall by (5.2.27) there is a k -algebra isomorphism $\mathcal{O}_X(X)_{f_i} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_X(D(f_i))$. By assumption $D(f_i)$ is affine so $\mathcal{O}_X(X)_{f_i}$ is finitely-generated as a k -algebra. Therefore by (3.23.21) so is $\mathcal{O}_X(X)$.

By (5.1.36) we may find an affine variety Z together with an isomorphism $\phi^\# : \mathcal{O}_Z(Z) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_X(X)$. By (5.2.22) there is a corresponding morphism of varieties $\phi : X \rightarrow Z$, which we wish to show is an isomorphism. Let $\tilde{f}_i := (\phi^\#)^{-1}(f_i)$ then by definition $\phi^{-1}(D(\tilde{f}_i)) = D(f_i)$.

We have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_Z(Z) & \xrightarrow[\sim]{\phi^\#} & \mathcal{O}_X(X) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathcal{O}_Z(D(\tilde{f}_i)) & \xrightarrow{\phi^\#} & \mathcal{O}_X(D(f_i)) \\ \sim \uparrow (5.2.27) & & (5.2.27) \uparrow \sim \\ \mathcal{O}_Z(Z)_{\tilde{f}_i} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_X(X)_{f_i} \end{array}$$

whence the middle arrow is an isomorphism. As $D(f_i)$ is an affine variety we deduce from (5.2.23) that $\phi|_{D(f_i)} : D(f_i) \xrightarrow{\sim} D(\tilde{f}_i)$ is a regular isomorphism. Further $X = \phi^{-1}(Z)$ whence the $D(f_i)$ cover X and ϕ is a regular isomorphism as required. $\square$

5.2.4 Lifting Stalk Maps

In the same way that stalks can be lifted to an open neighbourhood, for varieties we can lift stalk maps to an open neighbourhood. After reducing to the affine case this is essentially an algebraic statement about localisation.

Proposition 5.2.29 (Lifting Stalk Maps I)

Let $\phi, \psi : X \rightarrow Y$ be regular morphisms of varieties and $W \subset X$, $Z \subset Y$ non-empty irreducible subsets. Suppose

- a) $Z \subset \overline{\phi(W)} = \overline{\psi(W)}$, and
- b) the stalk maps $\phi_W, \psi_W : \mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ agree.

Then there exists an open subset $U \subset X$ for which $U \cap W \neq \emptyset$ and $\phi|_U = \psi|_U$.

Proof. For any open subset $V' \subset Y$ meeting Z (and therefore $\phi(W)$ (4.1.19)), then $\phi^{-1}(V')$ meets W . Similarly for ψ . So by irreducibility $\phi^{-1}(V') \cap \psi^{-1}(V')$ meets W (4.1.51).

Let $V \subset Y$ be an affine open subset meeting Z and choose an affine open subset $U \subset \phi^{-1}(V) \cap \psi^{-1}(V)$ meeting W .

From (4.3.19) we have a commutative cube for every open subset $V' \subset V$

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
& \mathcal{O}_X(\phi^{-1}(V') \cap \psi^{-1}(V')) & \xlongequal{\quad} & \mathcal{O}_U(U \cap \phi^{-1}(V') \cap \psi^{-1}(V')) & \\
& \nearrow \phi^\# & \downarrow & \nearrow (\phi|_U)^\# & \downarrow \\
\mathcal{O}_Y(V') & \xlongequal{\quad} & \mathcal{O}_V(V') & & \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\
& \mathcal{O}_{X,W} & \xrightarrow{\quad} & \mathcal{O}_{U,W \cap U} & \\
& \nearrow \phi_W & \downarrow & \nearrow (\phi|_U)_{W \cap U} & \\
\mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} & \xrightarrow{\quad} & \mathcal{O}_{V,Z \cap V} & &
\end{array}$$

By uniqueness of the bottom square we conclude that $(\phi|_U)_{W \cap U} = (\psi|_U)_{W \cap U}$ and we may reduce to the case of X and Y affine.

By (5.2.25) it is sufficient to find $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$ such that $\rho_f \circ \phi_Y^\# = \rho_f \circ \psi_Y^\#$. Suppose that $D(f) \cap W \neq \emptyset$ and consider the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{O}_Y(Y) & \xrightarrow[\psi^\#]{\phi^\#} & \mathcal{O}_X(X) \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow \rho_f \\
& & \mathcal{O}_X(X)_f \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow \\
\mathcal{O}_Y(Y)_{\mathfrak{M}_{Y,Z}} & \xrightarrow[\psi_W]{\phi_W} & \mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}}
\end{array}$$

where we have used (5.2.21) to replace $\mathcal{O}_{Y,Z}$ with $\mathcal{O}_Y(Y)_{\mathfrak{M}_{Y,Z}}$ and $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ with $\mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}}$.

Let $y_1, \dots, y_n$ be generators for $\mathcal{O}_Y$. Then by assumption there exists $t_i \notin \mathfrak{M}_{X,W}$ such that $t_i \phi^\#(y_i) = t_i \psi^\#(y_i)$. In particular $f = t_1 \cdots t_n$ works, since then $f \phi^\#(y_i) = f \psi^\#(y_i)$ for all i . $\square$

Proposition 5.2.30 (Lifting Stalk Maps II)

Let X, Y be varieties, $W \subset X$, $Z \subset Y$ irreducible subsets and suppose there exists a local k -algebra homomorphism $\phi_W : \mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,W}$. Then there exists an open subset $U \subset X$ and a regular morphism $\phi : U \rightarrow Y$ such that $\bar{Z} = \phi(W \cap U)$ and the following diagram commutes for all open subsets $V \subset Y$ meeting Z and $U' \subset \phi^{-1}(V)$ meeting W

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{O}_Y(V) & \xrightarrow{\phi^\#} & \mathcal{O}_X(U') \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow \\
\mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} & \xrightarrow{\phi_W} & \mathcal{O}_{X,W}
\end{array}$$

Proof. Let $Y' \subset Y$ be an open affine subset meeting Z , and $X' \subset \phi^{-1}(V)$ an affine open subset meeting W .

Then $W \cap X'$ is an irreducible subset of X' and similarly for $Z \cap Y'$ (...).

For every open subset $U \subset X'$ meeting W we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
& \mathcal{O}_X(U) & \xlongequal{\quad} & \mathcal{O}_{X'}(U) & \\
& \nearrow \phi^\# & \downarrow & \nearrow \phi^\# & \downarrow \\
\mathcal{O}_Y(Y') & \xlongequal{\quad} & \mathcal{O}_{Y'}(Y') & & \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\
& \mathcal{O}_{X,W} & \xrightarrow{\quad} & \mathcal{O}_{X',W \cap X'} & \\
& \nearrow \phi_W & \downarrow & \nearrow \phi_{W \cap X'} & \\
\mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} & \xrightarrow{\quad} & \mathcal{O}_{Y',Z \cap Y'} & &
\end{array}$$

Therefore we may assume without loss of generality that X and Y are affine, because we may reduce to finding a regular morphism $\phi : U \rightarrow Y'$.

We wish to find $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$ and $\phi_Y^\#$ which completes the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{O}_Y(Y) & \xrightarrow{\phi_Y^\sharp} & \mathcal{O}_X(X)_f \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow \\
i_Z \left(\mathcal{O}_{Y,Z} \right. & \xrightarrow{\phi_W^\sharp} & \left. \mathcal{O}_{X,W} \right) i_f \\
\downarrow \sim & & \downarrow \sim \\
\mathcal{O}_Y(Y)_{\mathfrak{M}_{Y,Z}} & \xrightarrow{\phi_W^\sharp} & \mathcal{O}_X(X)_{\mathfrak{M}_{X,W}}
\end{array}$$

For then a regular morphism $\phi : D(f) \rightarrow Y$ exists by (5.2.24). and by uniqueness (5.2.21).d) it has the required stalk map. As (5.2.19) $\phi_W^\sharp$ is local we may chase the diagram to show that $(\phi^\sharp)_Y^{-1}((\mathfrak{M}_{X,W})_f) = \mathfrak{M}_{Y,Z}$ and therefore $\overline{Z} = \overline{\phi(W \cap D(f))}$ as required.

By inspection it is sufficient to find f such that i_f is injective and $\text{Im}(\phi_W^\sharp \circ i_Z) \subset \text{Im}(i_f)$. We may find g such that i_g is injective by (3.7.31). Suppose $\mathcal{O}_Y(Y)$ is generated by $y_1, \dots, y_m$ then $\phi_W^\sharp(y_i/1) = x_i/g_i$ for some $g_i \notin \mathfrak{M}_{X,W}$. Then $f = gg_1 \dots g_m$ satisfies both criteria. As the stalk map is uniquely defined such that the diagram commutes we find that the regular morphism ϕ has stalk map precisely $\phi_W^\sharp$. $\square$

Corollary 5.2.31 (Lifting Stalk Maps I)

Let X, Y be varieties, $x \in X$ and $\phi, \psi : X \rightarrow Y$ regular morphisms for which

- a) $\overline{\{\phi(x)\}} = \overline{\{\psi(x)\}}$
- b) $\phi_x = \psi_x$

. Then there exists an open neighbourhood U of x such that $\phi|_U = \psi|_U$

Corollary 5.2.32 (Lifting Stalk Maps II)

Let X, Y be varieties and $\phi_x^\sharp : \mathcal{O}_{Y,y} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ a local k -algebra homomorphism. Then there exists an open subset $U \subset X$ and a regular morphism $\phi : U \rightarrow Y$ such that $y \in \overline{\{\phi(x)\}}$ and has stalk map precisely $\phi_x^\sharp$.

5.2.5 Open Subvarieties

Proposition 5.2.33 (Open Subset is Abstract Variety)

Let X be a variety (resp. separated variety) and $U \subset X$ an open subset. Then $(U, \mathcal{O}_X|_U)$ is a variety (resp. separated variety), which we call an **open subvariety**. We may write $\mathcal{O}_U := \mathcal{O}_X|_U$.

The inclusion $i : U \hookrightarrow X$ is an open immersion and an open immersion $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ induces an isomorphism between X and the open subvariety $\phi(X)$.

Proof. By definition $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ where U_i is affine. By (...) we have

$$U \cap U_i = \bigcup_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}_i} D(f_\alpha)$$

where $f_\alpha \in \mathcal{O}_X(U_i)$. By (5.2.21) $(D(f_\alpha), \mathcal{O}_X|_{D(f_\alpha)})$ is affine. Therefore we have an open cover of affine sets. By (5.2.7) U is quasi-compact and therefore there exists a finite affine cover. This shows that U is a variety.

Clearly the inclusion map $U \rightarrow X$ is injective and regular and so we see that U inherits separatedness. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.34 (Quasi-Affine Varieties are Abstract Varieties)

Let X be a quasi-affine variety. Then $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ is a separated variety. More precisely there exists a full and faithful functor

$$\mathbf{QuasiAffVar}_k \longrightarrow \mathbf{Var}_k$$

Proof. This follows from (5.2.33) and (5.1.39) $\square$

Proposition 5.2.35 (Morphisms into Open Subvarieties)

Let X, Y be varieties and $U \subset Y$ an open subvariety. Then a regular map $\phi : X \rightarrow U$ is regular when regarded as a map $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$.

Conversely a regular map $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ such that $\phi(X) \subset U$ may be regarded as a regular map $\phi : X \rightarrow U$.

Proposition 5.2.36 (Morphisms from Open Subvarieties)

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular map of varieties and $U \subset X$ an open subvariety. Then $\phi|_U : U \rightarrow Y$ is a regular map.

Proposition 5.2.37 (Patching Varieties)

Suppose $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ is a finite union of sets, $(U_i, \mathcal{O}_{U_i})$ is a variety, and suppose that for all $i, j = 1 \dots n$

- $U_i \cap U_j$ is open in U_j , and
- the identity map $1 : (U_i \cap U_j, \mathcal{O}_{U_i}|_{U_i \cap U_j}) \rightarrow (U_j \cap U_i, \mathcal{O}_{U_j}|_{U_i \cap U_j})$ is a regular morphism of spaces of functions .

Then there exists a unique structure of a variety on X such that

- U_i is open in X , and
- $\mathcal{O}_{U_i} = \mathcal{O}_X|_{U_i}$.

Proposition 5.2.38 (Glueing Varieties)

Suppose $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ is a finite union of sets and there exists bijections $\theta_i : U_i \xrightarrow{\sim} W_i$, with W_i varieties such that for all $i, j = 1 \dots n$

- $\theta_i(U_i \cap U_j)$ is open in W_i , and
- $\theta_{ij} = \theta_j \circ \theta_i^{-1} : \theta_i(U_i \cap U_j) \rightarrow \theta_j(U_i \cap U_j)$ is regular .

Then there exists a unique structure of a variety on X such that

- U_i is open in X , and
- θ_i is a regular isomorphism.

Proof. The topology exists by (4.3.26) and we may simply define

$$\mathcal{O}_X(U) := \{f : U \rightarrow \bar{k} \mid f \circ \theta_i^{-1}|_{\theta_i(U_i \cap U)} \text{ regular for all } i = 1 \dots n\}$$

which gives X the structure of a space of functions. As each U_i is a finite union of affine varieties, so is X . $\square$

5.2.6 Closed Subvarieties

Proposition 5.2.39 (Affine Closed Subvarieties)

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be an affine variety with explicit isomorphism $\theta : X \cong V(\mathfrak{a})$, and $Z \subset X$ a closed subset. Then the structure $(Z, \mathcal{O}_Z)$ defined in (4.3.21) is also affine with explicit isomorphism $\theta|_Z : Z \cong V(\mathfrak{b})$ where $\mathfrak{b} := I(\theta(Z))$.

Proof. This follows largely from (5.1.43). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.40 (Closed Subvariety)

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a variety with Z a closed subset. Then $(Z, \mathcal{O}_Z)$ with the structure defined in (4.3.21) is a variety.

Proof. By assumption $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ with $(U_i, \mathcal{O}_{U_i})$ affine. Evidently $Z = \bigcup_{i=1}^n (U_i \cap Z)$ is an open cover. Further $U_i \cap Z$ is a closed subset of U_i . By (5.2.39) $(U_i \cap Z, \mathcal{O}_{U_i}|_{U_i \cap Z}) \stackrel{(4.3.24)}{=} (U_i \cap Z, \mathcal{O}_Z|_{U_i \cap Z})$ is affine. Therefore Z is a variety. $\square$

Definition 5.2.41 (Closed Immersion)

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of varieties. Then it is a **closed immersion** if $\phi(X)$ is closed in Y and ϕ determines an isomorphism between X and the closed subvariety $\phi(X)$.

Proposition 5.2.42 (Closed Subvariety is a Variety)

Let X be a variety and $Z \subset X$ a closed subset. Then the space with functions $(Z, \mathcal{O}_Z)$ is a variety and the map $j : (Z, \mathcal{O}_Z) \rightarrow (X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ is a closed immersion.

When X is affine, then so is Z and the map $j^\# : \mathcal{O}_X(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_Z(Z)$ is surjective.

Proof. By definition $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ where U_i is affine. Then $Z \cap U_i$ is a closed subset of U_i and by (5.2.47) $\mathcal{O}_Z|_{Z \cap U_i} = \mathcal{O}_{U_i}|_{Z \cap U_i}$. Therefore by (5.2.39) $Z \cap U_i$ is affine, and open in Z . This shows that Z is a variety.

Suppose $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ then $f \circ j \in \mathcal{O}_Z(Z \cap U)$, which shows that j is a regular morphism.

The final statement follows from (5.1.44). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.43

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a closed immersion and Y an affine variety. Then X is affine.

Proposition 5.2.44

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular map of varieties and $Z \subset X$ a closed subvariety. Then $\phi|_Z$ is regular.

Proposition 5.2.45

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular map of varieties and $Z \subset Y$ a closed (resp. open) subvariety. If $\phi(X) \subset Z$ then ϕ may be regarded as a regular map $X \rightarrow Z$.

Proposition 5.2.46

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular map of affine varieties. Then ϕ is a closed immersion if and only if the induced homomorphism $\phi_Y^\# : \mathcal{O}_Y(Y) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(X)$ is surjective.

Proof. Restatement of (5.1.44). □

5.2.7 Locally Closed Subvariety**Proposition 5.2.47** (Locally Closed Subvariety)

Let X be a variety, Z a closed subset and U an open subset. Then $Z \cap U$ is a variety (viewed as a closed subvariety of U or an open subvariety of Z).

5.2.8 Rational Points

For abstract varieties we use a more local definition of rational point which coincides with the affine case (5.1.62).

Definition 5.2.48 (K -Rational Points)

Let X be a variety and K/k an algebraic field extension. Define the K -rational points as follows

$$X(K) := \{(x, \iota) \mid x \in X_0, \iota : k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}) \hookrightarrow K\}$$

where X_0 is the Kolomogorov Quotient (4.1.34) of X , and recalling that $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \mathcal{O}_{X,y}$ whenever x, y become equal in X_0 (5.2.11).

By (5.2.19) specifying ι is completely equivalent to specifying a k -algebra homomorphism $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} \rightarrow K$.

Proposition 5.2.49

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of varieties and K/k an algebraic field extension. Then the map

$$\begin{aligned} \phi_K : X(K) &\longrightarrow Y(K) \\ (x, \iota) &\longrightarrow (\phi(x), \iota \circ \phi_x) \end{aligned}$$

is well-defined and satisfies

$$\psi_K \circ \phi_K = (\psi \circ \phi)_K$$

In particular if ϕ is an isomorphism then ϕ_K is a bijection.

Proposition 5.2.50 (Points = Rational Points over $\bar{k}$)

Let X be a variety. Then there is a canonical bijection

$$\begin{aligned} X &\xrightarrow{\sim} X(\bar{k}) \\ x &\longrightarrow ([x], \text{ev}_x) \end{aligned}$$

which is functorial in X . More precisely if $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ is a regular morphism then

$$\text{ev}_{\phi(x)} = \text{ev}_x \circ \bar{\phi}_x$$

Further

$$y = \phi(x) \iff \phi(x) \in \overline{\{y\}} \text{ and } \text{ev}_x \circ \bar{\phi}_x = \text{ev}_y$$

Proof. Recall (4.1.33) that X may be written as a disjoint union

$$X := \bigsqcup_{x \in \mathcal{I}} \overline{\{x\}}$$

for some representative subset $\mathcal{I} \subset X$ which is in bijection with X_0 . By (5.2.11) X is symmetric and for all $z \in \overline{\{x\}}$ we have $[z] = [x]$ as elements of X_0 . So for a given $x \in \mathcal{I}$ we need to show that the map

$$\begin{aligned} \overline{\{x\}} &\longrightarrow \text{AlgHom}_k(k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}), \bar{k}) \\ z &\longrightarrow \text{ev}_z \end{aligned}$$

is bijective. It is well-defined because $z \in \overline{\{x\}}$ implies $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \mathcal{O}_{X,z}$. Let U be an affine open neighbourhood of x then by (4.1.41) $\overline{\{x\}} = \text{cl}_U(x)$. Further by (4.3.15) $U \hookrightarrow X$ induces a local isomorphism on stalks and therefore residue fields $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}) \cong k(\mathfrak{m}_{U,x})$. By functoriality (4.3.10) we may then reduce to the case of X affine. The result then follows from the affine case (5.1.62).

There is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{\sim} & X(\bar{k}) \\ \downarrow \phi & & \downarrow \phi_{\bar{k}} \\ Y & \xrightarrow{\sim} & Y(\bar{k}) \end{array}$$

from which the final statement follows easily. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.51

Let X be a variety. Then the evaluation map

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{ev}_X : X & \longrightarrow & \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_X(X), \bar{k}) \\ x & \longrightarrow & f \mapsto f(x) \end{array}$$

is natural in X .

When X is affine it is also a bijection.

Proof. More precisely when $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ is a regular morphism of varieties we require to show that the following diagram commutes

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{\text{ev}} & \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_X(X), \bar{k}) \\ \downarrow \phi & & \downarrow - \circ \phi^\sharp \\ Y & \xrightarrow{\text{ev}} & \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_Y(Y), \bar{k}) \end{array}$$

Suppose $g \in \mathcal{O}_Y(Y)$ and $x \in X$ then this amounts to

$$g(\phi(x)) = \phi^\sharp(g)(x)$$

which holds by definition.

Let $\theta : X \cong V(\mathfrak{a})$ be an isomorphism of varieties. Then $\phi^\sharp$ is an isomorphism of k -algebras, and so $- \circ \phi^\sharp$ is a bijection (since functors preserve isomorphisms). The evaluation map for $V(\mathfrak{a})$ is a bijection (5.1.62) and so we deduce it is also for X . $\square$

Corollary 5.2.52

Let X be a variety and $U \subset X$ an affine open subset. Then the evaluation map

$$\text{ev}_U : U \longrightarrow \text{AlgHom}_k(\mathcal{O}_X(U), \bar{k})$$

is bijective.

Suppose $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ is a regular morphism, U is an affine neighbourhood of x and V is an affine neighbourhood of y such that $U \subset \phi^{-1}(V)$, then

$$\phi(x) = y \iff \text{ev}_U(x) \circ \rho_{\phi^{-1}(V)U} \circ \phi^\sharp = \text{ev}_V(y)$$

5.2.9 Dimension

Definition 5.2.53 (Dimension of a Variety)

Let X be a variety. Then we define the **dimension** to be the Krull Dimension of X as a topological space.

Proposition 5.2.54

Let X be an integral variety. Then it is biequidimensional and

$$\dim X = \text{trdeg}_k(k(X))$$

The dimension equals $\dim U$ for every open subset.

Proof. Let U be an affine open subset then by (5.1.51) $\dim U = \text{trdeg}_k(k(U))$ which equals $\text{trdeg}_k(k(X))$ by (4.3.16). Further by (5.1.50) U is biequidimensional and so by (4.1.64) we conclude that X is biequidimensional with the same dimension as U .

Every open subset can be covered by affines so we are done by (4.1.79). $\square$

Corollary 5.2.55

Let X be a variety. Then it is quasi-biequidimensional. Moreover every closed subset $W \subset X$ satisfies the codimension formula

$$\dim X = \dim W + \operatorname{codim}(W, X).$$

If W is irreducible then we also have the identity

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,W} = \operatorname{codim}(W, X) = \dim X - \dim W$$

Proof. Every irreducible component is an integral closed subvariety and therefore biequidimensional (5.2.54). So by definition X is quasi-biequidimensional. The codimension formula is (4.1.78).

Let U be an affine open subset of X meeting W . Then there is an isomorphism $\mathcal{O}_{X,W} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_{U,W \cap U}$ (4.3.17). Further by (4.1.64) we have $\operatorname{codim}(W, X) = \operatorname{codim}(W \cap U, U)$. Therefore we may deduce from the affine case (5.1.56) that

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,W} = \dim \mathcal{O}_{U,W \cap U} = \operatorname{codim}(W \cap U, U) = \operatorname{codim}(W, X)$$

as required. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.56 (Irreducible Closed Subsets of Dimension 0)

Let X be a variety and $Z \subset X$ an irreducible closed subset. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\dim Z = 0$
- b) $Z = \overline{\{z\}}$ for some $z \in Z$
- c) Z is finite

In particular for every $x \in X$ we have $\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \dim X$.

Proof. Follows from (5.2.12). The dimension formula follows from (5.2.55). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.57

Let X be a variety. Then there is a bijective correspondence

$$X_0 \longleftrightarrow \{W \subset Z \mid W \text{ closed and irreducible and } \dim W = 0\}$$

Proof. By (5.2.11) and (4.1.84). $\square$

5.2.10 Product Variety

We construct the product in the category of varieties, but note that the topology of the product does *not* coincide with the usual product topology.

We first show that the product, if it exists, is unique in concrete sense.

Lemma 5.2.58 (Uniqueness of Product)

Let X, Y be varieties (resp. affine varieties), then there is at most one topology on $X \times Y$ and local space of functions $\mathcal{O}_{X \times Y}$ for which the projection maps are regular and the following map

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \operatorname{Mor}(Z, X \times Y) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \operatorname{Mor}(Z, X) \times \operatorname{Mor}(Z, Y) \\ \phi & \rightarrow & (\pi_X \circ \phi, \pi_Y \circ \phi) \end{array}$$

is a well-defined bijection for all varieties (resp. affine varieties) Z , natural in Z .

Proof. Suppose we have two such structures, denote them by $X \times Y$ and $\widetilde{X \times Y}$, then we have a natural bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \operatorname{Mor}(Z, X \times Y) & \rightarrow & \operatorname{Mor}(Z, \widetilde{X \times Y}) \\ \phi & \rightarrow & \phi \end{array}$$

which is the identity on the underlying set function because $\phi = \phi' \iff \pi_X \circ \phi = \pi_X \circ \phi'$ and $\pi_Y \circ \phi = \pi_Y \circ \phi'$. By the dual version of the Yoneda Lemma (2.6.53) the identity map $1 : X \times Y \rightarrow \widetilde{X \times Y}$ is a regular isomorphism. Therefore the topology is the same and so are the sheaf of functions. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.59

Let X, Y be varieties, then the categorical product $X \times Y$ exists, and coincides with the set-theoretic product. More precisely

- a) there exists a unique topology on $X \times Y$ and sheaf of functions $\mathcal{O}_{X \times Y}$ such that the projection maps $\pi_X : X \times Y \rightarrow X$ and $\pi_Y : X \times Y \rightarrow Y$ are regular and there is a natural bijection for all varieties Z

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}(Z, X \times Y) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Mor}(Z, X) \times \text{Mor}(Z, Y) \\ \phi &\rightarrow (\pi_X \circ \phi, \pi_Y \circ \phi) \end{aligned}$$

- b) If X and Y are affine (resp. separated), then so is $X \times Y$, and there is an isomorphism

$$(\mathcal{O}_X(X) \otimes_k \mathcal{O}_Y(Y))_{\text{red}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_{X \times Y}(X \times Y)$$

- c) If $U \subset X$ and $V \subset Y$ are open then so is $U \times V$, and $\mathcal{O}_{U \times V} = \mathcal{O}_{X \times Y}|_{U \times V}$
d) If $T \subset X$ and $S \subset Y$ are closed then $T \times S$ is a closed subset of $X \times Y$

Proof. Suppose X, Y are both affine. Then $X \times Y$ is given the structure of an affine variety in (5.1.95). This means the following map

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}(Z, X \times Y) &\rightarrow \text{Mor}(Z, X) \times \text{Mor}(Z, Y) \\ \phi &\rightarrow (\pi_X \circ \phi, \pi_Y \circ \phi) \end{aligned}$$

is bijective when Z is affine. Consider the case $Z = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ is a variety. Injectivity is obvious, for surjectivity suppose $f : Z \rightarrow X$ and $g : Z \rightarrow Y$ are regular. Then $f|_{U_i}$ and $g|_{U_i}$ are regular, and by the affine case so is $f|_{U_i} \times g|_{U_i}$. By (4.3.27) $f \times g$ is also regular.

Consider the general case $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ and $Y = \bigcup_{j=1}^m V_j$ are varieties with given affine coverings. Define $W_{ij} := U_i \times V_j$, then by the affine case W_{ij} may be given the structure of an (affine) variety with regular set-theoretic projections $\pi_X^{ij} : W_{ij} \rightarrow U_i$ and $\pi_Y^{ij} : W_{ij} \rightarrow V_j$ such that the following map is a bijection

$$\text{Mor}(Z, W_{ij}) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Mor}(Z, U_i) \times \text{Mor}(Z, V_j)$$

for all varieties Z . Then consider $Z = W_{ij} \cap W_{kl} = (\pi_X^{kl})^{-1}(U_i \cap U_k) \cap (\pi_Y^{kl})^{-1}(V_j \cap V_l)$ regarded as an open subvariety of W_{kl} . With this structure the projection maps $\pi_X : Z \rightarrow U_i$ and $\pi_Y : Z \rightarrow V_j$ may be shown to be regular by

- changing the codomain of $\pi_X^{kl} : W_{kl} \rightarrow U_k$ (resp. π_Y) to X , (5.2.35)
- restricting the domain to Z (5.2.36),
- changing the codomain to U_i (resp. V_j) (5.2.35)

Consequently the identity map $W_{ij} \cap W_{kl} \rightarrow W_{ij}$ is regular and therefore so is $W_{ij} \cap W_{kl} \rightarrow W_{ij} \cap W_{kl}$ (5.2.35) when considered as open subvarieties of W_{kl} and W_{ij} respectively. By symmetry this is a regular isomorphism. Therefore the W_{ij} satisfy the criteria of (5.2.37) and there exists a unique structure of a variety on $X \times Y$ for which $\mathcal{O}_{X \times Y}|_{W_{ij}} = \mathcal{O}_{W_{ij}}$. By (...) the set-theoretic projections $\pi_X : X \times Y \rightarrow X$ and $\pi_Y : X \times Y \rightarrow Y$ are regular. As before we need to show the following map is bijective

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Mor}(Z, X \times Y) &\rightarrow \text{Mor}(Z, X) \times \text{Mor}(Z, Y) \\ \phi &\rightarrow (\pi_X \circ \phi, \pi_Y \circ \phi) \end{aligned}$$

with injectivity obvious. Suppose $f : Z \rightarrow X$ and $g : Z \rightarrow Y$ are regular. Define $T_{ij} := f^{-1}(U_i) \cap g^{-1}(V_j)$. Then by (5.2.36) $f_{ij} := f|_{T_{ij}}$ and $g_{ij} := g|_{T_{ij}}$ are regular. Therefore by the universal property for W_{ij} the maps $f_{ij} \times g_{ij}$ are regular. Clearly they are compatible so these glue to give a regular map $f \times g : Z \rightarrow X \times Y$ (5.2.35) (4.3.27) as required. Further $X \times Y = \bigcup_{i,j} W_{ij}$ so it is indeed a variety. Uniqueness of the structure follows from (5.2.58).

For b) we already demonstrated that the affine product is also a product in the category of varieties, so it follows from uniqueness. For separatedness this is an easy exercise.

For c) we have $U \times V = \pi_X^{-1}(U) \cap \pi_Y^{-1}(V)$ is open, and the universal property naturally restricts to the subset $U \times V$. The identity then follows from uniqueness (5.2.58).

For d) we have $T \times S = \pi_X^{-1}(T) \cap \pi_Y^{-1}(S)$ is closed. □

Proposition 5.2.60

Let X be an integral variety and Y a geometrically integral affine variety (see (5.1.83)). Then $X \times Y$ is an integral variety.

Proof. By definition $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ for U_i affine. By (5.2.59) $X \times Y = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i \times Y$ and $U_i \times Y$ is affine. By (5.1.97) $U_i \times Y$ is integral. By (4.1.50) $U_i \cap U_j \neq \emptyset$ whence $(U_i \times Y) \cap (U_j \times Y) \neq \emptyset$. Therefore by (4.1.65) we conclude that $X \times Y$ is integral. □

5.2.11 Separated Varieties

Proposition 5.2.61

Let $\phi_1, \phi_2 : X \rightrightarrows Y$ be regular morphisms of varieties with Y separated. Then the equaliser

$$\{x \in X \mid \phi_1(x) = \phi_2(x)\}$$

is a closed subset of X .

Proof. Let $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ where U_i are affine. Then the equaliser is the finite union of

$$\{x \in U_i \mid \phi_1|_{U_i}(x) = \phi_2|_{U_i}(x)\}$$

which is by definition closed. □

The following shows that the separated property is analogous to the Hausdorff property in the classical case (4.1.88).

Proposition 5.2.62

Let X be a variety. Then X is separated if and only if the diagonal

$$\Delta_X := \{(x, x) \mid x \in X\}$$

is a closed subvariety of $X \times X$.

Proof. Suppose that Δ_X is closed. Then the equaliser of $\phi_1, \phi_2 : Z \rightrightarrows X$ is equal to $(\phi_1 \times \phi_2)^{-1}(\Delta_X)$. By (5.2.59) $\phi_1 \times \phi_2$ is regular and in particular continuous. We conclude the equaliser is closed.

Conversely Δ_X is the equaliser of $\pi_1, \pi_2 : X \times X \rightrightarrows X$ and so by (5.2.14) is closed. □

Proposition 5.2.63

Let X be a separated variety and $Z \subset X$ a closed (resp. open) subvariety. Then Z is separated.

Proof. Then $\Delta_Z = \Delta_X \cap (Z \times Z)$. By (5.2.59) $Z \times Z$ is a closed (resp. open) subvariety of $X \times X$. Then the result follows by (5.2.62). □

Lemma 5.2.64

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular map of varieties, with Y separated. Then the graph

$$\Gamma_\phi = \{(x, \phi(x)) \mid x \in X\}$$

is a closed subvariety of $X \times Y$. Further there is a canonical isomorphism of varieties

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \Gamma_\phi \\ x & \rightarrow & (x, \phi(x)) \end{array}$$

Proof. Consider the regular map

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (\phi \circ \pi_X) \times \pi_Y : X \times Y & \rightarrow & Y \times Y \\ (x, y) & \rightarrow & (\phi(x), y) \end{array}$$

Then

$$\Gamma_\phi = ((\phi \circ \pi_X) \times \pi_Y)^{-1}(\Delta_Y)$$

which is closed. The map $X \rightarrow \Gamma_\phi$ is evidently regular. Further $\Gamma_\phi \hookrightarrow X \times Y \rightarrow X$ is regular by (5.2.42) and (4.3.2). These are mutual inverses and so the last statement follows immediately. □

Proposition 5.2.65 (Intersection of Affines is Affine)

Let X be a separated variety and U, V open subsets. Then there is a regular isomorphism followed by a closed immersion

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U \cap V & \xrightarrow{\sim} & (U \times V) \cap \Delta_X \hookrightarrow U \times V \\ x & \rightarrow & (x, x) \end{array}$$

In particular when U, V are affine then so is $U \cap V$.

Proof. By (5.2.59) $U \times V$ is an open subvariety of $X \times X$.

$(U \times V) \cap \Delta_X = ((U \cap V) \times V) \cap \Delta_X$ is the graph of the inclusion map $U \cap V \hookrightarrow V$. By (5.2.64) it is a closed subvariety of $(U \cap V) \times V$ and therefore of $U \times V$. The same result shows that the first map is a regular isomorphism.

When U, V are affine, so is $U \times V$. By (5.2.42) so is $(U \times V) \cap \Delta_X$, and therefore $U \cap V$. □

Proposition 5.2.66 (Criteria for Separated Variety)

Let X be a variety with an open cover $\bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$. Then X is separated if and only if $(U_i \times U_j) \cap \Delta_X$ is a closed subvariety of $U_i \times U_j$ for all $i, j = 1 \dots n$.

Proof. Suppose X is separated then $(U_i \times U_j) \cap \Delta_X$ is a closed subvariety by (5.2.65).

Conversely if $(U_i \times U_j) \cap \Delta_X$ is closed for all i, j then by (4.1.22)

$$\Delta_X = \bigcup_{i,j} (U_i \times U_j) \cap \Delta_X$$

is closed, and therefore X is separated by (5.2.62). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.67 (Criteria for Separated Variety II)

Let X be a variety with an affine open cover $\bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$. Then X is separated if and only if $U_i \cap U_j$ is affine and the k -algebra homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{O}_X(U_i) \otimes_k \mathcal{O}_X(U_j) &\longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(U_i \cap U_j) \\ f \otimes g &\longrightarrow f|_{U_i \cap U_j} \cdot g|_{U_i \cap U_j} \end{aligned}$$

is surjective for all $i, j = 1 \dots n$

Proof. Suppose X is separated, then by (5.2.65) $U_i \cap U_j$ is affine and there is a closed immersion

$$U_i \cap U_j \xrightarrow{\sim} (U_i \times U_j) \cap \Delta_X \hookrightarrow U_i \times U_j$$

By (5.2.46) the corresponding map of global sections

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{O}_{U_i \times U_j}(U_i \times U_j) &\rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{U_i \cap U_j}(U_i \cap U_j) \\ f &\rightarrow u \rightarrow f(u, u) \end{aligned} \tag{5.2}$$

is surjective. Recall from (5.2.59) there is a surjective k -algebra homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{O}_{U_i}(U_i) \otimes_k \mathcal{O}_{U_j}(U_j) &\rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{U_i \times U_j}(U_i \times U_j) \\ f \otimes g &\rightarrow u \rightarrow f(u) \cdot g(u) \end{aligned}$$

which composes to give the required map.

Conversely suppose that $U_i \cap U_j$ are affine and the given map is surjective then evidently the map in Eq. (5.2) is surjective. By (5.2.46) this shows that the map $U_i \cap U_j \hookrightarrow U_i \times U_j$ is a closed immersion and in particular $(U_i \times U_j) \cap \Delta_X$ is a closed subvariety of $(U_i \times U_j)$. Then we are done by (5.2.66). $\square$

5.2.12 Rational Maps**Definition 5.2.68** (Rational Maps)

Let X, Y be varieties. A **rational map** $\phi : X \dashrightarrow Y$ is an equivalence class of regular morphisms

$$\phi : U \rightarrow Y$$

where U is a dense open subset of X . We say $(U, \phi) \sim (U', \phi')$ if there exists a dense open subset $W \subset U \cap U'$ such that $\phi|_W = \phi'|_W$.

We say the **domain of definition** of a rational map ϕ is the set of points $x \in X$ for which there exists a neighbourhood U of x and a representative (U, ϕ) . This is a dense open subset denoted by $\text{dom}(\phi)$.

Proposition 5.2.69

Let $\phi : X \dashrightarrow Y$ be a rational map with Y separated. Then there exists a representative regular morphism $\phi : \text{dom}(\phi) \rightarrow Y$.

Proof. It is enough to show that for any two representatives (U, ϕ) and (U', ϕ') we have $\phi|_{U \cap U'} = \phi'|_{U \cap U'}$. By (5.2.61) the equaliser is closed in $U \cap U'$ and by definition contains a dense open subset W . Therefore it equals $U \cap U'$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.70 (Rational Functions are Rational Maps)

Let X be an integral variety. Then there is a bijection

$$k(X) \xrightarrow{\sim} \{f : X \dashrightarrow \mathbb{A}_k^1\}$$

and every such map is either dominant or has finite image.

Proof. By (5.2.4) this is well-defined and bijective. Suppose $U \subset X$ is dense then by (4.1.61) it is irreducible. Therefore a regular map $f : U \rightarrow \mathbb{A}_k^1(\bar{k})$ has irreducible image (4.1.55) and $\overline{f(X)}$ is irreducible (4.1.56) and closed. Clearly $\dim \overline{f(X)} \leq \dim \mathbb{A}_k^1(\bar{k}) = 1$. If equality holds then by (4.1.74).f) $\overline{f(X)} = \mathbb{A}_k^1$ and by definition f is dominant. Otherwise $\dim \overline{f(X)} = 0$ whence by (5.2.56) $\overline{f(X)} = \{y\}$ for some $y \in \mathbb{A}_k^1(\bar{k})$. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.71

Let X be an integral variety. Then as subrings of $k(X)$ (...) we have

$$\mathcal{O}_X(U) = \{f \in k(X) \mid U \subset \text{dom}(f)\}$$

and

$$\mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \{f \in k(X) \mid x \in \text{dom}(f)\}$$

Furthermore

$$\mathcal{O}_X(U) = \bigcap_{x \in U} \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$$

Proof. Recall (...) that $\mathbb{A}_k^1$ being affine is separated. Therefore every rational map $f \in k(X)$ has a regular representative in $\tilde{f} \in \mathcal{O}_X(\text{dom}(f))$ by (5.2.69). So if $U \subset \text{dom}(f)$ then $\tilde{f} \sim \tilde{f}|_U$ and so $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$. Conversely if $\tilde{f} \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ then $(U, \tilde{f})$ is a rational map whose domain contains U .

The second statement is similar, and then the final statement follows trivially. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.72 (Dominant Rational Map)

Let X be an integral variety and $[(U, \phi)] : X \dashrightarrow Y$ a rational map. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\phi(U)$ is dense in Y
- b) $(U', \phi') \sim (U, \phi) \implies \phi'(U')$ is dense in Y

In this case we say that $[(U, \phi)]$ is a **dominant rational map**

Proof. Clearly b) $\implies$ a). Conversely suppose $\emptyset \neq W \subset U$ is open, then it is dense by (4.1.50) so $\text{cl}_U(W) = U$ by (4.1.21). Therefore by (4.1.29)

$$\phi(U) = \phi(\text{cl}_U(W)) \subset \overline{\phi(W)}$$

which means

$$X = \overline{\phi(U)} \subset \overline{\phi(W)}$$

and therefore $\phi(W)$ is dense. In particular by definition we have $W \subset U \cap U'$ such that $\phi(W) = \phi'(W)$. So we conclude that $\phi'(W)$ is dense and so a-fortiori is $\phi'(U')$. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.73

Let X, Y, Z be integral varieties and $\phi : X \dashrightarrow Y, \psi : Y \dashrightarrow Z$ rational maps with ϕ dominant. For every equivalence class (U, ϕ) and (V, ψ) we have $U \cap \phi^{-1}(V) \neq \emptyset$ and the map

$$\psi \circ \phi : U \cap \phi^{-1}(V) \rightarrow Z$$

is a regular morphism determining a rational map

$$\psi \circ \phi : X \dashrightarrow Z$$

which is dominant provided ψ is.

Further this is independent of the choice of equivalence class.

Proof. By definition $\phi(U)$ is dense which means that $\phi(U) \cap V \neq \emptyset \implies U \cap \phi^{-1}(V) \neq \emptyset$, which is therefore also dense in X (4.1.50). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.74

Let X, Y be integral varieties. Then there is a bijective map

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \{\phi : X \dashrightarrow Y \text{ dominant rational maps} \} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{AlgHom}_k(k(Y), k(X)) \\ \phi & \rightarrow & \phi_\star \end{array}$$

Further $\phi_\star$ is injective and the existence of ϕ implies that $\dim Y \leq \dim X$. Then following are equivalent

- a) $\dim Y = \dim X$

- b) $k(X)/\phi_*(k(Y))$ is algebraic
- c) $k(X)/\phi_*(k(Y))$ is finite

In this case we denote the **degree** by $\deg(\phi) := [k(X) : \phi_*(k(Y))]$.

Proof. The map is well-defined by (5.2.70) and (5.2.73), after we verify that the image is a k -algebra homomorphism.

Further it is injective by (5.2.29) and surjective by (5.2.30).

As $k(Y)$ is a field ϕ_* is injective. We claim that $\text{trdeg}_k(k(Y)) \leq \text{trdeg}_k(k(X))$. For a transcendence base for $k(Y)$ is a-fortiori algebraically independent as a subset of $k(X)$. Therefore the inequality follows from (3.18.151) and (5.2.54).

a) $\implies$ b) Suppose $\dim X = \dim Y$ and let $\mathcal{B}$ be a transcendence base for Y , then by (3.18.152) $\phi_*(\mathcal{B})$ is a transcendence base for X . Therefore $k(X)/\phi_*(k(\mathcal{B}))$ is algebraic

b) $\iff$ c) A-fortiori $k(X)/\phi_*(k(Y))$ is finitely generated. Therefore the equivalence follows from (3.18.57).

b) $\implies$ a) We have a-fortiori $k(X)/\phi_*(k(\mathcal{B}))$ is algebraic whence by (3.18.151) $\dim Y \geq \dim X$, and so $\dim Y = \dim X$. $\square$

5.2.13 Tangent Space

Definition 5.2.75

Let X be a variety and $W \subset X$ an irreducible subset. Define the **tangent space**

$$T_W X := \text{Der}(\mathcal{O}_{X,W}, k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}))$$

and the **cotangent space**

$$T_W^* X := \text{Hom}(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}/\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}^2, k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W}))$$

Definition 5.2.76 (Non-Singular Point)

Let X be a variety and $W \subset X$ an irreducible subset. Then we say that X is **non-singular** at W if

- a) W is contained in a unique irreducible component X_α (equivalently $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ is an integral domain), and
- b) $\dim T_W X = \dim \text{Der}(k(X_\alpha))$

We say that X is non-singular if it is integral and non-singular at all points.

Definition 5.2.77 (Regular Point)

Let X be a variety and $W \subset X$ an irreducible subset.

We say X is **regular** at W if

- a) W is contained in a unique irreducible component X_α , and
- b) $\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,W} = \dim T_x^* X$

We say that X is regular if it is integral and regular at all points.

Proposition 5.2.78 (Regularity / Non-Singularity is a local property)

Let X be a variety, $W \subset X$ an irreducible subset and $U \subset X$ an open subset such that $U \cap W \neq \emptyset$. Then there is a canonical isomorphism

$$T_W X \xrightarrow{\sim} T_{W \cap U} U.$$

X is regular (resp. non-singular) at W if and only if U is regular (resp. non-singular) at $U \cap W$.

Proposition 5.2.79

Let X be an integral variety. Then it is regular (resp. non-singular) if it has a regular (resp. non-singular) open cover.

Proposition 5.2.80

Let X be a variety and $W \subset X$ an irreducible subset such that $k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,W})/k$ is separably generated (e.g. k perfect). Then there is a canonical isomorphism

$$T_W X \xrightarrow{\sim} T_W^* W$$

In particular when W is contained in a unique irreducible component we have **regular** $\iff$ **non-singular**.

5.2.14 Completeness

Completeness is analogous to compactness in the Hausdorff case, and many results remain true when complete is replaced with compact and the standard product topology is used (in place of the topology induced by the product variety structure). We show in the next section that every projective variety is complete, so it is quite a natural condition.

Definition 5.2.81

Let X be a separated variety. Then it is

- **universally closed** if for every variety Y the projection map

$$\pi_Y : X \times Y \rightarrow Y$$

is closed (i.e. the image of a closed subset is closed).

- **complete** if for every irreducible closed subvariety $Z \subset X$ and valuation ring $k \subset R \subset k(Z)$ there is a point $z \in Z$ such that $\mathcal{O}_{Z,z} \subset R$

Proposition 5.2.82 (Image of Complete Variety is Closed)

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of varieties where X is universally closed and Y is separated. Then $\phi(X)$ is a closed subvariety of Y .

Proof. By (5.2.64) the graph Γ_ϕ is a closed subset of $X \times Y$. Then $\phi(X)$ is the projection of Γ_ϕ and therefore closed by definition. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.83 (Closed Subvariety of Complete Variety is also Complete)

A closed subvariety of a universally closed (resp. complete) variety is universally closed (resp. complete)

Proof. Suppose $Z \subset X$ is closed then by (5.2.59) $Z \times Y$ is a closed subset of $X \times Y$. Further T closed in $Z \times Y$ implies T closed in $X \times Y$ and the result follows.

The complete case is obvious. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.84

A separated variety X is universally closed (resp. complete) iff all its irreducible components are universally closed (resp. complete).

Proof. By (4.1.57) every irreducible component is closed, and therefore complete by (5.2.83).

Conversely suppose $X = X_1 \cup \dots \cup X_n$ is the irreducible decomposition (5.2.8). If $T \subset X \times Y$ is closed then $T \cap (X_i \times Y)$ is closed in $X_i \times Y$ and therefore by assumption $\pi_Y(T \cap (X_i \times Y)) = \pi_Y(T) \cap X_i$ is closed. Therefore $\pi_Y(T) = \bigcup_{i=1}^n \pi_Y(T) \cap X_i$ is also closed.

The complete case is straightforward. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.85

Let X be a separated variety. To demonstrate universal closedness it is sufficient to show that

$$\pi_Y : X \times Y \rightarrow Y$$

is closed for Y affine (or even $Y := \mathbb{A}_k^n$).

Further it is sufficient to show that $\pi_Y(T)$ is closed for all irreducible closed subsets $T \subset X \times Y$.

Proof. Suppose $Y = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$ for U_i open affines. Then by (5.2.59) $X \times U_i$ is an open cover of $X \times Y$. Let $T \subset X \times Y$ closed then $T \cap (X \times U_i)$ is closed in $X \times U_i$. By assumption $\pi_Y(T \cap (X \times U_i)) = \pi_Y(T) \cap U_i$ is closed in U_i . Therefore by (4.1.22) $\pi_Y(T)$ is closed in Y as required.

Clearly the closed property is preserved under isomorphism of Y , therefore we may assume that $Y = V(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$ is a closed subset for some n and ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$.

By (5.2.59) $X \times Y$ is a closed subset of $X \times \mathbb{A}_k^n$. There $T \subset X \times Y$ is also closed in $X \times \mathbb{A}_k^n$ and the result follows.

Finally if T is closed then by (...) $T = T_1 \cup \dots \cup T_m$ for T_j irreducible closed subsets of T (and therefore of $X \times Y$). Therefore

$$\pi_Y(T) = \pi_Y\left(\bigcup_{j=1}^m T_j\right) = \bigcup_{j=1}^m \pi_Y(T_j)$$

and it suffices to show that $\pi_Y(T_j)$ is closed. $\square$

The following is not strictly needed in application to projective case as it's already known however we include it for completeness of the argument.

Lemma 5.2.86

Let X be an integral variety and $R \subset k(X)$ is a valuation ring with local homomorphism $\Phi : R \rightarrow \bar{k}$. Suppose that there exists $x \in X$ such that $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} \subset R$, then x may be chosen such that $\Phi|_{\mathcal{O}_{X,x}} \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is evaluation at x .

Proof. By (5.2.19) $\Phi|_{\mathcal{O}_{X,x}}$ is local and by (5.2.50) we may choose $x' \in \overline{\{x\}}$ such that $\Phi|_{\mathcal{O}_{X,x}}$ is precisely evaluation at z' . $\square$

The following proof is adapted from [Bum98, Prop 7.17].

Proposition 5.2.87 (Complete $\implies$ Universally Closed)

A complete variety is universally closed.

Proof. We may consider the projection $\pi_Y : X \times Y \rightarrow Y$ for Y irreducible affine by (5.2.85), and demonstrate that $\pi_Y(T)$ is closed for every irreducible closed subset $T \subset X \times Y$.

Consider the closed subvariety $Z := \text{cl}_X(\pi_X(T))$ of X and the irreducible and affine closed subvariety $Y' := \text{cl}_Y(\pi_Y(T))$ of Y . Then evidently $T = T \cap (Z \times Y')$ and so

$$\pi_Y(T) = \pi_Y|_{Z \times Y'}(T \cap (Z \times Y'))$$

Further by (...) $Z \times Y'$ is a closed subvariety of $X \times Y$ and T is an irreducible closed subset of $Z \times Y'$. Therefore for fixed T we may assume without loss of generality that $\pi_Y(T)$ is dense in Y . The composite maps

$$\pi_Y \circ i : T \hookrightarrow Z \times Y \rightarrow Y$$

$$\pi_X \circ i : T \hookrightarrow Z \times Y \rightarrow Z$$

are regular (5.2.42) and dominant, and we require to prove the first is surjective. Consider the injective algebra homomorphism (5.2.17)

$$(\pi_Y \circ i)_* : k(Y) \hookrightarrow k(T)$$

For any $y \in Y$ there is a corresponding evaluation homomorphism $\phi : \mathcal{O}_Y(Y) \rightarrow \bar{k}$ (5.2.52). By (3.24.8) there is a valuation ring $(\pi_Y \circ i)_*(\mathcal{O}_Y(Y)) \subset R \subset k(T)$ and a local homomorphism $\Phi : R \rightarrow \bar{k}$ such that $\Phi \circ (\pi_Y \circ i)_*$ extends ϕ .

Consider further the injective algebra homomorphism

$$(\pi_X \circ i)_* : k(Z) \hookrightarrow k(T)$$

Then $R' := (\pi_X \circ i)_*^{-1}(R)$ is a valuation ring of $k(Z)$ together with local homomorphism $\Phi' : R' \rightarrow \bar{k}$ such that $\Phi' = \Phi \circ (\pi_X \circ i)_*$. By hypothesis there is some $z \in Z$ such that $\mathcal{O}_{Z,z} \subset R'$ and by (5.2.86) we may assume that $\Phi'|_{\mathcal{O}_{Z,z}}$ is precisely evaluation at z .

Let U be an open affine neighbourhood of z in Z , then by (5.2.59) $U \times Y$ is an affine open subset of $Z \times Y$. As $\pi_X(T)$ is dense in Z then $U \cap \pi_X(T)$ is non-empty. This shows that $U' := (U \times Y) \cap T$ is a non-empty open subset of T . Evidently U' is a closed subset of $U \times Y$. Therefore it is also affine (5.2.47) (5.2.42).

There is a commutative diagram (5.2.18)

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k(Z) & \xleftarrow{(\pi_X \circ i)_*} & k(T) \\ \uparrow & & \uparrow \\ \mathcal{O}_{Z,z} & & \mathcal{O}_T(U') \\ \uparrow & & \uparrow \\ \mathcal{O}_Z(U) & \xrightarrow{(\pi_X)^\#} \mathcal{O}_{Z \times Y}(U \times Y) \xrightarrow{(i|_{U'})^\#} & \mathcal{O}_T(U') \\ & \searrow & \uparrow \\ & & \mathcal{O}_Z(U) \otimes_k \mathcal{O}_Y(Y) \end{array}$$

By construction of R we see that $(i|_{U'})^\#(\mathcal{O}_Z(U) \otimes 1) \subset R$ (after suitable identifications). Similarly we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
k(Y) & \xrightarrow{(\pi_Y \circ i)_*} & k(T) \\
\uparrow & & \uparrow \\
\mathcal{O}_Y(Y) & \xrightarrow{(\pi_Y)^\#} \mathcal{O}_{Z \times Y}(U \times Y) \xrightarrow{(i|_{U'})^\#} \mathcal{O}_T(U') & \\
& \searrow & \uparrow \wr \\
& & \mathcal{O}_Z(U) \otimes_k \mathcal{O}_Y(Y)
\end{array}$$

and by construction we have $(i|_{U'})^\#(1 \otimes \mathcal{O}_Y(Y)) \subset R$ (after suitable identifications). By properties of the tensor product this means

$$(i|_{U'})^\#(\mathcal{O}_Z(U) \otimes \mathcal{O}_Y(Y)) \subset R$$

By (5.2.42) the map $(i|_{U'})^\#$ is surjective, therefore we conclude that $\mathcal{O}_T(U') \subset R$. Then by (5.2.52) the restriction of Φ to $\mathcal{O}_T(U')$ corresponds to a point (z', y') of U' . Further $\Phi \circ (\pi_Y \circ i|_{U'})^\# = (\Phi \circ (\pi_Y \circ i)_*)|_{\mathcal{O}_Y(Y)} = \phi$ and so by (5.2.52) we have $(\pi_Y \circ i)(z', y') = y$ that is to say $y' = y$. This shows that $\pi_Y \circ i$ is surjective as required. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.88

Let X, Y be varieties with Y complete such that

- a) $U \subset X$ is an irreducible open neighbourhood
- b) $x \in \overline{U}$
- c) $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is a valuation ring
- d) $\phi : U \rightarrow Y$ is a regular morphism

Then there exists an open subset $U' \supset U$ for which $\overline{\{x\}} \subset U'$ and ϕ lifts to U' .

Proof. We claim it's enough to find an open neighbourhood V of x such that $U \cap V \neq \emptyset$ and a regular function $\psi : V \rightarrow Y$ such that $\psi|_{U \cap V} = \phi|_{U \cap V}$. For then this extends to a regular function $U \cup V$ as required.

Replacing $X = \overline{U}$ we may assume that U is dense in X and X is irreducible. Observe $Z := \text{cl}_Y(\phi(U))$ is an irreducible closed subset of Y (4.1.61) (4.1.56). Therefore there is an injective k -algebra homomorphism (4.3.16)

$$\phi_* : k(Z) \hookrightarrow k(U) \xrightarrow{\sim} k(X)$$

By assumption $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is a valuation ring, whence so is the inverse image R . By assumption there is $z \in Z$ such that $\mathcal{O}_{Z,z} \subset R$. Therefore we have a k -algebra homomorphism $\mathcal{O}_{Z,z} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$. By (5.2.32) this lifts to a regular morphism $\psi : V \rightarrow Z \subset Y$ for which $x \in V$. As $x \in \overline{U}$ we have $U \cap V \neq \emptyset$ by (4.1.19). As Y is separated (5.2.61) the equaliser of ϕ, ψ is a closed subset of $U \cap V$. We have by construction a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
k(Z) & \xhookrightarrow{\phi_*} & k(X) \\
\uparrow & & \uparrow \\
\mathcal{O}_{Z,z} & \xrightarrow{\psi_x^\#} & \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \\
\uparrow & & \uparrow \\
\mathcal{O}_Z(Z) & \xrightarrow{\psi_Z^\#} & \mathcal{O}_X(V)
\end{array}$$

Regarding $\psi : X \dashrightarrow Y$ as a rational map we find by (5.2.74) that $\psi_* = \phi_*$ whence $\psi = \phi$ as rational maps. This means that the equaliser contains a dense open subset of $U \cap V$ and being closed is therefore the whole set. That is $\phi|_{U \cap V} = \psi|_{U \cap V}$ as required. $\square$

5.2.15 Projective Space

We introduce the notion of projective varieties by showing that projective space can naturally be given the structure of an abstract variety. A more low-tech approach is taken in Section 5.3 where the constructions are shown to be equivalent.

Definition 5.2.89 (Projective Space)

Let K be a field extension define

$$\mathbb{P}^n(K) := K^{n+1} \setminus \{(0, \dots, 0)\} / \sim$$

where

$$(x_0, \dots, x_n) \sim (x'_0, \dots, x'_n) \iff x_i = \lambda x'_i \text{ some } \lambda \in K^*$$

and write $(x_0 : \dots : x_n)$ for the corresponding equivalence class in $\mathbb{P}^n(K)$.

Lemma 5.2.90 (Comparing projective points)

Consider two projective points $x = (x_0 : \dots : x_n)$ and $y = (y_0 : \dots : y_n)$.

$$\text{a) } x = y \implies \forall i (x_i = 0 \iff y_i = 0)$$

Suppose that $x_i \neq 0$ for some i . Then $x = y$ iff

$$\text{a) } y_i \neq 0$$

$$\text{b) } \frac{x_j}{x_i} = \frac{y_j}{y_i} \text{ for all } j$$

Proposition 5.2.91 (Projective Space)

Consider the set $X = \mathbb{P}^n(\bar{k})$ and for every $i = 0, \dots, n$ define the subset

$$U_i := \{(x_0 : \dots : x_n) \mid x_0, \dots, x_n \in \bar{k}, x_i \neq 0\}.$$

There are canonical bijections

$$\begin{aligned} \theta_i : U_i &\xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{A}_k^n(\bar{k}) \quad i = 0 \dots n \\ (x_0 : \dots : x_n) &\longrightarrow \left(\frac{x_0}{x_i}, \dots, \frac{\widehat{x_i}}{x_i}, \dots, \frac{x_n}{x_i} \right) \\ (z_1 : \dots : 1 : \dots : z_n) &\longleftarrow (z_1, \dots, z_n) \end{aligned}$$

and there is a unique topology on X and space of function $\mathcal{O}_X$ such that U_i is open in X and θ_i is a regular isomorphism for all $i = 0 \dots n$.

Denote this by $\mathbb{P}_k^n$. With this structure $\mathbb{P}_k^n$ is an irreducible, separated algebraic variety of dimension n .

Further for any homogenous polynomial $F \in k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ of degree d the expression

$$(x_0 : \dots : x_n) \mapsto \frac{F(x_0, \dots, x_n)}{x_i^d}$$

is a well-defined regular function on U_i . In particular on U_i we may define the **homogenous coordinate functions** $\frac{X_0}{X_i}, \dots, \frac{X_n}{X_i}$.

Proof. It is straightforward to show that θ_i is a bijection. Define the cocycle maps

$$\theta_{ij} : \theta_i(U_i \cap U_j) \rightarrow \theta_j(U_i \cap U_j)$$

by $\theta_{ij} = \theta_j \circ \theta_i^{-1}$. We show that $\theta_i(U_i \cap U_j)$ is open in $\mathbb{A}_k^n(\bar{k})$ and the maps θ_{ij} are regular. First observe that

$$\theta_i(U_i \cap U_j) = \begin{cases} D(Z_j) & i < j \\ D(Z_{j+1}) & j < i \end{cases}$$

Then the cocycle map is given pointwise by

$$\begin{aligned} \theta_{ij} : D(Z_j) &\rightarrow D(Z_{i+1}) \\ (z_1, \dots, z_n) &\rightarrow \left(\frac{z_1}{z_j}, \dots, \frac{z_i}{z_j}, \frac{1}{z_j}, \dots, \frac{z_n}{z_j} \right) \end{aligned}$$

Using (5.2.45) and (5.1.39) we may show that θ_{ij} is a regular morphism of abstract varieties. Therefore the structure on X is uniquely determined by (5.2.38).

By construction U_i is affine and $U_i \cap U_j = D\left(\frac{X_j}{X_i}\right)$ where $\frac{X_j}{X_i} \in \mathcal{O}_X(U_i)$. Therefore $U_i \cap U_j$ is affine by (5.2.21) and there is a canonical isomorphism

$$\mathcal{O}_{U_i}(U_i) \frac{X_j}{X_i} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_{U_i}(U_i \cap U_j)$$

As $\frac{X_i}{X_j} \in \mathcal{O}_{U_j}(U_j)$ satisfies $\frac{X_i}{X_j}|_{U_i \cap U_j} = \left(\frac{X_j}{X_i}|_{U_i \cap U_j}\right)^{-1}$ we find the canonical map

$$\mathcal{O}_{U_i}(U_i) \otimes \mathcal{O}_{U_j}(U_j) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{U_i}(U_i \cap U_j)$$

is surjective. Therefore X is separated by (5.2.67).

By (5.1.21) the affine space $\mathbb{A}_k^n$ is irreducible whence so is U_i and $U_i \cap U_j$ (4.1.61). Therefore by (4.1.65) $\mathbb{P}_k^n$ is irreducible and has dimension n by (4.1.79). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.92 (Riemann Sphere)

There is a bijection

$$\mathbb{P}_k^1 \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{A}_k^1 \cup \{\infty\}$$

which sends $(x : 1)$ to x and $(1 : 0)$ to ∞ . This gives $\mathbb{A}_k^1 \cup \{\infty\}$ the structure of a variety under which $\mathbb{A}_k^1$ is an open subvariety and x^{-1} is a regular automorphism interchanging 0 and ∞ .

Consider $x = \frac{X_1}{X_0} \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}_k^1}(U_0)$ as an element of the function field $k(\mathbb{P}_k^1)$ then x is transcendental and $k(\mathbb{P}_k^1) = k(x)$.

Proof. Evidently x is transcendental because $\mathcal{O}(U_0) = k[x] \dots$. Let $f \in k(\mathbb{P}_k^1)$ and suppose $\text{dom}(f) \cap U_0 \neq \emptyset$. There is some $g(x) \in \mathcal{O}(U_0)$ such that $D(g(x)) \subset \text{dom}(f)$. Then by (...) $\mathcal{O}(D(g)) = k[x]_{g(x)}$ and so $f|_{D(g(x))} = h(x)/g(x)^r$ for some polynomial $h \in k[X]$ and integer $r > 0$. Therefore $f \in k(x)$. Similarly if $\text{dom}(f) \cap U_1 \neq \emptyset$ then $f \in k(x^{-1}) = k(x)$ as required, where $x^{-1} = \frac{X_0}{X_1} \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}_k^1}(U_1)$. $\square$

We show later that all projective closed subvarieties are complete, but here we demonstrate a simpler case more directly.

Proposition 5.2.93

$\mathbb{P}_k^1$ is complete.

Proof. Let $Z \subset \mathbb{P}_k^1$ be an irreducible closed subvariety. Then by (4.1.74) (5.2.56) it is either the (closure of) a single point or the whole space. In the former case the function field is algebraic over k and has no non-trivial valuation rings. Therefore we may assume wlog that $Z = \mathbb{P}_k^1$ and consider a valuation ring $R \subset k(\mathbb{P}_k^1) = k(x)$ where $x = \frac{X_1}{X_0}$. By (3.33.8) R is equal to either $k[x]_{p(x)}$ for some irreducible polynomial or $k[x^{-1}]_{x^{-1}}$. Let α be a root of $p(x)$ in $\bar{k}$, then this corresponds to the point $(1 : \alpha)$, or in the latter case just $(0 : 1)$. $\square$

5.2.16 Affine and Finite Morphisms

Definition 5.2.94

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of varieties. We say ϕ is **affine** if for every affine open $V \subset Y$, $\phi^{-1}(V)$ is affine.

We say in addition that ϕ is **finite** if the ring map $\mathcal{O}_Y(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(\phi^{-1}(V))$ is finite (and therefore integral ...).

We do not require this for the sequel, but it may be convenient for other applications to show that it's sufficient to demonstrate a morphism is affine (resp. finite) only over a single affine cover.

Lemma 5.2.95

Let X be a variety with U, V open affine subsets. Then there exists $g_1, \dots, g_r \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ and $g'_1, \dots, g'_r \in \mathcal{O}_X(V)$ such that

$$\text{a) } W_i := D(g_i) = D(g'_i) \text{ for } i = 1 \dots r,$$

$$\text{b) } U \cap V = \bigcup_{i=1}^r W_i$$

Proof. Given $x \in U \cap V$, then as $U \cap V$ is open in U by (5.2.10) we may find $f_x \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ such that $x \in D(f_x) \subset U \cap V$. Similarly we may find $f'_x \in \mathcal{O}_X(V)$ with $x \in D(f'_x) \subset D(f_x)$. By (5.2.21).c) there is a canonical isomorphism $\mathcal{O}_X(U)_{f_x} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_X(D(f_x))$. Therefore $f'_x|_{D(f_x)} = \frac{g}{(f_x)^r}$ for some $g \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$. Observe that $D(f'_x) = D(g) \cap D(f_x) = D(gf_x)$. This gives the required pair of sections for an arbitrary $x \in U \cap V$. Clearly these open sets cover $U \cap V$, and as $U \cap V$ is quasi-compact (5.2.7) we are done. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.96

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular morphism of varieties, and suppose there is an open cover $Y = \bigcup_{i=1}^n V_i$ for which V_i and $\phi^{-1}(V_i)$ are affine. Then ϕ is affine.

If in addition $\mathcal{O}_Y(V_i) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(\phi^{-1}(V_i))$ is finite for all $i = 1 \dots n$ then ϕ is finite.

Proof. By assumption we have affine open sets $U_i := \phi^{-1}(V_i)$ for $i = 1 \dots n$. Let $V \subset Y$ be an open affine set, then by (5.2.95) for each i we have an open cover

$$V \cap V_i = \bigcup_{j=1}^{n_i} W_{ij}$$

with $W_{ij} := D(f_{ij}) = D(f'_{ij})$ for $f'_{ij} \in \mathcal{O}_Y(V_i)$ and $f_{ij} \in \mathcal{O}_Y(V)$. Evidently

$$V = \bigcup_{i=1}^n \bigcup_{j=1}^{n_i} D(f_{ij}) \quad (5.3)$$

and so by (5.2.26) the f_{ij} generate $\mathcal{O}_Y(V)$, and consequentially $g_{ij} := \phi^\#(f_{ij})$ generate $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ (as both ideals contain 1). Further $\phi^{-1}(W_{ij}) = \phi^{-1}(D(f'_{ij})) = D(\phi^\#(f'_{ij})) \subset U_i$ is affine (5.2.21).c). Therefore from (5.2.28) U is affine, because we also have the representation $\phi^{-1}(W_{ij}) = \phi^{-1}(D(f_{ij})) = D(g_{ij})$.

Suppose ϕ is finite then by definition this means the ring maps $\mathcal{O}_Y(V_i) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(U_i)$ are finite. By (3.7.40).a) this means the localised maps are finite

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_Y(V_i)_{f'_{ij}} & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_X(U_i)_{g'_{ij}} \\ \downarrow \sim & & \downarrow \sim \\ \mathcal{O}_Y(W_{ij}) & \xrightarrow{\phi^\#} & \mathcal{O}_X(\phi^{-1}(W_{ij})) \\ \sim \uparrow & & \sim \uparrow \\ \mathcal{O}_Y(V)_{f_{ij}} & \dashrightarrow & \mathcal{O}_X(U)_{g_{ij}} \end{array}$$

Using equation (5.3) and (5.2.26) we see that f_{ij} generate the unit ideal of $\mathcal{O}_Y(V)$. Therefore by (3.7.40).b) $\phi_V^\#$ is finite. $\square$

5.2.17 Normal Varieties

Definition 5.2.97

Let A be an integral domain. We say that the ring A is **normal** if it is integrally closed in its field of fractions.

Recall that A factorial $\implies A$ is normal (3.23.12).

Proposition 5.2.98

The polynomial ring $A[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ is normal for every unique factorisation domain A .

Proof. See (3.23.12) and (3.16.35). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.99 (Normal Variety)

Let X be an integral variety. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ is normal for every open subset $U \subset X$
- b) $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$ is normal for every irreducible subset $W \subset X$
- c) $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is normal for every point $x \in X$

In this case we say that X is a **normal variety**. If X is affine then this is equivalent to $\mathcal{O}_X(X)$ being normal.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) Let $U \subset X$ be any affine open subset such that $U \cap W \neq \emptyset$, then by (...) $\mathcal{O}_{X,W} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_{U,W \cap U} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_X(U)_{\mathfrak{M}_{U,W \cap U}}$, and the result follows from (3.23.10).

b) $\implies$ c) is straightforward because $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \mathcal{O}_{X,\{x\}}$.

c) $\implies$ a) We first show this for the case that U is affine. By (...) $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_{U,x} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_X(U)_{\mathfrak{M}_{U,x}}$ is normal for every $x \in U$. Therefore by (5.2.21).b) and (3.23.10) $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ is normal.

Now let U be an arbitrary open set and $V \subset U$ affine. Then by (5.2.15) we have inclusions

$$\mathcal{O}_X(V) \hookrightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(U) \hookrightarrow \text{Frac}(\mathcal{O}_X(U)) \hookrightarrow k(X)$$

and $k(X)$ is a fraction field for $\mathcal{O}_X(V)$. If $\alpha \in \text{Frac}(\mathcal{O}_X(U))$ is integral over $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$, then it is a-fortiori integral over $\mathcal{O}_X(V)$. By the affine case then $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}_X(V)$ and we conclude that $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ is normal as required.

For the case X is affine we may use (3.23.10). $\square$

Corollary 5.2.100

The standard affine space $\mathbb{A}_n^k(\bar{k})$ is normal.

Proof. The coordinate ring is a UFD (3.16.35) and therefore normal (3.23.12). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.101

Let X be an integral variety with open cover $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^n U_i$. Then X is normal iff U_i are normal.

Proof. Straightforward, since normality is a local condition. $\square$

5.2.18 Weil Divisors

The notion of regular curves can be generalised in one direction.

Definition 5.2.102 (Prime Divisors of an Integral Variety)

Let X be an integral, separated variety. We say it is **regular in codimension one** if for every irreducible closed subset $Y \subset X$ for which $\text{codim}(Y, X) = 1$ the local ring $\mathcal{O}_{X,Y}$ is regular (equivalently integrally closed or a DVR (3.30.2)).

In this case, we say an irreducible closed subset of codimension 1 is a **prime divisor**.

We denote by $\text{Div } X$ the free abelian group generated by the prime divisors. We write a prime divisor D by a formal sum

$$D = \sum_{Y \subset X} n_Y Y$$

where $n_Y \in \mathbb{Z}$ and all but finitely many are zero. We define the **degree** of a divisor D by

$$\deg D = \sum_{Y \subset X} n_Y [k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,Y}) : k]$$

Proposition 5.2.103

An integral, separated variety X is regular in codimension one for either of the following special cases

- a) X is normal
- b) X is non-singular and k is perfect.

Proof. See (3.30.2) and (5.2.80). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.104 (Valuation Associated to Prime Divisor)

Let X be a variety satisfying (5.2.102) and $Y \subset X$ a prime divisor. Then $\mathcal{O}_{X,Y}$ is a discrete valuation ring.

We denote by $v_Y : k(X)^* \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ the corresponding valuation.

Proof. By (5.2.55) $\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,Y} = \text{codim}(Y, X) = 1$ and is integral, so the result follows from (3.30.2). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.105 (Prime Divisors on a Curve)

Let X be a regular curve. Then X satisfies (5.2.102) and the prime divisors are precisely irreducible closed subsets of the form $\overline{\{x\}}$. These are in bijective correspondence with the valuation rings of $k(X)$, via the map $x \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$.

Proof. By the codimension formula (5.2.55) the irreducible closed subsets of codimension 1 are precisely those of dimension 0. Therefore the result follows from (5.2.112). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.106

Let X be a variety satisfying (5.2.102) and $f \in k(X)^*$ a rational function. Then $v_Y(f) = 0$ for all but finitely many prime divisors Y .

Proof. By definition f is regular on some open subset U of X , which we may assume to be affine. Define $Z := X \setminus U$. Then by (...) $Z = Z_1 \cup \dots \cup Z_n$ is a decomposition into irreducible components. By (4.1.74).f) $\text{codim}(Z, X) > 0$ whence $\text{codim}(Z_i, X) > 0$ for all $i = 1 \dots n$. Suppose $Y \subset Z$ is a prime divisor then by definition $\text{codim}(Y, X) = 1$ and by (4.1.57) $Y \subset Z_i$ for some i . Therefore by (4.1.74).c) $\text{codim}(Y, Z_i) \leq \text{codim}(Y, X) - \text{codim}(Z_i, X) \leq 0$ and therefore by (4.1.74).f) $Y = Z_i$.

We conclude all but finitely many Y intersect U , so we may without loss of generality assume $Y \cap U \neq \emptyset$. Evidently U also satisfies (5.2.102) and by (4.1.70) there is a bijection between prime divisors of X meeting U , and prime divisors of U .

Therefore we may assume that X is affine and $0 \neq f \in \mathcal{O}_X(X)$. Then $v_Y(f) > 0 \iff f \in \mathfrak{M}_{X,Y} \iff f \in I(Y) \iff Y \subset V(f)$. We claim $V(f)$ is a proper subset of X (for $V(f) = X \iff \sqrt{(0)} = \sqrt{f} \iff f = 0$). Therefore $\text{codim}(V(f), X) > 0$ and

$$\text{codim}(Y, V(f)) \leq \text{codim}(Y, X) - \text{codim}(V(f), X) \leq 0$$

so Y is an irreducible component of $V(f)$, of which there are only finitely many (4.1.57). $\square$

Definition 5.2.107 (Principal Divisor)

Let X be a variety satisfying (5.2.102) then define the homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} k(X)^* &\longrightarrow \text{Div}(X) \\ f &\longrightarrow (f) \end{aligned}$$

where we define a formal sum over all prime divisors

$$(f) := \sum_{Y \subset X} v_Y(f) Y.$$

The co-kernel of this map is known as the **divisor class group** of X , and denoted $\text{Cl}(X)$. We say that two divisors are equivalent $D \sim D'$ if they become equal as elements of the divisor class group. Equivalently if $D - D' = (f)$ for some $f \in k(X)^*$.

5.2.19 Algebraic Curves

Definition 5.2.108

We say an integral, separated algebraic variety of dimension 1 is an **algebraic curve** or just a **curve**.

Proposition 5.2.109 (Characterisation Regular Point on a curve)

Let X be an algebraic curve and $x \in X$. Then the following are equivalent

- a) x is regular
- b) $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is a discrete valuation ring
- c) $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is an integrally closed domain

and when k is perfect this is equivalent to x being non-singular.

In particular X is regular if and only if it is normal.

Proof. Follows exactly the same lines as (5.1.99). $\square$

Example 5.2.110

Both $\mathbb{A}_k^1$ and $\mathbb{P}_k^1$ are regular algebraic curves.

Proposition 5.2.111 (Curve has Cofinite Topology)

Let X be an algebraic curve (or just an algebraic variety of dimension 1) then X_0 has the cofinite topology.

Proof. Follows from (4.1.83). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.112 (Points on Complete Regular Curve = Valuation Rings on Function Field)

Let X be a complete regular algebraic curve. Then there is a bijection

$$\{W \subset X \mid \dim W = 0 \text{ closed and irreducible}\} \longleftrightarrow X_0 \longleftrightarrow \{k \subset R \subsetneq k(X) \mid R \text{ a valuation ring}\}$$

Further the corresponding valuation rings are all discrete valuation rings.

For an affine open subset $U \subset X$ this restricts to a bijection

$$U_0 \longleftrightarrow \{\mathcal{O}_X(U) \subset R \subsetneq k(X) \mid R \text{ a valuation ring}\}$$

where $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ is identified as a subring of $k(X)$ (5.2.18).

Proof. The first map is (4.1.84) and the second map is well-defined by (5.2.109) and injective by (5.2.20).

Let $R \subset k(X)$ be a valuation ring then by definition of completeness there is a point $x \in X$ such that $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} \subset R$. By (5.2.55) we have $\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \dim X = 1$. By (5.1.91) and (5.1.90) $1 = \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \leq \dim R \leq \text{trdeg}_k k(X) \stackrel{(5.2.54)}{=} \dim X = 1$. Therefore $\dim R = 1$ and by the same result $R = \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$. This shows that the map is surjective.

For the final statement we may use the affine case (5.1.100) and the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathcal{O}_X(U) & \hookrightarrow & k(X) \\
\parallel & & \downarrow \sim \\
\mathcal{O}_U(U) & \hookrightarrow & k(U)
\end{array}$$

□

Proposition 5.2.113

Let X be a regular algebraic curve and Y a complete variety. Then the rational maps are precisely the regular maps. In other words the canonical map

$$\mathrm{Mor}(X, Y) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{Rat}(X, Y)$$

is a bijection. Further this restricts to dominant maps.

Proof. Clearly the map is well-defined. Suppose that two regular maps ϕ, ψ are equal as rational maps. Then by definition they agree on a dense open subset. By definition Y is separated so by (5.2.61) the equaliser is a closed subset, and therefore the whole of Y . This means the map is injective.

Consider a regular map $\phi : U \rightarrow Y$ for U a (dense) open subset of X . Then $Z := X \setminus U$ is a proper closed subset of X and therefore $\dim Z = 0$ by (4.1.75). By (5.2.12) we have $Z = \overline{\{z_1\}} \cup \dots \cup \overline{\{z_n\}}$, and we may apply (5.2.88) finitely many times to lift to a regular map on an open set containing U and $z_1, \dots, z_n$. By (4.1.39) this is the whole of X . Therefore the given map is surjective. □

Proposition 5.2.114 (Image of Complete Curve either Constant or Surjective)

Let X, Y be algebraic curves with X complete and $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ a regular morphism. Then ϕ is either surjective or has image of the form $\overline{\{x\}}$ (which we call constant).

Proof. By (5.2.87) ϕ is universally closed, so by (5.2.82) $\phi(X)$ is an irreducible closed subvariety of Y . Evidently $\dim \phi(X) = 0$ or 1. Then we may use (5.2.56) or (4.1.75). □

Corollary 5.2.115 (Equivalence between nice curves and function fields)

Let X, Y be complete, regular algebraic curves. Then there are bijections

$$\{\phi : X \rightarrow Y \text{ non-constant}\} \longleftrightarrow \{\phi : X \dashrightarrow Y \text{ dominant}\} \longleftrightarrow \{\phi_* : k(Y) \hookrightarrow k(X)\}$$

All such morphisms are surjective and the degree

$$\deg(\phi) := [k(X) : \phi_*(k(Y))]$$

is always finite.

Finally the fibres are finite (i.e. ϕ is “quasi-finite”).

Proof. This follows from (5.2.114), (5.2.113) and (5.2.74).

The fibres are finite because $\phi^{-1}(\{y\}) \subset \phi^{-1}(\overline{\{y\}})$. By assumption this is a proper closed subset of X and therefore has dimension 0. So we are done by (5.2.56). □

Proposition 5.2.116

Let X be a regular algebraic curve. Then there is a bijection

$$k(X)^* \longleftrightarrow \{\phi : X \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_k^1 \text{ non-constant}\}$$

More precisely given $f \in k(X)^*$, then for $x \in X$ the function

$$\phi_f(x) = \begin{cases} (f(x) : 1) & f \in \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \\ (1 : f^{-1}(x)) & f^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \end{cases}$$

is well-defined and regular.

Proof. Recall (5.2.109) (5.2.15) that $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is a (discrete) valuation ring with field of fractions $k(X)$.

Define the open subsets $U := \mathrm{dom}(f)$ and $V := \mathrm{dom}(f^{-1})$. We claim that $X = U \cup V$. For $x \in \mathrm{dom}(f) \iff f \in \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ and as $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is a valuation ring for $k(X)$ then we have either $x \in U$ or $x \in V$.

Define $\phi : U \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_k^1$ by $\phi(x) = (f(x) : 1)$, and similarly $\psi : V \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_k^1$ by $\psi(x) = (1 : f^{-1}(x))$. By definition of projective structure sheaf (5.2.91) these are regular. Then for $x \in U \cap V$ we must have $f \notin \mathfrak{m}_{X,x}$ that is $f(x) \neq 0$ and $f^{-1}(x) = f(x)^{-1}$. This shows that $\phi|_{U \cap V} = \psi|_{U \cap V}$. Therefore they glue to a well-defined regular map $X \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_k^1$ as required.

We note that $\phi_f^{-1}(U_1) = \text{dom}(f)$ where U_1 is the second affine piece, and we conclude the map is injective.

Conversely given a morphism $\phi : X \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_k^1$ then $U := \phi^{-1}(U_1)$ is a non-empty open subset of X and $f : \frac{X_0}{X_1} \circ \phi|_U : U \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is a regular function. Evidently $\phi|_U = \phi_f|_U$, and we conclude $\phi = \phi_f$ by (5.2.113). Therefore the map is surjective. $\square$

Proposition 5.2.117 (Regular Morphisms of Complete Curves are Finite)

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-constant morphism of complete regular algebraic curves. Suppose $V \subset Y$ is an affine open subset, then

$$\mathcal{O}_X(\phi^{-1}(V)) = \overline{\phi_\star(\mathcal{O}_Y(V))}$$

where $\bar{\cdot}$ denotes the integral closure in $k(X)$.

Further ϕ is a finite (and therefore affine, and integral) morphism.

Proof. Define $A := \mathcal{O}_Y(V)$ and $B := \overline{\phi_\star(A)}$. Then

$$B = \bigcap_{\phi_\star(A) \subset R} R \quad (3.24.11)$$

$$= \bigcap_{A \subset \phi_\star^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_{X,x})} \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \quad (5.2.112)$$

$$= \bigcap_{A \subset \mathcal{O}_{Y,\phi(x)}} \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \quad (5.2.18)$$

$$= \bigcap_{\phi(x) \in V} \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \quad (5.2.112)$$

$$= \mathcal{O}_X(\phi^{-1}(V)) \quad (5.2.71)$$

By (5.2.54) $\dim V = \dim Y = 1$ and therefore $\dim \mathcal{O}_Y(V) = 1$ (5.1.49). By (3.32.59) B is a Dedekind domain and a finite A -module with quotient field $k(X)$.

Let $U := \phi^{-1}(V)$ and observe that as $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is integrally closed

$$B \subset \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \iff \phi_\star(A) \subset \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \iff A \subset \mathcal{O}_{Y,\phi(x)} \iff \phi(x) \in V \iff x \in U$$

where we have used the fact V is affine (5.2.112). This shows that there is a bijection between U_0 and the valuation rings of $k(X)$ containing $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$. It remains to show that U is affine.

Let Z denote an integral affine curve with coordinate ring (isomorphic to) $B = \mathcal{O}_X(U)$. By (...) there is a corresponding regular morphism

$$\psi : U \rightarrow Z$$

such that $\psi_Z^\# : \mathcal{O}_Z(Z) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_U(U)$ is an isomorphism. Consider the commutative

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_Z(Z) & \xrightarrow[\sim]{\psi_Z^\#} & \mathcal{O}_U(U) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ k(Z) & \xrightarrow[\sim]{\psi_\star} & k(U) \end{array}$$

as $k(Z)$ is the field of fractions of $\mathcal{O}_Z(Z)$ (...) and similarly for $\mathcal{O}_U(U)$, we see that $\psi_\star$ is an isomorphism. In light of the correspondence of valuation rings to points we see that $\psi_0 : U_0 \rightarrow Z_0$ is a bijection. As these have the cofinite topology (5.2.111) then ψ_0 is necessarily a homeomorphism. This implies that ψ is open as well as continuous by properties of the Kolmogorov quotient (4.1.35).

For $g \in \mathcal{O}_Z(Z)$ we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_Z(Z) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_U(U) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathcal{O}_Z(D(g)) & \xrightarrow{\psi_{D(g)}^\#} & \mathcal{O}_U(D(\psi^\#(g))) \\ \sim \uparrow & & \sim \uparrow \\ \mathcal{O}_Z(Z)_g & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_U(U)_{\psi^\#(g)} \end{array}$$

where the bottom isomorphisms follow from (5.2.27). This shows that $\psi_{D(g)}^\sharp$ is an isomorphism. We claim that the morphism of stalks

$$\phi_x : \mathcal{O}_{Z, \psi(x)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{U, x}$$

is an isomorphism for all $x \in U$. Suppose we have $(W, \sigma) \in \mathcal{O}_{U, x}$ and let $g \in \mathcal{O}_Z(Z)$ be such that $\psi(x) \in D(g) \subset \psi(W)$ (5.1.15). Then as $\phi_{D(g)}^\sharp$ is an isomorphism there exists $\tau \in \mathcal{O}_Z(D(g))$ such that $\phi^\sharp(\tau) = \sigma|_{\psi^{-1}(D(g))}$ which has the required image in $\mathcal{O}_{U, x}$. Similarly suppose that $(T, \tau) \in \mathcal{O}_{Z, \psi(x)}$ maps to zero. Then there exists some neighbourhood $x \in W \subset \psi^{-1}(T)$ such that $\phi^\sharp(\tau)|_W = 0$. We may choose $g \in \mathcal{O}_Z(Z)$ such that $D(g) \subset \psi(W)$. Then $0 = \phi^\sharp(\tau)|_{\psi^{-1}(D(g))} = \phi^\sharp(\tau|_{D(g)})$ whence $\tau|_{D(g)} = 0$ which shows that (T, τ) is zero.

Using (5.2.49) we see that ψ is bijective on rational points, and therefore by (5.2.50) ψ is bijective. As curves have cofinite topology (after taking Kolmogorov Quotient) we can show that ψ is a homeomorphism. As $\psi^\sharp$ is an isomorphism on a basis of open sets, it is an isomorphism of sheaves. Therefore U is isomorphic to Z and affine as required. $\square$

Definition 5.2.118 (Order of Zero / Poles)

Let X be a regular algebraic curve. For every point $x \in X$ there is a well-defined and unique discrete valuation

$$v_x : k(X)^* \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$$

because $\mathcal{O}_{x, X}$ is a discrete valuation ring of $k(X)$ (5.2.112). For r a positive integer we say that $f \in k(X)^*$ has a **zero** (resp. **pole**) of order r at x if $v_x(f) = r$ (resp. $v_x(f) = -r$).

As before define the **principal divisor**

$$(f) = \sum_{x \in X_0} v_x(f)x$$

on the free abelian group indexed by X_0 .

Definition 5.2.119

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of regular curves and $\phi_* : k(Y) \hookrightarrow k(X)$ the correspond morphism of fields. Recall that for $x \in X$ that ϕ_* restricts to a local homomorphism

$$\mathcal{O}_{Y, \phi(x)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X, x}$$

Therefore for $x \in X$ we may define the **ramification index** at x as follows

$$e_x := v_x(\phi_*(t)) \geq 1$$

where t is a uniformiser for the discrete valuation ring $\mathcal{O}_{Y, \phi(x)}$. Similarly the **residue degree** is given by the degree of the field extension

$$f_x := [k(\mathfrak{m}_{X, x}) : \phi_* k(\mathfrak{m}_{Y, \phi(x)})]$$

Observe that if x and x' are topologically indistinguishable (equivalently Galois conjugate, or equal in X_0) then $e_x = e_{x'}$ and $f_x = f_{x'}$.

Note when k is algebraically closed then $f_x = 1$ since $k(x), k(y)$ are finite and therefore trivial extensions of k .

Proposition 5.2.120 (Ramification Formula)

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of regular curves which is finite (e.g. X and Y are complete (5.2.117)). For $y \in Y$ then

$$\deg(\phi) = \sum_{x_0 \in \phi_0^{-1}(\{y_0\})} e_x f_x$$

Proof. Let V be an affine neighbourhood of y , and define $U = \phi^{-1}(V)$. Then by assumption U is affine and $\phi^\sharp : \mathcal{O}_Y(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ is finite (and integral (3.23.4)).

Define $L := k(Y)$, $B := \mathcal{O}_Y(V)$, $K := \phi_*(k(X))$ and $A := \phi_*(\mathcal{O}_X(U))$, where $\phi_* : k(X) \hookrightarrow k(Y)$ is the canonical embedding

Then by (5.2.15) L is the quotient field of B , and K is the quotient field of A . By (5.2.99) (5.2.54) both B and A are Dedekind domains. B is finite and integral over A , and therefore B is the integral closure of A , being integrally closed. Therefore we are in the situation of (3.31.10).

By (5.2.21) there is a bijection between the maximal ideals of B (resp. A) and the points of U_0 (resp. V_0). And by (...) $\phi_0(x_0) = y_0 \iff \mathfrak{M}_{U, x} \cap A = \mathfrak{M}_{V, y}$.

By (3.31.15) the notion of ramification index and residue degree coincide with the same notions for Dedekind domains. Therefore the result follows from the corresponding result for finite morphisms of Dedekind domains (3.31.16). $\square$

Proposition 5.2.121 (Degree of Principal Divisor is Zero)

Let X be a complete regular curve and $f \in k(X)$ a non-constant rational function, then

$$\deg((f)) = 0$$

i.e. the degree of a principal divisor is zero.

Proof. By (5.2.116) f corresponds to a non-constant and therefore surjective regular morphism $\phi_f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_k^1 \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{A}_k^1 \cup \{\infty\}$, which by assumption is separable. From the construction we see that $v_x(f) > 0$ if and only if $\phi_f(x) = 0$ and $v_x(f) < 0$ if and only if $\phi_f(x) = \infty$. Therefore by definition

$$(f) = \sum_{\substack{x_0 \in X_0 \\ \phi(x_0)=0}} v_{x_0}(f)x_0 + \sum_{\substack{x_0 \in X_0 \\ \phi(x_0)=\infty}} v_{x_0}(f)x_0$$

We have canonical isomorphism $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}_k^1,0} \xrightarrow{\sim} k[X]_{(X)}$ and when $\phi_f(x) = 0$ the corresponding morphisms of stalks is given by $X \rightarrow f_x$, therefore the ramification index is $e_x = v_x(f)$. Similarly when $\phi_f(x) = \infty$ we have $e_x = v_x(f^{-1}) = -v_x(f)$. It's evident that $k(\mathfrak{m}_{\mathbb{P}_k^1,0}) = k$, whence $f_{x_0} = [k(x_0) : k]$. Therefore by definition of degree

$$\deg((f)) = \sum_{\substack{x_0 \in X_0 \\ \phi(x_0)=0}} e_{x_0} f_{x_0} - \sum_{\substack{x_0 \in X_0 \\ \phi(x_0)=\infty}} e_{x_0} f_{x_0}$$

As X is complete, and so is $\mathbb{P}_k^1$ (5.2.93) then ϕ_f is finite by (5.2.117) and we are done by (5.2.120) since both sums are equal to $\deg(\phi_f)$. $\square$

5.3 Projective Varieties

5.3.1 Projective Algebraic Sets

Proposition 5.3.1 (Projective Space is Functorial)

Let $\phi : K \rightarrow L$ be an injective ring homomorphism. Then there is a well-defined injective map

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{P}^n(K) &\rightarrow \mathbb{P}^n(L) \\ (x_0 : \dots : x_n) &\rightarrow (\phi(x_0) : \dots : \phi(x_n)) \end{aligned}$$

Proof. Evidently the map is well-defined. Suppose that

$$(\phi(x_0) : \dots : \phi(x_n)) \sim (\phi(x'_0) : \dots : \phi(x'_n))$$

Then for some i we have $x_i \neq 0$ and $\phi(x_i) = \lambda \phi(x'_i)$ and $\lambda \in L^*$. Therefore $\phi(x'_i) \neq 0 \implies x'_i \neq 0$ and $\lambda = \phi(x_i/x') =: \phi(\mu)$. Similarly $\phi(x_j) = \phi(\mu)\phi(x'_j) \implies \phi(x_j - \mu x'_j) = 0 \implies x_j = \mu x'_j$. $\square$

Proposition 5.3.2 (Zero Loci in Projective Space)

Let $A = k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ be the graded polynomial ring in $(n+1)$ -variables over a field k . For a homogenous ideal $\mathfrak{a} \subset k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ and field extension K/k define the **zero-locus**

$$V_+(\mathfrak{a})(K) := \{(x_0 : \dots : x_n) \in \mathbb{P}^n(K) \mid F(x_0, \dots, x_n) = 0 \quad \forall F \in \mathfrak{a}\}$$

Similarly for a subset $Y \subset \mathbb{P}^n(K)$ define

$$I_+(Y) := \{F \in k[X_0, \dots, X_n] \mid F_d(x_0, \dots, x_n) = 0 \quad \forall d \geq 0, (x_0 : \dots : x_n) \in Y\}$$

Then

- a) $I_+(Y)$ is a homogenous radical ideal and $\sqrt{\langle S \rangle} \subseteq I_+(V_+(S)(K))$
- b) I_+ and V_+ are order-reversing
- c) $S \subseteq I_+(V_+(S)(K))$ and $Y \subseteq V_+(I_+(Y))(K)$
- d) $V_+ \circ I_+ \circ V_+ = V_+$ and $I_+ \circ V_+ \circ I_+ = I_+$
- e) $V_+(S) = V_+(\sqrt{\langle S \rangle})$ and $V_+(\mathfrak{a}) = V_+(\sqrt{\mathfrak{a}})$
- f) $\bigcap_i V_+(S_i) = V_+(\bigcup_i S_i)$ and $\bigcap_i V_+(\mathfrak{a}_i) = V_+(\sum_i \mathfrak{a}_i)$
- g) $\bigcap_i I_+(W_i) = I_+(\bigcup W_i)$
- h) $V_+(\mathfrak{a}) \cup V_+(\mathfrak{b}) = V_+(\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b})$
- i) $V_+((0)) = \mathbb{P}^n(K)$

The sets of the form $V_+(\mathfrak{a})(K)$ determine the **Zariski Topology** on $\mathbb{P}^n(K)$. We denote the topological space by $\mathbb{P}_K^n(K)$. The topological closure satisfies the following identities

$$V_+(I_+(X)) = \overline{X}$$

and

$$I_+(X) = I_+(\overline{X})$$

There is a form of the Weak Nullstellensatz

$$V_+(\mathfrak{a})(\bar{k}) = \emptyset \iff A_+ \subset \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \iff \mathfrak{a} \text{ is "irrelevant"}$$

and a form of the Strong Nullstellensatz namely

$$\mathfrak{a} \text{ essential} \implies I_+(V_+(\mathfrak{a})(\bar{k})) = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$$

Further there is a dual isomorphism

$$\{\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A \mid \mathfrak{a} \text{ radical homogenous and } A_+ \not\subseteq \mathfrak{a}\} \xrightleftharpoons[V_+]{I_+} \{Z \in \mathbb{P}_K^n(\bar{k}) \mid Z \neq \emptyset\}$$

Proof. Let $V_K(S) := \{(x) \in K^{n+1} \mid f(x) = 0 \quad \forall s \in S\}$ denote the affine zero-locus. Then $V_+(S)(K) = \pi(V_K(S) \setminus \{\mathbf{0}\})$, where $\mathbf{0} = (0, \dots, 0)$ is the origin in K^{n+1} .

- a) Homogeneity follows from definition. The relation is straightforward.
- b) Follows by definition
- c) The pair I, V form a Galois connection by (2.1.53) and the relations follow formally by (2.1.49).
- d) Follows formally by (2.1.51)
- e) Follows from (2.1.52) by considering the closure operators $\sqrt{\langle - \rangle}$ and $\langle - \rangle$.
- f) The first equality follows from (2.1.54). The second equality follows from (3.4.28).
- g) This follows from (2.1.54).
- h) Then using the affine case we may deduce

$$V_+(\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}) = \pi(V(\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}) \setminus \mathbf{0}) = \pi(V(\mathfrak{a}) \cup V(\mathfrak{b}) \setminus \mathbf{0}) = \pi(V(\mathfrak{a}) \setminus \mathbf{0}) \cup \pi(V(\mathfrak{b}) \setminus \mathbf{0}) = V_+(\mathfrak{a}) \cup V_+(\mathfrak{b})$$

- i) Trivial

- **Weak Nullstellensatz** Observe that using the affine case $V_{\bar{k}}(A_+) = \{\mathbf{0}\}$ and $I_{\bar{k}}(\mathbf{0}) = A_+$. Therefore

$$V_+(\mathfrak{a})(\bar{k}) = \emptyset \iff V_{\bar{k}}(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \{\mathbf{0}\} \iff A_+ \subset \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \stackrel{(3.13.7)}{\iff} \mathfrak{a} \text{ irrelevant}$$

- **Strong Nullstellensatz** Assume $\mathfrak{a}$ is an essential homogenous ideal then $Y := V(\mathfrak{a}) \setminus \{\mathbf{0}\}$ is non-empty and $\bar{Y} = V(\mathfrak{a})$. Because $\mathfrak{a}$ is homogenous then Y is a cone- $x \in Y \implies \lambda x \in Y$ for $\lambda \in \bar{k}^*$. We claim that $V_+(\mathfrak{a}) = \pi(Y)$ and $I(Y) = I_+(\pi(Y))$. Suppose $F \in I(Y)$ then $F(\lambda x) = 0$ for all $\lambda \in \bar{k}^*$ and $x \in Y$. As $\bar{k}$ is infinite we deduce that $F_d \in I(Y)$ whence $F \in I_+(\pi(Y))$. The remaining claims are clear. Therefore we may deduce from (5.1.2) and (5.1.13)

$$I_+V_+(\mathfrak{a}) = I_+(\pi(Y)) = I(Y) = I(\bar{Y}) = I(V(\mathfrak{a})) = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}}$$

- **Topological Closure** By (2.1.51) $V_+ \circ I_+$ is a closure operator with image precisely the closed sets. Therefore by (2.1.40) $V_+ \circ I_+$ is the topological closure (4.1.19). Finally $I_+(\bar{X}) = I_+(V_+(I_+(X))) = I_+(X)$ using d).

The dual isomorphism follows from the Strong Nullstellensatz □

Definition 5.3.3 (Projective Variety)

For an essential homogenous radical ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ we say the family

$$X(K) := V_+(\mathfrak{a})(K) \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n(K)$$

is a **projective variety** and write it as $X(K) := V_+(\mathfrak{a})(K)$. We say X is **integral** if $X(\bar{k})$ is irreducible in the subspace topology. We also define the **homogenous coordinate ring**

$$k[X]_{\text{hom}} := k[X_0, \dots, X_n] / \mathfrak{a}$$

which is naturally a positive graded ring by (3.12.12). Define the **irrelevant ideal**

$$k[X]_+ := \bigoplus_{d>0} k[X]_d$$

We may generalise (5.3.2) as follows.

Proposition 5.3.4 (Zero Loci in Projective Varieties)

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ be a projective variety and $A = k[X]_{\text{hom}}$ the coordinate ring. For any homogenous ideal $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft A$ and field extension K/k define the **zero-locus** by

$$V_+(\mathfrak{b})(K) := \{(x_0 : \dots : x_n) \in X(K) \mid f(x_0, \dots, x_n) = 0 \quad \forall f \in \mathfrak{b}\}$$

Similarly for a subset $Y \subset X(K)$ define

$$I_+(Y) := \{f \in k[X] \mid f_d(x) = 0 \quad \forall d \geq 0, x \in Y\}$$

Suppose $\pi : k[X_0, \dots, X_n] \rightarrow k[X]$ is the quotient map. Then we have the following properties

$$\begin{aligned} V_+(\mathfrak{b})(K) &= V_+(\pi^{-1}(\mathfrak{b}))(K) \cap X(K) \\ I_+(Y \cap X(K)) &= \pi(I_+(Y)) \quad Y \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n(K) \\ I_+(V_+(\mathfrak{b})(K)) &= \pi(I_+(V_+(\pi^{-1}(\mathfrak{b})))) \end{aligned}$$

The pair $(V_+(-)(K), I_+)$ satisfies the same properties as (5.3.2). The image of $V_+(-)(K)$ forms the closed sets of a topology on $X(K)$ which coincides with the subspace topology from $\mathbb{P}_k^n(K)$. Further the Weak and Strong Nullstellensatz also hold

$$V_+(\mathfrak{b})(\bar{k}) = \emptyset \iff k[X]_+ \subset \sqrt{\mathfrak{b}} \iff \mathfrak{b} \text{ is irrelevant}$$

and

$$\mathfrak{b} \text{ essential} \implies I_+(V_+(\mathfrak{b})(\bar{k})) = \sqrt{\mathfrak{b}}$$

Further there is a dual isomorphism

$$\{\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft k[X]_{\text{hom}} \mid \mathfrak{b} \text{ radical, homogenous and } A_+ \not\subset \mathfrak{b}\} \xrightleftharpoons[V_+]{I_+} \{Z \in X(\bar{k}) \mid Z \neq \emptyset\}$$

Proposition 5.3.5 (Projective Subvariety)

Let X be a projective variety, $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft k[X]_{\text{hom}}$ an essential radical homogenous ideal. Then $V_+(\mathfrak{b})(-)$ is a **closed subvariety** which coincides with the projective variety $V_+(\pi^{-1}(\mathfrak{b}))$. There is a bijective correspondence between non-empty closed subsets of $X(\bar{k})$ and closed subvarieties of X .

Conversely if X', X are two projective varieties such that $X'(\bar{k}) \subset X(\bar{k})$ then X' may be expressed as a closed subvariety.

Proof. There is a canonical graded surjective k -algebra homomorphism $\pi : k[X_0, \dots, X_n] \rightarrow k[X]_{\text{hom}}$ by (3.12.12). Then $\pi^{-1}(\mathfrak{b})$ is graded (3.12.10) and radical (3.4.50.g). Also by definition of the quotient grading on π we find $\pi^{-1}(k[X]_+) = k[X_0, \dots, X_n]_+$ so that $\mathfrak{b}$ essential $\implies \pi^{-1}(\mathfrak{b})$ is essential (3.13.7). The bijective correspondence exists by (5.3.4).

If $X' = V_+(\mathfrak{b}')$, $X = V_+(\mathfrak{b})$ are two projective varieties such that $X'(\bar{k}) \subset X(\bar{k})$ then by the dual isomorphism we have $\mathfrak{b} \subset \mathfrak{b}'$. Therefore X' may be represented as the closed subvariety $V_+(\pi(\mathfrak{b}'))$ $\square$

Proposition 5.3.6 (Principal Open Sets)

Let $X \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ be a projective variety. The Zariski topology on $X(K)$ has a base consisting of subsets of the form

$$D_+(f)(K) := X(K) \setminus V_+((f)) = \{(x) \in X(K) \mid f_d(x) \neq 0 \text{ some } d > 0\}$$

where $f \in k[X]$ is a homogenous form. Note that $(x) = (y) \implies (f_d(x) = 0 \iff f_d(y) = 0)$ so the second form is well-defined.

Proof. A generic open set $U = X(K) \setminus V_+(\mathfrak{b})(K)$ where $\mathfrak{b}$ is a homogenous ideal of $k[X]$. Given $(x) \in U$ there is some $f \in \mathfrak{b}$ and $d > 0$ such that $f_d(x) \neq 0$. Therefore $D_+(f_d) \subset U$ is an open neighbourhood of (x) . $\square$

Proposition 5.3.7

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{b})$ be a projective variety and $f, g \in k[X]$ essential homogenous forms. Then

$$D_+(g) \subset D_+(f) \iff f \mid g^N \text{ some } N > 0$$

Proof.

$$D_+(g) \subset D_+(f) \iff V_+((f)) \subset V_+((g)) \iff \sqrt{(g)} \subset \sqrt{(f)} \iff f \mid g^N$$

$\square$

Proposition 5.3.8 (Irreducible Subsets)

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ be a projective variety and $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft k[X]$ a homogenous radical ideal. Then a closed subvariety $V_+(\mathfrak{b}) \subset X$ is integral iff $\mathfrak{b}$ is prime.

In particular $\mathbb{P}_k^n(\bar{k})$ is integral.

Proof. Let $Y := V_+(\mathfrak{b})$. Suppose that Y is not irreducible then $Y \subseteq V_+(\mathfrak{c}) \cup V_+(\mathfrak{d})$ is a non-trivial decomposition into closed subsets for $\mathfrak{c}, \mathfrak{d}$ essential homogenous radical ideals for which $Y \not\subseteq V_+(\mathfrak{c}) \implies \mathfrak{c} \not\subseteq \mathfrak{b}$ and similarly $\mathfrak{d} \not\subseteq \mathfrak{b}$ (see (4.1.52)). Choose $f \in \mathfrak{c} \setminus \mathfrak{b}$ and $g \in \mathfrak{d} \setminus \mathfrak{b}$. Then fg is zero on Y whence $fg \in \mathfrak{b}$. This shows that $\mathfrak{b}$ is not prime.

Conversely suppose $Y \subset V_+(\mathfrak{c}) \cup V_+(\mathfrak{d}) = V_+(\mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{d})$ then by (5.3.2) $\mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{d} \subset \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{b} \subset \mathfrak{b}$. By (3.4.38) we have $\mathfrak{c} \subset \mathfrak{b}$ or $\mathfrak{d} \subset \mathfrak{b}$, whence $Y \subset V_+(\mathfrak{c})$ or $Y \subset V_+(\mathfrak{d})$. Therefore we conclude that Y is irreducible by (4.1.52).

Therefore $\mathbb{P}_k^n(\bar{k})$ is irreducible by the special case both $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ being the zero ideals. $\square$

Proposition 5.3.9 (Dual Isomorphism between Closed Sets and Homogenous Ideals)

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ be a projective variety and $A = k[X]$ the coordinate ring. Under the dual isomorphism

$$\{\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft A \mid \mathfrak{b} \text{ radical homogenous and } A_+ \not\subseteq \mathfrak{b}\} \xleftrightarrow[V_+]{I_+} \{Z \subset X(\bar{k}) \text{ closed} \mid Z \neq \emptyset\}$$

we have the following correspondence

- irreducible sets correspond to prime ideals
- irreducible components (of $V_+(\mathfrak{b})$) correspond to minimal prime ideals (of $\mathfrak{b}$)

Proposition 5.3.10 (Decomposition into Irreducible Components)

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{a})$ be a projective variety then the topological space $X(\bar{k})$ is *Noetherian*. Furthermore every closed subset Z has finitely many irreducible components Z_i and the decomposition

$$Z = Z_1 \cup \dots \cup Z_n$$

is the unique *incomparable* decomposition into irreducible closed subsets.

If $Z = V_+(\mathfrak{b})$ then the irreducible components correspond to precisely the minimal prime ideals over $\mathfrak{b}$.

Proof. $X(\bar{k})$ is Noetherian by using the order isomorphism in (5.3.9) and the fact $k[X]$ is Noetherian. The result then follows from (4.1.67). $\square$

5.3.2 Affine Charts

References :

- Algebraic Curves [Ful08, Chap. 4.3]
- Algebraic Geometry [Har13, Chap. I §2]

For every $i = 0 \dots n$ the subset of $\mathbb{P}_k^n(K)$ consisting of points of the form

$$\{(x_0 : \dots : x_n) \mid x_i \neq 0\}$$

may be naturally identified with $\mathbb{A}_k^n(K)$. The purpose of this section is to make this notion precise.

Lemma 5.3.11

There is an isomorphism of rings

$$\begin{aligned} \theta_i^\sharp : k[X_0, \dots, X_n]_{(X_i)} &\longleftrightarrow k[x_0, \dots, x_{i-1}, x_{i+1}, \dots, x_n] \\ \frac{X_j}{X_i} &\longleftrightarrow x_j \end{aligned}$$

Proof. The algebra homomorphism $\theta_i^\sharp$ exists by (3.9.5) and (3.7.5), restricting to the subring $k[X_0, \dots, X_n]_{(X_i)}$. The inverse algebra homomorphism exists by (3.9.5), sending $x_j \rightarrow \frac{X_j}{X_i}$. We may verify directly that these are mutually inverse. $\square$

Lemma 5.3.12 ((De-)Homogenisation)

Fix n and $0 \leq i \leq n$. For $G \in k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ homogenous and $F \in k[x_0, \dots, x_{i-1}, x_{i+1}, \dots, x_n]$ define

$$\begin{aligned} G^a &:= G(x_0, \dots, x_{i-1}, 1, x_{i+1}, \dots, x_n) \\ F^h &:= X_i^{\deg(F)} F\left(\frac{X_0}{X_i}, \dots, \frac{X_{i-1}}{X_i}, \frac{X_{i+1}}{X_i}, \dots, \frac{X_n}{X_i}\right) \\ &= \sum_{j=0}^{\deg F} X_i^{\deg(F)-j} F_j(X_0, \dots, X_{i-1}, X_{i+1}, \dots, X_n) \end{aligned}$$

Then

- a) $(FF')^h = F^h F'^h$ and $(GG')^a = G^a G'^a$
- b) $F^{ha} = F$ and $X_i^k G^{ah} = G$ where $k := v_{X_i}(G)$ is the smallest power of X_i appearing in G .
- c) For $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ a homogenous ideal the set $\mathfrak{b}^a := \{G^a \mid G \in \mathfrak{b}\}$ is an ideal.

For $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[x_0, \dots, x_{i-1}, x_{i+1}, \dots, x_n]$ define the homogenous ideal

$$\mathfrak{a}^h := \langle \{F^h \mid F \in \mathfrak{a}\} \rangle$$

Then we also have the identities

- d) $\mathfrak{b} \subset \mathfrak{b}^{ah}$ with equality when $\mathfrak{b}$ is radical and $\mathfrak{b} \subset \mathfrak{p}$ minimal $\implies X_i \notin \mathfrak{p}$
- e) $\mathfrak{a} = \mathfrak{a}^{ha}$
- f) $\mathfrak{b}$ prime and $X_i \notin \mathfrak{b} \implies \mathfrak{b}^a$ prime.
- g) $\mathfrak{a}$ prime $\implies \mathfrak{a}^h$ prime
- h) $\mathfrak{a}$ radical $\implies \mathfrak{a}^h$ radical

Proof. Mostly tedious verification

- a) Using the notation of (5.3.11) we see that $F^h = X_i^{\deg(F)}(\theta_i^\#)^{-1}(F)$ so evidently $(FF')^h = F^h F'^h$ because $\deg(FF') = \deg(F) + \deg(F')$.

The second relation follows immediately from (5.3.11).

- b) The first identity is clear. We may write

$$G = \sum_{j=0}^{\deg(G)-v_{X_i}(G)} X_i^{\deg(G)-j} G_j(X_0, \dots, X_{i-1}, X_{i+1}, \dots, X_n)$$

where $\deg(G_j) = j$ and $v_{X_i}(G)$ is the smallest power of X_i appearing in G . So

$$\begin{aligned} G^a &= \sum_{j=0}^{\deg(G)-v_{X_i}(G)} G_j(x_0, \dots, x_{i-1}, x_{i+1}, \dots, x_n) \\ G^{ah} &= \sum_{j=0}^{\deg(G)-v_{X_i}(G)} X_i^{\deg(G)-v_{X_i}(G)-j} G_j(X_0, \dots, X_{i-1}, X_{i+1}, \dots, X_n) \end{aligned}$$

whence $G = X_i^{v_{X_i}(G)} G^{ah}$.

- c) This is evident because $(-)^a$ is a ring homomorphism.
- d) The first part is evident from b). Suppose $G \in \mathfrak{b}^{ah}$ then

$$G = \sum_{j=1}^r \lambda_j G_j^{ah} \implies X_i^k G = \sum_{j=1}^r \lambda_j X_i^{k_j} G_j$$

for $G_j \in \mathfrak{b}$. Then $X_i^k G \in \mathfrak{b} \implies G \in \mathfrak{b}$ as we assumed $X_i \notin \mathfrak{b}$.

- e) Trivially $F \in \mathfrak{a} \implies F^h \in \mathfrak{a}^h \implies F^{ha} = F \in \mathfrak{a}^{ha}$. Conversely any $G \in \mathfrak{a}^h$ is of the form

$$G = \sum_j \lambda_j F_j^h \implies G^a = \sum_j \lambda_j^a F_j^{ha} = \sum_j \lambda_j^a F_j \in \mathfrak{a}^{ha}$$

for some $\lambda_i \in k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$.

- f) Suppose $FF' \in \mathfrak{b}^a \implies F^h F'^h \in \mathfrak{b}^{ah} = \mathfrak{b} \implies F^h \in \mathfrak{b}$ or $F'^h \in \mathfrak{b} \implies F \in \mathfrak{b}^a$ or $F' \in \mathfrak{b}^a$.
- g) Suppose $GG' \in \mathfrak{a}^h$ then $GG' = \sum_j \lambda_j F_j^h$ for $F_j \in \mathfrak{a}$. Then $G^a G'^a = \sum_j \lambda_j^a F_j^{ha} = \sum_j \lambda_j^a F_j \in \mathfrak{a}$. Therefore say $G^a \in \mathfrak{a} \implies G^{ah} \in \mathfrak{a}^h \implies G = X_i^k G^{ah} \in \mathfrak{a}^h$.
- h) Suppose $G^n \in \mathfrak{a}^h$, then $(G^a)^n \in \mathfrak{a}^{ha} = \mathfrak{a}$ whence $G^a \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $G^{ah} \in \mathfrak{a}^h \implies G \in \mathfrak{a}^h$

□

Proposition 5.3.13 (Projective Space has Affine Covering)

Consider subsets $D_+(X_i)(K) = U_i(K) \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n(K)$ of the form

$$D_+(X_i)(K) = U_i(K) := \{(x_0 : \dots : x_n) \mid x_i \neq 0\} \quad i = 0 \dots n$$

These are open in the Zariski topology. Furthermore under the subspace topology U_i is homeomorphic to $\mathbb{A}_k^n(K)$, with an explicit homeomorphism given by

$$\begin{aligned} \theta_i : \mathbb{A}_k^n(K) &\rightarrow U_i \\ (x_0, \dots, x_{i-1}, x_{i+1}, \dots, x_n) &\rightarrow [x_0 : \dots : 1 : \dots : x_n] \end{aligned}$$

For $F \in k[x_0, \dots, x_{i-1}, x_{i+1}, \dots, x_n]$ and $(x) \in U_i$ we have

$$F(x) = 0 \iff F^h(\theta_i(x)) = 0$$

and similarly for $G \in k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ we have

$$G(\theta_i(x)) = 0 \iff G^a(x) = 0$$

Further we have

- a) $\theta_i(V^{\text{aff}}(\mathfrak{a})) = V_+(\mathfrak{a}^h) \cap U_i$ for $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft k[x_0, \dots, x_{i-1}, x_{i+1}, \dots, x_n]$
- b) $\theta_i(V^{\text{aff}}(\mathfrak{b}^a)) = V_+(\mathfrak{b}) \cap U_i = V_+(\mathfrak{b}^{ah}) \cap U_i$ for $\mathfrak{b} \triangleleft k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ homogenous
- c) $I^{\text{aff}}(Y)^h = I_+(\theta_i(Y))$ for $Y \subset U_i$

Proof. This follows largely from (5.3.12). The relations show that $\theta_i(D(F)) = D_+(F^h)$ and $\theta_i^{-1}(D_+(G)) = D(G^a)$, so that θ_i is a homeomorphism as required.

- a) $x \in \theta_i(V^{\text{aff}}(\mathfrak{a})) \implies x \in U_i$ and $F(\theta_i^{-1}(x)) = 0 \quad \forall F \in \mathfrak{a} \implies x \in U_i$ and $F^h(x) = 0 \quad \forall F \in \mathfrak{a} \implies G(x) = 0 \quad \forall G \in \mathfrak{a}^h \implies x \in V_+(\mathfrak{a}^h) \cap U_i$. Conversely $x \in V_+(\mathfrak{a}^h) \cap U_i \implies G(x) = 0 \quad \forall G \in \mathfrak{a}^h \implies F(\theta_i^{-1}(x)) = 0 \quad \forall F \in \mathfrak{a}^{ha} = \mathfrak{a} \implies x \in \theta_i(V^{\text{aff}}(\mathfrak{a}))$
- b) $\theta_i(V^{\text{aff}}(\mathfrak{b}^a)) = V_+(\mathfrak{b}^{ah}) \cap U_i$. It remains to show that $V_+(\mathfrak{b}) \cap U_i = V_+(\mathfrak{b}^{ah}) \cap U_i$. As (5.3.12) $\mathfrak{b} \subset \mathfrak{b}^{ah}$ then $V_+(\mathfrak{b}^{ah}) \cap U_i \subset V_+(\mathfrak{b}) \cap U_i$. Conversely if $x \in V_+(\mathfrak{b}) \cap U_i$ then $G(x) = 0 \implies x_i^k G^{ah}(x) = 0 \implies G^{ah}(x) = 0$ because $x_i \neq 0$. This shows $x \in V_+(\mathfrak{b}^{ah}) \cap U_i$
- c) Suppose $G \in I^a(Y)^h$ then $G = \sum_j \lambda_j F_j^h$ for $F_j \in I^{\text{aff}}(Y)$ and $\lambda_j \in k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$. Then $F_j(x) = 0 \implies F_j^h(\theta_i(x)) = 0 \implies G(\theta_i(x)) = 0$. Therefore we conclude $G \in I_+(\theta_i(Y))$. Conversely if $G \in I_+(\theta_i(Y))$ then $G^a(x) = 0$ for all $x \in Y$ and $G^a \in I^{\text{aff}}(Y) \implies G^{ah} \in I^{\text{aff}}(Y)^h \implies G = X_i^k G^{ah} \in I^{\text{aff}}(Y)^h$.

□

Lemma 5.3.14

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{b})$ be a projective variety. Then $X \cap U_i \neq \emptyset \iff X_i \notin \mathfrak{b} \iff \overline{X_i} \neq 0$.

Proof. Observe $X \cap U_i = \emptyset \iff X \subset V_+(X_i) \iff X_i \in I_+(X) = \mathfrak{b}$.

□

Corollary 5.3.15

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{b}) \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ be a projective variety and for each affine chart $U_i \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ consider the affine variety $X^a := V^{\text{aff}}(\mathfrak{b}^a) \subset \mathbb{A}_k^n$. Then there is a natural homeomorphism

$$\theta_i : X^a(K) \xrightarrow{\sim} D_+(\overline{X_i}) = X(K) \cap U_i(K)$$

for all algebraic extensions K/k .

Proposition 5.3.16 (Projective Closure)

Identify $\mathbb{A}_k^n(\bar{k})$ with $U_i \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n(\bar{k})$. Let $Y \subset U_i$ be a subset. Then we have the following expression for topological closure

$$\begin{aligned} \overline{Y} &= V_+(I^{\text{aff}}(Y)^h) \\ \overline{Y} \cap U_i &= \text{cl}_{U_i}(Y) \end{aligned}$$

We call $\overline{Y}$ the **projective closure** of Y .

Proof. By (5.3.13).c) $I_+(Y) = I^{\text{aff}}(Y)^h \implies \overline{Y} \stackrel{(5.3.4)}{=} V_+I_+(Y) = V_+(I^{\text{aff}}(Y)^h)$.

Then $\text{cl}_{U_i}(Y) = \overline{Y} \cap U_i$ by (4.1.21) (or more directly $\stackrel{(5.1.2)}{=} V_+(I_+(Y)) \stackrel{(5.3.13).a)}{=} V_+(I^{\text{aff}}(Y)^h) \cap U_i = \overline{Y} \cap U_i$).

□

5.3.3 Galois Orbits

Proposition 5.3.17

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ be a projective variety and K/k a normal algebraic extension (e.g. $\bar{k}$). Then there is a well-defined group action

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Aut}(K/k) \times X(K) &\rightarrow X(K) \\ (\sigma, (x_0 : \dots : x_n)) &\rightarrow (\sigma(x_0) : \dots : \sigma(x_n)) \end{aligned}$$

which commutes with the affine charts

$$\sigma(\theta_i(x)) = \theta_i(\sigma(x)) \quad \forall x \in U_i(K) \cap X(K)$$

Write $X_0(K)$ for the set of equivalence classes under this action. The projection map

$$\pi : X(K) \rightarrow X_0(K)$$

is the Kolmogorov Quotient (4.1.35). In particular points $x, y \in X(K)$ are topologically indistinguishable iff they are Galois conjugate. Further closed (resp. open) subsets are Galois-equivariant.

Proof. First consider the case $X = \mathbb{P}_k^n$. If $(x_0 : \dots : x_n) = (x'_0 : \dots : x'_n)$ then $x_i = \lambda_i x'_i$ for $\lambda_i \in K^\star$. Then $\sigma(x_i) = \sigma(\lambda_i)\sigma(x'_i)$ so $(\sigma(x_0) : \dots : \sigma(x_n)) \sim (\sigma(x'_0) : \dots : \sigma(x'_n))$ and the action is well-defined. For $x \in X(K)$ write $\sigma(x)$. Then $\tau(\sigma(x)) = (\tau \circ \sigma)(x)$ so it is a group action.

For the general case if $F(x) = 0$ for $F \in k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ then $F(\sigma(x)) = 0$. Therefore $x \in V(\mathfrak{a})(K) \implies \sigma(x) \in V(\mathfrak{a})(K)$ and the action is well-defined on $X(K)$.

We need to show that two points $x, y \in X(K)$ are conjugate by $\text{Aut}(K/k)$ iff they are topologically indistinguishable. Suppose $x = \sigma(y)$ and $x \in V(\mathfrak{b})$. Then evidently $y \in V(\mathfrak{b})$. Conversely if they are topologically indistinguishable then we may suppose $x, y \in U_i$. Then $\theta_i(x), \theta_i(y)$ are also indistinguishable, so by (5.1.9) they are Galois conjugate, and so $\theta_i(x) = \theta_i(\sigma(y))$. As θ_i is bijective we deduce $x = \sigma(y)$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 5.3.18

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ be a projective variety and $L/K/k$ a tower of normal extensions. Then there is an injective map

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X(K) & \xrightarrow{i_{KL}} & X(L) \\ \downarrow \pi & & \downarrow \pi \\ X_0(K) & \xrightarrow{i_0} & X_0(L) \end{array}$$

Proof. In order for i_0 to be well-defined, we require that $\pi(x) = \pi(y) \implies \pi(i_{KL}(x)) = \pi(i_{KL}(y))$. Recall $\pi(x) = \pi(y) \implies x = \sigma(y)$ for some $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(K/k)$. Then $i_{KL} \circ \sigma \in \text{Mor}_k(K, L)$ and by (3.18.81) there exists $\hat{\sigma} \in \text{Aut}(L/k)$ such that $\hat{\sigma}|_K := \hat{\sigma} \circ i_{KL} = i_{KL} \circ \sigma$. Therefore $\hat{\sigma}(i_{KL}(x)) = i_{KL}(y) \implies \pi(i_{KL}(x)) = \pi(i_{KL}(y))$.

To show i_0 is injective we need to show the converse, which follows from (3.18.83). $\square$

5.3.4 Projective Varieties are Abstract Varieties

Definition 5.3.19 (Regular Function)

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ be a projective variety and $U \subset X(\bar{k})$ an open subset. We say a function

$$f : U \rightarrow \bar{k}$$

is **regular** at $x \in U$ there is a neighbourhood V of x such that

$$f(y) = \frac{g(y)}{h(y)} \quad \forall y \in V$$

for $g, h \in k[X]$ homogenous polynomials of the same degree. We therefore define the **structure sheaf** as follows

$$\mathcal{O}_X(U) := \{f : U \rightarrow \bar{k} \mid f \text{ regular at all } x \in U\}$$

The pair $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ is a space of functions.

Proposition 5.3.20 (Structure Sheaf of Regular Functions)

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{a}) \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ be a projective variety, $U \subset X(\bar{k})$ open and $f : U \rightarrow \bar{k}$ a function. Consider the affine charts

$$\theta_i : X_i^a(\bar{k}) \xrightarrow{\sim} D_+(\bar{X}_i) = X(\bar{k}) \cap U_i \quad i = 0 \dots n$$

where $X_i^a = V^{\text{aff}}(\mathfrak{a}^a)$ as in (5.3.15). Then the following are equivalent

a) f is regular (at x) in the sense of (5.3.19)

b) $f \circ \theta_i : \theta_i^{-1}(U) \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is regular (at $\theta_i^{-1}(x)$) in the sense of (5.1.25) whenever $U \cap U_i \neq \emptyset$ ($x \in U \cap U_i$)

In other words for each $i = 1 \dots n$ there is an isomorphism of spaces with functions

$$\theta_i : (X_i(\bar{k}), \mathcal{O}_{X_i^a}) \xrightarrow{\sim} (D_+(\bar{X}_i), \mathcal{O}_X|_{D_+(\bar{X}_i)})$$

In particular $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ is an abstract variety.

Proof. a) $\implies$ b) Let $x := \theta(\hat{x})$. There exists an open nbhd V of x such that $f(y) = \frac{g(y)}{h(y)}$ for all $y \in V$. By definition $g = G + \mathfrak{a}$ and $h = H + \mathfrak{a}$ for $G, H \in k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ homogenous polynomials of the same degree, for which H doesn't vanish on V . Then $\widehat{V} := \theta_i^{-1}(V)$ is a open nbhd of $\hat{x}$. For all $\hat{y} \in \widehat{V}$ we have

$$(f \circ \theta_i)(\hat{y}) = f(\theta_i(\hat{y})) = \frac{G(\hat{y})}{H(\hat{y})} = \frac{G^a(y)}{H^a(y)}$$

b) $\implies$ a) Suppose $x \in U \cap U_i$. We have by definition an open nbhd $\widehat{V}$ of $\theta_i^{-1}(x)$ and $G, H \in k[x_0, x_1, \dots, x_{i-1}, x_{i+1}, \dots, x_n]$ for which

$$(f \circ \theta_i)(\hat{y}) = \frac{G(\hat{y})}{H(\hat{y})} \quad \forall \hat{y} \in \widehat{V}$$

As θ_i is a homeomorphism, $V := \theta_i(\widehat{V}_i)$ is an open nbhd of x . By (5.3.13) we have for $y := \theta_i(\hat{y})$

$$f(y) = \frac{G^h(y)}{H^h(y)}$$

which holds for all $y \in V$. □

We may generalise the dehomogenisation

Proposition 5.3.21 (Structure Sheaf on Basic Affines)

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{p})$ be an irreducible projective variety and suppose $X \cap U_i \neq \emptyset$. Then there is an isomorphism of k -algebras

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_X(D_+(\bar{X}_i)) & \xrightarrow[\sim]{(5.3.20)} & \mathcal{O}_{X \cap U_i}(X \cap U_i) \\ \uparrow \text{dashed} & & \uparrow (5.1.26) \\ k[X]_{(\bar{X}_i)} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & k[X \cap U_i] \\ \frac{\bar{X}_0}{\bar{X}_i} & \longleftrightarrow & \bar{x}_i \end{array}$$

and the dashed arrow is defined in the obvious way (and is therefore an isomorphism).

Proof. By (5.3.14) $X_i \notin \mathfrak{p}$. We first demonstrate the bottom map is well-defined and an isomorphism. Consider the following commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & k[X_0, \dots, X_n]_{(X_i)} & \xrightarrow[\sim]{\theta_i^\#} & k[U_i] \\ & \swarrow & \downarrow \pi_1 & & \downarrow \pi_2 \\ k[X_0, \dots, X_n]_{(X_i)} / \mathfrak{p}_{(X_i)} & \xrightarrow[\sim]{(3.12.17)} & k[X]_{(\bar{X}_i)} & \dashrightarrow & k[X \cap U_i] \end{array}$$

where the isomorphism $\theta_i^\#$ is defined in (5.3.11).

It follows from (3.4.56) that π_1 is uniquely defined and has kernel $\mathfrak{p}_{(X_i)}$ which equals $\mathfrak{p}_{X_i} \cap k[X_0, \dots, X_n]_{(X_i)}$ by (3.12.15). Therefore we may regard π_1 as a quotient map.

We also claim that the diagonal map $\pi_2 \circ \theta_i^\#$ has kernel $\mathfrak{p}_{(X_i)}$. It is enough by (3.7.5).b) and the preceding comment to show that the composite map $\pi_2 \circ (-)^a : k[X_0, \dots, X_n] \rightarrow k[X \cap U_i]$ has kernel $\mathfrak{p}$. However this follows from (5.3.12) for $F \in \ker(\pi_2 \circ (-)^a) \implies F^a \in \mathfrak{p}^a \implies F^a = G^a \implies F^{ah} = G^{ah} \in \mathfrak{p}^{ah} = \mathfrak{p} \implies F^{ah} \in \mathfrak{p} \implies X_i^k F \in \mathfrak{p} \implies F \in \mathfrak{p}$.

The required map exists by (3.4.56), as π_1 is a quotient map. Further it is injective, surjective and therefore an isomorphism

The map $k[X]_{(\bar{X}_i)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(D_+(\bar{X}_i))$ is defined in the obvious way. It is clear the diagram commutes and so this map is an isomorphism. □

Proposition 5.3.22

Let X be a projective variety. Then it is separated.

5.3.5 Regular Morphisms

For the category of quasi-projective varieties we introduce a number of equivalent definitions of morphism. In light of (5.3.20) then b) shows a function is regular iff it is regular in all affine coordinates.

Proposition 5.3.23 (Regular Morphism)

Let X be a projective variety, $U \subset X(\bar{k})$ an open subset, Y a quasi-projective variety and $\phi : U \rightarrow Y(\bar{k})$ a function. Then the following are equivalent

a) **pulls back regular functions** ϕ is continuous and determines a morphism of sheaves

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{O}_Y &\rightarrow \phi_* \mathcal{O}_U \\ f &\rightarrow f \circ \phi\end{aligned}$$

b) **affine projections are regular** There is an open cover $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$ such that $\phi(U_i)$ is a subset of an affine chart $W_{j(i)}$ and

$$\pi_k \circ \theta_{j(i)}^{-1} \circ \phi|_{U_i} : U_i \rightarrow \bar{k}$$

is regular (5.3.19) for all $i \in I$ and $k = 1 \dots m$

c) **locally homogenous** There is an open cover $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$ and families of homogenous polynomials $\{f_{i0}, \dots, f_{im}\} \subset k[X]_{\text{hom}}$ of the same degree such that $U_i \subset D_+(f_{i0}) \cup \dots \cup D_+(f_{im})$ and

$$\phi(y) = (f_{i0}(y) : \dots : f_{im}(y)) \quad \forall y \in U_i$$

In this case we say ϕ is **regular** or a **regular morphism** of quasi-projective varieties.

Proof. b) $\implies$ a) We may assume wlog that U_i is contained in an affine chart V_i . Therefore by definition and (5.3.20)

$$\theta_{j(i)}^{-1} \circ \phi \circ \theta_i|_{\theta_i^{-1}(U_i)} : \theta_i^{-1}(U_i) \rightarrow \mathbb{A}_k^m$$

is regular as a map of quasi-affine varieties. Therefore by (5.1.39) it is continuous. Whence $\phi|_{U_i}$ is continuous by (5.3.13), and ϕ is continuous by (4.1.27).

Suppose $f \in \mathcal{O}_Y(W)$ then it is enough to show for all $x \in \phi^{-1}(W)$ that $f \circ \phi$ is regular at x . Suppose $x \in U_i$ and replace W with $W \cap W_{j(i)}$. Then by definition $f \circ \theta_{j(i)} : \theta_{j(i)}^{-1}(W) \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is regular at $\theta_{j(i)}^{-1}(x)$. Whence by ??

$$f \circ \phi \circ \theta_i = (f \circ \theta_{j(i)}) \circ (\theta_{j(i)}^{-1} \circ \phi \circ \theta_i)$$

is regular at $\theta_i^{-1}(x)$, and therefore by (5.3.20) $f \circ \phi$ is regular at x .

a) $\implies$ b) For $x \in U$ there is some affine W_j such that $\phi(x) \in W_j \implies x \in \phi^{-1}(W_j) =: V_x$. By (5.3.20) $\pi_k \circ \theta_j^{-1} : W_j \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is regular whence by assumption $\pi_k \circ \theta_j^{-1} \circ \phi|_{V_x}$ is regular. As every point has a nbhd V_x we may find the required open cover.

b) $\implies$ c) By definition there exists homogenous $f_{i0}, \dots, f_{im}, g_{i0}, \dots, g_{im} \in k[X]_{\text{hom}}$ such that

$$\phi(y) = \left(\frac{f_{i0}(y)}{g_{i0}(y)} : \dots : 1 : \dots : \frac{f_{im}(y)}{g_{im}(y)} \right) \quad \forall y \in U_i$$

Therefore we may define

$$h_{il} := f_{il} \prod_{k \neq l} g_{ik}$$

Then evidently

$$\phi(y) = (h_{i0}(y) : \dots : h_{im}(y)) \quad \forall y \in U_i$$

c) $\implies$ b) For every $x \in U$ there exists some open nbhd V_x such that

$$\phi(y) = (f_0(y) : \dots : f_m(y)) \quad \forall y \in V_x$$

Suppose that $f_j(x) \neq 0$ then replace V_x with $V_x \cap D_+(f_j)$. Then

$$\left(\pi_k \circ \theta_j^{-1} \circ \phi|_{V_x} \right) (y) = \frac{f_k(y)}{f_j(y)}$$

which is regular by definition. The family $\{V_x\}_{x \in U}$ is the corresponding open cover. $\square$

Corollary 5.3.24

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ and $\psi : Y \rightarrow Z$ be regular morphisms of quasi-projective varieties. Then so is $\psi \circ \phi : X \rightarrow Z$.

Proof. This is immediate by (5.3.23).a). $\square$

Corollary 5.3.25

A function $f : X(\bar{k}) \rightarrow \bar{k}$ is regular iff it coincides with a regular morphism $f : X(\bar{k}) \rightarrow D_+(X_0) \cong \mathbb{A}_k^1$. In particular a regular function is continuous with respect to the co-finite topology on $\bar{k}$.

Proof. This follows from (5.3.23).b). $\square$

Proposition 5.3.26

Let $X \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ be a projective variety, $U \subset X(\bar{k})$ an open subset and $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$ an open cover. Suppose that we have $f_{i0}, \dots, f_{im} \in k[X]_{\text{hom}}$ homogenous of the same degree such that

a) For every $i \in I$

$$U_i \subset D_+(f_{i0}) \cup \dots \cup D_+(f_{im})$$

b) For every pair $U_i \cap U_{i'} \neq \emptyset$ we have

$$f_{ik'}(y)f_{i'k}(y) = f_{ik}(y)f_{i'k'}(y) \quad \forall y \in U_i \cap U_{i'}, \forall k, k' = 0, \dots, m$$

Then there exists a unique regular morphism $f : U \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_k^m(\bar{k})$ such that

$$f(x) = (f_{i0}(x) : \dots : f_{im}(x)) \quad \forall x \in U_i$$

5.3.6 Local Ring

Proposition 5.3.27

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{b}) \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ be a projective variety and $W = V_+(\mathfrak{p})$ an irreducible subset. Then there is an isomorphism

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k[X]_{(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{b})} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \mathcal{O}_{X,W} \\ \frac{\overline{F}}{\overline{G}} & \rightarrow & \left[\left(D(\overline{G}), \frac{F(-)}{G(-)} \right) \right] \end{array}$$

More precisely for any affine chart U_i such that $U_i \cap W \neq \emptyset$ there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k[U_i]_{\mathfrak{p}^a} & \xrightarrow[\text{(3.7.38)}]{\sim} k[U_i \cap X]_{\mathfrak{p}^a/\mathfrak{b}^a} & \xrightarrow[\text{(5.1.56)}]{\sim} \mathcal{O}_{U_i \cap X, U_i \cap W} \\ \downarrow \wr & & \downarrow \wr \\ k[X_0, \dots, X_n]_{(\mathfrak{p})} & \xrightarrow[\text{(3.12.18)}]{\sim} k[X]_{(\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{b})} & \dashrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,W} \end{array}$$

Proof. We construct the left vertical map, and then the dashed arrow is uniquely defined.

As $U_i \cap W \neq \emptyset$ then $W \not\subset V(X_i) \implies X_i \notin \mathfrak{p}$. So by (5.3.12).d) $\mathfrak{p}^{ah} = \mathfrak{p}$. To complete the diagram we consider the mutually inverse maps

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k[U_i] = k[x_0, \dots, x_{i-1}, x_{i+1}, \dots, x_n]_{\mathfrak{p}^a} & \rightarrow & k[X_0, \dots, X_n]_{(\mathfrak{p})} \\ & \xrightarrow{F/F'} & \frac{F\left(\frac{X_0}{X_i}, \dots, \frac{X_n}{X_i}\right)}{F'\left(\frac{X_0}{X_i}, \dots, \frac{X_n}{X_i}\right)} \\ & \xleftarrow{G^a/G'^a} & \frac{G}{G'} \end{array}$$

Note $F'^h \in \mathfrak{p} \implies F' = F'^{ha} \in \mathfrak{p}^a$. Therefore $F' \notin \mathfrak{p}^a \implies F'^h = X_i^{\deg(F')} F'\left(\frac{X_0}{X_i}, \dots, \frac{X_n}{X_i}\right) \notin \mathfrak{p} \implies F'\left(\frac{X_0}{X_i}, \dots, \frac{X_n}{X_i}\right) \notin \mathfrak{p}$. Similarly $G'^a \in \mathfrak{p}^a \implies G'^{ah} \in \mathfrak{p}^{ah} = \mathfrak{p} \implies G' = X_i^k G'^{ah} \in \mathfrak{p}$, so $G' \notin \mathfrak{p} \implies G'^a \notin \mathfrak{p}^a$. Finally

$$\frac{G^a\left(\frac{X_0}{X_i}, \dots, \frac{X_n}{X_i}\right)}{G'^a\left(\frac{X_0}{X_i}, \dots, \frac{X_n}{X_i}\right)} = \frac{X_i^{-\deg(G)} G}{X_i^{-\deg(G')} G'} = \frac{G}{G'}$$

so the maps are mutually inverse. $\square$

Corollary 5.3.28

Let X be an irreducible projective variety with $W = V_+(\mathfrak{p})$ an irreducible subvariety. Then there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
k[U_i]_{\mathfrak{p}^a} & \hookrightarrow & k[U_i]_{(0)} \\
\downarrow \sim & & \downarrow \sim \\
k[X]_{(\mathfrak{p})} & \hookrightarrow & k[X]_{((0))} \\
\downarrow \sim & & \downarrow \sim \\
\mathcal{O}_{X,W} & \hookrightarrow & k(X)
\end{array}$$

In particular $k(X)$ is the field of fractions for $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$.

Proof. The vertical maps are from (5.3.27) and the horizontal maps are the obvious ones. As the top map is injective and corresponds to field of fractions we deduce that $k(X)$ is field of fractions for $\mathcal{O}_{X,W}$. $\square$

5.3.7 Dimension

Proposition 5.3.29

Projective space $\mathbb{P}_k^n$ has dimension n . Furthermore it is non-singular, normal and regular.

Proof. Projective space is integral (5.3.8) and has an open subset isomorphic to $\mathbb{A}_k^n$. So we are done by (5.2.54) and (5.1.49). $\square$

The conditions are local (5.2.79) (3.23.10). $\square$

Proposition 5.3.30

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{p})$ be an irreducible projective variety then $\dim k[X] = \dim X + 1$.

Proof. We have $\overline{X_i} \neq 0$ for some i as X is non-empty. Therefore

$$\dim k[X] \stackrel{(3.32.31)}{=} \dim k[X]_{\overline{X_i}} \stackrel{(3.13.8)}{=} \dim k[X]_{(\overline{X_i})}[T, T^{-1}] \stackrel{(3.10.3)}{=} \dim k[X]_{(\overline{X_i})}[T]_T \stackrel{(3.32.31)}{=} \dim k[X]_{(\overline{X_i})}[T] \stackrel{(3.32.29)}{=} \dim k[X]_{(\overline{X_i})} + 1$$

By (5.3.21) $\dim k[X]_{(\overline{X_i})} = \dim k[X \cap U_i] = \dim X \cap U_i$.

Finally this equals $\dim X$ (4.1.79). $\square$

Proposition 5.3.31

Let X be a projective variety and $x \in X(\bar{k})$. Then

$$\overline{\{x\}} = \{\sigma(x) \mid \sigma \in \text{Aut}(\bar{k}/k)\}$$

is an irreducible set of order $[k(\mathfrak{m}_{X,x}) : k]_s$. Further X is a *symmetric space*.

Proof. We have $x \in U_i$ for some affine chart then we may use (5.3.20) to reduce to the affine case (5.1.18). $\square$

Corollary 5.3.32

Let X be a projective variety and $Z \subset X$ a closed subset. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\dim Z = 0$
- b) Z is finite

More precisely

$$Z = \overline{\{x_1\}} \cup \dots \cup \overline{\{x_n\}}$$

for a finite number of points $x_1, \dots, x_n \in Z$.

Proof. This follows from (4.1.82) and (5.3.31). $\square$

Proposition 5.3.33

Let $X = \mathbb{P}_k^n(\bar{k})$ and $G \in k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ an irreducible, homogenous polynomial of positive degree. Then $\dim V_+(G) = n - 1$.

Proof. Let $Y := V_+(G)$ then by (...) we have $Y \neq \emptyset$. Choose an affine patch U_i such that $U_i \cap Y \neq \emptyset$. Then $Y \cap U_i = V(G^a) \neq \emptyset$ which implies G^a has positive degree. By (...) $\dim Y \cap U_i = n - 1$. $\square$

5.3.8 Valuative Completeness

Lemma 5.3.34

Let R be a valuation ring for K . Suppose $x_0, \dots, x_n \in K$ not all zero, then there exists $0 \leq j \leq n$ such that $\frac{x_i}{x_j} \in R$ for all $i = 0 \dots n$.

Proof. Recall (3.24.13) that the abelian group K^*/R^* is totally ordered by the condition $x \leq y \iff yx^{-1} \in R^*$. Choose j for which $x_j \neq 0$ such that x_j is minimal under this ordering. $\square$

Proposition 5.3.35 (Projective Varieties are Complete)

Let $X = V_+(\mathfrak{p}) \subset \mathbb{P}_k^n$ be an irreducible projective variety. Let $k \subset R \subset k(X)$ be a valuation ring. Then there exists a point $x \in X(\bar{k})$ such that $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} \subset R$ and $\mathfrak{m}_R \cap \mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \mathfrak{m}_{X,x}$.

More precisely there exists a local homomorphism $\Phi : R \rightarrow \bar{k}$ such that $\Phi|_{\mathcal{O}_{X,x}} = \text{ev}_x$.

Proof. Denote the homogenous coordinate ring by simply $k[X]$. In light of (5.3.28) we may assume that $k(X) = k[X]_{((0))}$ and $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} = k[X]_{(\mathfrak{p}_x)}$ with $\mathfrak{m}_{X,x} = (\mathfrak{p}_x k[X]_{\mathfrak{p}_x})_{(0)}$.

By (...) we may assume that $k(\mathfrak{m}_R)/k$ is algebraic and therefore by (3.18.73) there exists a local k -algebra homomorphisms

$$\Phi : R \rightarrow k(\mathfrak{m}_R) \hookrightarrow \bar{k}$$

We may assume wlog that $X \cap U_0 \neq \emptyset$ and therefore $X_0 \notin \mathfrak{p}$ where $X_0, \dots, X_n$ are the homogenous coordinates. Define $x_i := \frac{\bar{X}_i}{\bar{X}_0} \in k[X]_{((0))}$ for $i = 0 \dots n$. By (5.3.34) there is $1 \leq j \leq n$ such that $t_i := \frac{x_i}{x_j} = \frac{\bar{X}_i}{\bar{X}_j} \in R$ for all $i = 0 \dots n$.

Note that $t_j = 1 \notin \mathfrak{m}_R$ so $\Phi(t_j) \neq 0$ we have a well-defined projective point $x = [\Phi(t_0) : \dots : \Phi(t_n)] \in \mathbb{P}_k^n(\bar{k})$. For any homogenous polynomial $F \in k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ of degree d we have

$$\begin{aligned} F(t_0, \dots, t_n) &= \bar{X}_j^d F(\bar{X}_0, \dots, \bar{X}_n) \\ &= \bar{X}_j^d \bar{F} \end{aligned}$$

regarding $k(X)$ as a subring of $\text{Frac}(k[X])$ and $\bar{\cdot}$ denoting the reduction map $k[X_0, \dots, X_n] \rightarrow k[X]$. Further

$$F(\Phi(t_0), \dots, \Phi(t_n)) = \Phi(F(t_0, \dots, t_n))$$

If $F \in \mathfrak{p}$ then $\bar{F} = 0$ and therefore $F(x) = 0$. This shows that $x \in X(\bar{k})$.

We require to show that $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} \subset R$ and $\Phi|_{\mathcal{O}_{X,x}} = \text{ev}_x$, from which it immediately follows that $\mathfrak{m}_R \cap \mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \mathfrak{m}_{X,x}$.

Consider $g, h \in k[X]$ homogenous of the same degree with $h \notin \mathfrak{p}_x$. We claim that $g/h \in R$. For there exists $G, H \in k[X_0, \dots, X_n]$ homogenous such that

$$\begin{aligned} g &= G(\bar{X}_0, \dots, \bar{X}_n) \\ &= \bar{X}_j^d G(t_0, \dots, t_n) \\ h &= H(\bar{X}_0, \dots, \bar{X}_n) \\ &= \bar{X}_j^d H(t_0, \dots, t_n) \\ \frac{g}{h} &= \frac{G(t_0, \dots, t_n)}{H(t_0, \dots, t_n)} \end{aligned}$$

Evidently $G(t_0, \dots, t_n) \in R$ since R is a k -algebra. Further by assumption

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &\neq h(\Phi(t_0), \dots, \Phi(t_n)) \\ &= H(\Phi(t_0), \dots, \Phi(t_n)) \\ &= \Phi(H(t_0, \dots, t_n)) \end{aligned}$$

which means $H(t_0, \dots, t_n) \notin \mathfrak{m}_R \implies H(t_0, \dots, t_n) \in R^*$. Using the expression above for $\frac{g}{h}$ shows it lies in R as required. Further

$$\begin{aligned} \Phi\left(\frac{g}{h}\right) &= \frac{\Phi(G(t_0, \dots, t_n))}{\Phi(H(t_0, \dots, t_n))} \\ &= \frac{G(\Phi(t_0), \dots, \Phi(t_n))}{H(\Phi(t_0), \dots, \Phi(t_n))} \\ &= \frac{G(x)}{H(x)} \\ &= \frac{g}{h}(x) \end{aligned}$$

as required.

□

5.4 Arithmetic Varieties

Proposition 5.4.1

Let $\mathfrak{o}$ be a ring with quotient field k . For an ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft \mathfrak{o}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ define the zero-locus

$$|X| := V(\mathfrak{a}) := \{x \in \bar{k}^n \mid f(x_1, \dots, x_n) = 0 \quad \forall f \in \mathfrak{a}\}$$

and the coordinate ring $\mathfrak{o}[X] := \mathfrak{o}[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} |X| &= V(\mathfrak{a}_k) \subset \bar{k}^n \\ \mathfrak{a}_k &:= \left\{ \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i f_i \in k[X_1, \dots, X_n] \mid f_i \in \mathfrak{a}, \lambda_i \in k \right\} \end{aligned}$$

where $\mathfrak{a}_k \triangleleft k[X_1, \dots, X_n]$. For every $f \in \mathfrak{o}[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}$ the sets of the form

$$D(f) := \{x \in |X| \mid f(x) \neq 0\}$$

form a basis for the usual Zariski topology. For every principal open set $D(f) \subset |X|$ define

$$\mathcal{O}_X(D(f)) := \left\{ \phi : D(f) \rightarrow \bar{k} \mid \phi(x) = \frac{g(x)}{f^r(x)} \forall x \in D(f) \text{ some } g \in \mathfrak{o}[X], r \geq 0 \right\}$$

then $\mathcal{O}_X$ extends uniquely to sheaf of $\bar{k}$ -valued functions with the obvious $\mathfrak{o}$ -algebra structure.

5.5 Scheme Notes

5.5.1 Schemes over $\mathbb{Z}$

Let A be a finitely-generated $\mathbb{Z}$ -algebra, it may be expressed in the form $A = \mathbb{Z}[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}$. For any $\mathbb{Q}$ -algebra R the rational points are given by $\text{AlgHom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(A, [R]_{\mathbb{Z}}) = \text{AlgHom}_{\mathbb{Q}}(A \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Q}, R)$.

5.5.2 Closed Points vs Maximal Ideals

In the case of affine schemes there is a straightforward relationship between closed points and maximal ideals.

Proposition 5.5.1

Let $X = \text{Spec}(A)$ be an affine scheme. Then the closed points of X correspond precisely to maximal ideals of A .

For a general scheme a closed point corresponds to a maximal ideal of all affine neighbourhoods.

Proposition 5.5.2

Let X be a scheme, $x \in X$ and $U \subset X$ an affine neighbourhood, with $U \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Spec}(A)$. Then if x is a closed in X we have x is closed in U and corresponds to a maximal ideal of A .

Remark 5.5.3

However the converse may not hold- there may be maximal ideals of affines subsets which do not correspond to a closed point. As an extreme example it's possible to construct a scheme with no closed points at all. Consider a local ring A with the following ideal structure

$$0 \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_0 \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}_n \subsetneq \dots \subsetneq \mathfrak{m} \subsetneq A$$

Then $\text{Spec}(A) \setminus \{[\mathfrak{m}]\}$ is an open subscheme with no closed points.

More simply consider the spectrum of a discrete valuation ring $\text{Spec}(A) = \{(0), \mathfrak{m}\}$. Then $\{(0)\}$ is not closed in $X := \text{Spec}(A)$, but it is open (being the complement of $V(\mathfrak{m})$) and even isomorphic to $\text{Spec}(A_{(0)})$, and so (0) is closed in an affine neighbourhood.

However we may obtain some partial converses

Proposition 5.5.4

Let X be a quasi-compact scheme, $U \subset X$ an affine open neighbourhood and $x \in U$ a closed point. Then there exists $y \in \overline{\{x\}}$ such that y is closed.

Proposition 5.5.5

Let X be a integral scheme locally of finite type over k . Then if $x \in U$ is closed for U affine, it is also closed in X .

Proof. By assumption we may write $X = \bigcup_{i \in I} V_i$ where V_i are affine (as finite type $\implies$ quasi-compact). Then by (4.1.21)

$$\text{cl}_X(\{x\}) \cap V_i = \text{cl}_{V_i}(\{x\})$$

whenever $x \in V_i$ (and it is empty otherwise). Therefore it is sufficient to show that $x \in V_i \implies x$ closed in V_i .

So we may consider the following situation: $U = \text{Spec}(A)$ and $V = \text{Spec}(B)$ are affine open neighbourhoods of x , for A, B finitely generated k -algebras, where additionally x is closed in U . Then by (5.5.1) x corresponds to a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$ of A , and a prime ideal of $\mathfrak{p}$ of B . As these are both stalks of X we have a local k -algebra isomorphism $A_{\mathfrak{m}} \xrightarrow{\sim} B_{\mathfrak{p}}$, and therefore also of residue fields $k(\mathfrak{m}) \xrightarrow{\sim} k(\mathfrak{p})$. Therefore by following lemma we have x is closed in V as required. $\square$

Lemma 5.5.6

Let A be a finitely-generated k -algebra and $\mathfrak{p}$ a prime ideal. Then the following are equivalent

- a) $\mathfrak{p}$ is maximal
- b) $[\mathfrak{p}]$ is a closed point of $\text{Spec}(A)$.
- c) $k(\mathfrak{p})/k$ is algebraic
- d) $k(\mathfrak{p})/k$ is finite

In particular the closed points of $\text{Spec}(A)$ correspond precisely to the maximal ideals of A .

Proof. First we observe that $k(\mathfrak{p})/k$ is always finitely generated, so c) $\iff$ d) is simply (3.18.57). Further a) $\iff$ b) is simply (5.5.1).

d) $\implies$ a) We have an inclusion $A/\mathfrak{p} \hookrightarrow k(\mathfrak{p})/k$. We deduce that $A/\mathfrak{p}$ is a finite-dimensional, integral k -algebra and therefore a field (3.32.54).

a) $\implies$ d) As A is finitely generated, so is $k(\mathfrak{p})/k$. By Zariski's Lemma (3.32.23) it is finite. $\square$

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